Deliverable 1 - KAS Mains Syllabus Mapping & Frequency

KPSC KAS (Gazetted Probationers) mains | Built 27-10-2026 (IST) | Part of the KAS Mains Library | status: BUILD (pending independent review - see REVIEW.md)

1. Official scheme (current)

Source S1 = KPSC KAS (GP) 2026-27 Final Notification dated 31-07-2026, para 12.6 (written examination). The 2026-27 notification lists **no optional papers**.

Paper	Subject	Marks	Duration
Qualifying	Kannada	150	2 h
Qualifying	English	150	2 h
Paper 1	Essay (two essays, 125 each)	250	3 h
Paper 2	General Studies 1	250	3 h
Paper 3	General Studies 2	250	3 h
Paper 4	General Studies 3	250	3 h
Paper 5	General Studies 4	250	3 h
	Written total (merit papers)	**1250**	
	Personality Test	25	
	Grand total	**1275**	

Rules read from the same source/gazette: qualifying papers need 35% each (52.5 of 150) and their marks are not counted for merit; the Kannada and English standard is first-language SSLC level; the other papers are degree level. Candidates may answer in Kannada or English. Papers 2-5 each have three sections.

> **Labelling note on numbering:** the 2015 gazette (S2) calls Essay "Paper I", GS1-GS4 "Paper II-V" and (obsolete here) optionals "Paper VI-VII". The 2026-27 notification numbers them Paper 1-5. This library uses **GS1-GS4** to avoid confusion.

Syllabus source (S2): Karnataka Gazette Extraordinary, 08-01-2015 (11th Amendment Rules 2014). The GS, Essay and language content below is taken from it. That gazette still includes the two optional papers and a 1750-mark total, which the 2026-27 notification has dropped. The KPSC website syllabus page did not load from the box, so a current-website cross-check is an open gap (see section 7).

Essay paper (S2): Essay 1 = topic of international/national importance; Essay 2 = topic of state/local importance; 125 marks each. The 2025 paper (unofficial mirror text) carried both essays as compulsory at roughly 1,500 words each: one on a media/culture theme and one on an urban-mobility/ technology theme for Karnataka (paraphrased).

Qualifying papers pattern (S2): English = comprehension, precis, usage, vocabulary, short essay, communication skills, 25 marks each. Kannada = comprehension of a passage, word usage, precis, vocabulary, short essay, English-to-Kannada translation, 25 marks each (items 1-6 decoded from the gazette's legacy-font text; native-reader confirmation advised).

2. Paper formats seen in the four question sets

Set	Format observed (from the papers read)
2014	20 questions per GS paper, about 12.5 marks each; "not more than 150 words" (GS4: 200 words).
2015	12 marks per question, with a few 10/15/20-mark items in GS2 and GS4.
2021	10-mark (150 words) and 15-mark (250 words) items; GS4 case studies carry 300 words.
2025	Same 10/15-mark pattern (150 and 250 words). GS1 has 20 questions, consistent with 10x10 + 10x15 = 250.

So **current practice = 150-word (10 marks) and 250-word (15 marks) answers; ethics case studies ~300 words.** Prepare to that pattern (frameworks in Deliverable 2).

3. How the mapping was built

1. Every one of the **317** tagged mains questions (2014: 80, 2015: 78, 2021: 78, 2025: 81; counted by paper below) was read and assigned **one primary syllabus unit** by hand, using the S2 gazette wording. Source of tags: `trends.xlsx` (Mains_Questions), question text in the paper files. `build/mapping.csv` holds the full row-level map.
2. Questions that straddle units get one primary unit, so totals reconcile to 317 (checked by script; see section 8). Obvious cross-listings are noted in section 6.
3. "Nearest-fit" = the topic is not named in the syllabus wording and was assigned to the closest unit (20 of 317 questions). They are counted in the totals and shown in their own column.
4. Question wording is **never reproduced**: only paraphrased unit labels and the tag labels from the trends file appear.
5. Band: CORE = seen in 3 or 4 of the 4 sets; RECURRING = 2 sets; OCCASIONAL = 1 set; NOT SEEN = 0. With only 4 sets, "not seen" means **not yet seen**, never "skip".

4. Per-unit frequency

KA-specific = tagged Karnataka-specific (37 of 317). Cur.-affairs = tagged current-affairs framed (20 of 317).

Paper II - General Studies 1 (Heritage, History, Society, Economy of India & Karnataka)

Questions tagged: 20 / 21 / 21 / 20 (2014 / 2015 / 2021 / 2025) = **82**.

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS1-A1	I-1 Cultural Heritage of India (Indus/Vedic, literature, S&T, arts, religions)	0	1	4	1	**6**	7%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	0	Ancient India; Mauryas; Pallavas; Ancient science
GS1-A2	I-2 Transforming Indian society: reformers & schools of thought (modern India)	2	1	2	2	**7**	9%	CORE (all 4 sets)	1	0	0	Post-independence movements (2); Social reform (2); Social reform movements; Modern India
GS1-A3	I-3 Kadambas to Hoysalas (antiquity, Kannada language/ literature, museums/ASI/World Heritage Sites, architecture)	1	1	0	2	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	3	1	Karnataka art and architecture; Art and architecture; Kannada language history; Karnataka architecture
GS1-A4	I-4 Vijayanagara Empire and thereafter, 1336-1799 (sects, Bahmani, Sufis, Hyder-Tipu)	1	1	0	0	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	2	0	Karnataka religion; Vijayanagara

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS1-A5	I-5 Modern Mysore 1799-1947 (Krishnaraja III, rebellions, Commissioner's Rule, Hyderabad-Karnataka, Dewans)	0	1	0	0	**1**	1%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	0	1	0	Modern Mysore
GS1-A6	I-6 Freedom movement in Karnataka & Unification 1885-1956 (incl. social/cultural developments, Backward Class movement, Miller Committee)	2	2	1	2	**7**	9%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	7	0	Freedom movement Karnataka (4); Unification of Karnataka (2); Backward class movements
GS1-B1	II-1 Post-independent Karnataka (backward classes, land reforms, disputes, Nanjundappa)	0	1	0	0	**1**	1%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	0	1	0	Backward classes
GS1-B2	II-2 Social change & movements (theories, disorganisation, social policy)	0	1	2	1	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	0	Social movements; Social change; Social legislation; Social disorganisation
GS1-B3	II-3 Social change & modernisation (role conflict, women, Sanskritisation, social evils)	1	1	4	2	**8**	10%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Women (3); Sanskritisation; Education and youth; Modernisation
GS1-B4	II-4 Government & political system (legislature/executive/judiciary, parties)	1	1	0	1	**3**	4%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Party system; State legislature; Separation of powers
GS1-B5	II-5 Decentralisation of power (Centre-State, Governor, PRI, caste/regionalism in politics)	2	1	0	1	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Local government (2); Centre-state relations; Federalism
GS1-B6	II-6 Socio-economic system (Jajmani, market economy, trade unions, globalisation)	2	1	0	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Rural society; Development; Market economy
GS1-B7	II-7 Rural social system & rural development (power structure, bonded labour, land reforms, green revolution)	1	1	2	2	**6**	7%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Rural society (2); Panchayati Raj; Bonded labour; Green revolution
GS1-C1	III-1 Indian economy post-independence & Karnataka economy in plan era	2	1	1	0	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	1	0	Karnataka economy; Services sector; Industry; Growth and employment
GS1-C2	III-2 India & international economic relations (trade, BoP, Karnataka exports)	2	2	0	0	**4**	5%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	1	0	External sector (2); Trade policy; Karnataka exports
GS1-C3	III-3 Development patterns & regional disparities (SEZ, Karnataka disparities)	1	1	0	0	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	2	0	Regional imbalance (2)
GS1-C4	III-4 Planning (five year plans, Karnataka planning)	0	0	0	0	**0**	0%	NOT SEEN (0 of 4)	0	0	0	
GS1-C5	III-5 Decentralisation, state/local finance, resource devolution	0	1	0	1	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Decentralised planning; Fiscal federalism
GS1-C6	III-6 Rural development (agriculture, irrigation, marketing, infrastructure, rural social infrastructure)	0	1	4	1	**6**	7%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	3	1	Rural sanitation; Digital agriculture; Agri marketing; Infrastructure
GS1-C7	III-7 Rural development initiatives (poverty/employment programmes, CPRs, PURA, SHGs/microfinance)	0	0	1	2	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	1	1	Rural development schemes; Common property resources; Microfinance
GS1-C8	III-8 Data collection, analysis, interpretation & quantitative aptitude	2	1	0	2	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Data interpretation (3); Charts; Combinatorics
Total		20	21	21	20	**82**	100%		4	22	3	

Paper III - General Studies 2 (Geography, Constitution, Public Administration & IR)

Questions tagged: 20 / 21 / 20 / 20 (2014 / 2015 / 2021 / 2025) = **81**.

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS2-A1	I-1 World geography: lithosphere, atmosphere, hydrosphere	1	1	1	1	**4**	5%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Oceanography (2); Landforms; Tides
GS2-A2	I-2 World: continents, human races, population, migration	2	1	1	2	**6**	7%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Human geography (2); Migration (2); Population; Deserts

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS2-A3	I-3 India: physiography, climate, minerals, crops, demography	0	1	2	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Agriculture geography; Minerals; Monsoon
GS2-A4	I-4 India: industrial planning, infrastructure, regional planning, towns	0	1	1	2	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	0	Regional development (2); Industrial regions; Transport
GS2-A5	I-5 Karnataka: physiography, agriculture, minerals, power, industry, transport	1	2	1	1	**5**	6%	CORE (all 4 sets)	1	5	0	Karnataka industry; Power sector; Agro-climatic regions; Transport
GS2-A6	I-6 Karnataka: urbanisation, land use, population policy, trade	2	1	1	1	**5**	6%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	2	0	Urbanisation (3); Urban geography; Land use
GS2-B1	II-1 Nature of the Constitution (Preamble, federation, features)	1	0	2	1	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	0	Federalism; Fundamental duties; Preamble; Comparative federalism
GS2-B2	II-2 Fundamental rights, SC/ST/minority provisions	0	1	1	2	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	1	Fundamental rights (2); Rights; Caste and politics
GS2-B3	II-3 Distribution of legislative powers, Union-State relations, Governor, Council of Ministers, judicial remedies	1	2	2	0	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	2	0	0	Governor (2); Parliament; Judiciary and PIL; Trade and commerce
GS2-B4	II-4 Legislatures, delegated legislation, CAG, Attorney-General, judicial review	1	2	1	1	**5**	6%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	1	Legislature (2); CAG; Delegated legislation; Legislative procedure
GS2-B5	II-5 Important amendments, basic structure, emergency, 73rd/74th	0	1	1	1	**3**	4%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	1	Amendments and basic structure; Amendment; Basic structure
GS2-B6	II-6 Welfare mechanism: DPSP, Election Commission, commissions, Finance Commission, NDC	3	1	0	2	**6**	7%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	2	DPSP (3); Election Commission; Planning bodies; Constitutional bodies
GS2-B7	II-7 Services under the Union and State	1	0	0	0	**1**	1%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	1	0	0	Civil services
GS2-C1	III-1 Private & public administration, NPA/NPM, responsive administration	0	1	3	1	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	1	Administrative theory; New public management; Administration theory; Good governance
GS2-C2	III-2 Structure of organisation, law & order, administrative law, development administration	0	1	1	0	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Law and order (2)
GS2-C3	III-3 Organisational behaviour: decision making, communication, delegation	3	0	0	0	**3**	4%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	0	0	0	Communication; Planning and decision making; Delegation
GS2-C4	III-4 Formal/informal organisation, leadership, motivation	2	1	0	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Leadership; Organisation theory; Motivation theory
GS2-C5	III-5 Management tools (PERT/CPM, SWOT, POSDCORB, quality tools)	0	1	0	1	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Short notes; Management tools
GS2-C6	III-6 Administrative reforms, good governance, Lokpal/Lokayukta, PRI, welfare programmes, ARCs	2	2	0	1	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Monitoring and evaluation; Welfare of weaker sections; Panchayati Raj committees; Administrative reforms
GS2-C7	III-7 UN & specialised agencies, international organisations, India & neighbours	0	1	2	3	**6**	7%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	1	0	3	United Nations (2); International organisations; SAARC; Neighbourhood and BRI
Total		20	21	20	20	**81**	100%		8	7	9	

Paper IV - General Studies 3 (Science & Technology, Agriculture, Environment)

Questions tagged: 20 / 21 / 21 / 23 (2014 / 2015 / 2021 / 2025) = **85**.

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS3-A1	I-1 Basics of S&T, ICT, e-governance, digital divide	0	1	3	6	**10**	12%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	2	0	1	e-Governance (2); Big data; Digital divide; Telecom

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS3-A2	I-2 Space science & technology	1	1	0	0	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Space (2)
GS3-A3	I-3 Energy resources (nuclear, renewable, waste-based)	0	1	2	2	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	1	1	Solar energy (2); Renewable energy; Waste to energy; Nuclear energy
GS3-A4	I-4 Disasters, pests & pollution (climate change & disasters, crop science/fertilisers/pest control, drinking water, sanitation, pollution control)	0	1	2	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Drinking water; Pollution control; Disasters
GS3-A5	I-5 Related perceptions (S&T literacy, HDI, indigenous knowledge)	0	0	0	0	**0**	0%	NOT SEEN (0 of 4)	0	0	0	
GS3-A6	I-6 Knowledge society (education, gender equality)	0	1	0	0	**1**	1%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	0	0	0	Gender
GS3-A7	I-7 Rural upliftment & S&T (rural connectivity, regional language in ICT, horticulture, agro-food processing, bio-fuel cultivation, scientific water harvesting)	0	0	1	0	**1**	1%	OCCASIONAL (1 of 4)	1	0	0	Agri technology
GS3-B1	II-1 Natural science (plants, animals, microorganisms)	1	1	0	0	**2**	2%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Biology; Microbiology
GS3-B2	II-2 Agriculture science (agri scenario, crop production/protection, fertilisers & vermicompost, revolutions, organic farming, post-harvest, land & water management)	2	1	2	1	**6**	7%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Green revolution; Post-harvest technology; Vermicompost; Agriculture economy
GS3-B3	II-3 Horticulture (incl. hi-tech/poly-house) & sericulture	2	1	0	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	1	0	Sericulture (2); Protected cultivation
GS3-B4	II-4 Biotechnology (GM crops, genetic engineering, biofertilisers/ biofuels)	1	2	0	2	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	1	Biotechnology; Biofuels; GM crops; GMOs
GS3-B5	II-5 Animal husbandry, dairy (KMF/AMUL), fisheries	0	1	2	1	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	2	0	Dairy (2); Livestock; Fisheries
GS3-B6	II-6 Agriculture policies, programmes, price policy, watershed, trade	2	1	2	0	**5**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	1	0	Watershed (2); Agri pricing (2); Farmer welfare
GS3-B7	II-7 Health & hygiene (diseases, vaccines, national programmes)	1	1	1	2	**5**	6%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	2	Health (3); Vaccines (2)
GS3-C1	III-1 Environmental segments: forest conservation, wildlife, Project Tiger, parks/sanctuaries, mining impact, Red Data Book, eco-tourism	3	1	0	0	**4**	5%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	1	0	Protected areas (2); Western Ghats; Red list
GS3-C2	III-2 Natural resources: forests, water, land, waste water, rainwater harvesting	2	1	1	1	**5**	6%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	1	0	Water resources; Resources; Rainwater harvesting; Waste water
GS3-C3	III-3 Ecosystem & biodiversity, hotspots, IPR	1	2	2	1	**6**	7%	CORE (all 4 sets)	1	0	0	Biodiversity (3); Carbon cycle; IPR and forestry; Ecosystems
GS3-C4	III-4 Pollution & solid waste management, environmental laws	0	2	2	4	**8**	9%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	2	1	1	Bioremediation (2); Air pollution (2); Solid waste; Water quality
GS3-C5	III-5 IT in environment & health; global issues (climate change, acid rain, wasteland, watershed, river linking, water crisis)	2	1	0	3	**6**	7%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	1	Climate change (2); River linking (2); IT and health; Wasteland
GS3-C6	III-6 State-community-civil society interface, JFM, displacement & rehabilitation, disaster mgmt, ozone/CFC, carbon credit	2	1	1	0	**4**	5%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	1	Ozone; Forests; Ozone and Kigali; Joint forest management
Total		20	21	21	23	**85**	100%		6	8	8	

Paper V - General Studies 4 (Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude)

Questions tagged: 20 / 15 / 16 / 18 (2014 / 2015 / 2021 / 2025) = **69**.

Unit	Syllabus unit (paraphrased label)	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total	% of paper	Band	Nearest-fit	KA-specific	Cur.-affairs	Recurring sub-themes (tag labels)
GS4-E1	I-a Essence, determinants, dimensions of ethics; ethics in private/public relationships	2	1	0	0	**3**	4%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (3)
GS4-E2	I-b Ethics in public administration, dilemmas, laws/rules/ conscience as guidance	1	1	0	2	**4**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (4)
GS4-E3	I-c Accountability & ethical governance, ethical issues in IR, corporate governance	2	1	1	0	**4**	6%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (4)
GS4-E4	I-d Public service, RTI/transparency, codes, citizen charters, service delivery, public funds, corruption	5	1	1	0	**7**	10%	CORE (3 of 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (5); Public service reforms; Civil service code
GS4-E5	I-e Human values, lessons from leaders, role of family/society/ education	2	1	2	1	**6**	9%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (6)
GS4-I	II Integrity, impartiality, objectivity, dedication, empathy, tolerance & compassion	2	5	5	5	**17**	25%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (17)
GS4-T1	III-a Aptitude/foundational values, attitude, thought & behaviour, social influence & persuasion	4	4	4	2	**14**	20%	CORE (all 4 sets)	0	0	0	Ethics concepts (12); Social influence; Persuasion
GS4-T2	III-b Emotional intelligence, contributions of moral thinkers	2	1	1	2	**6**	9%	CORE (all 4 sets)	2	0	0	Ethics concepts (4); Political thought; Swadeshi movement
GS4-CS	III-c Case studies on the above	0	0	2	6	**8**	12%	RECURRING (2 of 4)	0	0	0	Case study (8)
Total		20	15	16	18	**69**	100%		2	0	0	

5. What the pattern says (all numbers from the tables above)

- **GS1 - seen in all four sets:** GS1-A2 (I-2 Transforming Indian society: reformers & schools of thought) [7]; GS1-A6 (I-6 Freedom movement in Karnataka & Unification 1885-1956) [7]; GS1-B3 (II-3 Social change & modernisation) [8]; GS1-B7 (II-7 Rural social system & rural development) [6]
- **GS1 - seen in only one set:** GS1-A5 (I-5 Modern Mysore 1799-1947) [1]; GS1-B1 (II-1 Post-independent Karnataka) [1]
- **GS1 - not seen in any tagged set:** GS1-C4 (III-4 Planning) [0]
- **GS2 - seen in all four sets:** GS2-A1 (I-1 World geography: lithosphere, atmosphere, hydrosphere) [4]; GS2-A2 (I-2 World: continents, human races, population, migration) [6]; GS2-A5 (I-5 Karnataka: physiography, agriculture, minerals, power, industry, transport) [5]; GS2-A6 (I-6 Karnataka: urbanisation, land use, population policy, trade) [5]; GS2-B4 (II-4 Legislatures, delegated legislation, CAG, Attorney-General, judicial review) [5]
- **GS2 - seen in only one set:** GS2-B7 (II-7 Services under the Union and State) [1]; GS2-C3 (III-3 Organisational behaviour: decision making, communication, delegation) [3]
- **GS2 - not seen in any tagged set:** none
- **GS3 - seen in all four sets:** GS3-B2 (II-2 Agriculture science) [6]; GS3-B7 (II-7 Health & hygiene) [5]; GS3-C2 (III-2 Natural resources: forests, water, land, waste water, rainwater harvesting) [5]; GS3-C3 (III-3 Ecosystem & biodiversity, hotspots, IPR) [6]
- **GS3 - seen in only one set:** GS3-A6 (I-6 Knowledge society) [1]; GS3-A7 (I-7 Rural upliftment & S&T) [1]
- **GS3 - not seen in any tagged set:** GS3-A5 (I-5 Related perceptions) [0]
- **GS4 - seen in all four sets:** GS4-E5 (I-e Human values, lessons from leaders, role of family/society/education) [6]; GS4-I (II Integrity, impartiality, objectivity, dedication, empathy, tolerance & compassion) [17]; GS4-T1 (III-a Aptitude/foundational values, attitude, thought & behaviour, social influence & persuasion) [14]; GS4-T2 (III-b Emotional intelligence, contributions of moral thinkers) [6]
- **GS4 - seen in only one set:** none
- **GS4 - not seen in any tagged set:** none

Reading it: - **GS4 is concentrated.** Integrity and aptitude units (GS4-I, GS4-T1) account for 31 of 69 questions (45%); case studies jumped from 0 in 2014/2015 to 2 in 2021 and 6 in 2025. - **GS1 is Karnataka-heavy:** 22 of its 82 questions are Karnataka-tagged, mostly the Freedom/Unification unit, Kadamba-Hoysala heritage and rural development. GS1-A6 appears in every set. - **GS3 shifted toward ICT, health and pollution** (GS3-A1 rose 0, 1, 3, 6 across the four sets; GS3-C4 rose 0, 2, 2, 4). - **GS2-C7 (UN/IR/neighbours) grew 0, 1, 2, 3** while the management units GS2-C3/C4 appeared mainly in 2014. - Plain unseen units: GS1-C4 (Planning) and GS3-A5 (Related perceptions) have zero questions in four sets; treat them as low-cost "read once" units, not as dead.

6. Cross-listings & caveats (so nothing is double-counted or missed)

- Syllabus items appearing in two places: Nanjundappa report (GS1-B1 and GS1-C3); State/Finance Commission (GS1-B5 and GS1-C5; GS2-B6); Sufis (GS1-A1 and GS1-A4); DPSP (GS2-B1 and GS2-B6); responsive administration (GS2-C1 and GS2-C6); Panchayati Raj (GS1-B5, GS1-B7, GS2-B5, GS2-C6); watershed (GS3-B6 and GS3-C5); fertilisers (GS3-A4 and GS3-B2); biofuels (GS3-A7 and GS3-B4); disaster management (GS3-A4 and GS3-C6); ozone/CFC sits only in GS3-C6. Each question has one primary unit here; study both places.
- 2014 GS4 Q5-Q6 (political thought; swadeshi) fit no GS4 unit closely and are placed in GS4-T2 as nearest fit.
- 2021 GS1 Q13 and some 2021 GS2 items had truncated text, so they were mapped from the tag subtopic and are flagged nearest-fit.
- 2014 and 2025 paper text comes from unofficial re-hosts (2025 is OCR); 2015 and 2021 are official KPSC files. Treat 2025 unit assignments as accurate to the topic level only.
- The 2021 essay paper text is unreadable (OCR), so the essay paper is not mapped here; essay patterns are in Deliverable 5.

7. Sources & gaps

- S1 KPSC KAS (GP) 2026-27 Final Notification (31-07-2026), para 12.6. Local copy: `sources/notif.pdf`.
- S2 Karnataka Gazette Extraordinary 08-01-2015, mains syllabus. Local copy: `sources/syllabus_gs.pdf`.
- S3 `/workspace/kpsc-prediction/trends/trends.xlsx` (317 tagged mains questions) and the paper text files.
- Gaps: kpsc.kar.nic.in/Syllabus unreachable from the box (HTTP 301/500), so any post-2015 change to the GS syllabus wording is unverified; only four sets have question-level tags; no mains set between 2015 and 2021, or 2022-24, is tagged.

8. Reconciliation (scripted)

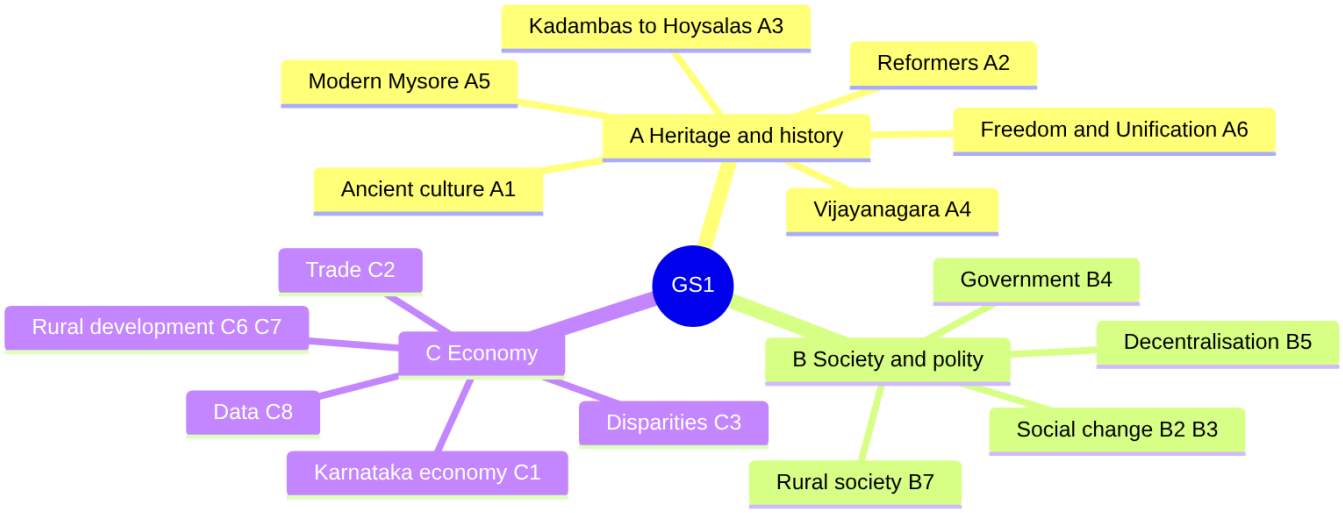
Total questions mapped: **317** = GS1 82 + GS2 81 + GS3 85 + GS4 69. Every (year, paper, qno) key in the trends file appears exactly once in `build/mapping.csv`, and every unit total in section 4 sums to its paper total. Nearest-fit = 20.

Deliverable 2 - KAS Mains Answer-Writing Frameworks (the chai-table version)

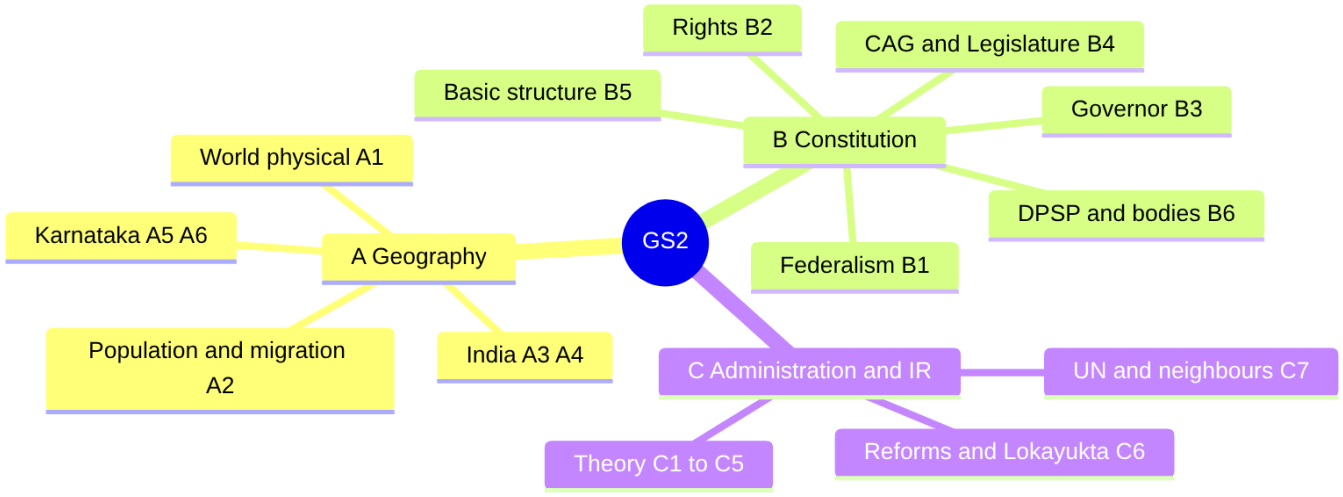
KAS (KPSC) mains | Built 27-10-2026 (IST) | Part 2 of 8 of the KAS Mains Library | status: pending independent review (REVIEW.md)

Library progress: 2 of 8 deliverables in your hands. Keep going, the next ones build on this.

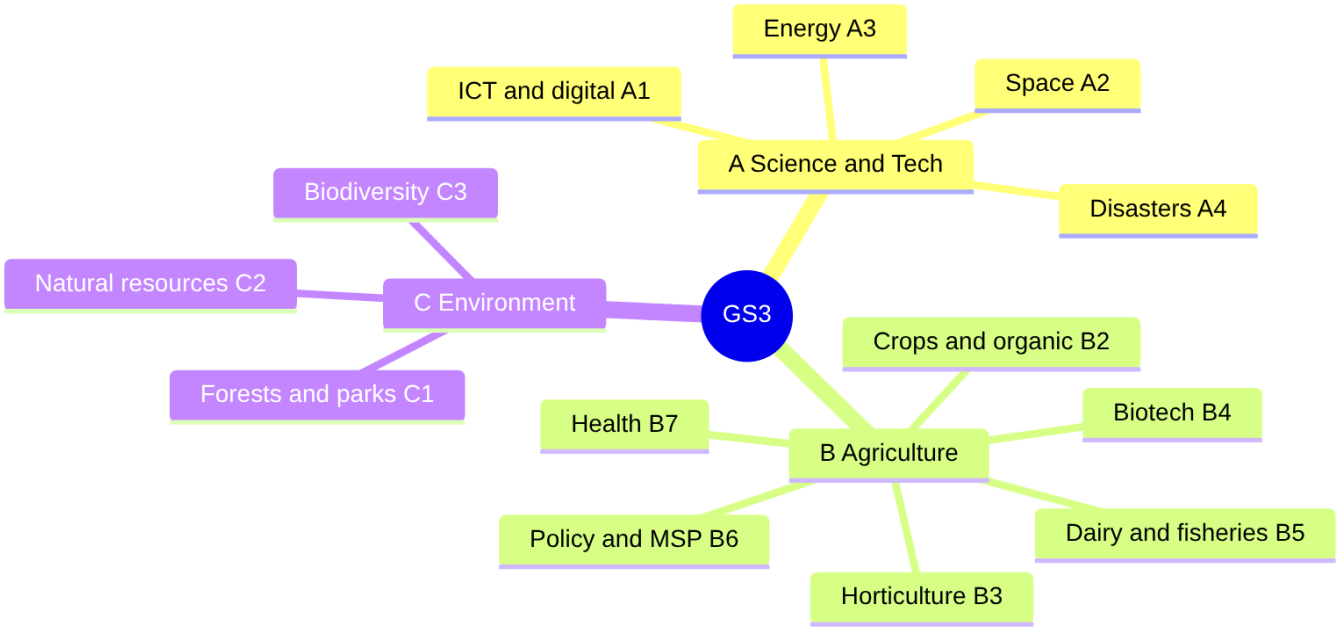
CHAI-TALK: Think of this chapter as a friend explaining over filter coffee (or chai, your call) how to stop knowing the answer and start writing it in 7 minutes flat. No predictions of any specific question here. Only methods. The numbers come from the official scheme: **150 words = 10 marks, 250 words = 15 marks, ethics case studies up to 300 words**, and each GS paper is **250 marks in 3 hours** (KPSC notification 31-07-2026, para 12.6).



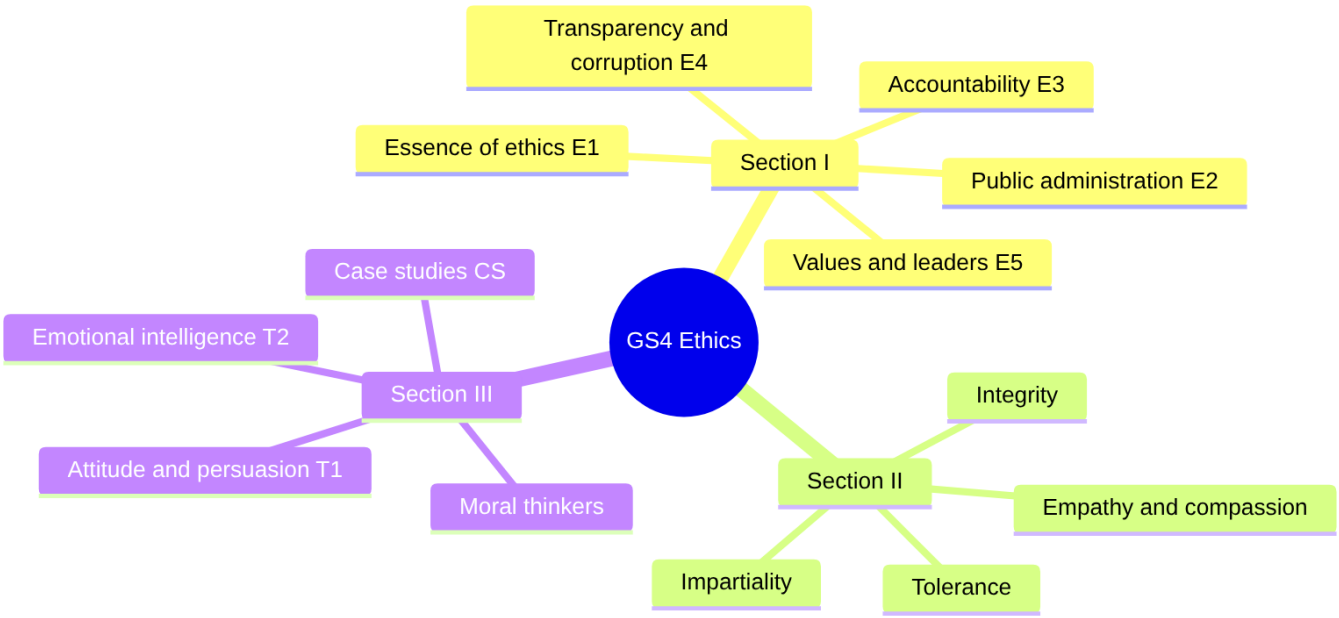
Map 1: GS1 units. Deliverable 1 tells you how often each one appeared.



Map 2: GS2 units (geography, Constitution, administration and IR).



Map 3: GS3 units (science and technology, agriculture, environment).



Map 4: GS4 ethics units (three syllabus sections plus case studies).

1. The clock is your boss (time and word budget)

Let us do the maths once, then never worry again. - One GS paper = 250 marks in 180 minutes = **0.72 minute per mark**. - **10-mark / 150-word answer = 7 minutes**: read 30 sec, plan 60 sec, write 5 min, check 30 sec. - **15-mark / 250-word answer = 11 minutes**: read 30 sec, plan 90 sec, write 8.5 min, check 1 min. - Illustration only (not the confirmed 2026 mix): 10 answers of 10 marks plus 10 of 15 marks need 10 x 7 + 10 x 11 = 180 minutes, with **zero spare time**. So train yourself to finish 10-markers in about 6 minutes and bank the saved time. - On exam day, count the 150-word and 250-word questions first, then recompute: minutes = marks x 0.72. - Handwriting benchmark: 250 words need roughly 8-9 minutes at 30 words a minute. Test your own speed once with a timer; Deliverable 8 has the self-evaluation sheet. - The paper says "not more than". A small overshoot is tolerated in practice, but the rubric (Deliverable 8) deducts for big ones. Writing 400 words for a 250-word question is the classic way to lose the next question.

> **PEAK FACT:** 0.72 minute per mark. Burn this number into your brain. Every time you feel like adding "one more point" to an answer, ask: does this extra point cost more than 0.72 minute per mark it could earn?

2. The one skeleton that fits every answer: I-B-C-W-F

Intro, Body, Challenges, Way forward, Finish. Say it as "I Be Confident, Win Finally".



Part	150 words	250 words	What goes in
Intro	2 lines (~25 w)	3 lines (~40 w)	A defined term, or a constitutional/legal anchor, or one precise fact. No storytelling.
Body	~75 w	~120 w	3 dimensions (150 w) or 4-5 (250 w). Each = bold lead phrase + one supporting fact.
Challenges	~25 w	~45 w	Only if the directive says examine/evaluate/critically analyse. Otherwise fold into the body.
Way forward	~25 w	~45 w	2-3 specific steps: who does what. No slogans.
Finish	1 line	1 line	Link back to the question, a constitutional value, or an SDG.

Dimension menu (pick 3-5 that fit): **Historical, Constitutional/Legal, Political, Administrative, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, Ethical, International, Karnataka/regional.** On a Karnataka-flavoured question, one dimension must be a **Karnataka example with a number and its source**.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "I Be Confident, Win Finally" = **I**ntro, **B**ody, **C**hallenges, **W**ay forward, **F**inish. Five letters, five paragraphs, one answer.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Starting with "India is a diverse country...". It burns two lines and earns nothing. Your first line must contain a term, an Article/Act or a fact. Always.

3. Directive words: what is the examiner really asking?

Directive	What they want	What to change in your skeleton
Define / What is	Precise meaning and features	Definition + 3 features + 1 example. No way forward needed.
Describe / Explain	A process or concept in clear sequence	Order logically; cause, then effect.
Discuss	Several sides, balanced	Dimensions with merits and limits, then a short conclusion.
Examine	Probe cause, extent, validity	Evidence for and against; one judgement line.
Analyse	Break it into parts and relate them	Components, relationships, then the pattern.
Evaluate / Assess	Weigh success against criteria	State criteria, score each, give a verdict.
Critically analyse / Comment	Strengths and weaknesses plus your stand	40% merits, 40% flaws, 20% stand + fix.
Justify / Do you agree	Take a side	Stand in line 1; 3 arguments; answer the strongest counter.
Distinguish / Compare	Differences	A small 2-column table (fine in an answer booklet) or parallel sentences.
Suggest / How can	Solutions	70% of the words on measures: by whom, funded how, measured how.
Short notes	A concept in 150 words	Definition, origin/legal basis, features, significance, limitation.
Illustrate / With examples	Cases	At least 2 named examples, one from Karnataka if possible.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** Directive words fall in three buckets. **Tell me** (define, describe, explain), **weigh it** (examine, evaluate, critically analyse, justify) and **fix it** (suggest, how can). Spot the bucket, pick the proportions.

4. Paper playbooks (one trick per paper)

GS1: history, culture, society, economy

- **History and culture:** chronology + contribution + significance. For each dynasty or movement: when, one lasting contribution (monument, text, institution), and the legacy. Name a monument or text only if you are sure of it (Deliverable 3 shows safe ones).
- **Karnataka unification and freedom movement** (seen in all four tagged sets; Deliverable 1): keep a short timeline from a standard textbook: early associations, Congress sessions, the Ekikarana movement, the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 (enlarged Mysore State formed 1 November 1956), renamed Karnataka on 1 November 1973. Check each date in your own textbook; this library does not reproduce a full history timeline.
- **Society:** define the concept (Sanskritisation = M.N. Srinivas), give the Indian context, add a Karnataka or rural example, finish with policy.
- **Economy and rural development:** diagnosis, scheme, gap, fix. Every scheme needs its launch year and ministry.
- **Data interpretation** (about 6% of GS1 in the tagged sets; unit GS1-C8): do the sum in the margin, show the formula, write the answer with units. No essay.

GS2: geography, Constitution, administration, IR

- **Geography:** process, pattern, implication. Add one labelled sketch for any 250-word answer (2 minutes max).
- **Constitution:** Article, doctrine, case, reform. Quote the Article number and the leading case only if certain: Kesavananda Bharati (1973) for basic structure; Minerva Mills (1980) for the FR-DPSP balance; S.R. Bommai (1994) on Article 356; Maneka Gandhi (1978) on Article 21.
- **Public administration:** name the thinker (Weber, Taylor, Fayol, Simon, Maslow, Herzberg, McGregor) and the Indian application (2nd ARC report).
- **IR:** interest, institution, instrument. Use dossier numbers only for events you have checked.

GS3: science, agriculture, environment

- **S&T:** concept, application, status, risk, policy. One Indian example with a year. Define every jargon word in a line.
- **Agriculture:** problem, technology, policy support, Karnataka status (Survey figures in Deliverable 6).
- **Environment:** cause, impact, law, community. Name the Act and year: Environment (Protection) Act 1986; Water Act 1974; Air Act 1981; Wild Life (Protection) Act 1972; Forest (Conservation) Act 1980; Biological Diversity Act 2002.

GS4: ethics

- **Concept answers:** definition, thinker/value, public-service example, limit.
- **Case studies:** use SDRAT (section 6).
- **300-word case split:** stakeholders 20%, options 30%, chosen action with steps 35%, ethical justification 15%.

> **RECAP:** Each paper has a one-line formula. GS1: when-what-why it mattered. GS2: Article-doctrine-case-reform. GS3: concept-use-risk-policy. GS4: value-thinker-example-limit.

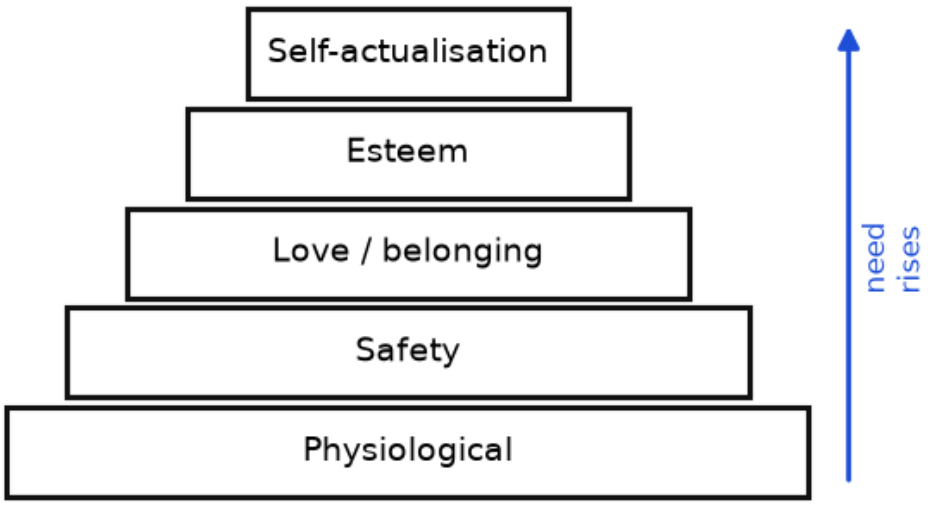
5. Diagrams: draw less, draw smart

Rule: **at most 1 diagram per 250-word answer, 90 seconds to draw.** Good targets: cause-effect chains, a Centre-State arrow diagram, a Venn for "formal vs informal", a ladder for Maslow, a sketch map for geography. Use plain black-and-blue pen sketches with labelled axes and units. Underline only keywords (Articles, Acts, case names, schemes); over-underlining kills the signal.

Here are the sketches you can reproduce by hand in the exam hall. Each one is deliberately simple: boxes, arrows, one label.

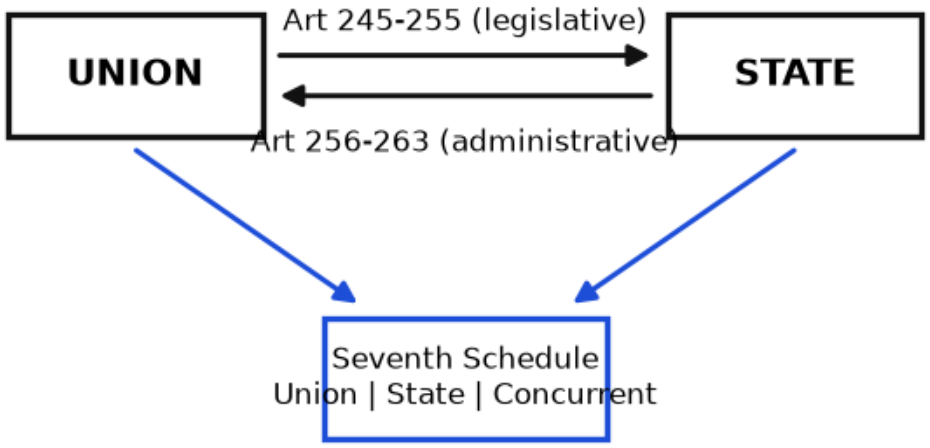
> **DRAW IT:** Practise each of these once with a pen and a timer. If it takes more than 90 seconds, simplify it.

Maslow ladder: draw as 5 stacked bars (60 seconds)



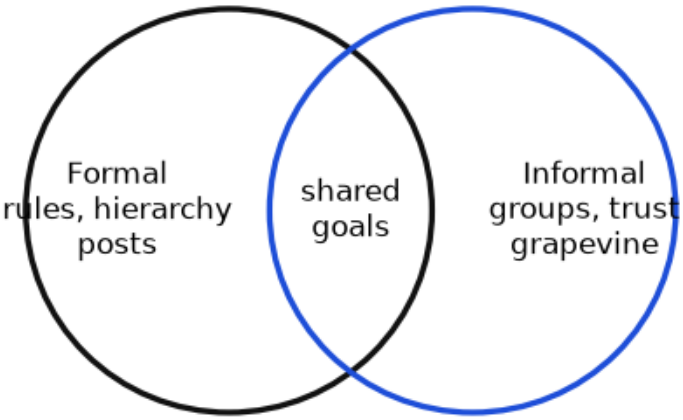
Use for: motivation, public service motivation, welfare schemes (Deliverable 3, GS2 C-unit answers).

Centre-State: draw as 3 boxes + double arrows



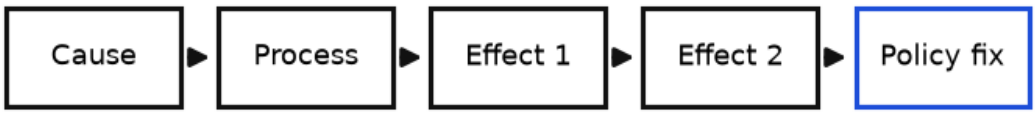
Use for: federalism, Governor, Finance Commission answers.

Venn: formal vs informal organisation



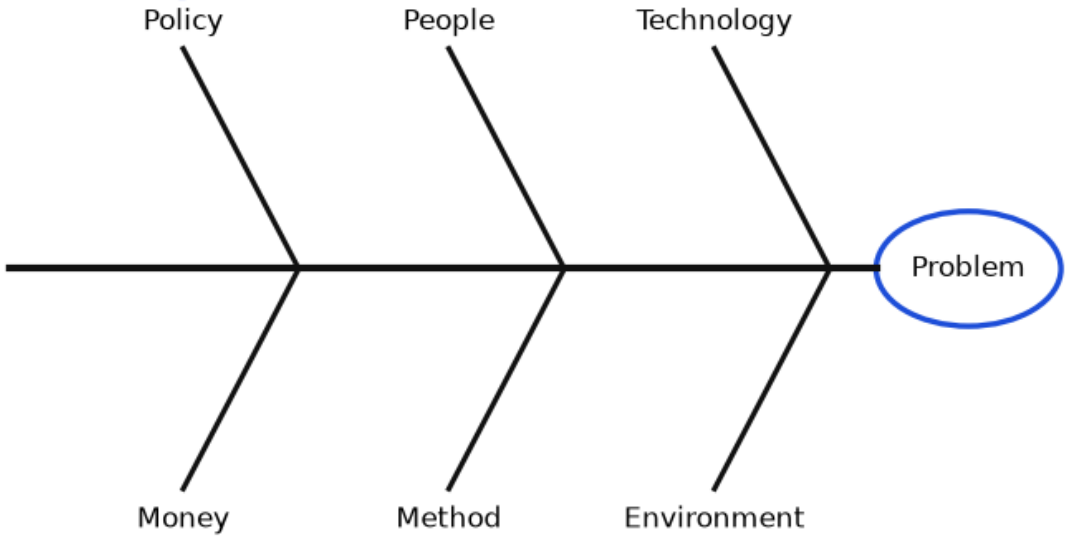
Use for: formal/informal organisation, compare-and-contrast answers.

Cause - effect chain (works for any "why/impact" answer)



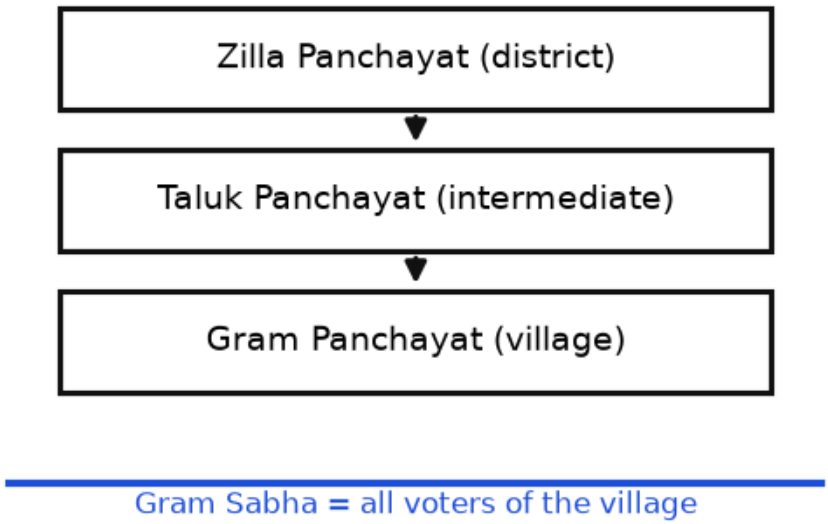
Use for: urbanisation, migration, pollution, digital divide answers.

Fishbone: problem at the head, 4-6 causes on bones

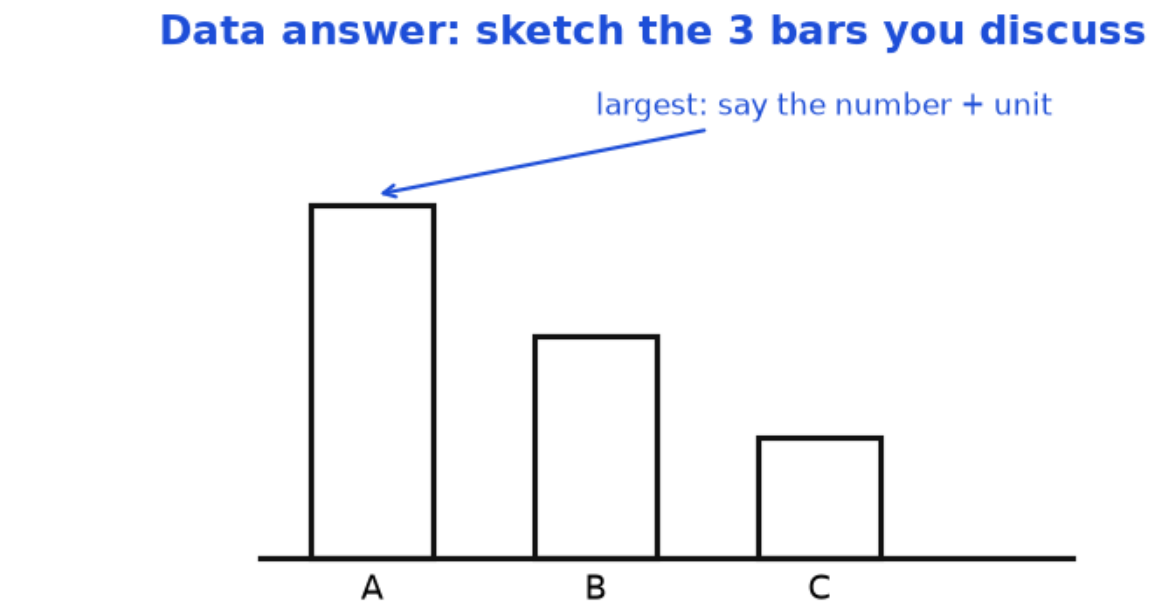


Use for: why a scheme/system fails (administration, governance answers).

Panchayat Raj: 3 boxes + Gram Sabha base



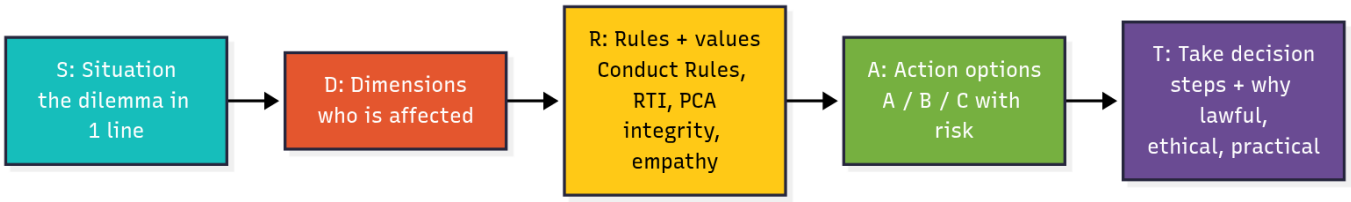
Use for: 73rd Amendment, rural governance answers.



Use for: GS1-C8 data interpretation; label axes and units.

COMMON TRAP: The "pretty infographic" trap. Examiners reward a legible, labelled sketch that supports a sentence in your answer. A coloured poster without a sentence earns nothing and eats 3 minutes.

6. SDRAT: the ethics case-study solver (300 words)

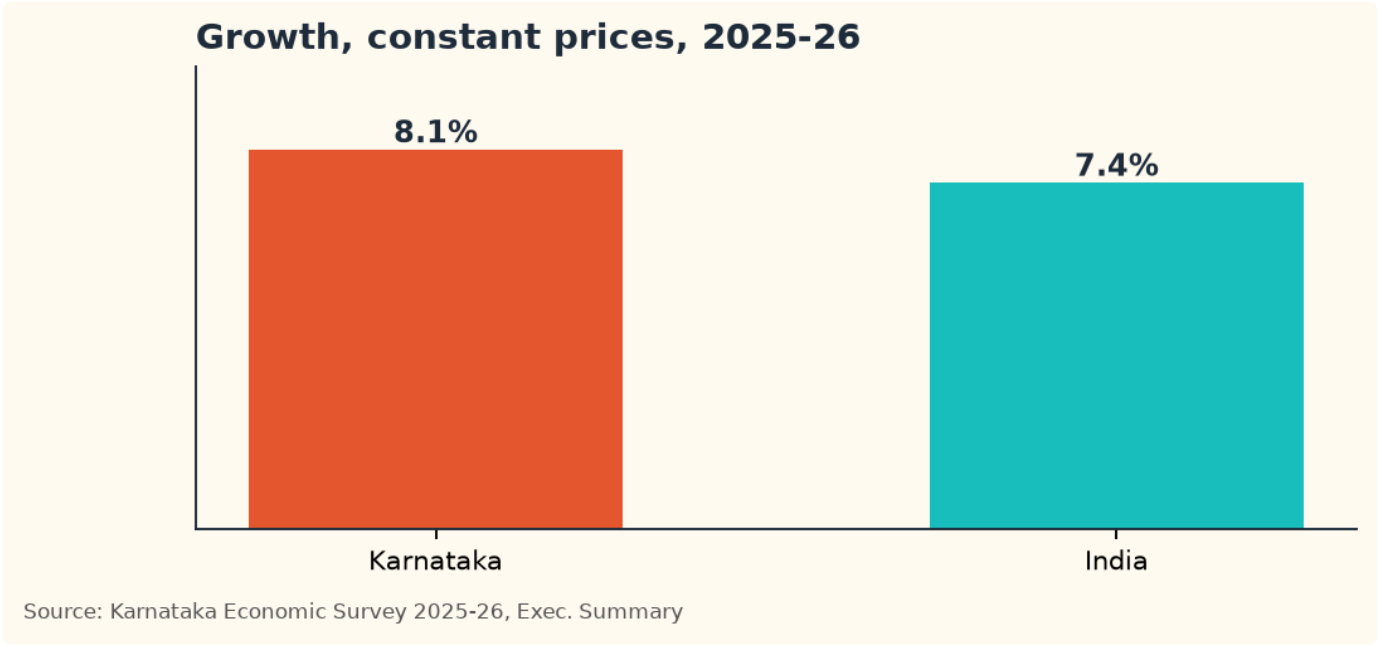


1. **S - Situation (2 lines):** the central dilemma in one sentence.
2. **D - Dimensions / stakeholders:** who is affected (you as officer, subordinate, complainant, public, department, politician, media), one line each on their interest.
3. **R - Rules and values:** legal rules (Conduct Rules, RTI Act, Prevention of Corruption Act, citizen's charter) and values (integrity, impartiality, objectivity, empathy, accountability).
4. **A - Action options (3):** options A, B, C, each with one merit and one risk.
5. **T - Take the decision and justify:** choose one; give steps (immediate, short term, systemic); one line each on why it is lawful, ethical and practical. Write "Option chosen" in the margin so the examiner finds your decision in 5 seconds.

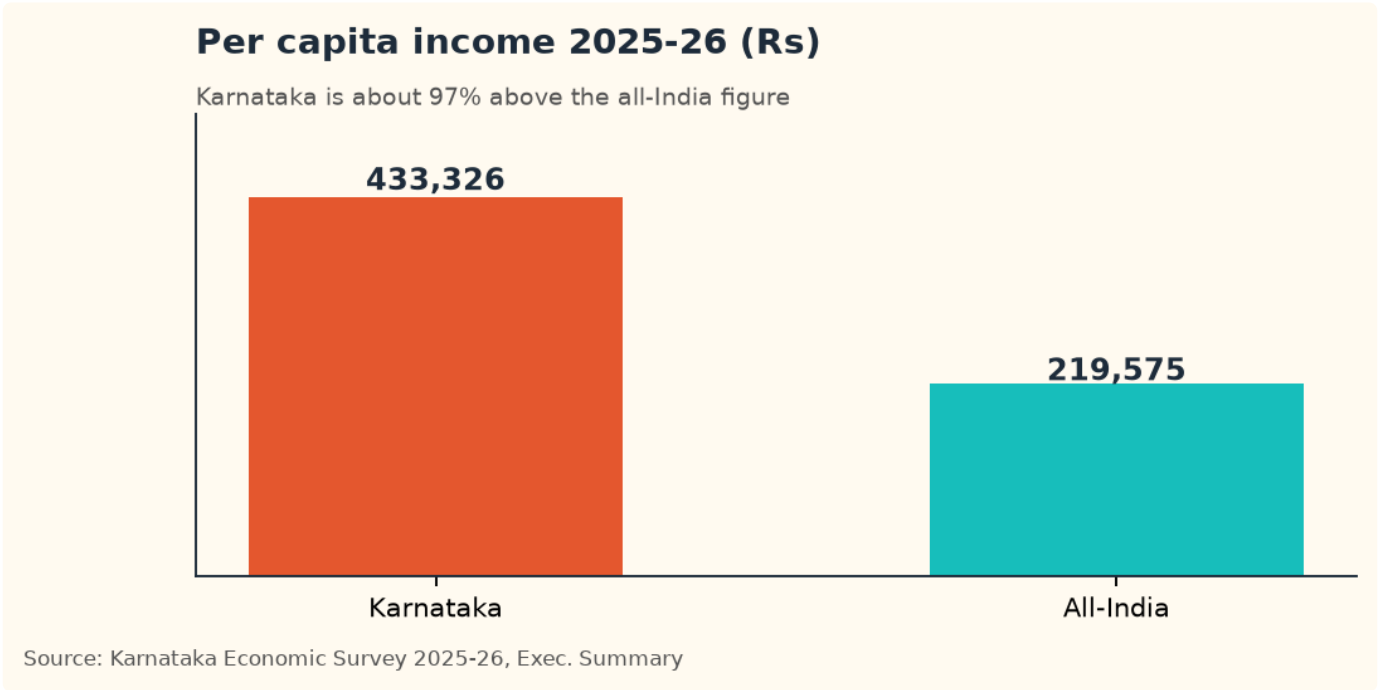
HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "**S**illy **D**ogs **R**un **A**round **T**rees". Silly (Situation), Dogs (Dimensions), Run (Rules), Around (Action), Trees (Take decision). Silly, but you will never forget it.

7. Karnataka examples bank (use one per answer)

All from the Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 unless stated; full list with sources in Deliverable 6.



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary

- **Economy:** GSDP Rs 32.81 lakh crore in 2025-26 at current prices (growth 12.9%); 8.1% growth at constant prices vs 7.4% for India; per capita income Rs 4,33,326 vs all-India Rs 2,19,575.
- **Regional disparity:** Bengaluru Urban district per capita income Rs 8,55,960 (highest) vs Kalaburagi division Rs 1,89,938 (lowest division), State average Rs 3,86,156 (all 2024-25).
- **Local government:** 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats, 31 Zilla Panchayats.
- **Welfare:** five guarantee schemes (Gruha Lakshmi, Gruha Jyothi, Anna Bhagya, Shakti, Yuva Nidhi); Budget 2026-27 provision about Rs 51,286 crore (PRS).
- **Governance:** Seva Sindhu, Bhoomi, Kutumba, Sakala, Janaspandana (named in the Survey's governance chapter).
- **Environment:** forest and tree cover 24.52% (ISFR 2023, as cited in the Survey); 5 national parks, 37 sanctuaries.
- **Agriculture:** 170 APMCs (167 linked to the Unified Market Platform); FRUITS platform registered over 102.95 lakh farmers.
- **Dairy:** KMF procurement averaging about 1 crore litres a day (June 2025).
- **Health:** IMR 14 (2023), MMR 68 (2021-23), as cited in the Survey from SRS.

8. Marks you are probably losing (and the fix)

Loss	Fix
Generic intro	First line carries a defined term, an Article/Act or a fact
Listing without linking	One connecting phrase between dimensions ("which in turn", "however")
No Karnataka angle on a Karnataka question (37 of 317 tagged questions were Karnataka-specific; Deliverable 1)	Keep 5 reusable Karnataka facts per paper
Unsupported numbers	If unsure, write the trend ("has risen sharply") and name the source
Overshooting the word limit	Practise in ruled 150/250-word boxes; use the rubric (Deliverable 8)
Weak ending	End with a way forward or a constitutional value, not a repeat of the intro
Messy presentation	One blank line between paragraphs; number sub-parts; one underline colour

9. The 10-minute daily drill (no coach needed)

1. Pick one unit from Deliverable 1 (start with CORE ones).
2. Write one 150-word answer in 7 minutes. Then, on another unit, one 250-word answer in 11 minutes.
3. Score yourself with the Deliverable 8 rubric straight away. Write your single biggest loss at the top.
4. Next day, rewrite only the part that lost marks.
5. Weekly: one full 3-hour mock. Deliverable 3 gives topics to practise; use fresh questions from your own sources, never memorised answers.

RECAP: Clock (0.72 min/mark) + skeleton (I-B-C-W-F) + directive word + one sketch + one Karnataka number. That is the whole game.

NEXT UP: Deliverable 6 (dossiers) loads your Karnataka ammunition with sources, and Deliverable 3 shows 40 predicted model answers using exactly this skeleton. Open one and spot the I-B-C-W-F in it.

10. Sources

- S1 KPSC notification 31-07-2026 (scheme, marks, duration). S2 Karnataka Gazette 08-01-2015 (syllabus).
- Constitution of India (legislative.gov.in); Acts named above (indiacode.nic.in).
- Supreme Court cases: Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973); Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980); S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994); Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978).
- Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Planning, Programme Monitoring and Statistics Dept, Govt of Karnataka); PRS Legislative Research, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27.
- Second Administrative Reforms Commission reports (2005-2009).

Deliverable 3 - Model answers (40 PREDICTED topics)

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | every answer has a 150-word (10-mark) and a 250-word (15-mark) version

Library progress: Deliverable 3 of 8

CHAI-TALK: Here is the idea in plain words. The answers are written in exam-grade, formal English, because that is what an examiner wants to read. The boxes around them are for you: a memory trick, a trap to avoid, and a small mind map you can redraw in 20 seconds. Read the answer once, cover it, redraw the map from memory, then write your own version. That is the loop.

PREDICTED: Every topic here is labelled PREDICTED because it is chosen from a pattern: how often its syllabus unit showed up in the four mains papers I tagged (2014, 2015, 2021, 2025; see Deliverable 1). It is a probability, not inside information, and no question below is copied from a past paper. Practice prompts are in my own words.

How the two versions work. The 150-word version is the 10-mark answer: one sharp intro line, 3-4 points, one line of conclusion. The 250-word version is the 15-mark answer: the same spine, with one more layer of evidence and a Karnataka angle where the syllabus asks for it. Aim to finish a 10-marker in about 7 minutes and a 15-marker in about 11 (a 250-mark paper in 3 hours leaves 0.72 minute per mark).

Contents

- GS1-01: Hoysala temple architecture and its World Heritage listing (GS1-A3)
- GS1-02: Unification of Karnataka, 1956 and after (GS1-A6)
- GS1-03: Social reform movements of the 19th century and their legacy (GS1-A2)
- GS1-04: Indian contributions to science and mathematics, and the Karnataka link (GS1-A1)
- GS1-05: Women's empowerment: promise, policy and persisting gaps (GS1-B3)
- GS1-06: Land reforms in India and Karnataka (GS1-B7)
- GS1-07: Environmental movements: Chipko, Appiko and what they teach (GS1-B2)
- GS1-08: Decentralisation in Karnataka: from the 1983 Act to the 1993 Act (GS1-B5)
- GS1-09: Data interpretation: reading a table and a chart, with Karnataka numbers (GS1-C8)
- GS1-10: Regional disparities in Karnataka: Nanjundappa Committee and Article 371J (GS1-C3)
- GS2-01: Ocean currents: influence on climate and fisheries (GS2-A1)
- GS2-02: Migration: causes, consequences and policy response (GS2-A2)
- GS2-03: The Indian monsoon: mechanism, variability and impact (GS2-A3)
- GS2-04: Urbanisation in Karnataka: pattern, problems and policy (GS2-A6)
- GS2-05: Indian federalism: nature, strains and cooperative practice (GS2-B1)
- GS2-06: The Governor: constitutional position, discretion and reform (GS2-B3)
- GS2-07: Basic structure doctrine and amendment of the Constitution (GS2-B5)
- GS2-08: Finance Commission: role, recent recommendations and Karnataka's concerns (GS2-B6)
- GS2-09: Good governance, Lokpal and Lokayukta, and service delivery in Karnataka (GS2-C6)
- GS2-10: India and its neighbourhood: principles, instruments and challenges (GS2-C7)
- GS3-01: e-governance and the digital divide: Karnataka's experience (GS3-A1)
- GS3-02: Renewable and nuclear energy: Karnataka's power transition (GS3-A3)
- GS3-03: Climate change and disaster risk reduction (GS3-A4)
- GS3-04: Sustainable agriculture: water, risk and markets in Karnataka (GS3-B2)
- GS3-05: Biotechnology: GM crops and genome editing in India (GS3-B4)
- GS3-06: Dairy cooperatives: the Anand pattern and KMF (GS3-B5)
- GS3-07: Watershed development and price support for farmers (GS3-B6)
- GS3-08: Public health: maternal and child outcomes and non-communicable disease in Karnataka (GS3-B7)
- GS3-09: Biodiversity and the Western Ghats: conservation and governance (GS3-C3)
- GS3-10: Pollution and solid waste: laws, bioremediation and Karnataka's experience (GS3-C4)
- GS4-01: Determinants of ethics: what shapes a person's moral compass (GS4-E1)
- GS4-02: Laws, rules, regulations and conscience as sources of guidance (GS4-E2)
- GS4-03: Accountability and ethical governance (GS4-E3)
- GS4-04: Citizen's charters, RTI and transparency in service delivery (GS4-E4)
- GS4-05: Corruption: causes, consequences and a layered response (GS4-E4)
- GS4-06: Human values: lessons from Gandhi and Basavanna (GS4-E5)

- GS4-07: Integrity, impartiality and objectivity in public service (GS4-I)
- GS4-08: Empathy, compassion and tolerance in administration (GS4-I)
- GS4-09: Attitude, its components and how to change it (GS4-T1)
- GS4-10: Emotional intelligence for civil servants (GS4-T2)

GS 1 (Paper 2): 10 model answers

GS1-01 | Hoysala temple architecture and its World Heritage listing

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-A3 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain what makes Hoysala temple architecture distinctive and why it earned global recognition.

150-word version (10 marks) [149 words]

The Hoysala temples of the 12th-13th centuries are the finest expression of medieval temple building in the Deccan. In 2023 UNESCO inscribed the Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (Channakeshava temple at Belur, Hoysalesvara temple at Halebidu, Keshava temple at Somanathapura) as India's 42nd World Heritage Site.

Distinctive features:

- A stellate (star-shaped) sanctum, with a circumambulatory platform following the same shape.
- Multi-tiered friezes and a sculptural gallery arranged thematically around epic and religious stories.
- Carving that covers the entire exterior surface, worked in soapstone.
- Inscriptions bearing the names of artists, showing individual creative recognition.
- The legend of Sala killing a tiger, the dynasty's emblem.

Significance: the style selected features from earlier kingdoms and contemporary southern temples and forged a distinct Hoysala identity. It was inscribed under criteria (i), (ii) and (iv).

Conclusion: the ensembles show how a regional dynasty converted stone into lasting cultural identity, which now needs careful conservation.

250-word version (15 marks) [246 words]

The Hoysala dynasty (12th-13th centuries) created one of the most original temple styles of South India. In September 2023 the World Heritage Committee inscribed the Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas, India's 42nd World Heritage Site, covering the Channakeshava temple at Belur, the Hoysalesvara temple at Halebidu and the Keshava temple at Somanathapura, all in Karnataka.

Architectural features:

- Stellate plan: star-shaped sanctum and platform, giving a complex outline with many projecting angles.
- Circumambulatory platform (pradakshina patha) following the shape of the sanctum.
- Sculptural gallery and multi-tiered frieze narrating epic and Puranic stories.
- Hyper-real sculpture and stone carving covering the whole exterior, worked in soapstone.
- Sala legend: the sculpture of Sala killing a tiger became the dynasty's emblem.

Cultural significance:

- Artists' names appear in inscriptions, evidence of recognised craftsmanship.
- The style combined features of past kingdoms with those of contemporary southern temples, forging a distinct Hoysala identity.
- It influenced later temples in the region.

UNESCO criteria: (i) masterpiece of creative genius, (ii) interchange of values, (iv) significant stage in Hindu temple architecture.

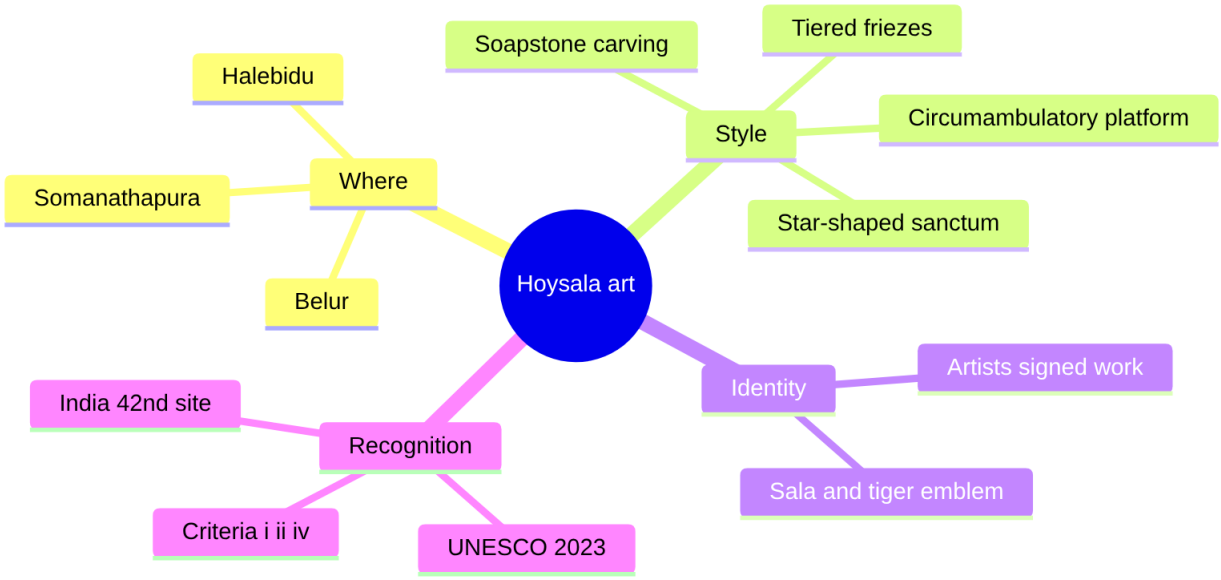
Challenges: soft stone is vulnerable to weathering, visitor pressure and encroachment around monuments; the site needs a management plan, buffer-zone control and community-based tourism.

Present-day relevance: the listing raises Karnataka's heritage-tourism profile and makes protection of the monuments and their surroundings a matter of international commitment, alongside the sites of Hampi and Pattadakal.

Conclusion: Hoysala temples are Karnataka's strongest argument that heritage is both identity and an economic asset; conservation and tourism must be planned together.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: BELT-S: Belur, Halebidu (Hoysalesvara), Somanathapura = the three; then Star plan, Tiers of friezes, Tiger (Sala), Signed by artists. Say it as "Be Ready: Star, Tiers, Tiger, Signatures".

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that all three temples are in one town, or that Hoysalas built only in Belur. Also avoid inventing construction years for each temple; "12th-13th centuries" is the safe, UNESCO-backed statement.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: UNESCO World Heritage Centre, "Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas" (whc.unesco.org/en/list/1670/), inscribed 2023, criteria (i)(ii)(iv); UNESCO news release dated 18 Sep 2023 (India's 42nd site). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS1-02 - Unification of Karnataka, 1956 and after

GS1-02 | Unification of Karnataka, 1956 and after

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-A6 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 7 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Trace the stages by which the Kannada-speaking regions came together as one State and what the unification left unfinished.

150-word version (10 marks) [148 words]

Before 1956 the Kannada-speaking people were divided among Madras and Bombay Presidencies, the Nizam's Hyderabad, Mysore, and Coorg, which weakened Kannada's political voice.

Stages:

- Cultural awakening: Karnataka Vidyavardhaka Sangha (1890) and Kannada Sahitya Parishat (1915) built a shared identity.
- Political push: the Karnataka Ekikarana movement gathered force around the 1924 Belgaum session of the Congress.
- Post-1947: the linguistic-states debate, with the Dhar Commission and the JVP Committee cautious, and the States Reorganisation Commission (1953-55) accepting language as a basis.
- On 1 November 1956 the States Reorganisation Act created an enlarged Mysore State.
- Mysore was renamed Karnataka on 1 November 1973.

Unfinished: regional imbalance, which Article 371J (2012) addresses for Hyderabad-Karnataka, and border questions.

Why it mattered: a shared language and shared administration let schools, courts and literature work in Kannada across the whole region.

Conclusion: unification gave political unity; the task now is equal development across its regions.

250-word version (15 marks) [250 words]

By 1947 Kannada speakers lived under five administrations: Madras and Bombay Presidencies, the Nizam's Hyderabad State, Mysore, and Coorg. Each pulled in a different political and educational direction.

Stages of unification:

1. Cultural phase: the Karnataka Vidyavardhaka Sangha (Dharwad, 1890) and the Kannada Sahitya Parishat (1915) created a shared literary identity.
2. Political phase: the Karnataka Ekikarana movement gained momentum, and the 1924 Belgaum Congress session, held in the Kannada region, gave it a national stage.
3. Constitutional phase: after 1947 the Dhar Commission and the JVP Committee were cautious about language-based states, but the States Reorganisation Commission (1953-55) accepted language as a principal basis.
4. Legal phase: the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 came into effect on 1 November 1956, creating an enlarged Mysore State.
5. Renaming: the State became Karnataka on 1 November 1973.

Legacy and gaps:

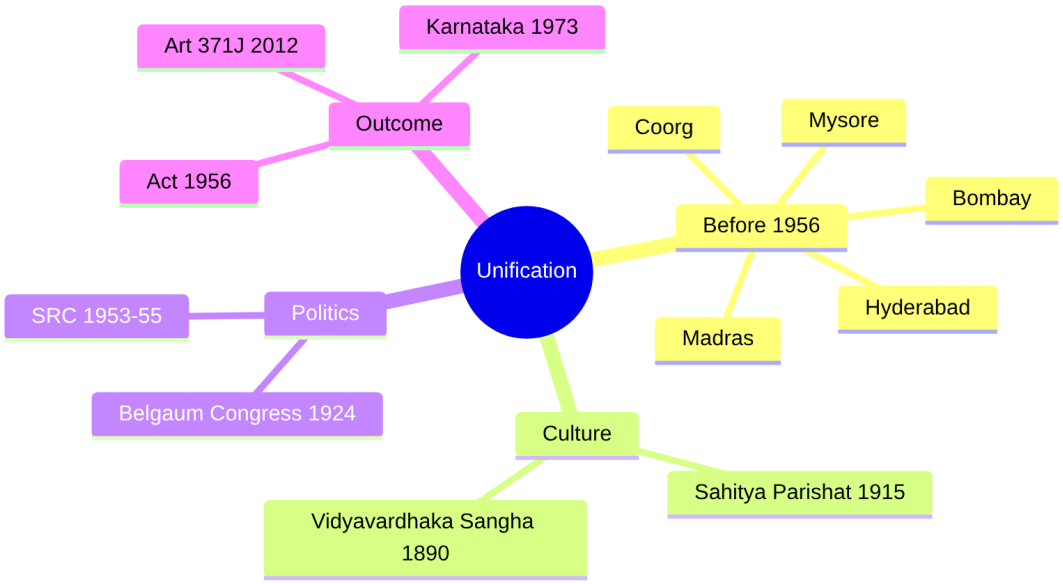
- Regional disparity: the older Mysore region developed faster than Hyderabad-Karnataka. Article 371J, added in 2012, gives special provisions to that region.
- Boundary and river disputes with neighbouring states remain.
- Integration needs administrative as well as emotional unity.

Significance: the integration let Kannada become the common language of administration, schools and courts across former princely, Presidency and Nizam territories, and gave the State a single political voice in the Union. It also set the template for later demands, for example the 2019 renaming of the Hyderabad-Karnataka region as Kalyana Karnataka.

Conclusion: unification was a cultural project before it was a political one; its test now is whether every region shares equally in growth.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: Three C's and a number: Culture (Sangha 1890, Parishat 1915), Congress (Belgaum 1924), Commission (SRC 1953-55) -> 1956 -> renamed 1973. Count "56 then 73": the State was formed in '56 and named in '73.

COMMON TRAP: Unification date is 1 November 1956 but the NAME Karnataka came on 1 November 1973. Mixing the two is the commonest slip. Also, do not say Hyderabad-Karnataka joined in 1947; it joined with the 1956 reorganisation.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: States Reorganisation Act, 1956 (indiacode.nic.in); Constitution of India Art. 371J (98th Amendment, 2012), legislative.gov.in; dates of the Karnataka Vidyavardhaka Sangha, Kannada Sahitya Parishat, Belgaum 1924 session and the 1973 renaming web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-03 - Social reform movements of the 19th century and their legacy

GS1-03 | Social reform movements of the 19th century and their legacy

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-A2 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 7 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Evaluate how 19th-century social reformers changed Indian society and where their work remained incomplete.

150-word version (10 marks) [148 words]

Nineteenth-century reform grew from contact with Western liberal ideas, a new educated class and a revival of rational thought within Indian tradition.

Contributions:

- Raja Ram Mohan Roy (Brahmo Sabha, 1828) campaigned against sati, leading to its prohibition in 1829.
- Vidyasagar's efforts led to the Widow Remarriage Act, 1856.
- Jyotirao Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj (1873) challenged caste hierarchy and promoted education for girls and the lower castes.
- The Arya Samaj (1875) promoted education and criticised idolatry and untouchability.
- Sir Syed Ahmad Khan's Aligarh movement promoted modern education among Muslims.

Limits: reform was often urban, upper-caste and led by men; caste and patriarchy persisted, as Ambedkar's later movements showed.

The movements also differed: Brahmo and Arya Samaj reinterpreted religion, while Phule attacked caste at its root.

Conclusion: reformers set the agenda of rights and education that the Constitution later made law, but social change needed mass participation, not just elite reform.

250-word version (15 marks) [235 words]

Nineteenth-century reform emerged from three forces: English education, the print public sphere and a search for rational foundations within Indian traditions.

Major movements:

- Brahmo Samaj: Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha in 1828; his campaign helped bring the 1829 regulation prohibiting sati.
- Vidyasagar: his advocacy led to the Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act, 1856.
- Satyashodhak Samaj (1873): Jyotirao Phule attacked Brahminical dominance and began schools for girls and the oppressed castes.
- Arya Samaj (1875): Dayananda Saraswati stressed Vedic authority, education and opposition to untouchability and child marriage.
- Aligarh movement: Sir Syed Ahmad Khan advanced modern education for Muslims, and the Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College was founded in 1875.
- Legislative reform: the Age of Consent Act, 1891 raised the age of consent.

Impact: a new language of rights, the spread of women's education, the questioning of caste hierarchy and the shift of social reform into law.

Limitations:

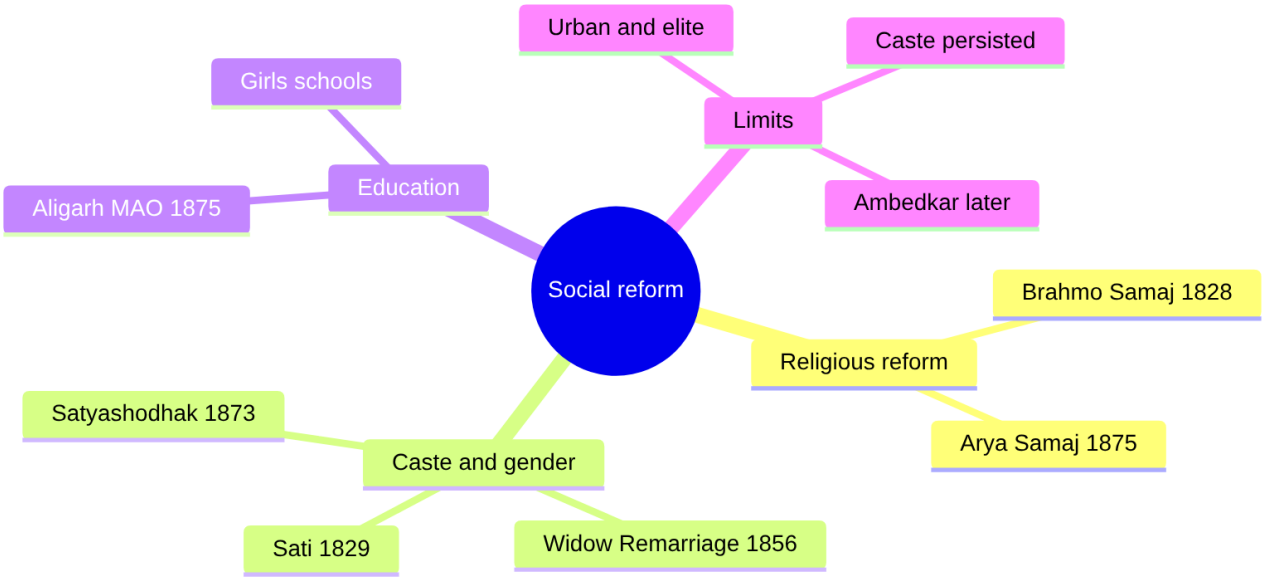
- Reach was largely urban and upper-caste.
- Reformers often depended on colonial legislation, which was cautious and limited.
- Caste and gender inequality persisted, leading to the later movements of Ambedkar and Periyar.

Regional strand: in Mysore, the Miller Committee (1918) examined the underrepresentation of non-Brahmin communities in public service, an example of reform moving into State policy in the princely States as well as British India.

Conclusion: reformers placed social justice on the national agenda; the Constitution's Articles 15, 17 and 21A are their successors, but the work remains unfinished.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: Remember "BASAA": Brahmo (1828), Arya (1875), Satyashodhak (1873), Aligarh (1875), Act of 1856 (widows). Or by order of date: 1828, 1829, 1856, 1873, 1875, 1891.

COMMON TRAP: Roy did not himself abolish sati; the law was the 1829 Regulation under Governor-General Bentinck. Likewise, the Age of Consent Act 1891 raised consent age (it did not ban child marriage; the 1929 Act did that).



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Spear, "A History of India" Vol. 2 (Penguin) and Bipan Chandra, "India's Struggle for Independence" (standard textbooks); Sati Regulation 1829, Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act 1856 and Age of Consent Act 1891 (indiacode.nic.in / National Archives); Constitution Arts. 15, 17, 21A. Dates web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-04 - Indian contributions to science and mathematics, and the Karnataka link

GS1-04 | Indian contributions to science and mathematics, and the Karnataka link

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-A1 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the contribution of ancient and early-medieval India to science, with a Karnataka example.

150-word version (10 marks) [134 words]

India's early contributions to science were systematic, written down and transmitted.

Mathematics and astronomy:

- Aryabhata (born 476 CE) wrote the Aryabhatiya (499 CE), which used a place-value system and stated that the Earth rotates.
- Brahmagupta's Brahmasphutasiddhanta (628 CE) set out rules for zero and negative numbers.
- Varahamihira's Brihat Samhita covers astronomy and natural phenomena.

Medicine: the Charaka Samhita is a foundation of internal medicine, and the Sushruta Samhita describes surgical procedures.

Metallurgy: the rust-resistant iron pillar at Delhi and wootz steel show advanced skill.

Karnataka: Mahaviracharya, a Jain mathematician at the Rashtrakuta court (9th century), wrote the Ganita Sara Sangraha.

Such works were transmitted through texts and teachers, which is why they survived and spread.

Conclusion: these works show a tradition of observation and reasoning that deserves study as science, not only as heritage.

250-word version (15 marks) [231 words]

Ancient and early-medieval India produced a rich, documented scientific tradition in mathematics, astronomy, medicine and metallurgy.

Mathematics and astronomy:

- Aryabhata (born 476 CE) composed the Aryabhatiya in 499 CE, using a place-value system and describing the Earth's rotation.
- Brahmagupta, in the Brahmasphutasiddhanta (628 CE), treated zero as a number and gave rules for operations with it and with negative numbers.
- Varahamihira's Brihat Samhita (6th century CE) is an encyclopaedic text on astronomy, weather and architecture.

Medicine and surgery:

- The Charaka Samhita systematised internal medicine and diagnosis.
- The Sushruta Samhita describes surgical instruments and procedures, including plastic surgery.

Metallurgy and engineering:

- The Gupta-period iron pillar at Delhi has resisted corrosion for centuries.
- Wootz steel was exported and admired abroad.

Karnataka contribution: Mahaviracharya (9th century), a Jain mathematician patronised by the Rashtrakuta king Amoghavarsha I, wrote the Ganita Sara Sangraha, a textbook of arithmetic. Amoghavarsha is also associated with the Kavirajamarga, the earliest surviving Kannada work on poetics.

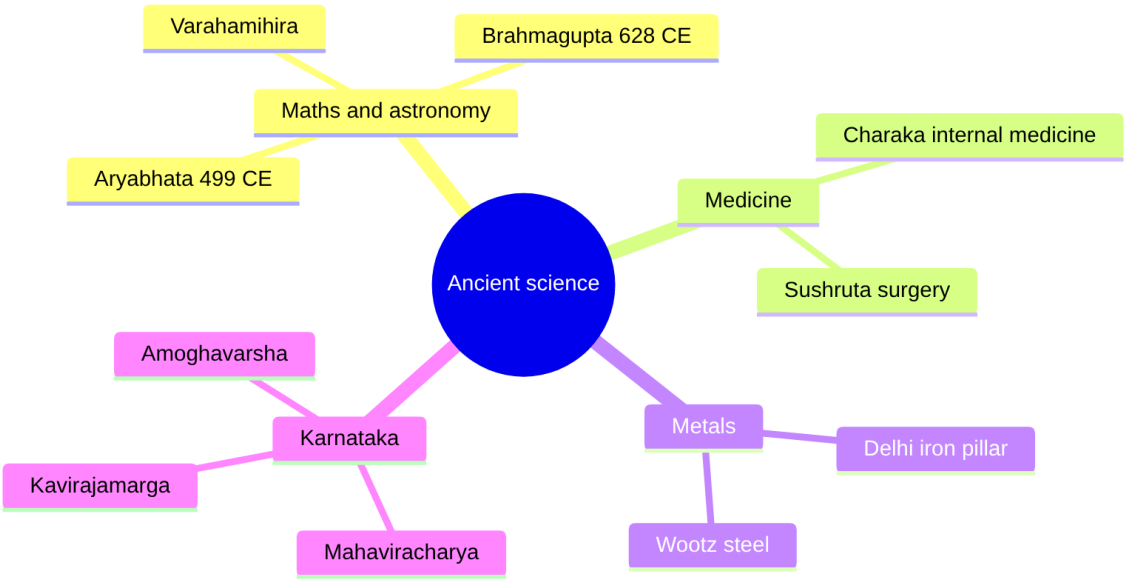
Significance: these works show that Indian knowledge was systematic and transmitted through texts; the place-value system later shaped world mathematics.

Transmission: Indian numerals and the place-value system travelled to the Arab world and then to Europe, which is why ancient India matters to the history of world science. Teachers used commentaries and manuscripts, and temples and mathas preserved them.

Conclusion: ancient science should be taught with evidence and dates, so that pride rests on fact.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "A-B-V, then C-S, then metal": Aryabhata (earth rotates), Brahmagupta (zero rules), Varahamihira (Brihat Samhita); Charaka (medicine), Sushruta (surgery); Delhi pillar, wootz. For Karnataka, say "Mahavira under Amoghavarsha".

COMMON TRAP: Aryabhata did not "invent zero". Say he used a place-value system; Brahmagupta gave the arithmetic rules for zero. Also avoid claiming modern devices existed; keep claims to what the text says.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Standard references: Encyclopaedia Britannica entries "Aryabhata", "Brahmagupta", "Mahavira (mathematician)"; Charaka and Sushruta Samhitas (National Institute of Indian Medical Heritage / AYUSH ministry pages); Archaeological Survey of India (Iron Pillar, Delhi). Web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-05 - Women's empowerment: promise, policy and persisting gaps

GS1-05 | Women's empowerment: promise, policy and persisting gaps

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-B3 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 8 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Assess the constitutional and policy framework for women's empowerment in India and Karnataka, and name the gaps that remain.

150-word version (10 marks) [138 words]

Constitutional promise: Article 14 (equality), Article 15(3) (special provisions for women), Article 39(a) and (d), Article 42 (maternity relief) and Article 51A(e) (duty to renounce practices derogatory to women).

Political space: the 73rd and 74th Amendments reserved one-third of local-body seats; Karnataka's 2010 amendment raised this to 50% in panchayats. The 106th Amendment (2023) reserves one-third of Lok Sabha and Assembly seats once implemented.

Laws: Dowry Prohibition Act 1961; Domestic Violence Act 2005; POSH Act 2013; Karnataka Devadasi (Prohibition of Dedication) Act 1982.

Karnataka schemes: Gruha Lakshmi gives Rs 2,000 a month to female heads of households; Shakti offers free bus travel.

Gaps: safety, unpaid care work and unequal access to work.

Enforcement, awareness and support services decide whether these rights reach women in villages.

Conclusion: rights exist on paper; economic independence and safety will make them real.

250-word version (15 marks) [218 words]

India's approach has moved from welfare to empowerment.

Constitutional framework: Article 14 (equality), 15(3) (special provisions), 39(a) and (d) (livelihood and equal pay), 42 (maternity relief), and the fundamental duty in 51A(e).

Political participation:

- The 73rd and 74th Amendments reserved one-third of seats in panchayats and municipalities.
- Karnataka's Panchayat Raj (Amendment) Act, 2010 provides 50% reservation for women in all three tiers.
- The 106th Amendment (2023, Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam) reserves one-third of seats in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies once implemented.

Legal protection: Dowry Prohibition Act 1961, Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005, Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act 2013, and the Karnataka Devadasi (Prohibition of Dedication) Act 1982.

Karnataka's welfare design: the Economic Survey 2025-26 notes that Gruha Lakshmi, launched in 2023-24, gives Rs 2,000 per month to female heads of households to reduce financial stress and strengthen women's economic agency; Shakti (free bus travel) supports mobility.

Gaps:

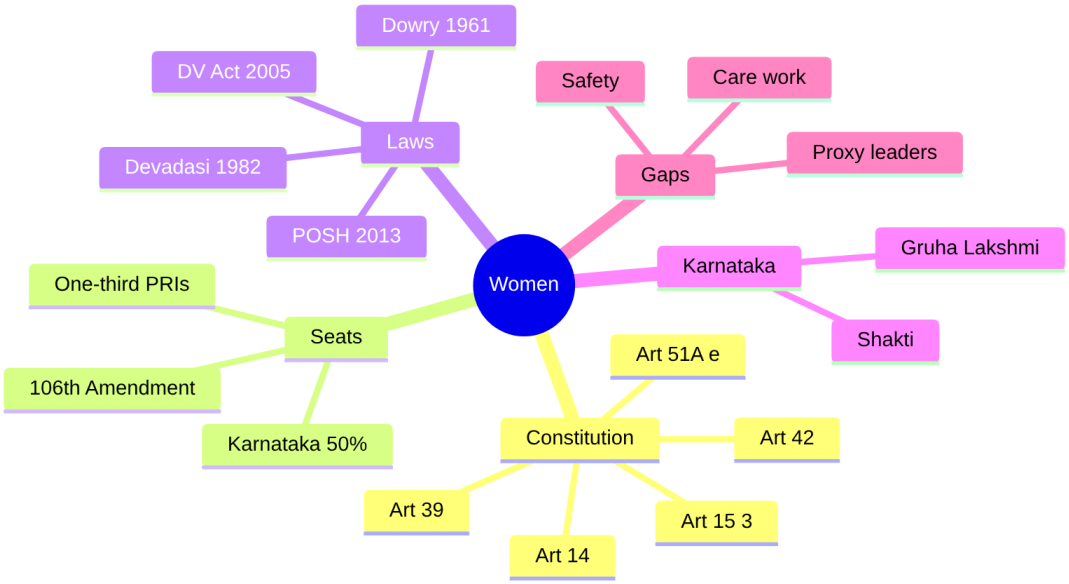
- Violence and safety concerns.
- Unpaid care work and low participation in quality jobs.
- Proxy leadership ("sarpanch-pati") in local bodies.

Lesson for policy: cash transfer and free travel raise mobility and household income; sustained empowerment needs complementary public services such as crèches, hostels and safe transport.

Conclusion: transfers and quotas help, but lasting empowerment needs safe workplaces, skills, childcare and a change in social norms.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "P-L-S": Promise (Articles 14, 15(3), 39, 42, 51A(e)), Law (1961, 2005, 2013), Seats (one-third, 50% in Karnataka PRIs, 106th Amendment). Then "Karnataka = Lakshmi + Shakti".

COMMON TRAP: The 106th Amendment Act was brought into force on 16 April 2026 (Gazette notification), but the seat quota applies only after a census and delimitation. Say "once implemented". Also do not mix up one-third (73rd/74th, Union) with 50% (Karnataka's own law).



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India (legislative.gov.in); Karnataka Panchayat Raj (Amendment) Act 2010 (Ministry of Panchayati Raj, panchayat.gov.in; web-verified); Constitution (106th Amendment) Act 2023 (legislative.gov.in); Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Gruha Lakshmi launch year, Rs 2,000 a month).

NEXT UP: GS1-06 - Land reforms in India and Karnataka

GS1-06 | Land reforms in India and Karnataka

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-B7 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Evaluate the success of land reforms in India, taking Karnataka's tenancy reform as the case study.

150-word version (10 marks) [138 words]

Land reform aimed at justice (end exploitation by intermediaries) and efficiency.

Components:

- Abolition of intermediaries such as zamindars.
- Tenancy reform: security, fair rent, ownership for tenants.
- Ceiling on holdings and distribution of surplus land.
- Bhoodan movement (1951) of Vinoba Bhave as a voluntary route.

Karnataka: the Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961 was transformed by the 1974 amendment, in force from 1 March 1974. It vested tenanted land in the State and entitled tenants who personally cultivated it to be registered as occupants. The slogan was "the tiller is the owner".

Assessment: abolition of intermediaries and tenancy reform succeeded in many States; ceiling laws gave limited surplus because of loopholes.

Features such as registration before Land Tribunals made the right enforceable, not merely declared.

Conclusion: reform worked where politics supported it; land records and fragmentation are the new challenges.

250-word version (15 marks) [244 words]

Land reform in India had three aims: end exploitation by intermediaries, give security to tenants and reduce concentration of ownership.

Measures:

- Abolition of zamindari and other intermediary tenures in the 1950s.
- Tenancy reform: regulation of rent, security of tenure and ownership rights for cultivating tenants.
- Ceilings on landholdings and redistribution of surplus.
- Bhoodan (1951) by Vinoba Bhave as a voluntary route.
- The Ninth Schedule (First Amendment, 1951) was used to protect agrarian laws from challenge.

Karnataka case study: the Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961 came into force in 1965, but its tenancy chapter bit only after the amendment of 1974, in force from 1 March 1974 under Chief Minister D. Devaraj Urs. All lands held by tenants vested in the State and tenants personally cultivating them could be registered as occupants before Land Tribunals. "Uluvavane bhoomi odeya" (the tiller is the owner of the land) became the slogan.

Assessment:

- Successes: end of intermediaries; millions of tenants gained ownership in several States, Karnataka among them.
- Failures: ceilings yielded limited surplus due to evasion; oral and concealed tenancy; poor land records.

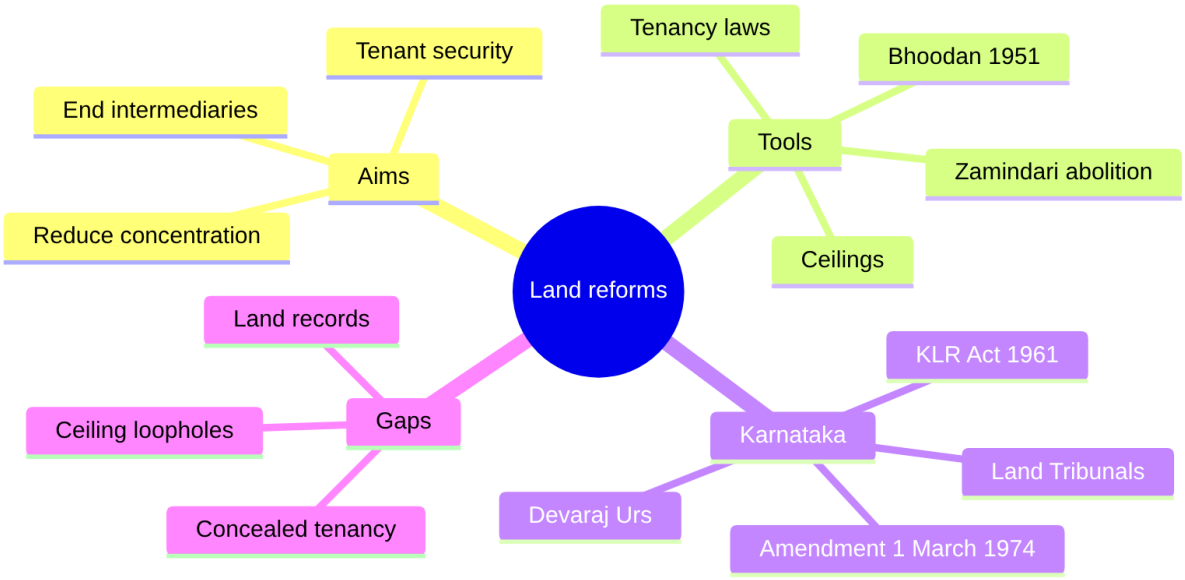
Contemporary challenges: fragmented holdings, digitised records, and landless labour.

Why Karnataka is a good case: the Act did not merely declare rights; it provided tribunals, a cut-off date and a procedure by which tenants applied for registration, so ownership could be proved and recorded.

Conclusion: Karnataka shows reform succeeds where law, tribunals and political will align; the next phase is secure records and land consolidation.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A-T-C-B": Abolish intermediaries, Tenancy, Ceilings, Bhoodan. For Karnataka just say "1-3-1974, tiller is the owner".

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Karnataka Act was passed in 1974. The Act is of 1961 (in force 1965); the 1974 AMENDMENT is the landmark. Do not exaggerate: say "millions" only if you can support it; otherwise say "many tenants".



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961 (Karnataka Act 10 of 1962; PRS Legislative Research text) and Amendment Act 1 of 1974 (in force 1 March 1974, per the Act's amendment notes and Supreme Court judgments); The Week, "Laying the groundwork" (9 Oct 2020) for the slogan. Web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-07 - Environmental movements: Chipko, Appiko and what they teach

GS1-07 | Environmental movements: Chipko, Appiko and what they teach

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-B2 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Compare Chipko and Appiko, and explain what environmental movements in India reveal about social change.

150-word version (10 marks) [134 words]

Environmental movements in India are livelihood movements before they are conservation movements.

Chipko (Garhwal Himalaya, early 1970s): villagers, especially women, embraced trees to stop commercial felling.

Appiko ("to hug" in Kannada): began on 8 September 1983 in Uttara Kannada, when villagers of Salkani, led by Pandurang Hegde, marched into the forest and hugged trees to stop felling. It spread to other Western Ghats districts.

Similarities: Gandhian non-violence; local control over forest resources; women's participation.

Differences: Chipko arose in a Himalayan region where forest dependence is strong; Appiko focused also on monoculture plantations and the Western Ghats's biodiversity.

Other movements: Silent Valley, Narmada Bachao Andolan.

Impact: the movement raised public awareness of forest dependence and pushed the State towards more cautious felling policy.

Conclusion: these movements widened democracy by making ecology a question of rights.

250-word version (15 marks) [237 words]

Indian environmental movements are struggles over who controls natural resources, which is why sociologists call them movements of the "environmentalism of the poor".

Chipko: in the early 1970s, villagers of the Garhwal Himalaya, with women prominent, embraced trees to resist commercial felling; it became the model for later protests.

Appiko: the word means "to hug" in Kannada. On 8 September 1983 villagers from Salkani and nearby villages in Uttara Kannada, organised through youth clubs and led by Pandurang Hegde, marched into the forest and hugged trees to stop felling for commercial use. It continued for weeks and spread across the Western Ghats.

Common features: Gandhian non-violence; community dependence on forests for water, fuel and fodder; women and youth as core participants.

Differences:

- Chipko: Himalayan slopes, early demand for local rights.
- Appiko: monoculture plantations and plywood demand in the Western Ghats, a biodiversity hotspot; later it also promoted forest conservation education.

Later movements: Silent Valley (Kerala), which saved a rainforest from a hydroelectric dam, and the Narmada Bachao Andolan on displacement.

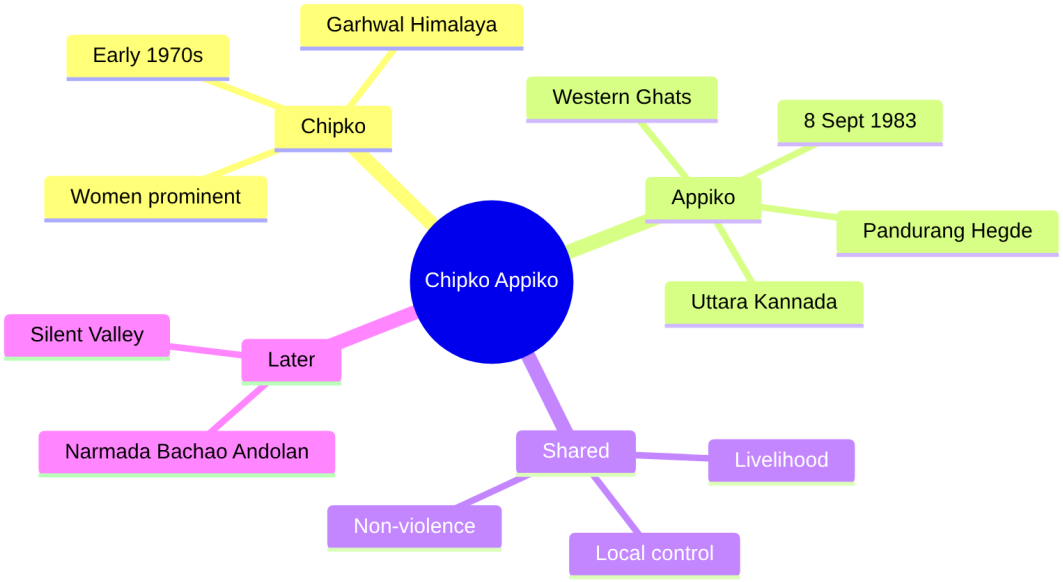
Impact: policy and public awareness, and a link between ecology, livelihoods and rights.

Social-change lens: these movements show that marginal groups can influence policy through moral pressure, and that identity, livelihood and ecology are linked; they also show how a local struggle can become a national symbol once it is documented and networked.

Conclusion: these movements show that conservation succeeds when communities have a stake in forests.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Chip" is the Hindi hug, "Appi" is the Kannada hug: C for Chamoli (Himalaya) and A for Uttara Kannada (Western Ghats, 8-9-1983). Both = "hug a tree to hold a livelihood".

COMMON TRAP: Appiko is not a copy of Chipko; it was local and also adapted its methods, including sit-ins. Also avoid saying it began in 1973 (that is Chipko). Keep the Appiko date as September 1983.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Global Nonviolent Action Database (Swarthmore), "Indian villagers hug trees (Appiko)... 1983-1990"; Gale / Indian Journal of Gender Studies abstract "In the margins: environment, resources and livelihoods in the Appiko Chaluvali"; Panduranga Hegde Papers, NCBS Archives. Chipko and Silent Valley details from standard texts (Guha, "The Unquiet Woods"); web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-08 - Decentralisation in Karnataka: from the 1983 Act to the 1993 Act

GS1-08 | Decentralisation in Karnataka: from the 1983 Act to the 1993 Act

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-B5 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Examine how Karnataka's panchayat system developed, and what stops it working fully.

150-word version (10 marks) [136 words]

Karnataka was a pioneer: the Balwantrai Mehta (1957) and Ashok Mehta (1977-78) committees shaped national thinking, and Karnataka's Zilla Parishads, Taluk Panchayat Samitis, Mandal Panchayats and Nyaya Panchayats Act, 1983 was among the earliest strong State models.

After the 73rd Amendment (in force 24 April 1993), the Karnataka Panchayat Raj Act, 1993 came into force on 10 May 1993. Three tiers: Gram, Taluk and Zilla Panchayats.

Features: Gram Sabha, regular elections, reservation for SC, ST, backward classes and women (50% for women since 2010), and a Grievance Redressal Authority.

Scale: 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats, 31 Zilla Panchayats.

Gaps: the three F's, namely funds, functions and functionaries.

Digital tools such as PoS machines for property tax are improving own-source revenue.

Conclusion: Karnataka built the structure early; its deeper challenge is real devolution to Gram Panchayats.

250-word version (15 marks) [221 words]

Karnataka's panchayat system developed in phases.

Phase 1 - committees: the Balwantrai Mehta Committee (1957) recommended three tiers; the Ashok Mehta Committee (1977-78) recommended two. Karnataka's 1983 Act, officially the Karnataka Zilla Parishads, Taluk Panchayat Samithis, Mandal Panchayats and Nyaya Panchayats Act, was an early, strong State model.

Phase 2 - constitutional status: the 73rd Amendment (in force 24 April 1993) added Part IX, the Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects), State Election and Finance Commissions. Karnataka replaced its 1983 Act with the Karnataka Panchayat Raj Act, 1993, in force from 10 May 1993.

Present structure (Economic Survey 2025-26): 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats and 31 Zilla Panchayats; about 61% of the population is rural.

Notable features: Gram Sabha as base, 50% reservation for women since 2010, reservation for SC, ST and backward classes, and a Grievance Redressal Authority under the Act. Digital tools include Android PoS machines in all Gram Panchayats for property tax.

Challenges:

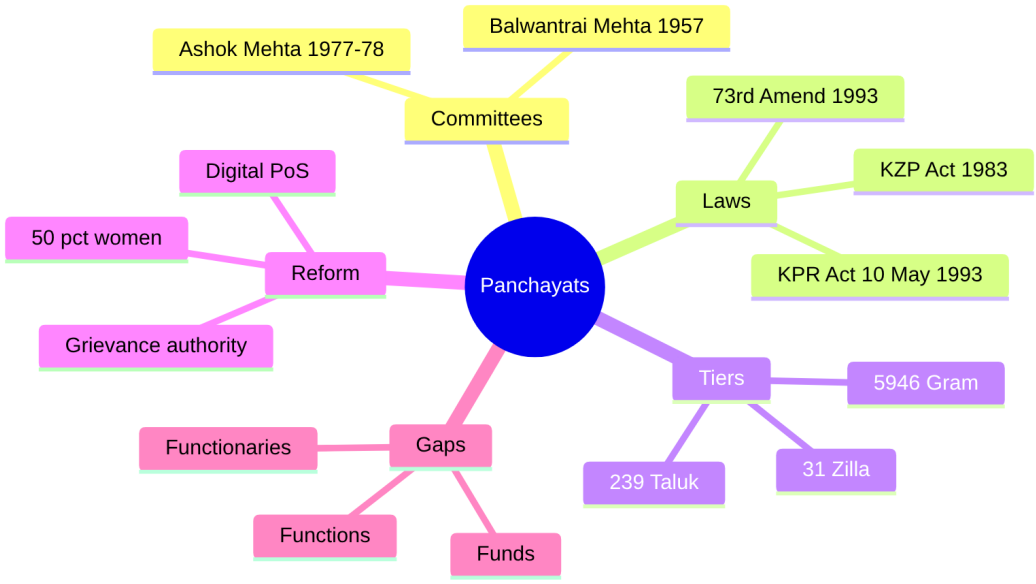
- Funds: heavy dependence on State and Union transfers.
- Functions: many subjects not effectively transferred.
- Functionaries: staff controlled by line departments.

Way forward: transfer activities with funds and staff (activity mapping), strengthen own-source revenue, hold regular Gram Sabhas with social audit and train elected representatives, especially first-time women members.

Conclusion: Karnataka's early lead gives it a strong base; real devolution needs activity mapping, untied funds and empowered Gram Sabhas.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Two committees, two Acts, three tiers": Mehta 1957, Mehta 1977-78; Act 1983, Act 1993 (10 May); Gram, Taluk, Zilla = 5,946 / 239 / 31 (it reads biggest to smallest).

COMMON TRAP: The Union amendment (24 April 1993) and the Karnataka Act (10 May 1993) are different dates; also, the Act is now titled the Karnataka Gram Swaraj and Panchayat Raj Act, 1993. Do not call Taluk Panchayat "Mandal Panchayat" (that was the 1983 Act's lower unit).



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Gram Swaraj and Panchayat Raj Act, 1993 (Karnataka Act 14 of 1993, in force 10 May 1993 per Notification RDP 259 ZPS 93; India Code); Constitution Part IX, Eleventh Schedule; Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (panchayat counts). Web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-09 - Data interpretation: reading a table and a chart, with Karnataka numbers

GS1-09 | Data interpretation: reading a table and a chart, with Karnataka numbers

PREDICTED: unit GS1-C8 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Show how to answer a data-interpretation question using a short table of Karnataka's economic indicators.

150-word version (10 marks) [130 words]

Method: read the title, units and year; compute the change; compare with a benchmark; then infer and add a caveat.

Worked example from the Economic Survey 2025-26:

- GSDP at current prices rose from Rs 29.06 lakh crore to Rs 32.81 lakh crore. Change = 3.75; 3.75 / 29.06 = 12.9%.
- At constant prices (Rs 15.94 to Rs 17.23 lakh crore) growth is 1.29 / 15.94 = 8.1%, above India's 7.4%.
- The gap between 12.9% and 8.1% is price inflation, so never use them interchangeably.
- Sector shares of GSVA: services 69.8%, industry 19.4%, agriculture 10.8%; they sum to 100%, confirming consistency.

Inference: Karnataka is service-led, with real growth ahead of India.

Caveat: shares do not show who benefits; per capita and regional data are needed.

Marks come from correct units, correct arithmetic and one clear inference.

250-word version (15 marks) [230 words]

Method (S-C-C-I): Scan title, units and year; Compute change, percentage and ratio; Compare with a benchmark or another year; Infer and add a caveat.

Worked example from the Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26:

1. Growth: GSDP at current prices rose from Rs 29.06 lakh crore to Rs 32.81 lakh crore. Absolute change = 3.75; percentage = 3.75 / 29.06 = 12.9%.
2. Real growth: at constant prices GSDP rose from Rs 15.94 to Rs 17.23 lakh crore, which is 1.29 / 15.94 = 8.1%. India's rate was 7.4%, so Karnataka grew 0.7 percentage points faster (a difference between two rates is in percentage points, not per cent).
3. Why the two differ: the 4.8-point gap reflects price changes.
4. Structure: shares of GSVA are services 69.8%, industry 19.4%, agriculture 10.8%. Check: 69.8 + 19.4 + 10.8 = 100.0.
5. Per capita: Karnataka Rs 4,33,326 and India Rs 2,19,575; ratio 4,33,326 / 2,19,575 = 1.97, so Karnataka is about 97% above India.

Inference: a service-led economy growing faster than India in real terms with high income per person.

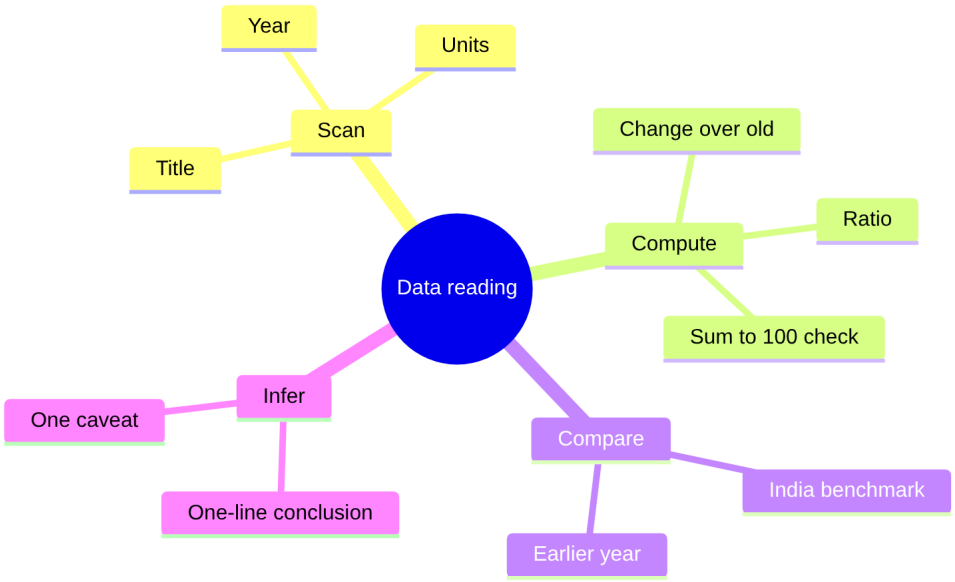
Caveats: averages hide the Bengaluru-versus-rest gap; one year is not a trend; per capita is not distribution.

Presentation tip: show each calculation in one line, round at the end, state the unit (lakh crore, per cent, percentage points) and, where allowed, sketch a small bar to show the shares.

Conclusion: in a data question, marks go to correct arithmetic, correct units and a one-line inference.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: Four letters, "S-C-C-I" = Scan, Compute, Compare, Infer. Percentage change is always (new minus old) divided by old. Two rates: subtract and call it "points".

COMMON TRAP: Percent versus percentage points. 8.1% minus 7.4% is 0.7 percentage points, not 0.7 per cent. Also never compare current-price and constant-price figures.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Executive Summary (planning.karnataka.gov.in); arithmetic checked by the review script (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS1-10 - Regional disparities in Karnataka: Nanjundappa Committee and Article 371J

GS1-10 | Regional disparities in Karnataka: Nanjundappa Committee and Article 371J

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS1-C3 appeared in 2 of the 4 sets tagged (RECURRING); 2 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Account for regional disparities within Karnataka and assess the measures taken to reduce them.

150-word version (10 marks) [128 words]

Karnataka is one of India's richer States but with sharp internal gaps.

Evidence (Economic Survey 2025-26): in 2024-25 Bengaluru Urban contributed 40.4% of State GDP, and Bengaluru Urban district's per capita income was Rs 8,55,960, against the State average of Rs 3,86,156. Kalaburagi division was lowest at Rs 1,89,938.

Causes: concentration of services, IT and investment in Bengaluru; history of the Hyderabad-Karnataka region; weak infrastructure and irrigation.

Measures:

- Nanjundappa Committee (2002) on regional imbalances.
- Article 371J (2012) special status for the Hyderabad-Karnataka region.
- Policies encouraging start-ups outside Bengaluru.

Evaluation: allocation helped social indicators but jobs need clusters, connectivity and power in northern districts. A Kalyana Karnataka board helps in monitoring. District-level planning should emphasise skills.

Conclusion: policy should shift from compensating backwardness to building clusters in other regions.

250-word version (15 marks) [222 words]

Karnataka's average income hides deep regional gaps.

Evidence (Economic Survey 2025-26, 2024-25 data):

- Bengaluru Urban contributed Rs 11,73,574 crore, 40.4% of State GDP.
- Per capita income: Bengaluru Urban district Rs 8,55,960 against a State average of Rs 3,86,156.
- Division level: Belagavi division Rs 2,26,213 and Kalaburagi division, the lowest, Rs 1,89,938.

Causes:

- Agglomeration: IT, services and investment cluster in Bengaluru.
- History: the Hyderabad-Karnataka region joined only in 1956 after under-investment in the Nizam's State.
- Structure: rain-fed farming, weak irrigation and thin industrial base in the north and interior.

Measures:

- The High Power Committee under D. M. Nanjundappa (report 2002) assessed taluk-level backwardness and recommended special development allocation.
- Article 371J (98th Amendment, 2012) provides special provisions, including a development board and reservation in education and jobs for the Hyderabad-Karnataka region, now called Kalyana Karnataka.
- The Startup Policy 2025-30 aims for 10,000 of its 25,000 start-ups to come from outside Bengaluru.

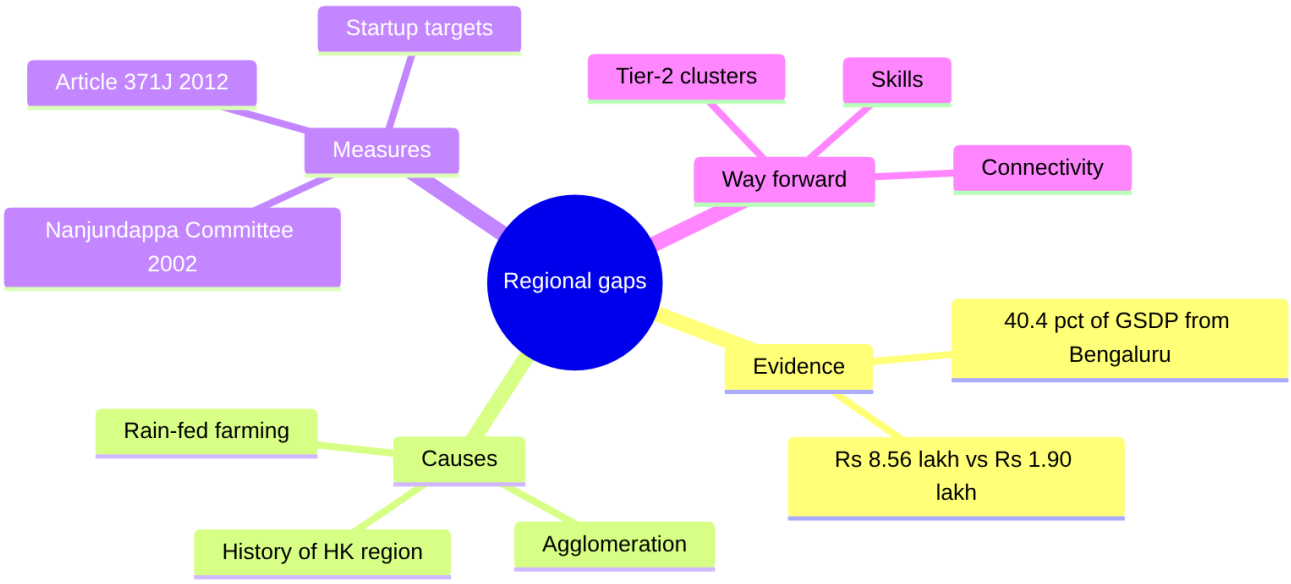
Evaluation: allocations raised social indicators but did not build jobs; the lesson is to build clusters in Tier-2 cities with connectivity, skills and power.

Way forward: develop Tier-2 hubs such as Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad and Mangaluru with logistics and power; strengthen irrigation and agro-processing in the north; use the Survey's division-level data for annual monitoring; and link allocation to outcomes rather than inputs.

Conclusion: equal development needs growth poles beyond Bengaluru, not only transfers.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "40 : 1 : 2": 40% of GSDP from one district; the richest district is about four times the poorest division's per-capita (8.6 lakh vs 1.9 lakh); fix = two tools, Committee 2002 + Article 371J 2012.

COMMON TRAP: Compare like with like: district per capita (Bengaluru Urban) and division per capita (Kalaburagi) are different units and the Survey's State average is for 2024-25. Say so in the answer or compare only within the same level.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Executive Summary); PRS/Survey for Startup Policy target; Constitution Art. 371J (legislative.gov.in); report of the High Power Committee for Redressal of Regional Imbalances (Nanjundappa, 2002), Government of Karnataka. Web-verified (see REVIEW.md).

NEXT UP: GS2-01 - Ocean currents: influence on climate and fisheries

GS 2 (Paper 3): 10 model answers

GS2-01 | Ocean currents: influence on climate and fisheries

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-A1 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Describe how ocean currents are generated and show how they influence coastal climate and the world's fishing grounds.

150-word version (10 marks) [149 words]

Ocean currents are large, continuous flows of surface water. They are driven by planetary winds, the Coriolis effect, differences in temperature and salinity and the coastline, and they form gyres: clockwise in the northern hemisphere and anticlockwise in the southern.

Climate effects:

- Warm currents raise coastal temperature and rainfall; the Gulf Stream and North Atlantic Drift keep north-west European ports ice-free in winter.
- Cold currents cool coasts and suppress rain; the Peru (Humboldt) current is linked to the Atacama and the Benguela current to the Namib desert.

Fisheries:

- Cold currents bring nutrient-rich water by upwelling, which supports plankton and fish.
- The Grand Banks, where the warm Gulf Stream meets the cold Labrador current, and the Peruvian coast are major fishing grounds.

El Nino weakens the Peru current and damages the anchoveta catch and rainfall patterns elsewhere.

Conclusion: currents redistribute heat and nutrients, so they shape both weather and livelihoods.

250-word version (15 marks) [248 words]

Ocean currents are continuous movements of surface water over long distances. They arise from planetary winds, the Coriolis effect, differences in temperature and salinity, and the deflection of flow by continents. Together they form gyres that run clockwise in the northern hemisphere and anticlockwise in the southern hemisphere.

Influence on climate:

- Warm currents carry heat polewards. The Gulf Stream and its extension, the North Atlantic Drift, give north-west Europe a much milder winter than other regions at the same latitude,.
- Cold currents carry cool water towards the equator and reduce rainfall over adjacent land. The Peru (Humboldt) current is associated with the Atacama desert, and the Benguela current with the Namib.
- Where warm and cold currents meet, fog is frequent, as near Newfoundland.
- Monsoon regions are influenced by the Somali current, which reverses with the seasons in the Indian Ocean.

Influence on fisheries:

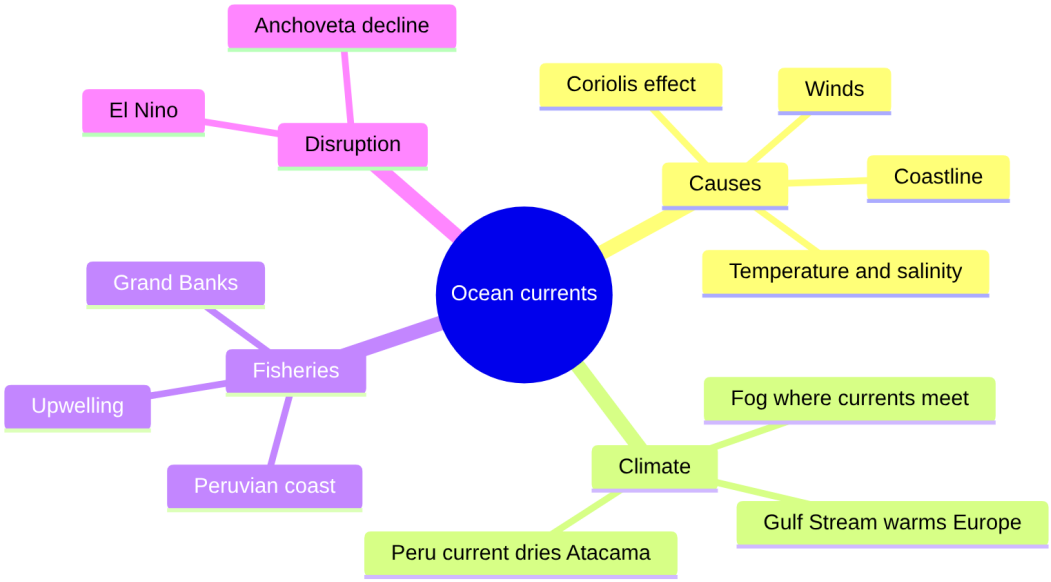
- Upwelling of cold water brings nutrients to the surface; plankton blooms feed large fish stocks.
- Major fishing grounds lie where currents meet: the Grand Banks (Gulf Stream and Labrador current), the north-west Pacific and the Peruvian coast.
- Fishing communities are also exposed: during El Nino the Peru current weakens, the anchoveta catch falls, and rainfall patterns change across the Pacific.

Human response: shipping uses currents to save fuel, and fisheries need quotas and satellite monitoring of sea-surface temperature to avoid over-fishing.

Conclusion: ocean currents work as a global conveyor of heat and nutrients; understanding them helps in forecasting weather, planning fisheries and protecting coastal livelihoods.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "W-C-F": Warm raises rain, Cold dries the coast, Fog + Fish where they Meet. Two desert pairs: Peru-Atacama, Benguela-Namib.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write "warm currents always cause rain everywhere"; say "raise coastal temperature and rainfall". Do not mix up clockwise (north) and anticlockwise (south).



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Standard physical-geography references: NCERT Class XI, Fundamentals of Physical Geography, ch. 14 (Movements of Ocean Water); NOAA National Ocean Service, "What is upwelling?" and "El Nino". Concepts only; no statistics used.

NEXT UP: GS2-02 - Migration: causes, consequences and policy response

GS2-02 | Migration: causes, consequences and policy response

PREDICTED: unit GS2-A2 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Examine the push and pull factors behind human migration and discuss its social and economic consequences for source and destination regions.

150-word version (10 marks) [146 words]

Migration is the movement of people from one place to another with the intention of settling, temporarily or permanently. E. S. Lee (1966) explained it through push and pull factors.

Push factors: unemployment, poverty, drought, conflict, discrimination and displacement by projects. Pull factors: jobs, higher wages, education, health services and safety.

Consequences:

- Source region: remittances raise household income and spending on education; but there is a loss of young skilled workers and social strain on the elderly left behind.
- Destination region: labour supply and growth; but pressure on housing, water, transport and the growth of slums.
- Migrants face poor wages, unsafe work and loss of voting and welfare entitlements.

Policy: portable benefits (ration card, health cover), registration of workers, affordable rental housing and skills.

Conclusion: migration is a natural response to unequal development; policy should make it safe and dignified rather than try to stop it.

250-word version (15 marks) [250 words]

Migration is the movement of people across a defined boundary to settle, temporarily or permanently. It may be internal (rural to urban, inter-State) or international, voluntary or forced. E. S. Lee (1966) framed it as a balance of push factors at the origin, pull factors at the destination and intervening obstacles such as cost and distance.

Push factors: unemployment, low farm income, drought and flood, conflict, discrimination and displacement by dams and mines. Pull factors: jobs, better wages, education and health services, safety, and social networks.

Consequences for source regions:

- Remittances raise household income, savings and spending on education and health.
- Loss of young, skilled workers (brain drain) and strain on families, with the elderly and women often left behind.

Consequences for destination regions:

- A larger labour force supports growth in construction, services and manufacturing.
- Pressure on housing, water, transport and sanitation, growth of informal settlements, and sometimes social tension.

Consequences for migrants: low wages, unsafe work, and loss of ration, health and voting access in the new place.

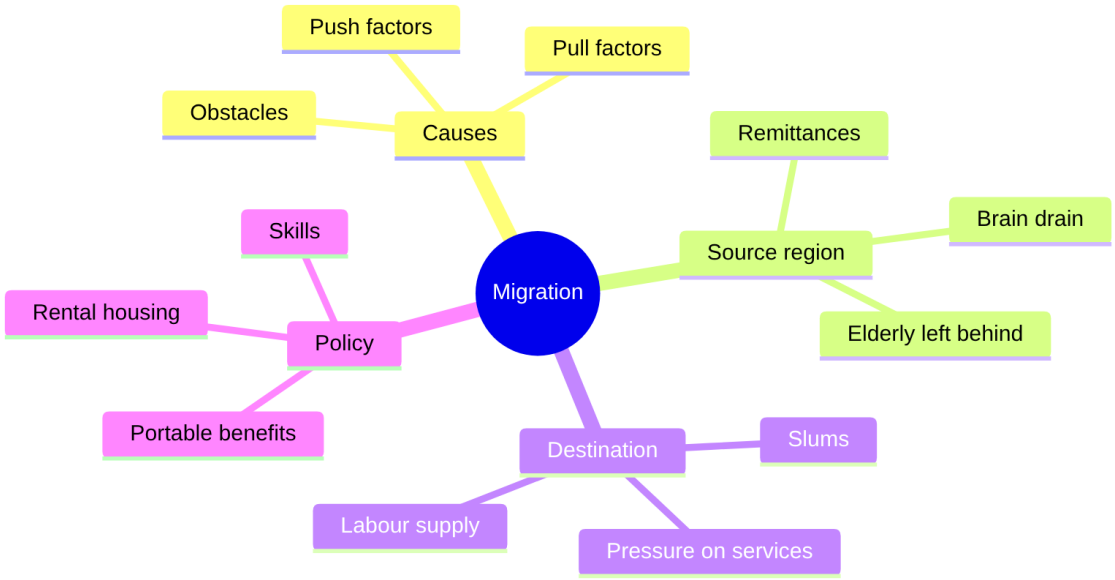
Karnataka angle: Bengaluru draws migrants for services and construction, while lower-income north and interior districts send seasonal workers; the Economic Survey 2025-26 recorded Bengaluru Urban as 40.4% of State GDP.

Policy response: portable welfare entitlements, worker registration, rental housing, skill training and city planning that treats migrants as residents.

Conclusion: migration is a rational response to uneven development. It cannot be wished away; a rights-based approach that spreads growth and protects migrants will turn it into a benefit for both ends.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "P-P-O": Push at home, Pull away, Obstacles in between (Lee, 1966). Then "Source gains money, loses youth; Destination gains labour, loses space."

COMMON TRAP: Do not call all migration "brain drain" or all migrants "problems". Show both source and destination, and mention migrants' own vulnerability. Avoid quoting migrant numbers you cannot source.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: E. S. Lee, "A Theory of Migration", Demography, vol. 3(1), 1966 (push-pull framework); NCERT Class XII, Human Geography, ch. 2 and 3 (Migration; Population); Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Executive Summary) for the Bengaluru Urban share.

NEXT UP: GS2-03 - The Indian monsoon: mechanism, variability and impact

GS2-03 | The Indian monsoon: mechanism, variability and impact

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-A3 appeared in 2 of the 4 sets tagged (RECURRING); 3 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain the mechanism of the south-west monsoon in India and the factors responsible for its variability.

150-word version (10 marks) [137 words]

The south-west monsoon is a seasonal reversal of winds that brings about three-quarters of India's annual rainfall between June and September.

Mechanism:

- In summer the Tibetan plateau and north-west India heat up and form a low-pressure area; the ITCZ shifts north.
- The south-east trade winds cross the equator, are deflected right by the Coriolis effect and blow as south-west winds, carrying moisture from the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal.
- The westerly jet moves north of the Himalaya and the tropical easterly jet strengthens, helping the onset, normally over Kerala around 1 June.

Variability: El Nino (weaker monsoon), La Nina (stronger), the Indian Ocean Dipole, break periods and Himalayan snow cover.

Impact: farm output, reservoir storage, food prices and the rural economy.

Conclusion: because Indian agriculture is still largely rain-dependent, accurate forecasts and drought-proofing are vital.

250-word version (15 marks) [248 words]

The south-west monsoon is a seasonal reversal of wind direction caused by the differential heating of land and sea. It brings roughly three-quarters of India's annual rainfall between June and September, so it governs agriculture, water supply and prices.

Mechanism:

- In summer the Tibetan plateau and the north-west plains heat up, creating a thermal low. The Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) shifts northward to about the Gangetic plain.
- South-east trade winds from the southern hemisphere cross the equator, are deflected to the right by the Coriolis force and become south-west winds, drawing moisture from the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal.
- The subtropical westerly jet withdraws north of the Himalaya and the tropical easterly jet appears over peninsular India, which triggers the burst of the monsoon. Onset is normally over Kerala around 1 June.
- Orography matters: the Western Ghats give heavy rain on the windward coast, while the leeward interior of Karnataka becomes a rain-shadow region.

Factors in variability:

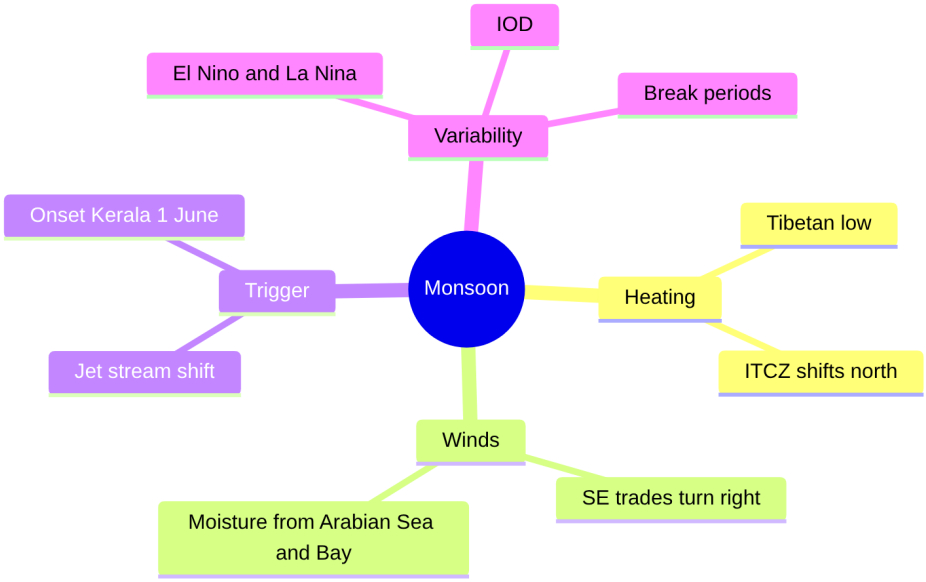
- El Nino years tend to weaken the monsoon and La Nina years strengthen it.
- The Indian Ocean Dipole: a positive phase can offset El Nino.
- Break monsoon periods, the position of the monsoon trough and extra-tropical disturbances.
- Indian Ocean warming and Eurasian snow cover are also studied.

Impact: rain-fed farming, kharif output, reservoir levels, hydropower and food prices are exposed to monsoon swings, and extremes of floods and drought both occur.

Conclusion: accurate forecasting, watershed management and crop insurance are needed to cushion the economy against a variable monsoon.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "H-C-J-O": Heat low over Tibet, Cross-equatorial flow turned right, Jets switch (westerly out, easterly in), Onset at Kerala ~1 June.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the monsoon "brings all of India's rainfall" or that El Nino always causes drought. Say "tends to". Avoid exact rainfall percentages other than "about three-quarters".



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: NCERT Class XI, India: Physical Environment, ch. 4 (Climate); India Meteorological Department (mausam.imd.gov.in), monsoon onset over Kerala (normal date 1 June); NOAA/IMD on El Nino and the Indian Ocean Dipole. Concepts only; no statistics beyond the standard three-quarters share.

NEXT UP: GS2-04 - Urbanisation in Karnataka: pattern, problems and policy

GS2-04 | Urbanisation in Karnataka: pattern, problems and policy

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-A6 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the pattern of urbanisation in Karnataka and the main challenges for its cities.

150-word version (10 marks) [135 words]

Karnataka's urbanisation is high but uneven. According to the Census 2011 (quoted in the Economic Survey 2025-26), 38.67 per cent of the State's population lives in urban centres, above the national average, and the urban share rose by 4.68 percentage points between 2001 and 2011.

Pattern:

- Bengaluru dominates; the Survey reports Bengaluru Urban at 40.4 per cent of State GDP (2024-25).
- Tier-2 cities such as Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, Mangaluru and Belagavi are growing more slowly.

Challenges:

- Traffic congestion, water supply, solid waste and flooding in Bengaluru.
- Weak finances and staff in urban local bodies.
- Urban sprawl onto farmland and lakes.

Response:

- Namma Metro (Phase-2 of 75.06 km) and the Suburban Rail project.
- Decentralised growth through the Startup Policy aim of 10,000 start-ups outside Bengaluru.

Conclusion: balanced urban growth needs strong city governments and well-connected second-tier cities.

250-word version (15 marks) [245 words]

Karnataka is more urbanised than India as a whole. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that, as per Census 2011, 38.67 per cent of the population lives in urban centres and the urban share increased by 4.68 percentage points during 2001-2011.

Pattern:

- Primate city: Bengaluru Urban contributed Rs 11,73,574 crore, 40.4 per cent of State GDP in 2024-25, drawing in IT, start-ups and services.
- Second-tier cities such as Mysuru, Mangaluru, Hubballi-Dharwad and Belagavi have specialised functions in education, ports, trade and industry, but with a far smaller scale of investment.
- Regional gap: the north and interior have fewer urban jobs and lower incomes.

Challenges:

- Mobility: congestion and air quality in Bengaluru.
- Basic services: water, sewerage and solid waste, and flooding because lakes and drains have been built over.
- Governance: fragmented agencies, limited own revenue of urban local bodies.
- Housing: informal settlements and high rents for migrants.

Responses (Economic Survey 2025-26):

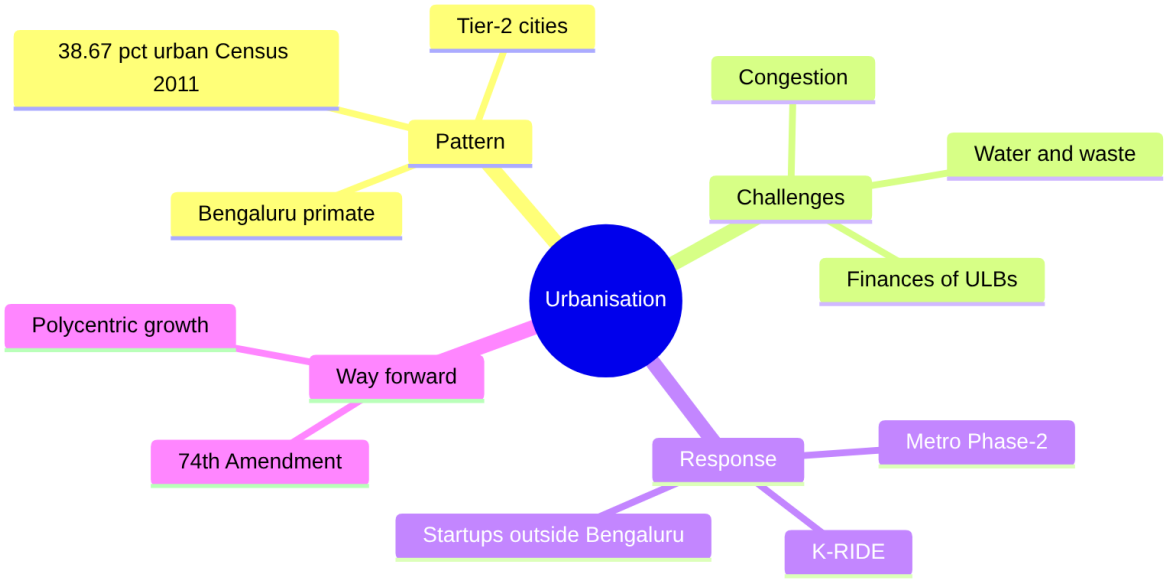
- Bengaluru Metro Phase-2 is 75.06 km, of which 53.80 km is operational; the Bengaluru Sub-Urban Rail (K-RIDE) has a revised cost of Rs 23,103 crore over 148.17 km and four corridors.
- The Startup Policy 2025-30 aims to nurture 10,000 start-ups outside Bengaluru, which can spread urban growth.

Way forward: strengthen the 74th Amendment institutions with funds, functions and functionaries; invest in Tier-2 city transport and water; protect lakes; and plan the metropolitan region as a whole.

Conclusion: Karnataka needs polycentric urban growth, because a single dominant city will keep hitting limits of space, water and mobility.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "38-4-40": 38.67% urban (Census 2011), +4.68 points in a decade, 40.4% of GSDP from Bengaluru Urban.

COMMON TRAP: The 38.67% is a 2011 Census figure; never present it as the current urban share. Also do not mix the district share of GSDP (40.4%) with population share.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Executive Summary and full text, Section on Demography/Urban Development), quoting Census 2011; Constitution (74th Amendment) Act, 1992 (legislative.gov.in).

NEXT UP: GS2-05 - Indian federalism: nature, strains and cooperative practice

GS2-05 | Indian federalism: nature, strains and cooperative practice

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-B1 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Is India's Constitution federal or unitary in spirit? Evaluate with the help of constitutional provisions and judicial decisions.

150-word version (10 marks) [149 words]

India is best described as a federation with a unitary bias, or "quasi-federal" (K. C. Wheare); Article 1 calls it a "Union of States".

Federal features: written constitution, two levels of government, Seventh Schedule distribution of powers, independent judiciary and a Constitution that cannot be changed by Parliament alone on federal matters (Article 368).

Unitary features: a strong Centre, residuary powers with Parliament, Governor appointed by the President, power to reorganise States (Article 3), single citizenship and an All-India Services cadre.

Judicial view: in S. R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) the Supreme Court held that federalism is part of the basic structure and made the use of Article 356 subject to judicial review.

Cooperative practice: Finance Commission (Article 280), Inter-State Council (Article 263), and the GST Council (Article 279A).

Conclusion: India is a flexible federation that tilts to the Centre in crises but is growing more cooperative.

250-word version (15 marks) [250 words]

India is a federation with a unitary bias. Article 1 describes India as a "Union of States", and K. C. Wheare called it "quasi-federal". Dr Ambedkar explained that the Union is not the result of an agreement by States and States cannot secede.

Federal features:

- Written Constitution and independent judiciary.
- Two levels of government with powers divided in the Seventh Schedule.
- Rigid amendment for federal provisions, which needs ratification by half of the States (Article 368).

Unitary features:

- Residuary power lies with Parliament and, in some cases, Parliament can legislate on State subjects (Articles 249 and 252).
- Power to alter State boundaries and names (Article 3).
- Governor is appointed by the President; All-India Services; emergency provisions (Article 356); single citizenship and integrated judiciary.

Judicial view: S. R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) held that federalism is part of the basic structure and that the President's proclamation under Article 356 is subject to judicial review. Bommai was a former Chief Minister of Karnataka.

Cooperative federalism in practice:

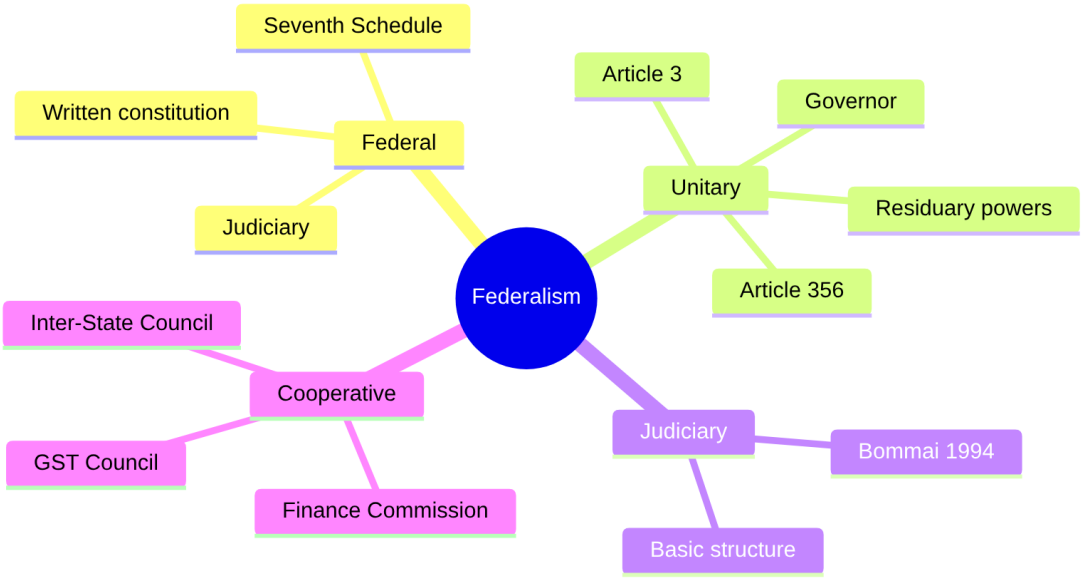
- Finance Commission (Article 280): the 16th Finance Commission retained States' share of the divisible pool at 41 per cent; Karnataka's horizontal share was raised to 4.131 per cent from 3.647 per cent in the 15th Commission.
- GST Council under Article 279A (101st Amendment, 2016) is a joint forum of the Union and States.

Strains: discretionary Centrally Sponsored Schemes, cess and surcharge outside the divisible pool, and gubernatorial disputes.

Conclusion: India's federalism is adaptive and works best when the Centre treats States as partners.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "W-B-C": Wheare's quasi-federal, Bommai makes federalism basic structure, Cooperative bodies (FC 280, ISC 263, GST Council 279A).

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that Bommai "abolished" Article 356; it made the use reviewable. Do not claim the share of the divisible pool changed; the 16th FC kept it at 41 per cent while shifting the inter-State shares.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Arts. 1, 3, 249, 252, 263, 279A, 280, 356, 368 (legislative.gov.in); S. R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) 3 SCC 1; Report of the Sixteenth Finance Commission (fincomindia.nic.in), Karnataka share 4.131% vs 3.647% (15th FC) per Lok Sabha reply of 3 Aug 2026 and The Hindu, 1 Feb 2026. Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS2-06 - The Governor: constitutional position, discretion and reform

GS2-06 | The Governor: constitutional position, discretion and reform

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-B3 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Critically examine the role of the Governor in the working of a State government and suggest reforms.

150-word version (10 marks) [145 words]

The Governor is the constitutional head of a State (Article 153), appointed by the President (Article 155) and holding office during the President's pleasure (Article 156). Under Article 163 the Governor acts on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers, except where the Constitution requires discretion.

Discretionary spaces: inviting a leader to form a government in a hung assembly, reserving a Bill for the President (Article 200), recommending President's Rule (Article 356).

Controversies: delay in giving assent to Bills, selection of the Chief Minister when no party has a majority, and removal at will.

Judicial guidance: Shamsher Singh (1974) held that the Governor is bound by ministerial advice in most matters; Nabam Rebia (2016) limited discretion in summoning the Assembly.

Reforms: Punchhi Commission (2010): fixed tenure and impeachment-like removal, appointee should not be an active politician.

Conclusion: a neutral Governor strengthens cooperative federalism.

250-word version (15 marks) [250 words]

The Governor is the constitutional head of a State: appointed by the President (Article 155), holding office during the President's pleasure (Article 156), and acting on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers headed by the Chief Minister, except in matters where the Constitution requires discretion (Article 163).

Powers:

- Executive: appoints the Chief Minister and other ministers.
- Legislative: summons and dissolves the Assembly, assents to Bills, reserves Bills for the President (Article 200), and issues ordinances (Article 213).

Areas of discretion: choosing a Chief Minister in a hung House, reserving Bills, and sending reports to the President.

Concerns:

- Perceived partisanship because appointment and removal are in the Centre's hands.
- Delays in assent to Bills and in summoning the House.
- Misuse of discretion in forming governments.

Judicial and expert guidance:

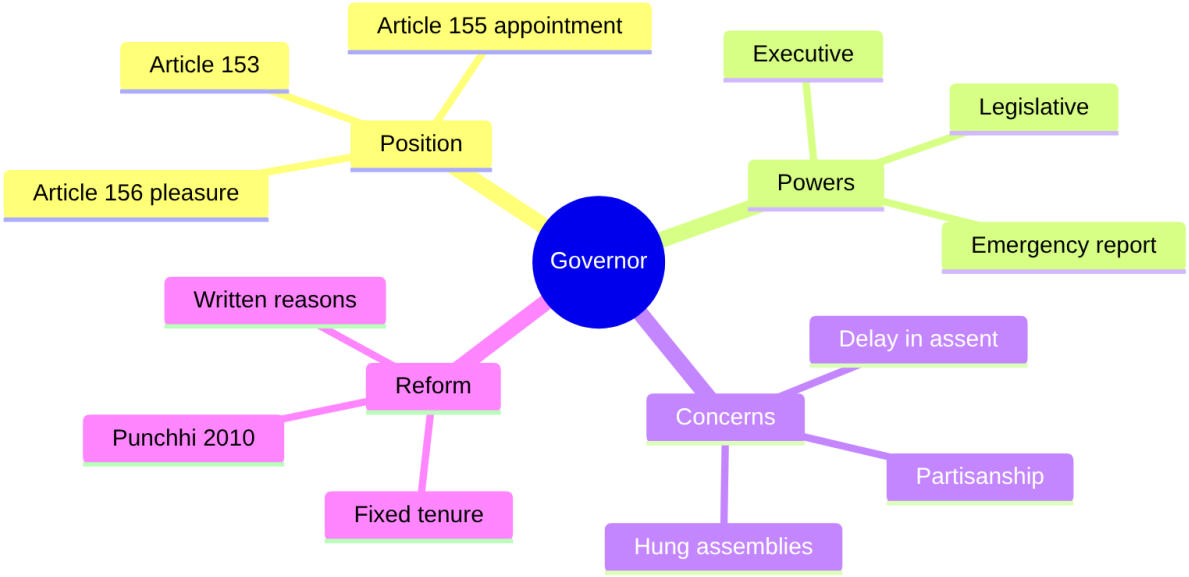
- Shamsher Singh v. State of Punjab (1974): the Governor is a constitutional head bound by ministerial advice in most matters.
- S. R. Bommai (1994): floor test is the proper way to decide majority.
- Nabam Rebia (2016): limited the Governor's discretion in summoning the Assembly.
- Punchhi Commission (2010): fixed five-year tenure, removal only by a process similar to impeachment, and the Governor should not be an active politician in the recent past.

Way forward: follow the Sarkaria-Punchhi norms through a convention accepted by the Centre and States, ensure the Chief Minister is consulted on appointment, and give reasons in writing for all discretionary decisions.

Conclusion: the Governor should be a guide and a bridge, not a rival centre of power.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "AAA-D": Appointed (155), At pleasure (156), Advice binding (163), Discretion narrow. Cases: Shamsher (74), Bommai (94), Nabam (2016), Punchhi (2010).

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Governor "must" accept ministerial advice in every matter; the Constitution carves out discretion. Also avoid citing recent Governor disputes by name unless you can source them.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Arts. 153, 155, 156, 163, 200, 213, 356 (legislative.gov.in); Shamsher Singh v. State of Punjab (1974) 2 SCC 831; Nabam Rebia v. Deputy Speaker (2016) 8 SCC 1; S. R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) 3 SCC 1; Punchhi Commission on Centre-State Relations (2010), vol. 2 (Governors). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS2-07 - Basic structure doctrine and amendment of the Constitution

GS2-07 | Basic structure doctrine and amendment of the Constitution

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-B5 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 3 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain the basic structure doctrine and how it has shaped Parliament's power to amend the Constitution.

150-word version (10 marks) [132 words]

Article 368 gives Parliament power to amend the Constitution, but the Supreme Court has placed a limit. In Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), by a 7:6 majority, the Court held that Parliament can amend any provision but cannot destroy the basic structure of the Constitution.

Earlier position:

- Shankari Prasad (1951) and Sajjan Singh (1965): Parliament can amend fundamental rights.
- Golak Nath (1967): Parliament cannot.

Elements recognised as basic: supremacy of the Constitution, republican and democratic government, secularism, federalism, separation of powers, judicial review, free and fair elections.

Later cases: Indira Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975), Minerva Mills (1980) (harmony between Parts III and IV), and I. R. Coelho (2007) (Ninth Schedule laws are open to review).

Conclusion: the doctrine protects constitutional identity and checks majoritarianism, though its content is judge-made.

250-word version (15 marks) [248 words]

Article 368 lets Parliament amend the Constitution, but the Supreme Court has held that the power is not unlimited. The basic structure doctrine arises from Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (24 April 1973), decided by a 13-judge bench with a 7:6 majority: Parliament may amend any provision, including fundamental rights, but cannot alter the basic structure or framework of the Constitution.

Evolution:

- Shankari Prasad (1951) and Sajjan Singh (1965): the amending power covers fundamental rights.
- Golak Nath (1967): Parliament cannot amend fundamental rights.
- Kesavananda Bharati (1973): amending power is wide but not unlimited; the Court did not list the basic features once and for all.
- Indira Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975): free and fair elections are basic.
- Minerva Mills (1980): limited amending power is itself a basic feature, and harmony between fundamental rights and directive principles is part of the structure.
- I. R. Coelho (2007): laws placed in the Ninth Schedule after 24 April 1973 are open to challenge if they violate the basic structure.
- NJAC case (2015): the 99th Amendment creating the National Judicial Appointments Commission was struck down for affecting judicial independence.

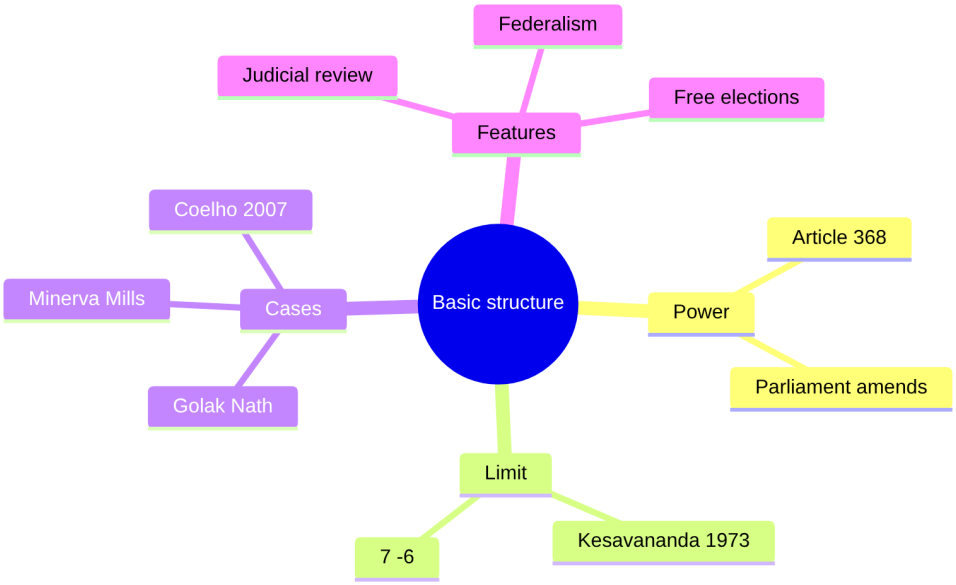
Features commonly recognised: supremacy of the Constitution, rule of law, republican and democratic form, secularism, federalism, separation of powers, judicial review.

Critique: critics argue the doctrine is judge-made and its content is open-ended; supporters say it prevents a temporary majority from rewriting the Constitution's identity.

Conclusion: the doctrine is the constitution's safeguard against its own amendment and a core part of Indian constitutionalism.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-G-K-M-C": Shankari (can), Golak (cannot), Kesavananda (cannot destroy basic structure), Minerva (balance), Coelho (Ninth Schedule reviewable).

> **COMMON TRAP:** Kesavananda did not give a closed list of basic features; do not claim it did. Write "illustrative features recognised in later cases".



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Art. 368 (legislative.gov.in); Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) 4 SCC 225 (7:6, 13-judge bench, 24 April 1973); Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980) 3 SCC 625; I. R. Coelho v. State of Tamil Nadu (2007) 2 SCC 1; Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association v. Union of India (2015) 5 SCC 1. Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS2-08 - Finance Commission: role, recent recommendations and Karnataka's concerns

GS2-08 | Finance Commission: role, recent recommendations and Karnataka's concerns

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-B6 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the role of the Finance Commission in Indian federalism, with reference to the concerns of a State such as Karnataka.

150-word version (10 marks) [136 words]

The Finance Commission is a constitutional body under Article 280, appointed by the President every five years to recommend how central taxes are shared with the States (vertical devolution), how each State's share is determined (horizontal devolution) and the principles for grants-in-aid.

The 16th Finance Commission (chair: Arvind Panagariya, period 2026-31) kept the States' share of the divisible pool at 41 per cent and raised Karnataka's horizontal share to 4.131 per cent from 3.647 per cent.

Concerns of Karnataka:

- Karnataka's share had fallen from 4.713 per cent in the 14th Commission to 3.647 per cent in the 15th.
- Fast-growing States feel penalised for efficiency and for their contribution to GDP.
- The Survey noted loss of GST compensation and lower devolution.

Conclusion: devolution should reward both need and performance; a transparent formula keeps trust in cooperative federalism.

250-word version (15 marks) [241 words]

Article 280 requires the President to constitute a Finance Commission every five years. It recommends how the net proceeds of central taxes are shared between the Union and the States, and the principles for grants-in-aid. It corrects vertical imbalance (the Centre raises more than it spends) and horizontal imbalance (States differ in capacity and need).

The Sixteenth Finance Commission, chaired by Arvind Panagariya, was tabled on 1 February 2026 and covers 2026-27 to 2030-31:

- The States' share of the divisible pool stays at 41 per cent.
- The formula gives a 10 per cent weight to a State's contribution to GDP.
- Karnataka's share rose to 4.131 per cent, from 3.647 per cent in the 15th Commission.
- Revenue deficit, sector-specific and State-specific grants of the 15th Commission were discontinued; a fiscal deficit target of 3 per cent of GSDP is recommended for States.

Karnataka's viewpoint:

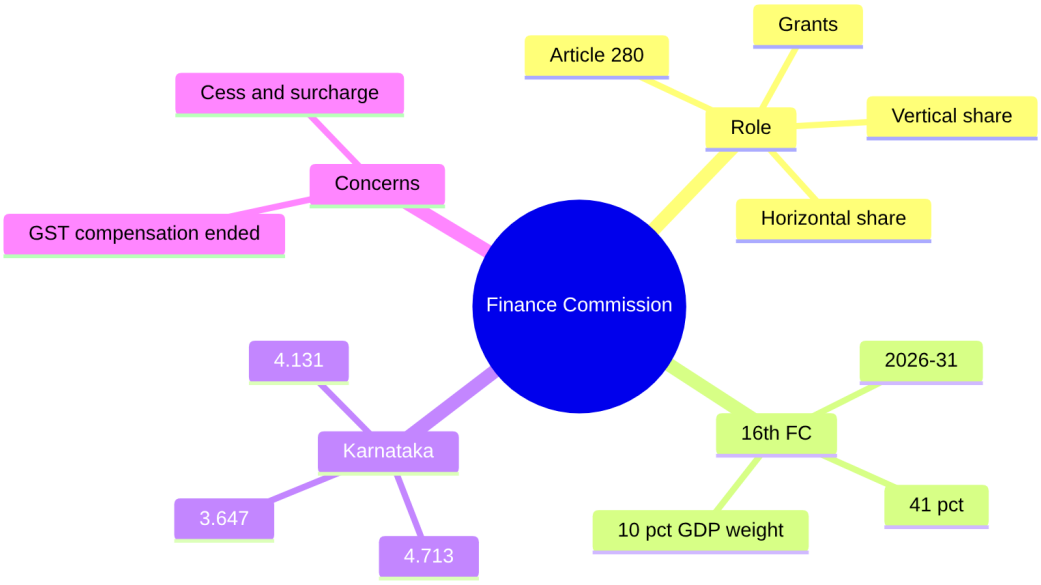
- The Chief Minister called the rise in the share marginal and the disaster and local-body grants disappointing (Indian Express, February 2026).
- The Economic Survey 2025-26 cites the end of GST compensation from 2023-24 and lower devolution under the 15th Commission as a source of fiscal strain.
- Budget 2026-27 estimates the State's share in central taxes at Rs 63,050 crore.

Evaluation: the Commission balances equity and efficiency, but cesses and surcharges outside the divisible pool and centrally sponsored schemes narrow the effect of devolution.

Conclusion: stable, rule-based devolution protects fiscal federalism; States need predictable resources for their own priorities.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "41 : 4.131": States keep 41%; Karnataka's slice 4.713 (14th) to 3.647 (15th) to 4.131 (16th): down then partly back.

> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the share of States was raised; it stayed at 41%. The change is the horizontal split. Also quote the year of each Commission.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Art. 280; Report of the Sixteenth Finance Commission (fincomindia.nic.in), tabled 1 Feb 2026; The Hindu (1 Feb 2026) and Lok Sabha reply of 3 Aug 2026 for Karnataka's shares (web-verified); PRS, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27; Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26.

NEXT UP: GS2-09 - Good governance, Lokpal and Lokayukta, and service delivery in Karnataka

GS2-09 | Good governance, Lokpal and Lokayukta, and service delivery in Karnataka

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-C6 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss how institutions such as Lokpal and Lokayukta and service-delivery laws promote good governance, with examples from Karnataka.

150-word version (10 marks) [145 words]

Good governance means governance that is participatory, transparent, accountable, responsive, rule-based, equitable and efficient. Corruption and slow delivery are its main obstacles.

Institutions:

- Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides a Lokpal for the Union and Lokayuktas for the States to inquire into corruption complaints against public servants.
- The Right to Information Act, 2005 gives citizens the right to seek information.
- Citizens' charters and service guarantees.

Karnataka examples (Economic Survey 2025-26): the Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions, with 209 new services added in 2025; Seva Sindhu delivers 712 services from over 80 departments through 7,569 Gram One centres.

Digital platforms such as Bhoomi and Kutumba and a WhatsApp grievance chatbot, which registered 7,136 grievances, widen access.

Challenges: limited staff and powers, delays in sanction for prosecution, and low awareness.

Conclusion: strong institutions with digital delivery and social audit make governance responsive.

250-word version (15 marks) [228 words]

Good governance is participatory, transparent, accountable, responsive, equitable and rule-based. The Second Administrative Reforms Commission linked it to ethics, citizen centricity and e-governance.

Institutional safeguards:

- Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013: a Lokpal at the Centre and Lokayuktas in States to inquire into corruption complaints; States must establish Lokayuktas by law. Karnataka already has an earlier Lokayukta under its own statute.
- Right to Information Act, 2005: proactive disclosure and the right to seek information.
- Central Vigilance Commission, courts and the CAG.
- Citizens' charters and service-delivery guarantees.

Karnataka's service-delivery model (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- The Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions, with 209 new services added in 2025.
- Under Seva Sindhu, 712 services from over 80 departments are delivered through 7,569 Gram One centres, with 4.23 crore transactions.
- Platforms such as Bhoomi, Kutumba and K-GIS streamline land, family and geospatial data.
- Grievance redressal through a WhatsApp chatbot: 1,70,659 users and 7,136 grievances registered.

Limitations:

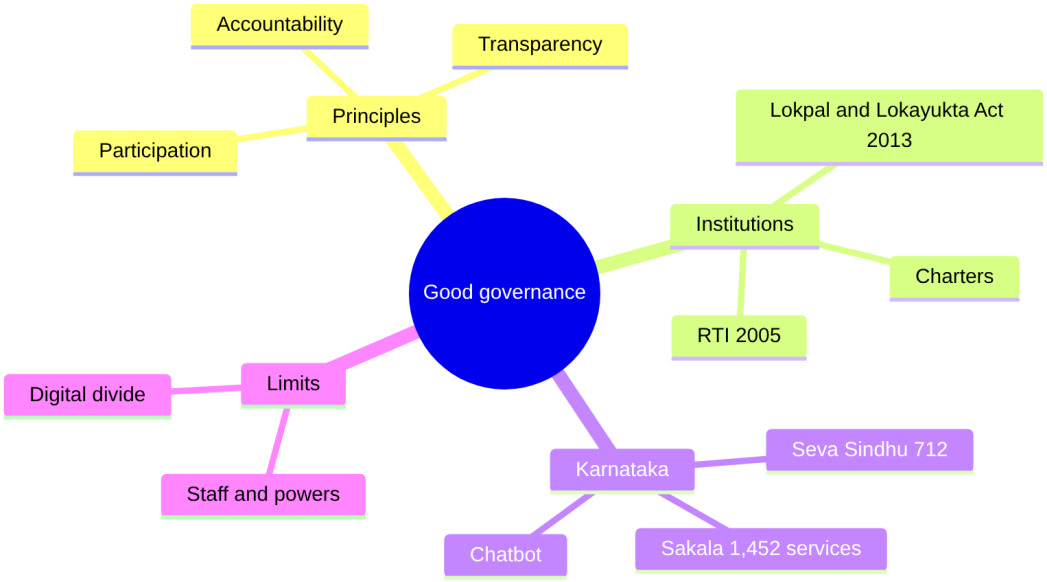
- Shortage of staff and investigative capacity in anti-corruption bodies, and dependence on government for sanction to prosecute.
- Digital divide: poor connectivity and low literacy exclude some citizens.
- Penalty clauses in service-delivery laws are often weakly enforced.

Way forward: functional independence and resources for the Lokayukta, social audit of services, a single grievance portal and regular publication of service-level data.

Conclusion: institutions create the rules, technology reduces contact, and citizen participation keeps both honest.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "3 doors": Rules (Sakala), Doors (Seva Sindhu / Gram One), Watchdogs (Lokayukta + RTI). Remember 1,452 / 114 / 209 as "Sakala numbers".

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim the Lokpal Act abolished State Lokayuktas; it requires States to establish them. Do not quote Sakala numbers from older years; the Survey figures are for 2025.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 (indiacode.nic.in); Right to Information Act, 2005; Second Administrative Reforms Commission, 4th Report, "Ethics in Governance" (2007) for the link between good governance and ethics; Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Executive Summary) for Sakala, Seva Sindhu and the grievance chatbot. Web-verified for statutes.

NEXT UP: GS2-10 - India and its neighbourhood: principles, instruments and challenges

GS2-10 | India and its neighbourhood: principles, instruments and challenges

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS2-C7 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Evaluate India's neighbourhood policy and the role of regional organisations such as SAARC and BIMSTEC.

150-word version (10 marks) [137 words]

India's neighbourhood policy rests on the Gujral Doctrine's idea of non-reciprocal goodwill, and since 2014 on "Neighbourhood First". It stresses connectivity, trade, security and people-to-people ties.

Instruments:

- Bilateral: lines of credit, development projects, energy and water treaties, the Indus Waters Treaty (1960) with Pakistan and the Ganga Waters Treaty (1996) with Bangladesh.
- Regional: SAARC (founded 1985) has stalled since its 2016 summit; India has put weight on BIMSTEC (1997) which links South and Southeast Asia and has a secretariat in Dhaka.
- Sub-regional: the BBIN motor vehicles initiative for road connectivity.
- Security: coordinated border management and counter-terrorism cooperation.

Challenges: border and terror issues with Pakistan, trade imbalance, China's growing presence in Sri Lanka, Nepal and the Maldives, and domestic politics of neighbours.

Conclusion: India should keep a steady, development-led approach, using sub-regional groupings to deliver results on time.

250-word version (15 marks) [244 words]

India's neighbourhood policy aims at a peaceful, stable and connected periphery, because India's own growth depends on regional stability. Its guiding ideas include the Panchsheel, the Gujral Doctrine (non-reciprocal goodwill towards smaller neighbours) and, since 2014, "Neighbourhood First" with emphasis on connectivity, trade and people-to-people ties.

Instruments:

- Bilateral: development aid, lines of credit, border trade, energy cooperation and water-sharing treaties such as the Indus Waters Treaty (1960) and the Ganga Waters Treaty (1996).
- Regional: SAARC (established 1985, Dhaka) has been largely inactive since the 19th Summit planned for Islamabad in 2016 did not take place. BIMSTEC (formed 1997) links South Asia and the Bay of Bengal states and has a secretariat in Dhaka; its summit in Bangkok in April 2025 was the sixth.
- Sub-regional: BBIN motor vehicles initiative and the Mekong-Ganga cooperation.
- Security: coordinated border management and counter-terrorism cooperation.

Challenges:

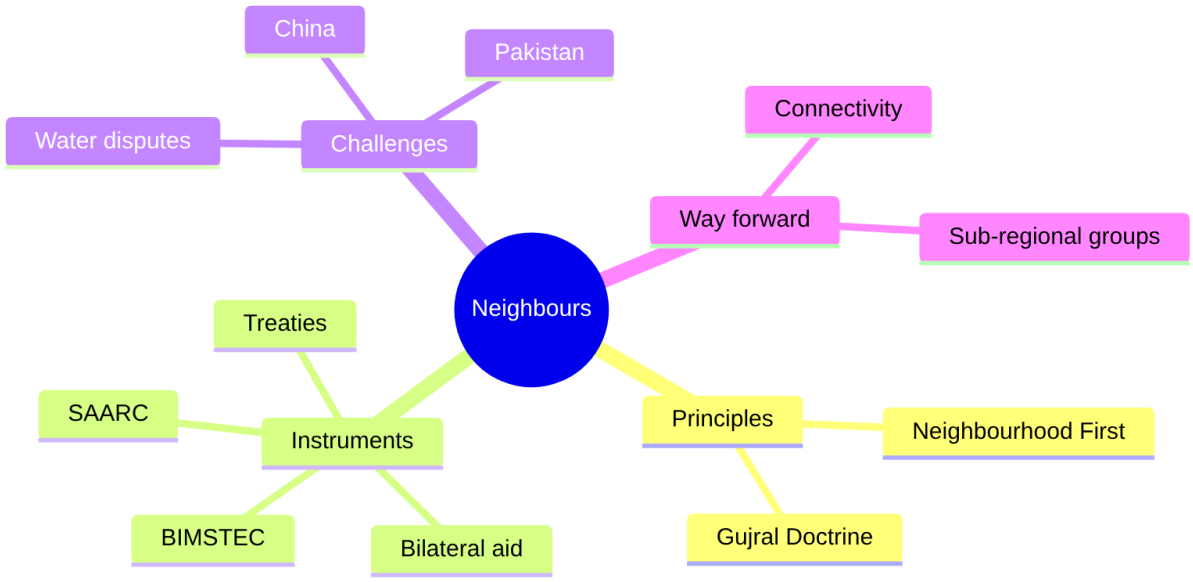
- Trust deficit and terror-related issues with Pakistan; in April 2025 India placed the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance.
- China's investments and ports in Sri Lanka and the Maldives, and its role in Nepal and Bangladesh.
- Boundary and water disputes, migration, and political changes in neighbouring States.
- Asymmetry: small neighbours fear India's size; India needs to pay attention to their domestic sensitivities.

Way forward: deliver connectivity projects on time, deepen BIMSTEC and sub-regional trade, use States such as Karnataka for education and technology links, and insist on a rules-based approach.

Conclusion: a development-first, patient neighbourhood policy offers better returns than a short-term contest for influence.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "G-N-S-B": Gujral doctrine, Neighbourhood First, SAARC 1985 stalled, BIMSTEC 1997 active. Treaties: Indus 1960, Ganga 1996.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that SAARC was "dissolved"; it exists but is inactive since 2016. Also note the 2025 abeyance of the Indus Waters Treaty is a policy position, not a withdrawal under the treaty text.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Ministry of External Affairs, mea.gov.in (Neighbourhood First; BIMSTEC); BIMSTEC Secretariat (bimstec.org) for founding 1997 and Dhaka secretariat; SAARC Secretariat (saarc-sec.org) for 1985 Dhaka Charter; Indus Waters Treaty 1960 and Ganga Waters Treaty 1996 (treaties database, mea.gov.in); MEA statement of 23 April 2025 on holding the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance. Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS3-01 - e-governance and the digital divide: Karnataka's experience

GS 3 (Paper 4): 10 model answers

GS3-01 | e-governance and the digital divide: Karnataka's experience

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-A1 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 10 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Assess how e-governance improves public service delivery and why the digital divide limits its reach, with examples from Karnataka.

150-word version (10 marks) [133 words]

E-governance uses information and communication technology to deliver government services, improve transparency and cut contact between citizen and official. India's Digital India programme (2015) gave it a national frame.

Karnataka examples (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Seva Sindhu delivers 712 services from over 80 departments through 7,569 Gram One centres, with 4.23 crore transactions.
- Sakala sets legal timelines for 1,452 services.
- Bhoomi (land records), Kutumba (family database) and K-GIS support welfare delivery and planning.

Benefits: speed, lower discretion and corruption, and data for targeting subsidies.

Digital divide: gaps in connectivity, devices, digital literacy and language, which fall hardest on rural, poor, elderly and women users. Kiosks and assisted-service centres reduce the gap.

Safeguards: data protection, cybersecurity and offline alternatives.

Conclusion: technology should extend rights, so e-governance must be paired with access, skills and grievance redress.

250-word version (15 marks) [231 words]

E-governance is the use of information and communication technology to deliver services, share information and improve accountability. India's Digital India programme (2015) and the National e-Governance Plan gave it a national frame, and Karnataka was an early mover.

Karnataka's platforms (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Seva Sindhu: 712 services from over 80 departments delivered through 7,569 Gram One centres, with 4.23 crore transactions.
- Sakala: statutory timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions.
- Bhoomi, Kutumba, K-GIS and DBT link land, family and welfare data.
- The Panchamitra WhatsApp chatbot has served 1,70,659 users on Gram Panchayat services and grievances.

Benefits:

- Speed and predictability of service, lower discretion and fewer visits to offices.
- Transparent records, and direct benefit transfer that reduces leakage.
- Data for planning, for example telemetric rain gauges and weather stations that feed flood and drought forecasts.

Digital divide:

- Access: uneven broadband and mobile coverage in remote areas.
- Capability: low digital literacy, language barriers and cost of devices.
- Social gaps: women, the elderly and the poor are more likely to be excluded.

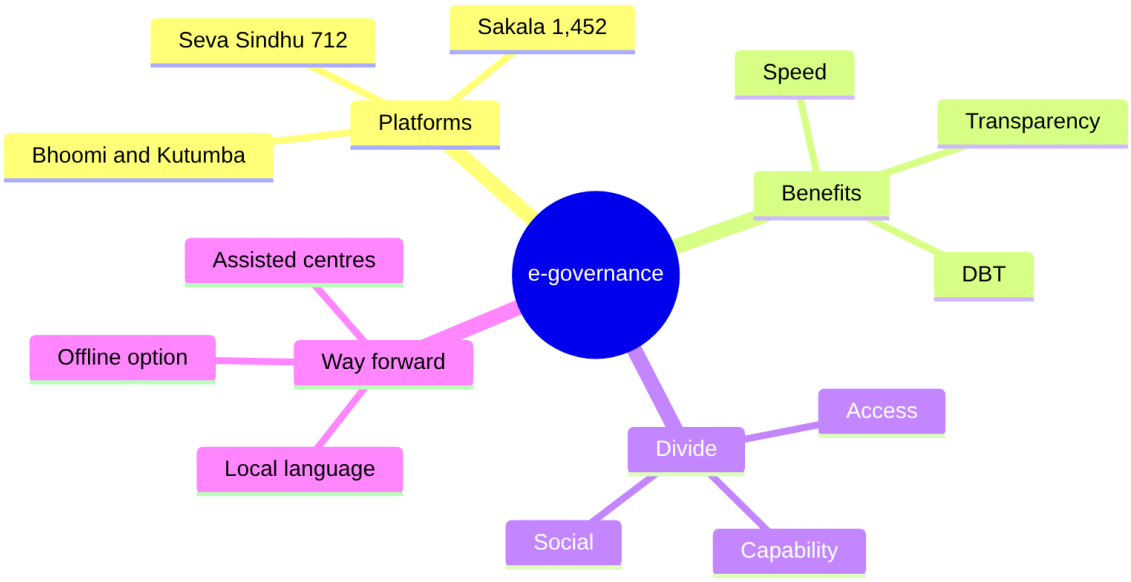
Risks: data privacy, cyber-attacks, exclusion through failed authentication, and over-dependence on vendors. Karnataka has adopted a Cybersecurity Policy 2024-29.

Way forward: assisted-service centres in every village, local-language interfaces, digital literacy in schools and Anganwadis, an offline option, and independent audit of data use.

Conclusion: e-governance succeeds when it widens citizens' access to rights; without bridging the digital divide it can deepen inequality.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "A-C-S": the divide has three gaps: Access (network), Capability (skills), Social (women, elderly, poor). Karnataka numbers: 712 / 7,569 / 1,452.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat e-governance as only "online services"; the question wants benefits and limits. Avoid national digital-divide statistics you cannot source; use Karnataka's Survey figures.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Executive Summary, e-governance and IT sections); Ministry of Electronics and IT, Digital India (digitalindia.gov.in), programme launched 1 July 2015 (web-verified); Karnataka Cybersecurity Policy 2024-29 as listed in the Survey.

NEXT UP: GS3-02 - Renewable and nuclear energy: Karnataka's power transition

GS3-02 | Renewable and nuclear energy: Karnataka's power transition

PREDICTED: unit GS3-A3 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Evaluate the potential and the constraints of renewable energy in meeting India's power needs, taking Karnataka as an example.

150-word version (10 marks) [131 words]

India has committed to net zero by 2070 and to 50 per cent non-fossil installed capacity by 2030, which makes renewable energy central to energy security.

Karnataka's record (Economic Survey 2025-26): installed capacity is 37,072.95 MW (December 2025), of which renewable sources contribute over 53.32 per cent; peak demand reached 18,395 MW in 2025-26. The Pavagada Solar Park (about 2,050 MW) is among the largest in the world, and the State topped the country in installed wind capacity added in 2024-25.

Constraints:

- Intermittency, so storage and flexible thermal back-up are needed.
- Land, evacuation lines and curtailment.
- Distribution losses (T&D losses fell from 16.34 per cent in 2021-22 to 12.57 per cent in 2024-25).

Complementary: nuclear power at Kaiga, rooftop solar and PM-KUSUM.

Conclusion: a diversified, grid-ready mix is the best route.

250-word version (15 marks) [245 words]

India's energy transition is driven by the pledge of net zero by 2070 and 50 per cent non-fossil installed capacity by 2030. Renewables reduce import dependence and emissions but need system support.

Karnataka (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Installed capacity is 37,072.95 MW (December 2025); renewable sources contribute over 53.32 per cent of it.
- Peak demand reached 18,395 MW in 2025-26, with a highest daily consumption of 356.88 million units.
- The State won the national prize for highest wind capacity installed in 2024-25, and the Pavagada Solar Park, with about 2,050 MW commissioned, won four awards at RE-Invest 2024.
- Solar pumps, feeder solarisation under PM-KUSUM and rooftop solar reduce load on conventional power and help farm incomes.

Potential: high solar insolation in the interior, wind corridors, hydro in the Western Ghats and waste-to-energy in cities.

Constraints:

- Intermittency: solar peaks by day while demand peaks in the evening, so storage and flexible hydro or thermal power are needed.
- Land acquisition, transmission lines and curtailment of renewable power.
- Weak distribution: T&D losses fell from 16.34 per cent in 2021-22 to 12.57 per cent in 2024-25, yet remain high.
- Finances of distribution companies and the burden of free-electricity schemes.

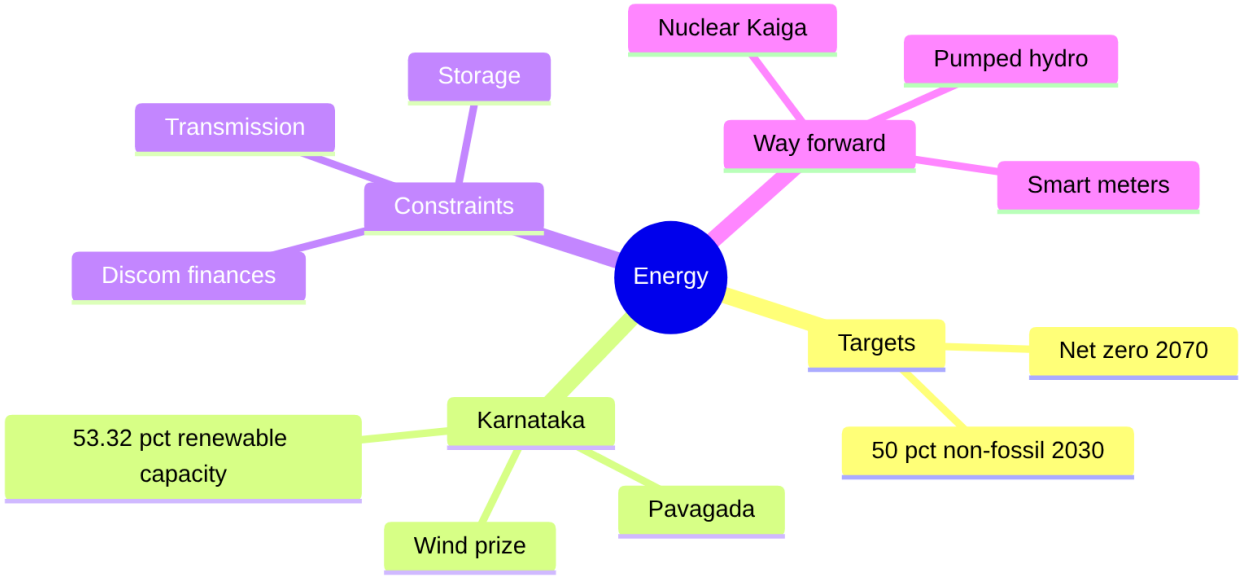
Role of nuclear power: a firm, low-carbon base. Karnataka hosts the Kaiga nuclear station, operated by NPCIL.

Way forward: battery storage and pumped hydro, green energy corridors, smart meters, and market-based tariffs.

Conclusion: renewables will lead, but only a balanced mix with storage and nuclear can give secure power to all.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "53 - 12.6 - 18.4": over 53% renewable share, T&D loss 12.57%, peak demand 18,395 MW. Constraint trio: Storage, Transmission, Finance (S-T-F).

COMMON TRAP: Do not say renewables are "53% of generation"; the Survey says 53.32% of installed capacity. Capacity share and generation share differ.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Energy chapter and Executive Summary); Government of India, Updated NDC to UNFCCC (August 2022; 50% non-fossil capacity by 2030) and COP26 statement of 1 Nov 2021 (net zero by 2070), web-verified at pib.gov.in; capacity of Pavagada Solar Park 2,050 MW per PIB/NS Energy (web-verified); NPCIL (npcil.nic.in) for the Kaiga station.

NEXT UP: GS3-03 - Climate change and disaster risk reduction

GS3-03 | Climate change and disaster risk reduction

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-A4 appeared in 2 of the 4 sets tagged (RECURRING); 3 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain the link between climate change and disasters in India and assess the institutional framework for disaster management.

150-word version (10 marks) [142 words]

Climate change is raising the frequency and intensity of floods, droughts, cyclones and heat waves, and the poor in coastal and rain-fed areas are the most exposed.

Karnataka's exposure: floods in Kodagu and the Western Ghats in 2018 and 2019, drought in the interior districts, and a long coastline.

Institutions (Disaster Management Act, 2005):

- National Disaster Management Authority, chaired by the Prime Minister (s.3).
- State Authority, chaired by the Chief Minister (s.14).
- District Authority, chaired by the Collector with an elected representative as co-chair (s.25).

Karnataka's tools: KSNDMC runs 6,605 telemetric rain gauges and 843 weather stations, with a Flood Forecast Cell. The Krishi Bhagya package of Rs 100 crore targets 5,482 units in 223 taluks to reduce drought risk to farmers.

Sendai Framework (2015-2030) shifts focus from relief to risk reduction.

Conclusion: resilience needs early warning, local capacity and climate-proof infrastructure.

250-word version (15 marks) [249 words]

Climate change increases the intensity and frequency of extreme events such as floods, droughts, cyclones and heat waves. Disasters hit the poor hardest because they live in exposed areas and depend on rain-fed farming.

Karnataka's profile: the State has a long Arabian Sea coastline, flood-prone river basins in the Western Ghats, and drought-prone interior districts. In August 2018 Kodagu saw severe landslides, and the August 2019 floods affected 22 districts, mainly in north Karnataka.

Institutional framework (Disaster Management Act, 2005):

- National Disaster Management Authority, chaired by the Prime Minister (section 3).
- State Disaster Management Authority, chaired by the Chief Minister (section 14).
- District Disaster Management Authority, chaired by the Collector with an elected local representative as co-chair (section 25).
- National and State Disaster Response Forces, and funds for response.

Karnataka's measures (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- The Karnataka State Natural Disaster Monitoring Centre (KSNDMC) operates 6,605 telemetric rain gauges at Gram Panchayats and 843 weather stations at hoblis, with a dedicated Flood Forecast Cell.
- Under the State Disaster Mitigation Fund, Krishi Bhagya received Rs 100 crore for 5,482 packages in 223 taluks.
- Dam safety: all 33 spillway gates of the Tungabhadra Reservoir are being replaced.

Global frame: the Sendai Framework 2015-2030 stresses prevention, preparedness and "building back better".

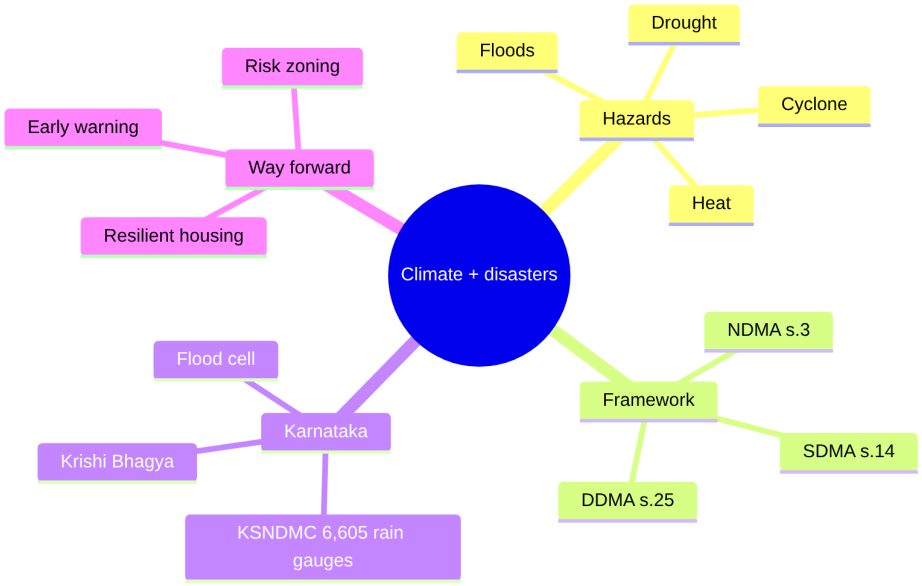
Gaps: weak land-use enforcement on flood plains, limited local capacity and delayed funds.

Way forward: risk zoning, community early-warning, resilient housing and adaptation finance.

Conclusion: because climate change makes disasters more frequent, the future of disaster management lies in prevention and local resilience.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "3-14-25 = PM-CM-DC": section 3 national (PM), 14 State (CM), 25 district (Collector). Sendai = Sendai 2015 to 2030.

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim the Act makes the Collector the sole head; the elected representative is co-chair. Do not name death tolls or losses for specific events unless sourced.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Disaster Management Act, 2005, ss.3, 14, 25 (indiacode.nic.in); UNDRR, Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030 (undrr.org); Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (KSNDMC, Krishi Bhagya, dam safety); Current Science vol. 117 (2019) on the August 2018 Western Ghats landslides, and The Hindu, August 2019, on the 2019 Karnataka floods (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS3-04 - Sustainable agriculture: water, risk and markets in Karnataka

GS3-04 | Sustainable agriculture: water, risk and markets in Karnataka

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-B2 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the main challenges of Karnataka's agriculture and the measures to make it more productive, resilient and remunerative.

150-word version (10 marks) [134 words]

Karnataka's agriculture is largely rain-fed and exposed to drought, uneven rainfall and price shocks. The Economic Survey 2025-26 reports an expected 9.1 per cent growth for agriculture at constant prices in 2025-26, which shows its volatility and its importance.

Challenges: dependence on monsoon, small holdings, depleting groundwater, input costs and weak market linkage.

Measures:

- Water: micro-irrigation covers 1,00,956 hectares in 2025-26; farm ponds (4,529 built up to December 2025) and watershed treatment.
- Risk: PMFBY crop insurance enrolled 25,76,388 farmers.
- Markets: 167 of 170 APMCs are linked to the Unified Market Platform.
- Data and finance: the FRUITS platform registers farmers for benefits.

The State also promotes millet production, which suits dry conditions, and a unified market for produce.

Gaps: delayed compensation and groundwater depletion.

Conclusion: water-use efficiency, insurance and market reform together make farming resilient.

250-word version (15 marks) [241 words]

Karnataka's agriculture depends heavily on rainfall, with a large dry-land area, small and fragmented holdings and rising input costs. Because farm output swings with the monsoon, the Economic Survey 2025-26 records agriculture growth of 9.1 per cent at constant prices in 2025-26, compared with 7.0 per cent in 2024-25, a recovery helped by a good monsoon.

Challenges:

- Rain-fed cultivation and recurrent drought in the interior.
- Depleting groundwater and low irrigation efficiency.
- Price volatility, weak storage and market access.
- Low credit and insurance cover for small farmers.

Measures (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Water: micro-irrigation brought 1,00,956 hectares under drip and sprinkler systems; 4,529 farm ponds were built up to December 2025; watershed treatment covers 74.94 lakh hectares out of 129.70 lakh hectares that can be treated.
- Risk: under PMFBY, 25,76,388 farmers were enrolled up to December 2025.
- Markets: 167 of the 170 APMCs are linked to the Unified Market Platform, which transacted Rs 4,39,852.54 crore of produce.
- Data and benefits: the FRUITS platform has over 102.95 lakh farmers registered, so benefits reach them directly.
- Crops: millet production and processing are being promoted for climate suitability.

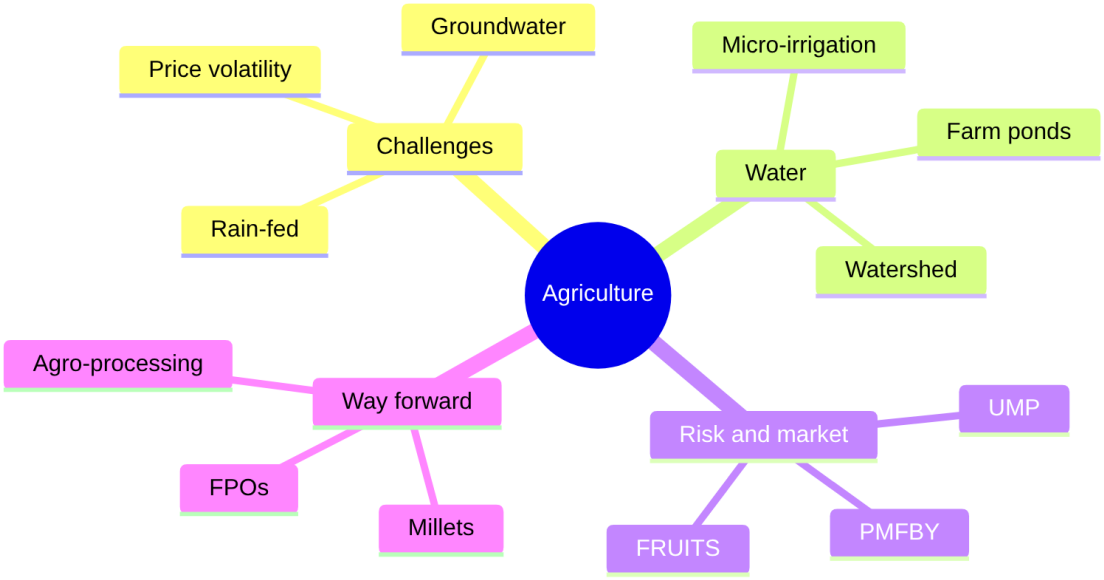
Gaps: small farmers' access to cold storage and value addition, delay in compensation, and depletion of groundwater.

Way forward: crop diversification to millets and horticulture, solar pumps, farmer producer organisations, soil-health management and agro-processing near farms.

Conclusion: the way to make Karnataka's agriculture remunerative lies in saving water, sharing risk and strengthening markets, rather than raising output alone.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "W-R-M-D": Water (micro-irrigation 1 lakh ha), Risk (insurance 25.8 lakh farmers), Markets (167/170 APMCs on UMP), Data (FRUITS 103 lakh farmers).

COMMON TRAP: 9.1% is the growth in the real (constant-price) agricultural sector in 2025-26 as per the Survey; do not call it "production growth" or compare it with current-price figures.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Agriculture and Allied Sectors; Executive Summary): growth rate, micro-irrigation, farm ponds, PMFBY, UMP, FRUITS, watershed; Karnataka Raitha Suraksha (PMFBY) data to December 2025 as quoted in the Survey.

NEXT UP: GS3-05 - Biotechnology: GM crops and genome editing in India

GS3-05 | Biotechnology: GM crops and genome editing in India

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-B4 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Examine the case for and against genetically modified crops in India and the regulatory approach to new breeding technologies.

150-word version (10 marks) [136 words]

Genetic modification inserts genes from another organism to give traits such as pest resistance. Bt cotton, approved by the Genetic Engineering Approval Committee (GEAC) in March 2002, remains the only GM crop approved for commercial cultivation in India.

For: higher yield stability, fewer pesticide sprays for the target pest, and potential for drought and nutrition traits. Against: biosafety and allergenicity concerns, loss of seed sovereignty, pest resistance, and impact on biodiversity and trade.

Regulation: Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 and the 1989 Rules, with GEAC as the apex approving body. On 23 July 2024 the Supreme Court gave a split verdict on GM mustard and asked the Centre to frame a national policy on GM crops.

Genome editing: in May 2025 ICAR released two genome-edited rice varieties.

Conclusion: a transparent, science-based and consultative regulatory path is needed.

250-word version (15 marks) [245 words]

Genetic modification transfers genes across species, for example the Bt gene that makes cotton toxic to bollworm. Bt cotton, approved by the Genetic Engineering Approval Committee (GEAC) on 26 March 2002, remains India's only GM crop approved for commercial cultivation.

Arguments for:

- Yield protection against target pests, with fewer sprays of insecticide against the bollworm.
- Potential for drought tolerance, herbicide tolerance and nutritional enrichment.

Arguments against:

- Biosafety, allergenicity, gene-flow and biodiversity concerns.
- Seed monopoly and cost for small farmers, and pest resistance developing over time.
- Trade risk because several markets restrict GM produce.

Regulatory framework: the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 and the 1989 Rules for hazardous micro-organisms and genetically engineered organisms, with the GEAC as the apex body and the Review Committee on Genetic Manipulation. India is a party to the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety.

Recent developments:

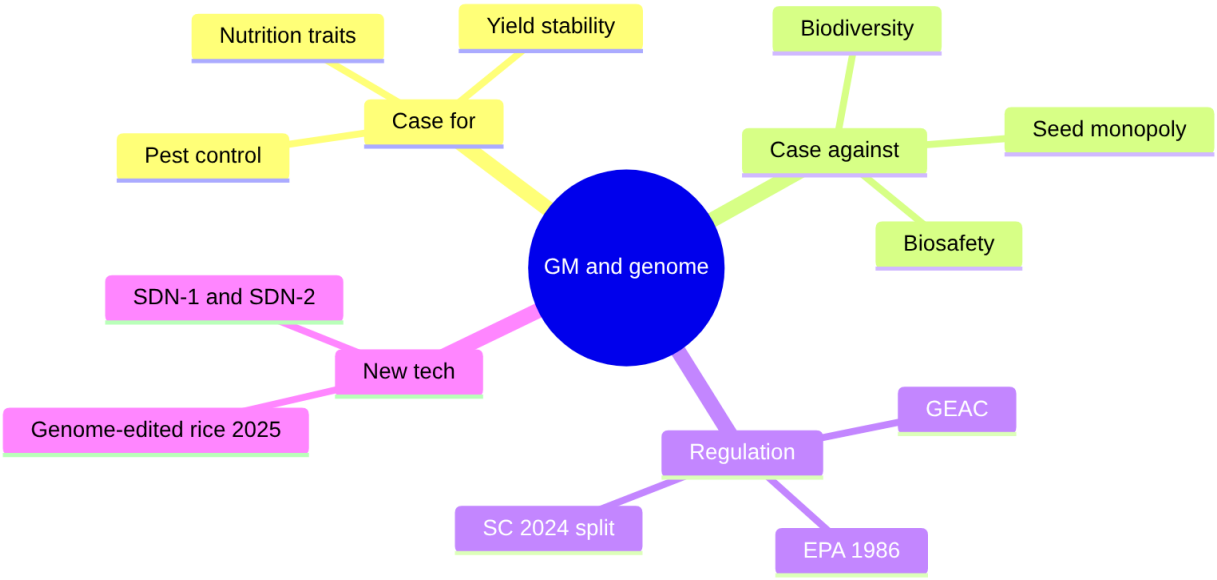
- On 23 July 2024 the Supreme Court delivered a split verdict on the environmental release of GM mustard (DMH-11), and both judges directed the Centre to frame a national policy on GM crops after consulting States, farmers and experts.
- On 4 May 2025 ICAR released two genome-edited rice varieties, DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala) and Pusa DST Rice 1. Plants without foreign DNA (SDN-1 and SDN-2) are exempt from the stricter GM rules.

Way forward: a national GM policy, independent biosafety testing with public data, fair seed pricing and public-sector research.

Conclusion: the debate should move from "yes or no" to which trait, for whom and under which safeguards.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "B-S-G": Bt cotton 2002 (only crop), Split verdict 2024 (mustard, policy), Genome-edited rice 2025 (two varieties).

COMMON TRAP: Genome-edited is not the same as GM; SDN-1/2 plants with no foreign DNA are treated differently. Do not say the Supreme Court "banned" GM mustard; it split and the matter went to a larger bench.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: GEAC, 32nd meeting, 26 March 2002 (geacindia.gov.in), approval of Bt cotton hybrids; Supreme Court of India, Gene Campaign v. Union of India, judgment of 23 July 2024 (2024 INSC 545) and The Hindu report of the same date; ICAR and PIB release of 4 May 2025 (PRID 2126802) on genome-edited rice; Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 and Rules, 1989; Convention on Biological Diversity, Cartagena Protocol (bch.cbd.int). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS3-06 - Dairy cooperatives: the Anand pattern and KMF

GS3-06 | Dairy cooperatives: the Anand pattern and KMF

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-B5 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain the role of dairy cooperatives in rural livelihoods, using the example of the Karnataka Milk Federation.

150-word version (10 marks) [129 words]

Dairy cooperatives collect milk from small producers, give assured prices and market it collectively. The Anand pattern, begun by Amul under Verghese Kurien and spread by the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) through Operation Flood from 1970, uses a three-tier structure: village society, district union and State federation.

Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF), marketing under the brand Nandini:

- Average daily milk procurement reached 1 crore litres in June 2025.
- It has 27.19 lakh members and pays Rs 35.36 crore daily to them through DBT.
- Nandini improved its brand ranking from 43rd to 38th in Brand Finance's list in 2025.

Impact: regular income, women's participation, and better cattle through artificial insemination.

Challenges: fodder, disease, price fluctuations and competition from private players.

Conclusion: cooperatives turn small producers into a collective market power.

250-word version (15 marks) [220 words]

Dairy cooperatives gather milk from millions of small producers, pay assured prices, and process and market the milk collectively. The Anand pattern, started by Amul and led by Verghese Kurien, was spread through the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) in Operation Flood from 1970. It has three tiers: village dairy society, district union and State federation.

Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF), brand Nandini (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Average daily milk procurement reached 1 crore litres in June 2025.
- KMF has 27.19 lakh members and disburses Rs 35.36 crore daily through direct benefit transfer.
- Nandini Semen Station processes 40 lakh doses annually; 40 lakh artificial inseminations resulted in 10 lakh calf births.
- Nandini improved its brand ranking from 43rd (2024) to 38th (2025) in Brand Finance.
- Programmes such as Ksheera Sanjeevini aim at women's empowerment through KMF and the State rural livelihoods mission.

Benefits:

- Regular income for landless and small farmers, especially women.
- Stable rural demand and links to veterinary services.
- Cooperative ownership keeps surplus in villages.

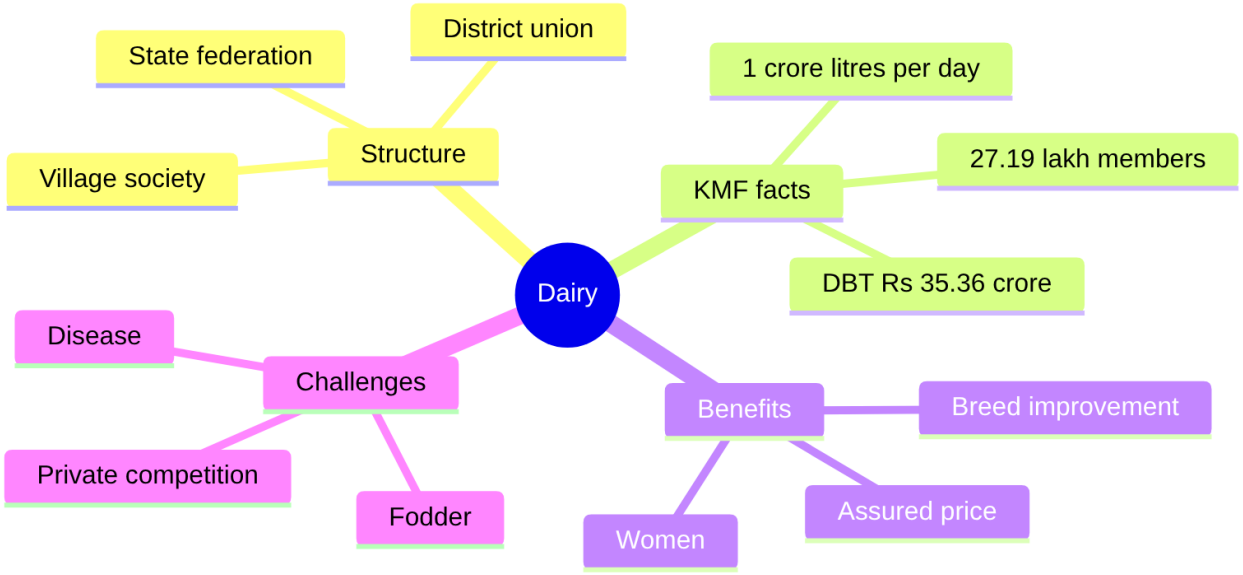
Challenges: fodder shortage, animal diseases, price volatility and competition from private dairies.

Way forward: fodder development, disease control (the Survey notes vaccination under ASCAD and Brucellosis programmes), value-added products and professional management with member control.

Conclusion: KMF shows that cooperative dairying can create livelihoods and a national brand, provided producers remain owners and quality is protected.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "1-27-35": 1 crore litres a day, 27 lakh members, Rs 35 crore daily paid. Three tiers: Village, District, State (V-D-S).

> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say KMF "invented" the Anand pattern (it comes from Amul, Gujarat) or mix procurement (1 crore litres/day in June 2025) with annual totals.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Animal Husbandry and Dairy; Executive Summary): milk procurement, members, DBT, Nandini; NDDB (nddb.coop) for Operation Flood from 1970 and the Anand pattern (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS3-07 - Watershed development and price support for farmers

GS3-07 | Watershed development and price support for farmers

PREDICTED: unit GS3-B6 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Compare watershed development and minimum support price as tools to improve farmers' incomes in dry regions.

150-word version (10 marks) [138 words]

Watershed development treats a drainage basin through soil and water conservation (contour bunds, check dams, farm ponds) to raise groundwater and crop yields. Minimum Support Price (MSP) is a price floor announced by the Centre on the recommendation of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP).

Karnataka's watershed record (Economic Survey 2025-26): of 190.50 lakh ha State area, 129.70 lakh ha can be treated and 74.94 lakh ha were treated up to March 2025.

MSP: announced for 22 crops, with the Budget of 2018-19 setting it at least 1.5 times the cost of production; procurement is effective mainly for rice and wheat.

Comparison: watershed raises productivity and resilience for dry-land farmers; MSP supports prices but depends on procurement.

Conclusion: dry regions benefit most from a mix: watershed for resilience, and MSP and market reform for price security.

250-word version (15 marks) [246 words]

Watershed development is area-based treatment of a drainage basin through soil and water conservation (contour bunds, check dams, farm ponds, plantation) so that rain is held where it falls. In India it is implemented under the Watershed Development Component of PM Krishi Sinchayee Yojana.

Karnataka (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Of the 190.50 lakh ha State area, 129.70 lakh ha is available for watershed intervention and 74.94 lakh ha was treated up to March 2025.
- 4,529 farm ponds were built up to December 2025.
- New programmes are modelled on Sujala-III with modern watershed practices.

Minimum Support Price (MSP) is a price floor announced by the Government of India on the recommendation of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) for 22 mandated crops, plus a fair and remunerative price for sugarcane. Budget 2018-19 promised MSP at least 1.5 times the cost of production, and PM-AASHA (2018) added price deficiency and procurement options.

Comparison:

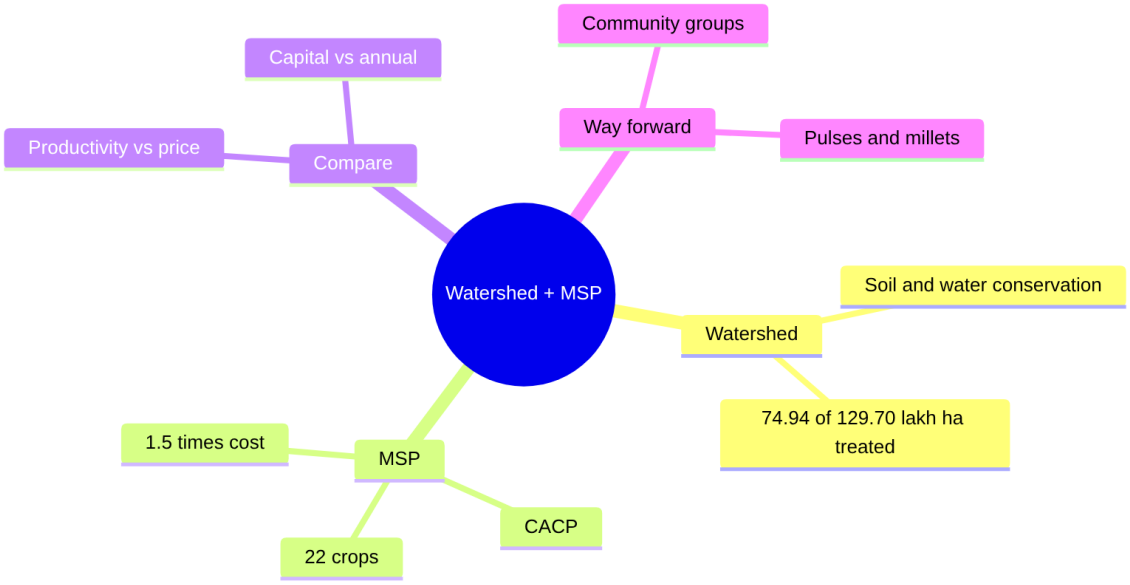
- Target: watershed raises productivity and resilience in rain-fed areas; MSP stabilises prices.
- Beneficiary: watershed reaches dry-land farmers who grow millets and pulses; MSP procurement has been strong mainly for rice and wheat.
- Fiscal impact: watershed is capital spending with long-term gain; MSP is an annual obligation.
- Risk: watershed needs community maintenance; MSP needs procurement and storage.

Way forward: expand community-led watershed, link it to millet and pulse procurement, and reform markets.

Conclusion: for dry regions, watershed development builds the base of production and MSP supports the price; the two are partners and not substitutes.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "190 - 130 - 75": 190.5 lakh ha State area, 129.7 treatable, 74.9 treated (about 58% of the treatable area, my own calculation). MSP = 22 crops, 1.5x cost.

COMMON TRAP: The 58% is a ratio of treated area to treatable area, not to State area. Do not confuse the two denominators.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (watershed data, farm ponds, Sujala-III); Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, CACP (cacp.dacnet.nic.in); Union Budget speech 2018-19 (MSP at 1.5 times cost); PM-AASHA, Cabinet approval September 2018 (pib.gov.in) (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS3-08 - Public health: maternal and child outcomes and non-communicable disease in Karnataka

GS3-08 | Public health: maternal and child outcomes and non-communicable disease in Karnataka

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS3-B7 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 5 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the progress and the remaining challenges in public health in Karnataka, with reference to maternal and child outcomes and non-communicable diseases.

150-word version (10 marks) [135 words]

Karnataka has improved key indicators under the National Health Mission and State schemes. According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, the maternal mortality ratio fell from 97 (2015-17) to 68 (2021-23), and the infant mortality rate from 28 (2015) to 14 (2023).

Delivery system:

- 9,058 Ayushman Arogya Kendras (health and wellness centres) were upgraded by December 2025.
- Gruha Arogya screened 62,37,026 people for hypertension and diabetes between August and December 2025, with 3,65,193 diagnosed with hypertension.
- The STEMI hub-and-spoke programme in 31 districts has done 10,75,535 ECGs.

Challenges: non-communicable diseases, urban-rural and regional gaps, staff shortage and out-of-pocket spending.

Policy anchors: National Health Policy 2017 and Ayushman Bharat (2018), with the Universal Immunisation Programme for children.

Conclusion: the next phase should shift from survival of mothers and children to prevention and early detection of lifestyle diseases.

250-word version (15 marks) [219 words]

Public health outcomes in Karnataka have improved because of the National Health Mission (2013), immunisation drives and State programmes. According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, the maternal mortality ratio fell from 97 (2015-17) to 68 (2021-23) and the infant mortality rate fell from 28 (2015) to 14 (2023).

Health service delivery (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- 9,058 Ayushman Arogya Kendras (health and wellness centres) were upgraded by December 2025, including 6,532 rural sub-centres, 2,161 rural PHCs and 365 urban PHCs.
- The Gruha Arogya programme screened 62,37,026 people for hypertension and diabetes between August and December 2025.
- The STEMI hub-and-spoke programme in 31 districts recorded 10,75,535 ECGs and identified 16,161 acute cases between March 2023 and December 2025.

National anchors: National Health Policy 2017, Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY, 2018), Universal Immunisation Programme and Mission Indradhanush (2014).

Remaining challenges:

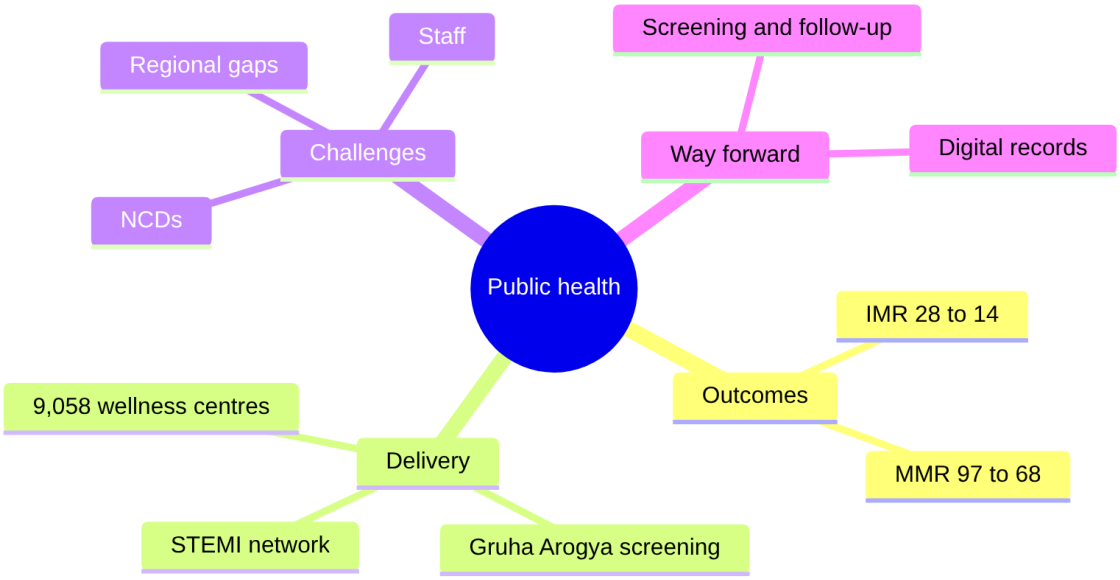
- Rising non-communicable diseases: heart disease, diabetes and hypertension.
- Regional and urban-rural gaps in specialists and diagnostic services.
- Out-of-pocket spending, shortage of staff and uneven quality.
- Climate and urbanisation risks such as vector-borne diseases.

Way forward: expand screening to the population level, follow-up care through health and wellness centres, digital health records, more specialists in the north and interior districts, and health-in-all-policies.

Conclusion: Karnataka has made progress in maternal and child health, and the next frontier is preventing and managing chronic disease at the primary level.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "97 to 68; 28 to 14": maternal deaths down about 30 per cent (my own calculation), infant deaths exactly halved. Then "screen, hub, spoke" for NCDs.

COMMON TRAP: MMR is per 1,00,000 live births and IMR per 1,000; state the unit and the period (MMR 2015-17 to 2021-23, IMR 2015 to 2023). Do not say "halved" for MMR: it fell about 30% (97 to 68); only IMR halved (28 to 14).



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Health, Executive Summary): MMR, IMR, AAKs, Gruha Arogya, STEMI; National Health Policy 2017 (mohfw.gov.in); Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY launched September 2018 and Mission Indradhanush launched December 2014 (pib.gov.in, web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS3-09 - Biodiversity and the Western Ghats: conservation and governance

GS3-09 | Biodiversity and the Western Ghats: conservation and governance

PREDICTED: unit GS3-C3 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Why is the Western Ghats a global biodiversity hotspot, and how should its conservation be governed?

150-word version (10 marks) [137 words]

A biodiversity hotspot is a region with at least 1,500 species of endemic vascular plants that has lost at least 70 per cent of its original habitat. India has four: the Himalaya, Indo-Burma, the Western Ghats and Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (which includes the Nicobar Islands).

Western Ghats: high rainfall, varied altitude and old geology create endemism; UNESCO inscribed it as a World Heritage Site in 2012. Nearly 60 per cent of the range lies in Karnataka.

Karnataka's record (Economic Survey 2025-26): forest and tree cover is 24.52 per cent of the area (ISFR 2023); the State is first in elephants (6,395) and second in tigers (563).

Governance: Biological Diversity Act, 2002 with 6,554 Biodiversity Management Committees at Gram Panchayat level in Karnataka.

Threats: mining, roads, plantations and human-wildlife conflict.

Conclusion: protect connected habitats with community participation.

250-word version (15 marks) [238 words]

A biodiversity hotspot, a concept from Conservation International, is a region with at least 1,500 species of endemic vascular plants that has lost at least 70 per cent of its original habitat. India has four hotspots: the Himalaya, Indo-Burma, the Western Ghats and Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (including the Nicobar Islands).

Why the Western Ghats: orographic rainfall, altitude variation and ancient geology support evergreen forests and high endemism in amphibians, plants and fish. UNESCO inscribed it as a World Heritage Site in 2012. Nearly 60 per cent of the range lies in Karnataka.

Karnataka's record (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- Recorded forest area is 40,678 sq. km (21.21 per cent); forest and tree cover is 24.52 per cent of the geographical area (ISFR 2023).
- Protected areas span 11,399 sq. km: 5 national parks, 37 wildlife sanctuaries including 5 tiger reserves, 19 conservation reserves and one community reserve.
- First in elephant population (6,395) and second in tigers (563).
- 6,554 Biodiversity Management Committees at Gram Panchayat level.

Legal framework: Biological Diversity Act, 2002 (National Biodiversity Authority, State Biodiversity Boards and local committees), the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 and the Forest Rights Act, 2006.

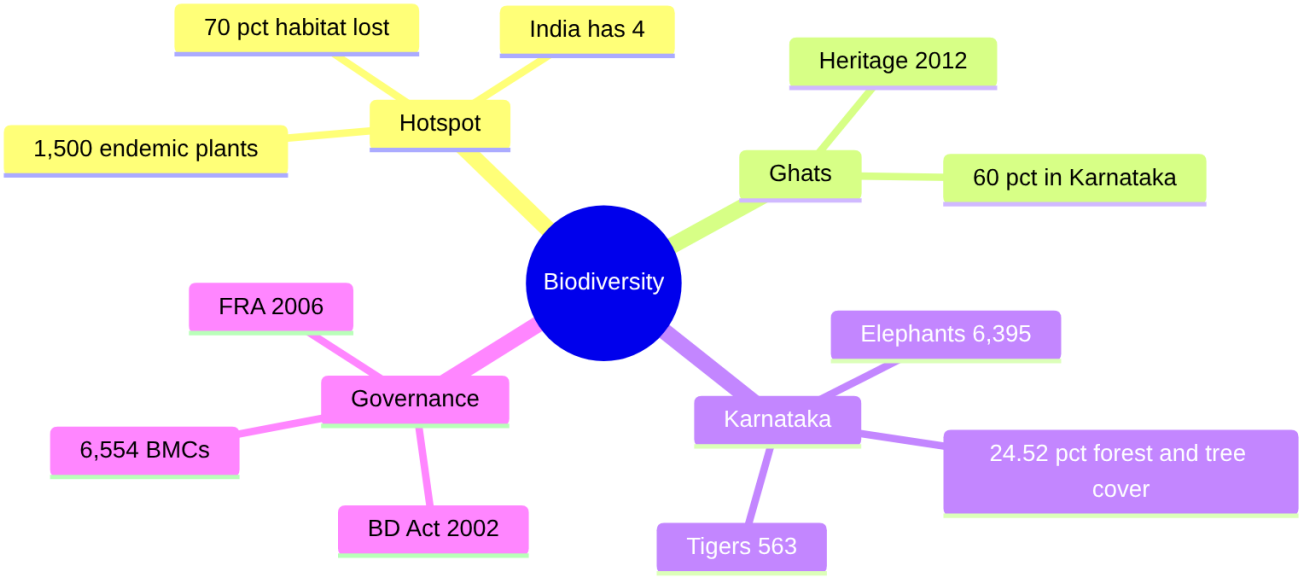
Threats: mining, linear infrastructure, monoculture plantations, climate change and human-wildlife conflict.

Way forward: wildlife corridors and elephant-proof barriers, community stewardship, ecological sensitivity assessment before projects, and benefit-sharing with local people.

Conclusion: conserving the Western Ghats protects water, climate and livelihoods, and it works best when local communities are partners.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "1500 - 70 - 4": hotspot = 1,500 endemic plants + 70% habitat lost; India has 4. Karnataka: 60% of the Ghats, elephants #1 (6,395), tigers #2 (563).

COMMON TRAP: Forest area (21.21% recorded forest) and forest-and-tree cover (24.52%) are different measures. Do not call 24.52% "forest cover". Rankings for elephants and tigers are as given by the Survey for the latest counts.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Conservation International, Biodiversity Hotspots (criteria); Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, India's four hotspots (moef.gov.in, web-verified); UNESCO WHC, "Western Ghats" (whc.unesco.org/en/list/1342), inscribed 2012; Biological Diversity Act, 2002; Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Forest and Environment).

NEXT UP: GS3-10 - Pollution and solid waste: laws, bioremediation and Karnataka's experience

GS3-10 | Pollution and solid waste: laws, bioremediation and Karnataka's experience

PREDICTED: unit GS3-C4 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 8 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Discuss the legal and technological measures to control pollution and manage solid waste, with reference to Karnataka.

150-word version (10 marks) [131 words]

India's pollution control rests on the Water Act (1974), the Air Act (1981), the Environment (Protection) Act (1986) and the National Green Tribunal Act (2010), applying the polluter-pays principle.

Solid waste: the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026, in force from 1 April 2026, replaced the 2016 Rules and require four-stream source segregation: wet, dry, sanitary and special-care waste. Plastic is controlled under extended producer responsibility.

Karnataka (Economic Survey 2025-26): the State produced 4,08,537 tonnes of plastic waste in 2024-25, with 135 licensed recycling facilities of 2,31,834 tonnes capacity. It has 12 polluted river stretches, and enforcement drives confiscated 223.09 tonnes of plastic in 2024-25.

Technology: sewage treatment plants, faecal sludge plants and bioremediation, in which microbes break down pollutants.

Conclusion: enforcement, segregation at source and citizen participation make the laws work.

250-word version (15 marks) [243 words]

India's pollution control framework is built on the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, the Air Act, 1981, the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 and the National Green Tribunal Act, 2010. It applies the polluter-pays and precautionary principles, and the National Clean Air Programme targets city-level air quality.

Solid waste: the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 came into force on 1 April 2026, superseding the 2016 Rules. They mandate four-stream source segregation: wet, dry, sanitary and special-care waste. Plastic waste is controlled through the Plastic Waste Management Rules and extended producer responsibility, and a ban on identified single-use plastic items has applied since 1 July 2022.

Karnataka (Economic Survey 2025-26):

- It produced 4,08,537 tonnes of plastic waste in 2024-25 and has 135 licensed recycling facilities with approved capacity of 2,31,834 tonnes.
- Karnataka has 12 polluted river stretches; an action plan includes sewage treatment plants, and grants for faecal sludge treatment in 110 towns.
- Enforcement drives confiscated 223.09 metric tonnes of plastic and levied fines of Rs 63.787 lakh.

Technological options:

- Sewage and effluent treatment and zero-liquid-discharge systems.
- Bioremediation: microbes and plants degrade oil, pesticides and organic pollutants at low cost.
- Waste-to-energy, composting and material recovery.

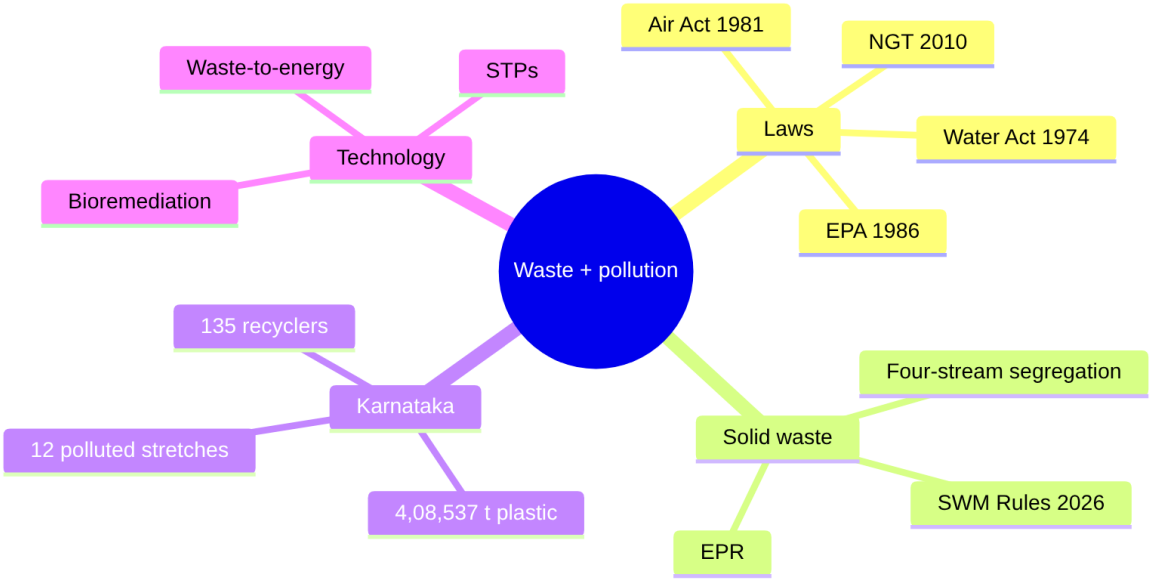
Challenges: weak urban local body finances, mixed waste, informal sector integration and monitoring capacity.

Way forward: strict segregation, decentralised composting, producer responsibility, real-time monitoring and community participation.

Conclusion: prevention at source, with strict enforcement and citizen participation, is the cheapest route to cleaner air, water and cities.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "W-A-E-N": Water 1974, Air 1981, Environment 1986, NGT 2010. SWM 2026: four bins = wet, dry, sanitary, special care.

COMMON TRAP: SWM Rules 2026 replaced the 2016 Rules from 1 April 2026; do not cite the 2016 Rules as current. Plastic waste figure is the 2024-25 production of 4,08,537 tonnes; recycling capacity is a licensed capacity, not actual recycling.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, Environment (Protection) Act 1986, NGT Act 2010 (indiacode.nic.in); Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026, notified 27 January 2026 (S.O. 388(E)), in force 1 April 2026 (PIB PRID 2219676, web-verified); Plastic Waste Management Amendment Rules 2021 (single-use plastic ban from 1 July 2022); Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Environment and Pollution Control).

NEXT UP: GS4-01 - Determinants of ethics: what shapes a person's moral compass

GS 4 (Paper 5, Ethics): 10 model answers

GS4-01 | Determinants of ethics: what shapes a person's moral compass

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-E1 appeared in 2 of the 4 sets tagged (RECURRING); 3 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Identify the main determinants of human ethical conduct and explain how they interact in a public servant's decisions.

150-word version (10 marks) [130 words]

Ethics is the study of right and wrong conduct; its determinants are the forces that shape a person's moral judgement.

Main determinants:

- Family: first school of values such as honesty and sharing.
- Society and culture: norms, religion and peers define what is acceptable.
- Education: builds reasoning and constitutional values.
- Law: external rules set minimum standards.
- Conscience: the inner voice that tests duty against self-interest.
- Leaders and role models: Gandhi's insistence on pure means is one example.
- Situation: pressure, incentives and organisational culture.

Interaction: values formed at home are tested by institutions and pressure; where law is silent, conscience guides.

For a public servant, the Constitution's Preamble (justice, liberty, equality, fraternity) is the common anchor.

Conclusion: ethical conduct is built, so schools, families and organisations must be shaped to build it.

250-word version (15 marks) [246 words]

Ethics is the systematic study of right and wrong conduct. Its determinants are the influences that shape a person's moral judgement and behaviour.

Internal determinants:

- Conscience: the inner voice that tests a choice against duty and self-interest.
- Character and emotions: habits of self-control, courage and empathy.

External determinants:

- Family: the first school of values such as honesty, sharing and respect.
- Society, culture and religion: shared norms define what is acceptable, for example Basavanna's insistence on work as worship (Kayakave Kailasa).
- Education: builds reasoning, scientific temper and constitutional values.
- Law: sets the minimum standard; ethics asks for more than legality.
- Role models and leaders: Gandhi's principle that means must be as pure as ends.
- Situation: incentives, peer pressure and organisational culture.

Interaction: a person brings values from family and society into an organisation, where rules, incentives and superiors either reinforce or erode them. Where law is silent or conflicting, conscience becomes the final guide.

Relevance for public servants:

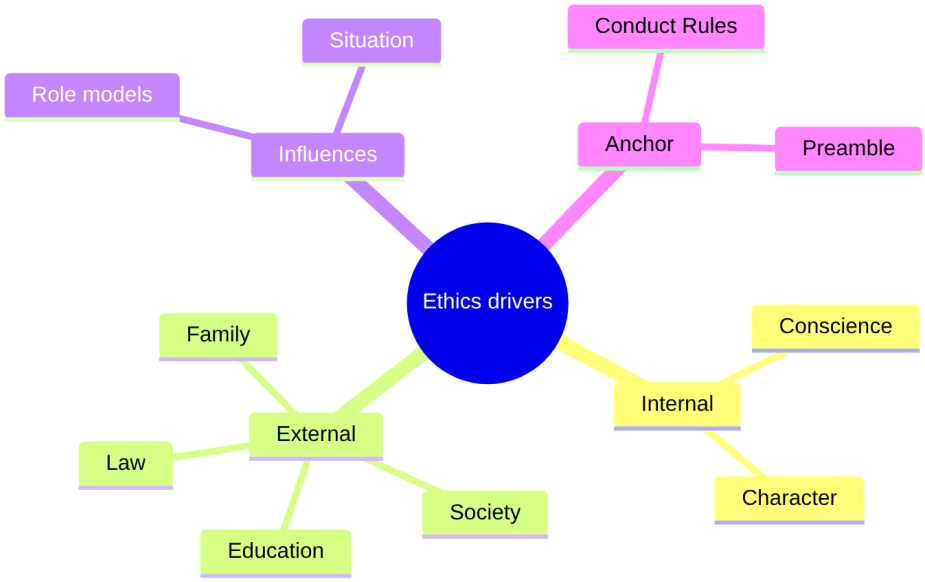
- The Preamble's values of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity are the anchor.
- The Conduct Rules require integrity and devotion to duty.
- A civil servant's decisions affect many people, so personal ethics must be matched by institutional ethics such as codes, audits and transparent procedures.

Way forward: values education from school, ethics training with case discussion during service, and a work culture where doing the right thing is rewarded.

Conclusion: ethical behaviour is the product of both character and context, so building it needs both personal reflection and institutional design.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "F-S-E-L-C": Family, Society, Education, Law, Conscience (plus role models and situation).

COMMON TRAP: Do not list determinants without showing interaction. Law is a determinant, but it sets the floor, not the ceiling of ethics.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Preamble; All India Services (Conduct) Rules, 1968, Rule 3 (maintain integrity and devotion to duty); M. K. Gandhi on means and ends, Hind Swaraj (1909), chapter XVI; Basavanna's vachanas, Kayakave Kailasa (12th century) (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS4-02 - Laws, rules, regulations and conscience as sources of guidance

GS4-02 | Laws, rules, regulations and conscience as sources of guidance

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-E2 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): When rules are silent or conflict with conscience, how should a civil servant decide? Illustrate with the sources of ethical guidance in administration.

150-word version (10 marks) [140 words]

Laws, rules and conscience are sources of guidance with different roles:

- Laws and rules give clarity, uniformity and protection against arbitrary action.
- Regulations and codes translate principles into procedure.
- Conscience guides where rules are silent, incomplete or unjust.

Rules cannot foresee every situation, and rigid compliance may defeat the purpose of the rule, while conscience alone is subjective.

Decision test:

1. What does the law say? Check legality first.
2. Does it serve the public purpose?
3. Does the decision pass the "publicity test": would I be comfortable if it were public?
4. Is it consistent for all similarly placed citizens?
5. Seek advice, and record reasons in writing.

The 2nd Administrative Reforms Commission (2007) advised that conscience should be informed by constitutional values.

Conclusion: follow the law, use conscience for gaps, and never use conscience to bypass lawful orders.

250-word version (15 marks) [247 words]

Laws and rules are formal, enforceable guidance, while conscience is the informal, internal guide. Both are needed because administration meets situations that rules do not foresee.

Roles:

- Laws: give legitimacy, uniformity and protection against arbitrary action.
- Rules and regulations: translate principles into procedure, for example the Conduct Rules and financial rules.
- Codes of ethics: explain the expected spirit, such as the Nolan principles of selflessness, integrity, objectivity, accountability, openness, honesty and leadership.
- Conscience: the inner sense of right and wrong that fills gaps and alerts the officer to unjust rules.

Limits:

- Rules may be silent, outdated or conflicting.
- Strict compliance can defeat the purpose of the rule, producing red tape.
- Conscience can be biased, self-serving or uninformed.

Decision approach:

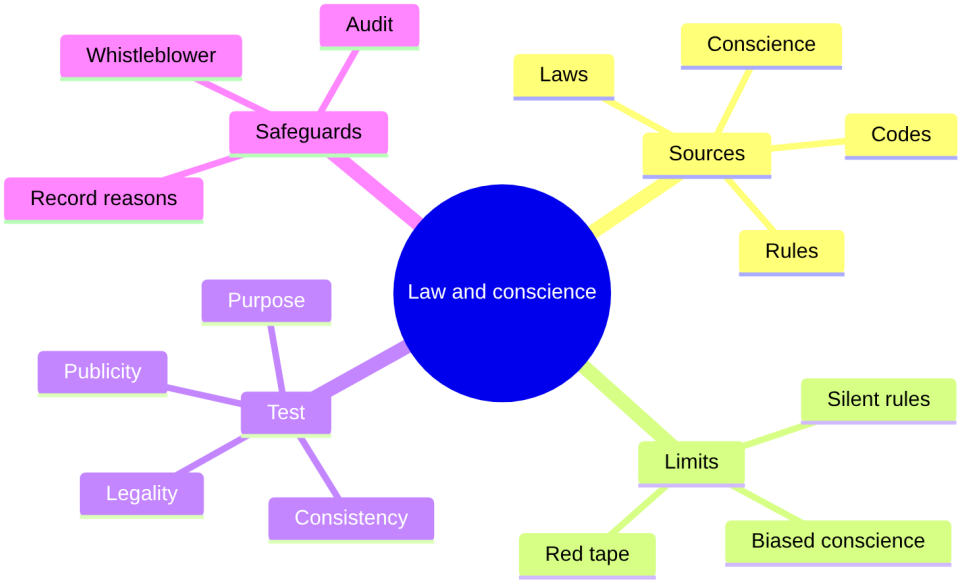
1. Check the law and the rule: legality is the first test.
2. Ask what purpose the rule serves and whether the decision advances it.
3. Apply the publicity test (would the decision stand public scrutiny?) and the universal test (would I accept it for everyone similarly placed?).
4. Consult a superior or a committee, and record the reasons in writing.
5. If an order is illegal, dissent through the lawful route and put it on record, as the Conduct Rules and the 2nd ARC's report on ethics in governance suggest.

Safeguards: whistleblower protection, independent audit and clear delegation of power.

Conclusion: rules set the boundary and conscience fills the gaps, yet conscience must be informed by constitutional values and must never be used to avoid lawful duty.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "L-R-C": Law first, Rule for procedure, Conscience for gaps. Then the "publicity test": would it stand in the newspaper?

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that conscience overrides law. In the exam, conscience fills gaps; in a clash with an illegal order the officer dissents lawfully and records it.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Committee on Standards in Public Life (UK), First Report, 1995 (Nolan principles) at gov.uk; Second Administrative Reforms Commission, Fourth Report, Ethics in Governance (January 2007) at darpg.gov.in; All India Services (Conduct) Rules, 1968 (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS4-03 - Accountability and ethical governance

GS4-03 | Accountability and ethical governance

PREDICTED: unit GS4-E3 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 4 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain the concept of accountability in public administration and suggest ways to strengthen ethical governance in India.

150-word version (10 marks) [149 words]

Accountability means that public officials must explain and answer for their decisions and actions, and accept consequences. It has three forms: political (to the legislature and voters), administrative (to superiors and audit bodies), and social (to citizens through RTI, social audit and grievance redress).

Ethical governance means decisions guided by integrity, transparency, fairness and public interest.

Strengthening measures:

- Legal: RTI Act (2005), Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013) and the Prevention of Corruption Act.
- Institutions: CAG, CVC, Lokayukta and Parliamentary committees.
- Service delivery: citizen charters and timelines, for example Karnataka's Sakala Act, with 1,452 services.
- Technology and open data.
- Ethical leadership and training.

Gaps: delayed prosecution, vacancies in oversight bodies and fear of punishment for honest mistakes, which leads to inaction. The 2nd ARC (2007) proposed ethics codes and ethics units in executive offices.

Conclusion: accountability needs both strong institutions and active citizens, because power answers best to public scrutiny.

250-word version (15 marks) [224 words]

Accountability means that those who exercise public power must answer for their decisions, disclose information and accept consequences. Ethical governance adds the requirement that power be used with integrity, transparency, fairness and for the public interest. Kautilya's Arthashastra states that in the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness.

Types of accountability:

- Political: to the legislature and the electorate.
- Administrative: to superiors, audit and vigilance bodies.
- Legal: to the courts.
- Social: to citizens through information, social audit and public hearings.

Existing mechanisms:

- Right to Information Act, 2005 and the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.
- CAG audit, Central Vigilance Commission and parliamentary committees.
- Citizen's charters and service guarantees: Karnataka's Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Gaps: weak enforcement, delay in prosecution, vacancies in oversight bodies, and officials' fear of punishment for honest errors, which leads to inaction.

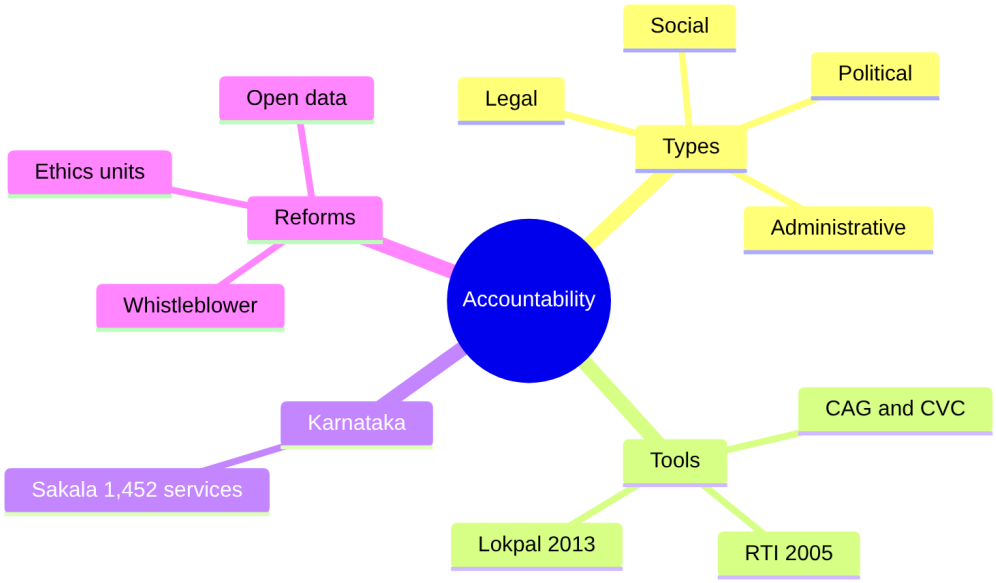
Reforms suggested by the 2nd ARC (2007): ethics codes for all branches, dedicated ethics units in executive offices, annual public reports on violations, reduced discretion and stronger whistleblower protection.

Way forward: proactive disclosure of information, open data, independent and time-bound grievance redress, protection to honest decision-makers, and ethics training with case studies; officers should also be trained to record the reasons for every important decision.

Conclusion: accountability turns authority into trust. It needs strong institutions and citizens who use them.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "P-A-L-S": Political, Administrative, Legal, Social accountability. Tools: RTI, Lokpal, CAG, Sakala.

COMMON TRAP: Accountability is not only punishment; it includes answerability and transparency. Mention both institutions and citizen-led social accountability.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Sakala figures); Right to Information Act, 2005; Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013; 2nd ARC, Fourth Report, Ethics in Governance (Jan 2007) at darpg.gov.in; Kautilya, Arthashastra 1.19 (R. P. Kangle's translation) (web-verified).

NEXT UP: GS4-04 - Citizen's charters, RTI and transparency in service delivery

GS4-04 | Citizen's charters, RTI and transparency in service delivery

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-E4 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 7 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): How do the Right to Information Act and citizen's charters promote transparency and responsive service delivery? What are their limits?

150-word version (10 marks) [140 words]

The Right to Information Act, 2005 gives citizens a legal right to information held by public authorities, with a time limit of 30 days for reply and appeals to Information Commissions. Section 4 requires proactive disclosure.

Citizen's charters, adopted from 1996-97 after the Conference of Chief Ministers, state the standards, timelines and grievance routes for services; Sevottam (2005) is the model for service-delivery excellence.

Together they cut discretion, deter delay and corruption and give citizens a voice.

Karnataka's Sakala Act gives legal timelines for 1,452 services, and Seva Sindhu delivers 712 services online.

Limits: poor awareness, vacancies and backlog in Information Commissions, charters without penalties, possible misuse of the exemptions in Section 8, and threats to RTI users.

Way forward: penalties for default, social audit and co-designed charters.

Conclusion: transparency works when it is backed by penalties and public awareness.

250-word version (15 marks) [225 words]

Transparency allows citizens to see how public power is used, and responsiveness means services are delivered promptly and fairly. The Right to Information Act, 2005 and citizen's charters serve these aims.

Right to Information Act, 2005:

- Citizens can seek information from public authorities, which must reply within 30 days.
- Section 4 requires proactive disclosure of rules, budgets and decisions.
- Appeals go to the Information Commissions; penalties can be imposed for refusal without reason.

Citizen's charters and service guarantees:

- Charters state the standards, time limits and complaint routes for services. They were taken up after the 1996-97 Conference of Chief Ministers, and the Sevottam model (2005) links the charter with grievance redress and service capability.
- Karnataka's Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions, and Seva Sindhu delivers 712 services from over 80 departments (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Impact: less discretion, faster delivery, fewer chances for bribes and a better citizen experience.

Limits:

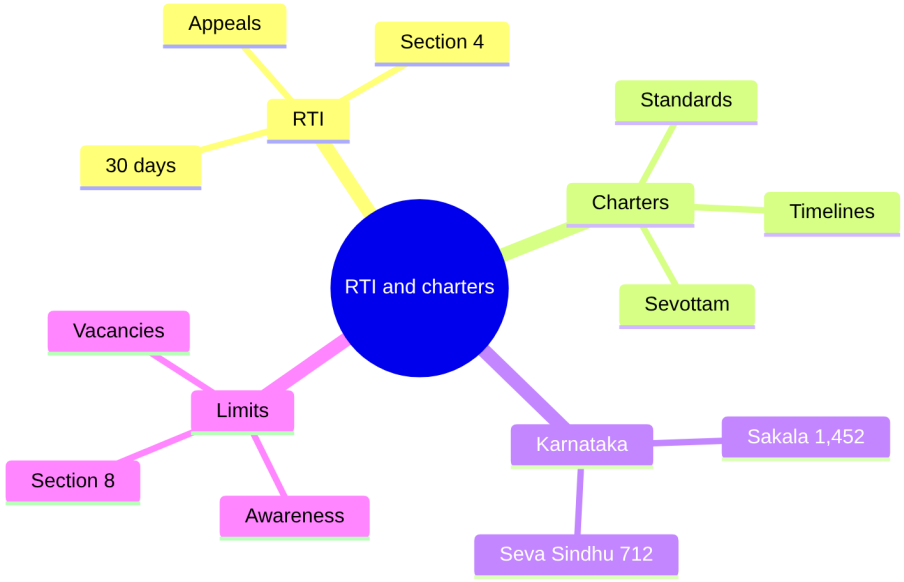
- Low awareness, especially among poor and rural citizens.
- Vacancies and backlog in Information Commissions.
- Charters without penalty for default, and exemptions under Section 8 that can be misused.
- Threats to RTI users.

Way forward: penalties for default, a digital RTI portal, social audit, whistleblower protection, and charters that are co-designed with citizens.

Conclusion: transparency and responsive service delivery strengthen each other, and both succeed when law, technology and public awareness work together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "30 - 4 - 8": 30 days to reply, section 4 for proactive disclosure, section 8 for exemptions.

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim the charter is legally enforceable everywhere; it is an administrative promise unless backed by a law such as Sakala.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Right to Information Act, 2005, ss.4, 7, 8, 19 (rti.gov.in); DARPG, Sevottam and Citizen's Charters (darpg.gov.in), web-verified; Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Sakala, Seva Sindhu).

NEXT UP: GS4-05 - Corruption: causes, consequences and a layered response

GS4-05 | Corruption: causes, consequences and a layered response

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-E4 appeared in 3 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 7 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Analyse the causes and consequences of corruption in public life and suggest an ethical and institutional response.

150-word version (10 marks) [142 words]

Corruption is the abuse of public office for private gain. In public administration it shows as bribery, nepotism and misuse of discretion.

Causes: wide discretion with low accountability, low pay in some cadres, complex rules, weak enforcement, a tolerance culture and the cost of elections.

Consequences: waste of public money, poor services for the poor, loss of trust in institutions, and distortion of markets.

Response:

- Law: Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 (amended in 2018 to criminalise giving bribes), and the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.
- Institutions: CVC, Lokayukta, CAG.
- Systems: e-services and DBT that reduce contact, and citizen's charters.
- Ethics: integrity pacts, role models and values education.

Way forward: reduce discretion, simplify procedures, speed up trials and use RTI and social audit to create public pressure.

Conclusion: corruption is a failure of both systems and values, so the cure must be both.

250-word version (15 marks) [226 words]

Corruption is the abuse of public office for private gain. It appears as bribery, extortion, nepotism, misuse of discretion and conflict of interest.

Causes:

- Wide discretion, low transparency and weak accountability.
- Complex procedures, delay and shortage of services, which create demand for "speed money".
- Weak enforcement, slow trials and low conviction.
- The cost of elections and a social tolerance for small bribes.

Consequences:

- Waste and leakage of public money, with the burden on the poor.
- Poor quality of infrastructure and services.
- Loss of trust in institutions and weaker rule of law.
- Distortion of competition and lower investment.

Institutional response:

- Law: the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, amended in 2018 to make bribe-giving an offence and to require prior approval for inquiry into official decisions (Section 17A); the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.
- Bodies: Central Vigilance Commission, State Lokayuktas (the Karnataka Lokayukta Act dates from 1984) and the CAG.
- Technology: e-procurement, DBT, and e-services such as Seva Sindhu, which reduce contact.

Ethical response:

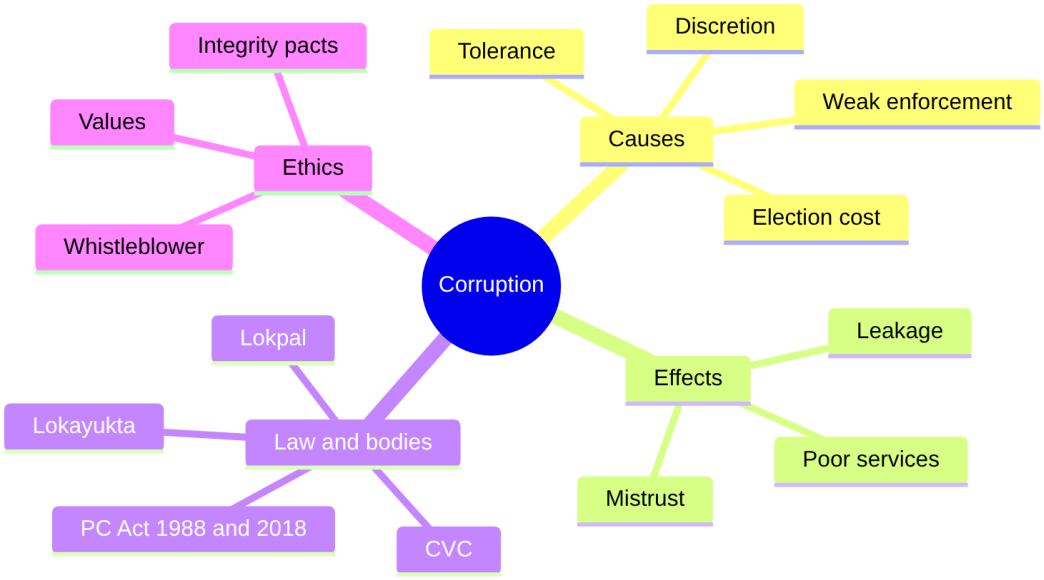
- Values education, role models and leadership by example.
- Codes of conduct and integrity pacts in contracts.
- Protection of whistleblowers and honest officers.

Way forward: reduce discretion, simplify procedures, speed up trials, and create social pressure through RTI and social audit.

Conclusion: corruption is both a failure of systems and of values, so laws and institutions must be matched by personal integrity and civic intolerance.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "D-W-E-T": Discretion, Weak enforcement, Elections cost, Tolerance. Response is Law, Bodies, Technology, Ethics (L-B-T-E).

COMMON TRAP: Do not quote a corruption-index rank or a percentage unless it is sourced; the exam rewards analysis of causes and layered remedies.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 as amended by the Prevention of Corruption (Amendment) Act, 2018 (indiacode.nic.in); Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013; Karnataka Lokayukta Act, 1984; 2nd ARC Fourth Report (2007); Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Seva Sindhu). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS4-06 - Human values: lessons from Gandhi and Basavanna

GS4-06 | Human values: lessons from Gandhi and Basavanna

PREDICTED: unit GS4-E5 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): What are human values, and what lessons can public servants draw from Gandhi and Basavanna? What roles do family and education play?

150-word version (10 marks) [142 words]

Human values are the enduring beliefs about what is good and desirable, such as truth, non-violence, compassion, justice and equality.

Gandhi: truth and non-violence, purity of means, and the talisman: recall the face of the poorest person and ask if your act will help. His seven social sins include wealth without work, knowledge without character and politics without principle.

Basavanna (12th century): through the Anubhava Mantapa he promoted equality beyond caste and gender, "Kayakave Kailasa" (work is worship) and compassion: "What religion lacks compassion?"

Family teaches values by example; schools build them through stories, service projects and discussion of constitutional values such as justice and fraternity.

Lesson for officers: treat service as duty, respect the dignity of labour, give equal treatment to every citizen, and test each major decision against the poorest person's interest.

Conclusion: values must be lived, not only taught.

250-word version (15 marks) [233 words]

Human values are the enduring beliefs about what is good and desirable, such as truth, non-violence, compassion, justice, equality and respect for life. They guide choices where rules are silent.

Lessons from Gandhi:

- Truth and non-violence, with purity of means as well as ends.
- The talisman: recall the face of the poorest person you have seen and ask whether your act will help them.
- The seven social sins (Young India, 1925): politics without principle, wealth without work, pleasure without conscience, knowledge without character, commerce without morality, science without humanity and worship without sacrifice.

Lessons from Basavanna (12th century, Karnataka):

- The Anubhava Mantapa was an open forum for people of all castes and for women to debate.
- Kayakave Kailasa: work is worship, so dignity of labour.
- Compassion as the core of religion: "Dayavillada dharma yavudayya?" (What religion is without compassion?).

Role of family and education:

- Family forms first habits of honesty, sharing and respect through example.
- Schools and colleges add reasoning, constitutional values, empathy and service through activities.
- Society and media reinforce or weaken these values.

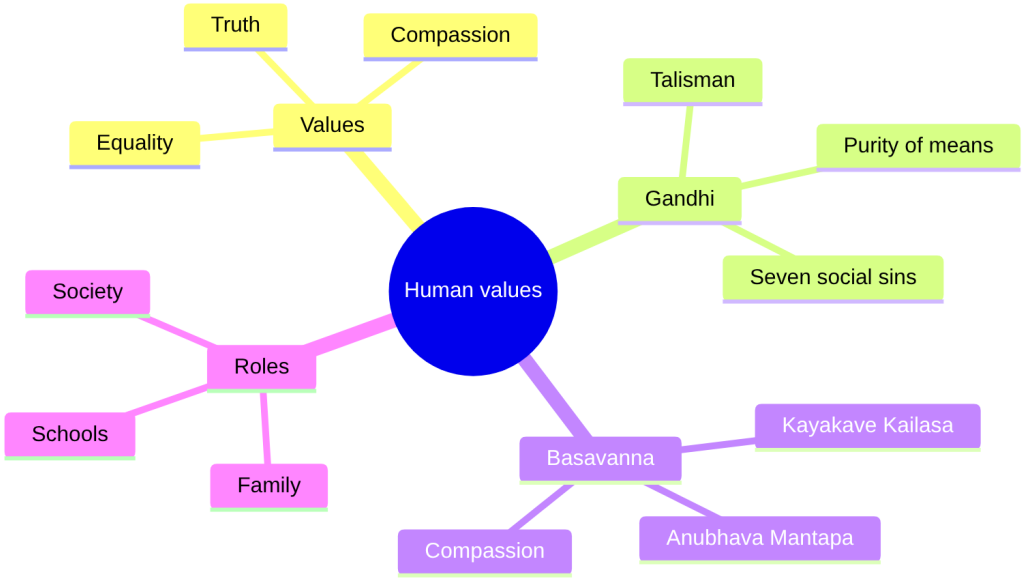
Application: a public servant should treat the poorest citizen as the test of every decision, work honestly and treat all citizens with equal dignity.

Way forward: values education through stories and service projects, ethics training in services, and recognition of ethical conduct.

Conclusion: values become character only when practised in daily decisions, and Gandhi and Basavanna show how.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "T-S-A": Talisman (poorest face), Sins (seven), Anubhava (Basavanna's forum). Equality + labour + compassion.

COMMON TRAP: Quote the sins accurately: the seventh is "worship (or religion) without sacrifice". Do not attribute the talisman to the 1925 article; it is a late note attributed to Gandhi (c. 1948, as reproduced by Pyarelal), not part of that article.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Mahatma Gandhi, Young India, 22 October 1925 (Seven Social Sins; mkgandhi.org); the "talisman" note attributed to M. K. Gandhi's last months, reproduced in Pyarelal, Mahatma Gandhi: The Last Phase, Vol. II (1958); vachanas of Basavanna, 12th century, Anubhava Mantapa and Kayakave Kailasa (Karnataka Sahitya Akademi collection of vachanas). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS4-07 - Integrity, impartiality and objectivity in public service

GS4-07 | Integrity, impartiality and objectivity in public service

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-I appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 17 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Distinguish integrity, impartiality and objectivity as values of a civil servant, and explain why they are necessary for good governance.

150-word version (10 marks) [135 words]

Integrity is the consistency of values, words and actions, even when unobserved. Impartiality means treating similar cases alike, without favour. Objectivity means deciding on facts and evidence, not on personal feelings.

Why they matter:

- They build public trust in government.
- They protect equality before law (Article 14) and fair procedure.
- They reduce corruption and nepotism.
- They ensure that policy is evidence-based.

These are three of the seven Nolan principles of public life, and the Conduct Rules require integrity and devotion to duty.

Safeguards: declare conflict of interest, record reasons, give hearing to all sides, and rotate sensitive postings.

Challenges: political pressure, loyalty to colleagues and frequent transfers, which can be reduced by fixed tenure for key posts and ethics training with realistic cases.

Conclusion: integrity is the base, impartiality and objectivity are its public face.

250-word version (15 marks) [235 words]

Integrity, impartiality and objectivity are three linked values. They define the character of a civil servant who must serve the Constitution rather than a person or party.

Meaning:

- Integrity: consistency between values, words and actions, even when no one is watching; honesty and incorruptibility.
- Impartiality: treating similar cases alike without favour or prejudice; political neutrality in the service.
- Objectivity: basing decisions on facts and evidence, free from personal bias.

Why they are necessary:

- Public trust: citizens accept decisions they believe are fair.
- Equality before the law (Article 14) and non-discrimination (Article 15) need impartial administration.
- Policy based on evidence is more effective and less wasteful.
- They reduce corruption, nepotism and arbitrary transfers.
- They protect the civil service from political and private pressure, which is the basis of a permanent and neutral executive.

Anchors in rules: the Nolan principles (1995) list integrity, objectivity and honesty among seven principles; the Conduct Rules require every member to maintain absolute integrity and devotion to duty.

Challenges: political pressure, frequent transfers, personal loyalty to colleagues, and conflict of interest.

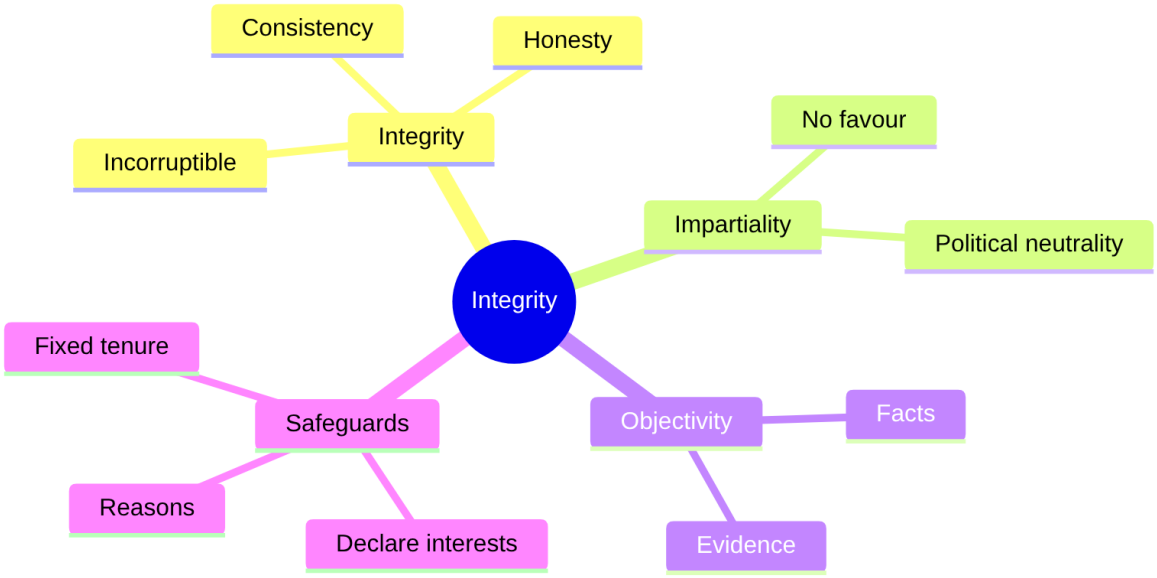
Safeguards: declaration of interests, written reasons for decisions, hearing all sides, fixed tenure for key posts, and an ethics adviser or committee.

Way forward: ethics training with realistic cases, and protection to officers who act on principle.

Conclusion: integrity is the foundation of character, and impartiality and objectivity are how it is seen in decisions. Without them, good governance cannot survive.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "I-I-O": Integrity = inside (same when unseen), Impartiality = between people (no favour), Objectivity = about facts (no feelings).

COMMON TRAP: Impartiality is not the same as neutrality; a civil servant is politically neutral but not morally neutral. Keep the three definitions distinct.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Committee on Standards in Public Life, First Report (1995), Nolan principles (gov.uk); All India Services (Conduct) Rules, 1968; Constitution of India, Articles 14 and 15. Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS4-08 - Empathy, compassion and tolerance in administration

GS4-08 | Empathy, compassion and tolerance in administration

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-I appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 17 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): Explain how empathy, compassion and tolerance improve public administration, with examples of how an officer can practise them.

150-word version (10 marks) [130 words]

Empathy is understanding another's feelings and situation; compassion adds the desire to help; tolerance is respect for differences in belief and way of life.

Importance:

- Welfare design improves when officers understand the user's constraints.
- Compassion reduces harshness in enforcement, while still applying the law.
- Tolerance protects pluralism and communal harmony, which the Constitution (Articles 25-28) guarantees.

Practice:

- Listen at grievance meetings and field visits.
- Speak in the local language and avoid jargon.
- Prioritise the vulnerable, as in Gandhi's talisman.
- Show firmness against law-breaking but dignity to the person.

Risk: empathy without objectivity can become favouritism, so compassion must stay within the law.

Way forward: sensitisation training, citizen feedback on services and recognition of citizen-centric officers.

Conclusion: empathy supplies the heart of administration, rules supply the discipline, and both are needed.

250-word version (15 marks) [232 words]

Empathy is the ability to understand another person's feelings and circumstances. Compassion goes a step further and moves a person to help. Tolerance is respect for people whose beliefs, language or way of life differ from one's own.

Importance in administration:

- Empathy improves policy design, because officers who understand the user's constraints design simpler procedures.
- Compassion corrects the harshness of rules in hard cases, for example by giving relief to a distressed farmer or a disaster-affected family, while following the law.
- Tolerance protects pluralism and communal harmony and upholds the freedom of conscience in Articles 25 to 28.
- Together they build trust, especially among the poor and minorities.

Ways an officer can practise them:

- Listen at grievance meetings and during field visits.
- Speak the local language and avoid jargon.
- Prioritise the most vulnerable, guided by Gandhi's talisman.
- Combine firm action against law-breaking with dignity for the person.
- Build teams that include people of different backgrounds.

Basavanna's vachana, "What religion is without compassion?", shows a Karnataka tradition in which compassion is the root of dharma.

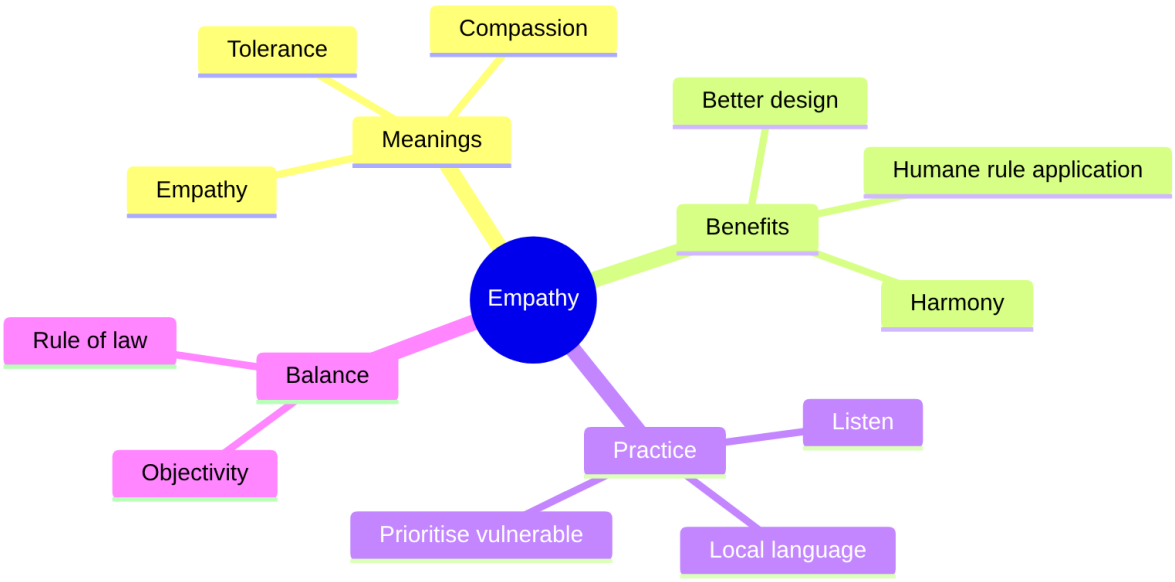
Limits and balance: empathy for one person must not lead to injustice for another. Hence objectivity and the rule of law should shape compassion.

Way forward: sensitisation training, user feedback on services, and rewarding officers for citizen-centric work.

Conclusion: empathy, compassion and tolerance give administration its human face, and rules give it discipline. A good officer uses both.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "E-C-T": Empathy = feel with, Compassion = act for, Tolerance = respect despite difference.

COMMON TRAP: Empathy is not agreement with a person's wrongdoing; the officer may feel with a person and still apply the law. Name the balance with objectivity.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Constitution of India, Articles 25-28; Gandhi's talisman note (attributed, c. 1948; Pyarelal, Last Phase, Vol. II); vachanas of Basavanna (12th century); Goleman, Emotional Intelligence (1995) for the definition of empathy as a component. Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS4-09 - Attitude, its components and how to change it

GS4-09 | Attitude, its components and how to change it

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-T1 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 14 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): What is attitude? Explain its components and the ways to change a harmful attitude in a workplace or community.

150-word version (10 marks) [136 words]

Attitude is a relatively stable tendency to feel, think and act in a favourable or unfavourable way towards a person, object or idea.

Components (ABC model):

- Affective: feelings.
- Behavioural: tendency to act.
- Cognitive: beliefs.

Functions: attitudes help us organise knowledge, defend self-image and express values.

Changing attitudes:

- Information and education, which change beliefs.
- Contact and shared goals, which reduce prejudice.
- Persuasion using a credible source and a clear message.
- Cognitive dissonance: when behaviour conflicts with belief, people adjust the belief (Festinger, 1957).
- Role models, rules and incentives.

Example: a village's reluctance to vaccinate can change if officials first listen to fears, use local leaders as messengers, show the benefit in simple words and reward early adopters.

Caution: persuasion must be truthful; manipulation destroys trust.

Conclusion: attitude change works best when information, contact and example act together.

250-word version (15 marks) [218 words]

Attitude is a relatively stable tendency to evaluate a person, object, idea or issue favourably or unfavourably, and to act accordingly.

Components (the ABC model):

- Affective: feelings towards the object.
- Behavioural: the tendency to act.
- Cognitive: beliefs and thoughts about it.

Functions: attitudes help us organise knowledge, protect self-image, express values and gain social acceptance.

Formation: family, peers, education, media and direct experience.

Changing a harmful attitude:

- Education: new, credible information changes beliefs.
- Persuasion: a trusted source, a clear and relevant message and repeated exposure. Petty and Cacioppo's Elaboration Likelihood Model (1986) shows that thoughtful listeners respond to strong arguments, while others respond to cues such as credibility.
- Contact and shared goals: working together reduces prejudice.
- Cognitive dissonance: when behaviour conflicts with belief, people tend to adjust one of them (Leon Festinger, 1957). Small, public commitments can start the change.
- Rules, incentives and role models: they reinforce new behaviour.

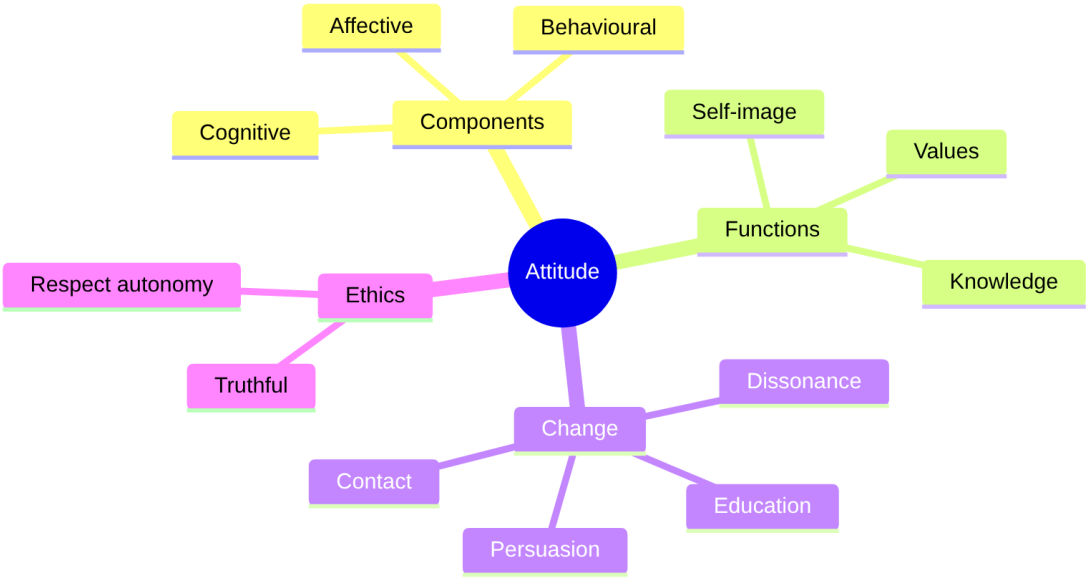
Application for public service: bringing a community to use public toilets or vaccinate children requires listening to the fear first, using local leaders as messengers, showing the benefit in simple words and rewarding early adopters.

Cautions: persuasion must be truthful and respectful of autonomy; manipulation damages trust.

Conclusion: attitudes change through information, contact and example. An officer who understands the three components can change behaviour through respect, not pressure.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "A-B-C": Affect (feel), Behaviour (do), Cognition (think). To change: Inform, Contact, Dissonance, Examples (I-C-D-E).

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse attitude with opinion or value: values are deeper and more stable; attitudes are specific evaluations. Avoid claiming one change method always works.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Standard social-psychology references: tri-component model of attitude; Leon Festinger, A Theory of Cognitive Dissonance (1957); Richard Petty and John Cacioppo, Communication and Persuasion: Central and Peripheral Routes to Attitude Change (1986). Web-verified.

NEXT UP: GS4-10 - Emotional intelligence for civil servants

GS4-10 | Emotional intelligence for civil servants

> **PREDICTED:** unit GS4-T2 appeared in 4 of the 4 sets tagged (CORE); 6 question(s) in total. Pattern-based prediction.

Practice prompt (own wording): What is emotional intelligence? Discuss its components and its usefulness for an administrator facing stress and conflict.

150-word version (10 marks) [129 words]

Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to recognise, understand and manage one's own emotions and those of others. Daniel Goleman (1995) popularised five components:

- Self-awareness: knowing one's moods and triggers.
- Self-regulation: staying calm and avoiding impulsive reactions.
- Motivation: drive beyond money or status.
- Empathy: sensing others' needs.
- Social skills: managing relationships and conflicts.

Usefulness: calm decision-making in crises, better teamwork and negotiation, handling public anger and fewer biased decisions.

EI is not a substitute for competence or law; it supports them.

Developing EI: reflection and feedback, mindfulness, active listening and role-play in training. It was developed by Salovey and Mayer (1990), before Goleman.

Way forward: include EI and ethics case discussion in induction and in-service training.

Conclusion: an emotionally intelligent officer leads people with the head and the heart.

250-word version (15 marks) [222 words]

Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to perceive, understand, manage and use emotions in oneself and in others. The concept was developed by Salovey and Mayer (1990) and popularised by Daniel Goleman in Emotional Intelligence (1995).

Goleman's five components:

- Self-awareness: knowing one's feelings, strengths and triggers.
- Self-regulation: controlling impulses and staying calm under pressure.
- Motivation: an inner drive to achieve and to serve.
- Empathy: understanding others' feelings and needs.
- Social skills: building relationships, persuading and resolving conflict.

Usefulness for an administrator:

- Crisis: remaining calm during a flood, riot or protest allows clear decisions.
- Public dealing: understanding anger behind a complaint helps de-escalate and solve the problem.
- Team leadership: motivating subordinates and managing conflicts.
- Ethical decisions: awareness of one's own bias reduces unfair judgement.
- Negotiation with the public and political leaders without losing neutrality.

Limits: EI cannot replace knowledge, law or analytical skills, and it can be misused to manipulate people; an ethical purpose is essential.

Developing EI: reflective journaling, feedback from peers and subordinates, active listening, mindfulness and role-play in training.

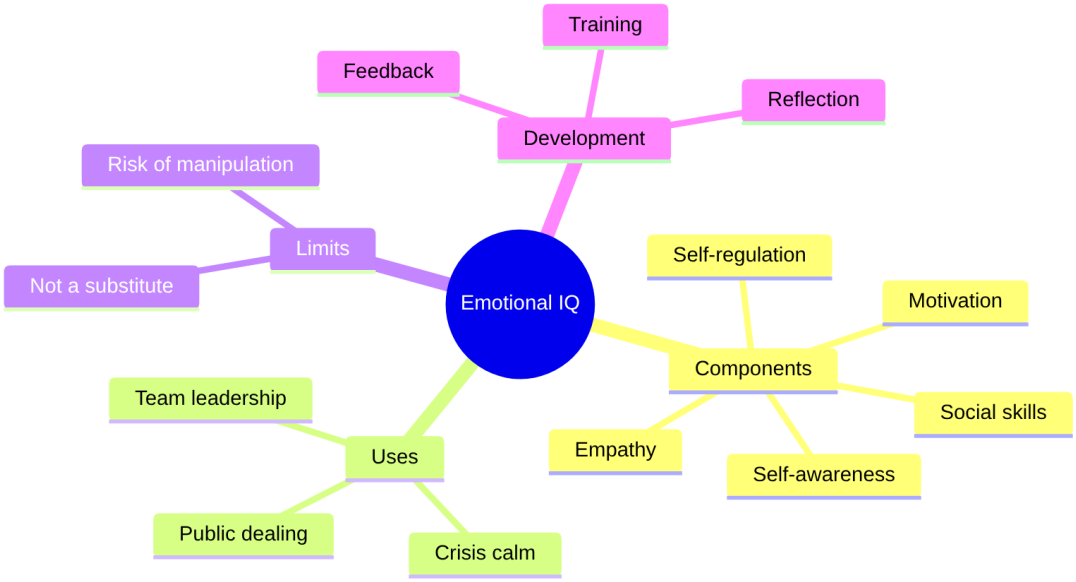
Way forward: include EI and ethics case discussions in induction and in-service training, and assess it in selection and appraisal.

Competence still matters: knowledge of law and procedure must go with EI.

Conclusion: emotionally intelligent administrators combine firmness with sensitivity, leading to calmer offices, fairer decisions and more trust from citizens.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "S-S-M-E-S": Self-aware, Self-regulate, Motivate, Empathise, Social skill. Think "know, control, drive, feel, connect".

COMMON TRAP: EI is not the same as being nice; it includes controlling oneself and being firm. Do not claim it replaces competence or legal knowledge.



Redraw this map from memory, then write the answer.

Sources: Peter Salovey and John Mayer, "Emotional Intelligence", Imagination, Cognition and Personality (1990); Daniel Goleman, Emotional Intelligence (1995). Web-verified.

Appendix: fact ledger (Karnataka and other figures)

Answer	Claim	Source key	Check
GS1-05	Gruha Lakshmi launched in 2023-24 to give Rs 2,000 a month to female heads of households	ES	matched
GS1-08	Three-tier panchayat system: 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats and 31 Zilla Panchayats	ES	matched
GS1-08	Android PoS machines distributed to all 5,946 Gram Panchayats for property tax collection	ES	matched
GS1-09	GSDP rose from Rs 29.06 lakh crore (2024-25) to Rs 32.81 lakh crore (2025-26) at current prices	ES	matched
GS1-09	Real growth 8.1% against India's 7.4%	ES	matched
GS1-09	Per capita income Rs 4,33,326 against all-India Rs 2,19,575	ES	matched
GS1-09	Services 69.8% of GSVA	ES	matched
GS1-10	Bengaluru Urban contributed 40.4 per cent of State GDP in 2024-25	ES	matched
GS1-10	Kalaburagi division recorded the lowest per capita income, Rs 1,89,938	ES	matched
GS1-10	Startup Policy 2025-30 targets 25,000 start-ups, 10,000 outside Bengaluru	ES	matched
GS2-02	Bengaluru Urban contributed 40.4 per cent of State GDP in 2024-25	ES	matched
GS2-03	The Western Ghats lie within Karnataka (nearly 60 per cent of the Western Ghats located in the State)	ES	matched
GS2-04	As per Census 2011, 38.67 per cent of Karnataka's population is urban	ES	matched
GS2-04	Urban share rose by 4.68 percentage points during 2001-2011	ES	matched
GS2-04	Bengaluru Urban contributed 40.4 per cent of State GDP	ES	matched
GS2-04	Metro Phase-2 is 75.06 km, 53.80 km operational; K-RIDE revised cost Rs 23,103 crore	ES	matched
GS2-04	Startup Policy 2025-30 targets 10,000 start-ups outside Bengaluru	ES	matched
GS2-05	16th Finance Commission retained States' share of the divisible pool at 41 per cent; Karnataka's share rose to 4.131 per cent from 3.647 per cent	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS2-05	Budget 2026-27 estimates Karnataka's share in central taxes at Rs 63,050 crore, up 24 per cent	PRS	matched
GS2-06	Constitutional Arts. 153, 155, 156, 163 define the Governor's office and the aid-and-advice rule	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS2-07	Kesavananda Bharati decided 24 April 1973 by a 13-judge bench, 7:6 majority	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS2-08	16th FC kept States' share at 41%; Karnataka's horizontal share 4.131% vs 3.647% (15th FC) vs 4.713% (14th FC)	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS2-08	Budget 2026-27 share in central taxes Rs 63,050 crore, up 24 per cent over 2025-26 RE	PRS	matched
GS2-08	Survey cites discontinuation of GST compensation from 2023-24 and a reduction in devolution under the 15th FC	ES	matched
GS2-08	16th FC recommended a fiscal deficit target of 3 per cent of GSDP for 2026-31	PRS	matched
GS2-09	Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions; 209 new services added in 2025	ES	matched
GS2-09	Seva Sindhu: 712 services, over 80 departments, 7,569 Gram One centres, 4.23 crore transactions	ES	matched
GS2-09	WhatsApp chatbot served 1,70,659 users and registered 7,136 grievances	ES	matched
GS2-10	SAARC founded 1985; BIMSTEC founded 1997 with secretariat in Dhaka; sixth BIMSTEC summit Bangkok April 2025	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-01	Panchamitra WhatsApp chatbot served 1,70,659 users	ES	matched
GS3-01	Seva Sindhu: 712 services, over 80 departments, 7,569 Gram One centres, 4.23 crore transactions	ES	matched
GS3-01	Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions	ES	matched
GS3-01	Karnataka Cybersecurity Policy 2024-29	ES	matched
GS3-01	KSNDMC has telemetric rain gauges at all Gram Panchayats (6,605) and 843 weather stations	ES	matched

Answer	Claim	Source key	Check
GS3-02	Installed capacity 37,072.95 MW; renewables over 53.32 per cent of capacity	ES	matched
GS3-02	T&D losses declined from 16.34% in 2021-22 to 12.57% in 2024-25	ES	matched
GS3-02	Peak demand 18,395 MW and highest daily consumption 356.88 MU in 2025-26	ES	matched
GS3-02	Karnataka won first prize for highest installed wind capacity in 2024-25; Pavagada Solar Park won four awards at RE-Invest 2024	ES	matched
GS3-02	Kaiga nuclear station in Uttara Kannada operated by NPCIL	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-02	Pavagada Solar Park commissioned capacity about 2,050 MW	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-02	India NDC: 50 per cent non-fossil capacity by 2030; net zero 2070	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-03	Disaster Management Act ss. 3, 14, 25 set PM, CM and Collector as heads of NDMA, SDMA, DDMA	DMA	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-03	KSNDMC has 6,605 telemetric rain gauges and 843 telemetric weather stations	ES	matched
GS3-03	Krishi Bhagya under State Disaster Mitigation Fund: Rs 100 crore for 5,482 packages in 223 taluks	ES	matched
GS3-03	Kodagu landslides August 2018; 22 districts flooded August 2019	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-03	Sendai Framework adopted 2015, covering 2015-2030	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-04	Agriculture expected to grow 9.1 per cent at constant prices in 2025-26	ES	matched
GS3-04	Micro-irrigation brought 1,00,956 hectares under coverage in 2025-26	ES	matched
GS3-04	4,529 farm ponds constructed up to December 2025	ES	matched
GS3-04	PMFBY enrolled 25,76,388 farmers up to December 2025	ES	matched
GS3-04	170 APMCs, 167 linked to the Unified Market Platform; UMP transacted Rs 4,39,852.54 crore	ES	matched
GS3-04	Watershed: 74.94 lakh ha treated of 129.70 lakh ha available	ES	matched
GS3-04	FRUITS platform has over 102.95 lakh farmers registered	ES	matched
GS3-05	GEAC approved Bt cotton hybrids on 26 March 2002; only GM crop approved for commercial cultivation	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-05	Supreme Court split verdict on GM mustard on 23 July 2024 and direction for a national GM policy	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-05	ICAR released two genome-edited rice varieties on 4 May 2025	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-06	KMF average daily milk procurement of 1 crore litres in June 2025	ES	matched
GS3-06	KMF has 27.19 lakh members and disburses Rs 35.36 crore daily through DBT	ES	matched
GS3-06	Nandini Semen Station processes 40 lakh doses; 40 lakh AIs resulted in 10 lakh calf births	ES	matched
GS3-06	Nandini ranking improved from 43rd (2024) to 38th (2025) in Brand Finance	ES	matched
GS3-06	Operation Flood began 1970 under NDDB; Anand pattern led by Kurien	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-07	Watershed: of 190.50 lakh ha State area, 129.70 lakh ha available; 74.94 lakh ha treated up to March 2025	ES	matched
GS3-07	4,529 farm ponds up to December 2025	ES	matched
GS3-07	Watershed programme in the lines of Sujala-III	ES	matched
GS3-07	MSP for 22 crops; Budget 2018-19 promised 1.5 times cost; PM-AASHA 2018	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-08	MMR declined from 97 (2015-17) to 68 (2021-23)	ES	matched
GS3-08	9,058 Health and Wellness Centres upgraded by December 2025 (6,532 sub-centres, 2,161 rural PHCs, 365 urban PHCs)	ES	matched
GS3-08	Gruha Arogya screened 62,37,026 for hypertension and diabetes (Aug-Dec 2025)	ES	matched
GS3-08	STEMI programme in 31 districts: 10,75,535 ECGs	ES	matched
GS3-08	National Health Policy 2017; PM-JAY 2018; Mission Indradhanush 2014	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)

Answer	Claim	Source key	Check
GS3-09	Nearly 60 per cent of the Western Ghats lies in Karnataka	ES	matched
GS3-09	Recorded forest area 40,678 sq. km (21.21%); forest and tree cover 24.52% (ISFR 2023)	ES	matched
GS3-09	Protected areas 11,399 sq. km: 5 national parks, 37 sanctuaries incl. 5 tiger reserves	ES	matched
GS3-09	Karnataka first in elephants (6,395), second in tigers (563)	ES	matched
GS3-09	6,554 Biodiversity Management Committees at Gram Panchayat level	ES	matched
GS3-09	Hotspot criteria (1,500 endemic plants; 70% habitat lost); India has four hotspots; Western Ghats WHS 2012	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-10	Karnataka produced 4,08,537 tonnes of plastic waste in 2024-25; 135 licensed recycling facilities, capacity 2,31,834 tonnes	ES	matched
GS3-10	Enforcement confiscated 223.09 metric tonnes of plastic in 2024-25	ES	matched
GS3-10	Karnataka has only 12 polluted river stretches	ES	matched
GS3-10	Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026, in force 1 April 2026, four-stream segregation	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS3-10	Single-use plastic ban from 1 July 2022	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-01	Conduct Rules: All India Services (Conduct) Rules 1968 require integrity and devotion to duty	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-01	Basavanna's maxim Kayakave Kailasa (work is worship)	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-02	Nolan Committee's seven principles of public life (1995)	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-02	2nd ARC Fourth Report, Ethics in Governance, January 2007	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-03	Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions	ES	matched
GS4-03	RTI Act 2005; Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act 2013	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-03	2nd ARC recommended ethics codes, ethics units, annual reports on violations and whistleblower protection	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-04	Sakala Act mandates timelines for 1,452 services under 114 institutions	ES	matched
GS4-04	Seva Sindhu: 712 services from over 80 departments	ES	matched
GS4-04	RTI Act 2005: reply within 30 days; s.4 proactive disclosure	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-04	Citizen's charters began 1996-97; Sevottam 2005	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-05	Prevention of Corruption Act 1988 amended in 2018 to criminalise bribe giving; s.17A prior approval	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-05	Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act 2013; Karnataka Lokayukta Act 1984	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-05	Seva Sindhu delivers 712 services	ES	matched
GS4-06	Gandhi's seven social sins, Young India, 22 October 1925	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-06	Basavanna: Anubhava Mantapa and Kayakave Kailasa, 12th century	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-06	Gandhi's talisman note, reproduced in Pyarelal's Last Phase (1958)	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-07	Nolan principles include integrity, objectivity, honesty (seven in all)	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-07	Articles 14 and 15 of the Constitution	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-08	Articles 25 to 28 guarantee freedom of religion	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-08	Goleman's Emotional Intelligence (1995) lists empathy as a component	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-09	Festinger, A Theory of Cognitive Dissonance, 1957	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)

Answer	Claim	Source key	Check
GS4-09	Petty and Cacioppo, Elaboration Likelihood Model, 1986	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-10	Salovey and Mayer (1990) formulated emotional intelligence; Goleman (1995) popularised it	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)
GS4-10	Goleman's five components: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills	WEB	web-verified (not fragment-matched)

Source keys: **ES** = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Executive Summary (data to Dec 2025 unless stated); **PRS** = PRS Legislative Research, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (Budget presented 06-03-2026); **PIB** = PIB / Parliament answer, Aug 2026 (web-verified: pib.gov.in PRID=2298231); **ISRO** = ISRO website isro.gov.in (Chandrayaan-3 page; Aditya-L1 halo-orbit release); **DMA** = Disaster Management Act, 2005 (India Code, indiacode.nic.in), ss.3, 14, 25. Statutes, judgments and international instruments are cited by name and year in each answer; they are web-verified at the official site named in that answer.

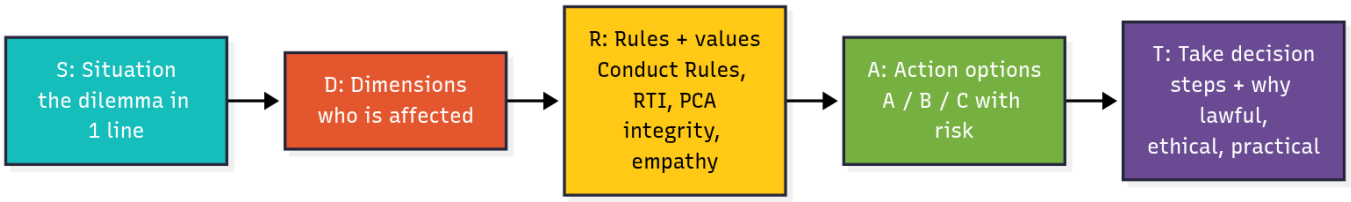
Deliverable 4 - Ethics case studies (15, SDRAT method)

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | GS 4 (Paper 5): case-study questions, each solved in at most 300 words

Library progress: Deliverable 4 of 8

CHAI-TALK: A case study is a small story with a hard choice inside it. The examiner is not hunting for the one right answer. The examiner is checking how you think: do you spot everyone affected, name the rule, weigh your options and still act? SDRAT is a five-step checklist that makes sure you do all of that in 300 words.
PREDICTED / FICTIONAL: All 15 cases are invented composites written in my own words. None is copied from a past paper. The laws they mention were checked on official sources (see the legal-reference list at the end). The case themes are chosen from the syllabus units, not from inside information.

The SDRAT method in one picture



Situation (one line), **D**ilemma and stakeholders, **R**ules and values, **A**lternatives with merit and risk, **T**he decision with steps and reasons. Spend about 15 per cent of your words on S and D, 20 per cent on R and A, and 65 per cent on T. Keep every case to 300 words or fewer.

COMMON TRAP: Never answer in one sentence ('I will report it'). Name the option you reject and why. Reasoning is where the marks are.

Coverage across the three syllabus sections

Section	Cases	Count
Section I: Ethics and human interface	CS-01, CS-02, CS-03, CS-04, CS-05	5
Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy	CS-06, CS-07, CS-08, CS-09, CS-10	5
Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values	CS-11, CS-12, CS-13, CS-14, CS-15	5

Word-count ledger

Case	Section	Unit	S+D+R+A+T words
CS-01	I	GS4-E4	276
CS-02	I	GS4-E4	274
CS-03	I	GS4-E2	256
CS-04	I	GS4-E3	248
CS-05	I	GS4-E1	248
CS-06	II	GS4-I	286
CS-07	II	GS4-I	255
CS-08	II	GS4-I	275
CS-09	II	GS4-I	268
CS-10	II	GS4-I	279
CS-11	III	GS4-T1	257

Case	Section	Unit	S+D+R+A+T words
CS-12	III	GS4-T2	257
CS-13	III	GS4-E4	270
CS-14	III	GS4-E2	273
CS-15	III	GS4-E3	246

CS-01 | A contractor's festival gift

Section I: Ethics and human interface | syllabus unit GS4-E4 | 276 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are the Executive Engineer of a district public works division. A contractor whose bill for Rs 2 crore is pending in your office sends an expensive gift hamper and an invitation to his daughter's wedding. The bill is genuine, the work is complete, and he says, "This is only a custom." Your junior engineer says refusing may offend a powerful local figure.

S - Situation. The gift arrives while the contractor's bill is pending, so accepting it creates a conflict of interest, even if the bill is genuine.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Contractor (wants payment and goodwill); you (integrity, reputation); junior staff (watching your example); department (credibility); other contractors (fair treatment); public (quality of works and trust).

R - Rules and values. The Conduct Rules limit gifts from persons with official dealings and require integrity. Values: integrity, impartiality, accountability, objectivity. The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 treats undue advantage to a public servant as an offence.

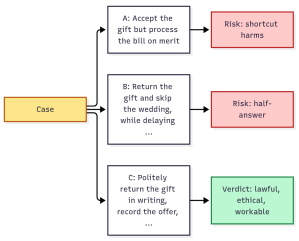
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Accept the gift but process the bill on merit. Merit: no friction. Risk: perception of a bribe and an obligation.
- **B.** Return the gift and skip the wedding, while delaying the bill to avoid suspicion. Risk: punishing a honest contractor and violating his entitlement to timely payment.
- **C.** Politely return the gift in writing, record the offer, process the bill strictly on its merits and the timeline, and decline the wedding invitation.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Return the hamper with a courteous note explaining the rule. (2) Report the offer to the superior authority as the Conduct Rules expect, and record it in the file. (3) Process the bill through the normal measurement and verification, with a second officer checking, and release it on schedule. (4) Say to the team that no gift is accepted from persons with pending work, and display this in the office. Justification: this is lawful because it follows the gift rules; ethical because integrity requires that even the appearance of obligation be avoided; practical because it keeps goodwill while protecting the contractor's right to timely payment and your independence. Systemic: a gift register and a notice to vendors.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "R-R-P": Return, Report, Process on merit.

COMMON TRAP: Do not delay the bill to look clean; delay is unfair to an honest contractor. Impartial payment is part of integrity.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-02 - Speed money at the taluk office

CS-02 | Speed money at the taluk office

Section I: Ethics and human interface | syllabus unit GS4-E4 | 274 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a Tahsildar. An elderly woman has waited three months for a mutation entry on her late husband's land. A clerk privately tells her that the file will move quickly if she pays Rs 5,000. She complains to you in tears. The clerk is the only one who knows the new software, and the office is short-staffed.

S - Situation. A clerk is allegedly demanding a bribe to deliver a service that carries a legal time limit, and the complainant is a vulnerable senior citizen.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Elderly woman (needs service and dignity); clerk (livelihood, possible guilt); you (accountability); office colleagues (morale, workload); other citizens (equal service); government (credibility of the service guarantee).

R - Rules and values. Karnataka's Sakala Act fixes timelines for notified services and allows penalties for delay. The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 makes a demand for a bribe an offence. Values: integrity, empathy, accountability, fairness in service delivery.

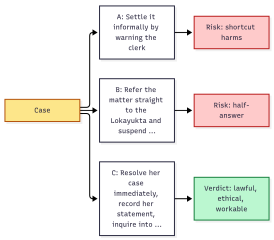
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Settle it informally by warning the clerk. Merit: fast, protects the clerk. Risk: no deterrence and no record.
- **B.** Refer the matter straight to the Lokayukta and suspend the clerk. Merit: strong signal. Risk: the evidence may be weak and the work may stop.
- **C.** Resolve her case immediately, record her statement, inquire into the allegation under rules, and assist the Lokayukta if evidence supports it.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Immediately direct that her mutation be completed and give her a written acknowledgement with the date. (2) Take her written statement and call for the clerk's explanation, with a hearing. (3) If there is prima facie evidence, initiate disciplinary action and inform the vigilance authority. Do not entrap without legal advice. (4) Review all pending Sakala applications and arrange a helper for the software. Justification: this is lawful, because a bribe demand is an offence and the clerk is entitled to due process; ethical, because her dignity comes first and the clerk is treated fairly; practical, because clearing backlog removes the opening for speed money. Systemic: display service timelines, a weekly pendency report and cross-training of staff.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "S-I-R": Service first, Inquire fairly, Reform the process.

COMMON TRAP: Do not punish before a fair inquiry. Natural justice applies even to a suspected clerk.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-03 - The ration card without the paper

CS-03 | The ration card without the paper

Section I: Ethics and human interface | syllabus unit GS4-E2 | 256 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a food and civil supplies officer. A 70-year-old woman living alone has lost her documents in a house fire and cannot prove her identity, so her name has dropped from the ration list. The rule says an Aadhaar-linked proof is required. The local ward member vouches for her, and neighbours confirm her story. Your staff says you must follow the rule.

S - Situation. A strict documentary rule would deny food to a person who is clearly entitled, creating a clash between the letter of the rule and its purpose.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. The woman (food security, dignity); you (duty and risk of audit objection); staff (fear of irregularity); other beneficiaries (system integrity); the department (rule consistency); neighbours and ward member (witnesses).

R - Rules and values. The National Food Security Act, 2013 treats food as an entitlement for eligible households. Rules are meant to prevent leakage, not to exclude genuine beneficiaries. Values: compassion, justice, proportionality, accountability.

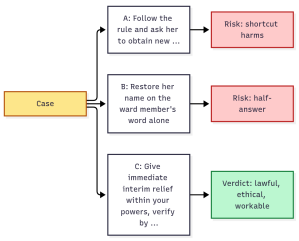
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Follow the rule and ask her to obtain new documents. Merit: safe. Risk: hunger during the delay.
- **B.** Restore her name on the ward member's word alone. Merit: quick relief. Risk: not verified, which could set a precedent for fraud.
- **C.** Give immediate interim relief within your powers, verify by an independent field inquiry, and help her get documents.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Check what interim relief is allowed under the department's guidelines, for example emergency grain, and give it in writing. (2) Order a field verification by two officials with statements of neighbours and a panchayat certificate, and record it. (3) Help her apply for duplicate Aadhaar and other proofs through the Seva Sindhu centre. (4) Report the case to the superior and suggest a standard procedure for disaster-hit households. Justification: lawful because it works within guidelines and records evidence; ethical because the purpose of a food entitlement is to prevent hunger; practical because a verified record protects you from audit objection. Systemic: a fast-track window for lost-document cases.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "H-V-H": Help now, Verify, Help to document.

COMMON TRAP: Do not break the rule and call it compassion. Compassion works inside a verified, recorded process.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-04 - The minister's phone call

CS-04 | The minister's phone call

Section I: Ethics and human interface | syllabus unit GS4-E3 | 248 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a District Commissioner. A minister phones you to cancel the transfer of a favoured official and to approve a road contract for a firm linked to his relative. The tender committee has ranked this firm third, and the Chief Minister's office has not instructed you. The minister hints that your own posting depends on cooperation.

S - Situation. A political superior is pressing for an irregular decision, and compliance would breach tender norms while refusing may cost your posting.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Minister (political interest); you (duty, career); the lowest qualified bidder (fair chance); the official whose transfer is involved; citizens (quality road, money); the civil service (neutrality); media (scrutiny).

R - Rules and values. Civil servants serve the Constitution, not individuals; the Conduct Rules require integrity and political neutrality. Tender rules require transparency and the lowest qualified bid. Values: objectivity, impartiality, accountability.

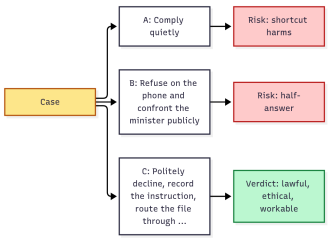
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Comply quietly. Merit: protects your posting. Risk: abuse of office and personal liability.
- **B.** Refuse on the phone and confront the minister publicly. Merit: bold. Risk: loses support and escalates unnecessarily.
- **C.** Politely decline, record the instruction, route the file through the committee with written reasons, and inform the Chief Secretary.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Tell the minister courteously that the decision is under the tender committee and that rules prevent any change. (2) Write a file note of the oral instruction and the reasons for your stand. (3) Complete the process on merit and publish the result. (4) Inform the Chief Secretary, and ask for guidance on the transfer request, which can be considered through the established transfer procedure on its own merits. Justification: lawful because it follows tender rules and the transfer procedure; ethical because it protects the equal chance of bidders and the public purse; practical because written reasons protect you and show that you are not obstinate. Systemic: e-tendering with public evaluation sheets and fixed tenure.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "D-R-R": Decline politely, Record, Route through rules.

COMMON TRAP: Do not turn firmness into insolence. Courtesy plus written reasons is the exam-winning tone.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-05 - The lakeside housing project

CS-05 | The lakeside housing project

Section I: Ethics and human interface | syllabus unit GS4-E1 | 248 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are the Commissioner of a city development authority. A builder seeks approval for a housing colony on land next to a lake in the buffer zone. The project will give 600 affordable homes and 400 jobs, but environmental experts warn that building may block the lake's inflow channels, and floods may follow. Local residents are divided, and the builder has influential backers.

S - Situation. A project with real social benefits threatens an ecologically sensitive area, so the question is how to balance development and environment.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Builder (profit); homeless families (housing); workers (jobs); lakeside residents (flood risk, water); the lake ecosystem and future generations; you (duty to law); the government (housing target).

R - Rules and values. The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, buffer-zone rules, and the principle of sustainable development with the precautionary principle. Article 48A directs the State to protect the environment, and Article 51A(g) makes this a duty of citizens. Values: intergenerational justice, honesty, public interest.

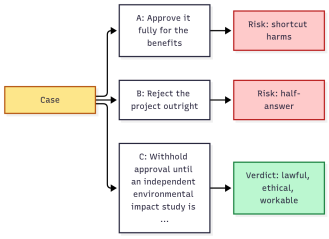
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Approve it fully for the benefits. Merit: homes and jobs. Risk: flood and illegality.
- **B.** Reject the project outright. Merit: protects the lake. Risk: loses housing and may be challenged as arbitrary.
- **C.** Withhold approval until an independent environmental impact study is done, and allow a redesigned project outside the buffer zone.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Commission an independent study with public hearing and publish it. (2) Tell the builder in writing that approval depends on keeping the buffer zone and the inflow channels clear. (3) Identify alternate public land for affordable housing and ask the builder to consider it. (4) Decide within a time limit so the delay is not misused. Justification: lawful because it follows the buffer-zone norms; ethical because it weighs the poor's housing and the lake's protection, and the precautionary principle requires caution where harm may be irreversible; practical because a redesign serves both aims. Systemic: a lake-protection plan and a register of water bodies.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "S-H-R": Study, Hearing, Redesign.

COMMON TRAP: Do not present it as development against environment. The best answer gives a third option that serves both.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-06 - The false bills

CS-06 | The false bills

Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy | syllabus unit GS4-I | 286 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a junior engineer in a rural water supply division. While checking records you find that your Executive Engineer, who is also your reporting officer and mentor, has passed bills for pipe laying that was never completed in two villages. He says the money will be spent next quarter and that you should "not spoil a good team". Your appraisal is due next month.

S - Situation. You have found evidence of false billing by a respected superior, and silence would make you complicit while speaking may harm your career.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. You (integrity, career); Executive Engineer (reputation, family); the two villages (water); the department (funds); co-workers (fear); taxpayers; future whistle-blowers.

R - Rules and values. The Conduct Rules require integrity and honest record-keeping. The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 covers criminal misconduct. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 is enacted but not yet in force, so the working routes are the Lokayukta and the department's vigilance authority. Values: integrity, courage, loyalty to the institution above the individual.

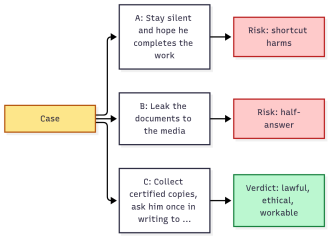
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Stay silent and hope he completes the work. Merit: keeps the relationship. Risk: complicity and later liability.
- **B.** Leak the documents to the media. Merit: public pressure. Risk: breaks procedure, may harm the case and your protection.
- **C.** Collect certified copies, ask him once in writing to correct the record, and if refused, report to the Chief Engineer and the vigilance authority.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Secure the official copies of the bills and measurement books, taking only what you are authorised to access. (2) Raise the discrepancy with the Executive Engineer in writing and give him a short time to correct it, which is fair and keeps the record. (3) If he does not, report through the proper channel to the Chief Engineer, with a request for confidentiality, and use the legal protection for complainants. (4) Ask for a physical verification of the villages' pipelines. Justification: lawful because the complaint follows service channels and protects the evidence; ethical because loyalty to the public interest outranks personal loyalty, and the fair opportunity to correct respects his dignity; practical because the verification will settle the facts. Systemic: geo-tagged photographs for every bill.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "C-A-R": Collect, Ask, Report.

COMMON TRAP: Do not label the officer corrupt without proof. Describe the discrepancy and call for verification.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-07 - A relative on the shortlist

CS-07 | A relative on the shortlist

Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy | syllabus unit GS4-I | 255 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You chair a selection committee for 20 posts of village accountants. On the shortlist you notice your sister-in-law, who has done well and qualifies on merit. Other members are unaware of the relationship. If you recuse yourself, the committee will lose its most experienced member and may delay the recruitment.

S - Situation. You are a decision-maker who has a family relationship with a candidate, and the question is how to preserve fairness without harming the recruitment.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. You (reputation); your relative (deserved chance); other candidates (equal opportunity); the committee (efficiency); the department (credibility); the public (merit-based service).

R - Rules and values. Natural justice says no person shall be a judge in his own cause. The Conduct Rules and recruitment rules require declaration of conflict of interest. Article 16 guarantees equality of opportunity in public employment. Values: impartiality, honesty, transparency.

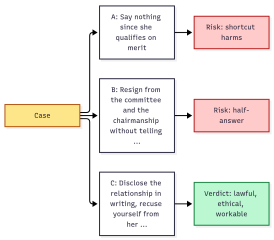
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Say nothing since she qualifies on merit. Merit: efficient. Risk: perceived bias, and the whole selection can be challenged.
- **B.** Resign from the committee and the chairmanship without telling anyone why. Risk: delays and unexplained exit.
- **C.** Disclose the relationship in writing, recuse yourself from her evaluation and all decisions concerning her, and let the remaining members decide.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Declare the relationship in writing to the appointing authority and the committee before the interviews. (2) Leave the room when her candidature is discussed and do not score her. (3) Ask the authority to appoint a replacement member or a temporary chair for her round so the process continues. (4) Record the declaration in the minutes. Justification: lawful because it follows the principle of natural justice and Article 16; ethical because honesty and impartiality are kept, and she is not penalised for her relationship since she is judged by others; practical because the disclosure protects the selection against later challenge. Systemic: a mandatory conflict-of-interest declaration form for every committee member.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "D-R-M": Declare, Recuse, Minute it.

COMMON TRAP: A conflict of interest is about the appearance as well as the fact. Do not argue that she was good enough anyway.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-08 - Demolition before the monsoon

CS-08 | Demolition before the monsoon

Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy | syllabus unit GS4-I | 275 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are an Assistant Commissioner. The High Court has ordered removal of 200 shanties built on a storm-water drain, with a deadline in two weeks, since they cause flooding in the colony downstream. The residents are daily-wage workers and have nowhere to go. The monsoon is ten days away. A social worker begs you to postpone the drive.

S - Situation. A binding court order and the safety of downstream residents conflict with the shelter of 200 poor families on the eve of the monsoon.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. The 200 families (shelter, children's schooling); downstream residents (flood risk); you (duty to the court); the court (authority); the municipality (resources); the social worker and NGOs; the neighbourhood.

R - Rules and values. Compliance with court orders is a constitutional duty. The right to life under Article 21 includes the right to shelter, as the Supreme Court has recognised, so eviction must be humane with rehabilitation. Values: compassion, rule of law, justice.

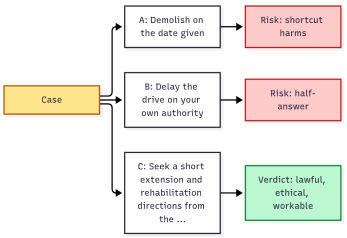
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Demolish on the date given. Merit: complies. Risk: families homeless in the rains and a humanitarian crisis.
- **B.** Delay the drive on your own authority. Merit: protects the families. Risk: contempt of court and downstream floods.
- **C.** Seek a short extension and rehabilitation directions from the court, with an immediate relocation plan, and clear the drain in stages.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) File an application before the High Court with a survey, a rehabilitation plan and the monsoon risk, and ask for a short extension. (2) Identify the nearest temporary shelter, such as a community hall, with water and sanitation, and move the most vulnerable first. (3) Verify eligibility for housing schemes and link families to a long-term plan. (4) Clean the drain's blockage immediately to reduce flood risk meanwhile. (5) Give written notice, and conduct the drive with women officers, medical aid and no force. Justification: lawful because the court is approached and not defied; ethical because dignity and shelter are protected; practical because a staged plan lowers both flood and humanitarian risk. Systemic: a register of vulnerable settlements and resettlement land.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "A-S-S": Apply to court, Shelter first, Stage the work.

COMMON TRAP: Never write that you will "defer the order". Officers do not suspend court orders; they seek directions.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-09 - Procession and prayer on the same street

CS-09 | Procession and prayer on the same street

Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy | syllabus unit GS4-I | 268 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are the District Magistrate. A religious procession of one community has applied to pass a street where a place of worship of another community stands, at the time of its evening prayers. Local leaders are tense after a rumour on social media. The police say they are short-staffed. Leaders of one side say that denying the route violates their freedom of religion.

S - Situation. Two communities have claims to religious freedom on the same street at the same time, and rumours may trigger violence.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Both communities (religious freedom and safety); police (capacity); traders and residents (livelihood, safety); you (public order); political groups (may exploit); media (amplification).

R - Rules and values. Articles 25 and 26 guarantee religious freedom subject to public order, morality and health. Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (successor to Section 144) allows orders to prevent disturbance, and these must be proportionate. Values: tolerance, impartiality, public order.

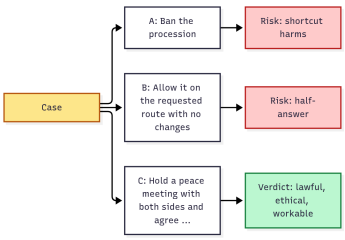
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Ban the procession. Merit: avoids clash. Risk: seen as biased, violates a right, may cause protest.
- **B.** Allow it on the requested route with no changes. Merit: respects the right. Risk: clash during prayers.
- **C.** Hold a peace meeting with both sides and agree on a changed time or route that gives each its due, with strong policing and rumour control.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Call leaders of both communities, with the police and trade representatives, and explain the safety limits. (2) Offer an alternative: the procession passes before or after the prayer hour, or uses a parallel route, with a clear written order that applies the same rule to all processions. (3) Deploy staff from neighbouring police stations and keep a flexible reserve. (4) Counter the rumour with verified facts through the district's official channels and ask the cyber cell to act against hate content. (5) Review after the event. Justification: lawful because restrictions are proportionate and in writing; ethical because both communities are heard and equally respected; practical because consent reduces risk more than force does. Systemic: a standing peace committee.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "H-A-P": Hear both, Alternative, Police and rumour control.

COMMON TRAP: Neutrality means the same rule for all sides, not silence. Do not name or blame any community in your answer.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-10 - The flood night

CS-10 | The flood night

Section II: Attitude, integrity, empathy | syllabus unit GS4-I | 279 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a Tahsildar. It is midnight; a river is rising and a village of 1,200 people could be cut off by dawn. Your jeep driver says his own house is in a low-lying area, and he wants to go home to move his family before helping you. Two revenue inspectors have switched off their phones. The Collector says "do what you can".

S - Situation. A disaster demands immediate action with limited staff, and a colleague's family need conflicts with official duty.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Villagers (life); you (duty, responsibility); the driver (family safety); revenue inspectors (accountability); the Collector and disaster authority; volunteers and the police; the village's elderly and sick.

R - Rules and values. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 places a duty on authorities, at district level under the District Collector, and gives the power to requisition resources. Values: dedication, empathy, accountability, courage.

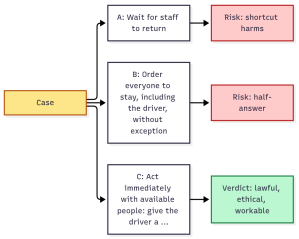
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Wait for staff to return. Merit: safe for you. Risk: loss of life.
- **B.** Order everyone to stay, including the driver, without exception. Merit: all hands. Risk: unfair to the driver and risk of poor morale.
- **C.** Act immediately with available people: give the driver a short time to move his family, assign others to the evacuation, and escalate for help.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Sound the alarm using the panchayat public-address system and phone alerts, and call the district control room for boats and the State Disaster Response Force. (2) Let the driver take 30 minutes with a vehicle from the volunteers to move his family, then rejoin. (3) Send other staff and the police to evacuate the elderly, the sick and pregnant women to the school building on high ground. (4) Take a list of those evacuated, and send a report of the situation to the Collector every hour. (5) Take disciplinary action against the absent staff only after the emergency, through due process. Justification: lawful because the powers in the Disaster Management Act allow rapid steps and records; ethical because lives come first and the driver's need is treated humanely; practical because it keeps the team's trust. Systemic: duty rosters and satellite phones.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "A-E-E": Alarm, Evacuate the weak, Escalate.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write a long reflection. In disaster cases, the first line should be an action, not a principle.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-11 - The village that will not vaccinate

CS-11 | The village that will not vaccinate

Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values | syllabus unit GS4-T1 | 257 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a Chief Executive Officer of a Zilla Panchayat. In a remote block, only 40 per cent of children have received the full childhood vaccination schedule. A rumour says the vaccine causes infertility. Health workers have been abused, and one village elder says, "Our ancestors never needed this." Strict enforcement is suggested by some officials.

S - Situation. A harmful belief, spread by rumour, is lowering child immunisation, and the question is how to change attitudes without coercion.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Children (health); parents (fear, trust); the elder and community leaders (influence); health workers (safety); the department (coverage target); neighbouring villages (herd protection); you (responsibility).

R - Rules and values. The right to health is part of Article 21; the Universal Immunisation Programme is voluntary. Ethical persuasion requires truth and respect for autonomy. Values: respect, empathy, objectivity, public welfare.

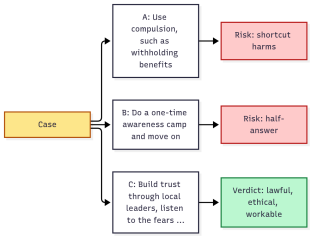
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Use compulsion, such as withholding benefits. Merit: fast. Risk: backlash, hostility, harm to the poor.
- **B.** Do a one-time awareness camp and move on. Merit: cheap. Risk: little change.
- **C.** Build trust through local leaders, listen to the fears first, use credible messengers and repeated contact, and make vaccination easy.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Hold a listening meeting with the elder, women's groups and the school teacher to learn the exact fears. (2) Ask a respected local doctor, a religious leader who supports vaccination, and mothers of vaccinated children to give the message in the local language. (3) Bring the vaccination to the village at convenient times, with a female health worker and a clear explanation of side effects. (4) Track coverage monthly and recognise improved villages publicly. (5) Counter the rumour with verified facts on the same channel on which it spread. Justification: lawful because the programme remains voluntary; ethical because it respects autonomy and uses truthful persuasion; practical because attitudes change through trust, contact and repeated example, as the cognitive, affective and behavioural components all need attention. Systemic: community health volunteers.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "L-M-M": Listen, Messengers, Make it easy.

COMMON TRAP: Persuasion is not manipulation. Do not use fear tactics or false claims to raise coverage.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-12 - The angry crowd at the health centre

CS-12 | The angry crowd at the health centre

Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values | syllabus unit GS4-T2 | 257 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are the District Health Officer. A pregnant woman died at a primary health centre after a delay in referral. Two hundred relatives and villagers have gathered, blocking the road and shouting at you. A local leader demands that the medical officer be arrested immediately. The medical officer is in tears and says the ambulance was unavailable.

S - Situation. A death and an angry crowd demand quick answers, while facts are not yet known and emotions are high.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. The family (grief, anger); the crowd; the medical officer (possible fault, fear); staff; you (calm and accountability); the leader (political interest); the department; future patients.

R - Rules and values. Duty of care and accountability for public health services; natural justice for the officer; the right to health. Values: empathy, objectivity, accountability, emotional self-control.

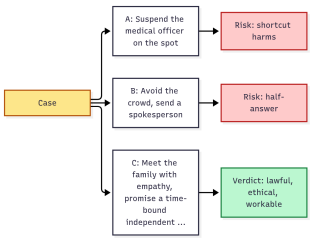
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Suspend the medical officer on the spot. Merit: calms the crowd. Risk: unjust, no inquiry, harms morale.
- **B.** Avoid the crowd, send a spokesperson. Merit: safe. Risk: looks evasive and worsens anger.
- **C.** Meet the family with empathy, promise a time-bound independent inquiry, ensure the officer's safety, and announce interim relief.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Stay calm, express condolences, sit with the family, and listen first without defending the department. (2) Announce an independent inquiry led by a senior doctor and report within seven days, with the family's representative informed of the findings. (3) Ensure the safety of the medical officer, who continues on non-clinical duty until the inquiry ends, without any finding of guilt. (4) Process interim compensation as permitted by rules, and arrange transport of the body and the family. (5) Repair the system: referral protocol, ambulance availability and a 24-hour response log. Justification: lawful because the officer gets natural justice; ethical because grief is respected and the truth is sought; practical because calm and a clear timeline lower tension. This shows the components of emotional intelligence: self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy and social skill. Systemic: ambulance tracking.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "L-I-S": Listen, Inquiry with date, Safeguard the officer.

> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not offer instant blame, and do not promise what you cannot deliver. A date for the inquiry is a promise you can keep.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

> **NEXT UP:** CS-13 - The inflated figures

CS-13 | The inflated figures

Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values | syllabus unit GS4-E4 | 270 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are a District Collector. A State-level award and extra funds are linked to showing that your district has achieved 100 per cent toilet use and full school enrolment. Field reports show that about 80 per cent of toilets are used and a few hundred children are out of school. Block officers suggest you "adjust" the numbers because other districts do the same.

S - Situation. There is pressure to report false data for an award and funds, which would harm honest planning and public trust.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. You (integrity, career); block officers (fear of targets); the families who lack toilets or school access; the State government (policy on bad data); other districts; the donors; future officers.

R - Rules and values. Honesty in official records, the Conduct Rules, and accountability to the public. False entries can attract disciplinary and penal action. Values: integrity, truthfulness, accountability, objectivity.

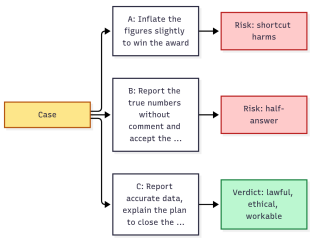
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Inflate the figures slightly to win the award. Merit: money and recognition. Risk: fraud, and the real gaps remain.
- **B.** Report the true numbers without comment and accept the lower rank. Merit: honest. Risk: demoralises staff and loses funds for needy families.
- **C.** Report accurate data, explain the plan to close the gaps with a time frame, and request support on the basis of need.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Instruct officers in writing that only verified data is to be uploaded, with random cross-checks. (2) Report the true figures with a short note on the causes: water shortage, school distance and migration. (3) Prepare a 90-day plan: water connections for toilets, bridging classes and transport for out-of-school children. (4) Write to the State seeking funds for the gap on the basis of verified need. (5) Recognise the blocks that report honestly. Justification: lawful because false data is punishable and true data protects everyone; ethical because integrity is more valuable than a prize; practical because a plan to improve the numbers earns credibility and resources, and the next audit will not expose you. Systemic: third-party verification and dashboards that reward improvement rather than a perfect number.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "T-P-A": Truth, Plan, Ask for support.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that you will "adjust slightly". There is no ethical level of false data.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-14 - Drought relief or a school building

CS-14 | Drought relief or a school building

Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values | syllabus unit GS4-E2 | 273 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You are the Chief Secretary's nominee managing a district drought fund of Rs 8 crore. Competing demands: drinking water tankers for 40 villages (Rs 5 crore), fodder camps for cattle (Rs 3 crore) and a long-promised school building (Rs 4 crore) that a powerful local leader is pushing. Total demand is Rs 12 crore, and the monsoon is two months away.

S - Situation. Funds are limited and needs compete, so the decision must follow priority of need and not of influence.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Villagers (drinking water); farmers (cattle and livelihood); school children (building); the local leader (credit); you (accountability); the treasury; future generations.

R - Rules and values. The disaster relief code gives priority to drinking water and livelihoods in a drought. The principle of utilitarian triage (greatest urgent need first) and the principle of fairness apply. Values: justice, objectivity, accountability, transparency.

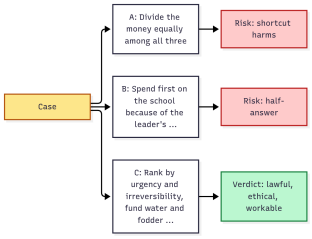
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Divide the money equally among all three. Merit: looks fair. Risk: none of them is properly met.
- **B.** Spend first on the school because of the leader's push. Merit: political peace. Risk: ignores urgent survival needs.
- **C.** Rank by urgency and irreversibility, fund water and fodder first, seek extra funds for the school from regular budgets, and publish the allocation.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Make a simple ranking using criteria: threat to life, irreversibility of loss, number of beneficiaries and alternatives available. (2) Allot Rs 5 crore to water and Rs 3 crore to fodder, a total of Rs 8 crore, and plan water by tankers and borewells in the worst villages first. (3) Place the school proposal under a regular education budget or the district mineral or CSR funds where eligible, with a timeline. (4) Explain the decision to the leader in person, with data. (5) Publish village-wise allocation and spending online. Justification: lawful because it follows the relief code; ethical because the urgent need of survival takes precedence over a deferrable need, and the process is open; practical because you retain a way to meet the school's need later. Systemic: a standard priority matrix for all relief decisions.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "U-I-N": Urgency, Irreversibility, Number affected.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat equal division as fairness. Fairness means equal concern, which can mean unequal money.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

NEXT UP: CS-15 - When the face scan fails

CS-15 | When the face scan fails

Section III: Aptitude, emotional intelligence, governance values | syllabus unit GS4-E3 | 246 words in the solution

Case (fictional): You head a welfare department that has introduced face-recognition attendance for pension payment to prevent fraud. The system has saved money by weeding out ghost beneficiaries, but many elderly and manual workers fail the scan because of worn fingerprints and poor lighting, and 8,000 genuine pensioners have stopped getting payments. A vendor says the system is 95 per cent accurate, and a minister wants the savings shown.

S - Situation. A technology that reduces fraud is excluding genuine beneficiaries, so efficiency and inclusion conflict.

D - Dilemma and stakeholders. Excluded pensioners (survival); honest pensioners who benefit from less leakage; taxpayers; the vendor (reputation); the minister; local staff; you (accountability).

R - Rules and values. Welfare is a matter of the right to life with dignity (Article 21); the data protection principle of proportionality and the need for grievance redress apply. Values: justice, empathy, accountability, transparency.

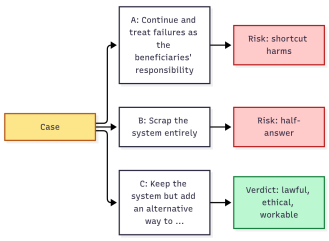
A - Alternatives.

- **A.** Continue and treat failures as the beneficiaries' responsibility. Merit: savings. Risk: harm to the poor.
- **B.** Scrap the system entirely. Merit: no exclusion. Risk: returns leakage.
- **C.** Keep the system but add an alternative way to authenticate, restore the excluded and measure the exclusion rate.

T - The decision. Option C. Steps: (1) Restore payments to the 8,000 pending a physical check, since a delayed pension is a harm. (2) Introduce alternatives: an OTP or a visit by a village official or postal staff, with a record. (3) Audit exclusion errors and publish the numbers on a dashboard, not only the savings. (4) Require the vendor to show the error rate on elderly and manual-worker users, and add the findings to the contract. (5) Create a helpline and a time-bound grievance process. Justification: lawful because it protects the entitlement and respects data protection; ethical because the cost of wrongly excluding a poor person outweighs the saving; practical because a hybrid approach keeps most of the savings. The 95 per cent accuracy still means thousands excluded at scale. Systemic: a human-in-the-loop standard for welfare technology.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "R-A-M": Restore, Alternative route, Measure exclusion.

COMMON TRAP: Do not accept a percentage accuracy figure at face value. At scale, even a small error rate harms many people.



Options at a glance. Redraw it in 20 seconds.

Legal and policy references used (all checked on official sources)

- Constitution of India: Articles 16, 21, 25, 26, 48A and 51A(g) (legislative.gov.in).
- Prevention of Corruption Act 1988, as amended 2018. Whistle Blowers Protection Act 2014 (enacted, but a commencement notification had not been issued when I checked, so CS-06 relies on the Lokayukta and vigilance routes).
- Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita 2023, section 163 (power to issue orders in urgent cases of nuisance or apprehended danger; the successor to CrPC section 144).
- National Food Security Act 2013; Disaster Management Act 2005; Right to Information Act 2005.
- All India Services (Conduct) Rules 1968 (gifts and conflict of interest).
- Karnataka Sakaala Services Act 2011 (guaranteed service delivery; penalties for delay).
- Olga Tellis v. Bombay Municipal Corporation (1985): right to livelihood and shelter is part of Article 21.

Case studies are fictional and exist only to teach the method. Please do not treat any case as a statement about a real officer or place.

Deliverable 5 - Essay pack (20 outlines, 5 full model essays)

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | Paper 1 (Essay): two essays, 125 marks each, 250 marks, 3 hours

Library progress: Deliverable 5 of 8

CHAI-TALK: Think of an essay as a short film in five scenes: a hook, a clear stand, two or three strong arguments, one honest 'but', and an ending that leaves the examiner nodding. Practise the outline first. A good outline takes 5 minutes and makes the next 50 minutes calm.

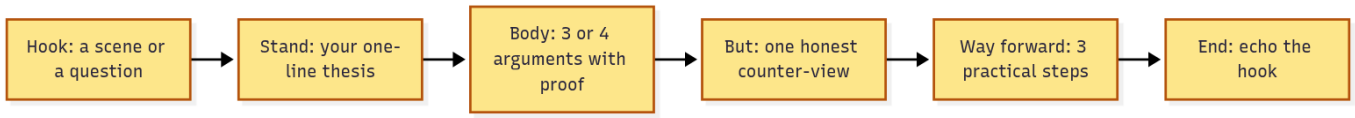
PREDICTED: The scheme sets Essay 1 on a topic of international or national importance and Essay 2 on a topic of State or local importance, 125 marks each (Karnataka Gazette of 08-01-2015, Paper I; 2026-27 notification, 250 marks). The 20 topics below are chosen from recurring themes (technology, environment, women, federalism, regional balance, welfare, culture, agriculture). They are my own wording, not past questions.

How to use this pack

1. Pick one national and one State topic. Draw its mind map from memory.
2. Write the outline in 5 minutes: hook, 4 headings, counter-view, way forward, end line.
3. Write the essay in about 50 minutes (1,000-1,200 words is a safe length for a 125-mark essay in 90 minutes; the 2025 paper allowed about 1,500 words).
4. Compare with the model essays. Mark yourself with the rubric in Deliverable 8.

COMMON TRAP: Writing a lecture instead of an argument. Every paragraph must make one point and prove it with an example or a number.

The skeleton in one picture



Time plan (90 minutes per essay): 5 min outline, 65 min writing, 10 min revision, 10 min buffer. Spend about 15 per cent of the words on the introduction and conclusion together, and 70 per cent on the body.

Contents: the 20 topics

Essay 1 type: international and national importance

- O-01: Digital public infrastructure: a bridge or a barrier for the poor? (full model essay E1)
- O-02: Can India grow rich and stay green? (full model essay E2)
- O-03: A country cannot fly on one wing: women in work and in power (full model essay E3)
- O-04: Rivers do not read maps: water sharing between States
- O-05: Degrees or skills: what should education deliver?
- O-06: Young India: dividend or burden?
- O-07: Social media: free speech, fake news and the public square
- O-08: Federalism: cooperation, competition or tug-of-war?
- O-09: India between the big powers: strategic autonomy
- O-10: Health is wealth: reaching universal care

Essay 2 type: State and local importance

- O-11: Bengaluru and the rest: one Karnataka or many? (full model essay E4)
- O-12: Guarantees and guardrails: welfare and the State's purse (full model essay E5)

- O-13: Kannada in the age of English and AI
- O-14: The Western Ghats: the water tower we keep cutting
- O-15: Farmers, rain and risk: making Karnataka agriculture climate-proof
- O-16: Cities that move: Bengaluru's traffic and its rail answer
- O-17: Kalyana Karnataka: special status, ordinary results?
- O-18: Milk and cooperation: lessons from KMF
- O-19: Heritage as a job engine: Hampi, Belur-Halebidu and beyond
- O-20: Start-ups beyond Bengaluru: spreading the tech dividend

Topics with a full model essay are marked in the lists above. Topics O-01 to O-03 and O-11 to O-12 have them.

Part A: 10 outlines for national and international topics

O-01 | Digital public infrastructure: a bridge or a barrier for the poor?

Full model essay included: see Part C.

Angle: Efficiency versus inclusion. Judge the system by the last person in the queue.

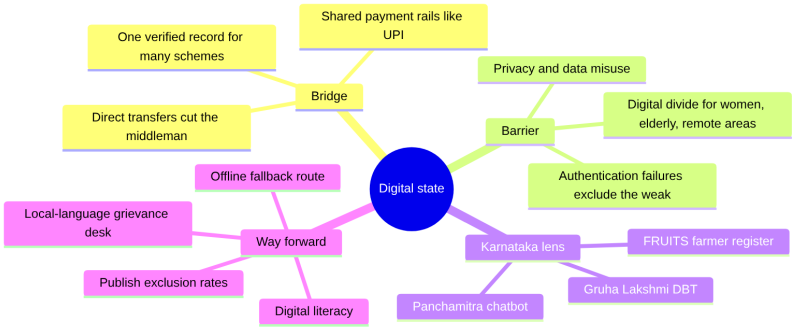
Hook: A failed fingerprint scan can mean a missed meal.

Body (4 headings):

- **Bridge:** Direct transfers cut the middleman; Shared payment rails like UPI; One verified record for many schemes
- **Barrier:** Authentication failures exclude the weak; Privacy and data misuse; Digital divide for women, elderly, remote areas
- **Karnataka lens:** FRUITS farmer register; Gruha Lakshmi DBT; Panchamitra chatbot
- **Way forward:** Offline fallback route; Publish exclusion rates; Local-language grievance desk; Digital literacy

Counter-view: Without digital tools, leakage and delay return.

Closing line: A digital state is judged by whom it leaves behind, and whether it notices.



O-02 | Can India grow rich and stay green?

Full model essay included: see Part C.

Angle: Show that growth and ecology can help each other, then name who pays.

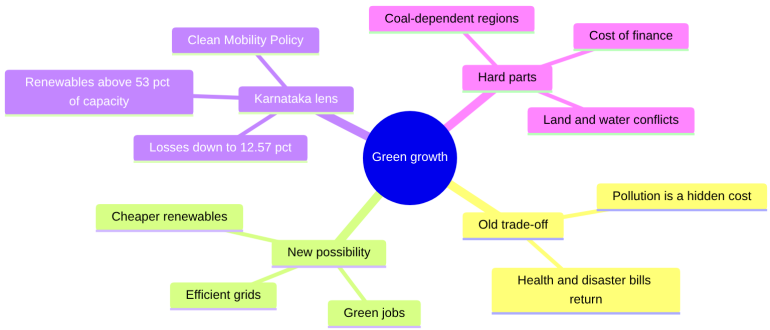
Hook: Grow first, clean later is a loan with a heavy interest rate.

Body (4 headings):

- **Old trade-off:** Pollution is a hidden cost; Health and disaster bills return
- **New possibility:** Cheaper renewables; Green jobs; Efficient grids
- **Karnataka lens:** Renewables above 53 pct of capacity; Losses down to 12.57 pct; Clean Mobility Policy
- **Hard parts:** Coal-dependent regions; Cost of finance; Land and water conflicts

Counter-view: Renewables are variable; the grid needs storage and backup.

Closing line: Treat the environment as part of the balance sheet, not a footnote.



O-03 | A country cannot fly on one wing: women in work and in power

Full model essay included: see Part C.

Angle: Women's participation is a question of national performance, not a favour.

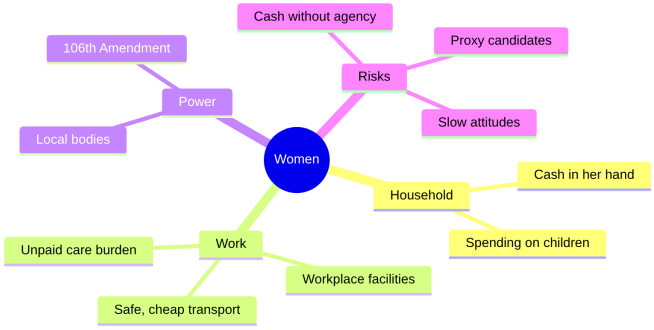
Hook: A bird with one wing flutters; it cannot fly.

Body (4 headings):

- **Household:** Cash in her hand; Spending on children
- **Work:** Safe, cheap transport; Workplace facilities; Unpaid care burden
- **Power:** Local bodies; 106th Amendment
- **Risks:** Cash without agency; Proxy candidates; Slow attitudes

Counter-view: Free services strain finances; judge by outcomes, not announcements.

Closing line: Success is the ordinary morning: a woman reaching a job she chose.



O-04 | Rivers do not read maps: water sharing between States

Angle: Water disputes are a test of cooperative federalism.

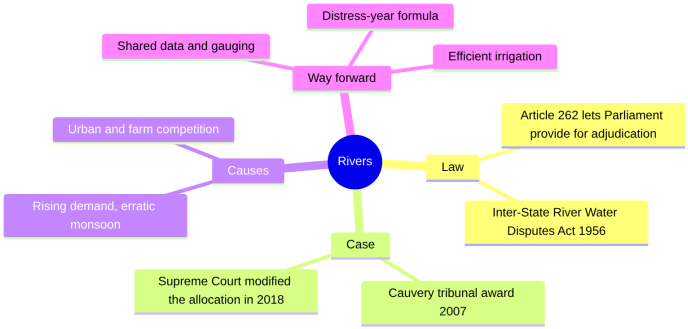
Hook: A river is one body; the map cuts it into many owners.

Body (4 headings):

- **Law:** Article 262 lets Parliament provide for adjudication; Inter-State River Water Disputes Act 1956
- **Case:** Cauvery tribunal award 2007; Supreme Court modified the allocation in 2018
- **Causes:** Rising demand, erratic monsoon; Urban and farm competition
- **Way forward:** Shared data and gauging; Distress-year formula; Efficient irrigation

Counter-view: Tribunals are slow; political will matters more than orders.

Closing line: A river settles quarrels only when its users treat it as shared.



O-05 | Degrees or skills: what should education deliver?

Angle: Education must build both thinking and employable ability.

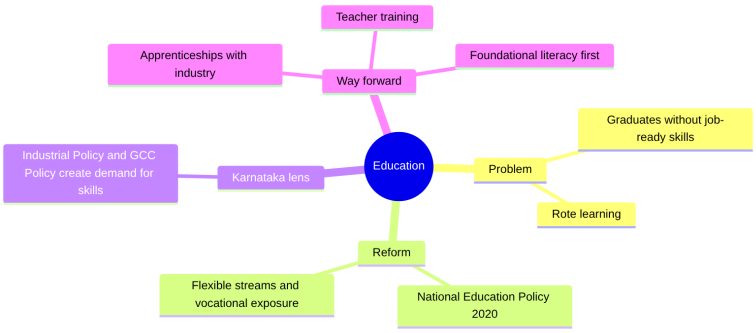
Hook: A certificate opens an interview; a skill keeps the job.

Body (4 headings):

- **Problem:** Graduates without job-ready skills; Rote learning
- **Reform:** National Education Policy 2020; Flexible streams and vocational exposure
- **Karnataka lens:** Industrial Policy and GCC Policy create demand for skills
- **Way forward:** Apprenticeships with industry; Teacher training; Foundational literacy first

Counter-view: Too narrow a skill focus can neglect values and citizenship.

Closing line: Teach children to learn, and they will learn the skills.



O-06 | Young India: dividend or burden?

Angle: A young population pays off only if it is healthy, schooled and employed.

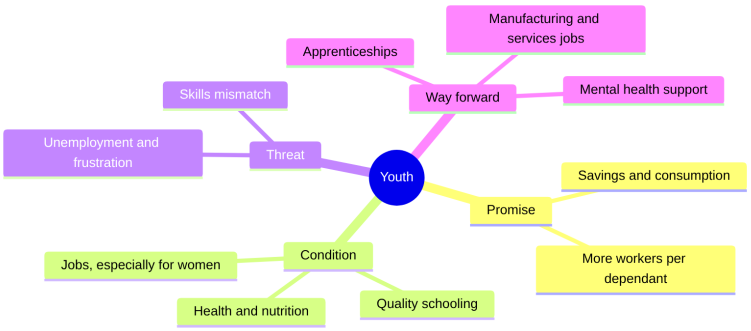
Hook: A window of opportunity does not stay open on its own.

Body (4 headings):

- **Promise:** More workers per dependant; Savings and consumption
- **Condition:** Health and nutrition; Quality schooling; Jobs, especially for women
- **Threat:** Unemployment and frustration; Skills mismatch
- **Way forward:** Manufacturing and services jobs; Apprenticeships; Mental health support

Counter-view: Ageing will arrive later; plan pensions and care early.

Closing line: The dividend is earned, not inherited.



O-07 | Social media: free speech, fake news and the public square

Angle: Balance Article 19(1)(a) with reasonable restrictions under 19(2) and the duty of platforms.

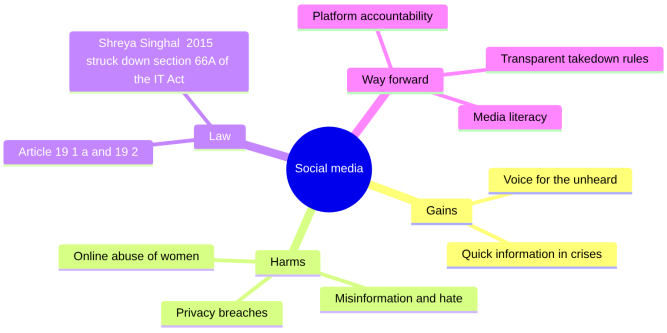
Hook: A rumour travels faster than a correction.

Body (4 headings):

- **Gains:** Voice for the unheard; Quick information in crises
- **Harms:** Misinformation and hate; Privacy breaches; Online abuse of women
- **Law:** Article 19(1)(a) and 19(2); Shreya Singhal (2015) struck down section 66A of the IT Act
- **Way forward:** Platform accountability; Media literacy; Transparent takedown rules

Counter-view: Over-regulation can chill legitimate speech.

Closing line: Free speech needs a public that can tell truth from noise.



O-08 | Federalism: cooperation, competition or tug-of-war?

Angle: Indian federalism works best when States are partners, not subordinates.

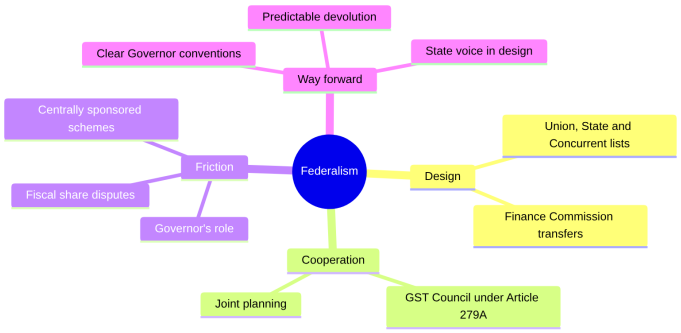
Hook: The Constitution drew the lines; politics tests them every day.

Body (4 headings):

- **Design:** Union, State and Concurrent lists; Finance Commission transfers
- **Cooperation:** GST Council under Article 279A; Joint planning
- **Friction:** Governor's role; Fiscal share disputes; Centrally sponsored schemes
- **Way forward:** Predictable devolution; Clear Governor conventions; State voice in design

Counter-view: A strong Centre is needed for national goals and crises.

Closing line: Unity in diversity is a daily practice, not a slogan.



O-09 | India between the big powers: strategic autonomy

Angle: Strategic autonomy means choosing partners by interest, not by bloc.

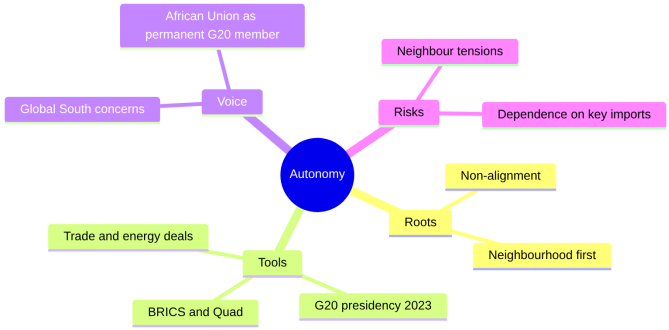
Hook: In a crowded room, a nation without a fixed seat can talk to everyone.

Body (4 headings):

- **Roots:** Non-alignment; Neighbourhood first
- **Tools:** G20 presidency 2023; BRICS and Quad; Trade and energy deals
- **Voice:** Global South concerns; African Union as permanent G20 member
- **Risks:** Neighbour tensions; Dependence on key imports

Counter-view: Flexibility can look like indecision.

Closing line: Autonomy is strongest when backed by a growing economy.



O-10 | Health is wealth: reaching universal care

Angle: Public health spending is an investment in productivity.

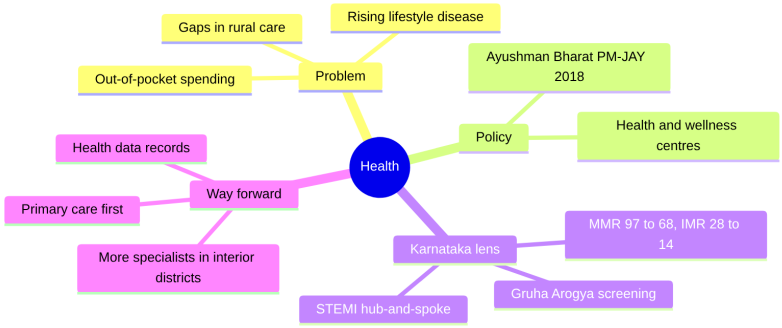
Hook: One illness can undo a decade of savings.

Body (4 headings):

- **Problem:** Out-of-pocket spending; Gaps in rural care; Rising lifestyle disease
- **Policy:** Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY (2018); Health and wellness centres
- **Karnataka lens:** MMR 97 to 68, IMR 28 to 14; STEMI hub-and-spoke; Gruha Arogya screening
- **Way forward:** Primary care first; More specialists in interior districts; Health data records

Counter-view: Insurance alone does not build clinics or train doctors.

Closing line: A healthy citizen is the cheapest asset a nation can have.



Part B: 10 outlines for State and local topics

O-11 | Bengaluru and the rest: one Karnataka or many?

Full model essay included: see Part C.

Angle: A bright core and a slower belt: name the gap, the roots and the tools.

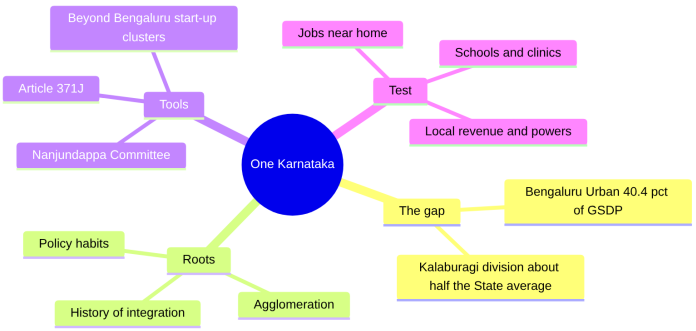
Hook: A State is not its capital.

Body (4 headings):

- **The gap:** Bengaluru Urban 40.4 pct of GSDP; Kalaburagi division about half the State average
- **Roots:** Agglomeration; History of integration; Policy habits
- **Tools:** Nanjundappa Committee; Article 371J; Beyond Bengaluru start-up clusters
- **Test:** Jobs near home; Schools and clinics; Local revenue and powers

Counter-view: Do not starve Bengaluru; spread growth, do not slow it.

Closing line: One Karnataka should be an experience, not a slogan.



O-12 | Guarantees and guardrails: welfare and the State's purse

Full model essay included: see Part C.

Angle: Not guarantees or no guarantees, but which, for whom, funded how and reviewed when.

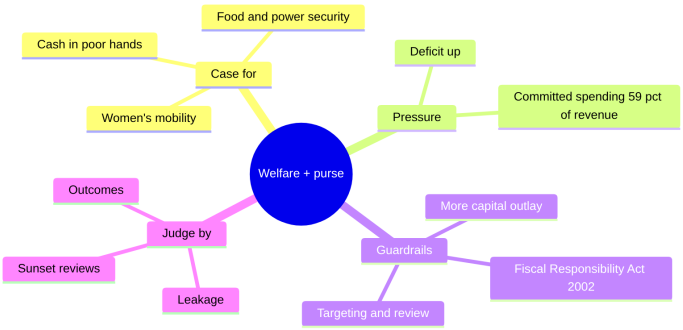
Hook: Compassion and arithmetic are partners.

Body (4 headings):

- **Case for:** Cash in poor hands; Women's mobility; Food and power security
- **Pressure:** Committed spending 59 pct of revenue; Deficit up
- **Guardrails:** Fiscal Responsibility Act 2002; More capital outlay; Targeting and review
- **Judge by:** Outcomes; Leakage; Sunset reviews

Counter-view: Ignoring social needs in the name of discipline harms growth too.

Closing line: Fiscal discipline protects the vulnerable by keeping the State able to help.



O-13 | Kannada in the age of English and AI

Angle: A language survives when it earns a livelihood and lives on screens.

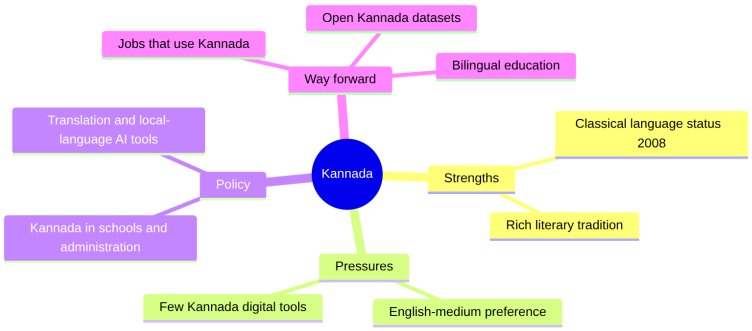
Hook: A language dies when it is not needed at the counter.

Body (4 headings):

- **Strengths:** Classical language status (2008); Rich literary tradition
- **Pressures:** English-medium preference; Few Kannada digital tools
- **Policy:** Kannada in schools and administration; Translation and local-language AI tools
- **Way forward:** Jobs that use Kannada; Open Kannada datasets; Bilingual education

Counter-view: English is a ladder; the aim is to hold both.

Closing line: A language is kept alive by use, not by pride alone.



O-14 | The Western Ghats: the water tower we keep cutting

Angle: Protect the source of rivers while allowing sensible local livelihoods.

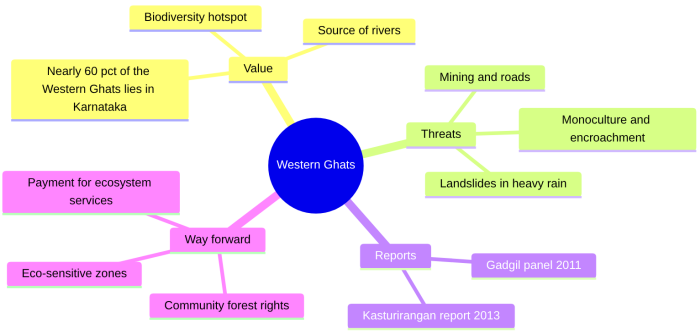
Hook: Cities drink from hills they never see.

Body (4 headings):

- **Value:** Nearly 60 pct of the Western Ghats lies in Karnataka; Biodiversity hotspot; Source of rivers
- **Threats:** Mining and roads; Monoculture and encroachment; Landslides in heavy rain
- **Reports:** Gadgil panel (2011); Kasturirangan report (2013)
- **Way forward:** Eco-sensitive zones; Community forest rights; Payment for ecosystem services

Counter-view: Local people need roads and income; consult them early.

Closing line: What the Ghats lose, the plains pay for.



O-15 | Farmers, rain and risk: making Karnataka agriculture climate-proof

Angle: Reduce risk through water, insurance and markets.

Hook: The monsoon is a gamble; policy must change the odds.

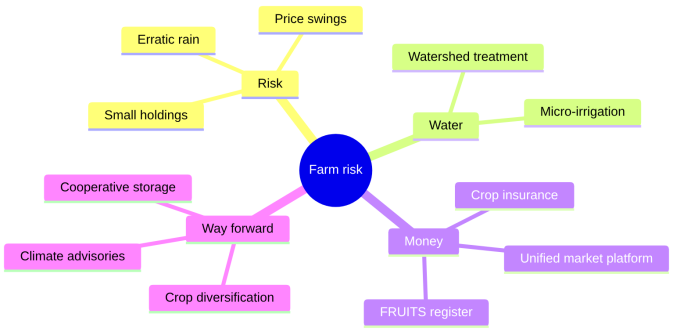
Body (4 headings):

- **Risk:** Erratic rain; Price swings; Small holdings

- **Water:** Watershed treatment; Micro-irrigation
- **Money:** Crop insurance; Unified market platform; FRUITS register
- **Way forward:** Crop diversification; Cooperative storage; Climate advisories

Counter-view: Insurance can delay payouts; speed and trust matter.

Closing line: A farmer who is protected will dare to innovate.



O-16 | Cities that move: Bengaluru's traffic and its rail answer

Angle: Mass transit is the way to keep a growing city livable.

Hook: A city that cannot move cannot grow.

Body (4 headings):

- **Problem:** Vehicle growth; Lost hours; Air quality
- **Projects:** Metro Phase 2; Suburban rail (K-RIDE); Bus priority
- **Cost:** Phase 2 is 75.06 km; K-RIDE revised cost Rs 23,103 crore
- **Way forward:** Last-mile links; Integrated fares; Land-use near stations

Counter-view: Rail is costly and slow to build; do interim bus and signal fixes.

Closing line: Move people, not just vehicles.



O-17 | Kalyana Karnataka: special status, ordinary results?

Angle: Ask what Article 371J has delivered and what is left.

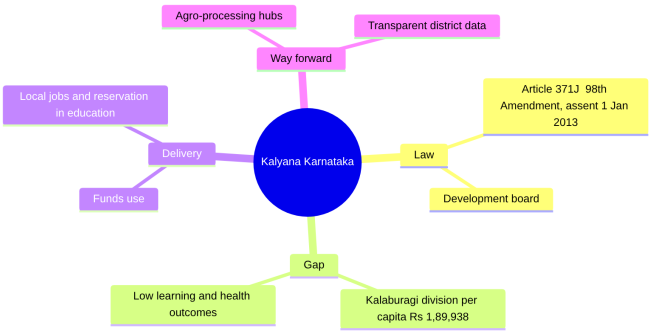
Hook: A special article is a promise; the road is the proof.

Body (4 headings):

- **Law:** Article 371J (98th Amendment, assent 1 Jan 2013); Development board
- **Gap:** Kalaburagi division per capita Rs 1,89,938; Low learning and health outcomes
- **Delivery:** Funds use; Local jobs and reservation in education
- **Way forward:** Agro-processing hubs; Transparent district data

Counter-view: Special provisions need capacity to spend and to deliver.

Closing line: A promise kept is measured in schools, clinics and jobs.



O-18 | Milk and cooperation: lessons from KMF

Angle: Cooperatives turn small producers into a market force.

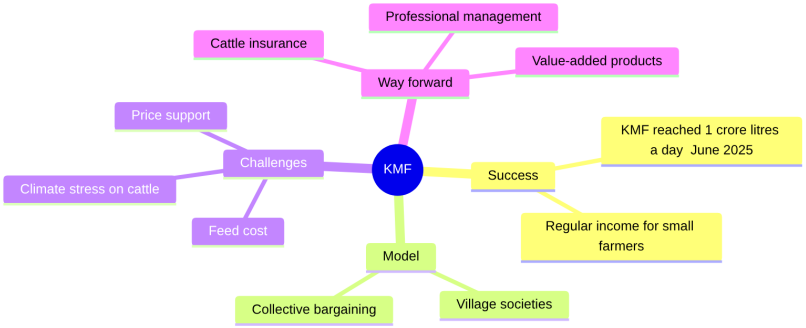
Hook: A litre of milk can carry a village's income.

Body (4 headings):

- **Success:** KMF reached 1 crore litres a day (June 2025); Regular income for small farmers
- **Model:** Village societies; Collective bargaining
- **Challenges:** Feed cost; Climate stress on cattle; Price support
- **Way forward:** Value-added products; Cattle insurance; Professional management

Counter-view: Political interference can weaken cooperatives.

Closing line: Cooperation is the small farmer's bargaining power.



O-19 | Heritage as a job engine: Hampi, Belur-Halebidu and beyond

Angle: Tourism can create local jobs without harming the monument.

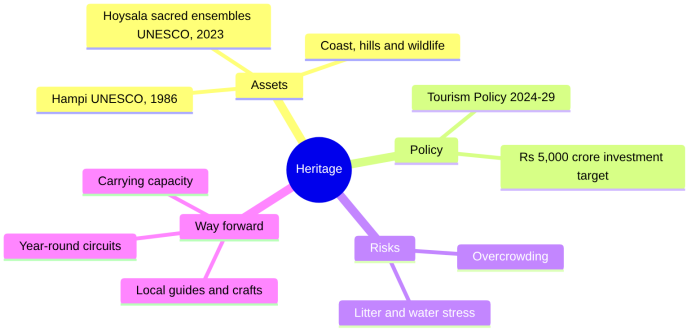
Hook: A temple can hold a thousand years and a thousand jobs.

Body (4 headings):

- **Assets:** Hampi (UNESCO, 1986); Hoysala sacred ensembles (UNESCO, 2023); Coast, hills and wildlife
- **Policy:** Tourism Policy 2024-29; Rs 5,000 crore investment target
- **Risks:** Overcrowding; Litter and water stress
- **Way forward:** Local guides and crafts; Carrying capacity; Year-round circuits

Counter-view: Heavy footfall can damage fragile sites.

Closing line: A heritage site is a trust: use the income, protect the stone.



O-20 | Start-ups beyond Bengaluru: spreading the tech dividend

Angle: Build regional hubs so talent does not need to migrate.

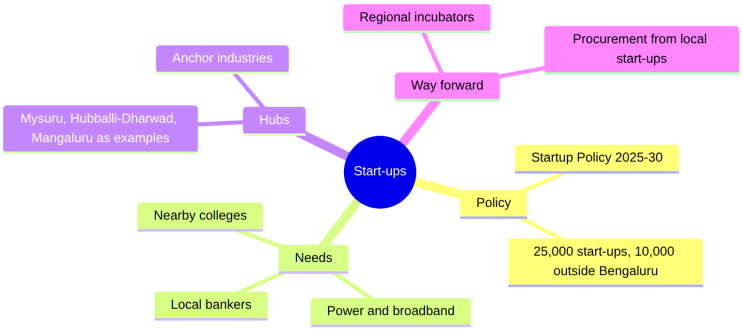
Hook: Ideas are everywhere; infrastructure is not.

Body (4 headings):

- **Policy:** Startup Policy 2025-30; 25,000 start-ups, 10,000 outside Bengaluru
- **Needs:** Power and broadband; Nearby colleges; Local bankers
- **Hubs:** Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, Mangaluru as examples; Anchor industries
- **Way forward:** Regional incubators; Procurement from local start-ups

Counter-view: Thin spread of effort may fail; pick a few hubs and back them.

Closing line: Make a start-up possible in every district town.

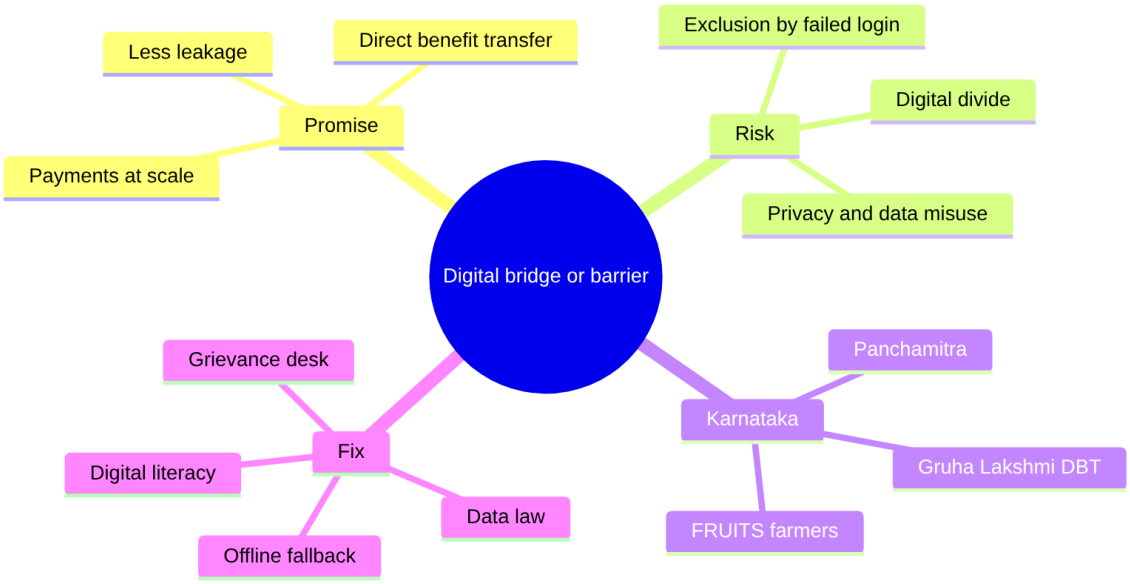


NEXT UP: Part C: five full model essays, each with a mind map, a memory trick and a common trap.

Part C: 5 full model essays

Model essay 1: Digital public infrastructure: a bridge or a barrier for the poor?

Essay 1 type (national/international) | outline O-01 | 1077 words



Redraw this map first, then write.

Every few years, a new tool arrives and promises to change how a government meets its people. In India, the tool of this generation is not a dam or a highway but something invisible: a layer of digital identity, payments and data that now sits beneath welfare, banking and public services. The question that matters is not whether this layer is clever. It is whether it carries the poorest citizen across to the other side, or leaves her standing at the gate holding a failed login.

The case for digital public infrastructure begins with a simple fact: it removes the middleman. Before direct benefit transfer, a subsidy travelled through many hands, and some of it stayed in those hands. A transfer straight to a bank account shortens the chain and leaves a record. The Unified Payments Interface, pilot-launched by the National Payments Corporation of India in April 2016, showed what a shared public rail can do: a street vendor and a large retailer use the same system, and a payment costs the sender almost nothing. The state did not build every app. It built the rails and let many others run on them. This is the strongest idea in the whole design.

Karnataka shows the same logic in a local setting. Its Survey for 2025-26 reports that the FRUITS platform has registered over 102.95 lakh farmers, and that 84.40 lakh unique beneficiaries have received Rs 39,596.98 crore through it. The register is not merely a list. It links a farmer's land and identity to benefits, so that one verified record can serve many schemes. In the same way, the Gruha Lakshmi scheme, which pays Rs 2,000 a month to the woman head of a household, had disbursed Rs 11,334.99 crore through direct benefit transfer by the time of the Survey. A woman in a village does not have to queue at a counter or know an official. The money reaches an account in her name. For a household with no spare day to lose, this is not a technical improvement. It is time and dignity returned.

Digital rails also make government answerable in new ways. The Panchamitra chatbot, which the Survey describes as a way to reach Gram Panchayat services through a messaging application, places a service request in a form that can be tracked. A request that is logged can be counted, and a delay that is counted can be challenged. Transparency, which was once a promise made in speeches, becomes a feature of the system.

Yet a bridge can have a gap in the middle, and the poor are the first to fall into it. The first gap is exclusion. A system built on authentication will, sooner or later, fail someone: the labourer whose fingerprints have worn away, the elder whose face does not match an old photograph, the family with no stable mobile signal. When a payment is the only source of food or medicine, a failed scan is not an inconvenience but a hunger. The argument that a system is "highly accurate" offers little comfort when the people in the error margin are the ones with the least to fall back on. Any honest design must therefore count the people excluded as carefully as it counts the money saved.

The second gap is privacy. When the state holds more data about its citizens, it also holds more power over them. In its landmark judgment of August 2017, the Supreme Court held that privacy is a fundamental right

under Article 21. In its Aadhaar judgment of 2018, the Court upheld the programme for the delivery of welfare, while placing limits on its use by private companies. Parliament later enacted the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. These steps show that the law is learning, but laws are only as good as their enforcement. A citizen who cannot read a consent notice cannot meaningfully give consent, and a breach does most harm to those who can least afford a remedy.

The third gap is the digital divide itself. Smartphones, reliable networks and basic literacy are not evenly spread. A system that assumes every citizen is online will leave behind women, the elderly, the disabled and those in remote areas, who already stand furthest from public services. Technology that is meant to reduce distance can, if carelessly designed, increase it.

What then is the way forward? The answer is not to abandon digital tools, which would bring back the leakages and delays that they were built to remove. It is to design for the weakest user first. A welfare system should always keep an offline route, such as a visit by a local official or postal worker, so that a failed authentication does not cut off an entitlement. It should publish exclusion figures beside savings figures, so that both are visible to the public and to the legislature. It should give every citizen a grievance desk that works in the local language and has a deadline. And it should invest in digital literacy, especially for women and the elderly, so that the citizen is a confident user and not a nervous guest.

There is also a lesson about the culture of administration. A tool does not make an institution honest; it only makes certain forms of dishonesty harder and others easier. A clerk who once demanded a bribe for a form may now demand it for "help" with an application. Digital governance therefore needs ethics alongside engineering: clear rules, audits, and officers who treat a complaint as information and not as an insult.

India's experience offers a lesson to other developing countries as well. Shared public rails, open standards and a focus on low-cost access have allowed rapid scale. But the same experience also warns that scale magnifies error. A small failure rate multiplied across millions becomes a large human cost. The countries that learn from India should take both halves of the lesson.

In the end, digital public infrastructure is neither a miracle nor a menace. It is a bridge, and a bridge is judged by whether the last person in the queue can cross it. If we measure success by the number of transactions, we shall celebrate. If we measure it by the number of people who got what they were entitled to on the day they needed it, we shall build better. The test of a digital state is not how fast it moves, but whom it leaves behind, and whether it notices.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "B-B-F": Bridge, Barrier, Fix. Every digital-governance essay is the same three beats.

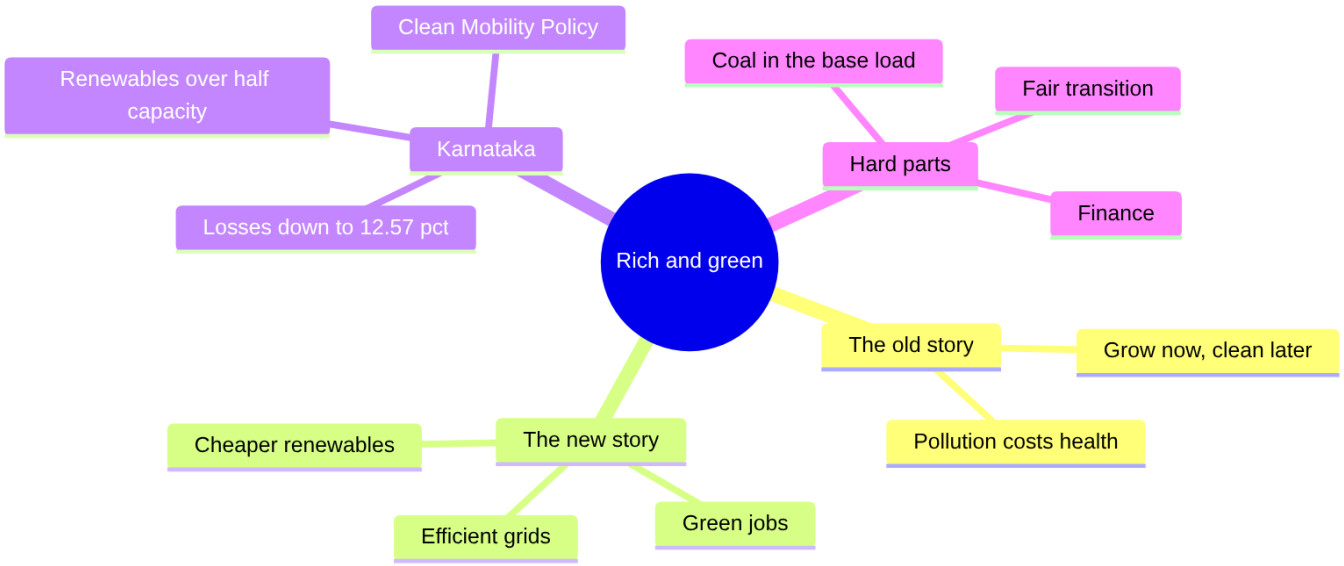
COMMON TRAP: Do not write an essay that only praises technology. The examiner rewards the line: "efficiency without inclusion is a failure of design."

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (FRUITS, Gruha Lakshmi DBT, Panchamitra); NPCI and PIB (UPI, 2016); Supreme Court of India, Puttaswamy judgments 2017 and 2018 (sci.gov.in); India Code (DPDP Act 2023).

NEXT UP: Model essay 2: Can India grow rich and stay green?

Model essay 2: Can India grow rich and stay green?

Essay 1 type (national/international) | outline O-02 | 1090 words



Redraw this map first, then write.

For most of the last two centuries, the rich countries followed a simple rule: grow first, clean up later. Smoke was treated as the smell of progress. India now stands at a different moment. It wants the income and comfort that growth brings, but it is already living with the bill for earlier choices: choking city air, stressed rivers and a climate that is shifting under its farmers. The real question is therefore not whether India should choose growth or the environment. It is whether it can arrange for each to help the other.

The traditional view saw a straight trade-off. A factory, a road or a power plant created jobs and income; the cost to air, water and land was an "externality", which meant that someone else would pay it. That view is now harder to defend, because the cost keeps coming back. Poor air raises the cost of health care and the number of working days lost. A failed monsoon reduces farm income and raises food prices. A flood damages roads, homes and trade at once. A country that ignores such costs does not save money; it merely moves the payment to a later date and to a poorer person.

The better news is that the technology has changed. Renewable energy has become far cheaper than it was a generation ago, and it can be built quickly and in small units. India has recognised this in its public commitments: at the climate summit in Glasgow in 2021, the country announced a goal of net-zero emissions by 2070. Targets alone achieve little, but they shape investment, because they tell industry which way the rules will move.

The experience of Karnataka shows how a State can take part in this shift. The Economic Survey for 2025-26 reports an installed power capacity of 37,072.95 MW at the end of December 2025, of which renewable sources account for more than 53.32 per cent. A State that draws more than half of its capacity from renewables has shown that green energy can be at the centre of a power system and not merely at the edge. The same Survey records that transmission and distribution losses fell from 16.34 per cent in 2021-22 to 12.57 per cent in 2024-25. This is an important and often neglected point: the cleanest unit of electricity is the one that is not lost on the way. Efficiency is a quiet form of green policy, and it also helps the balance sheet of the distribution companies.

Policy also looks to transport and industry. Karnataka's Clean Mobility Policy for 2025-30 targets Rs 50,000 crore of investment and one lakh jobs. Here the argument for linking growth with ecology is practical: if the next generation of vehicles, batteries and charging equipment is made in the State, the same policy that cuts urban emissions also creates employment. Green growth, in this sense, is an industrial strategy and not only a moral position.

None of this removes the hard parts. Renewable power is variable, and the grid needs storage, backup and flexible demand. A large share of the country's electricity still comes from coal, and coal-dependent regions hold jobs, municipal revenues and whole communities that cannot be wished away. A fair transition therefore requires retraining, support for affected districts and a time frame that workers can plan around. If the transition is not fair, it will not be durable, because those who lose from it will resist it.

Finance is another difficulty. Clean technology has high upfront costs and low running costs, which means that the interest rate matters greatly. Developing countries pay more to borrow, so the same solar plant costs them more over its life. This is one reason why the international discussion on climate finance matters to India: the promise of support from richer countries is not charity but a matter of fairness, since those countries emitted the most in the past. India's task is to use its own resources wisely while continuing to press for such support.

Land and water are the places where the conflict becomes visible. A solar park needs land, a hydroelectric project needs a valley, and a mine needs a forest. Here the environmental safeguards of the country, built on the Environment (Protection) Act of 1986 and later rules, have a real role. Karnataka holds nearly 60 per cent of the Western Ghats, one of the biodiversity hotspots of the world, and the Ghats also feed the rivers on which cities and farms depend. A project there that looks cheap on paper may prove expensive when the water falls. The principle of sustainable development, which asks that today's needs be met without taking away the options of tomorrow, is a test that each such project must pass openly, with public hearings and honest assessments.

Individuals and cities also have a part. Waste segregation, public transport, energy-efficient buildings and the protection of lakes and trees seem small, but cities are where most future growth will occur. A city that plans its mobility and drainage well can grow without becoming unlivable, while one that does not will pay with traffic, floods and disease.

It would be wrong to promise that green growth will be painless. It will require choices about land, subsidies and jobs, and some of these will be unpopular. But the alternative is not an easy path. It is a path with higher health bills, unstable harvests and costly disasters. The honest position is that the green path costs something now and saves a great deal later, while the old path appears cheap now and charges a heavy price later.

India's own history gives a hint of the right attitude. Our traditions of tank-building, sacred groves and shared water management were, in their own way, systems that tied the prosperity of the community to the health of the land. The task today is to translate that old wisdom into modern institutions: clear standards, strong regulators, honest data and fair compensation.

The question with which we began can now be answered. India can grow rich and stay green, but only if it treats the environment as a part of its balance sheet and not as a footnote to it. The test will be simple: when the next big project arrives, whether the first question is "how fast can we build it?" or "what will it cost our children, and who will bear it?" A nation that learns to ask both questions at once will find that prosperity and a living planet are not rivals but partners.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "G-C-F": Growth, Cost, Fairness. Show that green growth is possible, name the cost, then ask who pays.

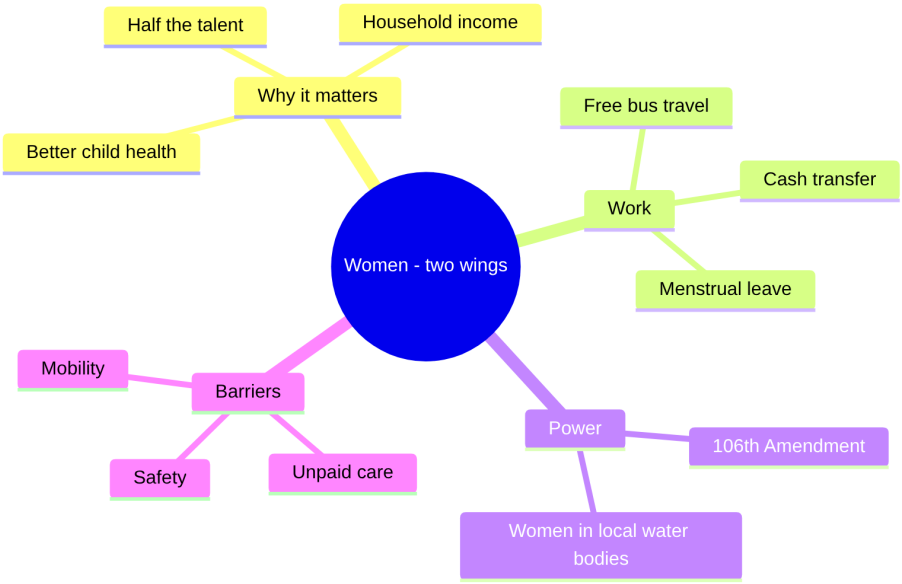
COMMON TRAP: Do not claim that growth and ecology never conflict. Name one real trade-off (land, water or jobs) and say how it is managed.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (power, Western Ghats, Clean Mobility Policy, GSDP); UNFCCC / PIB (India's net-zero announcement at COP26, 2021); Environment (Protection) Act 1986.

NEXT UP: Model essay 3: A country cannot fly on one wing: women in work and in power

Model essay 3: A country cannot fly on one wing: women in work and in power

Essay 1 type (national/international) | outline O-03 | 1114 words



Redraw this map first, then write.

A bird with one wing may flutter, but it cannot fly. A country that keeps half of its people on the ground, in unpaid work, with little say in public decisions, behaves in the same way. When we speak of women's empowerment, it is tempting to treat it as a favour or a welfare scheme. It is better understood as a question of national performance: a society that wastes the talent of half its citizens is poorer, slower and less fair than it needs to be.

The constitutional starting point is clear. The Constitution promises equality and, in Article 15(3), allows the State to make special provisions for women and children. This was never meant to cage women in protection; it was meant to lift the barriers that history had built. Over the decades, laws against dowry, workplace harassment and domestic violence have tried to remove the worst of those barriers. Yet the distance between a legal right and a lived right remains, and the gap is widest in the places that count for income: paid work and public power.

Consider first the household. A woman who has her own money makes a different set of choices. Evidence from many countries suggests that when women control income, more of it goes to food, health and schooling for children. Karnataka's Gruha Lakshmi scheme works on this idea. It pays Rs 2,000 a month to the woman who heads the household, and the Economic Survey for 2025-26 records that 1,28,88,617 women had enrolled by November 2025. Such a payment does not solve poverty, but it changes who holds the money, and in a household where the woman had to ask for every rupee, that is a significant shift.

Cash, however, is only a part of the story, because the larger prize is paid work. Here the barrier is often not willingness but distance and safety. A woman who must walk a long way, or pay for a bus ticket that cancels out her wage, may decide that the job is not worth it. Karnataka's Shakti scheme, which offers free bus travel to women, addresses this directly. The Survey reports that, within the Bangalore Metropolitan Transport Corporation alone, 202.10 crore women passengers travelled under the scheme between 11 June 2023 and 31 December 2025. It also cites a survey which reported that women's employment rose by 23 per cent in Bengaluru and 21 per cent in Hubballi-Dharwad. That figure comes from a survey of the scheme and should be read as an indication, not as proof that the bus alone created the jobs. Even so, the direction is sensible: when the cost of getting to work falls, more women can take up work.

The workplace also needs to change. A woman may reach the factory gate and still find that the toilets are missing, that the shift ends after dark with no transport, or that the supervisor is hostile. The Survey notes that dormitories for women workers, such as a 6,000-capacity facility at Narasapura in Kolar, improve living conditions and safety. Karnataka has gone further in recognising biological reality by adopting a Menstrual Leave Policy that gives women employees in registered establishments one paid day of leave a month. Whether one agrees with every detail or not, the principle is worth noting: a workplace that adapts to the people in it keeps them for longer.

Alongside paid work, there is the large and invisible burden of unpaid care: cooking, cleaning, looking after children and elders. It does not appear in the figures for national income, but it uses up the hours that might

otherwise be spent in earning, studying or taking part in public life. Reducing this burden through childcare centres, piped water, clean cooking fuel and shared household responsibility would release more time for women than almost any other measure.

Power is the third wing. Women's voices in public decisions change the choice of what is decided. The Constitution has long reserved seats for women in local bodies, and the experience of local government shows that women in office raise questions about drinking water, sanitation and schools that others had overlooked. The Survey notes that over 1.5 lakh women lead local water management in Village Water and Sanitation Committees. At the national level, Parliament passed the Constitution (106th Amendment) Act in 2023, known as the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, which reserves one-third of seats in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies for women. The reservation is to operate only after a delimitation exercise that follows the first census after the Act's commencement, so its full effect lies in the future. In the meantime, political parties can still choose to field more women, and voters can still choose to elect them.

There are also warnings to heed. A scheme that only pays money may make a woman a recipient and not a participant. A free service may stretch an operator's finances, and sustaining it takes fiscal planning. Reservations in legislatures can be captured by relatives of male leaders, unless women are given training and real authority. Social attitudes change slowly, and laws alone cannot cause them to change. Each of these risks suggests that policy should be judged by outcomes, such as the proportion of women in paid work, their wages, their safety, and the number who hold real decision-making power, and not by the volume of announcements.

Education is the foundation of everything above. A girl who completes school and acquires a skill is more likely to enter the workforce, marry later, have healthier children and take part in civic life. Keeping girls in secondary school, through safe transport, hostels, scholarships and toilets, pays back many times over.

There is also a lesson in respect. Empowerment does not mean that men lose and women gain. A household where both earn and share the care is more secure; a community where both vote and speak makes better decisions. The goal is a partnership in which each person can use her or his full ability.

We began with the picture of a bird. The wings of this bird are work, welfare and power, and each needs to be strong enough to carry weight. Karnataka's schemes show a state attempting to build the first two, and the 106th Amendment shows the country preparing the third. The work is unfinished. The measure of success will not be a number in a budget speech but the ordinary morning scene: a woman who leaves home safely, reaches a job she chose, controls the money she earns and has a say in what her village or city does next. When that scene is common, the country will have found its second wing.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "W-W-P": Work, Welfare, Power. Money in her hand, a way to reach work, a seat at the table.

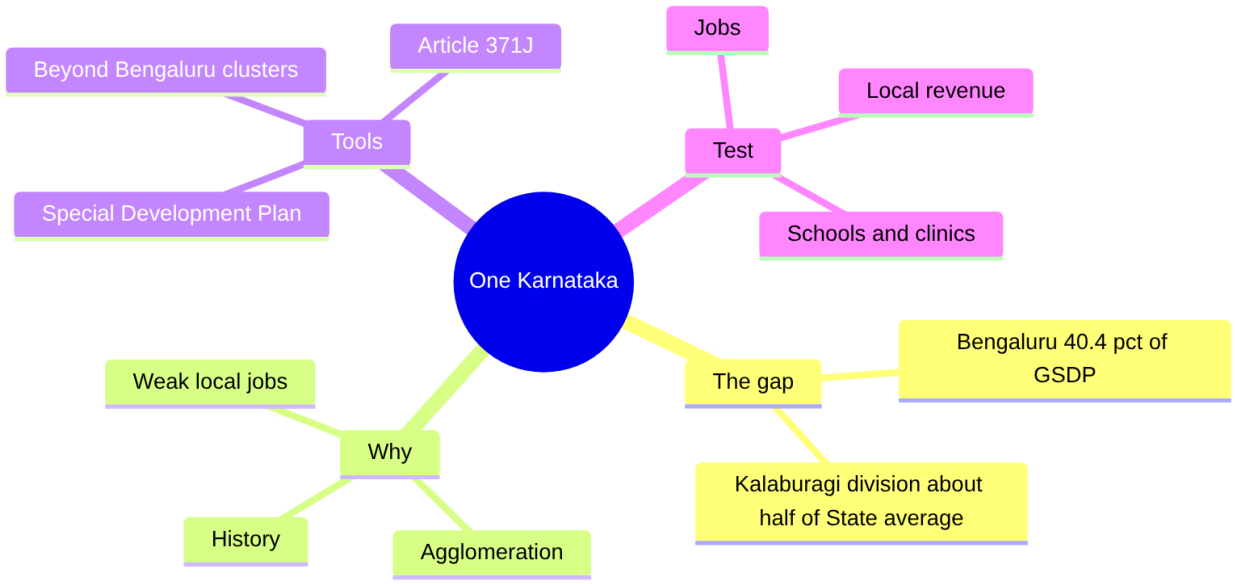
COMMON TRAP: Do not call a cash transfer "empowerment" on its own. Say what else is needed: safe transport, jobs, childcare and a voice in decisions.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (Gruha Lakshmi, Shakti, VWSC, Menstrual Leave Policy); The Constitution (106th Amendment) Act, 2023, Article 334A (indiacode.nic.in); Article 15(3) of the Constitution.

NEXT UP: Model essay 4: Bengaluru and the rest: one Karnataka or many?

Model essay 4: Bengaluru and the rest: one Karnataka or many?

Essay 2 type (State/local) | outline O-11 | 1016 words



Redraw this map first, then write.

Every State has a capital that shines, and Karnataka's shines brightly. Bengaluru is known across the world for its software, research institutions and start-ups. But a State is not its capital, and a map coloured by income reveals a quieter story. The question that this essay asks is whether Karnataka is one economy in which all regions rise together, or a bright core surrounded by a slower belt, and what the State should do about it.

The numbers set the scene. According to the Economic Survey for 2025-26, Bengaluru Urban district contributed Rs 11,73,574 crore to the State's GDP in 2024-25, which is 40.4 per cent of the total. A single district, home to a small fraction of the State's area, produces two-fifths of its income. The same Survey shows the spread in per capita income. In 2024-25 the State average stood at Rs 3,86,156, while Bengaluru Urban district recorded Rs 8,55,960, more than twice the average. At the other end, the Kalaburagi division had the lowest figure among the divisions, at Rs 1,89,938, which is about half of the State average. The two figures belong to different types of unit, a district and a division, so they should not be set directly against each other; each, however, makes the point clearly when compared with the State average.

Why does the gap exist? The first reason is agglomeration. Skilled workers, firms, universities, investors and airports cluster together because each gains by being near the others. This is natural and, to a degree, productive. The second reason is history. The regions that now form Karnataka came together from different political units, and some, such as the north-eastern districts that were once part of the Hyderabad State, entered with weaker schools, roads and irrigation. The third reason is that the policies of many decades often found it easier to support the place where companies were already located than to build the conditions for them elsewhere. The result is a self-reinforcing cycle: where people and capital already are, more people and capital go.

The State has not ignored the problem. The Committee for the Redressal of Regional Imbalances, headed by Dr D M Nanjundappa, submitted its report in 2002. It examined the 175 taluks of the time on a set of indicators and, according to published summaries, classified 114 of them as backward, with a smaller group as most backward. It recommended a special development plan, with funds allotted by need. The Constitution was later amended to add Article 371J, through the 98th Amendment, which received assent on 1 January 2013, and which gives special provisions to the Hyderabad-Karnataka region, including a development board and measures for equitable funding, education and public employment. The region was renamed Kalyana Karnataka in 2019. These are significant instruments. Yet the persistence of the gap suggests that money and reservations are necessary but not sufficient.

What more is needed? The first requirement is jobs near home. Sending funds to a backward taluk without creating anything that people can earn from will keep young adults migrating towards the capital. The State's Startup Policy for 2025-30 aims at 25,000 start-ups, of which 10,000 are to be outside Bengaluru, and the Survey reports that over 1,230 start-ups have been supported across the State, including innovators from regions

beyond Bengaluru. This is the right direction, but a start-up needs more than a grant. It needs reliable power, broadband, a nearby college, a market and a banker who knows the district. The aim should be to build a few regional hubs, each with a strong anchor such as an agricultural-processing cluster in the north, a port-linked industry on the coast, and a textile or defence supply chain elsewhere, rather than thin the effort across many places.

The second requirement is human capability. A child who attends a school with trained teachers and a clinic with a doctor is more likely to become a productive adult. Funds that raise these basics in lagging regions often have a better return than the grand project, because they widen the pool of people who can later work in modern jobs. Learning outcomes, attendance of teachers and doctors, and the availability of hostels for girls should be monitored as closely as road length.

The third requirement is a fair share of local revenue and decision-making. Local governments that raise some of their own revenue and decide how to spend their funds respond better to local needs. The Survey itself acknowledges that Panchayats face limited financial autonomy and inadequate devolution of authority; improvement here is one way of making regional development a local responsibility and not a distant favour.

There are cautions as well. It would be a mistake to starve Bengaluru in the name of balance, because the city is the engine that pays for much of the State's spending, and its own problems of traffic, water and housing need investment. The task is to plan so that growth spreads, not to slow it where it is strongest. Nor can we judge success only by average incomes. A region can improve its average while the poorest within it do not benefit, so measures should include health, learning and employment of the weakest groups.

Reducing regional gaps also has a political side. When a region feels neglected, it develops a sense of grievance that can erode trust in the State. A fair and visible commitment, with published district-wise data and a time-bound plan, is therefore an investment in unity. The people of Kalaburagi or Belagavi should be able to see, in numbers and on the ground, that they are partners in the State's rise.

The answer to the question we began with is that Karnataka today is a bright core and a slower belt, but it need not remain so. The State has a map of the problem, a constitutional instrument and a policy direction. What it requires now is patience, accurate data and consistency across governments. If every region sees a school, a clinic and a job within reach, then the phrase "one Karnataka" will describe an experience and not just a slogan.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "G-W-T": Gap, Why, Tools. Quote the gap in numbers, explain its roots, then judge the tools.

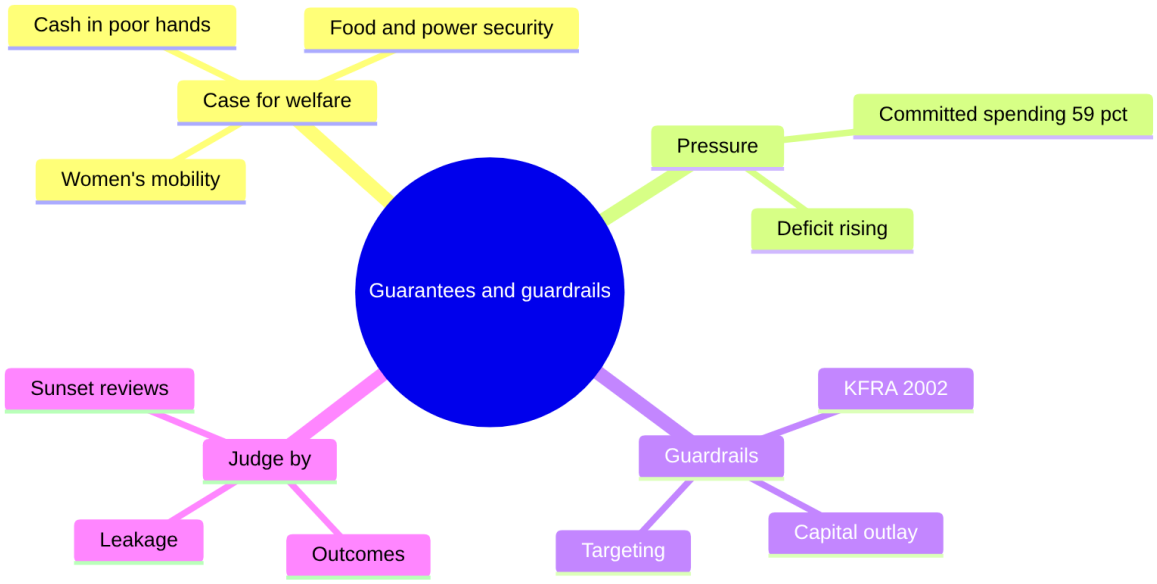
COMMON TRAP: Do not compare a district figure with a division figure. Compare the division with the State average, or district with district.

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (district GDP, regional per capita income, Startup Policy); The Constitution (98th Amendment) Act, 2012 (prsindia.org, indiacode.nic.in); Report of the High Power Committee for Redressal of Regional Imbalances (Nanjundappa), 2002, as summarised in published analyses.

NEXT UP: Model essay 5: Guarantees and guardrails: welfare and the State's purse

Model essay 5: Guarantees and guardrails: welfare and the State's purse

Essay 2 type (State/local) | outline O-12 | 1051 words



Redraw this map first, then write.

Few debates in a State capture the imagination like the one on welfare and money. A household that has a little more cash each month feels the difference immediately. A finance department that sees a growing share of its revenue promised in advance feels the difference too, only differently. The debate is often presented as a battle between compassion and arithmetic, but that is a false picture. A good government needs both, and the interesting question is how much it can promise, to whom and with what safeguards.

The case for welfare is strong. Karnataka's five guarantee schemes are Shakti, Anna Bhagya, Gruha Jyothi, Gruha Lakshmi and Yuva Nidhi. The Economic Survey for 2025-26 reports a combined provision of Rs 51,034.40 crore for them in the 2025-26 Budget, about 12.46 per cent of the total. They address different needs. Free bus travel for women lowers the cost of reaching work, school and health care. Food security through Anna Bhagya and free electricity up to 200 units through Gruha Jyothi reduce the burden of two essential household expenses. Gruha Lakshmi puts Rs 2,000 a month into the hands of the woman who heads the household, and Yuva Nidhi supports young job-seekers. When money reaches households that spend most of what they receive, it tends to circulate quickly in the local economy, supporting traders and small producers.

Welfare is also an investment in people. A child who is fed and schooled becomes a more productive adult. A woman who can travel safely can take a job. A family that is protected against a sudden shock does not have to sell its land or pull a child out of school. Such benefits are real even though they do not show up neatly in a budget line.

The pressure on the purse, however, is also real. According to PRS Legislative Research, the Budget for 2026-27 estimates spending on the five guarantees at Rs 51,286 crore, about 12 per cent of total expenditure excluding the repayment of debt, compared with 14 per cent in 2025-26. The State also carries large commitments that cannot be avoided: PRS estimates committed expenditure, which covers salaries, pensions and interest, at Rs 1,85,025 crore in 2026-27, equal to 59 per cent of estimated revenue receipts, up from 51 per cent in 2024-25. When more than half of every rupee of revenue is already spoken for before any new decision is made, the room for new schemes, or for investment, narrows.

The effect on investment is a particular concern. The Comptroller and Auditor General, in its audit of State finances as quoted by PRS, found that the fiscal deficit rose from 2.14 per cent of GSDP in 2022-23 to 2.97 per cent in 2024-25. The Economic Survey gives a revised estimate of 2.90 per cent for 2024-25. These figures differ because one is an audited outcome and the other is a revised estimate, so they should be read side by side and not as one. Either way, they show a rise. The audit also reported that spending on guarantees had reduced the funds available for infrastructure in 2023-24. The Budget for 2026-27, in response, proposes capital outlay of Rs 71,924 crore, which is 14 per cent above the revised estimate for 2025-26. It is a sign that the State recognises the problem, although it remains to be seen whether the outlay is actually spent.

What are the guardrails? The first is the fiscal law. Karnataka was the first State to enact a Fiscal Responsibility Act, in 2002, setting limits on the deficit and debt as a share of State output. Such a law is a promise to future citizens, who will bear the interest on today's borrowing. It is wise to keep that promise credible. The second guardrail is the quality of spending. A rupee spent on capital creation, such as irrigation, roads, schools and clinics, increases future income, while a rupee spent only on consumption does not. A welfare state should aim for both: protect the vulnerable today and build assets that raise tomorrow's revenue.

The third guardrail is better targeting and honest evaluation. Welfare schemes lose public support if benefits leak to the ineligible or are denied to the deserving. Digital registers and direct transfers help, but must be paired with grievance systems to catch the excluded. Each scheme should have clear objectives, simple indicators and a periodic independent review. If a scheme reaches its goal, it can be adjusted or phased; if it does not, it should be redesigned. Without such review, a scheme becomes a permanent line in the budget with no connection to results.

The fourth guardrail is revenue. The State's own tax collection, its share of Union taxes and the grants it receives set the limits. The Finance Commission formula affects how much a State receives, and Karnataka, as a relatively high-income State, has argued for a fair recognition of its contribution. Beyond argument, the State can improve compliance, widen the base and reduce wasteful subsidies. Growth itself is the greatest source of revenue: the same Survey reports that the State's GSDP grew by 8.1 per cent at constant prices in 2025-26, and sustained growth makes welfare more affordable.

It would be wrong to treat welfare and fiscal prudence as opposites. A State that runs heavy deficits for many years eventually spends a rising share on interest and has less for the poor. In the long run, fiscal discipline is itself a form of protection for the vulnerable, because it keeps the State's capacity to help intact. On the other side, a State that ignores social needs in the name of discipline loses the trust of its citizens and risks damaging the human capital on which growth depends.

The conclusion is that the issue is not "guarantees or no guarantees" but "which guarantees, for whom, funded how and reviewed when?" A responsible government will explain these choices to its people, publish the numbers and be ready to adjust. The measure of success is not whether a scheme is announced, or even whether it is paid, but whether a poor family is better off, a child is better schooled and the State's finances are still strong enough to keep the promise next year. Compassion and arithmetic, properly combined, are not enemies; together they are simply good governance.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "H-P-G": Help, Pressure, Guardrails. A welfare essay must hold both sides in one hand.

COMMON TRAP: Do not quote the Survey and the CAG deficit figures as if they were the same thing. One is a revised estimate (2.90%), the other an audited result (2.97%).

Sources: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 (guarantee outlays, fiscal deficit, KFRA 2002); PRS Legislative Research, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (committed expenditure, capital outlay, CAG figures quoted).

Appendix: fact ledger

Item	Claim	Source key	Check
O-01	FRUITS: 102.95 lakh farmers registered	ES	matched
O-02	Renewables over 53.32% of installed capacity	ES	matched
O-03	1,28,88,617 women enrolled in Gruha Lakshmi	ES	matched
O-04	Article 262 and the 1956 Act; Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal award 2007; Supreme Court 2018	WEB	web-verified
O-05	GCC Policy 2024-29 targets 500 GCCs and 3.5 lakh jobs	ES	matched
O-07	Shreya Singhal v. Union of India, 2015, struck down section 66A	WEB	web-verified
O-08	GST Council under Article 279A; GST from 1 July 2017	WEB	web-verified
O-09	India held the G20 presidency in 2023; the African Union joined as a permanent member at New Delhi	WEB	web-verified
O-10	MMR 97 (2015-17) to 68 (2021-23); IMR 28 (2015) to 14 (2023)	ES	matched
O-11	Bengaluru Urban 40.4% of State GDP	ES	matched
O-12	Committed expenditure 59% of revenue receipts (2026-27)	PRS	matched
O-13	Kannada declared a classical language in 2008	WEB	web-verified
O-14	Nearly 60% of the Western Ghats lies in Karnataka	ES	matched
O-15	74.94 lakh ha treated under watershed up to March 2025; 25,76,388 farmers enrolled in crop insurance	ES	matched
O-16	K-RIDE revised cost Rs 23,103 crore; 148.17 km	ES	matched
O-17	Kalaburagi division per capita income Rs 1,89,938 (2024-25)	ES	matched
O-18	KMF average daily milk procurement of 1 crore litres in June 2025	ES	matched
O-19	Tourism Policy 2024-29 targets Rs 5,000 crore investment and 10 lakh jobs	ES	matched
O-20	Startup Policy 2025-30: 25,000 start-ups, 10,000 outside Bengaluru	ES	matched
E1	Karnataka's FRUITS platform has registered over 102.95 lakh farmers and 84.40 lakh unique beneficiaries received Rs 39,596.98 crore	ES	matched
E1	Gruha Lakshmi: Rs 11,334.99 crore disbursed through DBT	ES	matched
E1	Karnataka's Panchamitra chatbot for Gram Panchayat services	ES	matched
E1	UPI pilot-launched by NPCI on 11 April 2016	WEB	web-verified
E1	Puttaswamy (24 Aug 2017): privacy is a fundamental right under Article 21; Aadhaar upheld for welfare in 2018 with limits on private use	WEB	web-verified
E1	Digital Personal Data Protection Act enacted 11 August 2023	WEB	web-verified
E2	Karnataka installed power capacity 37,072.95 MW (Dec 2025); renewables over 53.32%	ES	matched
E2	Transmission and distribution losses fell from 16.34% (2021-22) to 12.57% (2024-25)	ES	matched
E2	Clean Mobility Policy 2025-30 targets Rs 50,000 crore investment and one lakh jobs	ES	matched
E2	Nearly 60% of the Western Ghats lies in Karnataka	ES	matched
E2	GSDP at constant prices grew 8.1% in 2025-26	ES	matched
E2	India announced a net-zero target for 2070 at COP26, Glasgow, in 2021	WEB	web-verified
E3	Gruha Lakshmi pays Rs 2,000 per month to the woman head of household; 1,28,88,617 women enrolled (Nov 2025)	ES	matched
E3	Shakti: 202.10 crore women passengers in BMTC (11 Jun 2023 - 31 Dec 2025)	ES	matched
E3	A survey cited in the Survey reports women's employment up 23% in Bengaluru and 21% in Hubballi-Dharwad after Shakti	ES	matched
E3	Over 1.5 lakh women lead local water management in Village Water and Sanitation Committees	ES	matched
E3	A 6,000-capacity dormitory for women workers at Narasapura, Kolar (Rs 173 crore)	ES	matched
E3	Menstrual Leave Policy: one paid day a month for women employees	ES	matched

Item	Claim	Source key	Check
E3	106th Amendment (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023) reserves one-third of seats in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies, to operate after delimitation following the first census after commencement	WEB	web-verified
E4	Bengaluru Urban contributed Rs 11,73,574 crore, 40.4% of State GDP in 2024-25	ES	matched
E4	Kalaburagi division lowest per capita income Rs 1,89,938; State average Rs 3,86,156; Bengaluru Urban Rs 8,55,960 (2024-25)	ES	matched
E4	Startup Policy 2025-30: 25,000 start-ups, of which 10,000 outside Bengaluru	ES	matched
E4	Over 1,230 start-ups supported across the State, including innovators from regions beyond Bengaluru	ES	matched
E4	Article 371J inserted by the 98th Amendment, assented to on 1 January 2013, for the Hyderabad-Karnataka region	WEB	web-verified
E4	The Survey notes that Panchayats face limited financial autonomy and inadequate devolution	ES	matched
E4	Hyderabad-Karnataka renamed Kalyana Karnataka in 2019 (Cabinet approval 6 Sep 2019; announced 17 Sep 2019)	WEB	web-verified
E4	Nanjundappa Committee (report 2002) classified 114 of 175 taluks as backward	WEB	web-verified
E5	Five guarantee schemes Rs 51,034.40 crore in 2025-26 BE, about 12.46% of the Budget	ES	matched
E5	Budget 2026-27: guarantees estimated at Rs 51,286 crore, 12% of total expenditure excluding debt repayment (14% in 2025-26)	PRS	matched
E5	Committed expenditure Rs 1,85,025 crore, 59% of estimated revenue receipts in 2026-27 (51% in 2024-25)	PRS	matched
E5	Capital outlay Rs 71,924 crore in 2026-27, 14% above 2025-26 RE	PRS	matched
E5	CAG: fiscal deficit rose from 2.14% of GSDP in 2022-23 to 2.97% in 2024-25	PRS	matched
E5	Survey: fiscal deficit 2.90% (2024-25 RE); Karnataka the first State to enact a Fiscal Responsibility Act (2002)	ES	matched

Source keys: **ES** = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Executive Summary (data to Dec 2025 unless stated); **PRS** = PRS Legislative Research, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (Budget presented 06-03-2026). WEB items (statutes, judgments, dates) were checked on official or primary sites; see the Sources line under each essay.

Deliverable 6 - Dossiers (the fact-locker): Karnataka economy, schemes, governance, disaster management, S&T

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | every figure carries a source key; the review script re-matched each key fragment against the saved source text

Library progress: this is the 6th of 8 parts; Deliverables 3, 4, 5, 7, 8 follow.

CHAI-TALK: This is your fact-locker. Every number below has a source tag, and a script re-checked each one against the saved source text. Rule of the house: **if a number is not in this locker, do not quote it in the exam**; write the trend instead. Five sections (A to E), each with pictures, a peak fact, a common trap and a recap. Do one section per sitting.

How to use. Each row is one citable fact. 'Src' is the source key defined in the table below. Dates are as stated in the source; the Survey's figures are mostly 'up to December 2025'. Re-verify any figure on the exam-year Survey before quoting.

Source keys

Key	Source	Status
ES	Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Executive Summary (data to Dec 2025 unless stated)	text saved on box and fragment-matched
PRS	PRS Legislative Research, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (Budget presented 06-03-2026)	text saved on box and fragment-matched
PIB	PIB / Parliament answer, Aug 2026 (web-verified: pib.gov.in PRID=2298231)	web-verified (URL/search at build time); not fragment-matched
ISRO	ISRO website isro.gov.in (Chandrayaan-3 page; Aditya-L1 halo-orbit release)	web-verified (URL/search at build time); not fragment-matched
DMA	Disaster Management Act, 2005 (India Code, indiacode.nic.in), ss.3, 14, 25	web-verified (URL/search at build time); not fragment-matched

Known source discrepancies (flagged, not resolved)

- **Guarantee spending:** PRS says Rs 51,286 crore for 2026-27; the Survey says Rs 51,034.40 crore for 2025-26 BE. Different years. PRS's own sector table lists Anna Bhagya at Rs 7,700 crore for 2026-27 while a news-report component sum used elsewhere gave other totals, so only the PRS headline total is quoted here.
- **Forest Rights Act year:** an earlier research note found a press report (2000) and the Survey (2002) disagreeing on a forest-rights-related year. That item is NOT used in this dossier. The statute itself is the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, **2006** (India Code).
- **Per capita income:** 2025-26 figure (Rs 4,33,326) is an estimate at current prices; the district/division figures are for 2024-25 and are not comparable year-to-year.

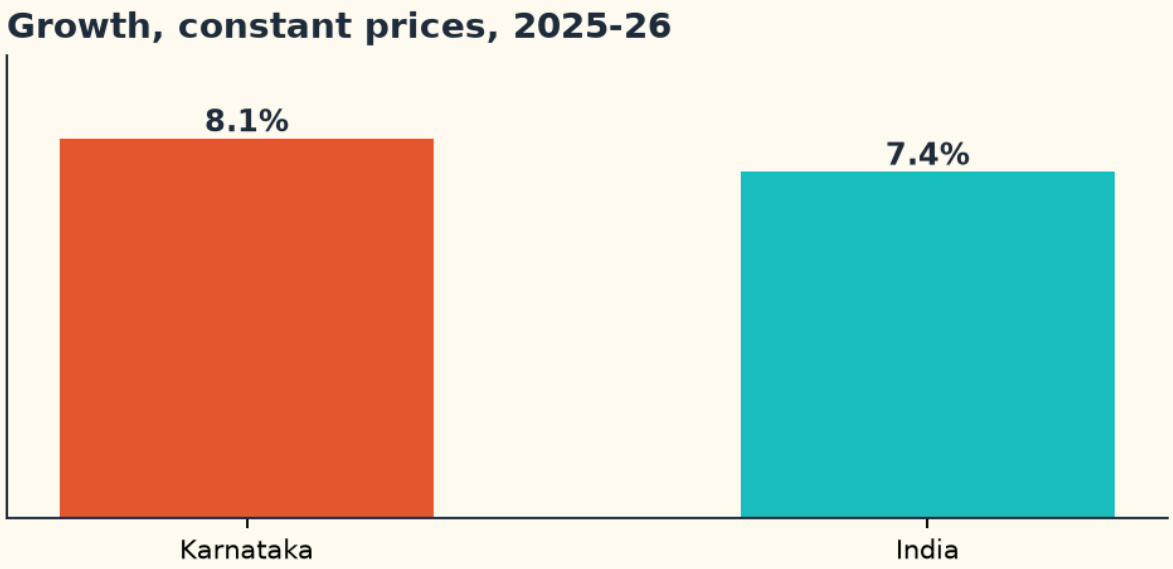
Verification rule used

Claims are quoted from the source with the same numbers; no figure was computed by me except where stated. The Survey was read from a mirror PDF of the official publication; PRS figures cite the Budget Documents 2026-27 via PRS.

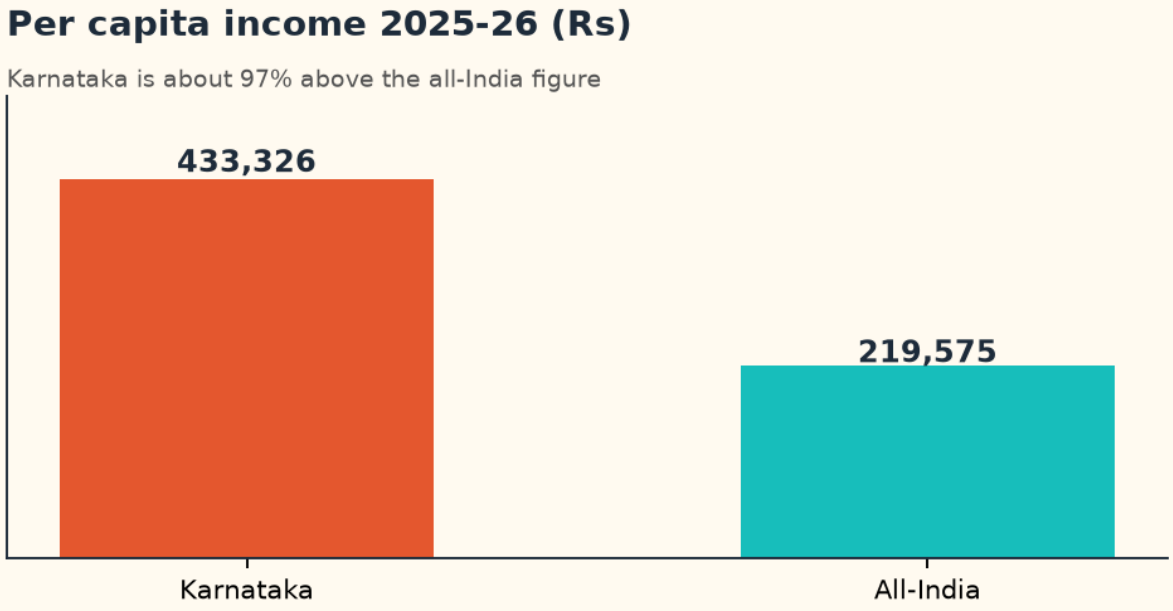
A. Karnataka economy and the Economic Survey 2025-26

Use these as the numeric spine for GS1 economy, GS2 and GS3 answers on Karnataka. Growth rates are labelled current-price or constant-price: do not mix them.

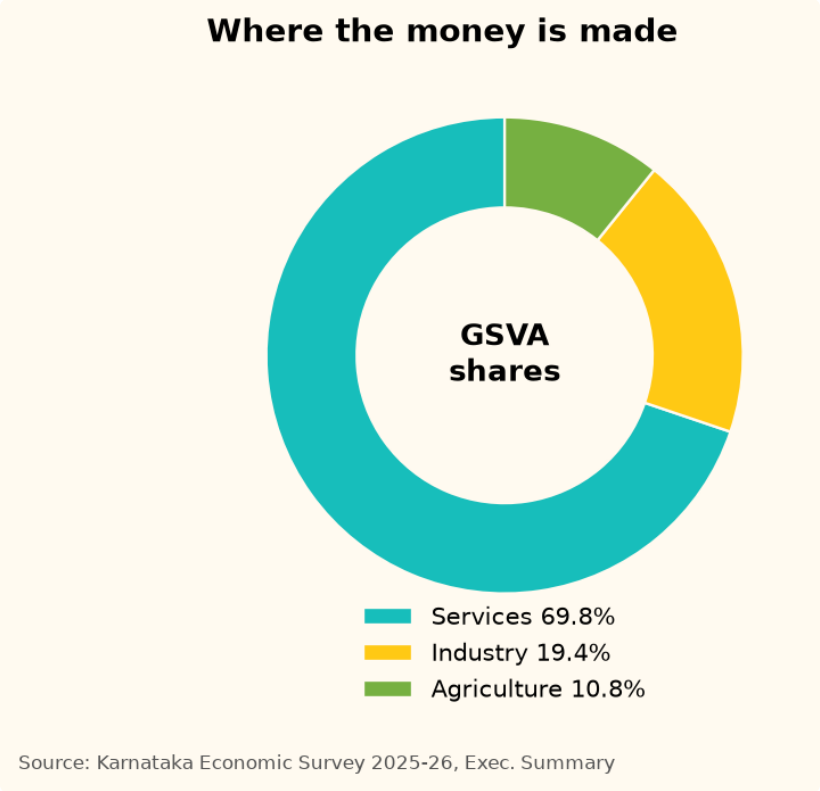
CHAI-TALK: Section A is the engine room: how big is Karnataka's economy, how fast is it growing, who is left behind. One rule: **current prices and constant prices are different things**. 12.9% is the sticker-price growth; 8.1% is the real (inflation-adjusted) growth. Quoting them interchangeably is the fastest way to look careless.

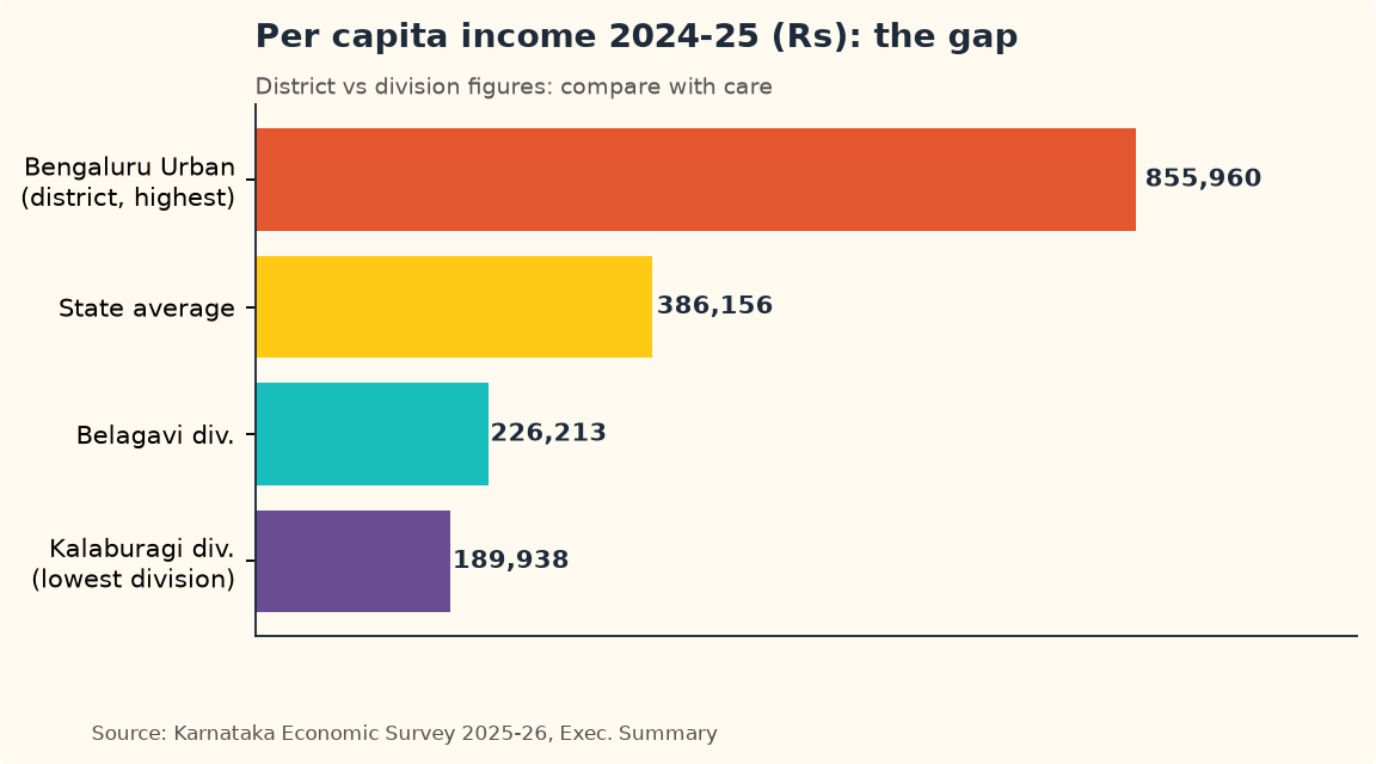


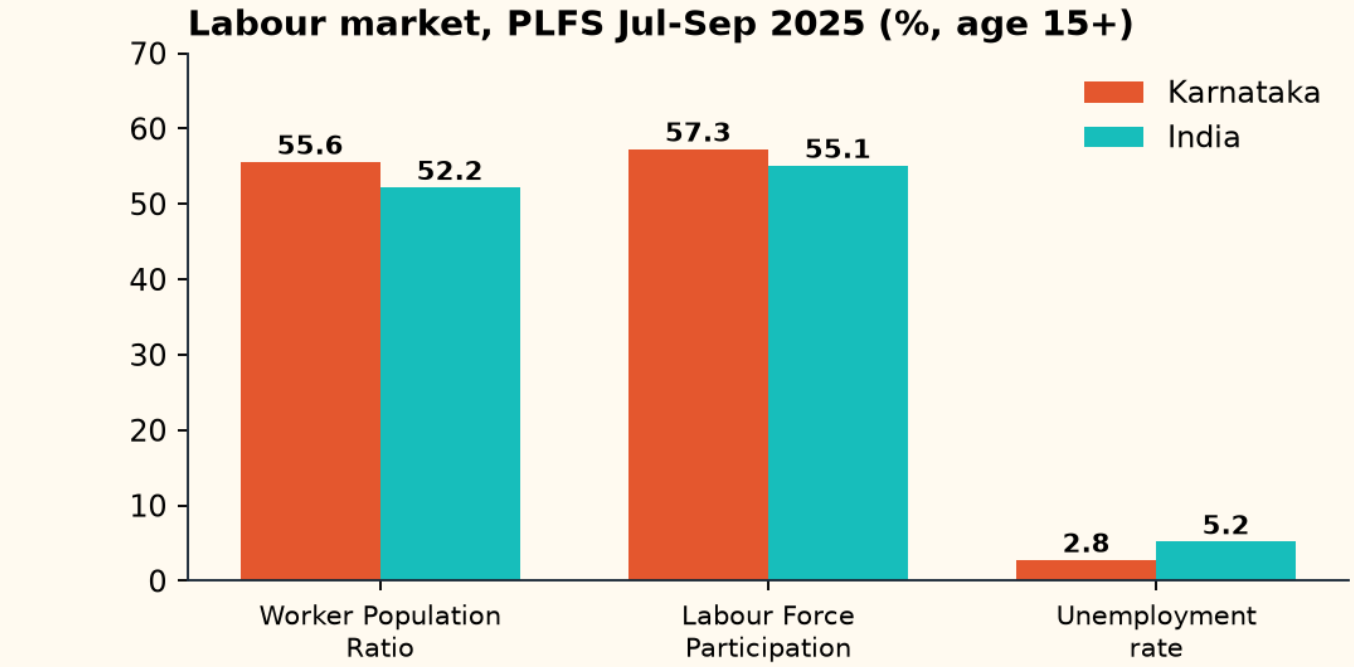
Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary



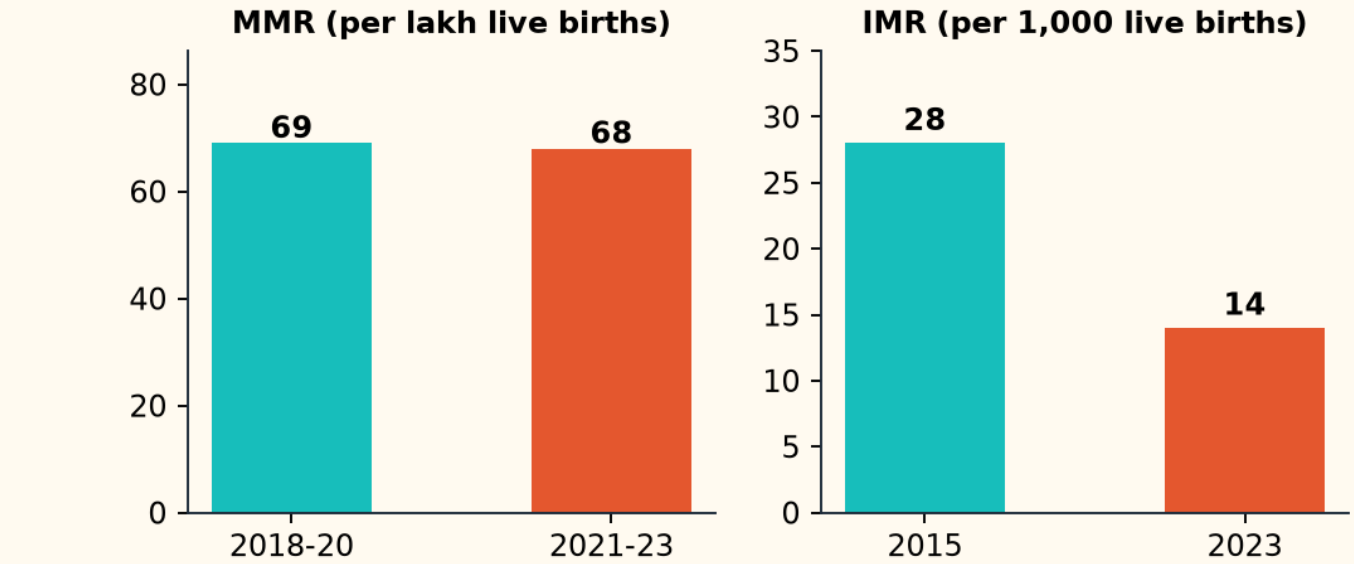
Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary


Where the money is made
GSVA shares
Services 69.8%
Industry 19.4%
Agriculture 10.8%
Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary

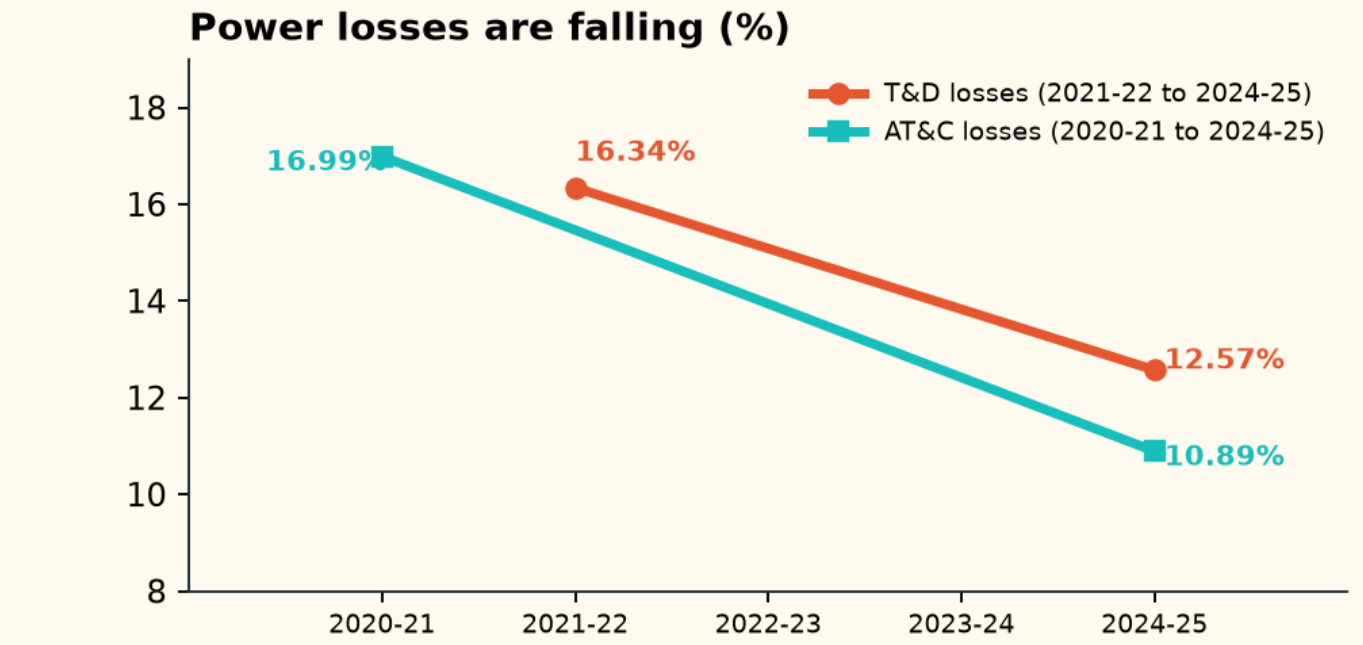

Per capita income 2024-25 (Rs): the gap
District vs division figures: compare with care
Bengaluru Urban (district, highest)
855,960
State average
386,156
Belagavi div.
226,213
Kalaburagi div. (lowest division)
189,938
Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary (SRS)



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary

#	Fact	Src
A1	GSDP rose from Rs 29.06 lakh crore (2024-25) to Rs 32.81 lakh crore (2025-26), growth 12.9% at current prices.	ES
A2	At constant prices GSDP grew 8.1% (Rs 15.94 lakh crore to Rs 17.23 lakh crore), above India's 7.4%.	ES
A3	Karnataka's share of India's GDP: 9.19% in 2025-26 (8.79% in 2024-25).	ES
A4	Per capita income Rs 4,33,326 (2025-26), about 97% above the all-India figure of Rs 2,19,575.	ES
A5	Sectoral shares of GSVA: Services 69.8%, Industry 19.4%, Agriculture 10.8%.	ES
A6	Sector growth 2025-26 (constant prices): agriculture 9.1%, industry 6.7% (manufacturing 7.2%), services 8.1%.	ES
A7	Bengaluru Urban contributed Rs 11,73,574 crore, 40.4% of State GDP in 2024-25; Dakshina Kannada 5.3%, Belagavi 3.9%.	ES
A8	Regional disparity (2024-25): Kalaburagi division lowest per capita income at Rs 1,89,938; Belagavi division Rs 2,26,213; Bengaluru Urban district highest at Rs 8,55,960; State average Rs 3,86,156.	ES
A9	Fiscal deficit 2.90% of GSDP (2024-25 RE), target 2.95% (2025-26 BE), under the Karnataka Fiscal Responsibility Act, 2002 (Karnataka was the first State to enact such an Act).	ES
A10	Five guarantee schemes in 2025-26 BE: Rs 51,034.40 crore (about 12.46% of Budget): Shakti Rs 5,300 cr; Anna Bhagya Rs 6,426 cr; Gruha Jyothi Rs 10,100 cr; Gruha Lakshmi Rs 28,608.40 cr; Yuva Nidhi Rs 600 cr.	ES
A11	Budget 2026-27 (PRS): spending on the five guarantees estimated at Rs 51,286 crore, 12% of total expenditure excl. debt repayment (2025-26: Rs 51,034 crore, 14%).	PRS
A12	Budget 2026-27: revenue expenditure Rs 3,38,007 crore; capital outlay Rs 71,924 crore (14% above 2025-26 RE).	PRS
A13	Committed expenditure 2026-27: Rs 1,85,025 crore, 59% of estimated revenue receipts (salaries 29%, pension 13%, interest 17%); it was 51% in 2024-25.	PRS
A14	CAG (State Finances Audit, Report No. 4 of 2025), as quoted by PRS: fiscal deficit rose from 2.14% of GSDP (2022-23) to 2.97% (2024-25); guarantee spending reduced infrastructure spending by Rs 5,229 crore in 2023-24.	PRS
A15	Nearly 40% of GSDP is linked to export-oriented activities; overall exports up 13.78% in 2025-26 over 2024-25.	ES
A16	FDI of USD 67,053 million (Oct 2019 to Sep 2025) = 21% of national inflows.	ES
A17	Industrial sector GSDP Rs 5,80,144 crore in 2025-26 (10.3% growth), 19.36% of State GDP, including 11.33% from manufacturing.	ES
A18	Policies: Industrial Policy 2025-30 (target Rs 7.5 lakh crore investment, 20 lakh jobs); Startup Policy 2025-30 (25,000 start-ups, 10,000 outside Bengaluru); GCC Policy 2024-29 (500 GCCs, 3.5 lakh jobs); Clean Mobility Policy 2025-30 (Rs 50,000 crore, 1 lakh jobs).	ES
A19	Labour market (PLFS Jul-Sep 2025, 15+): Worker Population Ratio 55.6% (India 52.2%); LFPR 57.3% (India 55.1%); unemployment 2.8% (India 5.2%).	ES
A20	MSMEs: 24.86 lakh registered under Udyam (Dec 2025), employing 235.27 lakh persons.	ES
A21	Agriculture: 170 APMCs, 167 linked to the Unified Market Platform; UMP transacted 12.67 crore MT worth Rs 4,39,852.54 crore (Dec 2025).	ES

#	Fact	Src
A22	Kharif/Rabi 2025-26 (Second Advance Estimates): area of major crops 107.1 lakh ha, foodgrains 78.6 lakh ha, estimated foodgrain production 136.22 lakh tonnes.	ES
A23	Watershed: of 190.50 lakh ha State area, 129.70 lakh ha is available for watershed interventions; 74.94 lakh ha treated up to March 2025.	ES
A24	Crop insurance (PMFBY, Karnataka Raitha Suraksha): 25,76,388 farmers enrolled to Dec 2025.	ES
A25	Dairy: KMF average daily milk procurement reached 1 crore litres in June 2025.	ES
A26	FRUITS platform: over 102.95 lakh farmers registered; 84.40 lakh unique beneficiaries received Rs 39,596.98 crore.	ES
A27	Power: installed capacity 37,072.95 MW (Dec 2025); renewables over 53.32%; T&D losses 16.34% (2021-22) down to 12.57% (2024-25); Gruha Jyothi subsidy Rs 22,040 crore disbursed, 1.65 crore households.	ES
A28	Tourism Policy 2024-29: Rs 5,000 crore investment, 10 lakh jobs; 3,017.47 lakh domestic and 4.37 lakh foreign tourists by Dec 2025.	ES
A29	Bengaluru Sub-Urban Rail (K-RIDE): revised cost Rs 23,103 crore, 148.17 km, four corridors. Metro Phase-2 75.06 km (53.80 km operational).	ES

PEAK FACT: Karnataka's per capita income (Rs 4,33,326 in 2025-26) is about 97% higher than the all-India figure, yet the lowest division (Kalaburagi, Rs 1,89,938) sits far below Bengaluru Urban's district figure (Rs 8,55,960). Rich on average, unequal inside. That one contrast answers half the regional-disparity questions.

COMMON TRAP: Comparing a 2025-26 figure with a 2024-25 figure as if they were the same year. Check the year before you subtract.

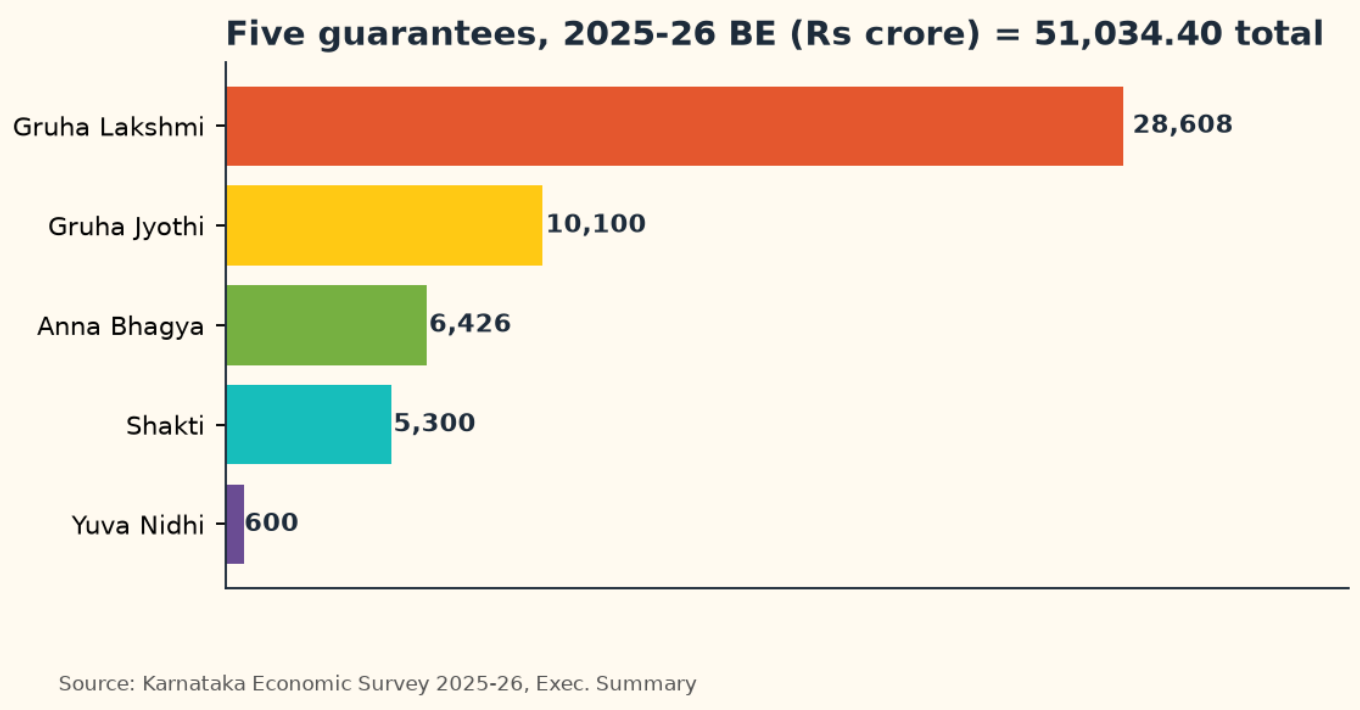
RECAP: Growth 8.1% (constant prices) vs India 7.4%. Services 69.8% of GSVA. Unemployment 2.8% vs India 5.2%. Gap: Bengaluru vs Kalaburagi division. Power losses falling.

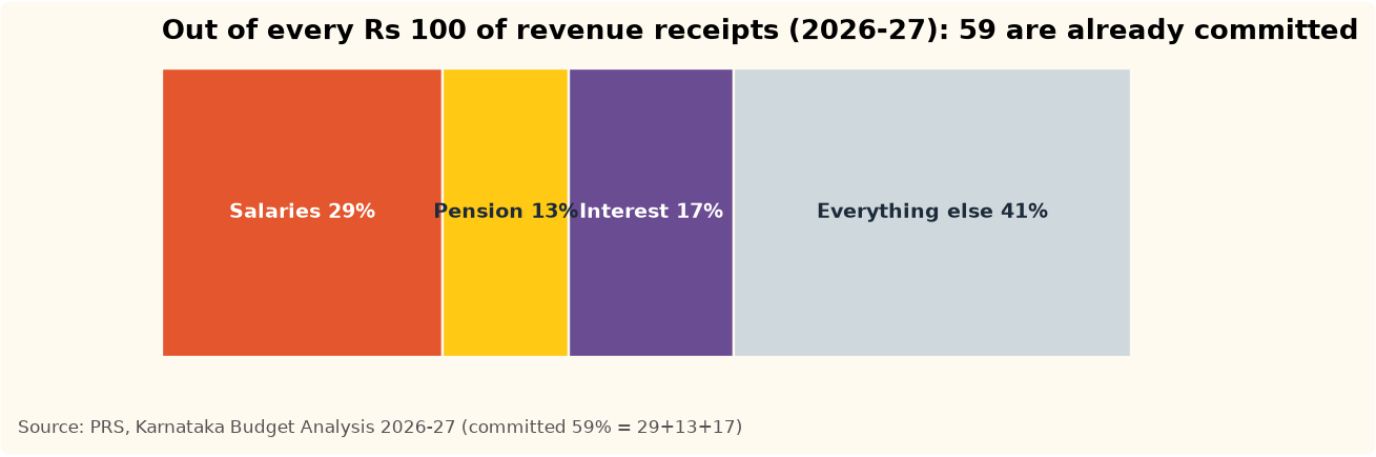
NEXT UP: Section B turns these numbers into rupees: the five guarantees and where the Budget puts its money.

B. State schemes and welfare

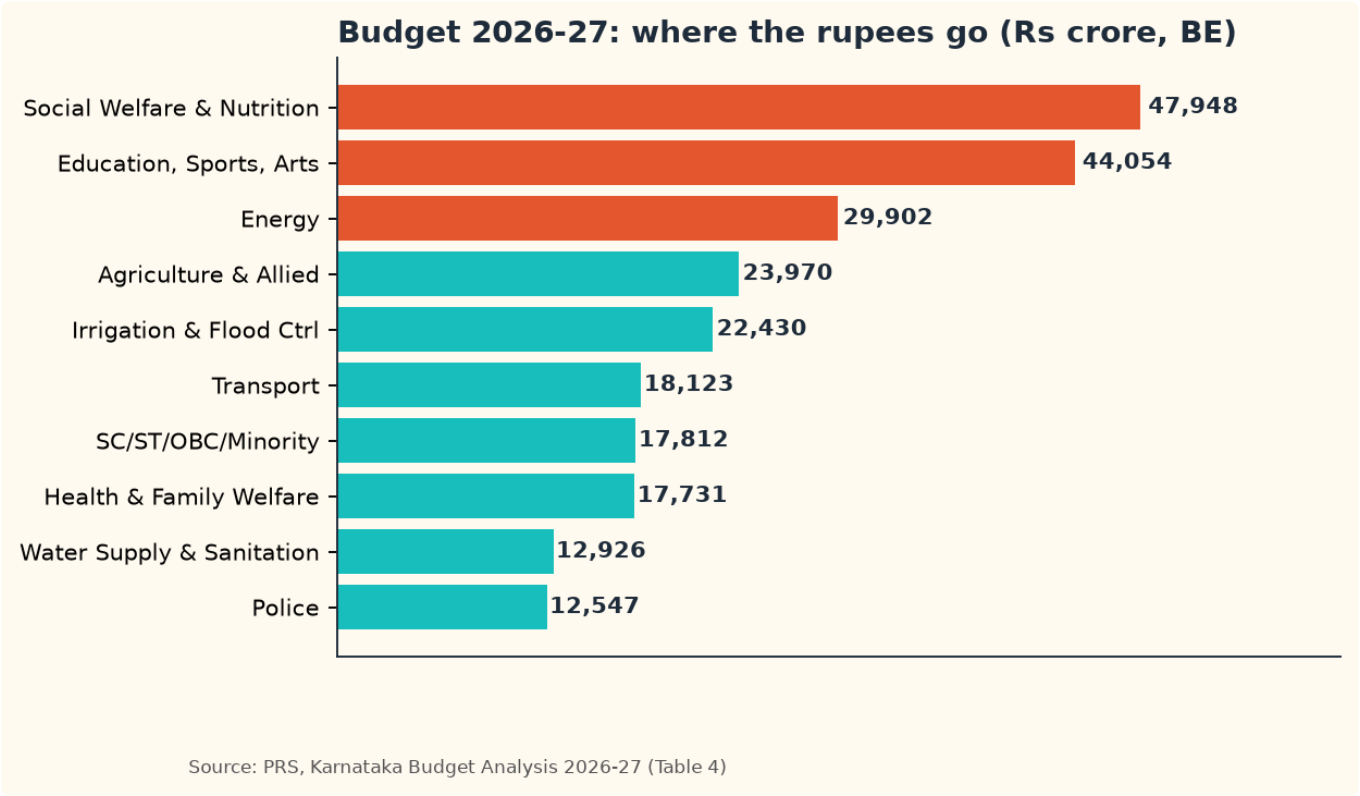
Scheme dossier: launch context, outlay and outcome. Where two sources give different numbers for the same scheme, both are shown with their year and the reason.

CHAI-TALK: Section B is about the five guarantee schemes and how much of the Budget they eat. Notice how much of the Budget is already spoken for before the government decides anything new: salaries, pensions and interest. That is what 'committed expenditure' means.

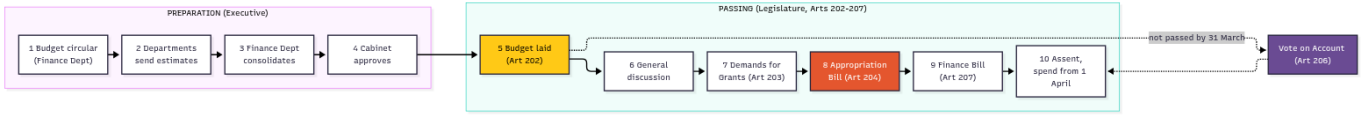




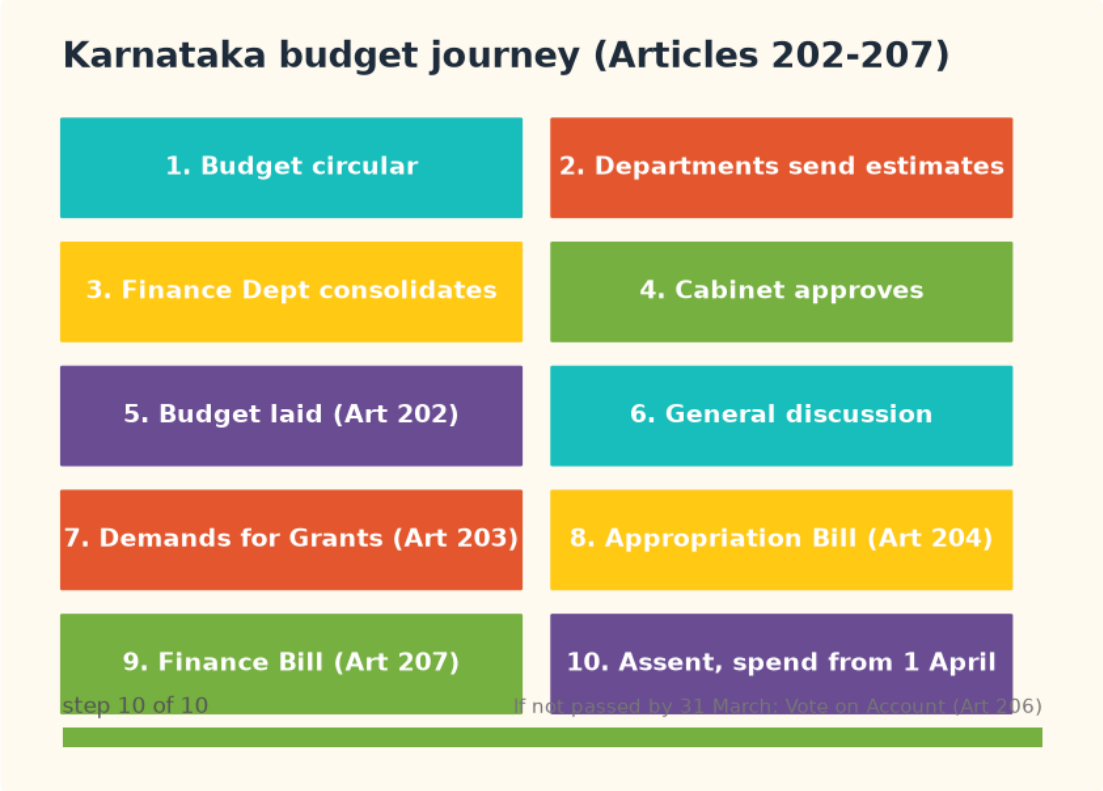
Source: PRS, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (committed 59% = 29+13+17)



Source: PRS, Karnataka Budget Analysis 2026-27 (Table 4)



Exploded view: how a budget is made and passed, Articles 202-207. A step-by-step animation is in `anim/anim_budget.gif` and `anim/anim_budget.mp4`; its last frame is below.



#	Fact	Src
B1	Gruha Lakshmi: Rs 2,000 per month to the woman head of household; 2025-26 allocation Rs 28,608 crore; Rs 11,334.99 crore disbursed through DBT; 1,28,88,617 women enrolled (Nov 2025).	ES
B2	Gruha Lakshmi 2026-27 Budget provision: Rs 28,608 crore (PRS).	PRS
B3	Gruha Jyothi: free electricity up to 200 units per month; Rs 22,040 crore subsidy to Dec 2025; 1.65 crore households. 2026-27 provision Rs 10,578 crore (PRS).	PRS
B4	Yuvanidhi: 3,93,358 candidates registered; 3,08,267 beneficiaries have received financial support.	ES
B5	Shakti (free bus travel for women): Rs 5,300 crore in 2025-26 BE (ES) and Rs 5,300 crore in 2026-27 BE (PRS).	PRS
B6	Anna Bhagya: Rs 6,426 crore (2025-26 BE, ES); Rs 7,700 crore listed in the Budget 2026-27 agriculture row (PRS). The two figures are for different years; do not quote one for the other's year.	PRS
B7	Women's and health: Menstrual Leave Policy: 1 day paid leave a month (max 12 days a year) for women employees aged 18-52 in registered establishments.	ES
B8	Health: MMR 97 (2015-17) to 68 (2021-23); IMR 28 (2015) to 14 (2023); U5MR 17; NMR 11 (SRS 2023).	ES
B9	Health: 9,058 Ayushman Arogya Kendras (Health & Wellness Centres) upgraded as of Dec 2025; Gruha Arogya screened 62,37,026 for hypertension/diabetes (Aug-Dec 2025).	ES
B10	Health: STEMI hub-and-spoke programme in 31 districts: 10,75,535 ECGs and 16,161 acute cases identified (Mar 2023 - Dec 2025).	ES
B11	Education: 70,392 schools in 2025-26 (21,864 lower primary; 29,519 upper primary; 19,009 secondary).	ES
B12	Education: GER 101.08% (lower primary) and 101.33% (upper primary) in 2025-26.	ES
B13	Skill: Karnataka State Skill Development Policy 2025 (CMKKY 2.0, bottom-up district skill plans); Tata Udyoga project upgraded 150 ITIs.	ES
B14	SC/ST: SCSP allocation Rs 29,991.69 crore (2025-26); TSP Rs 12,025.82 crore.	ES
B15	Rural: Jal Jeevan Mission tap connections rose from 24.51 lakh to 63.12 lakh (86.51% coverage); MGNREGA 680.35 lakh person-days to Dec 2025.	ES
B16	Rural housing: 47,60,879 houses built between 2000-01 and Dec 2025 under rural housing schemes.	ES
B17	Kalyana Karnataka: Kalyan Path scheme plans 1,150 km of roads in 38 constituencies at Rs 1,000 crore; Article 371(J) special status for the region (Survey text).	ES
B18	Water: Budget 2026-27 gives Rs 10,433 crore to Jal Jeevan Mission (PRS); sector expenditure on water supply and sanitation Rs 12,926 crore.	PRS

PEAK FACT: Of every Rs 100 of expected revenue receipts in 2026-27, Rs 59 is already committed: salaries 29, pensions 13, interest 17. Only Rs 41 is free for everything else, including new schemes.

COMMON TRAP: Mixing the Survey's 2025-26 guarantee figures with PRS's 2026-27 figures. They are different years (see the discrepancies section above).

RECAP: Five guarantees = about 12% of expenditure (PRS). Committed spending = 59% of revenue receipts. Social Welfare and Nutrition is the largest sector line in the 2026-27 Budget table.

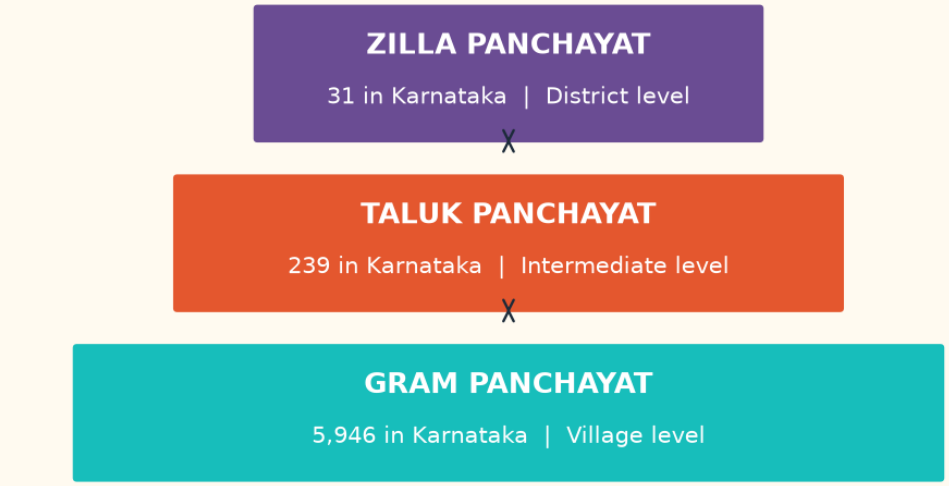
NEXT UP: Section C shows who delivers all this on the ground: panchayats and the digital state.

C. Governance and local government

Governance answers need an institution, a tool and a number. All items below are from the Survey's governance chapter or rural chapter.

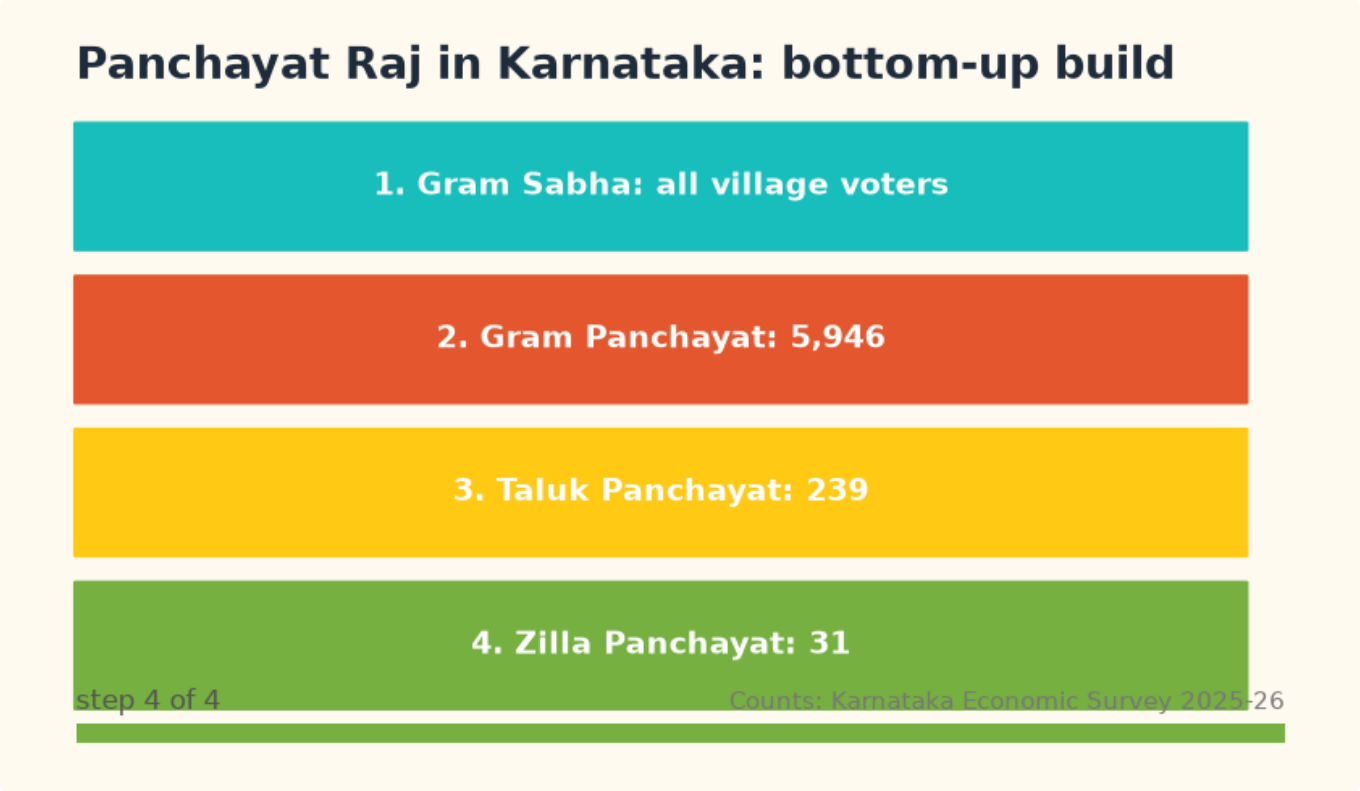
CHAI-TALK: Section C is delivery. A scheme is only as good as the office that carries it to the village. Start with the panchayat tiers, then the digital tools (Kutumba, Janaspandana, RTI portal) that let the State watch itself.

Panchayat Raj in Karnataka: exploded view



Below the GP: Gram Sabha = all registered voters of the village (people at the base).
Rural population is about 61% of the State (Survey).

Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary (counts); 73rd Amendment (Part IX)



Animation: `anim/anim_pr.gif` and `anim/anim_pr.mp4`.

#	Fact	Src
C1	Three-tier Panchayat Raj: 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats, 31 Zilla Panchayats; about 61% of population is rural.	ES
C2	Kutumba database integrates family-level data of 5.8 crore residents (about 90% of the population) for targeted welfare delivery.	ES
C3	Chief Minister Janaspandana: 9,725 grievances and 12,838 petitions with over 99% resolution; District Janaspandana: 71,385 grievances, 97.94% resolved.	ES
C4	RTI online portal: over 2,47,444 applications received, 1,82,201 disposed; 50,691 first appeals.	ES
C5	Aadhaar as a Service: 97 departments, over 29.8 crore transactions in Jan-Dec 2025.	ES
C6	Anupalana portal: real-time Action Taken Reports; CMS v4.0 with AI-based English-Kannada translation.	ES
C7	Kartavya attendance system: 1,19,539 employees onboarded, using AI and GIS.	ES
C8	State Data Centre hosts 535+ applications and 555 web portals at 99.95% uptime; KSWAN 2.0 connects about 8,500 offices.	ES
C9	Karnataka ranked first nationally in National Academic Depository implementation (6.4 crore records).	ES
C10	e-Governance department allocation Rs 11,061.91 crore in 2025-26; Rs 7,262.77 crore spent by Dec 2025.	ES
C11	Online counselling-based transfers for 1,574 Panchayat Development Officers, 894 Secretaries and 402 SDAs (a first); mandatory transfer after 5 years in one GP.	ES
C12	Property tax: Android PoS machines in all 5,946 GPs enabled Rs 1,313 crore collection.	ES

PEAK FACT: 5,946 Gram Panchayats, 239 Taluk Panchayats, 31 Zilla Panchayats, and about 61% of Karnataka's population is rural. The base of the pyramid is the widest, and so should be your answer's base: Gram Sabha first.

COMMON TRAP: Writing 'Gram Sabha = Gram Panchayat'. The Gram Sabha is all the registered voters of the village; the Gram Panchayat is the elected body.

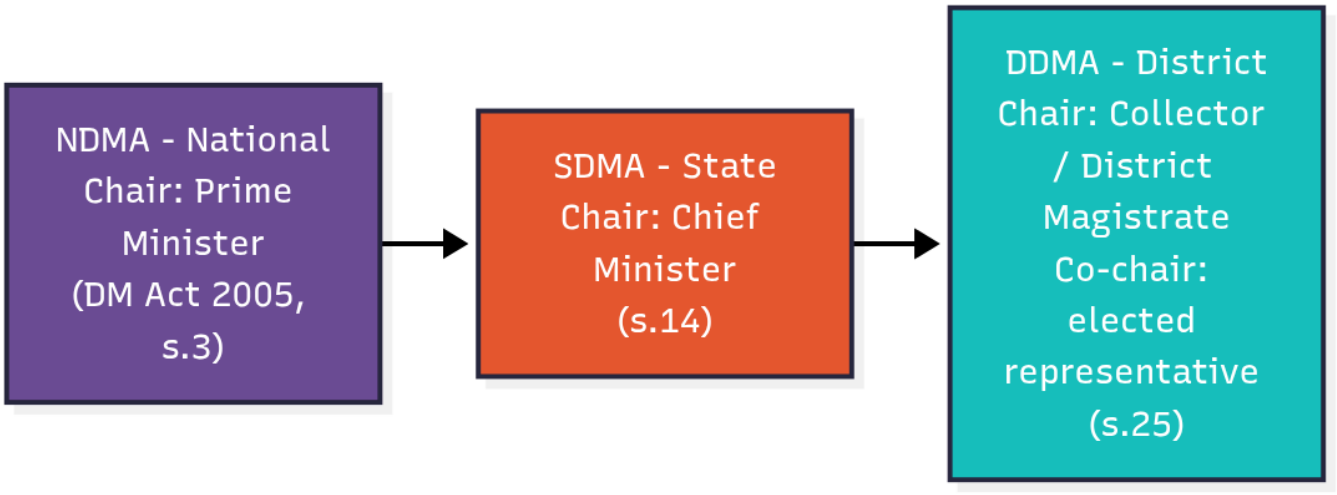
RECAP: 3 tiers (5,946 / 239 / 31). Digital delivery: Kutumba, Janaspandana, RTI portal, Aadhaar as a Service.

NEXT UP: Section D: what happens when delivery meets a disaster.

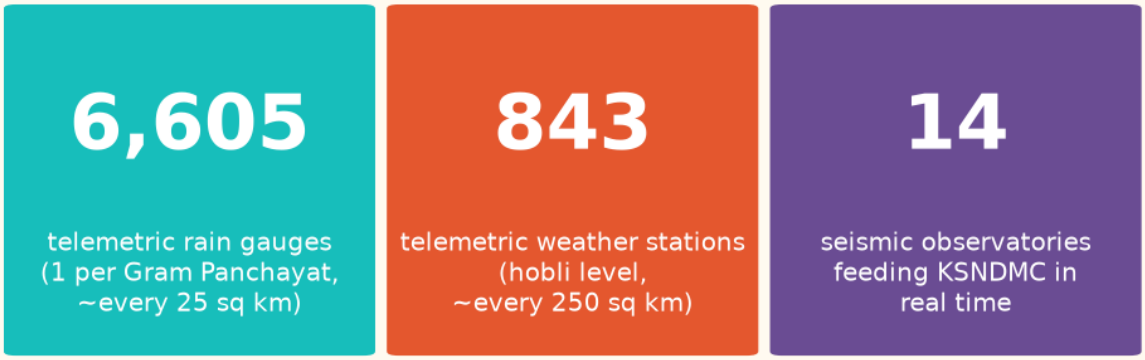
D. Disaster management

Legal frame (national) plus the State's monitoring system. For Karnataka numbers, the source is the Survey's environmental management section.

CHAI-TALK: Disaster management is a ladder: a national authority, a State authority, a district authority, each chaired by the person with the power to call the shots. Learn the ladder, then add Karnataka's early-warning eyes (KSNDMC).

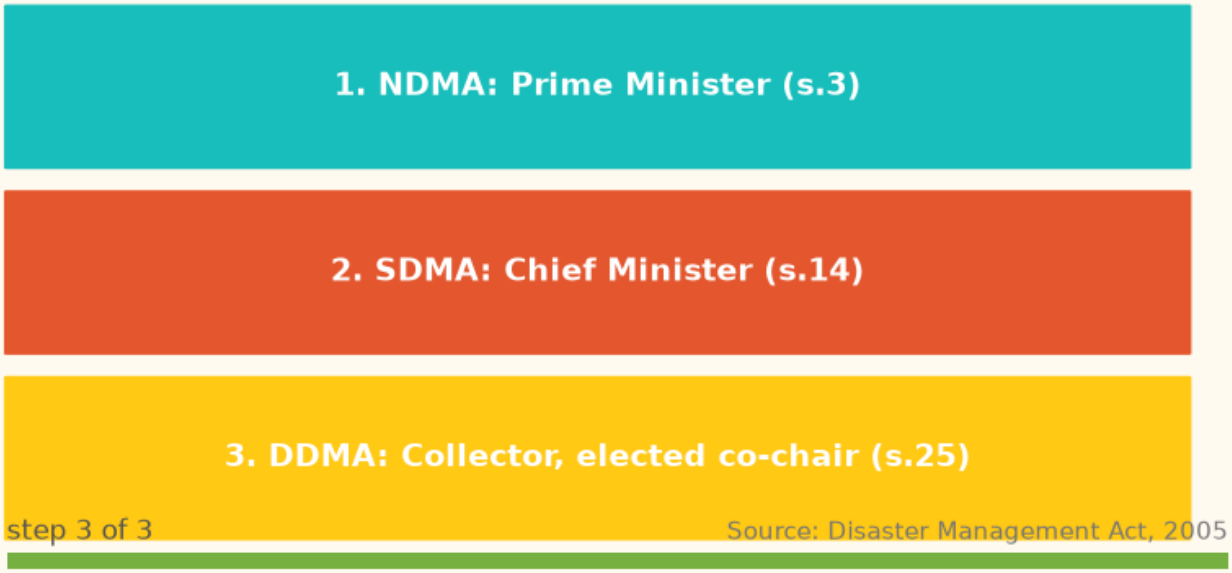


KSNDMC: Karnataka's early-warning eyes



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26, Exec. Summary

Disaster Management Act 2005: who chairs what



Animation: `anim/anim_dm.gif` and `anim/anim_dm.mp4`.

#	Fact	Src
D1	Disaster Management Act, 2005: the Prime Minister chairs the National Disaster Management Authority (s.3); the Chief Minister chairs the State Disaster Management Authority (s.14); the District Collector/Magistrate chairs the District Authority with an elected local representative as co-chair (s.25).	DMA
D2	KSNDMC runs 6,605 telemetric rain gauges (one per Gram Panchayat, about every 25 sq. km) and 843 telemetric weather stations (hobli level, about every 250 sq. km); data every 15 minutes; Survey calls the network the densest in the country.	ES
D3	Flood forecast: dedicated Flood Forecast Cell at KSNDMC; Bengaluru flood system has 100 telemetric rain gauges, 12 weather stations, 26 water-level sensors; app 'Bengaluru Meghasandesha'.	ES
D4	Seismic: KSNDMC's Master Control Facility receives real-time data from 14 remote observatories; events are SMS-alerted to district, taluk, GP and dam authorities.	ES
D5	Agro-met: 'Varuna Mitra' 24x7 help desk registered 11.43 lakh calls in 2025.	ES
D6	Weather data is used for the State crop insurance scheme (a risk-transfer mechanism).	ES
D7	Dam safety: all 33 spillway gates of Tungabhadra reservoir being replaced after Gate No. 19 was washed away; DRIP Phase II & III cover 58 dams; Dam Safety Act, 2021.	ES
D8	Krishi Bhagya under the State Disaster Mitigation Fund (SDMF): Rs 100 crore for 5,482 packages in 223 taluks; 4,529 farm ponds built up to Dec 2025.	ES
D9	Human-wildlife conflict relief: ex-gratia raised to Rs 20 lakh for loss of human life (2025-26); 428 km of railway barricades, 1,360.87 km solar fencing, 1,775.41 km elephant-proof trenches.	ES

PEAK FACT: PM chairs the NDMA (s.3), CM chairs the SDMA (s.14), the Collector chairs the DDMA with an elected representative as co-chair (s.25). Three sections, three chairs.

COMMON TRAP: Saying the Collector alone runs the district authority. The Act gives the DDMA an elected co-chair.

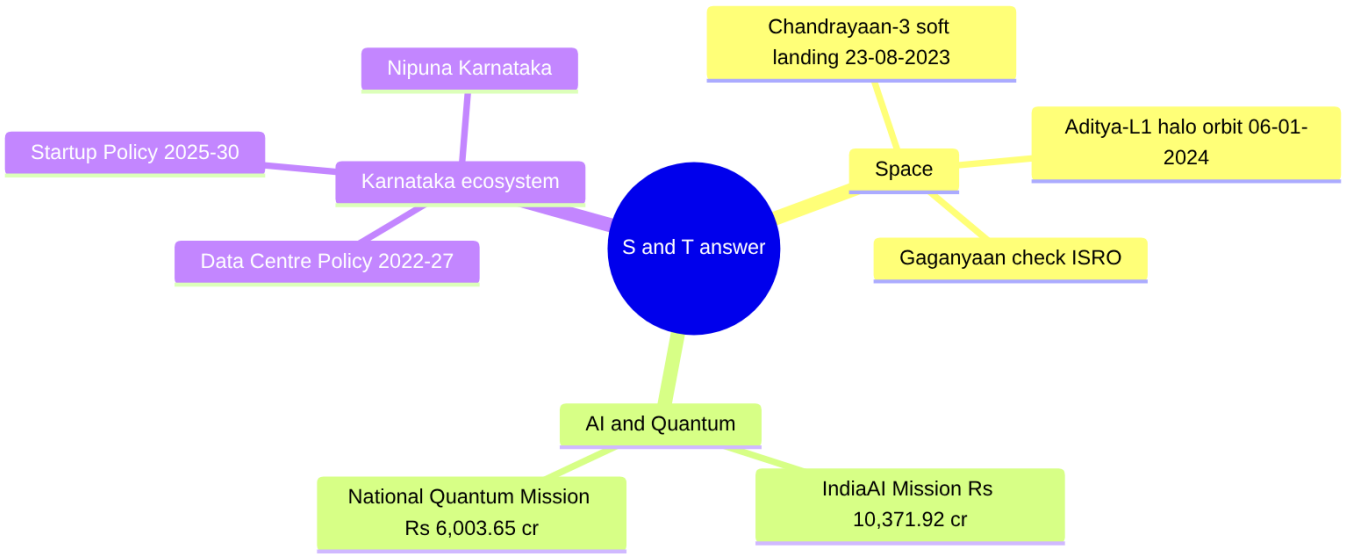
RECAP: Law (DM Act 2005); sensors (6,605 rain gauges, 843 weather stations, 14 seismic observatories); mitigation spending (Krishi Bhagya under the SDMF).

NEXT UP: Section E: science and technology.

E. Science and technology

National programmes (web-verified at pib.gov.in / isro.gov.in) and Karnataka's technology ecosystem (Survey).

CHAI-TALK: Section E is short but high-value for GS3: four national anchors (IndiaAI, Quantum, Chandrayaan-3, Aditya-L1) plus Karnataka's tech ecosystem. Gaganyaan: always check the latest status on isro.gov.in before quoting.



#	Fact	Src
E1	IndiaAI Mission outlay Rs 10,371.92 crore, approved by the Cabinet in March 2024.	PIB
E2	National Quantum Mission outlay Rs 6,003.65 crore for 2023-24 to 2030-31.	PIB

#	Fact	Src
E3	Chandrayaan-3: Vikram lander soft-landed on the Moon on 23 August 2023, followed by Pragyan rover deployment.	ISRO
E4	Aditya-L1: inserted into halo orbit around the Sun-Earth L1 point on 6 January 2024 (about 1.5 million km from Earth).	ISRO
E5	Karnataka Data Centre Policy 2022-27: capacity 245.5 MW, past the initial 200 MW target.	ES
E6	Nipuna Karnataka (launched 24 September 2024, Rs 100 crore): upskilling in IT, biotechnology, AI, data science, cybersecurity.	ES
E7	Startup Policy 2025-30 outlay about Rs 518.27 crore, focus on AI, blockchain, quantum computing and deep-tech.	ES
E8	144 Software Technology Park units approved; 93 foreign-equity companies invested Rs 668.86 crore in IT & BT (Dec 2025).	ES
E9	EV Cluster project in the Bengaluru region received Rs 25 crore in 2025-26.	ES
E10	Education technology: Kalika Deepa uses AI-based tools for reading and maths in 1,145 government primary schools (1,44,062 students).	ES
E11	Gaganyaan: ISRO's crewed programme; the first uncrewed flight (G1) was officially targeted for 2026. Check isro.gov.in before the exam for the current status.	ISRO

PEAK FACT: 23 August 2023: Chandrayaan-3's Vikram lander soft-landed on the Moon. 6 January 2024: Aditya-L1 reached its halo orbit. Two dates, two lines in every space answer.

COMMON TRAP: Writing 'Gaganyaan will launch in 2026' as a fact. The official status is only a target; check before you write it.

RECAP: National missions (AI, Quantum, space) + State ecosystem (Data Centre Policy, Startup Policy, Nipuna Karnataka).

NEXT UP: Deliverable 3 uses these facts inside 40 model answers.

Deliverable 7 - Kannada and English qualifying practice

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | for the two qualifying papers: Kannada 150 marks and English 150 marks

Library progress: Deliverable 7 of 8 (nearly there)

CHAI-TALK: These two papers never add to your rank, but each has a 52.5-mark gate (35% of 150). Think of them as the security check at the airport: you do not win anything by passing it, but you cannot board without it. Good news: the standard is first-language SSLC level, so steady daily practice clears it comfortably.

COMMON TRAP: Native-review flag. All practice material below is written by me for practice, in my own words. The Kannada passages, keys and model answers have **not** been reviewed by a native-speaker teacher. Before you rely on any Kannada key, have a Kannada teacher read it; use the review checklist at the end.

1. What the official scheme says (and what is my reading)

Point	Detail	Source
Marks and time	150 marks each, 2 hours each	KPSC notification 31-07-2026, para 12.6
Gate	At least 35% = 52.5 marks in each paper; the marks are not counted for merit; below the gate, no personality test	same, notes (1)
Standard	First-language Kannada and first-language English at SSLC level	same, note (4)
English items (25 marks each)	Comprehension, precis, usage, vocabulary, short essay, communication skills	KAS 2015 gazette (Karnataka Gazette 08-01-2015)
Kannada items (25 marks each)	Comprehension of a passage, word usage, precis, vocabulary, short essay, English-to-Kannada translation	same; the Kannada list was decoded from legacy-font text, so confirm with a native reader

Time plan for each 2-hour paper: six items, so about 18 minutes each, with 12 minutes for a final check. Do the item you find easiest first.

2. Part A: English practice set (one full mock paper plus keys)

A1. Comprehension (25 marks: five questions of 5 marks)

Passage 1: The tea stall at the bus stand

Every morning, before the first bus leaves Hosahalli, Lakshmi opens her small tea stall near the bus stand. She lights the stove, boils the milk and arranges the glasses in neat rows. By seven o'clock the stand is busy: farmers carrying vegetables, students with heavy bags, clerks hurrying to the taluk office. Lakshmi knows nearly everyone by name, and she remembers how each person likes his tea.

Ten years ago she had no shop at all. After her husband's illness, she took a small loan from a women's self-help group in her village and bought a stove and a few vessels. The group's members met every month, saved a little money together, and lent it to each other at low interest. Lakshmi repaid her loan in two years, and today she also lends to other women who wish to start small businesses.

When people praise her success, Lakshmi smiles and says that the loan was only a beginning. "The real help," she says, "was knowing that twenty women trusted me."

Questions

1. By what time does the bus stand become busy?
2. How did Lakshmi begin her business?
3. Explain how the self-help group works.
4. What does Lakshmi do for others now?

5. What does Lakshmi mean when she says that the real help was knowing that twenty women trusted her?

> **DRAW IT:** Answer in full sentences, in your own words, and quote the passage only for short phrases. One or two sentences per answer is enough; marks go for being correct and complete.

Key

1. By seven o'clock.
2. After her husband's illness, she took a small loan from a women's self-help group and bought a stove and a few vessels.
3. Members meet every month, save a little money together and lend it to each other at low interest.
4. She lends money to other women who want to start small businesses.
5. The money mattered, but the trust of the group mattered more: it gave her confidence and support. (Accept any answer that puts trust or confidence above the money.)

A2. Precis (25 marks)

Rules in one line: a third of the length, past tense is not needed, third person, no opinions, a title, and no new facts.

Passage 2: (about 175 words; aim for a precis of about 55-60 words, one third of the length)

Listening is perhaps the most neglected of all the skills we use at work and at home. We spend years learning to read and write, yet hardly any time learning to listen. Most people listen only to reply, not to understand. While the other person is still speaking, they are already preparing what they will say next, and so they miss half of the message.

Good listening needs three habits. The first is attention: putting aside the phone and looking at the speaker. The second is patience: letting the speaker finish without interruption, even when we disagree. The third is checking: repeating the main point in our own words to make sure we have understood it correctly.

An officer who listens to a complaint carefully can often solve it in minutes, whereas one who does not listen may spend days dealing with the anger that follows. In the same way, a student who listens in class saves hours of private study. Listening costs nothing, but its returns are large.

Model precis

Title: The value of listening

Listening is a neglected but vital skill, because most people listen only to reply, not to understand. Good listening needs attention (putting the phone aside), patience (not interrupting) and checking (restating the main point). It helps officers settle complaints quickly and helps students save hours of study. It costs nothing, yet its returns are large.

Marking guide (25): main ideas 10, length (about a third, give or take a few words) 5, own words and clear language 10.

A3. Usage (25 marks: ten items; score each 2.5)

Choose or correct as asked.

1. Each of the students (have / has) submitted the form.
2. She is senior (than / to) me in the office.
3. He has been working here (since / for) five years.
4. I saw (a / an) elephant near the lake.
5. The news (are / is) true.
6. If it (rains / will rain) tomorrow, the match will be cancelled.
7. Correct the sentence: She doesn't know nothing about it.
8. The clerk is accountable ___ the Tahsildar. (fill the preposition)
9. By the time we reached, the film (has started / had started).
10. Change to passive voice: The committee approved the plan.

Key and why

No.	Answer	Why
1	has	"Each" takes a singular verb
2	to	"Senior to", "junior to", "superior to": no "than"
3	for	"For" + a period of time; "since" + a point in time
4	an	Vowel sound at the start of "elephant"
5	is	"News" is uncountable and singular
6	rains	Present tense in an "if" clause for a future condition
7	She doesn't know anything about it.	Avoid a double negative
8	to	"Accountable to" a person; "accountable for" a thing
9	had started	Past perfect: the film started before "we reached"
10	The plan was approved by the committee.	Object becomes subject; "was" + past participle

A4. Vocabulary (25 marks: five items each of five parts)

Part	Question	Key
Synonyms	abundant, diligent, conceal, transparent, frugal	plentiful; hardworking; hide; clear or open; thrifty
Antonyms	scarce, ancient, expand, hostile, temporary	abundant; modern; contract; friendly; permanent
One word for	a person who loves books; a place where birds are kept; one who walks in sleep; fear of closed spaces; government by the people	bibliophile; aviary; somnambulist; claustrophobia; democracy
Idioms (give the meaning)	a blessing in disguise; to burn the midnight oil; once in a blue moon; a piece of cake; to break the ice	a misfortune that turns out good; to study or work late; very rarely; very easy; to start a conversation in an awkward setting
Meaning in a sentence	diligent, frugal, hostile, abundant, conceal	write your own sentence for each; example: A diligent student revises every day.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** Learn five new words a day with one sentence of your own each. Words learnt in a sentence stay; words learnt in a list leave.

A5. Short essay (25 marks; about 150 words)

Practice topics (pick one a day): (a) Why libraries still matter; (b) A day without electricity; (c) Road safety is everyone's duty; (d) The use and misuse of the mobile phone.

Model essay (a), about 150 words

In an age of smartphones, it is easy to believe that libraries have lost their purpose. Yet a good library offers what a screen cannot: silence, order and trusted knowledge. A student from a small town can read the same books as a student in a big city, free of cost. For job-seekers, a library is a place to prepare for examinations without paying for expensive guides. For children, it is the first door to the world of stories.

Libraries also bring people together. Reading clubs, story hours and newspaper corners make a quiet public space where people of all ages and incomes sit side by side.

Of course, libraries must change with the times. They need Wi-Fi, digital catalogues and books in Kannada and English. But their core promise remains the same: knowledge for everyone. A town that supports its libraries is investing in its people, and that is an investment that never loses value.

Marking guide (25): content and ideas 10, organisation (intro, body, conclusion) 5, language and grammar 10.

A6. Communication skills (25 marks)

Task: Write a formal letter to the Executive Officer of your town municipal council. Complain that garbage has not been collected from your street for a week, and request prompt action.

Format checklist: sender's address; date; receiver's designation and address; subject line; salutation; body in three short paragraphs (the problem, the effect, the request); complimentary close; signature and name.

Model letter

12, Gandhi Road
Ramapura
15 November 2026

The Executive Officer
Town Municipal Council
Ramapura

Subject: Request to clear uncollected garbage on Gandhi Road

Sir,

I write to bring to your notice that garbage has not been collected from Gandhi Road for the past seven days. The bins are overflowing and waste is lying on the road.

This has caused a foul smell and attracts stray animals and flies. Children and elderly residents are at risk of illness, and the rains may worsen the situation.

I request you to direct the sanitation staff to clear the garbage at once and to ensure regular collection in future. I shall be grateful for your prompt action.

Yours faithfully,
(signature)
R. Meena

Second task for another day: draft a notice, in 50 words, for a village meeting about a drinking water scheme (include the date, time, place and agenda).

Marking guide (25): format 8, content and tone 10, language 7.

3. Part B: Kannada practice set (full mock paper plus keys)

> **COMMON TRAP:** Native-review flag again. Everything in Part B needs a Kannada teacher's check before you trust the keys.

B1. ಗದ್ಯ ಗ್ರಹಿಕೆ (comprehension, 25 marks: five questions of 5 marks)

ಗದ್ಯಭಾಗ: ಕೆರೆ ನಮ್ಮ ಹಳ್ಳಿಯ ಜೀವಾಳ

ಕೆರೆ ನಮ್ಮ ಹಳ್ಳಿಯ ಜೀವಾಳ. ಹಿಂದಿನ ಕಾಲದಲ್ಲಿ ನಮ್ಮ ಪೂರ್ವಿಕರು ಮಳೆ ನೀರನ್ನು ಸಂಗ್ರಹಿಸಲು ಊರಿನ ಸುತ್ತ ಕೆರೆಗಳನ್ನು ಕಟ್ಟಿಸಿದರು. ಈ ಕೆರೆಗಳಿಂದ ರೈತರು ಬೆಳೆಗೆ ನೀರು ಪಡೆಯುತ್ತಿದ್ದರು; ಜಾನುವಾರುಗಳು ನೀರು ಕುಡಿಯುತ್ತಿದ್ದವು; ಅಂತರ್ಜಲವೂ ಹೆಚ್ಚುತ್ತಿತ್ತು. ಹಬ್ಬದ ದಿನಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಕೆರೆಯ ದಡದಲ್ಲಿ ಊರಿನವರೆಲ್ಲ ಸೇರುತ್ತಿದ್ದರು. ಆದರೆ ಇತ್ತೀಚಿನ ವರ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಅನೇಕ ಕೆರೆಗಳು ಕಸದಿಂದ ತುಂಬಿವೆ; ಕೆಲವು ಕಡೆ ಕೆರೆಯ ಜಾಗದಲ್ಲಿ ಕಟ್ಟಡಗಳು ಎದ್ದಿವೆ. ಇದರಿಂದ ಮಳೆ ನೀರು ನಿಲ್ಲದೆ ಹರಿದುಹೋಗುತ್ತದೆ, ಬೇಸಿಗೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ನೀರಿನ ಕೊರತೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚುತ್ತದೆ. ಈಗ ಕೆಲವು ಗ್ರಾಮಗಳ ಜನರು ಒಟ್ಟಾಗಿ ಕೆರೆಯ ಹೂಳನ್ನು ತೆಗೆದು, ಅದನ್ನು ಮತ್ತೆ ಜೀವಂತಗೊಳಿಸುತ್ತಿದ್ದಾರೆ. ಕೆರೆಯನ್ನು ಉಳಿಸುವುದು ಎಲ್ಲರ ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ.

ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆಗಳು

1. ಪೂರ್ವಿಕರು ಕೆರೆಗಳನ್ನು ಏಕೆ ಕಟ್ಟಿಸಿದರು?
2. ಕೆರೆಗಳಿಂದ ಆಗುತ್ತಿದ್ದ ಎರಡು ಪ್ರಯೋಜನಗಳನ್ನು ಬರೆಯಿರಿ.
3. ಇತ್ತೀಚಿನ ವರ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಕೆರೆಗಳಿಗೆ ಯಾವ ತೊಂದರೆ ಬಂದಿದೆ?
4. ಕೆರೆಯನ್ನು ಮತ್ತೆ ಜೀವಂತಗೊಳಿಸುವ ಕೆಲಸವನ್ನು ಯಾರು ಮಾಡುತ್ತಿದ್ದಾರೆ?
5. ಈ ಪದಗಳ ಅರ್ಥ ಬರೆಯಿರಿ: ಅಂತರ್ಜಲ, ಪೂರ್ವಿಕರು.

ಉತ್ತರ ಸೂಚಿ (key)

1. ಮಳೆ ನೀರನ್ನು ಸಂಗ್ರಹಿಸಲು. (To store rainwater.)
2. ರೈತರಿಗೆ ಬೆಳೆಗೆ ನೀರು ಸಿಗುತ್ತಿತ್ತು; ಜಾನುವಾರುಗಳಿಗೆ ಕುಡಿಯುವ ನೀರು ಸಿಗುತ್ತಿತ್ತು; ಅಂತರ್ಜಲ ಹೆಚ್ಚುತ್ತಿತ್ತು. (ಯಾವುದಾದರೂ ಎರಡು) (Any two: water for crops, drinking water for cattle, more groundwater.)
3. ಅನೇಕ ಕೆರೆಗಳು ಕಸದಿಂದ ತುಂಬಿವೆ; ಕೆಲವು ಕಡೆ ಕೆರೆಯ ಜಾಗದಲ್ಲಿ ಕಟ್ಟಡಗಳು ಎದ್ದಿವೆ. (Many tanks are filled with garbage, and in some places buildings have come up on tank land.)

4. ಕೆಲವು ಗ್ರಾಮಗಳ ಜನರು ಒಟ್ಟಾಗಿ ಹೂಳು ತೆಗೆದು ಮತ್ತೆ ಜೀವಂತಗೊಳಿಸುತ್ತಿದ್ದಾರೆ. (The people of some villages, working together to remove the silt.)
5. ಅಂತರ್ಜಲ = ನೆಲದ ಕೆಳಗಿರುವ ನೀರು; ಪೂರ್ವಿಕರು = ಹಿಂದಿನ ತಲೆಮಾರಿನ ಹಿರಿಯರು. (Groundwater = water under the ground; ancestors = elders of earlier generations.)

B2. ಪದ ಪ್ರಯೋಗ (word usage, 25 marks: five words of 5 marks)

ಈ ಪದಗಳನ್ನು ನಿಮ್ಮ ಸ್ವಂತ ವಾಕ್ಯಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಬಳಸಿ: ಸಂಗ್ರಹ, ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ, ಕೊರತೆ, ಪರಿಸರ, ಪ್ರಯೋಜನ.

ಮಾದರಿ ವಾಕ್ಯಗಳು (sample key)

- ಸಂಗ್ರಹ: ನಾನು ಹಳೆಯ ನಾಣ್ಯಗಳ ಸಂಗ್ರಹ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. (I collect old coins.)
- ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ: ಶಾಲೆಗೆ ಸರಿಯಾದ ಸಮಯಕ್ಕೆ ಬರುವುದು ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿಯ ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ. (Coming to school on time is a student's duty.)
- ಕೊರತೆ: ಬೇಸಿಗೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಊರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ನೀರಿನ ಕೊರತೆ ಉಂಟಾಯಿತು. (There was a shortage of water in the village in summer.)
- ಪರಿಸರ: ಪರಿಸರವನ್ನು ಸ್ವಚ್ಛವಾಗಿ ಇಡಬೇಕು. (The environment must be kept clean.)
- ಪ್ರಯೋಜನ: ಪುಸ್ತಕ ಓದುವುದರಿಂದ ಬಹಳ ಪ್ರಯೋಜನವಿದೆ. (Reading books is very beneficial.)

Marking: the word used correctly in a complete sentence with correct meaning = 5; right meaning with a spelling or grammar slip = 3; wrong meaning = 0.

B3. ಸಂಗ್ರಹ ಬರಹ (precis, 25 marks)

ಗದ್ಯಭಾಗ (about a third of the length is expected in the precis)

ಓದುವ ಹವ್ಯಾಸ ಮನುಷ್ಯನ ಜ್ಞಾನವನ್ನು ಹೆಚ್ಚಿಸುತ್ತದೆ. ಪುಸ್ತಕಗಳು ನಮಗೆ ಹೊಸ ವಿಚಾರಗಳನ್ನು ಕಲಿಸುತ್ತವೆ; ಹಳೆಯ ಕಾಲದ ಜನರ ಜೀವನವನ್ನೂ ದೂರದ ದೇಶಗಳ ಸಂಸ್ಕೃತಿಯನ್ನೂ ಪರಿಚಯಿಸುತ್ತವೆ. ಗ್ರಂಥಾಲಯಗಳು ಎಲ್ಲರಿಗೂ ಪುಸ್ತಕಗಳನ್ನು ಓದಲು ಅವಕಾಶ ನೀಡುತ್ತವೆ. ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಪುಸ್ತಕ ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಸ್ನೇಹಿತನಂತೆ ಯಾವಾಗಲೂ ನಮ್ಮ ಜೊತೆಗಿರುತ್ತದೆ. ಓದುವವನ ಭಾಷೆ ಸುಧಾರಿಸುತ್ತದೆ, ಮಾತಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಆತ್ಮವಿಶ್ವಾಸ ಬೆಳೆಯುತ್ತದೆ. ಇಂದು ಮೊಬೈಲ್ ಮತ್ತು ದೂರದರ್ಶನದ ಪ್ರಭಾವದಿಂದ ಯುವಕರು ಪುಸ್ತಕಗಳಿಂದ ದೂರವಾಗುತ್ತಿದ್ದಾರೆ. ಇದು ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಬೆಳವಣಿಗೆ ಅಲ್ಲ. ಪ್ರತಿದಿನ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಸಮಯವನ್ನಾದರೂ ಓದಿಗೆ ಮೀಸಲಿಟ್ಟರೆ ಜೀವನ ಸಮೃದ್ಧವಾಗುತ್ತದೆ.

ಮಾದರಿ ಸಂಗ್ರಹ (model precis)

ಶೀರ್ಷಿಕೆ: ಓದಿನ ಮಹತ್ವ

ಓದುವ ಹವ್ಯಾಸ ಜ್ಞಾನ, ಭಾಷೆ ಮತ್ತು ಆತ್ಮವಿಶ್ವಾಸವನ್ನು ಬೆಳೆಸುತ್ತದೆ. ಮೊಬೈಲ್ ಮತ್ತು ದೂರದರ್ಶನದಿಂದ ಯುವಕರು ಓದಿನಿಂದ ದೂರವಾಗುತ್ತಿರುವುದು ಸರಿಯಲ್ಲ. ದಿನವೂ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಓದಿದರೆ ಜೀವನ ಸಮೃದ್ಧವಾಗುತ್ತದೆ.

(Gloss: Reading builds knowledge, language and confidence. It is not right that young people are drifting from reading because of mobile phones and television. A little reading each day enriches life.)

Marking guide (25): main ideas 10, length 5, language 10.

B4. ಶಬ್ದ ಸಂಪತ್ತು (vocabulary, 25 marks)

ಭಾಗ	ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆ	ಉತ್ತರ ಸೂಚಿ
ಸಮಾನಾರ್ಥಕ ಪದ	ಕಾಡು, ನೀರು, ಸೂರ್ಯ, ಹೂವು, ಮನೆ	ಅರಣ್ಯ; ಜಲ; ರವಿ; ಪುಷ್ಪ; ಗೃಹ
ವಿರುದ್ಧಾರ್ಥಕ ಪದ	ಬೆಳಕು, ಹಗಲು, ಸತ್ಯ, ಸುಖ, ಹೊಸ	ಕತ್ತಲೆ; ರಾತ್ರಿ; ಸುಳ್ಳು; ದುಃಖ; ಹಳೆಯ
ಗಾದೆ ವಿವರಿಸಿ	ಕೈ ಕೆಸರಾದರೆ ಬಾಯಿ ಮೊಸರು	ದುಡಿದರೆ ಫಲ ಸಿಗುತ್ತದೆ (hard work brings reward)
ಗಾದೆ ವಿವರಿಸಿ	ಹನಿಹನಿ ಕೂಡಿದರೆ ಹಳ್ಳ	ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಕೂಡಿಸಿದರೆ ದೊಡ್ಡದಾಗುತ್ತದೆ (small things add up)
ಗಾದೆ ವಿವರಿಸಿ	ಅತಿ ಆಸೆ ಗತಿಗೇಡು	ಅತಿಯಾಸೆ ನಾಶಕ್ಕೆ ಕಾರಣ (too much greed ends in ruin)

Marking: 5 marks for each of the five rows, one mark per correct answer.

B5. ಪ್ರಬಂಧ (short essay, 25 marks; 100 to 150 words)

ವಿಷಯಗಳು (topics): (ಅ) ಜಲ ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆ; (ಆ) ಕನ್ನಡ ಭಾಷೆಯ ಹಿರಿಮೆ; (ಇ) ಮೊಬೈಲ್ ಫೋನ್: ವರವೋ ಶಾಪವೋ; (ಈ) ನನ್ನ ಊರಿನ ಜಾತ್ರೆ.

ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ: ಜಲ ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆ

ನೀರು ಜೀವನದ ಆಧಾರ. ನೀರಿಲ್ಲದೆ ಮನುಷ್ಯ, ಪ್ರಾಣಿ, ಸಸ್ಯ ಯಾರೂ ಬದುಕಲಾರರು. ಆದರೂ ನಾವು ನೀರನ್ನು ಅನಗತ್ಯವಾಗಿ ವ್ಯರ್ಥ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇವೆ. ಜನಸಂಖ್ಯೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿದಂತೆ ನೀರಿನ ಬೇಡಿಕೆಯೂ ಹೆಚ್ಚುತ್ತಿದೆ, ಆದರೆ ಕೆರೆ-ಬಾವಿಗಳು ಬತ್ತುತ್ತಿವೆ. ಮಳೆ ನೀರು ಕೊಯ್ಲು ಮಾಡುವುದು, ಕೆರೆಗಳನ್ನು ಉಳಿಸುವುದು, ಹನಿ ನೀರಾವರಿ ಬಳಸುವುದು ಮತ್ತು ನಲ್ಲಿಗಳನ್ನು ಸರಿಯಾಗಿ ಮುಚ್ಚುವುದು ನಾವು ಮಾಡಬಹುದಾದ ಕೆಲಸಗಳು. ಸರ್ಕಾರ ಮತ್ತು ಜನರು ಕೈಜೋಡಿಸಿದರೆ ಮಾತ್ರ ಮುಂದಿನ ಪೀಳಿಗೆಗೆ ನೀರು ಉಳಿಯುತ್ತದೆ. ಹನಿ ನೀರೂ ಅಮೂಲ್ಯ ಎಂಬ ಅರಿವು ಎಲ್ಲರಲ್ಲಿ ಮೂಡಲಿ.

(Gloss: water is the basis of life; we waste it; demand grows while tanks and wells dry up; harvest rainwater, save tanks, use drip irrigation, close taps; government and people together; every drop is precious.)

Marking guide (25): content 10, organisation 5, language and spelling 10.

B6. ಇಂಗ್ಲಿಷ್‌ನಿಂದ ಕನ್ನಡಕ್ಕೆ ಅನುವಾದ (translation, 25 marks)

Translate into Kannada

Passage (a): Karnataka is known for its rich culture. Every village has a fair and festivals. Farmers work hard to grow crops. We should respect them and protect our environment.

Passage (b): The Deputy Commissioner has ordered a survey of the tanks in the district. The report must be submitted within one month.

Model translation

(a) ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ತನ್ನ ಶ್ರೀಮಂತ ಸಂಸ್ಕೃತಿಗೆ ಹೆಸರುವಾಸಿಯಾಗಿದೆ. ಪ್ರತಿ ಹಳ್ಳಿಯಲ್ಲಿಯೂ ಜಾತ್ರೆ ಮತ್ತು ಹಬ್ಬಗಳು ನಡೆಯುತ್ತವೆ. ರೈತರು ಬೆಳೆ ಬೆಳೆಯಲು ಕಷ್ಟಪಟ್ಟು ದುಡಿಯುತ್ತಾರೆ. ನಾವು ಅವರನ್ನು ಗೌರವಿಸಬೇಕು ಮತ್ತು ನಮ್ಮ ಪರಿಸರವನ್ನು ಕಾಪಾಡಬೇಕು.

(b) ಜಿಲ್ಲಾಧಿಕಾರಿಗಳು ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಯ ಕೆರೆಗಳ ಸಮೀಕ್ಷೆ ನಡೆಸಲು ಆದೇಶಿಸಿದ್ದಾರೆ. ವರದಿಯನ್ನು ಒಂದು ತಿಂಗಳೊಳಗೆ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬೇಕು.

Marking guide (25): meaning kept 12, grammar and word order 8, spelling and style 5. Translate sense by sense, not word by word. A translation can differ from the model and still score full marks.

4. Scoring your mock paper

Item	English	Kannada
1. Comprehension	___ / 25	___ / 25
2. Precis (English) / word usage (Kannada)	___ / 25	___ / 25
3. Usage (English) / precis (Kannada)	___ / 25	___ / 25
4. Vocabulary	___ / 25	___ / 25
5. Short essay	___ / 25	___ / 25
6. Communication skills (English) / translation (Kannada)	___ / 25	___ / 25
Total	___ / 150	___ / 150
Gate (52.5)	pass / fail	pass / fail

Note: the order of the items in the English paper follows the gazette (comprehension, precis, usage, vocabulary, short essay, communication). In the Kannada paper the gazette order is comprehension, word usage, precis, vocabulary, short essay, translation, which is the order of Part B above, so the table's rows 2 and 3 are listed in the English order for English and the Kannada order for Kannada.

> **PEAK FACT:** 52.5 out of 150 is about 12.5 marks in each of the six items. Even a very ordinary paper clears that gate if you attempt every item. The biggest risk is leaving an item blank.

4-week plan (chunked so it never feels heavy)

Week	Daily 30 minutes	Weekend (1 hour)
1	One passage and its questions, alternate days Kannada and English	Full mock of one language
2	Five new words with sentences; one precis	Full mock of the other language
3	One short essay; one letter or translation	Both mocks, marked
4	Fix the weakest item only	Final mock and the 52.5 check

5. Native-review checklist (must be done before trusting Part B)

- Spelling and sandhi of each Kannada passage and key.
- Whether each key answer is acceptable in standard written Kannada.
- Whether the marks per item match the actual paper (the paper's official instructions govern).
- Whether the vocabulary words suit the SSLC first-language level.
- Whether the English-to-Kannada model translation reads naturally.

RECAP: (1) Both papers are a gate, not a rank: 52.5 in each. (2) Six items of 25 marks each. (3) Attempt every item. (4) Part B needs a native Kannada teacher's check.

NEXT UP: Deliverable 8 shows how to mark yourself and spot the leak.

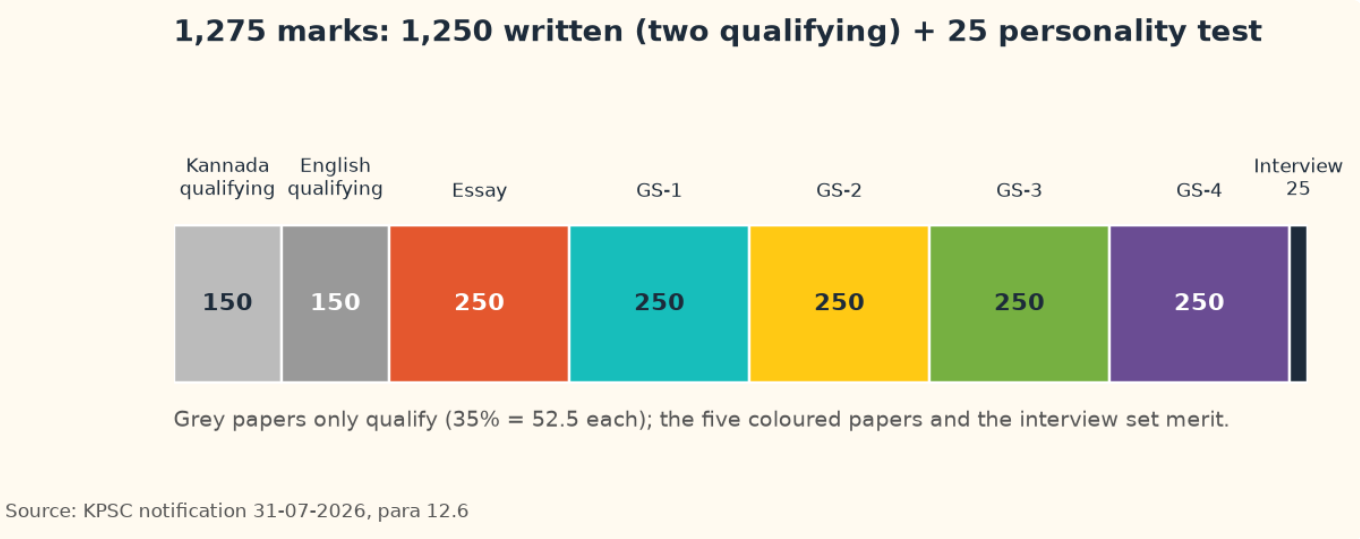
Deliverable 8 - Marking rubric and self-evaluation kit

KAS Mains Library | built 27-10-2026 (IST) | for self-marking: this is my own practice scheme, built on the official marks structure

Library progress: Deliverable 8 of 8 (the finish line!)

CHAI-TALK: Practice without marking is just exercise. Practice with marking is training. This kit turns "I think that went well" into "I scored 6.5 out of 10 and lost 2 marks on evidence", which is a thing you can actually fix. Everything below is a self-marking tool. KPSC does not publish its examiners' marking scheme, so these criteria are my own, built from the official marks structure and the question pattern.

1. The official frame (what is fixed)



Marks by paper. Source: KPSC notification dated 31-07-2026, para 12.6.

Fact	What the notification says
Written papers	Kannada 150 (2 hrs), English 150 (2 hrs), Essay 250 (3 hrs), GS-1 to GS-4 at 250 each (3 hrs each)
Totals	Written 1,250; personality test 25; grand total 1,275
Qualifying papers	Kannada and English count only for qualifying; at least 35% (52.5 of 150) in each; below that, no personality test
Merit	Written marks and personality test marks together decide merit; the marks of the two qualifying papers are not counted
Type	Conventional, descriptive; all papers compulsory
Language	Question papers are in Kannada and English; the five main papers may be answered wholly in Kannada or wholly in English; the two qualifying papers must be answered in their own language
Standard	Main papers: degree level. Qualifying papers: first-language level of SSLC
Paper structure	Papers II to V (GS) each have three sections

PEAK FACT: Two papers (Kannada and English) cannot add a single mark to your rank, but each one can end your attempt if you fall below 52.5. Treat them like a seat-belt: boring, essential, quick to fasten.

COMMON TRAP: Putting all the study time into the 1,000 marks that rank you, and leaving the 52.5 gate for the last week. Do a qualifying practice set every week (Deliverable 7).

2. Answer rubrics

All rubrics are out of the question's marks, so scale them freely. Half-marks are fine.

2.1 General Studies: 10-mark answer (150 words)

Criterion	Marks	Full marks look like	Zero looks like
Content and relevance	4	Answers exactly what the directive word asks; every line earns its place	Writes about the topic but not the question
Structure	2	Short intro, 3-4 clear points, a one-line close	One block of text, no ending
Evidence	2	At least 2 checkable facts: Article/Act, scheme, figure, report, one Karnataka example	General statements only
Analysis and way forward	1	One honest limitation and one practical step	Pure description
Presentation	1	Legible, headed points, language correct, within the limit	Messy, rambling

2.2 General Studies: 15-mark answer (250 words)

Criterion	Marks
Content and relevance (all parts of the question covered)	6
Structure (intro, headed body, conclusion)	3
Evidence (Constitution, laws, schemes, data, Karnataka example, one sketch or table if useful)	3
Analysis, balance and way forward	2
Presentation	1

2.3 Paper-wise additions (what the examiner's eye looks for)

Paper	Extra things that pick up marks	Common leak
GS-1 (Paper 2): heritage, history, society, economy	Correct dates and names; cause then effect; a Karnataka thread in history and society answers; Survey numbers in economy	Dates wrong by a decade; long storytelling
GS-2 (Paper 3): geography, Constitution, administration, IR	Article numbers; case names with years; labelled sketch map for geography; India's interest in IR answers	Opinion without Article or case; unlabelled maps
GS-3 (Paper 4): science and technology, agriculture, environment	Definition in one line; application, status, risk, policy; one Indian or Karnataka example	Jargon without definition; no policy link
GS-4 (Paper 5): ethics	Thinkers and concepts used to argue, not list; a real or realistic example; for cases, the SDRAT steps	Quote-dumping; a case answer with no stakeholder analysis

2.4 Ethics case study (300 words, scaled to 15 marks)

Criterion	Marks
Issues and stakeholders named (S, D)	3
Options with the pros and cons of each (R)	4
Chosen action with concrete steps and who does what (A)	5
Ethical justification: values, law, a thinker or code (T)	3

If the paper gives a different split of marks across sub-questions, keep the same proportions.

2.5 Essay (125 marks each; two essays = 250)

Criterion	Marks	Check
Relevance and a clear thesis	25	Is the stand visible in the first paragraph?
Depth of arguments	35	3-4 distinct arguments, each with a reason
Evidence and examples	20	At least 6 checkable facts, some from Karnataka

Criterion	Marks	Check
Structure and flow	20	Paragraphs link; no repetition
Language and expression	15	Simple, correct, vivid
Conclusion and way forward	10	Practical, balanced, echoes the opening

2.6 Qualifying papers (150 marks each, six items of 25)

Paper	Items (25 marks each)
English	Comprehension, precis, usage, vocabulary, short essay, communication skills
Kannada	Comprehension of a passage, word usage, precis, vocabulary, short essay, English-to-Kannada translation

Pass line: **52.5 out of 150**, that is about 12.5 per item if marks are spread evenly. Mark yourself by item. Safety target for practice: 75 or more (50%), so that a bad day still clears the gate. The Kannada item list was read from legacy-font text in the gazette; ask a native speaker to confirm it.

3. Word-limit rules for self-marking

> **CHAI-TALK:** The question says "not more than 150 words". A few extra words will not sink you, but a 300-word rant in a 150-word box tells the examiner you cannot edit. These deductions are practice rules to build the habit; KPSC has not published an official penalty.

Answer	No deduction	Small deduction	Large deduction
150 words (10 marks)	up to 165	166-187: minus 0.5	188 and above: minus 1
250 words (15 marks)	up to 275	276-312: minus 1	313 and above: minus 1.5
300 words (case, 15 marks)	up to 330	331-375: minus 1	376 and above: minus 1.5
Essay (limit given in the paper; the 2025 mirror text asked for about 1,500 words)	up to 10% over	10-25% over: minus 6	above 25% over: minus 12
Too short (any answer)			under 60% of the limit: cap the content marks at 60%

Count words the way you will write: every word counts, numbers and "Rs" count, a heading counts.

4. The 250-mark paper: converting your score

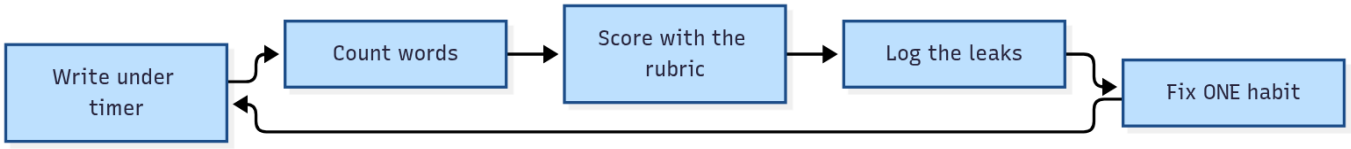
The official scheme fixes each GS paper at 250 marks. The exact mix of 10-mark and 15-mark questions is not confirmed for 2026; recent papers used 10 x 10 and 10 x 15 (= 250). So use this table, then change the counts if the real paper differs.

Part	Count	Marks each	Total
150-word answers	10	10	100
250-word answers	10	15	150
Paper	20		**250**

Study bands (my own targets, not KPSC cut-offs):

Your score	Band	What to do
Below 35%	Red	Fix content gaps first; re-read the dossiers
35% to 44.9%	Amber	Structure and evidence habits
45% to 54.9%	Green	Add analysis and way forward
55% and above	Gold	Polish and speed; protect from careless leaks

5. The self-evaluation loop



Fix **one** habit per week. Chunking beats a long to-do list.

5.1 Single-answer score sheet (print and reuse)

Item	Entry
Date / Paper / Question ref	___ / ___ / ___
Marks of question (10 or 15)	___
Words written / limit	___ / ___
Time taken / target (7 or 11 min)	___ / ___
Content (4 or 6)	___
Structure (2 or 3)	___
Evidence (2 or 3)	___
Analysis and way forward (1 or 2)	___
Presentation (1)	___
Word-limit deduction	___
Final	___
Biggest leak	Content / Structure / Evidence / Analysis / Presentation / Words / Time
Next time I will	___

5.2 Weekly dashboard

Week	Answers written	Average %	Over-limit count	Facts I got wrong	Habit to fix
1					
2					
3					
4					

5.3 Fact-error log (keep it, it is your best revision sheet)

Date	Wrong fact	Correct fact	Source I checked

6. Worked example: marking one answer

A practice question (my own wording, 10 marks, 150 words): Direct benefit transfers can empower women, but cannot do it alone. Discuss with reference to Karnataka.

A student's answer (175 words):

Direct benefit transfer (DBT) puts money straight into a woman's bank account. It removes middlemen and gives her a say in household spending. Karnataka's Gruha Lakshmi scheme gives Rs 2,000 a month to the woman head of the family, and about 1.29 crore women are enrolled (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Benefits:

- Cash in her hand raises spending on food, children and health.
- It reduces leakage, since the money does not pass through local officials.
- It brings more women into the banking system.

Challenges:

- Cash alone does not create jobs or change attitudes.
- Women without Aadhaar-linked accounts may be left out.
- A large recurring transfer puts pressure on the State's finances.
- Money may still be controlled by the family.

Cash transfers have been tried in many countries over many years, and many experts say that they are very good in general, though the results are mixed in many places and depend on many things, so it is a debated matter everywhere and nobody can say for sure what the final effect will be in the long run.

Marking:

Criterion	Marks	Why
Content and relevance (of 4)	3.0	Covers benefits and challenges; "with reference to Karnataka" handled only by one scheme
Structure (of 2)	1.0	Good headed points; the last paragraph is a drifting ending, not a conclusion
Evidence (of 2)	1.0	One solid fact (Gruha Lakshmi, Rs 2,000, about 1.29 crore enrolled); the rest is general
Analysis and way forward (of 1)	0.0	Challenges listed, but no practical step
Presentation (of 1)	0.5	Neat, but the last sentence is padded
Subtotal	5.5	
Word-limit deduction	minus 0.5	175 words is in the 166-187 band
Final	**5.0 out of 10**	

What a 9/10 version would change: cut the last paragraph (saves about 40 words), add one more Karnataka fact (for example the Shakti free-travel scheme, or Anna Bhagya), and end with one step such as "pair cash with skill training and bank-mitra help" (Evidence +1, Analysis +1, Words 0).

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** Score on five rows, **C-S-E-A-P**: Content, Structure, Evidence, Analysis, Presentation. A leak shows up in one row. Fix that row.

6.1 Worked example: a whole 250-mark paper

Illustrative numbers for a mock GS paper (10 x 10-mark and 10 x 15-mark answers):

Group	Marks scored per answer	Subtotal
Ten 10-mark answers	6.0, 5.5, 4.5, 6.5, 5.0, 4.0, 5.5, 6.0, 4.5, 5.5	53 out of 100
Ten 15-mark answers	8, 7.5, 6.5, 9, 7, 8, 6, 7.5, 8.5, 7	75 out of 150
Paper		**128 out of 250 = 51.2%**

Band: **Green** (45% to 54.9%). The two lowest 10-mark answers (4.0 and 4.5) are the plan for next week: look up their leak row in the score sheets, fix that one habit and rewrite both answers.

> **RECAP:** (1) The structure is fixed: five papers that rank you (250 each), two that only qualify (52.5 each), and 25 for the interview. (2) Score every practice answer on five rows. (3) Respect the word limit. (4) Fix one habit a week.
> **NEXT UP:** Return to Deliverable 3 and write one answer a day, then mark it here. Your first score is a baseline, not a verdict.

KAS Mains Mock Sets: Trend Blueprint

Built 27-10-2026 22:15 IST | drives all 10 mock sets | every set topic below is PREDICTED from the pattern, never copied from a past paper

Mock-set project: step 1 of 12 (blueprint). Next up: Set 1.

CHAI-TALK: Think of this page as the chef's shopping list. The 10 sets are cooked only from what is on this list, and the list is made from what the examiner has actually served in 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 (317 tagged mains questions). No guessing from the sofa.

1. What the data says (and where it is thin)

- **Base:** 317 tagged mains questions, 4 papers x 4 sittings (2014, 2015, 2021, 2025) from `trends.xlsx`. The 2014 and 2025 sets are unofficial re-hosts; 2025 is an OCR read, so treat its tags as likely-right, not certain.
- **Not tagged:** the Essay papers (no topic data), so essay themes are chosen from the GS trend and the syllabus split (Essay 1 national/international, Essay 2 state/local), not from counted essays.
- **Directive words** come from the text layer of the 2014, 2015 and 2021 papers only (about 205 of 236 questions parsed; the 2025 PDFs are scans). Read them as approximate.
- **Official frame:** KPSC notification dated 31-07-2026, para 12.6: Essay and GS1-4 are 250 marks each, 3 hours each; GS1-4 have three sections; answer in Kannada or English.

Paper	2014	2015	2021	2025	Total
GS1	20	21	21	20	82
GS2	20	21	20	20	81
GS3	20	21	21	23	85
GS4	20	15	16	18	69
All					**317**

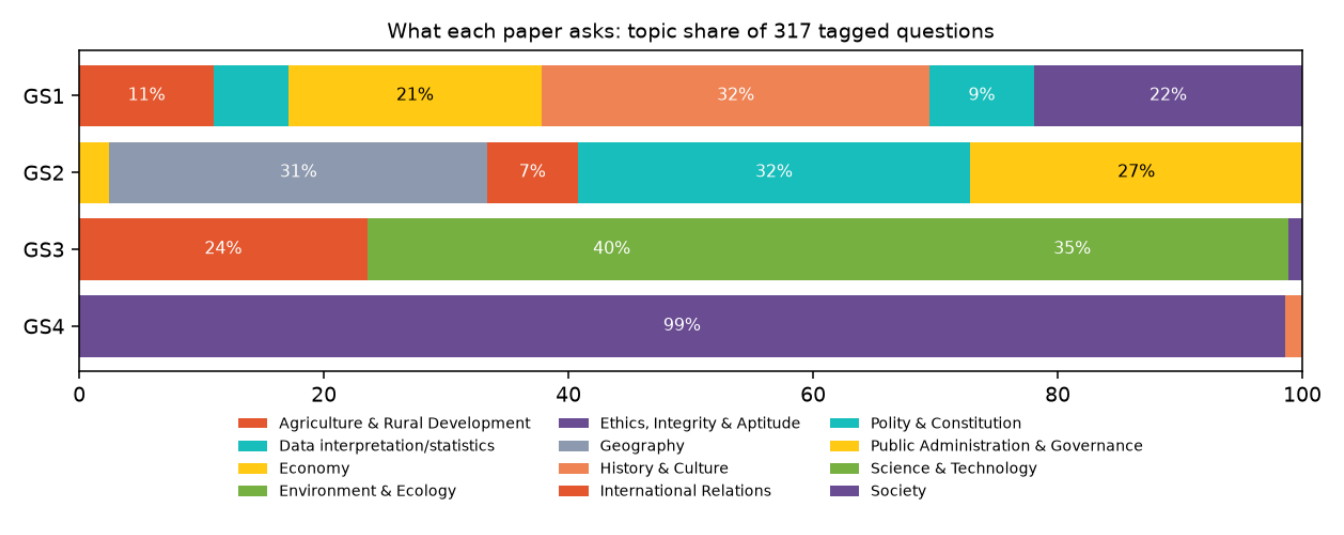


Figure 1. Topic share by paper.

Topic frequency per paper (count, with the four sittings in order 2014 / 2015 / 2021 / 2025)

Paper	Topic group	Count	Share	By sitting
GS1	History & Culture	26	32%	5 / 7 / 7 / 7
GS1	Society	18	22%	3 / 4 / 7 / 4
GS1	Economy	17	21%	6 / 6 / 3 / 2
GS1	Agriculture & Rural Development	9	11%	1 / 1 / 4 / 3
GS1	Polity & Constitution	7	9%	3 / 2 / 0 / 2
GS1	Data interpretation/statistics	5	6%	2 / 1 / 0 / 2
GS2	Polity & Constitution	26	32%	5 / 7 / 7 / 7
GS2	Geography	25	31%	5 / 6 / 7 / 7
GS2	Public Administration & Governance	22	27%	9 / 6 / 4 / 3
GS2	International Relations	6	7%	0 / 1 / 2 / 3
GS2	Economy	2	2%	1 / 1 / 0 / 0
GS3	Environment & Ecology	34	40%	9 / 9 / 7 / 9
GS3	Science & Technology	30	35%	5 / 7 / 7 / 11
GS3	Agriculture & Rural Development	20	24%	6 / 4 / 7 / 3
GS3	Society	1	1%	0 / 1 / 0 / 0
GS4	Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude	68	99%	19 / 15 / 16 / 18
GS4	History & Culture	1	1%	1 / 0 / 0 / 0

PEAK FACT: The big movers are GS3 science and technology (ICT and e-governance unit: 0, 1, 3, then 6 questions across the four sittings), GS4 case studies (0, 0, 2, then 6) and GS2 international relations (current-affairs framed: 3 of 6 in 2025). Public administration is the one that has been shrinking in GS2.

2. Directive-word mix

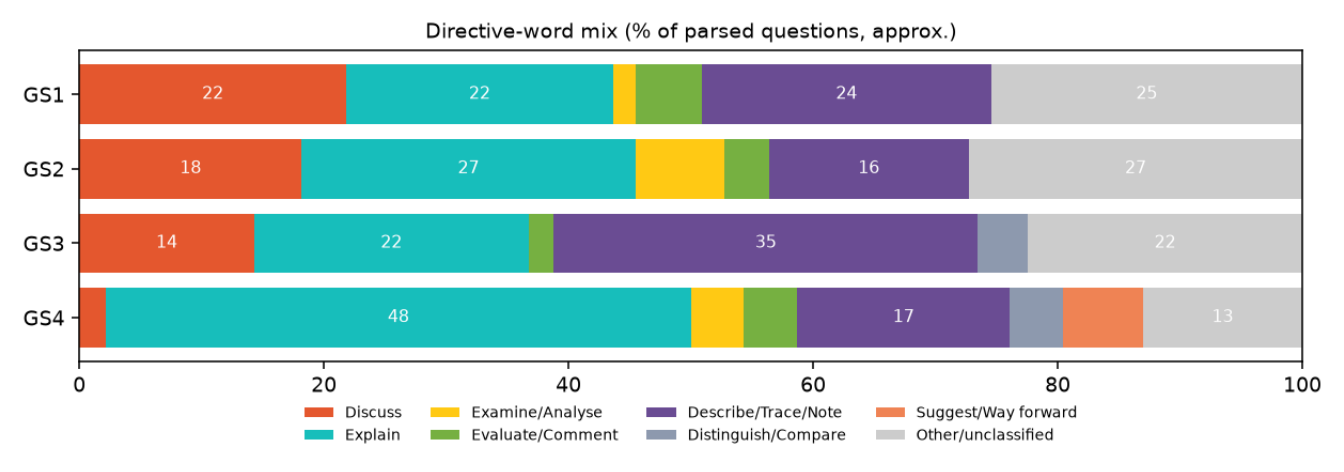


Figure 2. First directive word, approximate.

Read-out: **Explain** and **Discuss** carry 37% to 50% of the parsed questions in every paper (GS4 is Explain-heavy at about 48% on its own); **Describe/Trace/Write a note** is strongest in GS3 (35%). "Critically" appears in only about 7% of questions, so critical-analysis questions are the minority, not the norm. **Consequence for the sets:** in each GS set the mix is about 30% Explain, 25% Discuss, 15% Describe/Note, 12% Examine/Analyse (some with "critically"), 8% Evaluate/Comment, 5% Distinguish, 5% Suggest/Way forward. Case studies always end with "what would you do / how do you resolve this".

3. Karnataka-specific and current-affairs share

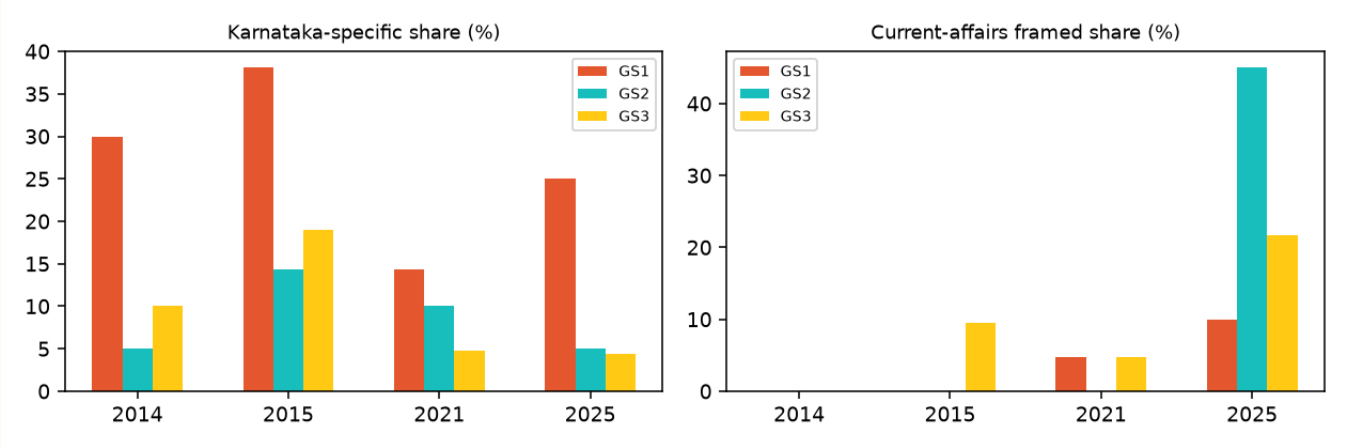


Figure 3. Share by paper and sitting.

Paper	Questions	Karnataka-specific	Share	Current-affairs framed	Share
GS1	82	22	27%	3	4%
GS2	81	7	9%	9	11%
GS3	85	8	9%	8	9%
GS4	69	0	0%	0	0%
All	317	37	12%	20	6%

COMMON TRAP: Karnataka-specific questions are NOT 30% of mains. That 30% is the prelims figure. In mains it is concentrated in **GS1 (27%)**; GS2 and GS3 are about 9% each; GS4 has none. But an answer with no Karnataka example still loses marks everywhere, so every model answer in the sets carries at least one Karnataka example. The sets keep **5 Karnataka-specific questions in GS1, 2 in GS2, 2 in GS3** per set.

Current-affairs framing jumped to **16 of 81 in 2025** (GS2: 9 of 20; GS3: 5 of 23). The sets carry **2 / 4 / 3** current-affairs-framed questions in GS1 / GS2 / GS3, with facts cited from official sources.

4. Recurring themes (seen in 3 or more questions, in 2 or more sittings)

- **GS1:** Freedom movement Karnataka (4, in 3 sittings); Women (3, in 3 sittings); Rural society (3, in 3 sittings); Data interpretation (3, in 2 sittings)
- **GS2:** Urbanisation (3, in 3 sittings); DPSP (3, in 3 sittings)
- **GS3:** Health (3, in 3 sittings); Biodiversity (3, in 3 sittings)
- **GS4:** Ethics concepts (55, in 4 sittings); Case study (8, in 2 sittings)

5. Gaps that are "due"

A unit is due when it is common in the long run but silent in the latest two sittings, or when it has never (or once) been asked. These get extra weight in the allocation.

Kind	Units
Never asked in 4 sittings	GS1-C4 Planning (five year plans, Karnataka planning); GS3-A5 Related perceptions (S&T literacy, HDI, indigenous knowledge)

Kind	Units
Asked once only	GS1-A5 Modern Mysore 1799-1947 (Krishnaraja III, rebellions,...; GS1-B1 Post-independent Karnataka (backward classes, land reforms,...; GS2-B7 Services under the Union and State; GS2-C3 Organisational behaviour: decision making, communication, delegation; GS3-A6 Knowledge society (education, gender equality); GS3-A7 Rural upliftment & S&T (rural connectivity, regional language in...
Common (3+) but silent in 2021 and 2025	GS1-B6 Socio-economic system (Jajmani, market economy, trade unions,... (3); GS1-C2 India & international economic relations (trade, BoP, Karnataka... (4); GS2-C3 Organisational behaviour: decision making, communication, delegation (3); GS2-C4 Formal/informal organisation, leadership, motivation (3); GS3-B3 Horticulture (incl. hi-tech/poly-house) & sericulture (3); GS3-C1 Environmental segments: forest conservation, wildlife, Project... (4); GS4-E1 Essence, determinants, dimensions of ethics; ethics in... (3)

6. How the blueprint was turned into 10 sets

1. **Slots:** GS1, GS2 and GS3 have 20 questions per set (10 x 10 marks, 150 words; 10 x 15 marks, 250 words) = 200 slots each over 10 sets. GS4 has 16 per set shaped like the 2021 paper: 5 x 10 marks (150 words), 4 x 15 marks (250 words), 7 x 20 marks (300 words) = 160 slots. Of the seven 20-mark GS4 slots, 4 are fictional **case studies** and 3 are long theory questions. Essay: two essays of 125 marks.
2. **Weight of a unit** = its total over 4 sittings + 1.5 x its 2025 count + a due bonus (+2 never asked, +1 asked once, +0.5 silent in 2021 and 2025). Every unit gets at least 4 slots over the 10 sets, so nothing is ignored.
3. **Spread:** slots are dealt evenly so each set has a similar shape and no unit repeats heavily inside one set. Mark size (10 or 15) alternates for the same unit across sets.
4. **No repeats:** every slot is a new angle. The 40 existing model answers (GS1-01 to GS4-10) are listed against their unit in `ALLOCATION_ROSTER.csv` as angles to avoid; the 6-gram check against past papers runs on every set.
5. The full slot list (780 rows: paper, set, slot, marks, unit, Karnataka/current-affairs flag) is in `ALLOCATION_ROSTER.csv`.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "**D-C-K-A**": **D**ue gaps get extra weight, **C**ore units never skipped, **K**arnataka in every answer, **A**ngles never repeated. If you can say D-C-K-A you can explain the whole blueprint.

7. Topic-to-set allocation (number of questions per unit per set)

GS1 (20 questions per set, 200 in all)

Unit	Topic	Past	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	Total
GS1-A1	Cultural Heritage of India (Indus/Vedic, literature, S&T, arts,...	6	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	13
GS1-A2	Transforming Indian society: reformers & schools of thought...	7	2	1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	17
GS1-A3	Kadambas to Hoysalas (antiquity, Kannada language/ literature,...	4	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	1	12
GS1-A4	Vijayanagara Empire and thereafter, 1336-1799 (sects, Bahmani,...	2			1	1			1			1	4
GS1-A5	Modern Mysore 1799-1947 (Krishnaraja III, rebellions,...	1		1			1	1			1		4
GS1-A6	Freedom movement in Karnataka & Unification 1885-1956 (incl....	7	1	2	2	1	2	2	1	2	2	2	17
GS1-B1	Post-independent Karnataka (backward classes, land reforms,...	1	1			1			1	1			4
GS1-B2	Social change & movements (theories, disorganisation, social policy)	4	1	1	1	1	1		1	1	1	1	9

GS1-B3	Social change & modernisation (role conflict, women,...	8	2	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	1	2	18
GS1-B4	Government & political system (legislature/executive/judiciary,...	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1			8
GS1-B5	Decentralisation of power (Centre-State, Governor, PRI,...	4	1	1		1	1	1	1	1	1	1	9
GS1-B6	Socio-economic system (Jajmani, market economy, trade unions,...	3	1	1		1			1	1	1		6
GS1-B7	Rural social system & rural development (power structure, bonded...	6	2	1	2	2	1	1	2	1	1	2	15
GS1-C1	Indian economy post-independence & Karnataka economy in plan era	4	1		1	1	1	1			1	1	7
GS1-C2	India & international economic relations (trade, BoP, Karnataka...	4	1		1	1		1	1	1		1	7
GS1-C3	Development patterns & regional disparities (SEZ, Karnataka...	2			1			1			1	1	4
GS1-C4	Planning (five year plans, Karnataka planning)	0	1	1			1			1			4
GS1-C5	Decentralisation, state/local finance, resource devolution	2		1	1		1	1			1	1	6
GS1-C6	Rural development (agriculture, irrigation, marketing,...	6	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	13
GS1-C7	Rural development initiatives (poverty/employment programmes,...	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
GS1-C8	Data collection, analysis, interpretation & quantitative aptitude	5	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	13

GS2 (20 questions per set, 200 in all)

Unit	Topic	Past	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	Total
GS2-A1	World geography: lithosphere, atmosphere, hydrosphere	4	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
GS2-A2	World: continents, human races, population, migration	6	2	1	1	2	1	2	2	2	1	2	16
GS2-A3	India: physiography, climate, minerals, crops, demography	3	1	1		1	1				1		5
GS2-A4	India: industrial planning, infrastructure, regional planning, towns	4	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	12
GS2-A5	Karnataka: physiography, agriculture, minerals, power, industry,...	5	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	12
GS2-A6	Karnataka: urbanisation, land use, population policy, trade	5	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
GS2-B1	Nature of the Constitution (Preamble, federation, features)	4	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
GS2-B2	Fundamental rights, SC/ST/minority provisions	4	1	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	12
GS2-B3	Distribution of legislative powers, Union-State relations,...	5	1	1		1	1	1	1	1	1	1	9
GS2-B4	Legislatures, delegated legislation, CAG, Attorney-General,...	5	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
GS2-B5	Important amendments, basic structure, emergency, 73rd/74th	3	1	1	1	1	1		1	1		1	8
GS2-B6	Welfare mechanism: DPSP, Election Commission, commissions, Finance...	6	1	2	2	1	2	2	1	2	2	1	16

GS2-B7	Services under the Union and State	1			1			1	1			1	4
GS2-C1	Private & public administration, NPA/NPM, responsive administration	5	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	11
GS2-C2	Structure of organisation, law & order, administrative law,...	2		1			1			1	1		4
GS2-C3	Organisational behaviour: decision making, communication, delegation	3	1			1	1	1	1	1	1		7
GS2-C4	Formal/informal organisation, leadership, motivation	3		1	1			1		1	1	1	6
GS2-C5	Management tools (PERT/CPM, SWOT, POSD-CORB, quality tools)	2	1		1	1		1	1			1	6
GS2-C6	Administrative reforms, good governance, Lokpal/ Lokayukta, PRI,...	5	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
GS2-C7	UN & specialised agencies, international organisations, India &...	6	2	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	2	19

GS3 (20 questions per set, 200 in all)

Unit	Topic	Past	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	Total
GS3-A1	Basics of S&T, ICT, e-governance, digital divide	10	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	30
GS3-A2	Space science & technology	2			1	1			1			1	4
GS3-A3	Energy resources (nuclear, renewable, waste-based)	5	1	2	1	1	2	1	2	1	1	1	13
GS3-A4	Disasters, pests & pollution (climate change & disasters, crop...	3	1		1	1			1			1	5
GS3-A5	Related perceptions (S&T literacy, HDI, indigenous knowledge)	0		1			1	1			1		4
GS3-A6	Knowledge society (education, gender equality)	1	1			1			1	1			4
GS3-A7	Rural upliftment & S&T (rural connectivity, regional language in...	1			1			1			1	1	4
GS3-B1	Natural science (plants, animals, microorganisms)	2	1	1			1			1			4
GS3-B2	Agriculture science (agri scenario, crop production/ protection,...	6	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	12
GS3-B3	Horticulture (incl. hi-tech/poly-house) & sericulture	3		1			1	1		1	1		5
GS3-B4	Biotechnology (GM crops, genetic engineering, biofertilisers/biofuels)	5	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	13
GS3-B5	Animal husbandry, dairy (KMF/AMUL), fisheries	4	1	1	1	1	1		1	1	1	1	9
GS3-B6	Agriculture policies, programmes, price policy, watershed, trade	5	1	1		1	1	1	1	1		1	8
GS3-B7	Health & hygiene (diseases, vaccines, national programmes)	5	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	1	12
GS3-C1	Environmental segments: forest conservation, wildlife, Project...	4	1		1	1	1	1		1	1		7
GS3-C2	Natural resources: forests, water, land, waste water, rainwater...	5	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
GS3-C3	Ecosystem & biodiversity, hotspots, IPR	6	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	12

GS3-C4	Pollution & solid waste management, environmental laws	8	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	22
GS3-C5	IT in environment & health; global issues (climate change, acid...	6	2	1	1	2	1	2	2	2	2	1	16
GS3-C6	State-community-civil society interface, JFM, displacement &...	4		1	1			1	1		1	1	6

GS4 (16 questions per set, 160 in all)

Unit	Topic	Past	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	Total
GS4-CS	Case studies on the above	8	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	40
GS4-E1	Essence, determinants, dimensions of ethics; ethics in...	3		1	1		1	1			1		5
GS4-E2	Ethics in public administration, dilemmas, laws/rules/ conscience...	4	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	11
GS4-E3	Accountability & ethical governance, ethical issues in IR,...	4	1			1	1		1	1		1	6
GS4-E4	Public service, RTI/transparency, codes, citizen charters, service...	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
GS4-E5	Human values, lessons from leaders, role of family/ society/education	6	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
GS4-I	II Integrity, impartiality, objectivity, dedication, empathy,...	17	4	3	4	4	3	4	4	4	3	4	37
GS4-T1	Aptitude/foundational values, attitude, thought & behaviour,...	14	3	3	2	3	3	2	2	3	3	2	26
GS4-T2	Emotional intelligence, contributions of moral thinkers	6	1	1	2	1	1	2	2	1	1	2	14

Set shape check (every set): GS1 5 Karnataka + 2 current-affairs; GS2 2 Karnataka + 4 current-affairs; GS3 2 Karnataka + 3 current-affairs; GS4 4 case studies, no Karnataka-specific slot (cases may be set in a Karnataka-like district).

8. Essay allocation (two essays per set, 125 marks each, about 1,000 to 1,200 words in the model essay)

Essays are not topic-tagged in the data, so themes follow the GS trend (technology and environment rising, ethics and governance steady, society and Karnataka development steady) and the paper rule: **Essay 1 = national or international importance; Essay 2 = state or local importance**. The 2025 essays (a media/culture theme and an urban-mobility/technology theme for Karnataka) are not repeated.

Set	Essay 1 (national / international)	Trend basis	Essay 2 (state / local)	Trend basis
1	AI, automation and the future of work in India	S&T / economy: GS3 ICT unit is the fastest riser	Bengaluru's growth and its limits: water, waste and housing	GS2-A6 urbanisation; GS3-C4 waste
2	Federalism: cooperation, competition and the fiscal question	GS2-B1/B6 steady core	Karnataka and the Finance Commission: a fair share for a growing state	GS2-B6, 2025 current-affairs
3	Climate change, energy transition and the development dilemma	GS3-C5, GS3-A3 rising	Western Ghats: conserving biodiversity and livelihoods together	GS3-C3, C1 due
4	Education and the knowledge society: skills for a young nation	GS3-A6 asked once; GS1-B3 youth	Kannada, English and employability: Karnataka's schooling choices	GS1-B3, language units

Set	Essay 1 (national / international)	Trend basis	Essay 2 (state / local)	Trend basis
5	Women in public life: from representation to leadership	GS1-B3 women; GS4 values	Women, work and welfare in Karnataka: Shakti and beyond	GS1-B3, KA welfare (CA)
6	Water: scarcity, sharing and stewardship across states	GS2-A1/GS3-C2; river disputes	Dryland Karnataka: drought, farm income and water-smart farming	GS3-B2/B6, C2
7	Integrity in public life: can transparency alone end corruption?	GS4-E4, GS4-I core	Local self-government in Karnataka: the 73rd Amendment on the ground	GS1-B5, GS2-B5
8	Food security and the farmer's future	GS3-B6, GS1-C6	Regional balance in Karnataka: Kalyana Karnataka's equity journey	GS1-B1/C3 due, 371J
9	India in a multipolar world: neighbourhood, trade and strategic autonomy	GS2-C7 current-affairs surge	Coastal Karnataka: ports, fisheries and climate risk	GS3-B5, C5
10	Health for all: building public health systems after the pandemic	GS3-B7 core, CA	Karnataka's cultural heritage as a development asset	GS1-A3 core, KA

9. Set shape in one line and what happens next

Paper	Questions	Marks pattern	Words	Notes
Essay	2	2 x 125	about 1,000-1,200 in model	one national, one state
GS1, GS2, GS3	20 each	10 x 10 + 10 x 15	150 and 250	5/2/2 Karnataka-specific, 2/4/3 current-affairs per set
GS4	16	5 x 10 + 4 x 15 + 7 x 20	150, 250, 300	4 case studies (fictional), 3 long theory
Language	1 section per set	short Kannada and English practice	n/a	flagged for native review

> **NEXT UP:** Set 1 is built next, then Sets 2 and 3. After every third set I report with paths and review results (6-gram check against past papers, fact-line check, word limits, and an independent re-check of at least 15% of the answers).

Caveats: (a) the 2021 GS1 and GS3 papers carried 21 questions each; this library keeps 20 per set for a clean 250 marks, and can switch to 21 on request; (b) GS4 20-mark / 300-word shape is read from the 2021 paper text (OCR), the official notification gives only papers and total marks; (c) Karnataka and current-affairs targets are rounded from the counts above.

KAS Mains Mock Set 1: Fully Solved

Built 27-10-2026 23:25 IST | 5 papers x 250 marks | every question is PREDICTED from the trend blueprint, never copied from a past paper

PREDICTED: These questions are predictions from the pattern of the 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 papers (see TREND_BLUEPRINT). They are practice, not leaked or past questions. Model answers stay inside the word limit printed with each question. Facts are tied to official sources where possible; a fact list is kept for each answer.

CHAI-TALK: Do this set like an exam: one paper at a time, three hours each, writing by hand. Then read the model answer, tick what you covered, and copy the purple memory line for anything you missed. Do not read all five papers in one sitting. Five good papers beat fifty skimmed ones.

Set 1: step 1 of 6. Next up: Paper 1, the Essay.

Paper 1: Essay

Set 1: step 2 of 6 (Essay). Next up: General Studies I (GS1)

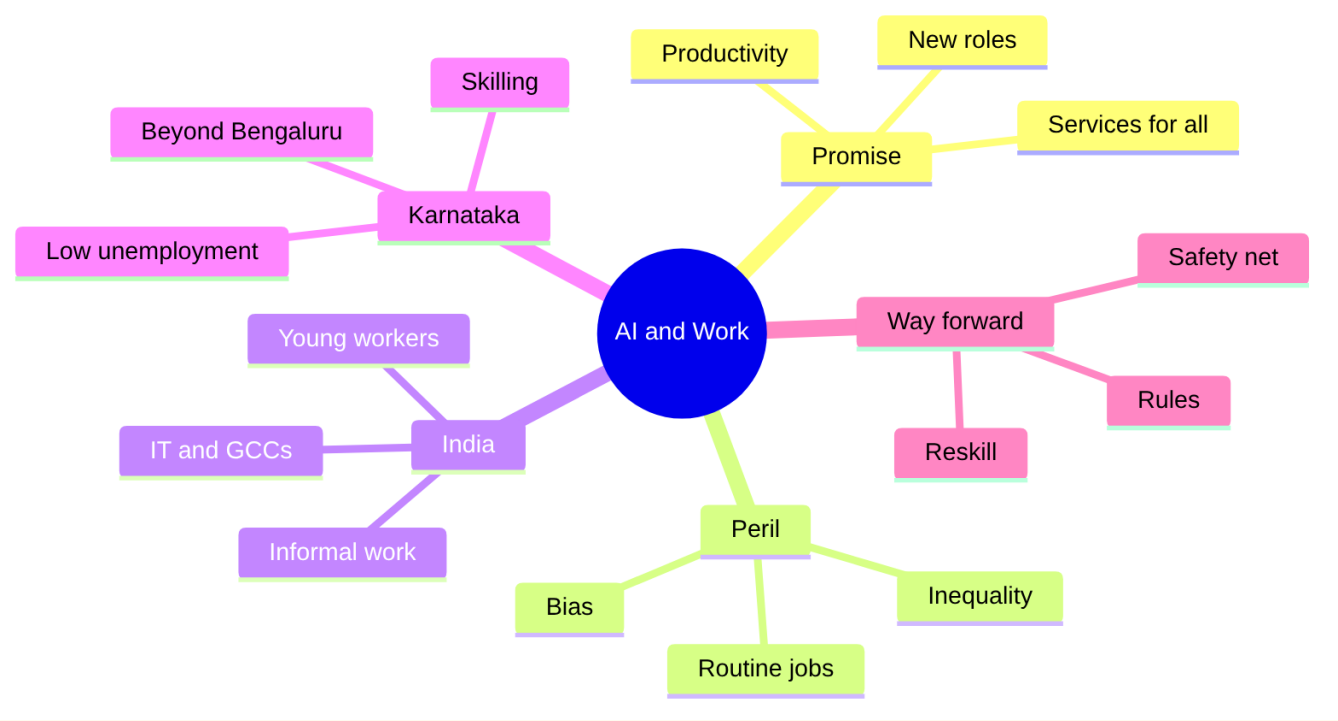
Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Instructions:** write two essays, one from each part, about 1,000 to 1,200 words each. Both carry 125 marks. (This is the practice shape; check the latest KPSC notification for exact instructions.)

> **CHAI-TALK:** An essay is a short journey: a hook, a clear stand, three or four strong turns, a fair look at the other side and a landing that points forward. Read the mind map first, then the essay, and then try to rebuild the map from memory.

Essay 1 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-1

Q1. Artificial intelligence, automation and the future of work in India: will technology create more jobs than it destroys? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 1: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

Every great technology has been feared as a job-killer: the loom, the tractor, the computer. Each did destroy some jobs, and each created many more, but never painlessly and never for the same people. Artificial intelligence (AI) is different in one respect: it does not only replace muscle; it begins to imitate judgement, language and design. For India, a young country with a large informal economy and a world-class technology sector, the question is not whether AI will arrive, but who will gain and who will be left behind.

What AI changes in the nature of work

Automation of routine, rule-based tasks is old; generative AI extends it to drafting, coding, translation, customer support and data analysis. Studies of the world of work, such as the World Economic Forum's

Future of Jobs Report 2025, expect a large churn: some roles shrink, some grow, and many existing roles change in content. The usual finding is that more jobs are created than displaced over the decade, but the new jobs ask for different skills. The honest answer to "more or fewer jobs?" is therefore: more tasks will be automated than jobs abolished, and the outcome depends on policy, not on technology alone.

The case for optimism

First, productivity. Cheaper, faster work lets firms grow, and growth creates demand for labour. Second, new roles: data annotators, AI trainers, prompt specialists, cyber-security staff, and the many support jobs around digital platforms. Third, access: a farmer who can ask for advice in her own language, a patient in a remote village who is screened by an algorithm, a student who has a patient tutor at home. India's Bhashini platform and the IndiaAI Mission (2024) aim to make such access broad. Fourth, small firms and the self-employed can now use tools that once only large companies could afford.

The case for caution

The risks are real and uneven.

Task displacement. Entry-level white-collar work such as basic coding, back-office processing and call-centre work is the most exposed, and these were the ladders by which first-generation graduates entered the middle class.

Inequality. The gains of AI may flow to owners of capital, data and computing power. Without safeguards, a few firms and a few cities may capture most of the benefit.

The informal economy. Most Indian workers are informal and self-employed. Gig and platform workers are managed by algorithms, which may set pay and punish workers without explanation. Karnataka has recognised this by passing a law for gig workers in 2025, but implementation is the test.

Bias and accountability. AI systems trained on skewed data can discriminate in hiring, lending or welfare targeting, and they are hard to question. A person refused a job by an algorithm needs a right to know why.

Gender and the digital divide. If women and the rural poor have less access to devices, skills and data, AI can widen existing gaps.

India's position

India has advantages: a very large pool of young people, a deep software industry, strong digital identity and payment systems, and low-cost data. Its technology sector employs millions and its GCCs (global capability centres) increasingly do high-value design and analytics work. But India also has disadvantages: uneven school quality, an enormous informal workforce, limited research spending and dependence on foreign computing infrastructure and models. A country in which most workers have not finished secondary school cannot move to "AI jobs" by wishing.

The Karnataka lens

Karnataka is the laboratory. Bengaluru is the national capital of technology and start-ups, and the State introduced India's first GCC Policy for 2024-29, which aims at 500 more such centres and 3.5 lakh jobs by 2029. Karnataka's unemployment rate of 2.8% in the PLFS quarterly bulletin for July-September 2025 is well below the national figure of 5.2%. The State's IT Policy 2025-30 stresses AI and deep technology and the spread of growth to cities beyond Bengaluru. For skilling, over 13 lakh individuals have registered on the State's skilling portal, and the Yuva Nidhi scheme links an allowance for graduates and diploma holders with training. These are good foundations. Yet the State also shows the risks: Bengaluru accounts for 40.4% of the State's GSDP, so any shock to its technology employers is felt across Karnataka, while districts such as Yadgir and Kalaburagi have far lower human development.

Ethical and social dimensions

Work is not only income; it is identity, dignity and routine. A society that treats displaced workers as a statistic will pay with social unrest. The ethical principles are those of Gandhi's talisman: judge each policy by its effect on the poorest person. A just transition requires that those whose tasks vanish are given time, money and training. It also requires transparency: citizens should know when an algorithm decides, and have someone to appeal to.

The way forward

1. Education. Teach foundations (literacy, numeracy, logic) better at school, since they decide who can learn new skills later. Add AI literacy and critical thinking to curricula.
2. Reskilling at scale. Short, modular and employer-linked courses, with credit for prior learning, and income support while learning. Use the State's skill portals, ITIs and polytechnics, and take training to taluk level.
3. A safety net for transitions. Portable social security for gig and informal workers, as envisaged in the Social Security Code, and unemployment support that is tied to retraining.
4. Smart regulation. Risk-based rules: light for low-risk uses, strict audit, explainability and human review for high-risk uses such as hiring, credit and welfare. Enforce data protection under the DPDP Act, 2023.
5. Public compute and local-language data. Shared computing facilities, open datasets in Indian languages, and support for small firms to use AI.
6. Spread the opportunity. Support clusters beyond Bengaluru, and let colleges in Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad and Mangaluru connect to employers.
7. Human-in-the-loop design. Use AI to assist workers, not only to replace them, as in tools that help a nurse or an agricultural extension worker do more.

Conclusion

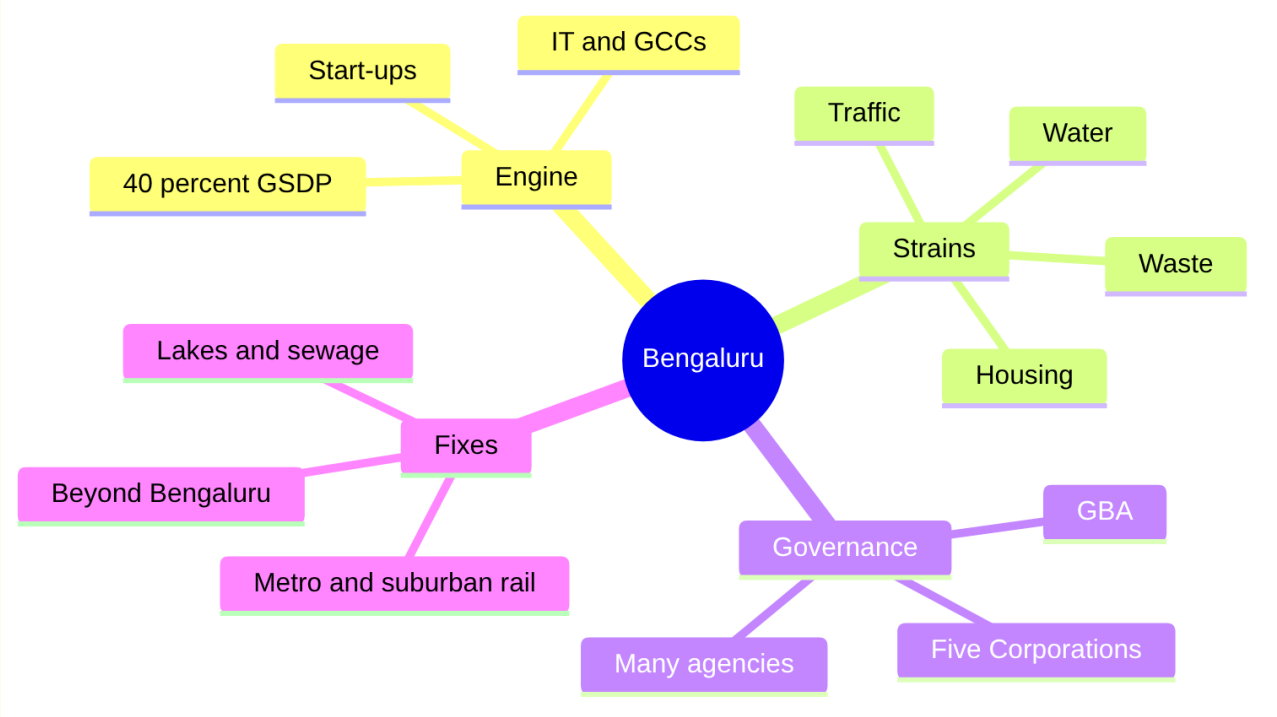
AI will not decide the future of work; societies will. If India invests in schooling, skills and safety nets, and regulates for accountability, AI can raise productivity and open doors for the first-generation learner. If it leaves the transition to the market alone, the gains will go to a few and the costs to many. The test of a good technology policy is simple and old: does it leave the weakest person better able to work with dignity? Karnataka has the talent and the institutions to answer yes, and India has the scale to make that answer count.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-E-W-L-N": Skills, Education, Welfare net, Law (regulation), Nurture clusters beyond cities.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write a one-sided essay (either "AI will take all jobs" or "AI is only good"); the examiner rewards balance and a way forward.

Essay 2 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-2 · Karnataka-specific

Q2. Bengaluru's growth and its limits: can the engine of Karnataka's economy stay livable? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 2: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

Few Indian cities have changed the economy of their State as much as Bengaluru. Once called the "Garden City" and the "Pensioners' Paradise", it is now India's technology capital, a magnet for migrants and a name in boardrooms from Silicon Valley to Singapore. Its success has also created its own problems: clogged roads, thirsty neighbourhoods, overflowing garbage and rents that push out the very workers on whom the city depends. The real question for Karnataka is whether an engine can keep running if its own cooling system fails.

The strength of the engine

The economic facts are striking. In 2024-25 Bengaluru Urban district accounted for 40.4% of the State's GSDP at current prices, with Dakshina Kannada at 5.3% and Belagavi at 3.8%. It leads the State in Human Development, with an index of 0.738 against 0.538 in Yadgir. It is home to public-sector science (ISRO, IISc, HAL, DRDO labs), to software, biotechnology and aerospace, and to a large number of start-ups and GCCs. The State's GCC policy for 2024-29 aims at 500 more centres and 3.5 lakh jobs, while the IT Policy 2025-30 stresses artificial intelligence and deep-tech. This concentration of talent creates what economists call agglomeration benefits: firms, workers and ideas gain from being close.

The limits: the city's strains

Mobility. The city grew outwards faster than its roads and public transport. Commuters lose hours daily. The State has taken up a large programme: Metro Phase-2 (75.06 km, 61 stations) is opening in stages; Phase-3 of 44.65 km and 31 stations has been approved at Rs 15,611 crore, including a 37.121 km double-decker corridor combining a flyover and metro; two vehicular tunnel corridors have been cleared, with the 16.75 km North-South corridor estimated at Rs 16,980 crore. The Suburban Rail Project's Corridors 2 and 4 have been approved at Rs 16,876 crore. The investment is huge, but experts warn that tunnels for cars may invite more cars, and that the fastest relief comes from buses, last-mile links and integrated ticketing.

Water. Bengaluru lies far from a perennial river and has depended on the Cauvery, which is shared with Tamil Nadu, and on falling groundwater. The Survey's own way forward lists completion of Cauvery Stage

V, universal sewerage with full treatment and maximum reuse, smart metering, and stronger enforcement of rainwater harvesting. A city that treats and reuses its water is less dependent on distant rivers.

Waste and lakes. The old tank system of the city has been choked by sewage and encroachment. Rejuvenation efforts continue, but the lesson of small plants like the one at Tolanakeri, where treated water refills the lake and raises nearby groundwater, is that the cure begins with the sewer.

Housing and inequality. High land prices push affordable housing to the edge, away from jobs. Domestic workers, drivers and delivery riders spend large shares of their incomes on rent and travel. Slums and informal colonies remain.

Governance. Many agencies, such as the municipal bodies, the water board, the development authority, the transport corporation and the metro company, share responsibility and often work in silos. The creation of the Greater Bengaluru Authority, which coordinates five Corporations and other agencies, is an attempt to give the metropolitan area an integrated structure and uniform service delivery. Its success will depend on real financial powers, elected local bodies and citizen participation.

Environment. Loss of green cover, heat islands and urban flooding after heavy rain show that unplanned growth has an ecological cost. Trees, lakes and open soil are not decoration; they are part of the city's cooling, drainage and recharge system.

Why the limits matter beyond the city

Because so much of the State's income depends on one city, Bengaluru's troubles are Karnataka's troubles. If firms feel that the city cannot offer reliable roads, water and power, new investment will go to other cities. Equally, the concentration deepens regional inequality: Kalaburagi division has the lowest per capita income among the State's divisions while Bengaluru Urban the highest. This is why the question is not "Bengaluru or the rest" but how the rest can share in its dynamism.

A balanced way forward

1. Plan metropolitan Bengaluru as one region. Use the GBA for common standards, give the Corporations money and staff, and plan jointly with surrounding districts.
2. Put public transport first. Complete metro and suburban lines, feed them with buses and footpaths, and develop transit-oriented neighbourhoods around stations, as the State has begun to do for new metro corridors.
3. Make water circular. Treat every drop of used water, reuse it for industry and gardens, restore lakes as flood and recharge systems, enforce rainwater harvesting and meter supply to cut losses.
4. Waste at source. Segregation, decentralised composting and strong penalties for dumping.
5. Affordable housing near jobs. Use public land, rental housing and higher density along transit lines, with safeguards for existing residents.
6. Spread growth. The State's Beyond Bengaluru initiative, with start-up and industrial clusters in Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, Mangaluru and Kalaburagi, should be supported by roads, skills and reliable power, so that migrants have choices.
7. Citizen voice. Ward committees, open data on services and independent audit of projects.

Conclusion

Bengaluru's growth has been a gift to Karnataka and to India. But a city is not only an economic engine; it is a place where people have to live, travel, drink water and raise children. If water, transport, housing and governance fail, the engine will lose its fuel: talent. The best response is neither to stop growth nor to ignore its costs, but to build the city's public systems at the pace of its private success, and to carry the benefit of that success to every part of Karnataka. A livable Bengaluru and a balanced Karnataka are not rivals; they are the same goal seen from two ends.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "G-T-W-H-S": Governance, Transport, Water, Housing, Spread growth: five fixes.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write only a complaint list about traffic and potholes; add economic strengths and a way forward based on policy and governance.

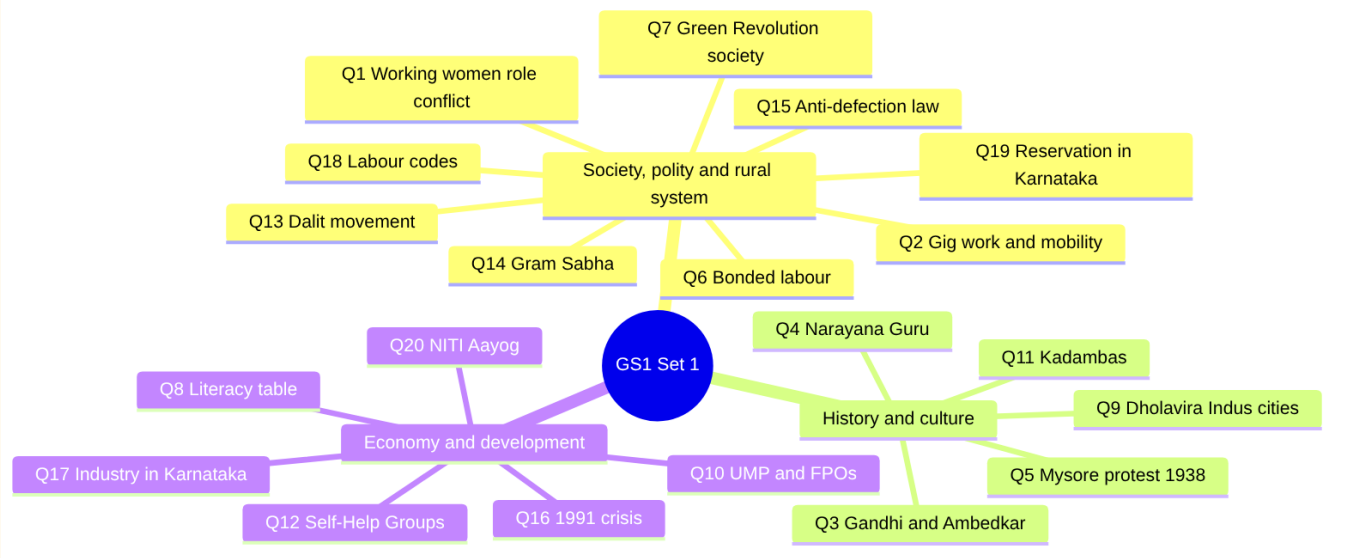
RECAP: Both essays follow the same shape: hook, stand, turns, other side, way forward. Try writing a 5-line plan for any new topic in 4 minutes before you start.

Paper 2: General Studies I (GS1)

Set 1: step 3 of 6 (General Studies I (GS1)). Next up: General Studies II (GS2)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** History and culture first, then society and the economy. Expect Karnataka questions in every section; use the Karnataka line in each answer to score extra.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS1 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · Working women, role conflict

PREDICTED · GS1-B3 · Current affairs

Q1. Working women often face role conflict between household duties and paid work. Examine how State policy, including free-travel schemes such as Shakti in Karnataka, can ease this conflict. (250 words)

Model answer

Role conflict arises when the expectations of two roles, such as caregiver and employee, compete for the same time and energy. Sociologists call the result the "double burden": women add paid work but keep most domestic work.

Sources of conflict

- Unequal sharing of care work, and limited childcare.
- Long, unsafe or costly commutes that cut working hours.
- Social norms that treat women's earnings as secondary.

How policy can ease it

- Mobility: Karnataka's Shakti scheme (launched 11 June 2023) gives free bus travel to women. According to the State's Survey for 2025-26, women's employment rose by 23% in Bengaluru and 21% in Hubballi-Dharwad, and beneficiaries save 30-50% of monthly spending on travel.
- Income support: Gruha Lakshmi pays the woman head of each eligible household a monthly cash transfer of Rs 2,000, raising her bargaining power at home.
- Care infrastructure: anganwadis, creches and the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017, which mandates creche facilities in larger establishments.
- Legal safeguards: the POSH Act, 2013 for safe workplaces.

Limits Free travel solves the journey, not the home. Without shared domestic responsibility, women may simply work longer hours. Crowded buses and weak last-mile links also limit gains.

Way forward Combine mobility with creches, flexible work, safe public spaces and campaigns that make care work a shared duty. Policy succeeds when it changes both the bus and the kitchen.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "BUS + CRECHE + CHORES": the bus (mobility), the creche (care), and chores shared (norms).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit free travel alone; examiners want the home-side fix (shared care work) too.

GS1 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · Gig work and mobility

PREDICTED · GS1-B3 · Current affairs

Q2. Platform and gig work is changing how young people experience modernisation and social mobility. Explain, with reference to Karnataka's 2025 law on gig workers. (150 words)

Model answer

Modernisation is the shift from tradition-bound to market-based, skill-based life. Gig work, such as delivery and ride-hailing, offers quick entry with no caste or degree barrier, so it can act as a ladder for first-generation workers.

Gains

- Low entry barrier and flexible hours; useful for students and migrants.
- Income that does not depend on family contacts.

Risks

- No assured wage, leave or pension; algorithmic control and rating-based penalties.
- Mobility may stall at the entry rung, creating a "precariat".

Policy response Karnataka enacted the Karnataka Platform-Based Gig Workers (Social Security and Welfare) Act, 2025 for app-based workers. It aims at registration, welfare and social security, with funding through a levy on platforms.

Conclusion Gig work widens access but not security. Mobility becomes real only when platforms carry social-security costs and workers can build skills beyond the first job.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** Gig = "Ladder with a loose rung": easy to step on, risky to climb.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call gig workers "employees" in law; they are treated as platform partners unless a statute says otherwise.

GS1 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Gandhi and Ambedkar

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q3. "Gandhi and Ambedkar both fought untouchability, but by different means." Compare their approaches to the caste question. (250 words)

Model answer

Both leaders saw untouchability as a moral and political wrong, but they differed on diagnosis and method.

Gandhi

- Saw caste evils as a corruption of Hindu society that Hindus must repent and reform; he called Dalits Harijan and founded the Harijan Sevak Sangh (1932).
- Relied on moral persuasion, temple entry, and personal service, within a reformed varna order in his early years.
- Wanted unity of the Hindu fold against colonial rule.

Ambedkar

- Saw caste as a system of graded inequality, enforced by scripture, that needed to be destroyed (Annihilation of Caste, 1936).
- Relied on law, political representation and mass action: the Mahad Satyagraha (1927) for water and the Kalaram temple entry movement (1930).
- Wanted constitutional guarantees and independent political power for the depressed classes.

Where they clashed and met The Poona Pact (1932) replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates, a compromise after Gandhi's fast. Ambedkar later drafted the Constitution, whose Article 17 abolishes untouchability.

Assessment Gandhi's method changed hearts and mobilised mass opinion; Ambedkar's method created rights and institutions. Today's reservation, the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the SC/ST Atrocities Act, 1989 reflect Ambedkar's legal route, while social campaigns reflect Gandhi's moral route. Karnataka's own reformers, from Basavanna to the non-Brahmin movement, show that both routes can work together in one society.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** G = Gentle conscience, A = Act of law. "Heart vs Rule-book".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Poona Pact did not abolish reservation; it changed separate electorates into reserved seats.

GS1 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · Narayana Guru

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q4. Explain the teachings of Narayana Guru and their influence on social reform in coastal Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Sree Narayana Guru (1856-1928) of Kerala preached "One caste, one religion, one god for man" and worked for the dignity of the Ezhava community. He founded the SNDP Yogam in 1903, installed a Shiva idol at Aruvippuram in 1888 as a challenge to Brahmin monopoly of worship, and promoted education and the abolition of costly rituals.

Teachings

- Human unity above caste.
- Education and enterprise as tools of uplift.
- Temples open to all and simple, non-wasteful rites.

Influence in coastal Karnataka

- The Billava community of Dakshina Kannada and Udupi drew inspiration from his message; the Sri Gokarnanatha temple in Mangaluru (1912), consecrated under his guidance, became a centre of Billava assertion.
- Cooperative banks and schools followed the pattern.

Conclusion His movement shows that reform worked best when moral teaching was joined with institutions: temples, schools and cooperative credit.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "One-One-One": one caste, one religion, one god.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse his Aruvippuram consecration (1888) with the 1903 founding of SNDP; keep two dates.

GS1 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Mysore protest 1938

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. Princely Mysore saw popular protest in 1938 in a different political setting from British Karnataka. Examine the Mysore Congress movement of 1938, including Vidurashwatha and the Shivapura flag satyagraha. (250 words)

Model answer

In British Karnataka, the Congress led open civil disobedience against a colonial state. In princely Mysore, the Maharaja's government banned the Congress flag and political meetings, so the struggle was for **responsible government and civil liberties** under a ruler, not for independence directly.

Background The Mysore State Congress was formed in 1936 and demanded responsible government. The Maharaja's Dewan, Sir Mirza Ismail, refused political concessions.

Events of 1938

- Shivapura flag satyagraha (April 1938): volunteers defied the ban on hoisting the Congress tricolour at Shivapura in Mandya district. It drew thousands, including leaders from outside Mysore, and became the largest protest.
- Vidurashwatha (25 April 1938): police firing on a crowd at Vidurashwatha village in what was then Kolar district killed several people. It is remembered as the "Jallianwala Bagh of Karnataka".
- Leaders such as K.C. Reddy, H.K. Veeranna Gowda and T. Siddalingaiah led the agitation.

Outcome The government negotiated and released prisoners; the Congress was recognised and constitutional reforms followed. K.C. Reddy became the first Chief Minister of Mysore State in 1947-52.

Assessment The movement shows how nationalism in a princely state was expressed through civil rights. It strengthened the Praja Mandal idea and prepared the path to responsible government and later unification.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Two V-S": Vidurashwatha (firing) and Shivapura (flag).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not label it a "Quit India" event; it was 1938, four years earlier, and aimed at responsible government.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Vidurashwatha 25 April 1938; Shivapura flag satyagraha April 1938; K.C. Reddy first CM of Mysore State 1947-52.

GS1: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Bonded labour.

GS1 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Bonded labour

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q6. Bonded labour persists despite legal abolition. Explain its causes and the measures to eliminate it. (150 words)

Model answer

Bonded labour is work extracted to repay a debt, often with unpaid or underpaid wages and loss of freedom. Article 23 bans forced labour, and the Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976 declared all bonded debts void.

Causes

- Landlessness, poverty and informal credit from employers.
- Caste and social hierarchy, so most victims are Dalits and Adivasis.
- Weak enforcement, low awareness and seasonal migration to brick kilns, quarries and farms.

Measures

- Identification and release by district magistrates, with vigilance committees.
- Rehabilitation grants under the Centre's scheme, plus land, housing and skills.
- Minimum wages, formal credit through SHGs, and the Supreme Court's directions in PUDR (1982) and Bandhua Mukti Morcha (1984).

Conclusion Release without rehabilitation sends people back to the same creditor. Lasting abolition needs credit, land and a working labour inspectorate.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "RRR": Release, Rehabilitate, Restore credit.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Bonded labour is not just child labour; the test is debt-linked loss of freedom.

GS1 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Green Revolution society

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q7. Examine the impact of the Green Revolution on India's rural social structure and regional balance. (250 words)

Model answer

The Green Revolution of the mid-1960s combined high-yielding varieties (HYV) of wheat and rice, fertiliser, irrigation and assured procurement at minimum support prices. It made India self-sufficient in foodgrains within a decade.

Positive impact

- Foodgrain output and farm incomes rose in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh.
- Rural demand, tractors and agro-industry grew; migrant labour found work.

Social structure

- Class gap widened: large and medium farmers who could afford seeds, pumps and fertiliser gained more than small tenants.
- Tenant eviction: landowners resumed land for self-cultivation.
- Labour: mechanisation reduced demand for some farm work but created new demand in harvesting and transport.
- Caste and power: rising incomes strengthened the dominant farming castes in politics.

Regional imbalance Wheat-rice regions with assured irrigation gained; eastern India, dryland areas and most pulses and coarse cereals lagged. Karnataka's irrigated tracts such as the Tungabhadra and Kaveri commands benefited, while rainfed districts did not.

Environmental costs Falling water tables, soil degradation and chemical overuse.

Way forward Second-generation reforms: diversify to millets and pulses, efficient irrigation, soil health, and support for small farmers through cooperatives and FPOs. Karnataka's focus on millets and rainfed agriculture policy is a step in this direction.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Seeds, Water, Money": the three keys that opened the door only for some.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say all regions benefited; the revolution was region-, crop- and class-selective.

GS1 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Literacy table

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q8. Study the (illustrative, fictional) table below and answer.

District	2019 literacy (%)	2024 literacy (%)	Female share of workers (%) 2024
A	68	76	31
B	61	72	28
C	75	79	36
D	55	66	22

(a) Which district improved most? (b) Compute the average gain. (c) Comment on the link between literacy and female share of workers. (150 words)

Model answer

(a) Gains in percentage points (2024 minus 2019): A = 8; B = 11; C = 4; D = 11. Districts B and D improved most, each by 11 points. In relative terms D grew faster: 11/55 = 20%, against B's 11/61 = 18%.

(b) Average gain: (8 + 11 + 4 + 11) / 4 = 34 / 4 = **8.5 percentage points**.

(c) Link: Districts with higher literacy generally have a higher female share of workers: C (79%) has 36%, while D (66%) has 22%. District B is an exception to the smooth trend: its literacy of 72% is higher than D's, but only 6 points of female share more than D. The data show association, not proof of cause.

Conclusion Low-base districts (B, D) are catching up fastest, as expected; yet the lowest female share (D) coincides with the lowest literacy. Policy should target female education and work together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Subtract, Share, Say": subtract for change, divide for share, say what it means.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Mixing percentage points with per cent change is the commonest slip; state which you use.

GS1 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Dholavira, Indus cities

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q9. "Dholavira shows how Harappans planned for water and for people." Discuss the features of Indus Valley urban planning with reference to Dholavira. (250 words)

Model answer

The Indus (Harappan) Civilisation, c. 2600-1900 BCE, is known for planned cities. Dholavira in Kutch, Gujarat was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2021 and shows the system at its best.

Common features of Harappan planning

- Grid-like streets crossing at right angles, with drains along them.
- A raised citadel for rulers or rituals and a lower town for residents.
- Standard-sized baked bricks and uniform weights and measures.
- Covered drains, soak pits and, in many houses, bathrooms and wells.

What is special in Dholavira

- Three divisions, citadel, middle town and lower town, rather than two, each fortified.
- A remarkable system of reservoirs and channels that stored scarce rainwater in an arid island of Kadir.
- Stone used for building, because the site has little clay; a large ceremonial ground and a signboard of ten large Indus letters near the gate.

Significance Water conservation planned at city scale shows early engineering and civic control. It echoes today's water harvesting and watershed work in dry regions, including north Karnataka.

Limits The script is undeciphered and the political system is unclear, so conclusions on rule and religion remain tentative.

Conclusion Harappan cities combined drainage, order and water security; Dholavira adds a lesson in designing with scarcity.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Grid, Drain, Tank": Harappan town in three words.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Dholavira is in Gujarat, built of stone; do not describe it with brick-only features of Mohenjo-daro.

GS1 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · UMP and FPOs

PREDICTED · GS1-C6 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Explain how the Unified Market Platform and farmer producer organisations can raise farm incomes in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Farm incomes suffer from weak bargaining power, fragmented holdings and poor price discovery. Two tools address this: market integration and collective action.

Unified Market Platform (UMP) Karnataka's UMP, the e-marketing platform linking APMC yards, lets traders from different mandis bid online. Of 170 APMCs, 167 are linked, and e-trade worth over Rs 4.39 lakh crore has been recorded (Economic Survey 2025-26). Open bidding improves price discovery and reduces middlemen's margins.

Farmer producer organisations (FPOs)

- Pool produce for bulk sale, share storage and transport costs.
- Access credit, inputs and processing, so farmers capture more value.

Challenges Digital literacy, grading standards, storage and limited FPO capital.

Conclusion UMP widens the market and FPOs widen the farmer's power; together with warehouses and quality grading they move farmers from price-takers to price-makers.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Bid wide, Bunch together": online bids and farmer bunches (FPOs).

COMMON TRAP: UMP is a market platform, not a price guarantee; MSP is a separate tool.

PEAK FACT: 170 APMCs, 167 linked to UMP; transactions Rs 4,39,852.54 crore.

GS1: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Kadambas.

GS1 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Kadambas

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. Evaluate the role of the Kadambas of Banavasi in the making of Karnataka's political and cultural identity. (250 words)

Model answer

The Kadambas (4th to 6th centuries CE) were the first indigenous dynasty of Karnataka to build an independent kingdom, with their capital at Banavasi in present Uttara Kannada.

Political contribution

- Founded by Mayurasharma, who, according to tradition, turned against the Pallavas of Kanchi and established his rule.
- Under Kakusthavarma the kingdom reached its height and made matrimonial ties with the Guptas.
- Their administration used Kannada-speaking local officials, and land grants to Brahmins and temples supported rural settlements.

Cultural contribution

- The Talagunda inscription (Shimoga district) of the Kadambas is an early Sanskrit record of the dynasty's rise.
- The Halmidi inscription, usually dated to around 450 CE, is the earliest known inscription in the Kannada language and is traced to the Kadamba period.
- They patronised temples and Jaina and Buddhist traditions; Banavasi (Madhukeshwara temple) remained a cultural centre for centuries, and the Kadamba architectural style, with its stepped pyramidal tower (shikhara), influenced later temple building.

Evaluation They gave the Kannada region a political centre and gave the Kannada language its first documentary status. Their power was limited and later overshadowed by the Chalukyas of Badami, who absorbed their territory.

Conclusion The Kadambas deserve credit as the first builders of a Kannada-speaking state; the Halmidi inscription is their lasting legacy.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Banavasi, Mayura, Halmidi": the three Ms of Kadamba memory (place, founder, first Kannada).

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse Kadambas of Banavasi (4th century) with the later Kadambas of Goa.

GS1 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Self-Help Groups

PREDICTED · GS1-C7 · Karnataka-specific

Q12. Explain how Self-Help Groups under Sanjeevini-KSRLPS have contributed to rural livelihoods in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Sanjeevini, the Karnataka State Rural Livelihood Promotion Society, implements the National Rural Livelihoods Mission. It builds a three-tier structure: women's SHGs, village-level federations and cluster-level federations.

Reach By the 2025-26 Survey, every SECC-identified household has been covered; 32.23 lakh households are in SHGs and federations.

Contribution

- Thrift and bank credit linkage reduce dependence on moneylenders.
- Livelihood activities such as dairy, tailoring and agri-enterprise raise income.
- Training programmes such as Nal Jal Mitra train women as water-supply technicians.

Challenges Market linkage for products, delay in credit and uneven federation capacity.

Conclusion SHGs turn savings into enterprise and give women a voice in the village; the next step is market access and branding for SHG products.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Save, Lend, Earn, Lead": the four steps of an SHG.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** SHGs are not microfinance companies; they are member-owned and self-managed.

GS1 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Dalit movement

PREDICTED · GS1-B2

Q13. Distinguish between reformative and revolutionary social movements, and assess the Dalit movement in Karnataka in this light. (250 words)

Model answer

A social movement is organised collective action for change in society. Sociologists classify movements by their goals and methods.

Reformative movements Aim at gradual change within the existing system, using law, petition and persuasion. Example: the Arya Samaj and Brahmo Samaj.

Revolutionary movements Aim at replacing the existing order, sometimes by force. Example: the Naxalite movement.

Dalit movement in Karnataka

- Roots: Basavanna's 12th-century rejection of caste hierarchy and the non-Brahmin movement in Mysore in the early 20th century.
- Rise of Dalit Sangharsh Samiti (DSS): founded in the mid-1970s, DSS combined street protest, literature and politics. It resisted caste atrocities, demanded land and dignity, and gave Kannada literature its Dalit-Bandaya strand.
- Methods: mass protests, cultural resistance and later electoral politics.

Assessment It blends both types: its goal, annihilation of caste hierarchy, is radical, but its methods are mostly constitutional, such as legal action and electoral mobilisation. It secured land reform implementation, reservation awareness and cultural voice. Challenges include factionalism, co-option by political parties, and persisting atrocities.

Conclusion The movement began as a radical challenge but works through reformative means within the constitutional frame; it shows how movements can be radical in aim and legal in method.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Aim vs Method": ask what it wants, then how it works.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call a movement revolutionary only because it protests; check whether it seeks to replace the system.

GS1 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Gram Sabha

PREDICTED · GS1-B5

Q14. Explain the role and importance of the Gram Sabha under the Constitution and the challenges in its functioning. (150 words)

Model answer

Article 243(b) defines the Gram Sabha as a body of all persons registered in the electoral rolls of a village within a panchayat area. Article 243A empowers it to exercise the powers and perform the functions that the State Legislature provides.

Importance

- The base of direct democracy; it approves the plan and budget, selects beneficiaries and conducts social audit.
- Makes the panchayat accountable to the people.

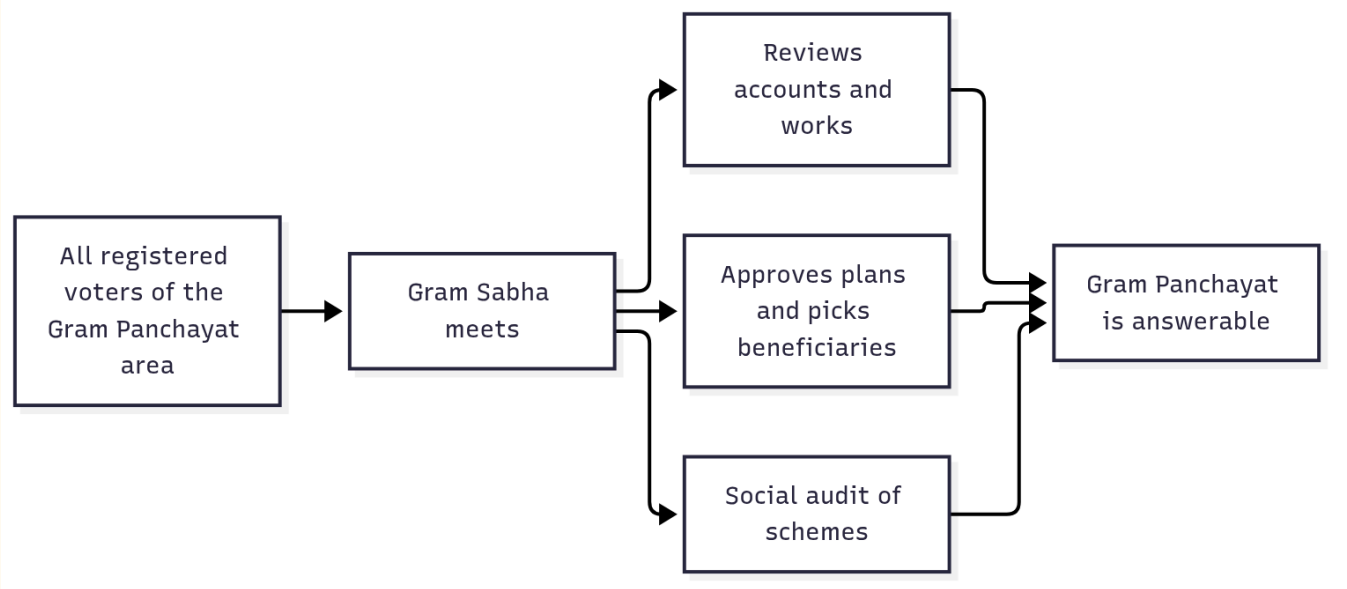
Challenges

- Low attendance, especially of women and marginalised groups.
- Meetings held only on paper; dominance of local elites.
- Poor information and lack of follow-up on decisions.

Measures

- Fixed dates with advance notice, quorum rules and mandatory participation of women.
- Social audit and transparency boards; use of technology for notice and recording.

Conclusion A strong Gram Sabha turns a panchayat from a service office into a self-governing community.



DRAW IT: Gram Sabha at the centre of village democracy. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Sabha = Sab ka Haq": everybody's say.

COMMON TRAP: Gram Sabha is not the same as Gram Panchayat; one is all voters, the other an elected body.

GS1 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Anti-defection law

PREDICTED · GS1-B4

Q15. Evaluate the working of the anti-defection law in India. Has it strengthened or weakened parliamentary democracy? (250 words)

Model answer

The Tenth Schedule, added by the 52nd Amendment (1985), disqualifies a legislator who voluntarily gives up party membership or defies the party whip on a vote. It was meant to end the "Aya Ram, Gaya Ram" politics of floor-crossing.

Strengths

- Gave stability to governments and reduced horse-trading of individuals.
- The 91st Amendment (2003) removed the "one-third split" exemption and left only the two-thirds merger exception.
- The Supreme Court upheld the law in Kihoto Hollohan (1992) and held that the Speaker's decision is subject to judicial review.

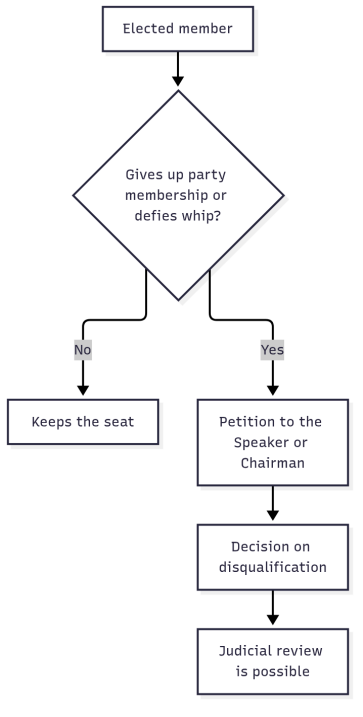
Weaknesses

- Speaker as the deciding authority is a party member, which leads to delay and partisanship.
- It curbs legislators' freedom to vote on conscience or constituency interest, strengthening party leaders.
- Wholesale mergers and mass resignations have found ways around it, as seen in several State legislatures, including Karnataka in 2019.

Reform options

- Transfer decisions to the President or Governor on the Election Commission's advice, or to an independent tribunal.
- Time limit for decisions (the Supreme Court has urged three months).
- Limit whip-bound votes to confidence motions and money bills.

Conclusion The law brought stability but at the cost of legislators' independence; reform should protect the vote on conscience while stopping the sale of mandates.



DRAW IT: How the Tenth Schedule works. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Speaker's speed and Split's shadow": two weak spots.

COMMON TRAP: Anti-defection does not apply to nominated members forever; and independent members joining a party after election are disqualified. Do not state only one side.

PEAK FACT: 52nd Amendment 1985; 91st Amendment 2003; Kihoto Hollohan 1992.

GS1: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, 1991 crisis.

GS1 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · 1991 crisis

PREDICTED · GS1-C2

Q16. Describe the balance of payments crisis of 1991 and the reforms that followed. (150 words)

Model answer

A balance of payments (BoP) crisis occurs when a country cannot finance its import bill with export earnings and capital inflows.

Causes in 1991

- High fiscal and current account deficits through the 1980s.
- The Gulf War of 1990-91 raised oil prices and cut remittances.
- Political uncertainty reduced confidence. Foreign exchange reserves fell to about 1 billion US dollars, enough for only a few weeks of imports.

Response

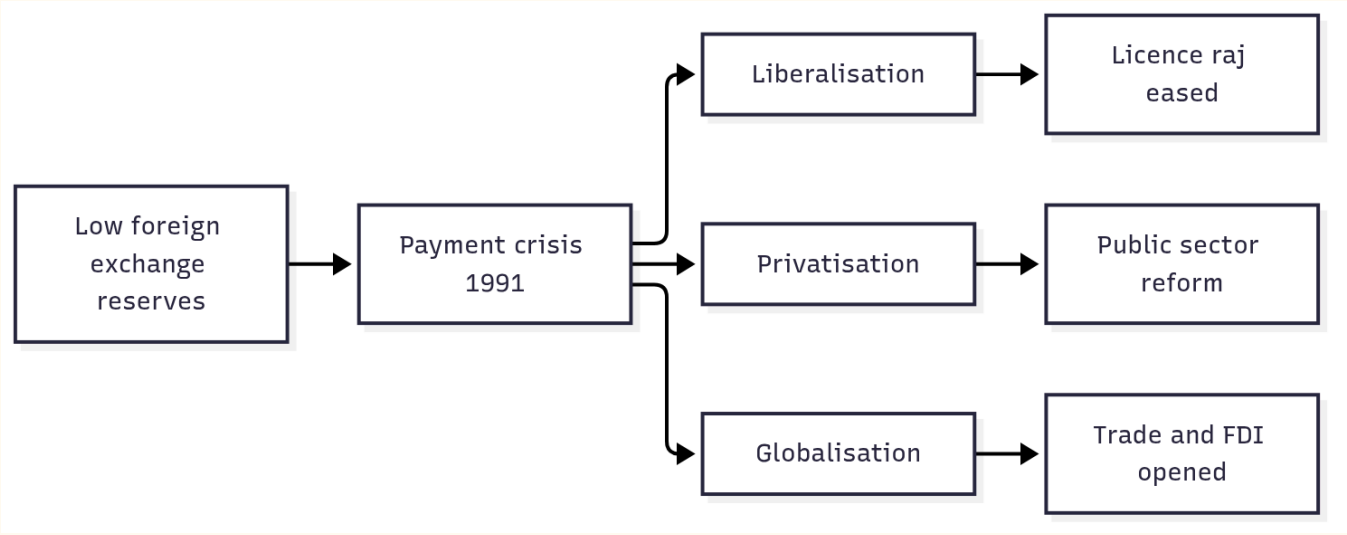
- India airlifted gold to pledge it, and obtained a loan from the IMF.
- The rupee was devalued in July 1991.

Reforms (LPG)

- Liberalisation: abolition of most industrial licensing.

- Privatisation: disinvestment of public sector holdings.
- Globalisation: lower tariffs, FDI opening and moving toward current-account convertibility.

Conclusion The crisis was the trigger for structural reform, and growth accelerated after 1991. Karnataka's IT and biotechnology growth benefited from the new policy climate.



DRAW IT: 1991: from crisis to reform. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "LPG": Liberalise, Privatise, Globalise, plus a Gold pledge.

COMMON TRAP: The reforms began in 1991 but did not end the role of the State; do not call it a total withdrawal.

GS1 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Industry in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-C1

Q17. Trace the industrial journey of Karnataka from the public sector enterprises of the 20th century to the knowledge economy. (250 words)

Model answer

Karnataka's industrial history shows a shift from State-led heavy industry to private, knowledge-based services.

Phase 1: Princely Mysore (1900-1947) Sir M. Visvesvaraya and the Mysore government built Krishnarajasagara dam, the Mysore Iron and Steel Works at Bhadravati (1923), the Mysore Sandalwood Oil factory and the Mysore Sugar Company. Electric power came from the Shivanasamudra hydro project (1902), among Asia's first.

Phase 2: Public sector era (1950s-1980s) Bengaluru became India's centre of defence, aerospace and electronics: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (from 1940), Bharat Electronics Limited, Hindustan Machine Tools, Indian Telephone Industries, BHEL and ISRO's headquarters. Government labs such as the Indian Institute of Science (1909) supplied talent.

Phase 3: IT and biotechnology (from 1990s) Texas Instruments set up in Bengaluru in 1985, followed by Infosys and Wipro. The 1991 reforms and STPI software parks helped. Biotechnology, startups and global capability centres followed.

Phase 4: Knowledge economy today Karnataka introduced India's first Global Capability Centres Policy 2024-29, targeting 500 new GCCs, 3.5 lakh jobs and USD 50 billion contribution.

Assessment Talent from public institutions seeded private growth. Concentration in Bengaluru, however, leaves other regions behind; clusters at Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad and Mangaluru are now being promoted to share the gains.

Conclusion Karnataka moved from steel and sugar to software and semiconductors; the next task is to spread the gains.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Dam, Defence, Digital": three eras in three Ds.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Bengaluru's PSU base came from both Mysore State and Union investment; do not credit only one.

GS1 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Labour codes

PREDICTED · GS1-B6 · Current affairs

Q18. The four labour codes have changed the legal framework for trade unions in India. Explain their role in industrial relations and the concerns raised. (150 words)

Model answer

A trade union is an association of workers formed to protect their interests through collective bargaining. The Trade Unions Act, 1926 gave registered unions legal status.

Role

- Negotiate wages and conditions; represent workers in disputes.
- Provide welfare, training and a political voice.

The labour codes Parliament passed four codes in 2019-2020: on Wages, Industrial Relations, Social Security, and Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions. They subsume 29 earlier central laws and were brought into effect from 21 November 2025.

Concerns

- Higher thresholds for layoff and retrenchment approval in the Industrial Relations Code.
- Stricter conditions for strikes and recognition of unions.

Supportive view Simplified compliance, universal minimum wage and social security for gig and unorganised workers.

Conclusion The codes try to balance flexibility with protection; their success depends on workers' voice and enforcement.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "W-I-S-O": Wages, Industrial relations, Social security, Occupational safety.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the codes repeal all labour laws; 29 central laws were folded into four codes.

GS1 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · Reservation in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-B1 · Karnataka-specific

Q19. Trace the evolution of reservation policy for backward classes in Karnataka from the Miller Committee to the post-independence commissions. (250 words)

Model answer

Karnataka has one of India's oldest traditions of reservation for the non-dominant communities, and its policy shows how a princely State led social policy.

Early steps

- In 1918 the Maharaja of Mysore appointed the Miller Committee, which recommended reservation in government jobs for backward communities, defined as all except Brahmins. Its report was accepted in 1921.
- This responded to the non-Brahmin movement that sought a share in public employment and education.

After independence

- The Constitution (Article 15(4) and 16(4)) allowed special provisions for socially and educationally backward classes.
- The Nagana Gowda Committee (1960) classified backward classes using caste and income tests, and the L.G. Havanur Commission (1975) re-examined the backwardness of communities and widened the list of beneficiaries.
- The Venkataswamy Commission (1983) and the Chinnappa Reddy Commission (1990) revised the lists and categories.
- The Supreme Court's Indra Sawhney ruling (1992) set a 50% ceiling and ruled on the creamy layer for OBCs.

Assessment Karnataka's policy expanded access to education and public jobs and strengthened social justice. Challenges include disputes on the ceiling, sub-categorisation and creamy-layer enforcement.

Conclusion From Miller to the present, the policy has moved from caste-based categories towards social and educational criteria, balancing representation with merit under constitutional limits.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "M-H-V-C": Miller, Havanur, Venkataswamy, Chinnappa: four names, four decades.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat Mysore reservation as the same as the Constitution's Article 16(4); it began 30 years earlier.

GS1 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · NITI Aayog

PREDICTED · GS1-C4

Q20. How does NITI Aayog differ from the Planning Commission in its approach to development planning? (150 words)

Model answer

The Planning Commission (set up in March 1950) drew five-year plans and allocated central assistance to States. NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) replaced it on 1 January 2015.

Differences | Basis | Planning Commission | NITI Aayog | |---|---|---| | Approach | Top-down, centralised | Bottom-up, cooperative federalism | | Role | Allocates funds | Think-tank and advisory body | | Plans | Fixed five-year plans | Strategy documents and long-term vision | | States | Limited voice | Governing Council with Chief Ministers |

Assessment NITI Aayog gives States a larger voice and promotes competitive indices, but has no power to allocate funds; this role is now with the Finance Commission and the Finance Ministry.

Conclusion Planning has moved from commanding to coordinating; its success depends on how well it supports State priorities such as Karnataka's own planning.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Commission COMMANDS, NITI NUDGES."

COMMON TRAP: NITI Aayog is not a constitutional or statutory body; it was created by an executive resolution.

PEAK FACT: Planning Commission 1950; NITI Aayog replaced it on 1 January 2015.

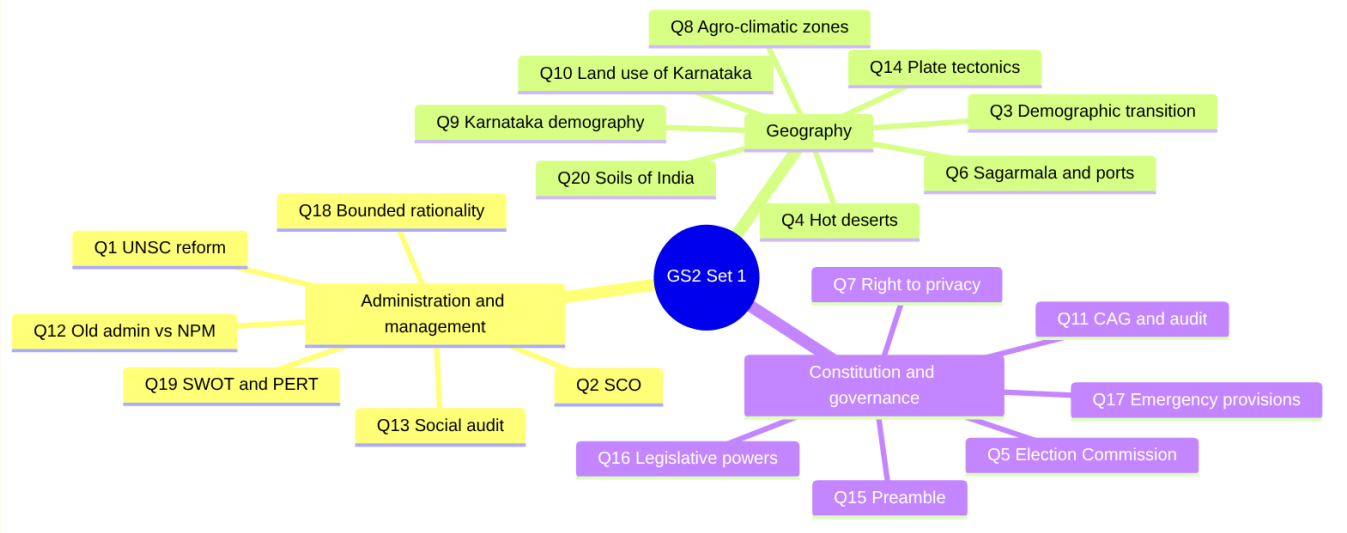
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 1991 crisis:** "LPG": Liberalise, Privatise, Globalise, plus a Gold pledge. **Q17 Industry in Karnataka:** "Dam, Defence, Digital": three eras in three Ds. **Q18 Labour codes:** "W-I-S-O": Wages, Industrial relations, Social security, Occupational safety. **Q19 Reservation in Karnataka:** "M-H-V-C": Miller, Havanur, Venkataswamy, Chinnappa: four names, four decades. **Q20 NITI Aayog:** "Commission COMMANDS, NITI NUDGES."

Paper 3: General Studies II (GS2)

Set 1: step 4 of 6 (General Studies II (GS2)). Next up: General Studies III (GS3)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Geography is about maps and reasons, the Constitution about articles and cases, and administration about clear models with one example each.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS2 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · UNSC reform

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q1. India seeks a permanent seat in a reformed United Nations Security Council. Examine the case for reform, the obstacles, and India's strategy. (250 words)

Model answer

The Security Council (UNSC) has 15 members: five permanent members (P5: USA, UK, France, Russia, China) with veto, and ten elected non-permanent members serving two-year terms. Its structure reflects the 1945 balance of power.

Case for reform

- Legitimacy: Africa and Latin America have no permanent seat; Asia is under-represented.
- India is the most populous country, one of the world's largest economies, a major troop contributor to UN peacekeeping and a nuclear power.
- The veto has paralysed action in crises such as Syria and Ukraine.

Obstacles

- Reform needs a two-thirds vote in the General Assembly and ratification by two-thirds of members including all P5 (Article 108).
- The "Uniting for Consensus" group (Italy, Pakistan and others) opposes new permanent seats.
- P5 reluctance to dilute privilege, and China's reservations.

India's strategy

- Works with the G4 (Brazil, Germany, Japan, India) for expansion in both categories.

- Pursues the Africa Common Position (Ezulwini Consensus) and intergovernmental negotiations on UNSC reform.
- Builds support through peacekeeping, development partnerships and elected terms in the Council (India has served eight times).
- Calls for reformed multilateralism and a Global South voice.

Way forward Incremental options include longer-term seats and a limit on the veto. India should also strengthen its claim through economic strength and credible reform proposals.

Conclusion The case rests on legitimacy and representation; progress needs a coalition larger than the G4 alone.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "G4 knocks, P5 holds the key": Brazil, Germany, Japan, India need the five to agree.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that India has a veto or a permanent seat; it is only a claimant.

GS2 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · SCO

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q2. Explain the significance of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation for India's strategic and regional interests. (150 words)

Model answer

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), founded in 2001 with headquarters in Beijing, is a Eurasian political, security and economic grouping. India and Pakistan joined as full members in 2017; Iran joined in 2023 and Belarus in 2024.

Significance for India

- Central Asia access: The SCO offers a platform for engagement with energy-rich Central Asia, where India has no land route.
- Security cooperation: The Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) allows exchange of intelligence on terrorism and extremism.
- Multipolarity: Membership balances India's partnerships with the West and Russia.
- Connectivity: Links with the International North-South Transport Corridor and Chabahar.

Limits China and Pakistan are members, India has declined to endorse the Belt and Road Initiative in SCO statements, and bilateral disputes limit joint action.

Conclusion The SCO gives India a seat at the table on Eurasian security, but India must use it selectively to protect its interests and sovereignty.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SCO = Sea-less Central-Asia Outreach": India's door to the landlocked heart of Asia.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse SCO (security and economy, Eurasia) with SAARC (South Asia) or BRICS.

GS2 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Demographic transition

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q3. Explain the demographic transition model and assess at which stage India stands. What policy lessons follow for the demographic dividend? (250 words)

Model answer

The demographic transition model describes how population change moves with development, from high birth and death rates to low birth and death rates.

Stages

1. High stationary: birth and death rates are both high; growth is slow.
2. Early expanding: death rates fall because of better health and food; births remain high, so growth is rapid.
3. Late expanding: birth rates also fall; growth slows.
4. Low stationary: both rates are low.
5. Declining (some models): deaths exceed births.

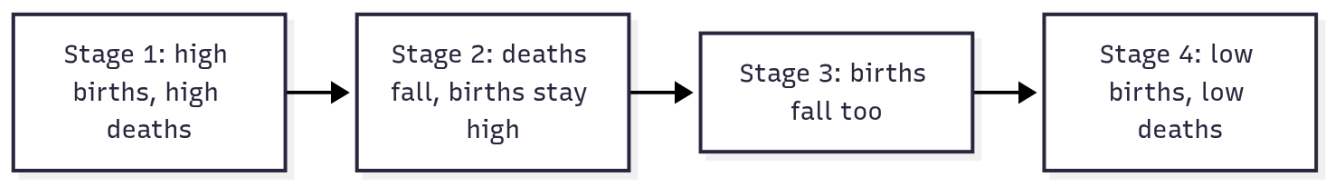
India's position India is in the late-expanding stage, moving towards the low stationary stage. The total fertility rate has fallen to about the replacement level of 2.1 and many States, including Karnataka, are already below it. Population growth continues because of the large young cohort (population momentum). Karnataka's decadal growth was 15.60% in 2001-11 compared with 17.70% for India.

Demographic dividend A rising share of working-age people can raise growth, but only if they are healthy, skilled and employed. The window is limited; it will close as ageing begins, and southern States will age first.

Policy lessons

- Invest in health, nutrition and quality education, especially for girls.
- Create jobs through skills, manufacturing and services.
- Prepare for ageing with pensions, geriatric care and the care economy.
- Manage regional differences between young northern States and ageing southern States.

Conclusion India's dividend is neither automatic nor permanent; it is a policy opportunity.



DRAW IT: Stages of demographic transition. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Down, Down, Slow, Still": deaths fall first, births fall next, growth slows, then stills.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Fertility falling below replacement does not stop growth at once; momentum keeps population rising for decades.

GS2 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · Hot deserts

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q4. Account for the occurrence of hot deserts on the western margins of continents, with examples. (150 words)

Model answer

Most great hot deserts lie between 15° and 30° north and south of the equator, and many of them on the western sides of continents.

Causes

- Subtropical high pressure: Air that rises at the equator descends at about 30°, warming and drying as it sinks, which suppresses cloud formation.
- Trade winds: On the western margins, the trade winds blow from the land, so they carry little moisture.
- Cold currents: Cold ocean currents, such as the Peru (Humboldt), Benguela and Canary currents, cool the air above them, which stabilises it and prevents rain. Fog forms but rainfall does not.

Examples

- Atacama (South America) beside the Peru current.
- Namib (Africa) beside the Benguela current.
- Sahara (north Africa) beside the Canary current.
- Western Australian deserts.

Conclusion Descending dry air and cold coastal currents together create aridity; the Atacama, the driest of all, shows both at work.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "High, Land, Cold": High pressure, wind from Land, Cold current.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Rain shadow explains deserts like the Thar partly, but not the western-margin deserts; do not mix the two causes.

GS2 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Election Commission

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q5. The independence of the Election Commission of India is a cornerstone of free elections. Examine the constitutional safeguards, the 2023 law on appointments, and the debate on special revision of electoral rolls. (250 words)

Model answer

Article 324 vests the superintendence, direction and control of elections in the Election Commission of India (ECI). Its credibility rests on both independence and fair procedure.

Constitutional safeguards

- The Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) can be removed only in the manner and on the grounds of a Supreme Court judge.
- The service conditions of the CEC cannot be varied to his disadvantage after appointment.
- The other Election Commissioners can be removed only on the CEC's recommendation.

The 2023 law on appointments Until 2023 the President appointed the CEC and Election Commissioners on the Government's advice. In Anoop Baranwal (2023) the Supreme Court directed a selection committee of the Prime Minister, the Leader of Opposition and the Chief Justice until Parliament legislated. The CEC and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 replaced the Chief Justice with a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. Critics say this gives the Government a majority in the panel; supporters say the Constitution contemplates a law by Parliament.

Revision of rolls The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, begun in Bihar in 2025, seeks to remove duplicates and ineligible names. Concerns relate to documentation requirements, risk of exclusion of genuine voters and the short timeline.

Way forward

- A broader selection panel and statutory protection for Election Commissioners.
- Transparent, time-bound revision procedure with a clear appeals process.

Conclusion An independent ECI needs a balanced appointment process and a fair, inclusive roll.



DRAW IT: Election Commission: from schedule to result. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Panel, Protect, Purify": Panel for appointment, Protection of tenure, Purify the roll.

COMMON TRAP: Only the CEC has the same removal protection as a Supreme Court judge; the other Commissioners do not.

PEAK FACT: Article 324; Anoop Baranwal 2023; CEC and Other ECs (Appointment) Act 2023; SIR Bihar 2025.

GS2: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Sagarmala and ports.

GS2 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Sagarmala and ports

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q6. Explain the Sagarmala programme and the status of ports in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Sagarmala, launched in 2015 by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, aims at port-led development through modernising ports, port connectivity, port-based industrialisation and coastal community development.

Components

- Port modernisation and new ports.
- Connectivity by rail, road and inland waterways.
- Coastal economic zones and support to fishing communities.

Karnataka's ports Karnataka has one Major Port, New Mangalore Port, which is under the Union Government, and 13 Minor Ports under the State. Under Sagarmala, specialised infrastructure is being created at Karwar Port to handle Class-B petroleum products safely, and a feasibility study has been prepared for Manki Port.

Challenges Last-mile rail connectivity across the Western Ghats, shallow draught at minor ports and environmental limits.

Conclusion Ports can turn the 320 km coastline into a growth corridor if the Ghat connectivity is solved.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Port, Plant, People": port upgrade, port-led industry, coastal people.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call New Mangalore a State port; it is the only Major Port and under the Union.

GS2 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Right to privacy

PREDICTED · GS2-B2 · Current affairs

Q7. "The right to privacy is the constitutional core of the digital age." Discuss with reference to the Puttaswamy judgment and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. (250 words)

Model answer

Privacy is the right to be let alone and to control personal information. The Constitution does not name it, but the Supreme Court has read it into Article 21.

Puttaswamy (2017) A nine-judge bench in K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (24 August 2017) unanimously held privacy to be a fundamental right under Articles 14, 19 and 21. It overruled M.P. Sharma (1954) and Kharak Singh (1962) on this point, and set a three-fold test for any restriction: legality, legitimate aim and proportionality. The case began as a challenge by Justice K.S. Puttaswamy, a retired Karnataka High Court judge, to the Aadhaar scheme.

DPDP Act, 2023

- Applies to digital personal data; consent-based processing with specified "legitimate uses".
- Creates rights to access, correction and erasure, and duties of "data fiduciaries".
- Establishes a Data Protection Board.
- Allows broad exemptions to the State, and amends the RTI Act's treatment of personal information.

Issues

- State exemptions may fall short of the proportionality test.
- Risk to journalism and transparency, and compliance burden on small firms.

Way forward Narrow the exemptions, ensure the Board's independence and provide support for small enterprises. Digital public infrastructure such as Aadhaar and UPI must follow privacy by design.

Conclusion Puttaswamy gave a right; the DPDP Act gives a mechanism. The test is whether the State is bound by the same standard as private actors.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "L-L-P": Legality, Legitimate aim, Proportionality, the three-part test.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** The DPDP Act is not a "right to privacy" law as such; it is a data-processing law resting on the right.

GS2 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Agro-climatic zones

PREDICTED · GS2-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q8. Karnataka's agro-climatic zones shape its cropping pattern. Explain, and comment on the government's plan to re-delineate them. (150 words)

Model answer

Agro-climatic zones group areas with similar rainfall, soil and temperature, so that crops and advisories can be matched to local conditions. Karnataka has a geographical area of 190.50 lakh hectares, of which 118.05 lakh hectares are cultivated by 86.81 lakh farm families.

Broad pattern

- Coastal and Malnad (Western Ghats): heavy rainfall; paddy, arecanut, coffee, spices, cashew.
- Northern dry zone and plateau: low rainfall and black soils; jowar, pulses, cotton, sunflower, groundnut.
- Southern dry zone: red soils; ragi, groundnut, sericulture, fruits and vegetables.

Why re-delineate Recurring droughts and floods have changed rainfall patterns. The State plans an Expert Committee to review and re-delineate the zones for better planning and risk management.

Conclusion Updated zones will help match crops to climate, improve insurance design and advisories, and reduce risk for rainfed farmers.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Wet coast, Dry middle, Red south": three bands of Karnataka crops.

COMMON TRAP: Avoid listing crops without linking them to rainfall and soil.

GS2 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Karnataka demography

PREDICTED · GS2-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. Karnataka's demographic indicators are better than the national average. Discuss, with reference to sex ratio, literacy and urbanisation, and the issues that remain. (250 words)

Model answer

The 2011 Census and later State data show that Karnataka is demographically ahead of the Indian average, but with unfinished tasks.

Indicators

- Population: 6,10,95,297 in 2011, or 5.05% of India, in an area of 1,91,791 sq. km (5.83% of India).
- Growth: 15.60% in 2001-11, below the national 17.70%.
- Sex ratio: 973 females per 1,000 males, against 943 for India.
- Literacy: 75.36%, against 73.00% for India.
- Urbanisation: 38.67% urban, against 31.15% for India.

Why Karnataka does better Earlier social reform in Mysore and coastal districts, expanding education and health infrastructure, and economic opportunities in services, particularly Bengaluru.

Remaining issues

- Falling child sex ratio: The sex ratio at birth was 947 in 2023 and 946 in 2024 (civil registration), below the biological norm. Hence the importance of the PC-PNDT Act, 1994, with over 6,600 registered scanning centres.
- Regional gaps: Literacy and health outcomes in Kalyana Karnataka lag behind southern districts.
- Unplanned urbanisation around Bengaluru.

Way forward Enforce PC-PNDT, invest in girls' education and in Kalyana Karnataka, and plan for an ageing population.

Conclusion Karnataka's lead is real but uneven. The task now is to close gaps within the State: between Bengaluru and Kalyana Karnataka, between boys and girls at birth, and between cities and villages.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "973, 75, 39": sex ratio, literacy, urban per cent, three anchors.

COMMON TRAP: Sex ratio (all ages, 973) is different from sex ratio at birth (946-947); never mix the two.

GS2 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · Land use of Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS2-A6

Q10. Describe the land use pattern of Karnataka and the role of forests in it. (150 words)

Model answer

Land use is the way land is put to use: forest, cultivated land, fallow, pasture, and non-agricultural uses.

Karnataka pattern

- Of a geographical area of 190.50 lakh hectares, 118.05 lakh hectares are cultivated, which is about 62%.
- Recorded forest is 21.21% of the State, and forest and tree cover together form 24.52% (ISFR 2023).
- The rest consists of land put to non-agricultural uses, barren and uncultivable land, pasture and fallow.

Forests

- Protected areas cover 11,399 sq. km of forest, including national parks, sanctuaries and tiger reserves.
- Forests anchor the Western Ghats watersheds that feed the Kaveri, Krishna and Tungabhadra.

Pressures Urban sprawl, mining and human-wildlife conflict.

Conclusion Karnataka's land use must balance food, forests and cities. Forest and tree cover of 24.52% is below the national policy goal of one-third of land, so protecting the Ghats matters most.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Farm, Forest, Fill": farmland, forest, built-up land.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mix recorded forest area (21.21%) and forest-and-tree cover (24.52%).
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Forest 21.21%; forest and tree cover 24.52%.

GS2: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, CAG and audit.

GS2 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · CAG and audit

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q11. Discuss the constitutional position of the Comptroller & Auditor-General (CAG) and the role of audit in legislative control over finance. (250 words)

Model answer

The Comptroller & Auditor-General (CAG), created under Article 148, was described by Dr Ambedkar as perhaps the most important officer under the Constitution. Audit is how the legislature checks that money voted by it was spent as authorised.

Independence

- Appointed by the President; removed only like a Supreme Court judge.
- Salary and service conditions cannot be changed to his disadvantage; he cannot hold any further office under the Government after retirement.
- Expenses charged to the Consolidated Fund of India.

Functions (Articles 149 and 151)

- Audits accounts of the Union and States, and of bodies substantially funded by the Government.
- Audit of receipts and expenditure, with tests of legality, regularity, economy, efficiency and effectiveness.
- Submits reports to the President for the Union and to the Governor for States; these are laid before the legislature.

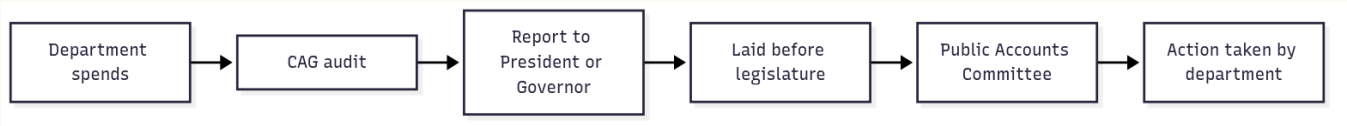
Link with Parliament The Public Accounts Committee examines the CAG's reports; the CAG is often called the PAC's "friend, philosopher and guide". Major reports such as the 2G spectrum audit show its role.

Concerns

- No role in the appointment procedure beyond the executive's choice.
- Delays in PAC discussions, limited follow-up, and no power to enforce recommendations.
- Audit access is limited in public-private partnerships.

Reform A collegium for appointment, time-bound Action Taken Reports and wider audit of PPPs.

Conclusion Audit is the legislature's eye on the executive; independence of the CAG needs matching follow-up by the legislature.



DRAW IT: How audit reaches the legislature. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CAG = the Eyes, PAC = the Voice".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** CAG audits, but does not decide on wrongdoing; the PAC and courts act on the findings.

GS2 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Old admin vs NPM

PREDICTED · GS2-C1

Q12. Compare the traditional model of public administration with the New Public Management. (150 words)

Model answer

Traditional public administration, associated with Max Weber and Woodrow Wilson, stresses hierarchy, rules, permanence and neutrality. New Public Management (NPM), which emerged in the 1980s in the UK and New Zealand, applies private-sector methods to government.

Basis	Traditional	New Public Management
Focus	Rules and procedures	Results and performance
Structure	Hierarchical, centralised	Agencies, decentralised
Citizen	Beneficiary	Customer
Tools	Seniority, process audit	Contracts, targets, competition

Assessment NPM improved efficiency, citizen charters and outsourcing. Critics say it narrows public values to cost and weakens equity, so later "New Public Governance" stresses networks and participation.

India Citizen charters and e-governance, such as Karnataka's Sakala guarantee, show NPM ideas; Mission Karmayogi shows a capacity-building shift.

Conclusion Modern administration needs both: rules for fairness and results for service.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Rules to Results": from "Follow the file" to "Finish the job".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** NPM is not privatisation of all services; it is a management style inside the State.

GS2 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Social audit

PREDICTED · GS2-C6

Q13. Social audit is a tool of monitoring and evaluation of welfare programmes. Explain its legal basis, method and the lessons from MGNREGA, including Karnataka's experience. (250 words)

Model answer

A social audit is an independent, participatory check of whether public resources reached the intended people, carried out by beneficiaries and civil society rather than officials.

Legal basis Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 mandates regular social audit by the Gram Sabha. The Audit of Scheme Rules, 2011 required each State to set up an independent Social Audit Unit.

Method

1. Collect muster rolls, job cards and measurement books.
2. Trained village volunteers verify work, wages and entitlements at the household level.
3. Findings are placed before the Gram Sabha in a public hearing, with officials present.
4. Corrective action and recovery are tracked.

Lessons from MGNREGA

- Exposed fake muster rolls, delays and leakage; raised awareness of the right to work.
- Worked best where the audit unit was independent, as pioneered in Andhra Pradesh.
- Failed where officials retaliated or follow-up was weak.

Karnataka Karnataka's rural employment scheme generated 680.35 lakh person-days up to December 2025, for 21.5 lakh households, with Rs 2,918.97 crore utilised. At this scale, social audit is the main safeguard against leakage.

Way forward Independent funding for audit units, mandatory time-bound recovery, and use of technology (geo-tagging, e-muster) while retaining physical verification.

Conclusion Social audit makes the beneficiary an auditor; its power depends on independence and follow-up.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Verify, Voice, Verdict": check records, speak in Gram Sabha, act on findings.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Social audit is not the same as financial audit by CAG; it is done by the community.

GS2 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Plate tectonics

PREDICTED · GS2-A1

Q14. Explain the theory of plate tectonics and its relation to earthquakes and volcanoes. (150 words)

Model answer

Plate tectonics holds that the Earth's lithosphere is broken into rigid plates that move slowly over the softer asthenosphere, driven by mantle convection, ridge push and slab pull. It grew from Wegener's continental drift (1912) and sea-floor spreading.

Plate boundaries

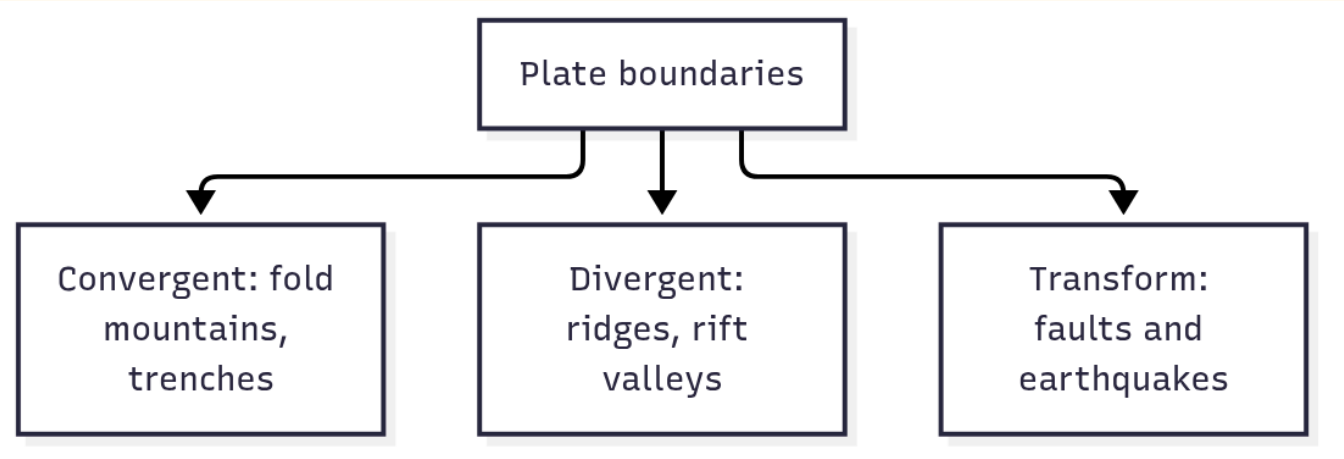
- Divergent: plates move apart, forming mid-ocean ridges and rift valleys (Mid-Atlantic Ridge, East African Rift).

- Convergent: plates collide, forming mountains (Himalayas) or subduction zones with trenches and volcanic arcs (Andes, Japan).
- Transform: plates slide past each other (San Andreas Fault).

Hazards Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur on plate boundaries, as in the Pacific "Ring of Fire", because stress builds and is released there.

India The Indian plate moves north at about 5 cm a year into Eurasia, so the Himalaya is quake-prone; Karnataka lies on the stable shield.

Conclusion The theory unifies mountains, quakes and volcanoes in one explanation.



DRAW IT: Plate boundaries and what they make. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Apart, Together, Past": divergent, convergent, transform.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say volcanoes occur only at plate boundaries; hotspots such as Hawaii are exceptions.

GS2 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Preamble

PREDICTED · GS2-B1

Q15. Examine whether the Preamble is a part of the Constitution and discuss the significance of its key words, including those added in 1976. (250 words)

Model answer

The Preamble sets out the objectives and spirit of the Constitution.

Is it a part?

- In Berubari Union (1960) the Supreme Court said the Preamble is not a part of the Constitution.
- In Kesavananda Bharati (1973) it overruled this: the Preamble is a part of the Constitution and can be amended, but not so as to damage the basic structure.
- In S.R. Bommai (1994) it was again treated as an integral part; in LIC of India (1995) the Court called it an integral part.

Key words

- Sovereign: external and internal independence.
- Socialist, Secular: added by the 42nd Amendment (1976), along with "integrity". Secularism implies equal respect for all religions.
- Democratic, Republic: rule by the people and an elected head of State.

- Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity: the ideals; fraternity assures the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation.

Use of the Preamble It is a key to interpreting ambiguous provisions, but it is neither a source of power nor a limitation on power, nor directly enforceable.

Karnataka link S.R. Bommai, a Karnataka Chief Minister, later used the same constitutional spirit to secure judicial protection of secularism as a basic feature.

Conclusion The Preamble is both a creed and an interpretive guide.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SSDRJ-LEF": Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic; then Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Socialist and Secular were added in 1976, but the idea of secularism was already in the Constitution; do not say it was absent.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Berubari 1960; Kesavananda 1973; 42nd Amendment 1976; Bommai 1994.

GS2: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Legislative powers.

GS2 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · Legislative powers

PREDICTED · GS2-B3

Q16. Explain the distribution of legislative powers between the Centre and the States, and the doctrine of pith and substance. (150 words)

Model answer

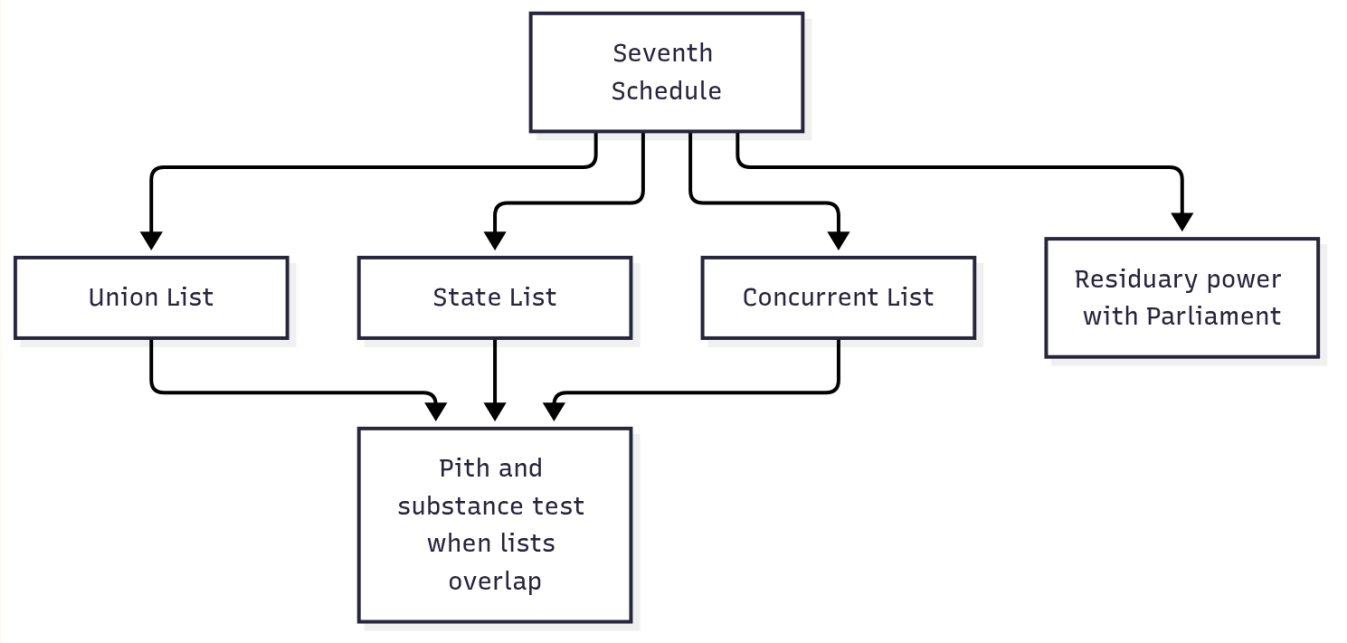
Articles 245-255 distribute legislative powers. Article 246 divides subjects into three lists in the Seventh Schedule: the Union List (Parliament exclusive), State List (State Legislatures exclusive) and Concurrent List (both; Union law prevails in a conflict under Article 254).

Residuary powers Article 248 gives Parliament power over subjects not listed anywhere, unlike the United States, where residuary power lies with States.

Parliament's power over State subjects In certain cases: Rajya Sabha resolution (Article 249), national emergency (Article 250), State consent (Article 252), and treaties (Article 253).

Pith and substance When a law seems to encroach on another list, courts look at its true nature (pith and substance). If it is mainly within the enacting legislature's list, incidental encroachment is allowed. See State of Bombay v. F.N. Balsara (1951).

Conclusion The doctrine adds flexibility to a rigid scheme, but too much central reach tests federalism.



DRAW IT: Three lists, one residuary power. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "U-S-C, 248 residue": three lists, residuary to Union.

COMMON TRAP: Education and forests moved to the Concurrent List in 1976 (42nd Amendment); do not place them in the State List.

GS2 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Emergency provisions

PREDICTED · GS2-B5

Q17. Describe the emergency provisions in the Constitution and the safeguards introduced by the 44th Amendment. How did the S.R. Bommai case limit the misuse of Article 356? (250 words)

Model answer

Part XVIII (Articles 352-360) provides for three kinds of emergency.

Types

- National (Art 352): war, external aggression or armed rebellion; Union takes powers over States and fundamental rights (Art 19) are suspended automatically.
- State (Art 356, President's Rule): failure of constitutional machinery in a State.
- Financial (Art 360): threat to financial stability; never used.

44th Amendment (1978) safeguards

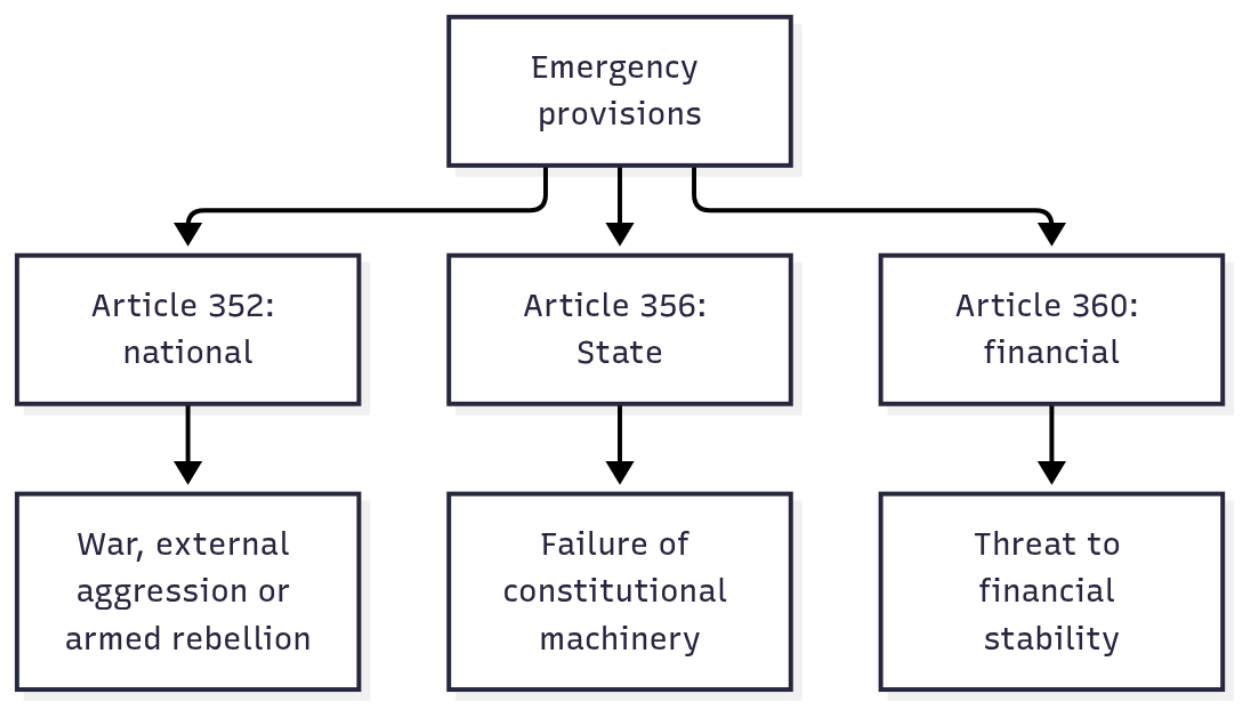
- "Armed rebellion" replaced "internal disturbance".
- The President acts only on the Cabinet's written advice.
- Parliament must approve within one month, by a special majority, and every six months.
- Articles 20 and 21 cannot be suspended.
- One-tenth of Lok Sabha members can demand a special sitting to disapprove it.

the Bommai case (1994) S.R. Bommai, a Janata Dal Chief Minister of Karnataka, was dismissed in 1989 when the Governor said he had lost his majority without a floor test. The Supreme Court held:

- The President's proclamation is subject to judicial review.
- Majority must be tested on the floor of the House, not in the Raj Bhavan.

- Parliament must approve the proclamation within two months, and the Assembly cannot be dissolved before that.
- Secularism is a basic feature; a State acting against it may face action.

Conclusion Bommai turned Article 356 from a political weapon into a judicially checked remedy, and it began with a Karnataka dismissal.



DRAW IT: Three kinds of Emergency. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Floor not Raj Bhavan": prove majority on the floor.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not state that the Bommai case abolished Article 356; it set conditions on its use.

GS2 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Bounded rationality

PREDICTED · GS2-C3

Q18. Compare rational decision-making with Herbert Simon's concept of bounded rationality, with an administrative example. (150 words)

Model answer

Decision-making is choosing among alternatives to solve a problem.

Rational model Assumes the decision-maker defines the problem, lists all options, evaluates consequences fully and chooses the optimal one. It is the ideal in cost-benefit analysis.

Bounded rationality (Simon) Herbert Simon, who won the Nobel Prize in 1978, argued that real decision-makers have limited information, time and mental capacity. They do not optimise, but "satisfice": they choose the first option that meets a minimum standard.

Administrative example A district collector choosing relief measures after floods works with partial damage data under time pressure. She picks a workable package and revises it as new data comes in.

Implications

- Use checklists, standard operating procedures, expert advice and decision-support systems.

- Accept incremental improvement, as in Lindblom's "muddling through".

Conclusion The rational model shows what is ideal; bounded rationality shows what is feasible.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Simon says: Satisfice, don't Optimise."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Satisficing is not carelessness; it is a reasoned stopping rule.

GS2 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · SWOT and PERT

PREDICTED · GS2-C5

Q19. Explain SWOT analysis and the PERT/CPM technique with a simple example, and show how they help a public project such as a metro rail line. (250 words)

Model answer

SWOT analysis appraises an organisation or project by its internal Strengths and Weaknesses and external Opportunities and Threats. For a metro line: strength: dedicated funding and a strong agency; weakness: delays in land acquisition; opportunity: dense demand and green mobility; threat: cost escalation and traffic during construction.

PERT/CPM These are network techniques for scheduling.

- CPM (Critical Path Method): uses fixed activity times. The **critical path** is the longest path through the network; any delay in its activities delays the project.
- PERT (Programme Evaluation and Review Technique): uses three time estimates (optimistic a, most likely m, pessimistic b); expected time is (a + 4m + b) / 6.

Example Activities: A (survey) 2 weeks; B (land) 6 weeks; C (design) 4 weeks; D (civil work) 8 weeks, which needs both B and C.

- Path A-B-D = 2 + 6 + 8 = 16 weeks.
- Path A-C-D = 2 + 4 + 8 = 14 weeks.
- Critical path is A-B-D, 16 weeks; C has 2 weeks of slack.

Use in public projects Metro projects such as Namma Metro in Bengaluru involve land, utilities, design and civil work in parallel. Network techniques identify the critical path, manage slack and fix accountability.

Limits Estimates are uncertain and need regular updating.

Conclusion SWOT chooses the direction; PERT/CPM keeps the clock.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SWOT looks around; PERT looks at the clock."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Critical path is the LONGEST path, not the shortest; do not reverse it.

GS2 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Soils of India

PREDICTED · GS2-A3

Q20. Describe the major soil types of India and their crop suitability, with reference to the black and red soils of Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Soil is shaped by parent rock, climate and vegetation. The Indian Council of Agricultural Research classifies India's soils into eight major groups.

Major types

- Alluvial: Indo-Gangetic plains; fertile; wheat, rice, sugarcane.
- Black (regur): Deccan lava; retains moisture; cotton, jowar, pulses.
- Red and yellow: crystalline rocks; poor in nitrogen; ragi, groundnut, millets.
- Laterite: heavy rainfall regions; leached; cashew, tea, coffee, rubber.
- Arid, mountain and saline soils.

Karnataka

- The northern plateau (Kalaburagi, Raichur, Vijayapura) has deep black soil for cotton, jowar and pulses.
- The southern maidan and old Mysore region have red soils for ragi, groundnut and horticulture.
- Coastal and Malnad areas have laterite soils for arecanut, cashew and coffee.

Conclusion Matching crops to soil raises yields and reduces input cost; soil health cards and scientific fertiliser use help conserve soil.

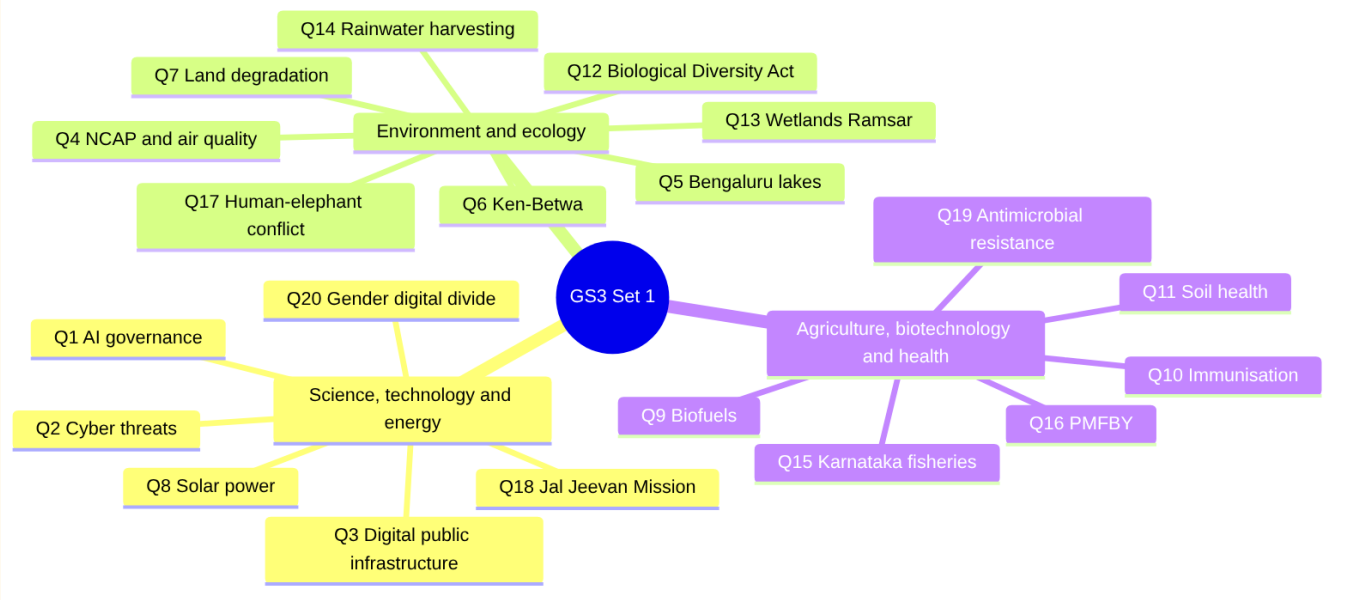
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Black = Cotton cradle, Red = Ragi, Laterite = Cashew."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say laterite soil is fertile; it is acidic and needs management.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Soil classification and crops.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Legislative powers:** "U-S-C, 248 residue": three lists, residuary to Union. **Q17 Emergency provisions:** "Floor not Raj Bhavan": prove majority on the floor. **Q18 Bounded rationality:** "Simon says: Satisfice, don't Optimise." **Q19 SWOT and PERT:** "SWOT looks around; PERT looks at the clock." **Q20 Soils of India:** "Black = Cotton cradle, Red = Ragi, Laterite = Cashew."

Paper 4: General Studies III (GS3)

Set 1: step 5 of 6 (General Studies III (GS3)). Next up: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Science answers score when they join a scheme, a number and a Karnataka example. Draw the small diagrams; they save words.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS3 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · AI governance

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q1. Artificial intelligence promises growth but raises risks of bias, job loss and misuse. Discuss India's approach to AI governance and the role of Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Artificial intelligence (AI) refers to systems that learn from data to perform tasks such as prediction, language use and decision support. Generative AI has made it a general-purpose technology.

Opportunities

- Agriculture: crop advisories and price forecasts for small farmers.
- Health: diagnostic support in places with few doctors.
- Governance: grievance analysis, language translation (Bhashini), and fraud detection.

Risks

- Algorithmic bias and opaque decisions; deepfakes and misinformation.
- Automation of routine jobs; concentration of computing power in a few firms.
- Privacy and data security.

India's approach

- The IndiaAI Mission (approved in March 2024 with an outlay of Rs 10,371.92 crore over five years) funds computing capacity, datasets, foundation models and skilling.

- India follows a "light-touch, pro-innovation" approach: existing laws, the DPDP Act, 2023 and the IT Act, 2000, along with voluntary guidelines, rather than a single AI statute.
- India hosted the AI Impact Summit in New Delhi in February 2026.

Karnataka Bengaluru hosts many AI start-ups and global capability centres. The State's new IT Policy 2025-30 is aimed at deep-tech and AI, with growth in clusters beyond Bengaluru.

Way forward Risk-based regulation for high-risk uses, audit of public-sector algorithms, local-language datasets and reskilling for displaced workers.

Conclusion India's challenge is to keep the speed of innovation without losing the safeguard of accountability.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "BIAS: Bias, Impact on jobs, Abuse, Secrecy": the four AI risks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** India has no single AI law; do not write that an "AI Act" has been passed.

GS3 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · Cyber threats

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q2. Examine the main cyber threats to India and the legal and institutional framework to counter them. (150 words)

Model answer

Cyber threats arise from the growth of digital payments, e-governance and connected infrastructure.

Threats

- Ransomware and attacks on power grids, hospitals and banks.
- Phishing and digital arrest frauds against citizens.
- State-sponsored espionage and attacks on critical information infrastructure.
- Deepfakes and data breaches.

Framework

- Law: the Information Technology Act, 2000 (Section 66 offences; Section 70 for protected systems) and the DPDP Act, 2023.
- Institutions: CERT-In (incident response, since 2004), the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre (NCIIPC), and the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) with the portal cybercrime.gov.in.
- Karnataka: a Cyber Crime Command (CID) and cyber police stations, as Bengaluru has the largest share of IT activity.

Gaps Low awareness, a shortage of skilled staff and slow cross-border cooperation.

Conclusion Resilience needs law, skilled staff, and an informed citizen, because most attacks begin with a human click.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Think before you click": most cyber fraud needs the victim's cooperation.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** CERT-In handles incidents; NCIIPC protects critical infrastructure. Do not swap them.

GS3 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Digital public infrastructure

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q3. Digital public infrastructure has changed payments and welfare delivery in India. Examine the features of UPI and the India Stack, and the challenges that remain. (250 words)

Model answer

Digital public infrastructure (DPI) means shared, open digital systems, such as identity, payments and data exchange, on which public and private services are built.

India Stack layers

- Identity: Aadhaar, a 12-digit biometric-based identity.
- Payments: the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) of NPCI, launched in 2016, enables instant bank-to-bank transfers by phone.
- Data: the Account Aggregator framework, which allows sharing of financial data with consent, and DigiLocker.

Impact

- UPI processes billions of transactions every month, including small street vendors in Bengaluru and Mysuru.
- Direct Benefit Transfer reduces leakage in welfare schemes. Karnataka transfers guarantee-scheme payments such as Gruha Lakshmi directly to bank accounts.
- UPI has also been linked with systems such as Singapore's PayNow.

Challenges

- Digital divide in rural and Kalyana Karnataka areas; exclusion where Aadhaar authentication fails.
- Cyber fraud, privacy and the dependence of the system on a few players (market concentration).
- Zero merchant fees affect the long-term business model of banks.

Way forward Local-language interfaces, offline options, quick grievance redress, data-protection compliance and a cap on the market share of any single app. Digital literacy drives for women and senior citizens would also widen the user base.

Conclusion India's DPI shows that public rails with private innovation can scale, but trust and inclusion decide whether it endures.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "I-P-D": Identity, Payments, Data: three rails of India Stack.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** UPI is a payment system run by NPCI, not an app; the apps are PhonePe, Google Pay and others.

GS3 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · NCAP and air quality

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q4. What are the main sources of urban air pollution? Explain the National Clean Air Programme and the measures Bengaluru can adopt. (150 words)

Model answer

Urban air pollution comes from vehicles, dust, burning of waste, industry and power plants. Fine particles (PM2.5) harm lungs and the heart.

National Clean Air Programme (NCAP), 2019 A time-bound programme for non-attainment cities to cut particulate pollution, using city action plans, monitoring and funds for dust control and public transport. Targets were first set for 2024 and later extended to 2026.

Bengaluru Vehicles are the largest source. Karnataka plans to run 148 non-air-conditioned electric buses on a gross-cost-contract model under the NCAP and DULT schemes, of which 113 were already in operation.

Measures

- Electric buses, metro expansion and a cap on private vehicles.
- Dust control at construction sites, no open burning, and cleaner fuels.
- Real-time monitoring and public alerts.

Conclusion Cleaner air depends on shifting trips from private vehicles to public transport; monitoring should guide action.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "V-D-B": Vehicles, Dust, Burning, the three big urban sources.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** NCAP has city-level targets; it is not a legally binding limit.

GS3 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Bengaluru lakes

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q5. Lake pollution in Bengaluru has become a symbol of urban ecological failure. Examine its causes, consequences and the remedies being tried. (250 words)

Model answer

Bengaluru was built on a chain of tanks (kere) that stored rainwater and recharged groundwater. Lakes such as Bellandur and Varthur now show toxic froth and fires, which reveal sewage and industrial effluent.

Causes

- Untreated sewage entering the lakes from a growing city, exceeding treatment capacity.
- Encroachment on lake beds and stormwater drains.
- Industrial effluents and dumping of solid waste.
- Loss of the interconnected tank system that once carried water between lakes.

Consequences

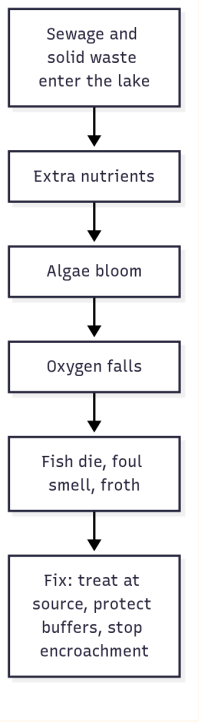
- Froth and foul smell, fish deaths and loss of groundwater recharge.
- Flooding in the monsoon because stormwater drains are blocked.
- Health risks to nearby residents.

Remedies

- Rejuvenation: The State has earmarked Rs 100.30 crore for Bellandur Lake with 73% of desilting completed (as of the Survey).
- Used-water treatment: The Tolanakeri used-water treatment plant, commissioned in May 2020, shows that treated water can refill lakes naturally.
- Law: The National Green Tribunal and High Court orders on buffer zones, with Lake Development Authority oversight.
- Community: Citizen groups for lake adoption and monitoring.

Way forward Treat every drop of sewage before it enters a lake; restore the connectivity of drains; enforce buffer zones.

Conclusion Lakes can recover when sewage is treated at source, and when citizens guard them.



DRAW IT: How a city lake gets sick. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Stop the flow, Free the drain, Guard the edge": three lake rules.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Desilting alone does not clean a lake; unless sewage is stopped, the lake refills with pollution.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Bellandur Rs 100.30 crore; 73% desilting.

GS3: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Ken-Betwa.

GS3 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Ken-Betwa

PREDICTED · GS3-C5 · Current affairs

Q6. Explain the objectives of the Ken-Betwa link project and the environmental concerns raised against river interlinking. (150 words)

Model answer

River interlinking aims to transfer water from surplus to deficit basins to counter droughts and floods. The National Perspective Plan (1980) identified Himalayan and Peninsular components.

Ken-Betwa Link Project The first project under the plan connects the Ken river in Madhya Pradesh to the Betwa river in Uttar Pradesh, to irrigate drought-prone Bundelkhand. The Prime Minister laid the foundation stone in December 2024. The Daudhan dam will be built in Panna Tiger Reserve.

Concerns

- Submergence of forest and tiger habitat, and displacement of people.
- Doubts about the water surplus in the Ken basin.
- Ecological flow of rivers and the cost of the project.

Karnataka link The Peninsular component includes the Mahanadi-Godavari-Krishna-Pennar-Cauvery chain, which would involve Karnataka's rivers and inter-State water disputes.

Conclusion Water security in Bundelkhand matters, but demand management and local tanks should be developed alongside interlinking.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Ken to Betwa, Tigers in between": the dam sits inside a tiger reserve.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Ken-Betwa is the first, not the only, link; other links are still at planning stage.

GS3 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Land degradation

PREDICTED · GS3-C5

Q7. Land degradation and desertification threaten India's food and water security. Explain the causes and the measures for reclaiming wasteland, with examples from Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Land degradation is the decline in the biological or economic productivity of land. Desertification is its extreme form in dry regions. India has hosted the 14th Conference of the Parties of the UN Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) in 2019 and committed to restoring 26 million hectares of degraded land by 2030.

Causes

- Water erosion, wind erosion and salinity or waterlogging in irrigated areas.
- Deforestation, overgrazing and shifting cultivation.
- Mining, construction and excessive use of chemicals.

Effects Loss of soil fertility, falling crop yields, silted reservoirs, falling groundwater recharge and rural distress. Poor households that depend on rainfed farming and common grazing land suffer most.

Measures

- Watershed management: contour bunds, check dams and farm ponds. Karnataka has treated 74.94 lakh hectares through watershed interventions against 129.70 lakh hectares available.
- Afforestation: the Green India Mission and farm forestry.
- Soil health: soil health cards, crop rotation and organic matter.
- Rainfed agriculture: a comprehensive Rainfed Agriculture Policy for climate-resilient practices.

Karnataka Dry districts of the north and the south interior face erosion and low rainfall. Watershed development across them improves groundwater and incomes.

Conclusion Treat land as a living asset, with community ownership of restoration: restoring one hectare of soil helps food, water and climate together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SOIL": Save water, Open pasture, Increase trees, Lessen chemicals.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Desertification is not the spread of existing deserts alone; it is degradation in dry sub-humid zones.

GS3 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Solar power

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q8. Explain how solar energy can help farmers and households. Describe PM-KUSUM, PM Surya Ghar and the Pavagada solar park. (150 words)

Model answer

Solar energy converts sunlight into electricity through photovoltaic cells. India's sunshine, falling costs and the target of 500 GW of non-fossil capacity by 2030 make it central to the energy transition.

For farmers: PM-KUSUM (2019) Provides solar pumps, solarisation of grid-connected pumps and small solar plants on farm land. It reduces diesel and subsidy costs and lets farmers sell surplus power.

For households: PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana (2024) Aims to install rooftop solar for one crore households with central financial assistance, to reduce bills.

Karnataka Pavagada in Tumakuru district is one of the largest solar parks in the country, and Karnataka is recognised as the second-largest solar-park host. Feeder solarisation separates farm power supply from domestic supply.

Challenges Grid integration, storage and land use.

Conclusion Solar can cut bills and make farmers energy producers.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Pump, Roof, Park": KUSUM for pumps, Surya Ghar for roofs, Pavagada for parks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Rooftop solar is for households; do not credit PM-KUSUM with it.

GS3 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Biofuels

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q9. Examine the role of ethanol and other biofuels in India's energy and agricultural policy. What are the concerns? (250 words)

Model answer

Biofuels are fuels made from biomass. Ethanol is blended with petrol; biodiesel with diesel.

Policy

- The National Policy on Biofuels (2018, amended 2022) allows ethanol from sugarcane juice, molasses, damaged grain and surplus rice, and advanced biofuels (2G) from agricultural residue.
- The Ethanol Blended Petrol programme moved from 5% blending in 2019-20 to about 20% (E20) by 2025, five years ahead of the original 2030 target.
- Support includes interest subvention for distilleries, and administered prices for ethanol.

Benefits

- Lower crude imports and carbon emissions; assured demand for cane and surplus grain.
- Better income for sugarcane farmers; a use for crop residue.

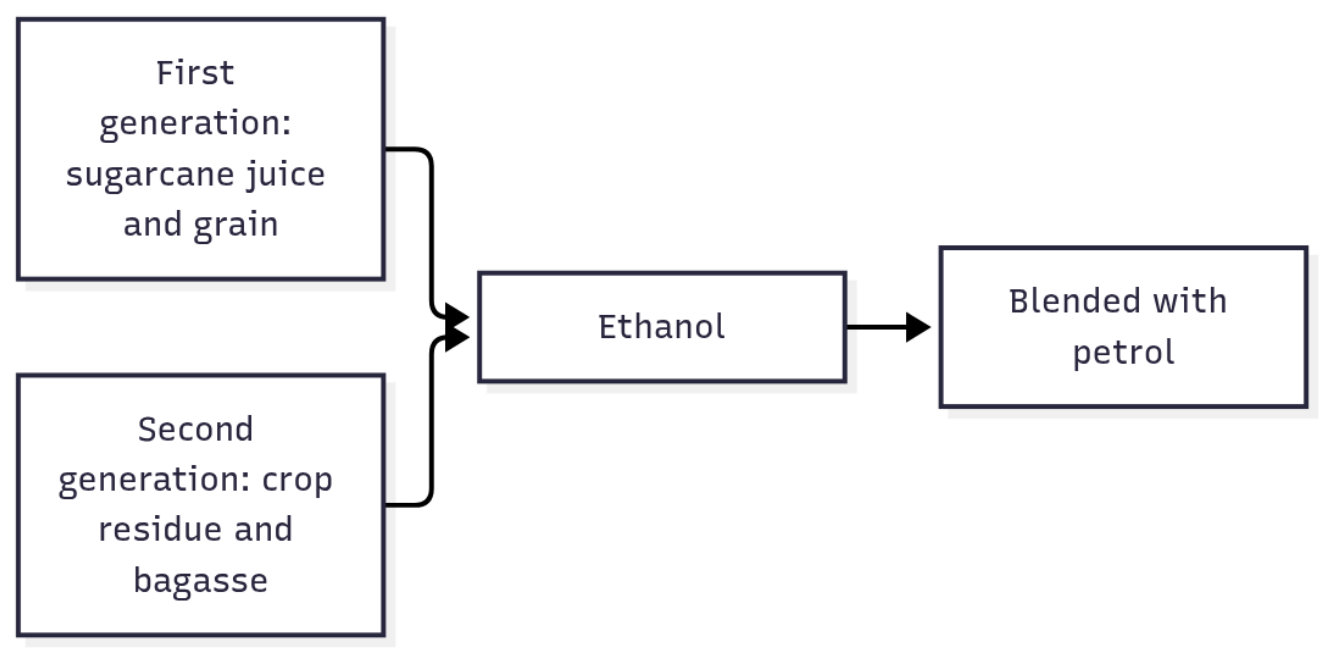
Karnataka Karnataka is a major sugarcane State. Its Bioenergy Development Programme promotes biofuel plantations under MGNREGA and forestry schemes, and its policy encourages blending of bio-ethanol and biodiesel.

Concerns

- Food versus fuel: diverting grain and sugarcane raises the water demand of cane and may affect food prices.
- Lower fuel economy at higher blends for older vehicles.
- Limited feedstock for 2G biofuels; high cost of collecting residue.

Way forward Move to residue-based, non-food feedstock; protect the food basket; support flex-fuel vehicles and farmers' income.

Conclusion Ethanol helps both farm and fuel economy, but it must not compete with food and water.



DRAW IT: Two generations of ethanol. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Cane to Can": sugarcane to fuel can, but "Food First".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** 2G ethanol uses non-food residue; 1G uses cane and grain. Do not mix them.

GS3 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · Immunisation

PREDICTED · GS3-B7

Q10. Explain the Universal Immunisation Programme and the role of Mission Indradhanush in raising coverage. (150 words)

Model answer

The Universal Immunisation Programme (UIP), started in 1985, protects children and pregnant women against vaccine-preventable diseases such as tuberculosis, diphtheria, pertussis, tetanus, polio, measles, hepatitis B and others. Vaccines are free, and delivered through sub-centres and anganwadis.

Gaps Children missed because of migration, remote habitation, urban slums and hesitancy.

Mission Indradhanush (2014) A drive to reach "partially vaccinated" and "unvaccinated" children, especially in low-coverage districts. Its later phases, called "Intensified Mission Indradhanush", used micro-planning of hard-to-reach areas, mobilisation by ASHA workers and tracking through digital platforms, such as U-WIN for e-records.

Karnataka The State's health programme uses ASHA workers and e-tracking of mother and child; coverage is better in urban areas than in remote tribal habitations.

Conclusion High coverage requires reaching the last child. Tracking, trust and community health workers close the gap.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Rainbow = seven diseases": Indradhanush's original seven vaccine-preventable diseases.

COMMON TRAP: Indradhanush is a campaign inside the UIP, not a new vaccine or a replacement for it.

PEAK FACT: UIP 1985; Mission Indradhanush 2014; U-WIN.

GS3: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Soil health.

GS3 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Soil health

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q11. Discuss the importance of soil health and the role of organic and integrated nutrient management. What are the limitations of chemical fertiliser use? (250 words)

Model answer

Soil health is the capacity of soil to function as a living system that sustains plants, animals and humans.

Why chemical fertilisers need care

- Imbalanced use of nitrogen over phosphorus and potash lowers response and raises costs. India's subsidy on urea encourages overuse.
- Leaching of nitrates harms groundwater; runoff causes eutrophication; and fertilisers emit nitrous oxide.
- Long-term decline in organic carbon and microbial life.

Integrated nutrient management Combines chemical fertiliser with organic sources and biofertilisers:

- Farmyard manure, compost, vermicompost and green manure.
- Biofertilisers: Rhizobium, Azotobacter and phosphate-solubilising bacteria.
- Soil testing: the Soil Health Card scheme (2015) advises balanced doses.
- Neem-coated urea (2015) and nano-urea to improve efficiency.

Organic and natural farming Karnataka has an Organic Farming Policy (2017) and the Centre's National Mission on Natural Farming. An Organic and Millet Hub is being established at Hebbal in Bengaluru to give producers market access.

Limitations of organic alone Slower yield response in the early years, bulky inputs and certification costs.

Way forward Balanced use based on soil tests, support for organic inputs, price premium for organic produce and extension through farmer producer organisations.

Conclusion Feed the soil, not just the plant; the balance of chemical, organic and biological inputs is the best option.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Test, Top-up, Turn the soil": test the soil, top up what is lacking, add organic matter.

COMMON TRAP: Organic farming is not zero input; it needs manures, biofertilisers and certification.

GS3 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Biological Diversity Act

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q12. Explain the Biological Diversity Act, 2002 and the working of Biodiversity Management Committees. (150 words)

Model answer

Under the Convention on Biological Diversity (1992) and the Nagoya Protocol (adopted 2010) on access and benefit sharing (ABS), India enacted the Biological Diversity Act, 2002, which gives effect to these treaties.

Three-tier structure

- National Biodiversity Authority (NBA), Chennai, at the Centre.
- State Biodiversity Boards, such as the Karnataka Biodiversity Board.
- Biodiversity Management Committees (BMCs) at the local body level.

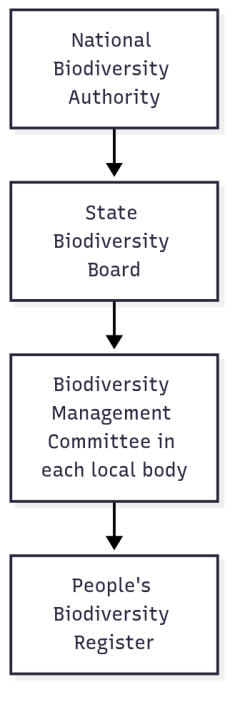
Key provisions

- Foreign nationals and companies need NBA approval for access to biological resources.
- Benefit-sharing with local communities that conserve and use the resource.
- BMCs prepare People's Biodiversity Registers that document local knowledge and resources.

Karnataka The State has 6,554 BMCs in gram panchayats, linking local communities with conservation.

Issues Weak documentation, little benefit-sharing so far and limited funds for BMCs.

Conclusion BMCs turn biodiversity law into village action; the Act succeeds if communities share in the benefit.



DRAW IT: Three tiers of biodiversity governance. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "N-S-B": National Authority, State Board, BMC at local body.

COMMON TRAP: The BMC is a local body committee, not a forest department unit.

GS3 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Wetlands, Ramsar

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q13. Wetlands provide vital ecosystem services but are under threat. Explain their value, the threats, and India's Ramsar commitments, with examples from Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Wetlands include lakes, marshes, mangroves, estuaries and reservoirs. The Ramsar Convention (1971) provides for the "wise use" of wetlands and lists sites of international importance.

Services

- Flood moderation and groundwater recharge.
- Water purification (natural filters).
- Fisheries and livelihoods for coastal communities.
- Habitat for migratory birds and carbon storage, especially in mangroves.

Threats

- Encroachment, drainage and conversion to real estate, which is common around growing cities.
- Pollution from sewage and agriculture.
- Invasive species; climate change and sea-level rise.

India and Karnataka India has designated many Ramsar sites, which include Karnataka's Ranganathittu Bird Sanctuary (designated 2022). Later Karnataka additions include Magadi Kere, Ankasamudra and the Aghanashini estuary, each of which brings community conservation to the foreground.

Legal framework Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017, which set up State Wetland Authorities, and the National Plan for Conservation of Aquatic Ecosystems.

Way forward Map and notify all wetlands, and stop encroachment. Treat sewage before it reaches water bodies, and let local fishing and farming communities share in management through wetland committees. Regular water-quality and bird monitoring should be made public, so that decline is noticed early.

Conclusion Wetlands are the kidneys of the landscape; destroying them damages water, food and climate security together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Kidneys of the Land": wetlands filter, store and regulate.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Ramsar listing does not by itself give legal protection; domestic law must back it.

GS3 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Rainwater harvesting

PREDICTED · GS3-C2

Q14. Rainwater harvesting can ease urban water stress. Explain its methods and the policy support, with reference to Bengaluru. (150 words)

Model answer

Rainwater harvesting (RWH) collects and stores rain for use or groundwater recharge. It is relevant to cities that depend on distant rivers and falling water tables.

Methods

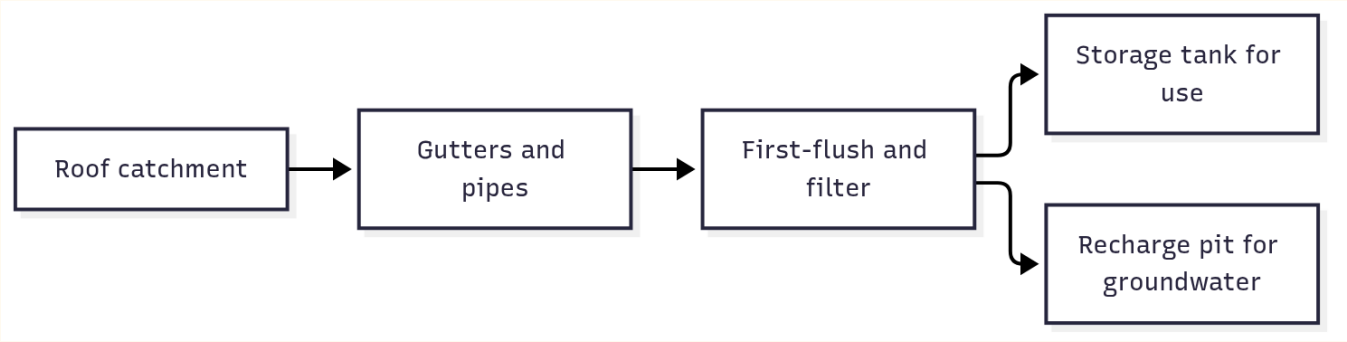
- Rooftop harvesting: roof water through filters into storage tanks or recharge pits and borewells.
- Surface runoff: recharge trenches and percolation tanks.
- Lake rejuvenation: restoring lakes so stormwater recharges aquifers.

Policy support

- Karnataka made RWH compulsory in Bengaluru for larger buildings through BWSSB rules.
- The Centre's Jal Shakti Abhiyan: "Catch the Rain" campaign.
- Rainfall data from the State's telemetric network helps plan storage and recharge.

Challenges Weak enforcement, poor maintenance, contamination of recharge wells and low awareness among apartment residents. Open soil in cities is shrinking, which limits natural recharge.

Conclusion Every roof can be a small reservoir; compliance and maintenance matter more than rules on paper.



DRAW IT: Rooftop rainwater harvesting. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Catch, Clean, Keep": catch rain, clean by filter, keep in tank or soil.

COMMON TRAP: RWH is not only storage; recharge of groundwater is equally vital.

GS3 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Karnataka fisheries

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Fisheries are an important livelihood on Karnataka's coast and in its inland waters. Examine the status, challenges and policy measures. (250 words)

Model answer

Fisheries provide high-quality protein, employment and foreign exchange. Karnataka has a coastline on the Arabian Sea and inland waters in reservoirs, tanks and rivers.

Status

- Fish production rose from 5.81 lakh tonnes in 2015-16 to 9.63 lakh tonnes in 2024-25, a growth of 8.31% a year. The sector contributes 0.48% of GSDP.
- About 9.84 lakh fishers, of whom 3.31 lakh are marine and 6.53 lakh inland.
- 25,246 fishing boats operate in marine waters: 4,828 mechanised, 11,443 motorised, 8,953 traditional and 22 deep-sea vessels.

Challenges

- Overfishing near the shore and declining catch per boat.
- Climate variability, cyclones and warming seas.
- Marine pollution, plastics and loss of mangroves.
- Market access, cold chain and indebtedness.

Policy measures

- PMMSY (Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana) for infrastructure.
- A savings-cum-relief scheme for marine fishers during the lean season.

- Fish Farmers Producer Organisations; fish seed production centres for inland fisheries.
- A monsoon fishing ban to protect breeding.

Way forward Sustainable catch limits and scientific stock assessment, deep-sea fishing capacity, value addition in processing, cold storage near landing centres, and insurance for fishers. Women in fish vending and drying need credit and market access.

Conclusion The blue economy can grow if fish stocks and fishing families both are protected.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Catch, Cold, Credit": boats and catch, cold chain, credit and insurance.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** The marine fishing ban is a conservation measure for breeding; do not describe it as a punishment.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Fish production 5.81 to 9.63 lakh tonnes; 8.31% growth; 0.48% of GSDP.

GS3: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, PMFBY.

GS3 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · PMFBY

PREDICTED · GS3-B6

Q16. Explain how the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana works and the issues in its implementation, with reference to Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Crop insurance protects farmers from yield losses caused by non-preventable natural risks. The Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY), launched from Kharif 2016, covers risks from pre-sowing to post-harvest.

Features

- Farmers pay a low premium: 2% for kharif foodgrains and oilseeds, 1.5% for rabi crops and 5% for commercial and horticultural crops; the rest is shared by the Centre and the State.
- Claims are based on yield estimated through crop-cutting experiments, with satellite data and drones increasingly used.

Karnataka Under Karnataka Raitha Suraksha PMFBY, about 25.76 lakh farmers had enrolled by December 2025, with 22.64 lakh hectares insured.

Issues

- Delays in claim settlement and disputes over yield data.
- Low awareness among tenant farmers.
- High premium subsidy burden on States.

Conclusion Crop insurance should be quick, transparent and technology-based, so farmers trust it.



DRAW IT: A crop insurance claim. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "2-1.5-5": the farmer's premium: kharif, rabi, commercial.

COMMON TRAP: Premiums are capped for farmers; the rest is subsidy, not "free insurance".

GS3 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Human-elephant conflict

PREDICTED · GS3-C1 · Karnataka-specific

Q17. Human-elephant conflict is a growing challenge in Karnataka. Examine its causes, the measures taken and a long-term strategy. (250 words)

Model answer

Karnataka, with an estimated 6,395 elephants in the 2023 estimation, ranks first among States and holds nearly a quarter of India's elephants. This large population shares land with farms and villages in Hassan, Kodagu, Chamarajanagar and Mysuru.

Causes

- Loss and fragmentation of forest and corridors by plantations, mining, roads and railways.
- Crop-raiding because farms are near forests and the crops are nutritious.
- Invasive weeds such as lantana reduce fodder in forests.
- Population growth in protected areas.

Consequences Loss of human life and crops, strain on rural livelihoods, retaliation and electrocution of elephants, and local resentment toward conservation.

Measures taken

- 428 km of railway barricades, 1,360.87 km of solar fencing and 1,775.41 km of elephant-proof trenches.
- The Bandipur Elephant Task Force and early-warning systems.
- Compensation for crop and life loss, and rapid response teams.

Long-term strategy

- Secure and notify elephant corridors with community consent.
- Restore forest fodder and water, and remove lantana.
- Use technology for real-time alerts to villagers.
- Crop insurance and alternative crops such as chilli and lemon that elephants avoid.
- Voluntary relocation of farms from corridors and village-level coexistence plans.

Conclusion Fences hold elephants only for a season; secure corridors and local trust protect both farmers and elephants.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Fence, Forest, Farmer": Barriers now, Forest fodder next, Farmer income last.

COMMON TRAP: Translocation of problem elephants rarely works; it moves the conflict to a new place.

GS3 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Jal Jeevan Mission

PREDICTED · GS3-A4

Q18. Safe drinking water is a public health priority. Explain the Jal Jeevan Mission and the problem of fluoride contamination, with reference to Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Safe drinking water must be adequate, safe and accessible. Fluoride, arsenic and nitrate come from geology and pollution.

Jal Jeevan Mission (Har Ghar Jal) Launched in 2019, it aims to provide functional household tap connections (FHTC) to every rural household. In Karnataka, rural tap connections rose from 24.51 lakh to 63.12 lakh, achieving 86.51% coverage, and 6,768 villages have reached 100% FHTC.

Fluoride Excess fluoride in groundwater causes dental and skeletal fluorosis. The National Programme for Prevention and Control of Fluorosis (NPPCF) supports testing, treatment and nutrition advice.

Challenges Source sustainability in dry districts, quality testing and operation and maintenance of schemes.

Way forward Use surface water or treated sources in affected areas, community testing kits and village water committees.

Conclusion A tap is only useful if the water is safe and sustained, so source, quality and upkeep matter as much as the pipe.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Pipe, Purity, Permanence".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** JJM is for rural households; urban supply is under AMRUT.

GS3 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · Antimicrobial resistance

PREDICTED · GS3-B1

Q19. Antimicrobial resistance is called a silent pandemic. Explain how resistance develops, its impact on public health, and the measures India should take. (250 words)

Model answer

Antimicrobial resistance (AMR) occurs when bacteria, viruses, fungi and parasites evolve so that medicines no longer kill them. Resistant infections lead to longer illness, higher costs and death.

How resistance develops

- Mutation and natural selection: the antibiotic kills sensitive microbes, while resistant ones survive and multiply.
- Genes pass between bacteria through plasmids (horizontal gene transfer).
- Misuse speeds this: incomplete courses, over-the-counter sales and unnecessary prescriptions.

Drivers in India

- Heavy, unregulated use of antibiotics for humans and animals.
- Antibiotics in poultry and aquaculture feed, and discharge from pharmaceutical plants.
- Poor sanitation and infection control in hospitals.

Impact

- Infections such as tuberculosis, typhoid and neonatal sepsis become hard to treat.
- Surgery, chemotherapy and organ transplants carry higher risk.
- Higher health costs hit poor families hardest, and may push them into debt.

Measures

- The National Action Plan on AMR (2017) and its updated version, with surveillance networks.

- Prescription-only sales (Schedule H1), antibiotic stewardship in hospitals and a ban on colistin in animal feed.
- Better sanitation, vaccination and rapid diagnostics.
- Public awareness through "complete the course" messaging.
- Karnataka's e-health records and telemedicine can support stewardship data.

Conclusion AMR is a slow emergency, and no single ministry can solve it: every unnecessary antibiotic dose brings the end of the antibiotic era closer.



DRAW IT: How antimicrobial resistance spreads. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Use less, Test more, Clean up": reduce use, diagnose before prescribing, improve hygiene.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Antibiotics do not work against viruses; do not suggest them for colds or flu.

GS3 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Gender digital divide

PREDICTED · GS3-A6

Q20. Explain the gender digital divide and measures to increase women's participation in science and technology. (150 words)

Model answer

The gender digital divide is the gap between men and women in access to and use of digital technology. In India, women are less likely than men to own a smartphone or use mobile internet, and are under-represented in STEM careers.

Causes

- Social norms on girls' phone use; cost of devices; lower digital literacy.
- Lack of role models, unsafe workplaces and career breaks.

Measures

- The Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan for digital literacy.
- Scholarships and fellowships for women in science, and schemes to help return after a break.
- Karnataka's Shakti free-travel scheme has improved women's access to cities and workplaces, and its women-led SHGs now use digital payments.
- Women-friendly workplace policies, flexible hours and safe hostels.

Conclusion Women's participation in technology is both a right and a source of growth; policy must reach girls in school and women in the workplace.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Phone, Pay, Path": own a phone, pay digitally, find a career path.

COMMON TRAP: Do not give a national percentage unless you can source it; name the gap, not an invented number.

PEAK FACT: PMGDISHA digital literacy.

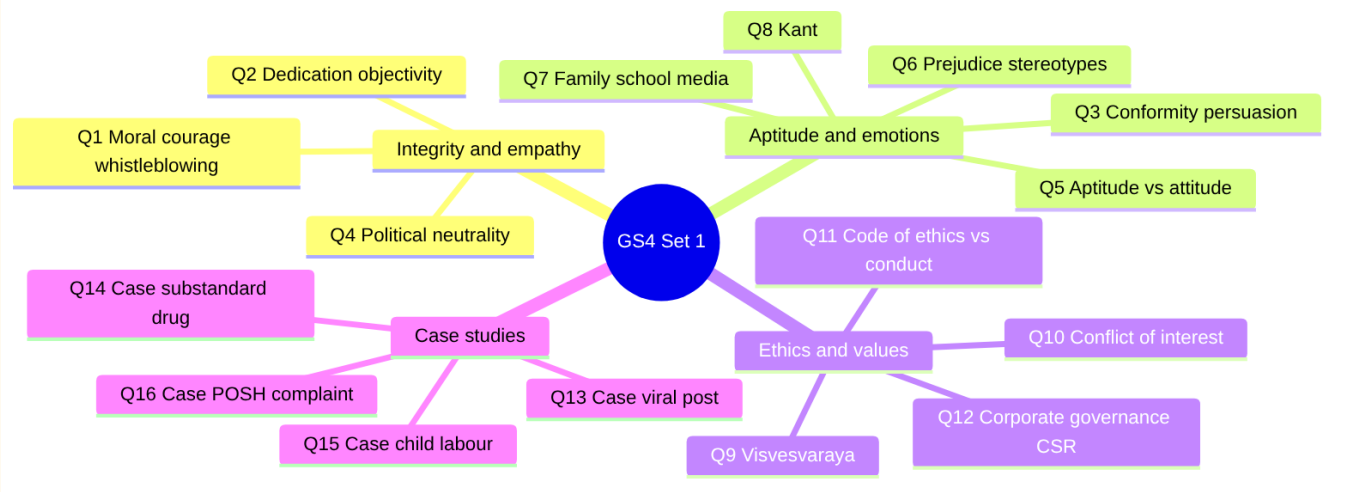
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 PMFBY:** "2-1.5-5": the farmer's premium: kharif, rabi, commercial. **Q17 Human-elephant conflict:** "Fence, Forest, Farmer": Barriers now, Forest fodder next, Farmer income last. **Q18 Jal Jeevan Mission:** "Pipe, Purity, Permanence". **Q19 Antimicrobial resistance:** "Use less, Test more, Clean up": reduce use, diagnose before prescribing, improve hygiene. **Q20 Gender digital divide:** "Phone, Pay, Path": own a phone, pay digitally, find a career path.

Paper 5: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Set 1: step 6 of 6 (General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)). Next up: Kannada and English practice

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 16 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** In ethics, the case studies carry the most marks per question. Use the five-step SDRAT habit every time, and keep your own voice firm but fair.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS4 Q1 of 16 · 20 marks · Moral courage, whistleblowing

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q1. "Courage is the first of human qualities because it is the quality that guarantees the others." Discuss the place of moral courage and whistleblowing in public service, and the safeguards needed for those who speak up. (300 words)

Model answer

Moral courage is the willingness to do the right thing despite fear of loss, ridicule or punishment. A public servant needs it because integrity is easy to claim and hard to practise when a superior, a politician or a powerful contractor pushes the other way.

Why it matters

- Courage keeps an officer honest when no one is watching.
- Wrongdoing is usually known first to insiders such as clerks, engineers and accountants. If they stay silent, corruption becomes a habit.
- Visible courage by one officer gives permission to others, and so changes the culture of an office.

Whistleblowing Whistleblowing is a disclosure, made in good faith, of corruption, abuse of power or danger to the public. It is different from a grudge or a leak for personal gain. Three tests apply: Is the claim true? Was the internal route tried or unsafe? Is the public interest greater than the harm of disclosure?

Dilemmas for the individual

- Loyalty to the organisation versus loyalty to the public.
- Duty of confidentiality versus the right of citizens to know.
- Personal risk: transfer, harassment, loss of promotion, or even violence.

Safeguards

- The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 provides for complaint channels and protection against victimisation, but its commencement is yet to be notified; the CVC's 2004 PIDPI Resolution offers partial cover.
- The RTI Act, 2005 lets citizens expose records; several RTI activists have been attacked, which shows weak protection.
- Karnataka's Lokayukta receives complaints against public servants and can investigate.
- Internal ethics hotlines, anonymous reporting, time-bound inquiry and penalties for retaliation.
- A culture that thanks the person who reports.

Way forward Verify before disclosing; use official channels first; document facts; and seek legal advice. Institutions should protect identity and reward honesty.

Conclusion A system is as honest as its most junior employee is free to be.



DRAW IT: A whistleblower's safe route. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "T-I-P": Truth checked, Internal route first, Public interest, the three whistleblower tests.

COMMON TRAP: Whistleblowing is not leaking for revenge; the motive must be public interest and the facts must be checked.

GS4 Q2 of 16 · 20 marks · Dedication, objectivity

PREDICTED · GS4-I · Karnataka-specific

Q2. "A public servant must serve with dedication, yet decide with objectivity." Explain how dedication to public service and objectivity support each other, and how an officer can protect objectivity under pressure. Illustrate with Karnataka's service-delivery reforms. (300 words)

Model answer

Dedication to public service means commitment of time, skill and care to the welfare of citizens, treating the post as a duty and not as a privilege. Objectivity means deciding on evidence and rules, free from personal liking, pressure or prejudice.

How they support each other

- Dedication gives the energy to master files, visit sites and persist when a problem is dull or hard.
- Objectivity directs that energy to the right problem, so that effort is not wasted on the loudest demand.
- Dedication without objectivity becomes zeal for a favoured cause; objectivity without dedication becomes cold, delayed paperwork.

Pressures on objectivity

- Political direction and expectation of favours in postings and transfers.
- Local caste, community or religious identity of the officer.
- Public anger after a tragedy; media trial.
- Personal ties with contractors or relatives.

Ways to protect objectivity

- Record reasons in writing and follow the file; written orders deter improper instructions.
- Follow rules such as the Karnataka Civil Services (Conduct) Rules, 1966 and disclose personal interest.
- Use data and checklists instead of memory and impression.
- Consult an independent colleague on sensitive decisions.
- Use the 'newspaper test': would you defend the decision on the front page?

Karnataka illustration The Sakala Act sets time limits for 1,452 services across 114 institutions, and 209 services were added in 2025. Timelines and online tracking limit the room for personal discretion, which promotes objective, citizen-first service.

Way forward Fixed tenures, ethics training, and public reporting of disposal times reduce pressure on individuals.

Conclusion Dedication makes an officer work for the people; objectivity makes the work fair to all of them. A good civil servant needs both, and rules and systems help both survive pressure.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HEART and HEAD": dedication is the heart, objectivity is the head. A good officer uses both.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Objectivity does not mean being cold; the answer should show it with empathy.

GS4 Q3 of 16 · 20 marks · Conformity, persuasion

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q3. How do conformity, obedience and persuasion shape the attitudes and behaviour of people? Discuss their relevance for public campaigns and for the conduct of civil servants. (300 words)

Model answer

Social influence is the process by which the real or imagined presence of others changes an individual's thoughts, feelings and actions. Its three forms are conformity, obedience and persuasion.

Conformity Conformity is changing one's behaviour to match a group. Solomon Asch's line experiments (1950s) showed that many people give a wrong answer to agree with the group. It arises from the wish to be accepted (normative influence) and from the belief that the group knows better (informational influence).

Obedience Obedience is following the order of an authority figure. Stanley Milgram's experiments (1960s) found that ordinary people could give what they thought were painful shocks when told to do so by an authority. Its lesson: "I was only following orders" is no defence for an unlawful act.

Persuasion Persuasion is changing attitudes through communication. Its effect depends on the source (credible and likeable), the message (clear, emotionally and factually sound) and the audience (their prior beliefs). The central route uses facts; the peripheral route uses cues such as celebrities.

Relevance for campaigns

- Social norms can be used for good: a village in which every home builds a toilet makes others follow.
- Respected local voices, such as teachers, ASHA workers or religious leaders, make health messages more credible.

Relevance for civil servants

- Resist conformity to a corrupt office culture; the first dissent makes others bold.

- Obey lawful orders but question unlawful ones in writing.
- Use persuasion before coercion when enforcing change, for example in vaccination drives.

Ethical limits Persuasion should inform, not manipulate; campaigns must not use false claims or exploit fear.

Conclusion People are shaped by those around them. A wise administrator uses social influence to build good habits and refuses to let it override conscience.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "C-O-P": Copy the crowd, Obey the boss, Persuade by message; "Asch, Milgram" - lines and shocks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Conformity is not the same as obedience: conformity follows peers, obedience follows authority.

GS4 Q4 of 16 · 15 marks · Political neutrality

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q4. What is political neutrality of civil servants? How is it compatible with responsiveness to elected representatives? Suggest safeguards. (250 words)

Model answer

Political neutrality means that a civil servant serves every government of the day faithfully, regardless of the party in power, and does not take part in party politics. It is a pillar of a permanent executive in a parliamentary democracy.

Why it matters

- Citizens of all parties receive equal treatment.
- The administration remains stable when governments change.
- Advice remains honest ("speaking truth to power") and not tailored to please.

Responsiveness to elected leaders Ministers are accountable to the legislature and the voters, so the civil servant must carry out lawful policy and give frank advice. Neutrality does not mean indifference; it means loyalty to the Constitution and the law, and not to a person or a party.

Where conflict arises

- Pressure to favour supporters in transfers, licences and welfare lists.
- Ministers' instructions that are oral and unlawful.
- Officers who show political leanings for personal gain.

Provisions

- Conduct Rules bar government servants from taking part in politics or canvassing for a party. In Karnataka, the Karnataka Civil Services (Conduct) Rules, 1966 apply.
- The model code of conduct during elections.
- Article 311 gives procedural protection against arbitrary dismissal.

Safeguards

- Fixed minimum tenures and a Civil Services Board for transfers (the Supreme Court's 2013 direction in the T.S.R. Subramanian case).
- Written orders for all important instructions.
- Training on constitutional values.

Conclusion The civil servant should be "politically sensitive but not politically partisan": loyal to the elected government's lawful policy and to the Constitution, above all.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Loyal to the Law, not to the Leader."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Neutrality is not silence; an officer may and must record dissent in writing.

GS4 Q5 of 16 · 15 marks · Aptitude vs attitude

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q5. Differentiate between aptitude and attitude. How can aptitude for civil services be identified, and how can attitude be developed? (250 words)

Model answer

Aptitude is the natural or acquired ability to learn and perform a task. Attitude is a lasting positive or negative disposition toward a person, object or idea.

Difference

- Aptitude shows what one can do; attitude shows how one is disposed to do it.
- Aptitude is relatively stable and tested; attitude is learned and changeable.
- A person with high aptitude but a poor attitude may be skilled yet unreliable.

Components of civil services aptitude Analytical and numerical reasoning, communication, decision-making, empathy, and the ability to work under stress.

Identifying aptitude

- Psychometric and situational judgement tests; essay and case-study questions.
- Personality interviews and group tasks; reference checks of earlier work.
- On-the-job probation and assessment, as at the training academies.

Developing the right attitude

- Induction training with field attachments in villages and slums, so that officers see citizens' difficulties first hand.
- Role models and mentors; reflective diaries.
- Exposure to community voices, grievances and feedback.
- Rewards for ethical behaviour, and consequences for misconduct.
- Karnataka's training institutes, such as the Administrative Training Institute in Mysuru, offer programmes for officers.

Challenges Tests can be coached, and attitudes may be hidden in an interview.

Conclusion Aptitude opens the door; attitude determines the quality of service. Selection must test the first, and training must shape the second.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A for Ability, A for Approach": aptitude is ability, attitude is approach.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call attitude 'inborn'; it is learnt, hence it can be changed.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Administrative Training Institute Mysore programmes.

GS4 Q6 of 16 · 15 marks · Prejudice, stereotypes

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q6. What are prejudice and stereotypes? How do they lead to discrimination, and what can administrators do to reduce them? (250 words)

Model answer

A stereotype is a fixed, oversimplified belief about a group, such as "women cannot lead" or "people of a region are lazy". Prejudice is a negative feeling or judgement toward a person because of the group they belong to. Discrimination is the unfair action that follows.

How they arise

- Socialisation in family, school and media.
- Competition for jobs or resources, and scapegoating.
- Limited contact between groups and the habit of mental shortcuts.
- Caste, religion, gender and region add layers of difference.

From belief to action Stereotype (thought), prejudice (feeling), discrimination (behaviour). An officer who assumes that a poor applicant is dishonest may demand more documents from him, though the law does not require it.

Consequences Exclusion from services and jobs, violence, loss of dignity and wasted talent.

Constitutional response Articles 14, 15, 16 and 17 guarantee equality and abolish untouchability. The SC and ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 provides punishment for caste-based crimes.

What administrators can do

- Use clear, written criteria so that personal judgement has less room.
- Anonymise applications where possible; use diverse selection panels.
- Sensitivity training for frontline staff and a grievance system.
- Promote contact between groups through joint projects and sports.
- Correct rumours quickly with facts.

Karnataka example Karnataka's Anna Bhagya gives 10 kg of rice per member monthly to eligible families on need, not identity.

Conclusion Prejudice is learnt and can be unlearnt. Rules punish discrimination, but contact, evidence and example change hearts.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "T-P-D": Thought (stereotype), Prejudice (feeling), Discrimination (act).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Prejudice is an attitude; discrimination is behaviour. Do not use the two words as if they were the same.

GS4 Q7 of 16 · 15 marks · Family, school, media

PREDICTED · GS4-T1 · Karnataka-specific

Q7. Examine the role of family, school and media in forming moral and political attitudes. What lessons does Kuvempu's idea of the "Vishwa Manava" (universal human) offer? (250 words)

Model answer

Attitudes are formed through learning. Moral attitudes concern right and wrong; political attitudes concern authority, rights and participation.

Role of the family The first and strongest influence. Children learn honesty, respect, gender roles and often party preference from parents through example and rewards. Authoritarian homes may produce obedience; open homes produce questioning.

Role of the school

- Teaches civic values: equality, rule of law and cooperation.
- Peer groups and teachers model fairness; mid-day meals and mixed classrooms reduce prejudice.
- Debates and student councils build political awareness.

Role of media

- Informs citizens, but can also polarise through fake news and echo chambers on social media.
- Role models and advertisements shape ideas of success and gender.
- Media literacy is therefore a moral skill.

Other influences Religion, caste, peers, workplace and personal experience.

Kuvempu's "Vishwa Manava" The poet Kuvempu (1904-1994), author of the Kannada poem on the Ramayana, "Sri Ramayana Darshanam", urged that every child is born a universal human (Vishwa Manava) and is later narrowed by caste, creed and nation. He called for regaining that universal outlook. His message for educators and parents: do not teach children to see walls first. His thinking supports the constitutional vision of fraternity.

Way forward Value education, free debate, media literacy and parents who act on what they preach.

Conclusion Attitudes are caught more than taught: the home, school and media together decide what citizens come to believe.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "F-S-M": Family first, School second, Media third, and "Kuvempu: be born universal".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the media a villain; it can educate or mislead, so the answer should show both sides.

GS4 Q8 of 16 · 10 marks · Kant

PREDICTED · GS4-T2 · Karnataka-specific

Q8. Explain Immanuel Kant's categorical imperative and its relevance for decisions in public administration. (150 words)

Model answer

Immanuel Kant (1724-1804) held that an act is moral if it is done from duty. His test is the categorical imperative, which applies without exception.

Main formulations

- Universal law: act only on a rule that you could will to become a universal law. If every officer took bribes, no public service could work.
- Humanity as an end: treat people always as ends in themselves, never merely as means. A citizen is a rights-holder, not a number.

Relevance

- It supports non-discrimination, honesty and keeping promises.
- It shows why bribery is wrong even if the result seems good.
- Karnataka's Sakala timelines treat every applicant alike, whoever they know.

Limits It can be rigid: rules may clash (truth against saving a life), and it ignores consequences and compassion.

Conclusion Kant gives the officer a firm floor of duty; judgement and empathy must build above it.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Rule for all, Person as end": Universal law and Humanity formula.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Kant is a duty-based (deontological) thinker. Do not call him a utilitarian.

GS4 Q9 of 16 · 10 marks · Visvesvaraya

PREDICTED · GS4-E5 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. What lessons can civil servants learn from the life and work of Sir M. Visvesvaraya? (150 words)

Model answer

Sir Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya (1861-1962), engineer and Diwan of Mysore (1912-1918), is remembered as a builder of modern Karnataka. He was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 1955.

Lessons

- Integrity and discipline: He was known for punctuality and careful use of public money.
- Planning and evidence: He used engineering data and planning to design projects such as the Krishnaraja Sagara dam on the Cauvery, and a flood-protection system for Hyderabad.
- Institution building: He promoted the Bank of Mysore, Mysore University and the Mysore steel works.
- Education and industrial growth: He believed that "industrialise or perish".
- Humility and long public life: He worked into his nineties.

Relevance Officers should pair honesty with technical competence, think of systems that outlast them, and spend public money with care.

Conclusion He shows that integrity and professionalism together create lasting public good.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "3 P's": Punctual, Planner, Public-money-protector.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mix up his offices: Diwan of Mysore (not Chief Minister) and engineer of the KRS dam design.

GS4 Q10 of 16 · 10 marks · Conflict of interest

PREDICTED · GS4-E2

Q10. What is a conflict of interest in public life? Explain its types and how institutions can manage it. (150 words)

Model answer

A conflict of interest arises when a public servant's private interest (financial, family or social) could improperly influence, or appear to influence, their official duty.

Types

- Actual: the private interest does affect the decision.
- Potential: it may do so in the future, for example when an officer's relative bids for a tender.
- Perceived: people reasonably think so, even if no harm is done.

Forms Gifts and hospitality, post-retirement jobs with a firm one regulated, shareholding, and favours for relatives.

Why it matters Even a perceived conflict reduces public trust.

Management

- Declare the interest and recuse from the decision.
- Annual declaration of assets and interests under service rules.
- Cooling-off period before joining a firm one dealt with.
- Gift registers and limits.
- Independent oversight, such as the Lokayukta.

Conclusion The test is simple: "Would an informed citizen believe my decision was fair?" If not, disclose and step aside.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Actual, Potential, Perceived": the three A-P-P types; remedy: "Declare and Step aside".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Conflict of interest is not corruption itself; it is the condition that can lead to it, so disclosure is the first step.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Karnataka Lokayukta; service rules on asset declaration.

GS4: 10 of 16 done. Next up: Q11, Code of ethics vs conduct.

GS4 Q11 of 16 · 10 marks · Code of ethics vs conduct

PREDICTED · GS4-E4

Q11. Distinguish between a code of ethics and a code of conduct. Explain the Seven Principles of Public Life. (150 words)

Model answer

A code of ethics states the values that guide an organisation, such as integrity and fairness. It is aspirational and broad. A code of conduct lists specific rules and penalties for behaviour, such as gift limits and conflict-of-interest disclosure. The first says "what we stand for"; the second says "what you must do or not do".

Seven Principles of Public Life (Nolan Committee, UK, 1995)

1. Selflessness: act in the public interest.
2. Integrity: avoid obligations to outside interests.
3. Objectivity: decide on merit.
4. Accountability: accept scrutiny.
5. Openness: be transparent.
6. Honesty: declare private interests.
7. Leadership: practise and promote these principles.

India The Second ARC recommended a code of ethics for public servants.

Conclusion Values without rules are weak; rules without values are mechanical. Good administration needs both.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "SIO-AOHL": Selflessness, Integrity, Objectivity, Accountability, Openness, Honesty, Leadership.

COMMON TRAP: The Nolan principles are British in origin; do not say they are in the Indian Constitution.

GS4 Q12 of 16 · 10 marks · Corporate governance, CSR

PREDICTED · GS4-E3

Q12. What is corporate governance? Explain its ethical dimensions and the role of CSR under the Companies Act, 2013. (150 words)

Model answer

Corporate governance is the system by which companies are directed and controlled, balancing the interests of shareholders, employees, customers, lenders and society.

Ethical dimensions

- Transparency in accounts and disclosures.
- Fairness to minority shareholders and honest dealing with consumers.
- Accountability of directors and an independent board.
- Protection of whistleblowers and avoidance of insider trading.
- Environmental and social responsibility.

Institutions Board with independent directors, audit committee, SEBI's listing rules and the Companies Act, 2013.

CSR Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013 requires qualifying companies to spend 2% of average net profit of the preceding three years on social projects such as education, health and environment, and to report on it. Karnataka's Survey also lists CSR compliance and independent directors as governance practices for its State enterprises.

Conclusion Ethical governance in business means trust: honest books and a fair share of benefits for society.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Board, Books, Balance": a watchful board, honest books, and balance of all stakeholders.

COMMON TRAP: CSR is not a tax or donation by choice; the Act makes it a duty for qualifying companies, though the form of spending is chosen.

GS4 Q13 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: viral post

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q13. Case study (fictional). You are the Chief Executive Officer of a Zilla Panchayat in a northern Karnataka district. A young Assistant Engineer in your office posts on social media a sharp personal criticism of a new State irrigation policy, saying that it favours big farmers. The post goes viral; a local politician demands disciplinary action; farmer groups praise the engineer. Your Chief Secretary asks for a report. The engineer says that he was off duty and that the post is his "freedom of speech". (a) What are the ethical issues? (b) What options do you have? (c) What would you do? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. An officer's public criticism of government policy creates a clash between his freedom of expression and the discipline of service.

D - Dimensions. Engineer: free speech, job security. Politician and government: public image and loyalty. Farmers: right to debate policy. You: fairness and neutrality. Colleagues: a signal of what is allowed.

R - Rules and values. Article 19(1)(a) gives freedom of speech, subject to reasonable restrictions under 19(2). The Karnataka Civil Services (Conduct) Rules, 1966 restrict adverse criticism of government policy by a government servant. Values: objectivity, political neutrality, proportionality, due process and tolerance of dissent.

A - Options.

1. Suspend him quickly: satisfies the politician, but may be disproportionate, and chills free debate.
2. Ignore the post: protects the engineer, but ignores the rule and invites indiscipline.
3. Graded and fair response: issue a notice, hear him, and examine whether the post was a personal factual critique or a breach of the rules; counsel him about using the proper channels.

T - Take the decision. I choose option 3.

- Immediate: Reply to the Chief Secretary with facts; do not bow to political pressure for hasty action.
- Give the engineer a written opportunity to explain, in line with natural justice.
- If the rules are found to be breached, impose only a proportionate, minor penalty (such as a warning), not suspension.
- Policy: Check whether his concerns about big farmers have merit and forward them through proper channels; invite him to present them at a review meeting.
- Systemic: Issue a clear social media guideline for staff, with training.

Justification. The decision is lawful (rules observed), ethical (proportion and a fair hearing) and practical (it protects discipline without silencing useful feedback).



DRAW IT: SDRAT: the five-step case method. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HEAR, then ACT": hear the officer first, then apply the rule in proportion.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call for suspension on day one; a fair hearing and proportional penalty are expected.

GS4 Q14 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: substandard drug

PREDICTED · CS

Q14. Case study (fictional). You are the Drugs Controller of a State. During a routine check, you find that a batch of a common antibiotic, due to be supplied next week to all district hospitals under a popular health programme, fails the quality test. The supplier is a large firm with close links to a senior Minister, who tells you to "avoid delay and sort it out quietly", as the programme launch is to be inaugurated by the Chief Minister. Your assistant fears that retesting will bring a threat to his job. (a) What are the ethical issues? (b) What are your options? (c) What would you do? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A substandard drug batch is about to reach patients, and a minister wants it quietly cleared.

D - Dimensions. Patients: life and health, especially the poor in district hospitals. Minister and CM: political credibility. Supplier: business and reputation. Assistant: fear of retaliation. You: duty, integrity and career. Public: trust in drug regulation.

R - Rules and values. The Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940 prohibits sale or supply of drugs "not of standard quality" and empowers the controller to stop sale and prosecute. Values: public safety, integrity, accountability and the principle of "do no harm". A minister's wish is not a lawful order.

A - Options.

1. Clear the batch quietly: keeps the minister happy but risks patient harm, drug resistance and criminal liability.
2. Delay with no explanation: avoids confrontation, but is evasive and risky.
3. Stop the supply, confirm with a second lab test, and act under law: protects patients, is transparent and defensible.

T - Take the decision. I choose option 3.

- Immediate: Issue a stop-sale order; confirm the test with a referral laboratory; record the Minister's call in the file.
- Write to the Health Secretary explaining the risk, offering a substitute batch to save the launch.
- Begin proceedings against the supplier under the Act.
- Protect the assistant by owning the order, so that responsibility rests with me.
- Systemic: Randomised pre-supply testing and publication of batch results.

Justification. The choice is lawful, ethical (patient safety first) and practical, since it also offers the Government a way to protect the launch with safe supply.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Safe first, Speed later": patient safety comes before any launch date.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not suggest "informing the media first" as the first step; use the official chain and law.

GS4 Q15 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: child labour

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Case study (fictional). You are the Deputy Commissioner of a district in Karnataka with many stone quarries. During an inspection, you find that 30 children between ages 10 and 14 are working with their parents at a crushing unit. The parents say that the family's income would fall by a third if the children stop working, and that they will leave for another district. The owner says the children only "help their parents" and threatens to close the unit, which employs 200 workers. A local NGO demands immediate action. (a) What are the ethical issues? (b) What are your options? (c) What would you do? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Child labour in a quarry unit conflicts with the immediate livelihood of poor families and the jobs of 200 workers.

D - Dimensions. Children: education, health, safety. Parents: income and survival. Owner: profit, legal liability. Workers: jobs. NGO: child rights. You: duty to enforce law with compassion.

R - Rules and values. The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act prohibits employment of children below 14 and bars adolescents from hazardous work, which includes mining and quarrying. Article 21A and the Right to Education Act, 2009 guarantee schooling. Values: child welfare, justice, compassion, proportion and the "best interest of the child".

A - Options.

1. Close the unit immediately: enforces law but harms 200 workers and may push families into worse work.
2. Warn the owner and leave: avoids conflict, but leaves children at risk.
3. Rescue children, prosecute the owner, rehabilitate and support the families.

T - Take the decision. I choose option 3.

- Immediate: Rescue the children with the child welfare committee, give medical care, and file a case against the owner. Let the unit continue only after compliance, so that adult workers are protected.
- Admit the children to school or a bridge course, with a stipend or residential option.
- Link parents to MGNREGA work, wage-linked schemes and the State child-labour scheme; Karnataka's Survey records that 518 child labourers have been identified and rehabilitated.
- Systemic: Joint inspections with labour and education departments; community awareness; monitoring of school attendance.

Justification. The decision is lawful, humane, and practical: it removes children from work without leaving their families without support.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Rescue, Rehabilitate, Re-enrol": three R's of child labour cases.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not close the unit and ignore the 200 workers; the answer should protect adult livelihoods.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** 518 child labourers identified and rehabilitated.

GS4: 15 of 16 done. Next up: Q16, Case: POSH complaint.

GS4 Q16 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: POSH complaint

PREDICTED · CS

Q16. Case study (fictional). You are the Managing Director of a State public-sector transport corporation. A woman conductor files a written complaint that a senior depot manager, who is popular and is leading the corporation's flood-relief bus operations, repeatedly made inappropriate remarks. She fears retaliation and asks that her name be kept private. The depot manager denies it and says that it is a conspiracy. Some union leaders say that action now would affect relief work. (a) What are the ethical issues? (b) What are your options? (c) What would you do? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A sexual-harassment complaint against a valued senior is made at a time when the corporation depends on him for relief work.

D - Dimensions. Complainant: dignity, safety, fear of retaliation. Accused: right to a fair hearing. Union and staff: morale, fear of disruption. Flood victims: continued transport. You: fairness, legal duty and the credibility of the corporation.

R - Rules and values. The POSH Act, 2013 (sexual harassment at the workplace) requires every employer to set up an Internal Committee (IC), to conduct an inquiry with confidentiality, and to protect the complainant. Values: justice, dignity, impartiality, presumption of innocence and gender sensitivity.

A - Options.

1. Delay the matter until the relief work ends: protects operations, but denies justice and invites retaliation.
2. Punish the manager at once: shows firmness but violates natural justice.
3. Refer to the IC, take interim safeguards, and keep operations running.

T - Take the decision. I choose option 3.

- Immediate: Refer the complaint to the IC the same day. Ensure confidentiality of the complainant's name and prevent retaliation, such as transfer or duty changes.
- Use the interim relief the Act allows, for example moving the accused from supervision of the complainant, or granting her leave if she wishes.
- Appoint a capable deputy to lead relief work, so that operations continue.
- Ask for the inquiry report within the 90-day period.
- Systemic: Awareness sessions, display of IC members at every depot and a safe complaint channel.

Justification. The decision follows law, treats both parties fairly, and shows that no one is indispensable to justice.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Refer, Protect, Replace": refer to IC, protect the complainant, replace the duty cover.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not conduct your own inquiry; the law requires the Internal Committee to do it.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q12 Corporate governance, CSR:** "Board, Books, Balance": a watchful board, honest books, and balance of all stakeholders. **Q13 Case: viral post:** "HEAR, then ACT": hear the officer first, then apply the rule in proportion. **Q14 Case: substandard drug:** "Safe first, Speed later": patient safety comes before any launch date. **Q15 Case: child labour:** "Rescue, Rehabilitate, Re-enrol": three R's of child labour cases. **Q16 Case: POSH complaint:** "Refer, Protect, Replace": refer to IC, protect the complainant, replace the duty cover.

Kannada and English practice (short)

> **REVIEW:** The Kannada text in this section was written without a native-speaker check. Please have a Kannada teacher or fluent speaker read it before you treat it as a model. The English parts follow plain formal style.

Practice 1: Kannada essay (ಪ್ರಬಂಧ), about 120 words

Topic: ನೀರಿನ ಮಹತ್ವ ಮತ್ತು ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆ (The importance and conservation of water)

Outline (ರೂಪರೇಖೆ): ಪೀಠಿಕೆ → ನೀರಿನ ಉಪಯೋಗಗಳು → ಕೊರತೆಯ ಕಾರಣಗಳು → ಪರಿಹಾರಗಳು → ಉಪಸಂಹಾರ

Model essay (ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ):

ನೀರು ಜೀವನದ ಆಧಾರ. ಮನುಷ್ಯ, ಪ್ರಾಣಿ, ಸಸ್ಯ ಎಲ್ಲರಿಗೂ ನೀರು ಬೇಕು. ನಮ್ಮ ಕರ್ನಾಟಕದಲ್ಲಿ ಕಾವೇರಿ, ಕೃಷ್ಣಾ ಮತ್ತು ತುಂಗಭದ್ರಾ ನದಿಗಳು ಹರಿಯುತ್ತವೆ. ಆದರೂ ಬೇಸಿಗೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಅನೇಕ ಊರುಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಕುಡಿಯುವ ನೀರಿನ ಕೊರತೆ ಕಾಣಿಸುತ್ತದೆ. ಜನಸಂಖ್ಯೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚಳ, ಕೆರೆಗಳ ಒತ್ತುವರಿ, ಕೊಳವೆಬಾವಿಗಳ ಅತಿಯಾದ ಬಳಕೆ ಮತ್ತು ನೀರಿನ ಮಾಲಿನ್ಯ ಇದಕ್ಕೆ ಮುಖ್ಯ ಕಾರಣಗಳು. ಮಳೆನೀರು ಕೊಯ್ಲು, ಕೆರೆಗಳ ಪುನಶ್ಚೇತನ, ಹನಿ ನೀರಾವರಿ ಮತ್ತು ಬಳಸಿದ ನೀರಿನ ಶುದ್ಧೀಕರಣ ಹಾಗೂ ಮರುಬಳಕೆ ಇದಕ್ಕೆ ಪರಿಹಾರಗಳು. ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಬ್ಬ ನಾಗರಿಕನೂ ನೀರನ್ನು ಮಿತವಾಗಿ ಬಳಸಬೇಕು. ನೀರು ಅಮೃತಕ್ಕೆ ಸಮಾನ. ಇಂದು ನೀರನ್ನು ಉಳಿಸಿದರೆ, ನಾಳೆ ಅದು ನಮ್ಮನ್ನು ಉಳಿಸುತ್ತದೆ.

Practice 2: Translate into Kannada (ಅನುವಾದ)

#	English	Model Kannada
1	Water is the source of life.	ನೀರು ಜೀವನದ ಮೂಲ.
2	Every citizen should use water carefully.	ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಬ್ಬ ನಾಗರಿಕನೂ ನೀರನ್ನು ಎಚ್ಚರಿಕೆಯಿಂದ ಬಳಸಬೇಕು.
3	Lakes should be protected from encroachment.	ಕೆರೆಗಳನ್ನು ಒತ್ತುವರಿಯಿಂದ ರಕ್ಷಿಸಬೇಕು.
4	Rainwater harvesting reduces dependence on borewells.	ಮಳೆನೀರು ಕೊಯ್ಲು ಕೊಳವೆಬಾವಿಗಳ ಮೇಲಿನ ಅವಲಂಬನೆಯನ್ನು ಕಡಿಮೆ ಮಾಡುತ್ತದೆ.
5	A small saving today secures water for tomorrow.	ಇಂದಿನ ಸಣ್ಣ ಉಳಿತಾಯ ನಾಳೆಯ ನೀರನ್ನು ಭದ್ರಪಡಿಸುತ್ತದೆ.

Practice 3: English precis (reduce to one-third)

Passage (about 150 words):

A city that cannot move its people cannot grow. In many Indian cities, the number of private vehicles has risen much faster than road space, and the result is long delays, noisy streets and dirty air. Widening roads helps only for a short time, because more road space invites more cars. Experience from cities across the world shows that the better answer is to give people a choice that is faster and cheaper than the private car. Reliable buses, metro lines, safe footpaths and cycle tracks do this together. They work best when they are linked, so that one ticket and one timetable carry a passenger from home to office. Such systems also reduce accidents and pollution, and they serve the poor, who spend a large part of their income on travel. But public transport needs steady funds and honest management. Without these, even a fine metro line will remain half empty.

Model precis (about 50 words), with title "Moving people, not cars":

Cities cannot grow if people cannot move. Wider roads only attract more cars. A linked network of buses, metro lines, footpaths and cycle tracks gives a faster, cheaper choice, cuts accidents and pollution and helps the poor. Its success, however, depends on steady funding and honest management.

Practice 4: Formal letter (English)

Task: Write a letter to the Commissioner of your city corporation about the irregular collection of garbage in your ward.

Model letter:

From: A. Kumar, 12, Lake View Road, Ward 45, Bengaluru - 560 000 To: The Commissioner, City Corporation, Bengaluru Date: 27 October 2026

Sir,

Subject: Irregular collection of garbage in Ward 45

I write to draw your attention to the irregular collection of household garbage in our ward. For the past three weeks, the collection vehicle has come only twice a week instead of daily. As a result, waste piles up at street corners, attracts stray animals and has begun to cause a foul smell and a risk of disease, particularly for children and the elderly.

I request you to direct the concerned officer to restore daily collection, to arrange separate collection of wet and dry waste, and to inform residents of the timings. I would be grateful for an early reply.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, A. Kumar

Review report for Set 1

REVIEW: Checks run on 27-10-2026 (IST). Machine checks cover every answer; the fact review covers a sample of 14 of 76 questions (18%, above the 15% target) plus every web-checked item listed below. The reviewer pass was done by the same author in a separate read, not by an outside person, so treat it as a careful self-review.

Check	Result
Word limits (10 marks: 150; 15 marks: 250; 20 marks: 300; essays: 1,200)	0 over the limit; all answers at 80% of the limit or more (one data-interpretation answer exempt)
Copy check: 6-word overlaps with past mains papers, the existing 40 model answers, and the other Set 1 files	0 flagged after fixes
Economic Survey and PRS figures, matched against the saved source text	0 mismatches
Remember-line and common-trap box on every answer	All present

Fact sources, honestly stated

- **Machine-matched (ES = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 summary; PRS = Karnataka Budget analysis 2026-27):** every number tagged ES or PRS was found word for word in the saved source.
- **Checked on the web this session (official pages):** IndiaAI Mission outlay (Cabinet, 7 March 2024: Rs 10,371.92 crore; the draft said "about Rs 10,300 crore", now fixed); four labour codes in force from 21 November 2025 replacing 29 laws; AI Impact Summit, New Delhi, 16-20 February 2026; Karnataka's four Ramsar sites and dates; UNCCD COP14 (2019) target of 26 million hectares; Ken-Betwa foundation stone, 25 December 2024, Daudhan dam; Whistle Blowers Protection Act 2014 status.
- **Found wrong and fixed:** the draft said the Whistle Blowers Act's "rules remain a gap". The Government says the Act itself has not been brought into force (PIB, 11 December 2025); the answer now says this and mentions the CVC's 2004 PIDPI Resolution. Also fixed: the Nagoya Protocol "2010" is the adoption year, not India's joining year; Narayana Guru's temple wording; Vidurashwatha's district now says "then Kolar district".
- **Static or textbook facts (statutes, case names, historical dates):** checked from memory in the sample read, not by live search. Most are standard (Tenth Schedule, Puttaswamy 2017, Article 108, Miller Committee 1918, Kihoto Hollohan 1992). Please re-verify any date you plan to quote in the real exam from a standard textbook.
- **Not checked live:** dates of Narayana Guru, SNDP, Dholavira, Halmidi, Dalit Sangharsh Samiti, the 1991 reserves, Mysore industries, PMFBY premiums, Mission Indradhanush, NAP-AMR, and Kuvempu details. These are widely published and looked right in the sample read.

Known gaps

- The 2025 past papers are scanned images, so the copy check against them is weaker than against 2014, 2015, 2020 and 2021.
- Fictional case studies and the fictional literacy table are invented; no real person or institution is meant.
- The Kannada practice section needs a native reader.

KAS Mains Mock Set 2: Fully Solved

Built 27-10-2026 23:26 IST | 5 papers x 250 marks | every question is PREDICTED from the trend blueprint, never copied from a past paper

PREDICTED: These questions are predictions from the pattern of the 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 papers (see TREND_BLUEPRINT). They are practice, not leaked or past questions. Model answers stay inside the word limit printed with each question. Facts are tied to official sources where possible; a fact list is kept for each answer.

CHAI-TALK: Do this set like an exam: one paper at a time, three hours each, writing by hand. Then read the model answer, tick what you covered, and copy the purple memory line for anything you missed. Do not read all five papers in one sitting. Five good papers beat fifty skimmed ones.

Set 2: step 1 of 6. Next up: Paper 1, the Essay.

Paper 1: Essay

Set 2: step 2 of 6 (Essay). Next up: General Studies I (GS1)

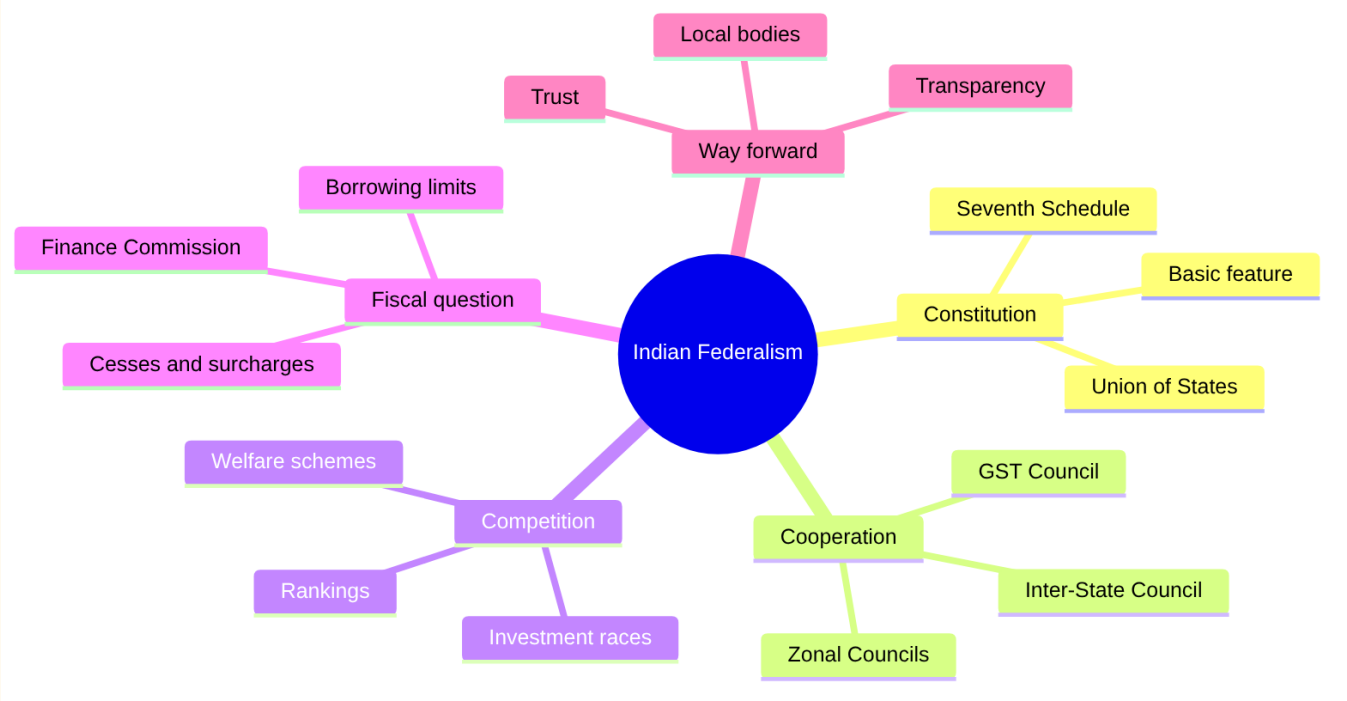
Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Instructions:** write two essays, one from each part, about 1,000 to 1,200 words each. Both carry 125 marks. (This is the practice shape; check the latest KPSC notification for exact instructions.)

> **CHAI-TALK:** An essay is a short journey: a hook, a clear stand, three or four strong turns, a fair look at the other side and a landing that points forward. Read the mind map first, then the essay, and then try to rebuild the map from memory.

Essay 1 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-1

Q1. Indian federalism: cooperation, competition and the fiscal question. (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 1: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

India is described in Article 1 as a "Union of States", a phrase chosen deliberately. The founders wanted a strong Centre to hold a diverse country together, yet they also gave States real powers over police, public health, agriculture, land and local government. In the S.R. Bommai case (1994) the Supreme Court ruled that federalism is among the basic features of the Constitution. Seventy-five years on, the question is not whether India is federal, but whether the three instincts of cooperation, competition and money are in balance.

The constitutional design: a flexible federation

The Seventh Schedule divides subjects into the Union, State and Concurrent Lists, and Parliament holds the residuary power. In an emergency, Parliament may legislate on State subjects, and the Governor,

Article 356 and all-India services give the Union reach into State affairs. Yet the Constitution also contains instruments of partnership: the Inter-State Council (Article 263), the Zonal Councils created by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, and the Finance Commission (Article 280). This mixture is why scholars call India "quasi-federal" or a "cooperative union": a system built to bend, not to break.

Cooperative federalism: where it works

The best example is the Goods and Services Tax. By the 101st Constitutional Amendment (2016), the Union and States gave up independent power over many indirect taxes and created the GST Council (Article 279A), in which the Union holds one-third of the votes and States together hold two-thirds, and decisions need a three-fourths majority. For the first time, a national policy on taxes is made across a table where every State sits. The Council also moved rates to a simpler structure in 2025, showing that a shared forum can reform. Other examples are coordination during the COVID-19 pandemic, disaster response through the National and State Disaster Funds, and the work of Zonal Councils on water, power and border issues.

The Planning Commission was replaced in 2015 by the NITI Aayog, which presents itself as a forum for "Team India" and whose Governing Council includes all Chief Ministers. The idea is right, but a body that only advises cannot settle a dispute over a river or a tax.

Competitive federalism: a healthy rivalry

Competition between States can drive reform. States compete for investment through land, power and speed of clearances; indices of the NITI Aayog on health, education, the Sustainable Development Goals and innovation create a public scoreboard. Welfare innovation spreads from State to State: mid-day meals began in Tamil Nadu, and several States have adopted women-focused transfers and bus-travel schemes after others began them. Karnataka's early lead in information technology, and the slow rise of second-tier hubs beyond Bengaluru, show how a State's own policy can change a regional economy.

But competition has costs. A race to the bottom in incentives, tax breaks or labour standards can leave public finances poorer. Rankings reward those which already have good records of data and administration. And competition among unequal States is not a fair race: Bihar and Karnataka do not begin at the same line. The Constitution therefore pairs competition with equalisation, which brings us to money.

The fiscal question: who raises, who spends

India has a vertical imbalance: the Union has the more elastic taxes, while States carry much of the spending on health, schools, agriculture, police and local services. The gap is bridged by transfers: a share of central taxes, grants, and centrally sponsored schemes.

The Sixteenth Finance Commission, in a report placed before Parliament on 1 February 2026, recommended that States' share in the divisible pool remain at 41% for 2026-31, unchanged from the Fifteenth. That figure looks generous; yet the divisible pool excludes cesses and surcharges, and these can grow as a part of the Union's gross tax collections. When the Union raises revenue through cesses, the States do not share in it. The States' real share of the Union's gross receipts is therefore below the headline number.

Second, a share of the pool is divided among States by a formula. The Sixteenth Commission assigned 42.5% weight to income distance, 17.5% to population, 10% each to demographic performance, area and forest, and 10% to each State's weight in national output. The new "contribution to GDP" criterion rewards States which grow fast and eases the penalty that high performers felt earlier. It also shows the two principles at war: equity asks for more for the poorer, efficiency asks for more for the productive.

Third, centrally sponsored schemes with matching shares and conditions can narrow a State's freedom to design its own programmes, while borrowing limits, now set at 3% of GSDP for States by the Commission, bind the States more tightly than the Union. States argue that the Centre should treat their capital loans and power-sector liabilities with the same flexibility it uses for itself.

Tensions: Governors, language and delimitation

Federal friction is not only fiscal. Disputes over Governors' delay in assenting to Bills, the choice of language in education, the reach of central investigative agencies and the coming delimitation of seats based on population raise the same worry: that States which have done well in controlling population and raising incomes might pay a political price for success. The Supreme Court has reminded Governors that they must act within constitutional timelines, and it has said that federal balance is not a matter of favour. Each tension is a test of trust.

Way forward

- Make the Inter-State Council and Zonal Councils meet regularly and keep minutes public, so that disputes are settled before they reach courts.
- Keep cesses and surcharges within a clear limit, or bring a fair part of them into the divisible pool.
- Provide untied grants and reduce the number of conditional schemes, so that States can match funds to local need.
- Strengthen local governments, since the real third tier of federalism lies in panchayats and municipalities, and the 73rd and 74th Amendments will mean little without funds, functions and functionaries.
- Use data openly: publish State-wise tax collection, transfer and expenditure figures so that debate rests on facts.

Conclusion

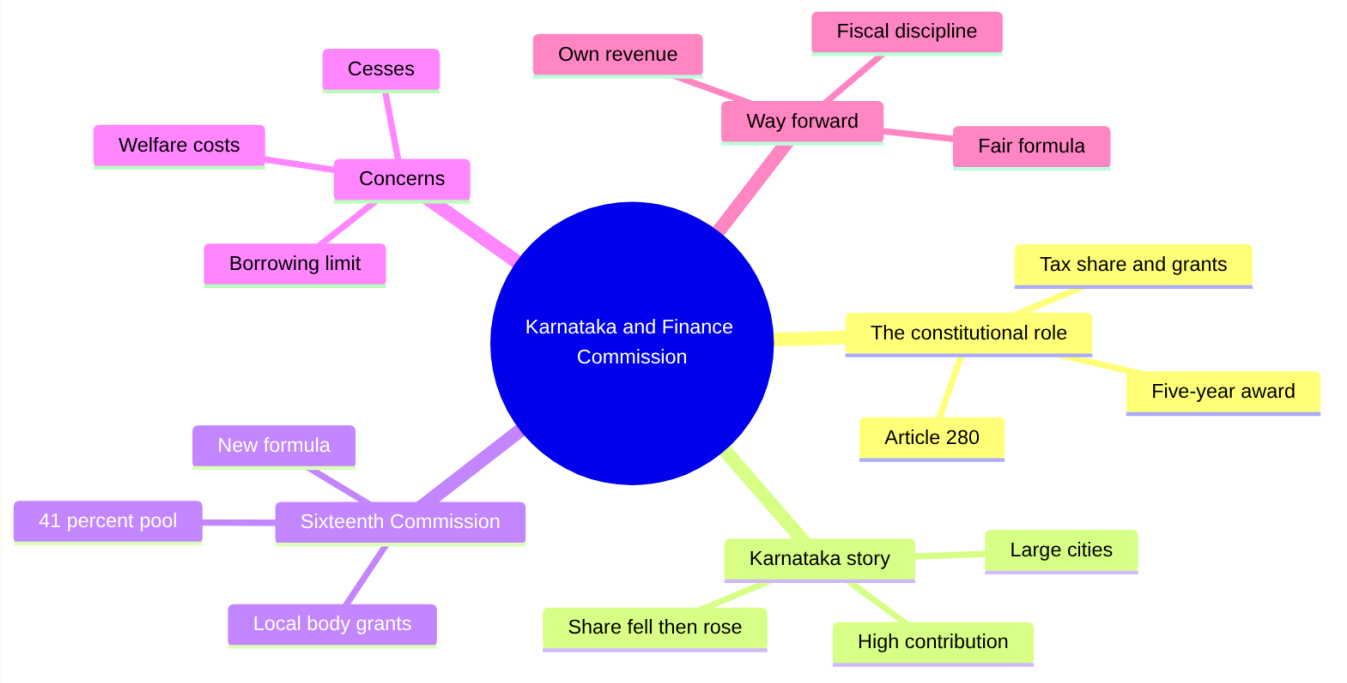
A federation is held together not by force of law alone but by habit of trust. Cooperation without competition becomes dull; competition without cooperation becomes a feud; and both fail if money is not shared fairly. India's federal experiment has survived because it has kept all three in tension. The task for the coming decades is to keep that tension creative, so that a citizen in Raichur and a citizen in Ranchi can count on the same promise of a fair share of the nation's growth.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "C-C-M": Cooperate (GST Council), Compete (rankings), Money (Finance Commission): the three corners of the federal triangle.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write only about Governor and Article 356 politics; the examiner wants the fiscal dimension and a way forward too.

Essay 2 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-2 · Karnataka-specific

Q2. Karnataka and the Finance Commission: a fair share for a growing state. (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 2: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

Every five years a small constitutional body decides how the nation's tax money is shared between Delhi and the States, and among the States themselves. For Karnataka, one of India's most productive States, the Finance Commission is not a technical matter; it shapes how much money reaches schools, roads, hospitals and gram panchayats. The recent award of the Sixteenth Finance Commission, which gave Karnataka a higher share than the Fifteenth, has reopened an old debate: what is a fair share for a growing State?

What the Finance Commission is

Under Article 280 the President appoints a Finance Commission at five-year intervals. It advises on the sharing of Union tax proceeds with the States, on the rules for grants-in-aid under Article 275, and on measures to supplement the funds of panchayats and municipalities. Its report is placed in Parliament with an explanatory memorandum on action taken. The Commission is advisory, but its recommendations are accepted in practice, which gives them great weight.

Karnataka's place in the national economy

Karnataka is a State of high output and a large service sector, with Bengaluru as a global technology and start-up hub. Its per capita income is well above the national average, and Bengaluru Urban district alone produces about two-fifths of the State's GSDP, as the Economic Survey of Karnataka shows. A State that contributes so much to national output also contributes heavily to central tax collections: income tax, corporate tax and GST paid by firms and people based in Karnataka flow to the Union's pool.

Yet the formula used by past Finance Commissions has given higher weight to need than to contribution. Because a rich State has a smaller "income distance", it receives a smaller share. This is what economists call horizontal equalisation, and it is the reason why Bihar receives about 10% of the pool and Karnataka a little over 4%.

The numbers: a fall and a recovery

Karnataka's share in the divisible pool was 4.71% under the Fourteenth Finance Commission (2015-20). It fell to 3.65% under the Fifteenth (2021-26), a drop of more than one percentage point, and the State argued that it lost a large sum over the five years. Under the Sixteenth Commission (2026-31), the State's

share rises to 4.13%. The 2026-27 Karnataka budget puts the State's receipts from the Union's tax pool at Rs 63,050 crore, 24% higher than the revised figure for 2025-26, which reflects the larger share.

The Sixteenth Commission also changed the formula. Income distance now carries 42.5% (earlier 45%), population 17.5% (earlier 15%), demographic performance 10% (earlier 12.5%), area 10% (earlier 15%), forest 10%, and the new "contribution to GDP" criterion 10%, replacing the earlier tax-effort criterion. The new measure gives credit to States such as Karnataka that add most to the national economy. The Commission also changed "demographic performance" to measure population growth between 1971 and 2011, which gives credit to States that stabilised their population early.

Grants and local bodies

The Commission recommended grants of Rs 9.47 lakh crore for the whole country, concentrated on local bodies and disaster management, and discontinued revenue deficit grants, sector-specific grants and State-specific grants. For Karnataka, the Commission recommended Rs 18,483 crore for urban local bodies, Rs 18,889 crore for rural local bodies and Rs 6,419 crore for disaster management, over 2026-31. This is welcome for a State where Bengaluru and other cities face heavy infrastructure demands. These grants carry conditions: all local body grants require that local bodies be constituted as per the Constitution, accounts be published, and State Finance Commissions be formed on time. The State must therefore keep its own panchayat and municipal institutions strong.

Concerns that remain

- Cesses and surcharges. They are excluded from the divisible pool. A growing share of the Union's collections that does not reach States reduces the practical value of the 41% headline.
- The loss of specific grants. The Fifteenth Commission had recommended special grants for Karnataka, including Rs 3,000 crore each for Bengaluru's peripheral ring road and for lake development. The State says they were never released; the Union told Parliament in December 2025 that no such grant is pending. The Sixteenth Commission discontinued State-specific grants altogether, so Karnataka's needs must now be met from the pool.
- Welfare spending and fiscal discipline. The Commission urged States to review and rationalise subsidies and unconditional cash transfers, and to avoid off-budget borrowing. Karnataka's five guarantee schemes make a large claim on the budget, and the State must show that they are well targeted and sustained.
- Borrowing limits. The fiscal deficit limit of 3% of GSDP applies to all States. For a growing State with big capital needs, the 50-year interest-free capital loans from the Union help, but are small.
- Political fairness. Past debates over population-based delimitation and tax shares fed a sense that States which performed better in development paid for it. The newer criteria soften, but do not remove, this feeling.

Karnataka's own responsibility

A State that asks for fairness from the Union must also set its own house in order. It should widen its own tax base, since most of its revenue still comes from its own taxes; make the State Finance Commission effective in sharing funds with panchayats and city corporations; and improve public sector enterprises, many of which, as the Commission noted, earn low returns. Using borrowed money for capital works, such as the metro, tanks and roads, builds assets, whereas using it for recurrent spending leaves debts for the next generation.

Way forward

- Press for a formula that rewards both equity and efficiency, and make the data used for it transparent.
- Seek a ceiling on cesses and surcharges, or their inclusion in the divisible pool, through the GST Council, the Inter-State Council and the Finance Commission process.
- Improve own-tax revenue through compliance and technology, and use subsidies for those who need them.

- Strengthen local bodies with funds and staff, and meet the entry conditions for Finance Commission grants.
- Publish a medium-term fiscal plan so that the public can see how borrowing translates into assets.

Conclusion

A fair share is not a favour; it is the price of a union in which the strong help the weak and the weak do not punish the strong. Karnataka's rise from 3.65% to 4.13% shows that a better-designed formula can recognise contribution as well as need. The State will best defend its claim by combining a firm voice in the federation with careful discipline at home. In that way a growing State can serve both its own people and the idea of India.

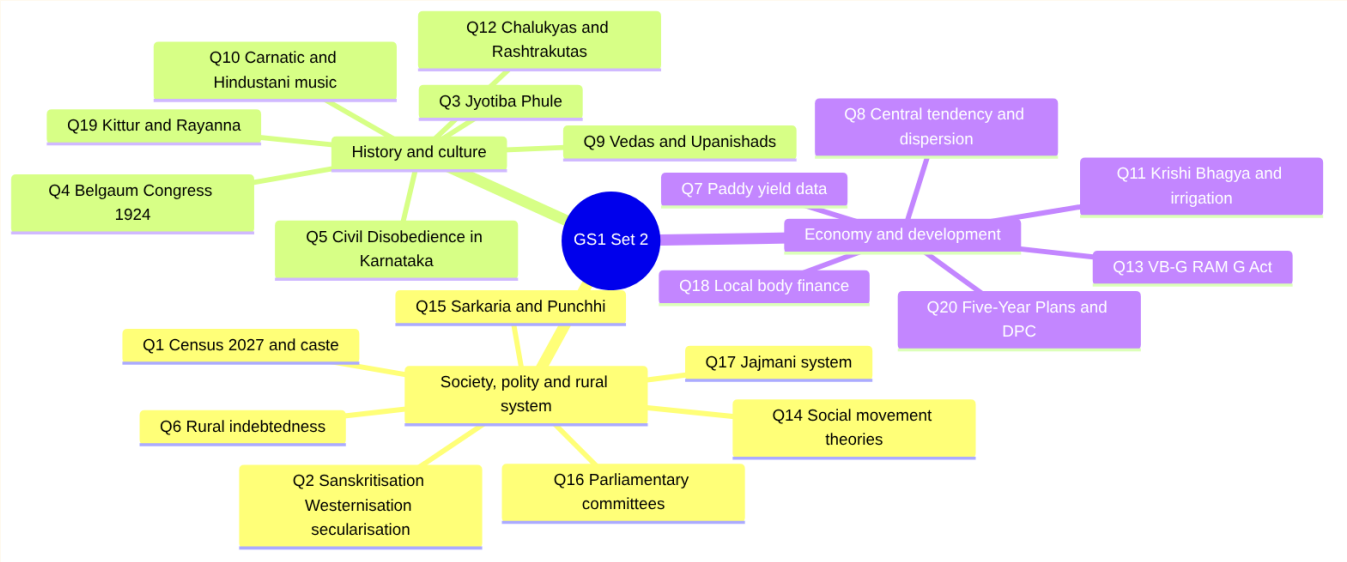
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "E-C-P-G": Equity, Contribution, Population, Grants: the four lenses of any Finance Commission award.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not quote only the 3.65% to 4.13% numbers; the examiner looks for the formula, the grants, the concerns and Karnataka's own duties.
>
> **RECAP:** Both essays follow the same shape: hook, stand, turns, other side, way forward. Try writing a 5-line plan for any new topic in 4 minutes before you start.

Paper 2: General Studies I (GS1)

Set 2: step 3 of 6 (General Studies I (GS1)). Next up: General Studies II (GS2)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Set 2 opens with Karnataka's caste and social structure, then moves through the nationalist movement in the State and the Vedic and music traditions. Each answer pairs a number or a date with a Karnataka example.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS1 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · Census 2027 and caste

PREDICTED · GS1-B3 · Current affairs

Q1. Census 2027 will, for the first time since 1931, record caste for all communities in its population enumeration. Discuss its significance for social policy and the concerns it raises. (150 words)

Model answer

The decennial Census counts people, housing and amenities. Census 2027 has two phases: house-listing in 2026 and population enumeration in February 2027 (reference date 1 March 2027). It is the first digital Census, and the second phase will include caste.

Significance

- Evidence for policy: Reservation, scholarships and welfare schemes for backward classes have relied on old or sample data; a count gives a base.
- Targeting: Shows which sub-groups within broad categories are left behind, helping sub-categorisation debates.
- Representation: Informs debate on delimitation and women's reservation, which follow the Census.

Concerns

- Risk of hardening identities and political mobilisation on caste lines.
- Data quality: the large number of caste names and spelling variations.
- Privacy of individual responses.

Way forward Clear category lists tested in advance, trained enumerators, strict data protection and publication of aggregated tables.

Conclusion Counted properly, caste data can make equality of opportunity measurable.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HEAT": Household listing first, Enumeration of population next, Appears digitally, Totals include caste.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Census will list religion-wise caste "for the first time in history"; caste of the Scheduled Castes and Tribes was always counted and the last full caste count was in 1931.

GS1 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · Sanskritisation, Westernisation, secularisation

PREDICTED · GS1-B3

Q2. Distinguish between Sanskritisation, Westernisation and secularisation as processes of social change. How far do they explain change in contemporary India? (250 words)

Model answer

M.N. Srinivas coined "Sanskritisation" in his study of the Coorgs of Karnataka (Religion and Society among the Coorgs of South India, 1952) and "Westernisation" in later writing. Together with secularisation, they describe the three directions in which Indian society has moved.

Sanskritisation A lower or middle caste adopts the rituals, vegetarian diet and customs of a higher caste to claim a higher status in the local hierarchy. It changes position, not the structure: it is "positional change" within the system. Examples are the adoption of sacred-thread practices by several communities.

Westernisation Change in dress, institutions, ideas and technology through contact with British rule and later with global culture: modern education, law and the English language. Srinivas observed two layers, a few who adopted Western lifestyle and many who changed in subtler ways.

Secularisation Decline in the control of religion over public life: law, education and the economy become rational and separate from ritual. In India, "secularisation" is also linked with the constitutional idea of equal respect to all religions.

Assessment

- Strength: They capture how people imitate reference groups and how change happens without revolution.
- Limits: Critics say Sanskritisation overstates the Brahmin model; Dalit and tribal movements often reject upper-caste norms, as in the assertion of Ambedkar's followers. Today's "Anglicisation", consumer culture and digital media also shape change.
- Contemporary forms: Urbanisation, social media and migration create new hybrid identities.

Conclusion These concepts remain useful starting points, but modern India also changes through democratic assertion, markets and technology.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-W-S": Sanskritise = climb by imitation, Westernise = absorb by contact, Secularise = separate by reason.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe Sanskritisation as conversion to Sanskrit; it is imitation of higher-caste customs by lower castes.

GS1 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · Jyotiba Phule

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q3. Evaluate the contribution of Jyotiba Phule to social reform in India. (150 words)

Model answer

Jyotirao (Jyotiba) Phule (1827-1890) of Maharashtra pioneered the movement against caste hierarchy and for the education of women and the so-called untouchable castes.

Work

- Opened a girls' school in Pune in 1848 with his wife, Savitribai, and later schools for lower-caste children.
- Founded the Satyashodhak Samaj in 1873 to promote equality and to free people from priestly intermediaries.
- Wrote Gulamgiri (1873), a sharp criticism of caste, dedicated to the Americans who fought slavery.
- Supported widow remarriage and opened a home for children born to widows.
- Spoke for the farmers in Shetkaryacha Asud ("The Cultivator's Whipcord").

Significance He saw education as the key to emancipation, and he linked caste oppression with economic exploitation. His ideas influenced the non-Brahmin movements of western and southern India, including Karnataka, and Ambedkar treated him as a guru.

Conclusion Phule's lasting message is that social democracy must precede political democracy.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "3 S": School for girls, Satyashodhak Samaj, Shetkaryacha Asud.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse Phule with the Brahmo or Arya reformers; he opposed the Brahmin-dominated social order itself, not just its practices.

GS1 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · Belgaum Congress 1924

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q4. The Belgaum session of the Indian National Congress in 1924 is a landmark in Karnataka's political history. Discuss its significance and the people and institutions that prepared the ground for it. (250 words)

Model answer

The 39th session of the Indian National Congress was held at Belgaum (now Belagavi) in December 1924. It was the only session over which Mahatma Gandhi presided, and it was held in a region whose Kannada speakers lived under several different governments.

The setting The Karnataka Congress had grown out of the Home Rule agitation and Non-Cooperation. Kannada speakers were then spread over the Bombay and Madras Presidencies, Hyderabad, Mysore and Coorg, and the Congress of the Kannada districts wanted a common political voice.

Preparation

- Leaders such as Gangadharrao Deshpande ("Karnataka Kesari"), who organised the Belgaum Congress, and the publishers of Kannada newspapers prepared public opinion.
- Associations such as the Karnataka Vidyavardhaka Sangha at Dharwad (1890) promoted Kannada culture and identity.
- Literary and cultural bodies built a sense of one linguistic region.

Significance

- Gandhi's presence gave national weight to khadi, removal of untouchability and Hindu-Muslim unity.
- It raised the demand for a united Karnataka and for the linguistic reorganisation of provinces that the Congress itself accepted in principle at Nagpur (1920) and later in its election manifestos.
- It brought mass participation and leaders from other regions into Karnataka's public life.

Limits The session did not by itself create unification, which required later political pressure and the States Reorganisation Act of 1956.

Conclusion Belgaum 1924 linked the national movement with the Kannada identity movement and made the demand for Ekikarana a political programme.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "1924-39-1": year 1924, 39th session, only 1 session chaired by Gandhi.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say Gandhi presided over many sessions; Belgaum 1924 was the only one.

GS1 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · Civil Disobedience in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. Describe the participation of coastal and Malnad Karnataka in the Civil Disobedience Movement of 1930. (150 words)

Model answer

The Civil Disobedience Movement (1930-34) began with Gandhi's Salt March. In Karnataka, it spread through the salt and forest laws, taxes and boycotts.

Salt satyagraha

- At Ankola in Uttara Kannada, volunteers broke the salt law in April 1930; similar action took place at Sanikatta.
- Mangaluru and other coastal towns saw picketing of foreign cloth and liquor shops.

Forest and tax resistance

- In Malnad and Uttara Kannada, people at Sirsi and Siddapur protested against forest restrictions and revenue demands, and refused to pay certain taxes.
- Women took part in picketing and processions.

Impact

- Thousands courted arrest; the British answered with lathi charges and fines.
- The Congress base widened among peasants and women.
- It later strengthened the demand for responsible government in princely Mysore.

Conclusion Karnataka's coast and Malnad showed that local grievances over salt, forests and tax could link with the national struggle.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-F-T": Salt (Ankola), Forest (Sirsi-Siddapur), Tax refusal.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit Karnataka with the Dandi March; it started in Gujarat. Karnataka's role was in the local salt and forest actions.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Ankola salt satyagraha 1930; Sirsi-Siddapur forest/tax protests.

GS1: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Rural indebtedness.

GS1 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · Rural indebtedness

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q6. What are the causes of rural indebtedness and agrarian distress in India? Evaluate the measures taken to address them. (250 words)

Model answer

Rural indebtedness means that farm households owe more than they can comfortably repay. Agrarian distress is the wider stress of falling margins, risk and uncertain income, and it is seen in loan waivers and farm suicides.

Causes

- Small and fragmented holdings: most holdings are under two hectares, which limits scale and investment.
- Input costs and price risk: seeds, fertiliser and labour costs rise faster than output prices; markets fluctuate.
- Weather and climate shocks: droughts, floods and unseasonal rain destroy crops in rain-fed areas.
- Credit: informal moneylenders charge high interest where banks and cooperatives do not reach small and tenant farmers.
- Social obligations: marriage and health emergencies force borrowing.
- Weak marketing: distress sale at harvest due to lack of storage and information.

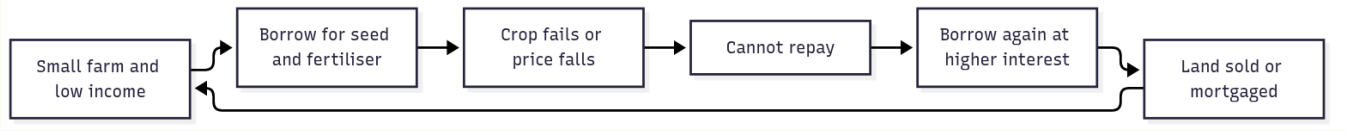
Measures taken

- Institutional credit: Kisan Credit Card, cooperative banks and interest subvention for timely repayment.
- Risk cover: Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and the Soil Health Card.
- Income support: PM-KISAN and State-level transfers.
- Market reforms: e-NAM, minimum support price, Farmer Producer Organisations.
- Debt relief by States, often through loan waivers.

Assessment Waivers give relief but weaken credit discipline and benefit the better placed. Insurance and credit still miss tenant farmers.

Way forward Cover tenants with credit and insurance, diversify income through allied activities, strengthen FPOs and storage, and give counselling and a mental health network in distressed districts.

Conclusion Lasting relief lies in raising incomes and reducing risk, not in repeated debt write-offs.



DRAW IT: The debt trap: how small loans become lasting debt. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "C-I-C-R-M": Costs, Income risk, Credit gaps, Rain shocks, Market weakness.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that loan waivers are a complete solution; examiners expect a balanced view.

GS1 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · Paddy yield data

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q7. Data (fictional). The average paddy yield (quintals per hectare) in a district in five successive years was: 2020: 34; 2021: 36; 2022: 33; 2023: 39; 2024: 43. (a) Find the mean yield. (b) Find the percentage change from year to year and identify the year of the sharpest rise and the year of decline. (c) Calculate the compound annual growth rate over the four-year period. (d) Comment on what the data show. (150 words)

Model answer

(a) Mean yield. (34 + 36 + 33 + 39 + 43) / 5 = 185 / 5 = **37 quintals per hectare**.

(b) Year-to-year change.

- 2021: (36 - 34) / 34 = +5.9%.
- 2022: (33 - 36) / 36 = -8.3% (the only decline).
- 2023: (39 - 33) / 33 = +18.2% (sharpest rise).
- 2024: (43 - 39) / 39 = +10.3%.

(c) CAGR. CAGR = (43 / 34)^(1/4) - 1 = (1.2647)^(0.25) - 1, which is about 0.0605 or **6.0% a year**.

(d) Comment.

- Yield rose by about 26.5% over four years, so the trend is upward, though not smooth.
- The dip in 2022 suggests a weather or pest shock; the sharp recovery in 2023 may be a bounce back from the low base, so it should not be treated as normal growth.
- The mean (37) hides the variation; one should look at rainfall and input data before drawing conclusions.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Change over old, then multiply by 100": (new - old) / old x 100.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not calculate percentage change over the new value; always divide by the earlier year.

GS1 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · Central tendency and dispersion

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q8. Explain the measures of central tendency and dispersion with an example. Why is the standard deviation preferred to the range, and how do these help in comparing regions? **Data (fictional):** literacy rate (%) in seven villages: 62, 70, 58, 74, 70, 66, 80. (250 words)

Model answer

Central tendency gives a single typical value:

- Mean: the sum divided by the number of items. For the data: 480 / 7 = **68.6%**.
- Median: the middle value of the ordered data: 58, 62, 66, **70**, 70, 74, 80, so the median is **70%**.
- Mode: the most frequent value: **70%**. The mean is affected by extreme values; the median is not; the mode helps when one value dominates.

Dispersion shows how scattered values are around the centre:

- Range: highest minus lowest = 80 - 58 = **22 percentage points**. It uses only two values.
- Variance and standard deviation (SD): the squared deviations from the mean sum to about 325.7; dividing by 7 gives a variance of 46.5, so the SD is **about 6.8**. (For sample data, divide by 6 to get 7.4.)
- Coefficient of variation: SD / mean x 100 = 6.8 / 68.6 x 100, about **9.9%**, which allows comparison between datasets with different means.

Why SD over range The range ignores everything between the extremes, and one odd village would change it sharply. The SD uses every observation and underlies the normal distribution and sampling.

Use in regional comparison Two districts may have the same average literacy but different spread: a low SD means even development; a high SD points to pockets of deprivation, which planners must target. This is why regional disparity studies report averages along with a measure of dispersion.

Conclusion Central tendency tells where the data are; dispersion tells how far they are spread. Both are needed for sound planning.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "MMM-RSC": Mean, Median, Mode, then Range, SD, CV.

COMMON TRAP: Do not stop at the mean; examiners reward the measure of spread and a policy reading.

GS1 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · Vedas and Upanishads

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q9. Describe the four Vedas and the significance of the Upanishads in Indian thought. (150 words)

Model answer

The Vedas (shruti, "that which is heard") are the oldest sacred texts of the Indo-Aryans, composed orally over many centuries, from about 1500 BCE onwards.

The four Vedas

- Rigveda: hymns to deities such as Agni, Indra and Varuna; ten books (mandalas).
- Samaveda: verses from the Rigveda set to melody; source of Indian musical tradition.
- Yajurveda: prose formulae for sacrifices.
- Atharvaveda: spells, healing and everyday life.

Each Veda has hymn collections (Samhita), ritual texts (Brahmana), forest texts (Aranyaka) and philosophical texts (Upanishads).

Upanishads They are the concluding part of the Vedas ("Vedanta"). They turn from ritual to enquiry about the self (atman) and the ultimate reality (Brahman). Ideas such as karma, rebirth and liberation were developed there. They influenced Buddhism, Jainism and later thinkers such as Shankara, whose nondualist philosophy was developed at Sringeri in Karnataka.

Conclusion The Vedic corpus is a foundation of Indian literature, ritual and thought.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "R-S-Y-A" = "Rig-Sama-Yajur-Atharva": hymn, song, ritual, spell.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call the Upanishads separate from the Vedas; they are the final part of each Veda.

GS1 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · Carnatic and Hindustani music

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q10. Trace the development of Carnatic and Hindustani music. What has been Karnataka's contribution to Indian music? (250 words)

Model answer

Indian classical music rests on raga (melodic framework) and tala (rhythmic cycle), and traces its theory to the Natya Shastra of Bharata and to the Sangita Ratnakara of Sharngadeva (13th century).

Two streams Until about the 13th century, there was one tradition. Contact with Persian and Central Asian culture in the north gave rise to the **Hindustani** tradition, with forms such as dhrupad, khayal and thumri. In the south, which developed under temple and court patronage, the **Carnatic** tradition emerged with kritis, varnams and a strong emphasis on devotional composition.

Features

- Hindustani: ragas linked to times of day; exploration of the raga (alap) is elaborate; instruments include the sitar, sarod and tabla.
- Carnatic: the compositions are central, with improvisation (alapana, swara kalpana) within them; the melakarta scheme of 72 parent scales; instruments include the veena, violin and mridangam.

Karnataka's contribution

- Purandara Dasa (c. 1484-1564) of the Vijayanagara period is called the "Pitamaha" (father) of Carnatic music, for organising the system of teaching with exercises such as sarali varisai and composing devotional songs in Kannada.
- Kanaka Dasa and the Haridasa tradition spread devotional music in Kannada.
- Mysuru's court under the Wadiyars patronised musicians; Karnataka also has a rich Hindustani tradition in the Dharwad region, with artists such as Gangubai Hangal, Bhimsen Joshi and Mallikarjun Mansur.

Conclusion Karnataka is one of the few regions that nurtured both streams, and it shows the shared roots of India's music.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "H = hall and horizon of north; C = composition and temple of south"; Karnataka = both.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say Hindustani and Carnatic are unrelated; both come from the same theory and the same ancient roots.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Purandara Dasa (c. 1484-1564) "Pitamaha" of Carnatic music; Natya Shastra; Sangita Ratnakara; Hindustani artists of Dharwad.

GS1: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Krishi Bhagya and irrigation.

GS1 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Krishi Bhagya and irrigation

PREDICTED · GS1-C6 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. Describe the main interventions of Karnataka in agriculture such as Krishi Bhagya and micro-irrigation, and assess how they help small farmers. (150 words)

Model answer

Karnataka has a large rain-fed area, so its farm policy focuses on water security, climate resilience and market access.

Interventions

- Krishi Bhagya: farm ponds and water harvesting for rain-fed farms.
- Micro-irrigation: drip and sprinkler systems are subsidised; about 1.01 lakh hectares came under micro-irrigation in 2025-26 up to December.
- Millets: special emphasis on millet production and processing that suit dry zones, and a Directorate of Secondary Agriculture, created to add value to produce.

Assessment

- Farm ponds give protective irrigation in dry spells.
- Micro-irrigation saves water and fertiliser.
- Gaps remain in tenant farmers' access and in maintenance.

Conclusion Water harvesting and efficient irrigation, backed by markets, are the best defence of the small farmer against climate risk.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "P-D-M": Ponds (Krishi Bhagya), Drip (micro-irrigation), Millets.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mention only subsidies; show how the schemes reduce risk and link with value addition.

GS1 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · Chalukyas and Rashtrakutas

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q12. Discuss the contribution of the Badami Chalukyas and the Rashtrakutas to the art, architecture and literature of Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Between the 6th and 10th centuries, two dynasties made Karnataka a centre of Deccan power and culture.

Badami Chalukyas (c. 543-753 CE)

- Political: Pulakeshin II (610-642) defeated Harshavardhana on the Narmada, and his Aihole inscription, composed by the court poet Ravikirti, records the event.
- Architecture: They experimented with temple forms at Aihole (Durga and Lad Khan temples), Badami (rock-cut caves) and Pattadakal, where northern (nagara) and southern (dravida) styles stand together; Pattadakal is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- Language: Kannada appears in records such as the Kappe Arabhatta inscription at Badami (c. 700).

Rashtrakutas (c. 753-982 CE)

- Political: Dantidurga founded the empire; Amoghavarsha I (c. 814-878) ruled from Manyakheta (Malkhed).
- Architecture: The Kailasa temple at Ellora, cut from a single rock under Krishna I, is a masterpiece of monolithic architecture.
- Literature: Kavirajamarga (c. 850), attributed to Amoghavarsha or Sri Vijaya, is the earliest available work on Kannada poetics and describes the Kannada country; Jain poets such as Pampa and Ponna flourished under their successors and feudatories.

Significance They gave Kannada literary status, created temple styles, and linked the Deccan with north and south, laying the base for the Hoysala and Vijayanagara achievements.

Conclusion The Chalukya and Rashtrakuta periods turned Karnataka's stone and language into a lasting heritage.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "B-P-A-K-E": Badami, Pattadakal, Aihole; Kavirajamarga, Ellora.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix up the Kailasa temple at Ellora (Rashtrakuta, Maharashtra) with Pattadakal's Virupaksha temple (Chalukya, Karnataka).

GS1 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · VB-G RAM G Act

PREDICTED · GS1-C7 · Current affairs

Q13. The Viksit Bharat - G RAM G Act, 2025 replaces the MGNREGA scheme from 1 July 2026. Describe its main features and the issues in the transition. (150 words)

Model answer

The Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 (VB-G RAM G) replaces the 2005 rural job guarantee law, MGNREGA, from 1 July 2026.

Main features

- A legal guarantee of **125 days** of unskilled manual work per rural household each year, against 100 days earlier.
- Work may pause for up to 60 days in notified peak sowing and harvest seasons, so that farms get labour.
- Funding is shared 60:40 between Union and States (90:10 for the North-Eastern and Himalayan States).
- Unemployment allowance stays.
- Works link to water security, rural infrastructure, livelihoods and climate resilience.

Issues

- States' burden under the new sharing pattern, especially for those with high demand.
- Right to work during the pause period, and wage timeliness.
- Gram panchayats' capacity to plan.

Conclusion Success needs timely wages, fair funding to States and active gram sabhas.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "125-60-60:40": days of work, days of pause, funding ratio.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that the right to work has been removed; the Act is still a legal guarantee, with changed terms.

GS1 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · Social movement theories

PREDICTED · GS1-B2

Q14. Explain the main theories of social movements. Illustrate with the women's and environmental movements in India. (250 words)

Model answer

A social movement is a sustained collective effort to bring about or resist change, outside normal institutional channels.

Theories

- Relative deprivation: movements arise when people feel that they are worse off than what they expect or than others are (Ted Gurr).
- Resource mobilisation: movements need leaders, funds, organisation and networks; grievances alone are not enough (McCarthy and Zald).
- Collective behaviour: sudden crowds and reform sects arise in times of strain (Smelser's value-added model).
- New social movements: since the 1970s, movements centred on identity, environment and rights rather than class (Touraine, Melucci).
- Political process theory: opportunities within the political system decide the movement's success.

Illustrations

- Women's movement: Led by reformers in colonial days; after the Committee on the Status of Women (1974), autonomous groups campaigned on dowry, rape and domestic violence, producing laws such as the 2005 domestic violence law and the POSH Act, 2013. It shows resource mobilisation (NGOs, networks) and new-movement features (identity, rights).
- Environmental movements: The Narmada Bachao Andolan and Silent Valley campaign show deprivation, displacement and the use of media, courts and public opinion.

Evaluation No single theory is enough; movements need grievance, organisation and opportunity, and they also change law and public values.

Conclusion Understanding the theories helps administrators engage early with grievances before they become confrontation.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "D-R-C-N-P": Deprivation, Resources, Collective behaviour, New movements, Political process.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not list theories without examples; link each to a real movement.

GS1 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · Sarkaria and Punchhi

PREDICTED · GS1-B5

Q15. Summarise the main recommendations of the commissions headed by Justices Sarkaria and Punchhi on Union-State relations. (150 words)

Model answer

Sarkaria Commission (1983-88) Headed by Justice R.S. Sarkaria, it reported in 1988, accepting a strong Centre but urging cooperation.

- Article 356 only as a last resort, sparingly, after other remedies fail.
- Governors should be eminent persons from outside the State, not active in politics, appointed after consulting the Chief Minister.
- A permanent Inter-State Council (Article 263).
- Residuary power of taxation to stay with Parliament; surcharges only for temporary needs.
- Three-language formula.

Punchhi Commission (2007-10) Justice M.M. Punchhi's commission reaffirmed most of this and added:

- Governors to have a fixed five-year term, removable only through a process like impeachment.
- Use Articles 355 and 356 for "localised emergency" in a district before imposing a full State emergency.
- Safeguards against misuse of Governor's discretion.

Impact Some ideas were adopted slowly, such as the Inter-State Council (1990).

Conclusion Both favour cooperative federalism with a strong but restrained Centre.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-P": Sarkaria 1988 = sparing use of Art 356; Punchhi 2010 = Punish misuse with safeguards, fixed tenure.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that the Commissions recommended abolishing Article 356; they asked for restraint.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Sarkaria Commission 1983-88; Punchhi Commission 2007-10 recommendations; Inter-State Council 1990.

GS1: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Parliamentary committees.

GS1 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · Parliamentary committees

PREDICTED · GS1-B4

Q16. How effective are Parliamentary committees in ensuring legislative oversight of the executive? Suggest reforms. (250 words)

Model answer

Parliament is too busy to examine every Bill and every rupee of spending in detail. It therefore works through committees: small, cross-party groups that study subjects in depth.

Types

- Standing committees: Public Accounts Committee, Estimates Committee and Committee on Public Undertakings, which scrutinise expenditure; and the departmentally related standing committees, formed in 1993 to cover ministries.
- Ad hoc committees: Joint Parliamentary Committees on specific issues or Bills; select committees.

Effectiveness

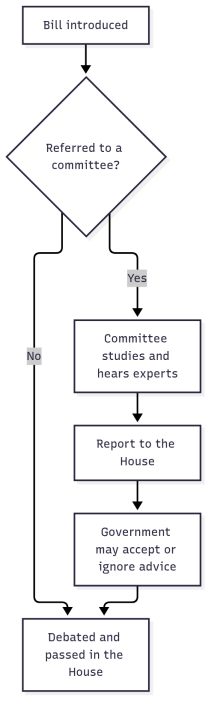
- Strengths: Closed-door discussions reduce partisanship, experts are called, and reports often influence policy. The Public Accounts Committee tests departmental spending against audit reports.
- Weaknesses: Their recommendations are advisory and the government may not accept them; many Bills are passed without referral; attendance is irregular; members change frequently; technical support is limited.

Karnataka The State Legislature has similar committees on public accounts and estimates, and State follow-up could improve through a tracked action-taken report.

Reforms

- Refer all major Bills to committees automatically.
- Time-bound reports and action-taken statements by the government.
- More research staff and a fixed tenure for members.
- Open hearings and public reports, including a yearly scorecard of how many recommendations were accepted.

Conclusion Strong committees make legislatures a real check on the executive between elections.



DRAW IT: A Bill and Parliamentary committee oversight. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "P-E-D-J": Public accounts, Estimates, Department committees, Joint committees.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say committees can enforce their reports; their power is persuasive, not binding.

GS1 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · Jajmani system

PREDICTED · GS1-B6

Q17. What was the jajmani system? Examine how the market economy and democratic politics have changed it. (150 words)

Model answer

The jajmani system was the traditional exchange of goods and services in the village. Families of artisans and service castes (carpenter, blacksmith, barber, washerman, priest) served landowning patrons (jajmans) and received payment, in kind, at harvest. The term was popularised by W.H. Wiser (The Hindu Jajmani System, 1936).

Features Hereditary, caste-based, personal and based on mutual obligation.

Change

- Market economy: Cash wages, factory goods and urban jobs reduced reliance on village artisans.
- Land reforms and Green Revolution: Tenants gained rights and landowners mechanised, so labour moved to wage work.
- Education and democracy: Lower castes gained political voice and refused hereditary service.
- Migration: Many moved to towns for new occupations.

Present Traces remain in some communities, for example in ritual services and in village festivals.

Conclusion The jajmani system gave security but also inequality; its decline widens freedom but leaves new risks of unemployment for craft families.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "W-C-A": Wiser (1936), Caste duties, Annual payment in grain.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call the jajmani system a market exchange; it was a social obligation, not a free contract.

GS1 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · Local body finance

PREDICTED · GS1-C5 · Karnataka-specific

Q18. Examine the sources of revenue of urban and rural local bodies in India and the problems of their finance. What steps has Karnataka taken to strengthen them? (250 words)

Model answer

Local bodies provide water, sanitation, roads and street lighting. The 73rd and 74th Amendments created panchayats and municipalities, but did not give them a guaranteed tax base.

Sources

- Own revenue: property tax, professional tax, trade licence fees, user charges and, for municipalities, advertisement and building fees. Panchayats have limited own taxes.
- Assigned or shared taxes: a share of State taxes recommended by the State Finance Commission (Articles 243I and 243Y).

- Grants: from the Union under the Finance Commission and centrally sponsored schemes, and from the State.
- Borrowing: municipal bonds in a few large cities.

Problems

- Weak property tax collection and old records.
- Dependence on grants, many of which are tied to schemes chosen by others.
- Delays in constituting State Finance Commissions and releasing funds.
- Weak accounts and audit, which affect eligibility for grants.

Karnataka The 2026-27 State budget raises the share of own revenue receipts devolved to local bodies from 48% to 50%. The Sixteenth Finance Commission, in turn, has made its grants conditional on timely accounts and State Finance Commissions.

Way forward Update property records using GIS, publish audited accounts, link grants to performance, and build municipal credit.

Conclusion Without a dependable financial base, local self-government remains local administration.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "O-S-G-B": Own taxes, Shared taxes, Grants, Borrowing.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say panchayats can levy any tax; they can levy only what the State legislature authorises.

GS1 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Kittur and Rayanna

PREDICTED · GS1-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q19. Write a note on the revolt of Kittur (1824) and Sangolli Rayanna, and its significance in Karnataka's history. (150 words)

Model answer

Kittur, in present-day Belagavi district, was a small principality under the Desai family. After Raja Mallasarja died in 1824, Queen Chennamma adopted a boy as heir. The East India Company refused to recognise him and sent troops.

Events

- In October 1824, Kittur's forces won the first battle, and the Collector and Political Agent, St John Thackeray, was killed.
- A larger British force defeated her in December 1824; Chennamma was imprisoned and died in 1829.
- Sangolli Rayanna, her commander, continued the guerrilla war to restore Kittur. He was captured and hanged in 1831.

Significance It was one of the earliest armed protests against Company rule, long before 1857. Chennamma and Rayanna have become icons of Kannada pride and bravery.

Conclusion The revolt showed that resistance to the Company's expansion existed in Karnataka from the early nineteenth century.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "1824-1829-1831": revolt, death of Chennamma, hanging of Rayanna.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit Kittur to Mysore State; it was part of the Bombay Karnataka region under the Company's rule.

GS1 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · Five-Year Plans and DPC

PREDICTED · GS1-C4

Q20. Trace the evolution of Five-Year Planning in India and explain how district-level planning works under Article 243ZD. (250 words)

Model answer

Five-Year Plans (1951-2017) The Planning Commission, set up by a Cabinet resolution in 1950 with the Prime Minister as chairman, prepared the plans. The First Plan (1951-56) emphasised agriculture; the Second (1956-61), on the Mahalanobis model, stressed heavy industry; the Third and Fourth plans dealt with food shortage and the Green Revolution; the Fifth turned to poverty removal; the Eighth (1992-97) followed the market reforms of 1991; the Eleventh aimed at "inclusive growth". Planning was top-down: the Commission fixed allocations for States. The Twelfth Plan (2012-17) was the last, and the Commission was wound up in 2015.

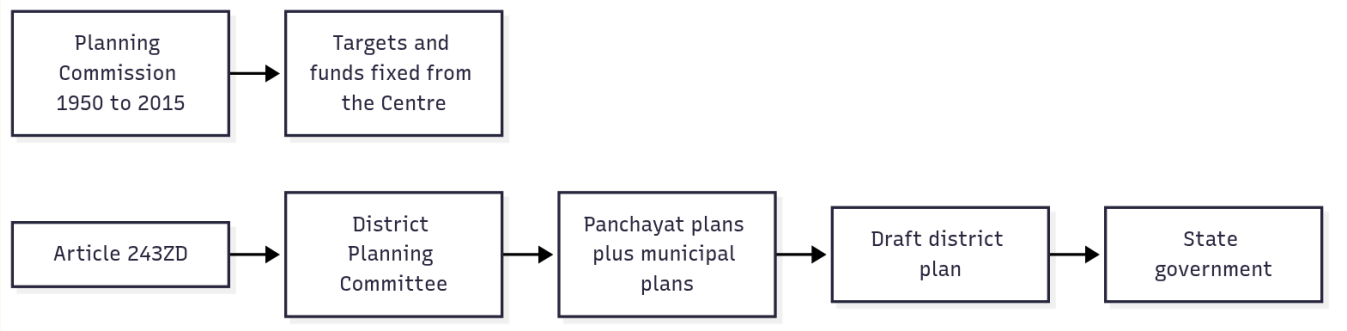
What replaced it A new think tank advises on policy but does not allocate funds, so State planning machinery matters more than before.

Planning at the district level

- Article 243ZD (74th Amendment) requires a District Planning Committee (DPC) in every district to consolidate plans of panchayats and municipalities into a draft district plan.
- At least four-fifths of its members must be elected by the elected members of the panchayats and municipalities from among themselves.
- The plan considers spatial planning, shared resources, and environmental conservation.

Assessment Planning moved from central targets to guidance. But DPCs in many States remain weak, with poor staff and little real money.

Conclusion Bottom-up planning through DPCs suits the new setting, but needs untied funds and trained planners.



DRAW IT: Planning from the top and from the district. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "PC-1950, NITI-2015": from allocating funds to offering ideas; DPC links village to district.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that the Planning Commission was a constitutional body; it was set up by a Cabinet resolution, as is NITI Aayog.

PEAK FACT: Planning Commission 1950; wound up 2015; Art 243ZD; DPC four-fifths elected.

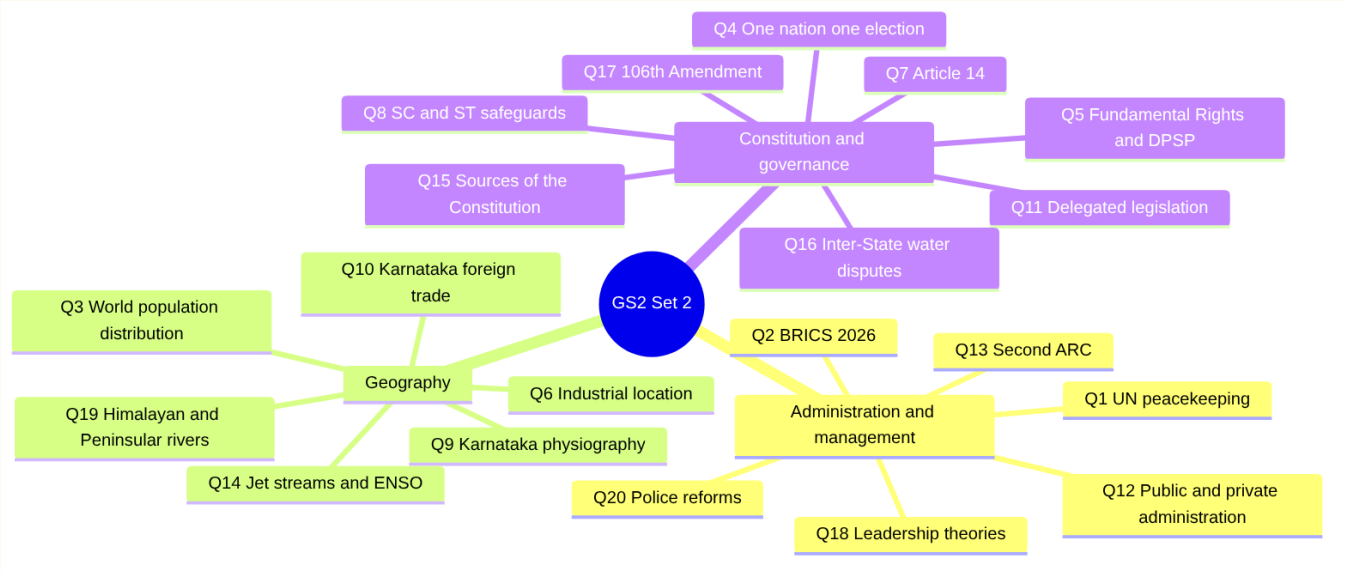
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Parliamentary committees:** "P-E-D-J": Public accounts, Estimates, Department committees, Joint committees. **Q17 Jajmani system:** "W-C-A": Wiser (1936), Caste duties, Annual payment in grain. **Q18 Local body finance:** "O-S-G-B": Own taxes, Shared taxes, Grants, Borrowing. **Q19 Kittur and Rayanna:** "1824-1829-1831": revolt, death of Chennamma, hanging of Rayanna. **Q20 Five-Year Plans and DPC:** "PC-1950, NITI-2015": from allocating funds to offering ideas; DPC links village to district.

Paper 3: General Studies II (GS2)

Set 2: step 4 of 6 (General Studies II (GS2)). Next up: General Studies III (GS3)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Polity and administration questions use the Constitution first, then a court case or committee. Geography answers link physical causes to Karnataka's regions, and trade and world questions use fresh 2026 facts.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS2 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · UN peacekeeping

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q1. India is among the largest cumulative troop contributors to United Nations peacekeeping. Discuss the principles of peacekeeping, its importance for India, and the challenges Indian contingents face. (150 words)

Model answer

UN peacekeeping deploys civilian, police and military personnel, with host-State consent, to help a fragile peace hold. India has sent about 290,000 personnel to over 50 missions since 1948; nearly 180 Indian peacekeepers have died on duty.

Principles

- Consent of the main parties.
- Impartiality.
- Non-use of force except in self-defence and defence of the mandate.

Importance for India

- Strengthens its claim to a reformed Security Council.
- Projects a responsible Global South power; in 2007 India sent the first all-women formed police unit to Liberia.
- The Centre for United Nations Peacekeeping, New Delhi, trains personnel from many countries.

Challenges

- Broad mandates, thin resources and unclear rules of engagement.
- Attacks on peacekeepers, as in Lebanon, the DRC and South Sudan.
- Late reimbursements and little say for troop contributors in drafting mandates.

Conclusion Troop contributors should have formal consultation before mandates are drawn up.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CIN": Consent, Impartiality, No-force-except-defence.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Peacekeeping is not "peace enforcement"; peacekeepers need the host State's consent. Do not call it a Chapter VII war operation.

GS2 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · BRICS 2026

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q2. India holds the chair of BRICS in 2026 and hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi in September 2026. Discuss the evolution of BRICS and the opportunities and limits of the grouping for India. (250 words)

Model answer

BRICS began as "BRIC", a term coined by an economist in 2001 and a diplomatic forum from 2006; South Africa joined in 2010. India's 2026 chair theme is "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability", and the 18th Summit was held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 12-13 September 2026.

Evolution

- Institutions: The New Development Bank (2015, Shanghai) and the Contingent Reserve Arrangement lend support to development and to members facing payment pressures.
- Expansion: From 2024 the grouping expanded to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the UAE and, in 2025, Indonesia.

Opportunities for India

- A platform for the voice of the Global South and for reform of the UN, IMF and World Bank.
- Finance for infrastructure through the NDB and trade in local currencies.
- Bridge-building between emerging economies and the West, and a stage for India's digital public infrastructure.

Limits

- Divergent interests: India-China border tension, and different views on the West and Russia.
- Talk of an alternative currency sits uneasily with India's stress on financial stability; India has said it does not seek de-dollarisation.
- Enlargement can dilute decision-making by consensus.
- Intra-bloc trade is thin and dominated by China.

Way forward India should use the chair to push reform of multilateral institutions, digital public goods and climate finance, and keep BRICS non-confrontational.

Conclusion BRICS is useful to India as one of many platforms, not as a bloc against anyone.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "BRICS = Build Reform, Include, Cooperate, Stay-friendly": five ideas for India's agenda.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe BRICS as a military or anti-West alliance; it is a consensus-based, issue-based forum. Do not list members you are not sure of; name only those you can confirm.

GS2 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · World population distribution

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q3. Describe the pattern of world population distribution and explain the physical and human factors that influence it. (150 words)

Model answer

About 8 billion people live unevenly on Earth: roughly nine-tenths in the Northern Hemisphere and over half in Asia. The inhabited, densely settled area is the "ecumene"; the near-empty zones are the "anecumene".

Major clusters East Asia, South Asia, Europe and north-eastern North America. Sparse regions include deserts, polar areas, high mountains and equatorial forests.

Physical factors

- Relief: Plains and river valleys favour farming and cities; steep mountains discourage them.
- Climate and water: Moderate temperature and reliable rainfall support dense populations; extremes do not.
- Soils and resources: Alluvial soils feed large numbers; minerals attract settlement.

Human factors

- Agricultural history and early civilisations.
- Industry, trade and transport.
- Political stability and policy.

Karnataka Dense settlement in the Bengaluru region, coastal Karnataka and the Cauvery basin contrasts with the sparsely peopled forests of the Western Ghats.

Conclusion Population follows resources and opportunity; technology now loosens the hold of climate.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "RCS + HIP": Relief, Climate, Soil + History, Industry, Politics.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that population follows only physical factors; economic and political factors explain places such as Singapore and the Gulf cities.

GS2 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · One nation one election

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q4. The Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 seeks to hold elections to Parliament's lower House and State legislatures together. Discuss its provisions, merits and concerns. (250 words)

Model answer

Simultaneous elections were the norm until 1967. A committee under former President Ram Nath Kovind (March 2024) recommended a return to them in two steps: Parliament and the Assemblies first, and local bodies within 100 days. The Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, introduced on 17 December

2024, was referred to a Joint Parliamentary Committee. As of October 2026 the committee has not reported, so the proposal remains a Bill.

Main provisions

- A new Article 82A to allow simultaneous elections after an "appointed date" notified by the President after a general election.
- Amendments to Articles 83 and 172 and a change to Article 327.
- If an Assembly is dissolved early, fresh elections are held only for the remainder of the term.

Merits

- Lower cost of elections and fewer disruptions caused by the Model Code of Conduct.
- Continuity in policy and use of security forces and staff.
- Possibly higher voter turnout.

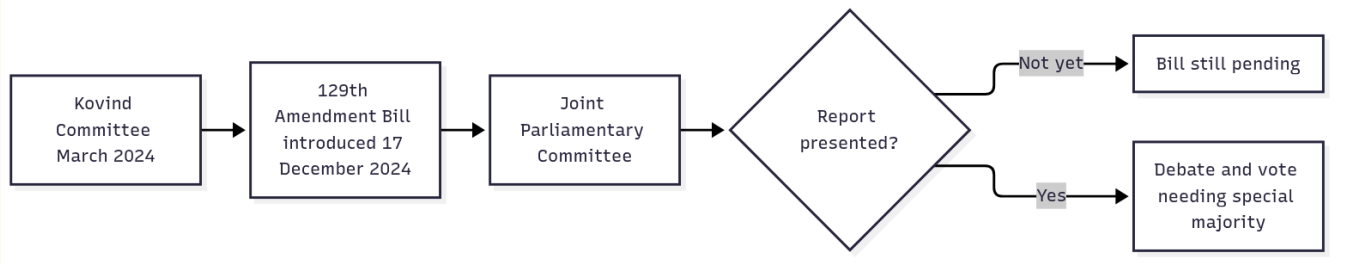
Concerns

- Curtailing the term of Assemblies raises federal and democratic questions.
- Regional parties may lose to the national narrative in joint elections.
- Logistical needs: voting machines and polling staff.
- The basic structure doctrine may be invoked.

Karnataka The Assembly elected in May 2023 would see its term shortened to align with 2029.

Way forward Phased approach, consensus and a clear route for early dissolution.

Conclusion Efficiency must not weaken federal accountability.



DRAW IT: The simultaneous election proposal so far. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "82A + 83 + 172 + 327": the four articles; "Kovind - 100 days" for local bodies.

COMMON TRAP: The Bill is not law yet; it is before a JPC. Do not claim that simultaneous elections have been enacted.

GS2 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · Fundamental Rights and DPSP

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q5. Compare Fundamental Rights with Directive Principles of State Policy, and explain how the Supreme Court has reconciled them. Why is the Uniform Civil Code in the news? (150 words)

Model answer

Fundamental Rights (Part III) are justiciable and restrain the State; Directive Principles (Part IV, Articles 36-51) are non-justiciable guidelines for governance, aimed at a welfare State (Article 37).

Harmonisation

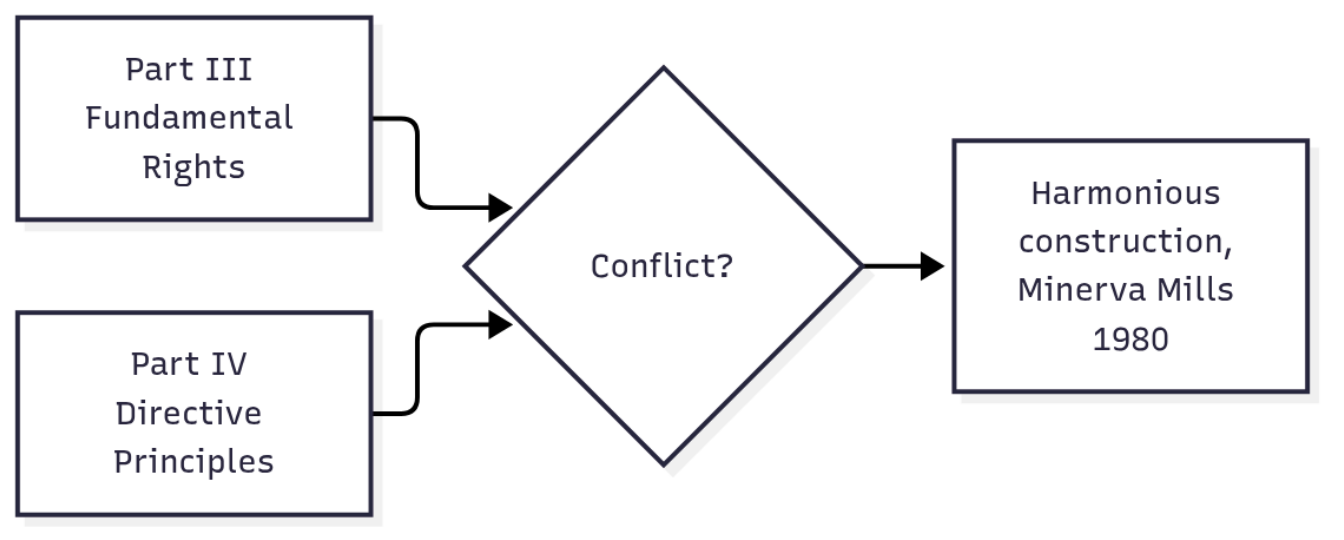
- Early cases (Champakam Dorairajan, 1951) said Fundamental Rights prevail.

- Kesavananda Bharati (1973) treated both as complementary.
- Minerva Mills (1980) held that balance between the two is a basic feature.
- Under Article 31C, laws giving effect to Article 39(b) and (c) are shielded, to the extent upheld.

Uniform Civil Code Article 44 asks the State to "endeavour" to secure a uniform civil code. Uttarakhand's Uniform Civil Code Act, 2024 came into force on 27 January 2025, covering marriage, divorce, succession and live-in relationships, but not Scheduled Tribes.

Karnataka The Anna Bhagya scheme of free food grains advances Article 47 (nutrition) and Article 39(a).

Conclusion Rights and directives together form the conscience of the Constitution.



DRAW IT: Rights and directives. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Right = Rule on the State; Directive = Dream for the State."

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Directive Principles are "unenforceable and therefore useless"; courts read them into Article 21 and use them to test reasonableness.

PEAK FACT: Uttarakhand UCC Act 2024 in force 27 Jan 2025; excludes Scheduled Tribes; covers live-in relationships.

GS2: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Industrial location.

GS2 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · Industrial location

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q6. Industrial corridors are said to change the geography of production. Explain the factors that shape industrial location and assess the role of industrial corridors, with reference to Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Industry locates where costs are lowest and markets reachable. Alfred Weber stressed transport cost, labour and agglomeration; modern firms add policy, skills and logistics. Location also decides regional growth and jobs.

Factors of location

- Raw material and power: Steel near iron ore, textiles near cotton, cement near limestone.
- Market and transport: Ports, rail and highways.
- Labour and skills: Bengaluru's engineering talent drew electronics and aerospace.
- Agglomeration: Suppliers and customers cluster, lowering costs.

- Government policy: Industrial parks, incentives, SEZs.

Industrial corridors A corridor links industrial nodes along a freight line or highway with common infrastructure, power, water and "plug and play" land. India's National Industrial Corridor Development Programme has several corridors, including the Delhi-Mumbai and the Chennai-Bengaluru Industrial Corridors. In August 2024, the Union Cabinet approved 12 new industrial nodes.

Karnataka The Chennai-Bengaluru corridor has its Karnataka node at Tumakuru, close to Bengaluru, planned on about 8,484 acres in three phases and developed through the corridor authority and the State's industrial areas board (KIADB).

Assessment

- Advantages: Planned infrastructure, jobs and exports, and lower logistics cost, since goods move along dedicated freight and highway links.
- Concerns: Land acquisition, displacement of farmers, water stress, and uneven spread that can deepen regional gaps if only established regions benefit.

Conclusion Corridors must be paired with skills, environmental safeguards and attention to backward regions such as north Karnataka.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "MTL PA": Material, Transport, Labour, Policy, Agglomeration.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that raw material alone decides location; for modern services and electronics, skills, airports and agglomeration matter more.

GS2 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · Article 14

PREDICTED · GS2-B2

Q7. Explain the scope of Article 14 of the Constitution. How have the courts interpreted "reasonable classification" and "arbitrariness"? (150 words)

Model answer

Article 14 says the State shall not deny any person equality before the law or equal protection of the laws, so it covers citizens and non-citizens alike.

Two ideas

- Equality before the law (British idea): no one is above the law.
- Equal protection of laws (American idea): like persons are treated alike in like circumstances.

Reasonable classification A law may classify if the classification (a) rests on an intelligible differentia and (b) has a rational nexus with the law's object, for example special provisions for women and children.

Arbitrariness In E.P. Royappa (1974), Justice Bhagwati said equality is antithetical to arbitrariness; Maneka Gandhi (1978) linked Articles 14, 19 and 21. A law or action can be struck down if manifestly arbitrary (Shayara Bano, 2017).

Conclusion Article 14 now demands fairness and reason in every State action.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "ID + RN": Intelligible Differentia + Rational Nexus.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate equality with identical treatment; the Constitution allows reasonable classification and affirmative action.

GS2 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · SC and ST safeguards

PREDICTED · GS2-B2

Q8. Examine the constitutional safeguards and legal protections available to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. How has the law on sub-classification of Scheduled Castes evolved? (250 words)

Model answer

Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs) have faced exclusion for centuries. The Constitution provides protection in several forms.

Constitutional safeguards

- Social: Article 15(4) and Article 17 (abolition of untouchability); Article 23 (bonded labour).
- Educational and economic: Article 46 (promotion of interests) and Article 15(4).
- Services: Articles 16(4), 16(4A) and 335.
- Political: Reserved seats in Parliament and Assemblies (Articles 330 and 332), extended by the 104th Amendment to 2030.
- Institutional: The National Commissions (Articles 338 and 338A); the Fifth and Sixth Schedules for tribal areas.

Statutes

- The 1955 law on civil rights (untouchability offences).
- Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, amended in 2015 to add offences and in 2018 to restore the position on arrest after a Supreme Court ruling diluted it.
- Karnataka's SC/ST Sub-Plan law (2013) earmarks funds in proportion to the population.

Sub-classification E.V. Chinnaiah (2004) held that SCs form one homogeneous class, so States could not sub-divide them. In State of Punjab v. Davinder Singh (August 2024), a seven-judge bench held that States may sub-classify SCs on empirical data, while the "creamy layer" question was raised in separate opinions.

Challenges Implementation gaps, low conviction rates and pending cases.

Conclusion Safeguards are strong on paper; stronger enforcement and data are needed.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-E-S-P-I": Social, Educational, Services, Political, Institutional.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not state that the 2024 judgment struck down reservation or gave "creamy layer" exclusion to SCs as law; it allowed sub-classification on data, and creamy layer views were observations.

GS2 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · Karnataka physiography

PREDICTED · GS2-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. Describe the physiographic divisions of Karnataka and show how relief shapes regional development policy in the State. (150 words)

Model answer

Karnataka (1.92 lakh sq km) has three broad physical regions.

Karavali (coastal plain) A narrow strip of about 320 km along the Arabian Sea, with sandy beaches, estuaries and the west-flowing rivers such as the Netravati and Sharavathi.

Malnad (Western Ghats) A high, forested range with heavy rainfall. Mullayanagiri (about 1,930 m) in Chikkamagaluru is the State's highest peak. Rivers fall steeply, as at Jog Falls.

Bayaluseeme (plateau) The dry Deccan plateau, sloping eastwards and drained by the Krishna, Tungabhadra and Cauvery. It includes the northern maidan and the southern Mysuru plateau.

Relief and policy

- The Malnad Area Development Board, constituted under the Malnad Area Development Act, 1991, addresses ecological and development needs of hill taluks.
- Bayaluseeme (Maidan Area) comprises 57 taluks recognised as drought-prone, supported by a separate Board.

Conclusion Policy follows relief: ecology in the Ghats, water in the plateau.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "KMB": Karavali, Malnad, Bayaluseeme: coast, hills, dry plateau.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not use the old label "Bayalu Seeme" as a synonym for the entire plateau; the northern and southern plateaus differ in rainfall and soil. Do not mix up Mullayanagiri with Kudremukh.

GS2 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · Karnataka foreign trade

PREDICTED · GS2-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Examine the profile of Karnataka's foreign trade, including the gateways through which it trades and the opportunities and constraints. (250 words)

Model answer

Karnataka is a major exporter of services and electronics. Its Economic Survey for 2025-26 notes that nearly 40 per cent of GSDP is linked to export-oriented activities, and that overall exports increased by 13.78 per cent during 2025-26 compared to 2024-25.

Pattern

- Exports: Electronics, software and other services lead. Agricultural exports rose from USD 2,043.70 million in 2023-24 to USD 2,457.42 million in 2024-25, nearly 20 per cent.
- Imports: The largest imports through the State's gateways in 2024-25 were electronic goods through Bengaluru airport (USD 11,272.40 million) and crude petroleum products through New Mangalore Port (USD 11,186.36 million).

Gateways

- The State's only Major Port is New Mangalore; it also has 13 Minor Ports.
- Kempegowda International Airport (BIAL) and the Inland Container Depot at Bengaluru carry high-value cargo.
- The sea port at Karwar handles petroleum products.

Opportunities

- Electronics, aerospace and defence, biotechnology and the new Clean Mobility Policy.
- Agri-exports of coffee, spices and processed food, and geographical-indication products.

Constraints

- Heavy reliance on a few sectors and on Bengaluru.
- Dependence on global demand and tariff shocks.
- Hinterland connectivity to ports; one planned port drew no bids in three tenders and is being moved to the New Mangalore Port Authority.

Conclusion The State should spread exports across districts and strengthen coastal logistics.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "EGO": Electronics, Gateways, Opportunities, then Obstacles.

COMMON TRAP: Do not quote merchandise-trade data as if they were all exports; the table of the commodities in the Survey lists imports through each airport and port.

PEAK FACT: Nearly 40% of GSDP linked to export-oriented activities.

GS2: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Delegated legislation.

GS2 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Delegated legislation

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q11. What is delegated legislation? Discuss its need, the safeguards that exist and the dangers of excessive delegation. (150 words)

Model answer

Delegated legislation means rules, regulations, orders and bye-laws made by the executive or another authority under power given by a law passed by the legislature.

Need

- Lawmakers lack time for details.
- Technical subjects such as drugs, electricity or taxation need expertise.
- Flexibility and speed in emergencies.

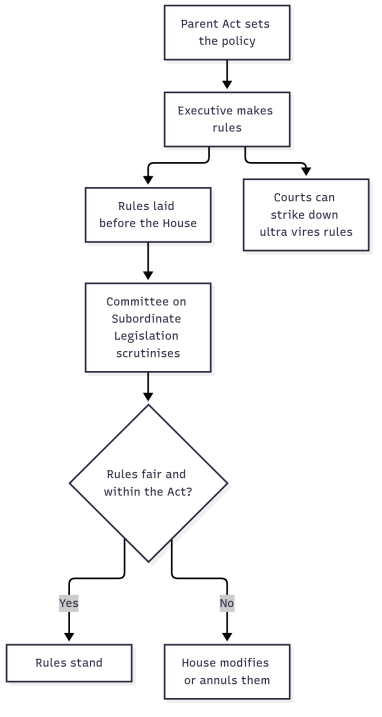
Safeguards

- The parent Act must lay down the policy; the legislature cannot abdicate its essential functions (In re Delhi Laws Act, 1951).
- Rules are "laid before" the House, which can modify or annul them.
- Parliament's Committee on Subordinate Legislation scrutinises rules; State legislatures have similar committees.
- Courts review rules for violation of the Constitution or the parent Act.

Dangers

- Excessive or vague delegation, including "Henry VIII" clauses that allow the executive to amend the Act itself.
- Weak scrutiny and delays in laying rules.

Conclusion Delegation is necessary, but the legislature must keep policy in its own hands.



DRAW IT: How delegated legislation is kept in check. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "PLAN": Parent Act sets Policy, Laid before House, Audited by committee, Needs judicial check.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call delegated legislation unconstitutional per se; only excessive delegation is struck down.

GS2 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · Public and private administration

PREDICTED · GS2-C1

Q12. "Public administration and private administration are alike in all unimportant respects." Examine this statement and discuss how the gap between the two has changed. (250 words)

Model answer

The remark, usually credited to Wallace Sayre ("Sayre's law"), means the two differ in what matters most. Paul Appleby, in Government Is Different (1945), held that government is distinct because of its public character.

Similarities

- Both need planning, organisation, budgeting and leadership.
- Both use techniques such as management information systems and performance measurement.
- Both face human relations problems.

Differences

- Purpose: The public sector serves public interest; the private sector pursues profit.
- Accountability: Public bodies answer to the legislature, courts, audit and media; private firms answer to owners.
- Political context: Policy emerges from political bargaining and law.
- Rules and secrecy: Strict procedure, uniform treatment and open records under the Right to Information Act.
- Measurement: Profit is a clear test; public value is hard to measure.

The gap today

- Reforms such as outsourcing, public-private partnerships and performance contracts bring business methods into government.
- Citizens now expect service of a quality similar to private providers.
- Private bodies performing public functions are increasingly brought under public law.

Karnataka The Karnataka Guarantee of Services to Citizens Act (Sakala), 2011 sets time limits for services, borrowing the "service level" idea from business.

Conclusion The gap has narrowed in technique, but the ethic of public accountability still sets government apart.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PAP-PM": Purpose, Accountability, Politics, Procedure, Measurement.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit the remark to Simon or Appleby; it is Wallace Sayre's. And do not say government cannot learn from business; the remark only says the similarities are minor.

GS2 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · Second ARC

PREDICTED · GS2-C6

Q13. Discuss the major recommendations of the Second Administrative Reforms Commission and assess their implementation. (150 words)

Model answer

Set up in 2005 under M. Veerappa Moily, the Second ARC submitted 15 reports between 2006 and 2009 on how to make governance more responsive.

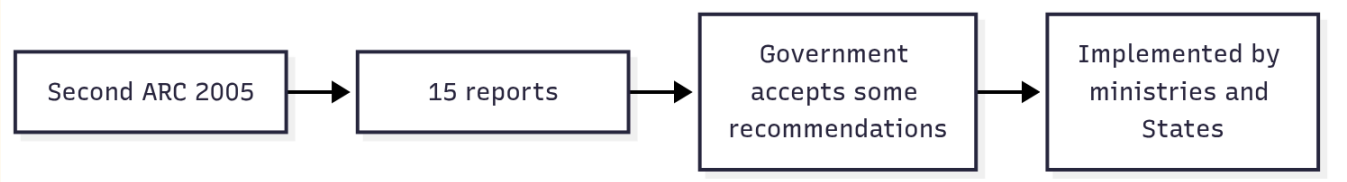
Key recommendations

- Right to Information: "Master Key to Governance" (first report), including proactive disclosure.
- Ethics in governance: Law on ethics, stronger anti-corruption bodies and a code of conduct.
- Local governance and citizen-centricity: Empower local bodies and make citizens' charters meaningful.
- Personnel administration: Performance-linked pay, merit and reform of civil service rules.
- Public order and crisis management: Police reforms and disaster response.
- State and district administration: Strengthen the district as the unit of delivery.

Implementation

- Partial: Lokpal Act, e-governance and capacity-building initiatives followed.
- Many proposals, such as civil service restructuring, lie unimplemented because they need State action.

Conclusion The reports remain a ready menu; the gap lies in political will.



DRAW IT: Second ARC: from report to reform. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "RE-LPP": RTI, Ethics, Local, Personnel, Public order.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix the Second ARC (2005, Moily) with the first ARC (1966, Morarji Desai, later K. Hanumanthaiya).

GS2 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · Jet streams and ENSO

PREDICTED · GS2-A1

Q14. Explain the origin and characteristics of jet streams and their effect on weather. Discuss how El Nino and La Nina influence India's monsoon. (250 words)

Model answer

Jet streams are narrow, fast-moving bands of air at 9-14 km height, flowing from west to east in the upper troposphere, with speeds above 100 km per hour. They arise from the sharp temperature gradient between air masses and the rotation of the Earth.

Main types

- Polar front jet and subtropical westerly jet, wavy streams that bring cyclones and cold waves.
- Tropical easterly jet, which forms over the Indian region in summer and is linked to the strength of the monsoon.

Effects

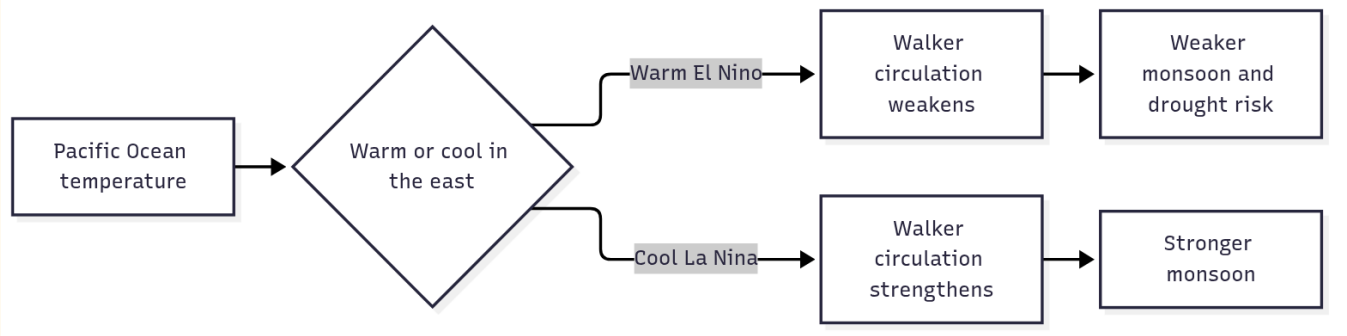
- Steering of temperate cyclones, western disturbances and tropical storms.
- Aircraft route and fuel use.
- The withdrawal of the subtropical jet from the Himalayas in early summer coincides with the "burst" of the monsoon.

El Nino and La Nina

- El Nino is abnormal warming of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific; the Walker circulation weakens, and the monsoon usually becomes weaker, with droughts in many years.
- La Nina is cooling of the same waters, which usually strengthens the monsoon.
- The Indian Ocean Dipole (temperature difference across the ocean): when positive, it may cushion an El Nino year, so forecasts use several indicators.

Karnataka North interior Karnataka, a rain-shadow region, suffers most in weak monsoon years.

Conclusion Upper-air flows and ocean temperatures together set the pace of the monsoon, and so of India's farm economy.



DRAW IT: El Nino and La Nina and the Indian monsoon. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "P-S-T": Polar, Subtropical, Tropical-easterly jets; "El Nino = Empty rain, La Nina = Lots of rain".

COMMON TRAP: Do not state that El Nino always causes drought in India; 1997 saw a normal monsoon despite a strong El Nino, because of a positive Indian Ocean Dipole.

GS2 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · Sources of the Constitution

PREDICTED · GS2-B1

Q15. "The Indian Constitution is a borrowed Constitution." Examine the claim by tracing the sources of its major features. (150 words)

Model answer

The Constituent Assembly first met on 9 December 1946, and the Drafting Committee under B.R. Ambedkar worked from August 1947. The Constitution was adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into force on 26 January 1950. Members from Mysore such as K. Hanumanthaiya took part.

Sources

- Government of India Act, 1935: the federal scheme, Governor, Public Service Commissions and emergency provisions.
- Britain: parliamentary government, rule of law, single citizenship, bicameralism.
- United States: Fundamental Rights, judicial review, independence of the judiciary.
- Ireland: Directive Principles; nomination to the Rajya Sabha.
- Canada: a federation with a strong Centre, residuary powers.
- Australia: Concurrent List.
- Germany (Weimar): suspension of rights in an emergency.
- USSR: Fundamental Duties (added in 1976).
- South Africa: amendment procedure.

Assessment It selected and adapted ideas to Indian conditions, as Ambedkar said.

Conclusion Borrowed pieces, original design.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "BU-ICA-GSS": Britain, US, Ireland, Canada, Australia, Germany, Soviet, South Africa, after the 1935 Act.

COMMON TRAP: Do not credit Fundamental Duties to the original 1950 text; they were added by the 42nd Amendment (1976).

PEAK FACT: Constituent Assembly first met 9 Dec 1946; adopted 26 Nov 1949; in force 26 Jan 1950.

GS2: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Inter-State water disputes.

GS2 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · Inter-State water disputes

PREDICTED · GS2-B3

Q16. Discuss the constitutional and legal framework for the settlement of inter-State water disputes. Illustrate with reference to the disputes involving Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Water is a State subject (Entry 17, List II), but Entry 56, List I allows Parliament to regulate inter-State rivers in the public interest. Article 262 empowers Parliament to provide for the adjudication of inter-State river disputes, and to bar courts from deciding them.

Legal framework

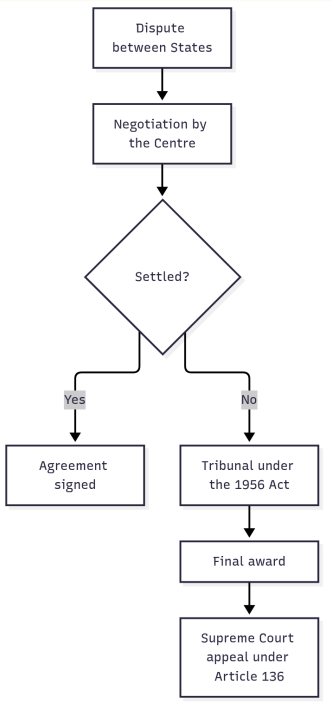
- River Boards Act, 1956: regulation of inter-State rivers (hardly used).
- Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956: the Centre first negotiates, then constitutes a tribunal whose award is binding. Tribunals are time-bound, yet delays are long.
- The Act bars courts from original jurisdiction, but the Supreme Court has heard appeals under Article 136, as in the Cauvery case.

Karnataka's disputes

- Cauvery: The tribunal (1990) gave its final award in 2007. In 2018 the Supreme Court raised Karnataka's share to 284.75 TMC, noting that water is a "national asset". The Cauvery Water Management Authority and Regulation Committee were set up in 2018 to implement the verdict.
- Krishna: The second tribunal's award (2010, further report 2013) allocated shares among Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra, and has been contested by States.
- Mahadayi: The tribunal award of August 2018 gave Karnataka 13.42 TMC (including 5.4 TMC for consumptive use) against Goa's 24 TMC; appeals by all three States are pending in the Supreme Court.

Way forward A permanent tribunal with technical experts, shared data, a distress-sharing formula and better efficiency of water use.

Conclusion Water disputes need a federal, data-driven and cooperative solution.



DRAW IT: Ladder of settling an inter-State water dispute. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "NEP-RIC": Negotiate, Establish tribunal, Pronounce award; remember rivers Cauvery, Krishna, Mahadayi.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Article 262 itself bars the Supreme Court; it lets Parliament exclude courts, yet appeals have reached the Court through Article 136.

GS2 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · 106th Amendment

PREDICTED · GS2-B5 · Current affairs

Q17. The Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023 reserves a third of legislative seats for women. Discuss its main provisions, its significance and the difficulties in implementing it. (150 words)

Model answer

The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, enacted as the 106th Amendment in September 2023, inserts Articles 330A, 332A and 334A.

Provisions

- Women get a third of the seats in the Lok Sabha, the State Assemblies and the Delhi Assembly, including a third within the SC and ST seats.
- It operates after the next Census and delimitation, for 15 years, with seats rotated after each delimitation.
- The Rajya Sabha and Legislative Councils are excluded.

Significance

- Increases women's voice; panchayat evidence shows changes in spending priorities, such as drinking water.
- Raises India's low share of women legislators.

Issues

- Dependence on Census 2027 and delimitation delays operation.
- No sub-quota for OBC women, which many parties demand.
- Rotation may reduce incentive to nurse a constituency.
- Risk of proxy politics.

Conclusion Timely delimitation and capacity-building for women candidates can make the Act effective.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "330A-332A-334A": Lok Sabha, Assembly, Time-line.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that the reservation applies from the 2024 election; it is linked to Census and delimitation, which follows Census 2027.

GS2 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · Leadership theories

PREDICTED · GS2-C4

Q18. Examine the major theories of leadership and explain how they apply to leadership in the public service. (250 words)

Model answer

Leadership is the ability to influence a group to achieve shared goals. In public service it also demands integrity and service.

Theories

- Trait theory: Leaders are born with qualities such as intelligence and confidence. It ignores situations and training.
- Behavioural theories: Style matters. The Ohio State studies stressed "initiating structure" and "consideration"; Blake and Mouton's grid rates concern for production against concern for people.
- Contingency (situational) theories: Fiedler and Hersey-Blanchard say the best style depends on the task, the followers and the leader's position.

- Transformational leadership: James MacGregor Burns and Bernard Bass: leaders inspire followers, raise aspirations and bring change. Transactional leadership relies on rewards and rules.
- Servant leadership: The leader serves the team and community.

Application in public service

- A district officer in a flood needs a directive style; with a long reform programme, a participative and transformational style fits.
- Visible integrity builds trust more than rank.
- Leaders should delegate and develop juniors.

Karnataka example Justice N. Santosh Hegde, Lokayukta of Karnataka (2006-11), led the illegal-mining inquiry; after his report of 27 July 2011 indicted the Chief Minister, the latter resigned on 31 July 2011.

Conclusion No single style works everywhere; good public leaders adapt their style while holding firm to values.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "T-B-C-T-S": Trait, Behaviour, Contingency, Transformational, Servant.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present trait theory as the only view; it is the oldest and most criticised. Do not write "transformational is always better"; crisis may need a directive style.

GS2 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Himalayan and Peninsular rivers

PREDICTED · GS2-A3

Q19. Compare the Himalayan and Peninsular river systems of India in terms of origin, flow, regime and utility. (150 words)

Model answer

India's rivers fall into two systems that differ in history and behaviour.

Himalayan rivers (Indus, Ganga, Brahmaputra)

- Origin: Snow and glaciers, so they are perennial.
- Course: Long courses with deep gorges in the mountains, meanders and floods in the plains, forming large deltas.
- Utility: Irrigation, navigation and hydroelectricity; but frequent floods.

Peninsular rivers (Godavari, Krishna, Cauvery, Narmada, Tapi)

- Origin: The Western Ghats or the plateau, so rain-fed and seasonal.
- Course: Shorter, in older, more stable valleys, with fixed courses. Most flow east to the Bay of Bengal; the Narmada and Tapi flow west through rift valleys.
- Utility: Irrigation and hydroelectric power; storage dams are essential.

Karnataka Rivers rising in the Western Ghats split: the Sharavathi and Netravati race west, while the Krishna, Tungabhadra and Cauvery flow east.

Conclusion Himalayan rivers bring water and floods; peninsular rivers need dams.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Ice vs Rain": Himalayan rivers are Ice-fed, Peninsular rivers are Rain-fed.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call all peninsular rivers east-flowing; the Narmada and Tapi flow west.

GS2 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · Police reforms

PREDICTED · GS2-C2

Q20. Examine the need for police reforms in India in the light of the Prakash Singh case. What is the status of reform? (250 words)

Model answer

Police and public order are State subjects (Entries 1 and 2, List II). The colonial Police Act, 1861 still shapes the structure; Karnataka follows the Karnataka Police Act, 1963.

Need for reform

- Political interference in transfers and investigations.
- Low trust, human rights complaints and custodial deaths.
- Shortage of personnel, poor forensics and burdened investigators.

Reports The National Police Commission (1977-81), the Ribeiro, Padmanabhaiah and Malimath committees, the Second ARC and the Model Police Act, 2006 all recommended change.

Prakash Singh v. Union of India (2006) directives

- State Security Commissions to ensure that the police is free from improper pressure.
- A fair selection of the Director General of Police from a panel prepared by the Union Public Service Commission, with a minimum tenure of two years.
- Minimum tenure for officers in operational posts.
- Separation of investigation from law and order.
- A Police Establishment Board for transfers and postings.
- Police Complaints Authorities at State and district levels.
- A National Security Commission for central forces.

Status Most States have passed laws or orders but diluted the intent; compliance is incomplete. The Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, which replaced the Code of Criminal Procedure from 1 July 2024, changes procedure but not the structure of the force.

Way forward Honest compliance, fixed tenure, forensic capacity and community policing.

Conclusion Police reform is the route to rule of law as well as to legitimacy of the State.

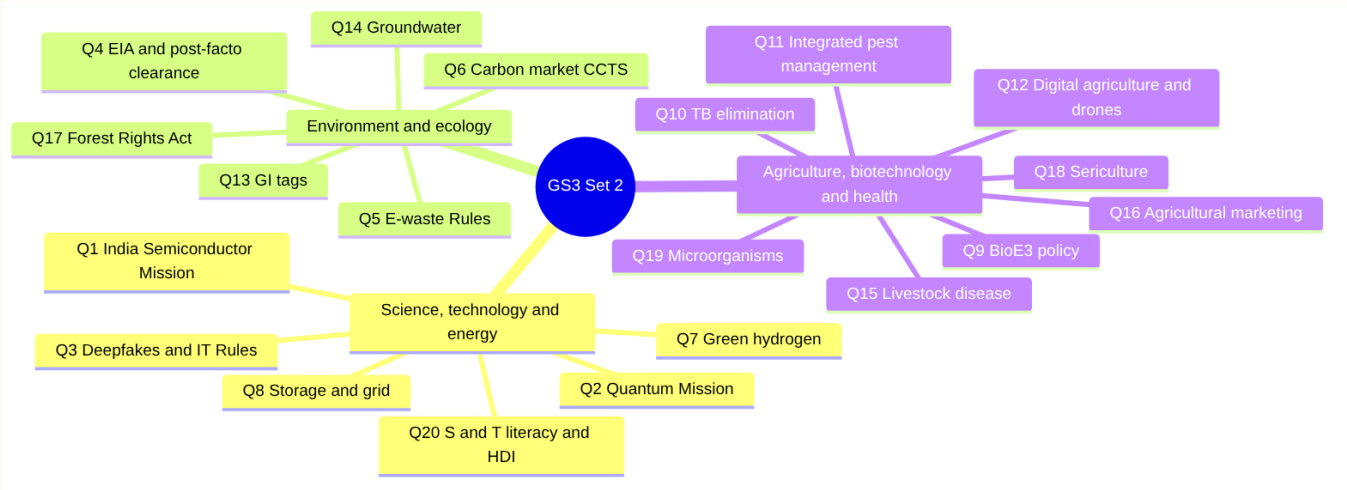
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SS-DG-MT-SI-PEB-PCA-NSC": rhyme: "Safe, Selected, Minimum, Separated, Board, Complaints, National."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Prakash Singh directives are law passed by Parliament; they are Supreme Court directions under Article 142 until legislatures act.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Prakash Singh v UoI 2006: seven directives incl. State Security Commission, DGP tenure, PEB, PCA, NSC.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Inter-State water disputes:** "NEP-RIC": Negotiate, Establish tribunal, Pronounce award; remember rivers Cauvery, Krishna, Mahadayi. **Q17 106th Amendment:** "330A-332A-334A": Lok Sabha, Assembly, Time-line. **Q18 Leadership theories:** "T-B-C-T-S": Trait, Behaviour, Contingency, Transformational, Servant. **Q19 Himalayan and Peninsular rivers:** "Ice vs Rain": Himalayan rivers are Ice-fed, Peninsular rivers are Rain-fed. **Q20 Police reforms:** "SS-DG-MT-SI-PEB-PCA-NSC": rhyme: "Safe, Selected, Minimum, Separated, Board, Complaints, National."

Paper 4: General Studies III (GS3)

Set 2: step 5 of 6 (General Studies III (GS3)). Next up: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** In science, this set tests the new frameworks: semiconductors, quantum, carbon markets and hydrogen. Link each scheme to its figures, one risk and a Karnataka line, and draw the small flow charts.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS3 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · India Semiconductor Mission

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q1. India is building a semiconductor ecosystem through the India Semiconductor Mission. Explain its objectives, progress so far, and the main constraints. (150 words)

Model answer

Semiconductors power phones, vehicles, defence systems and data centres, so supply security is strategic. The India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) began in December 2021 with Rs 76,000 crore for fabs, packaging and design.

Progress

- By 2026, twelve manufacturing projects had been approved across six States, with committed investment above Rs 1.64 lakh crore; five facilities had begun commercial production.
- The mix covers one silicon fab, compound-semiconductor fabs and several packaging (ATMP/OSAT) units.
- In July 2026 the Cabinet approved ISM 2.0 with about Rs 1.275 lakh crore over six years, widening support to design, equipment, materials and talent.
- Karnataka's Economic Survey notes support for semiconductor design.

Constraints

- Fabs need ultra-pure water, stable power and suppliers.
- Equipment and know-how remain import-dependent.
- Process engineers are scarce.

Conclusion Design, packaging and a skilled workforce should lead, with fabs added step by step.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Fab, Package, Design": the three doors into the chip chain.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call ISM a single factory scheme; it covers fabs, packaging, design and talent. Quote only figures you can tie to an official source.

GS3 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · Quantum Mission

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q2. Quantum technologies are expected to transform computing, communication and sensing. Discuss the National Quantum Mission and Karnataka's quantum roadmap, and examine the challenges before India. (250 words)

Model answer

Quantum technology uses superposition and entanglement to build computers, secure communication and ultra-precise sensors. The Union Cabinet approved the National Quantum Mission (NQM) on 19 April 2023 with an outlay of Rs 6,003.65 crore for 2023-24 to 2030-31.

National Quantum Mission

- Four thematic hubs: quantum computing at IISc Bengaluru; quantum communication at IIT Madras with C-DOT; quantum sensing and metrology at IIT Bombay; quantum materials and devices at IIT Delhi.
- Targets include intermediate-scale quantum computers of 50 to 1,000 qubits and secure satellite-based links over long distances.

Karnataka's roadmap

- The Karnataka Quantum Roadmap, unveiled at the Quantum India Summit in Bengaluru, seeks a USD 20 billion contribution to the State economy by 2035.
- It rests on five pillars: talent, research and development, infrastructure, industry enablement and global partnerships.
- Planned actions include a Karnataka Quantum Mission and Policy, a Quantum Hardware Park, and Quantum Innovation Zones.
- Goals: over 10,000 jobs, 100+ startups and 150+ patents.

Challenges

- Fragile hardware: qubits need extreme cooling and isolation.
- Dependence on imported components such as cryogenic equipment and specialised lasers.
- Thin talent pool in quantum engineering.
- Risk that quantum computers will break present encryption, calling for post-quantum cryptography.

Way forward

- Build indigenous hardware supply chains and link start-ups with defence and health pilots.
- Align the State mission with the national hubs to avoid duplication.

Conclusion Bengaluru's research base gives India an edge, but quantum success will depend on hardware depth and patient funding.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "4 Hubs, 5 Pillars": four national hubs, five Karnataka pillars.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse quantum computing with classical supercomputing; speed-ups apply only to certain problems. Do not give outlay figures from memory without the year range.

GS3 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · Deepfakes and IT Rules

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q3. Deepfakes and other synthetic media threaten privacy, elections and public trust. Examine the regulatory response in India under the 2026 amendment to the IT Rules and the limits of that response. (150 words)

Model answer

A deepfake is audio, video or an image made or altered by artificial intelligence to look real. It enables fraud, harassment and political deception cheaply.

Regulatory response

- The IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Amendment Rules, 2026, notified on 10 February 2026 and in force from 20 February 2026, cover "synthetically generated information".
- Intermediaries must prevent unlawful synthetic content such as deceptive impersonation, non-consensual intimate imagery and false documents.
- Lawful synthetic content must carry a visible label and permanent metadata, which cannot be removed.

Limits

- Detection lags behind generation.
- Cross-border platforms and encrypted channels are hard to police.
- Over-removal may chill satire; limits must satisfy Article 19(2).

Way forward

- Detection research, media literacy and quick complaint redress.

Conclusion Labelling helps, but trust also depends on literacy and swift remedy.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Label, Trace, Take down": three duties on platforms.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say deepfakes are banned outright; lawful, labelled synthetic content is permitted. Do not skip the free-speech balance.

GS3 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · EIA and post-facto clearance

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q4. Environmental clearance is the main legal gate for projects that may harm the environment. Explain the Environmental Impact Assessment process in India, its weaknesses, and recent legal developments on post-facto clearances. (250 words)

Model answer

Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) is a study of the likely effects of a project, done before it begins, so that harm can be avoided or reduced. In India it is governed by the EIA Notification, 2006, issued under the parent law of 1986.

Process

- Screening: projects are placed in Category A (Centre) or Category B (State), the latter handled by the State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA).
- Scoping: the expert committee fixes terms of reference.
- Public consultation: a public hearing near the site, followed by the final report.

- Appraisal and decision: the expert appraisal committee recommends; the authority grants or refuses clearance, with conditions.

Karnataka

- The Economic Survey notes that a quarry lease on Government land requires clearance from the SEIAA, and that obtaining clearances within the stipulated time is a challenge.

Weaknesses

- Reports prepared by consultants hired by project proponents.
- Hearings with poor notice or participation.
- Weak post-clearance monitoring and cumulative impacts ignored.

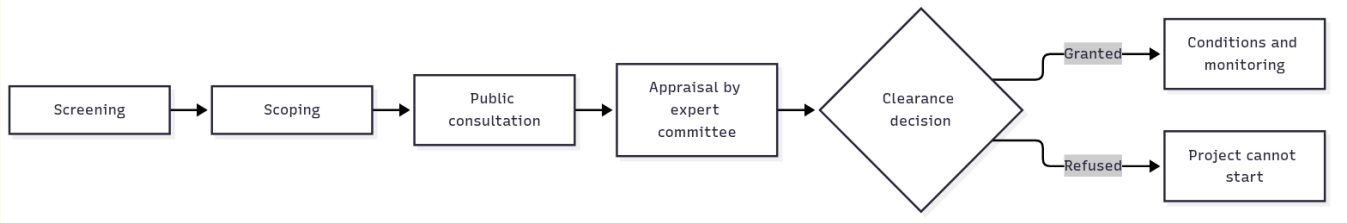
Legal developments

- In May 2025 the Supreme Court in Vanashakti struck down the provisions allowing post-facto clearance.
- On 18 November 2025 a three-judge bench recalled that judgment by a 2:1 majority and sent the matter for fresh consideration.

Way forward

- Independent, accredited consultants, digital disclosure in local languages, strict monitoring and penalties for violation.

Conclusion The clearance should be a real test before work begins, not a formality after it.



DRAW IT: Steps of Environmental Impact Assessment. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "S-S-P-A": Screen, Scope, Public hearing, Appraise.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say EIA bans projects; it is an informed-decision tool. Do not state that post-facto clearance is now barred; the 2025 judgment was recalled in November 2025.

GS3 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · E-waste Rules

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q5. Electronic waste is among the fastest-growing waste streams. Explain the main features of the E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022 and the challenges in implementing them. (150 words)

Model answer

E-waste is discarded electronic equipment such as computers, mobiles and batteries. It holds lead and mercury, but also recoverable gold and copper.

Main features

- Notified on 2 November 2022 and in force from 1 April 2023, replacing the 2016 rules.
- Built on Extended Producer Responsibility: manufacturers, producers, refurbishers and recyclers register on the CPCB portal.
- Dealing with unregistered entities is prohibited.

- Producers must meet recycling targets.

Challenges

- Most e-waste is handled by the informal sector, which uses acid leaching and open burning.
- Consumers do not know take-back channels.
- Weak tracking of certificates.
- Bengaluru, with its large IT base, needs strong take-back and refurbishing capacity.

Way forward

- Link informal collectors to authorised recyclers, set up easy drop points and promote repair and refurbishment.

Conclusion A circular approach turns e-waste into a resource, but only if the informal sector is part of the system.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Register, Recover, Report": the three things every EPR entity must do.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe e-waste only as a pollution problem; it is also a resource and livelihood question.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** E-Waste (Management) Rules 2022 notified 2 November 2022, in force 1 April 2023, replacing the 2016 rules.

GS3: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Carbon market CCTS.

GS3 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · Carbon market CCTS

PREDICTED · GS3-C5

Q6. Carbon markets are being promoted as tools to cut emissions at lower cost. Explain the Carbon Credit Trading Scheme of India and examine its prospects and risks. (250 words)

Model answer

A carbon market puts a price on emissions by letting entities trade credits. India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS), set up under the Energy Conservation Act as amended in 2022, creates a compliance market and an offset mechanism.

Working

- The Bureau of Energy Efficiency sets greenhouse-gas intensity targets for obligated sectors; units that beat the target earn Carbon Credit Certificates, and those that fall short must buy or surrender them.
- By October 2026 compliance obligations applied to seven sectors: aluminium, cement, chlor-alkali, pulp and paper, petroleum refining, petrochemicals and textiles, covering about 490 entities, with FY 2023-24 as the baseline.
- Iron and steel was still at the draft stage, and certificates are issued only after verified performance against the 2023-24 baseline.

Prospects

- Rewards efficiency, so cuts happen where they are cheapest.
- Supports India's 2070 net-zero goal and helps exporters facing carbon border taxes such as the EU mechanism.
- Raises finance for clean technology.

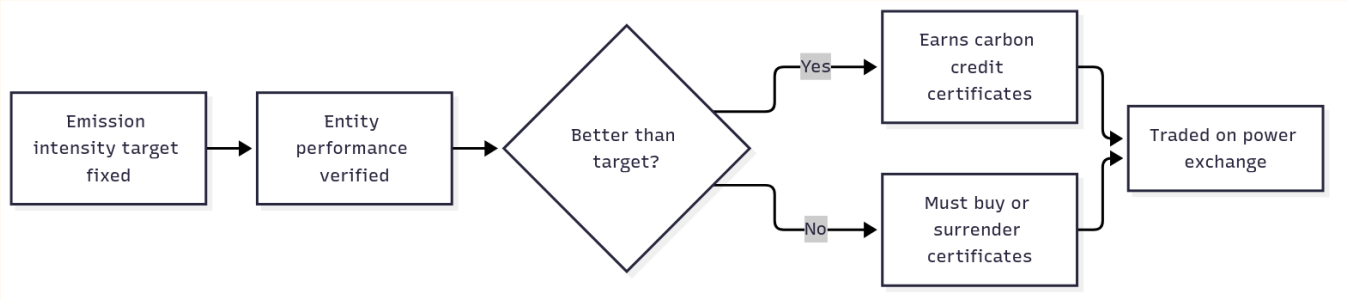
Risks

- Intensity targets, unlike absolute caps, can let total emissions rise with output.
- Weak monitoring and verification can create hollow credits.
- Price volatility and market manipulation.
- Small firms may face high compliance costs.

Way forward

- Build verification capacity, widen coverage in phases and move towards absolute caps.
- Link with Article 6 of the Paris Agreement carefully, avoiding double counting.

Conclusion A well-governed market can cut emissions at lower cost, but credibility rests on measurement.



DRAW IT: How CCTS works. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Target, Trade, Track": set the intensity target, trade the surplus, track by verification.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the scheme a carbon tax; it is a trading system. Do not claim that certificates have already been traded at scale; check the latest status first.

GS3 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · Green hydrogen

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q7. Green hydrogen is seen as a fuel for industries that are hard to electrify. Discuss the National Green Hydrogen Mission, its prospects and challenges. (150 words)

Model answer

Green hydrogen is made by splitting water with renewable electricity. It can replace fossil hydrogen in fertiliser and refining and can decarbonise steel and heavy transport.

The Mission

- Approved in January 2023 with an initial outlay of Rs 19,744 crore up to 2029-30, including Rs 17,490 crore for the SIGHT incentive scheme.
- Targets at least 5 million tonnes a year by 2030, with about 125 GW of added renewable capacity.
- In October 2025 Kandla, Tuticorin and Paradip were recognised as green hydrogen hubs.

Prospects

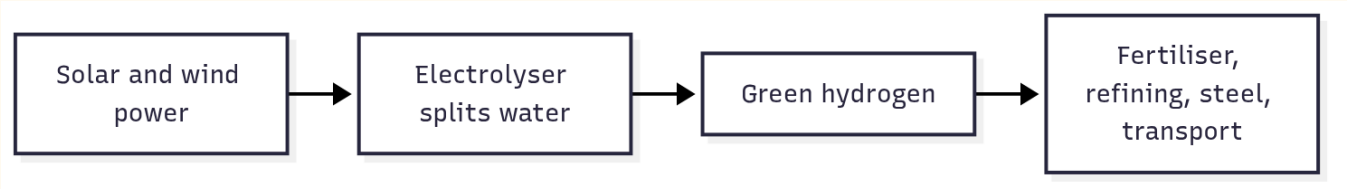
- Lower oil and ammonia imports, export potential and new jobs.
- Karnataka's Clean Mobility Policy refers to hydrogen technologies alongside batteries.

Challenges

- High cost of electrolysers and renewable power.
- Storage, transport and safety standards.

- Water needs and offtake certainty.

Conclusion Green hydrogen should first serve industries that cannot electrify, with costs falling through scale.



DRAW IT: Green hydrogen chain. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Split, Store, Substitute": split water, store the gas, substitute grey hydrogen.

COMMON TRAP: Green hydrogen is not "hydrogen from any source"; the colour depends on the energy used. Do not call it a fuel that is already cheap.

GS3 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · Storage and grid

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q8. Renewable energy needs storage and a strong grid to be reliable. Discuss why energy storage and grid integration matter for India's energy transition, taking Karnataka as an illustration. (250 words)

Model answer

Solar and wind generate when nature allows, not when demand peaks. Without storage, surplus midday solar is wasted and evening demand is met by coal or gas. Storage and grid upgrades turn variable power into dependable supply.

Storage options

- Pumped storage: uses surplus electricity to lift water to a reservoir and releases it at peak; suited to hilly States such as Karnataka.
- Battery energy storage systems (BESS): fast response, falling costs.
- The Ministry of Power launched in June 2025 a viability-gap scheme for 30 GWh of BESS with Rs 5,400 crore, after an earlier scheme for 4,000 MWh with Rs 3,760 crore.

Grid integration

- Green energy corridors evacuate renewable power to demand centres.
- Better forecasting, flexible thermal plants and time-of-day tariffs smooth demand.
- Karnataka's Economic Survey records that battery systems are being implemented to store energy during renewable periods and use it in non-renewable periods, and that the Green Energy Corridor is being implemented with KPTCL and MNRE.

Challenges

- High upfront cost and supply chains for cells.
- Land, forest and ecological issues for pumped storage.
- Transmission delays, and market rules that do not yet reward flexibility.

Way forward

- Co-locate storage with solar parks, support domestic cell manufacturing and reform tariffs to pay for peak and flexibility.

Conclusion Storage and grids are the missing half of the energy transition.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Store, Send, Smooth": store it, send it through corridors, smooth the demand.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say batteries alone can solve intermittency; pumped storage, grids and demand management are also needed. Do not confuse VGF (capital support) with a tariff subsidy.

GS3 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · BioE3 policy

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q9. The BioE3 Policy seeks to promote high-performance biomanufacturing. Explain its aims and examine how Karnataka can benefit. (150 words)

Model answer

Biomanufacturing uses living cells, enzymes and fermentation to make chemicals, foods, materials and medicines in place of petrochemical routes. The Union Cabinet approved the BioE3 Policy (Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment) on 24 August 2024.

Aims

- Support six areas: bio-based chemicals and enzymes, functional foods and smart proteins, precision biotherapeutics, climate-resilient agriculture, carbon capture, and marine and space research.
- Create shared infrastructure through biomanufacturing hubs, biofoundries and Bio-AI hubs for scale-up.
- Link growth with sustainability and jobs.

Karnataka

- The Economic Survey names biotechnology among the State's high-technology strengths, and Bengaluru hosts leading institutions and start-ups, which can use shared pilot facilities.

Challenges

- Scale-up funding, skilled workforce, biosafety rules and demand for bio-based products.

Conclusion BioE3 can turn laboratory strength into industry, if pilot facilities and regulation move together.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "3 E's": Economy, Environment, Employment.

COMMON TRAP: BioE3 is not only a health policy; it covers materials, food, agriculture and climate. Do not list sectors you cannot recall.

GS3 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · TB elimination

PREDICTED · GS3-B7

Q10. Tuberculosis remains a major public health challenge. Discuss India's programme for TB elimination and the progress and gaps in Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Tuberculosis (TB) is a bacterial disease, mostly of the lungs, spread through the air. India accounts for roughly a quarter of the world's cases. The World Health Organization's Global TB Report 2025 estimates that India's incidence fell 21 per cent between 2015 and 2024, from 237 to 187 per lakh population, almost double the global fall of 12 per cent.

National programme

- The National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP) runs under the National Health Mission, with the aim of a TB-free India by 2025, ahead of the WHO target of 2030; the 2025 date was not met.
- Main tools: free diagnosis and treatment, notification of private cases, Nikshay Poshan Yojana cash support, community "Nikshay Mitra" volunteers and a 100-day campaign in high-burden districts.

Karnataka

- 1,464 of 5,690 Gram Panchayats have been declared TB-free.
- Between January and December 2025, 74,616 patients were notified against a target of 80,000, which is 93 per cent.
- The cohort recorded a mortality of 6 per cent and a treatment success rate of 88 per cent.

Gaps

- Under-notification from the private sector, late diagnosis and drug-resistant TB.
- Malnutrition, diabetes and tobacco, which raise risk.
- Stigma and treatment dropout among migrant workers.

Way forward

- Active case finding with molecular tests, nutrition support, shorter regimens and private-sector engagement.
- Gram Panchayat ownership of the TB-free tag.

Conclusion Falling incidence is encouraging; elimination needs nutrition and social support alongside medicine.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Find, Treat, Feed": find the case, treat fully, feed the patient.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say India has eliminated TB or claim 2025 was achieved; the target date was missed. Quote Karnataka numbers with their period.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** WHO Global TB Report 2025: India incidence fell 21 per cent from 2015 to 2024 (237 to 187 per lakh), global fall 12 per cent (PIB, WHO).

GS3: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Integrated pest management.

GS3 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Integrated pest management

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q11. Integrated Pest Management is promoted as an alternative to routine chemical spraying. Explain its principles and challenges, with an example of an invasive pest in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Integrated Pest Management (IPM) combines methods to keep pests below the level that causes economic loss, using chemicals only as the last resort. It protects farmers' health, natural enemies of pests and soil life.

Principles

- Prevention: resistant varieties, crop rotation, clean seed and timely sowing.
- Monitoring: field scouting, pheromone traps and economic threshold levels.
- Biological control: parasitoids such as Trichogramma, neem products and bio-pesticides.

- Mechanical and chemical: hand-picking, light traps; selective pesticides only when thresholds are crossed.

Karnataka example

- The fall armyworm was first detected in India on 18 May 2018 in maize fields at Shivamogga. The response combined seed treatment, pheromone traps, neem sprays and targeted pesticides.

Challenges

- Farmers' habit of calendar spraying, weak extension, and costly bio-agents.
- Pesticide residues affecting exports.

Conclusion IPM works when training, local bio-agent supply and surveillance reach the farmer together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "P-M-B-C": Prevent, Monitor, Biocontrol, Chemical last.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** IPM does not mean "no pesticide"; it means pesticide only when thresholds are crossed. Do not equate it with organic farming.

GS3 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · Digital agriculture and drones

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q12. Digital tools and drones are changing farm practice. Discuss the role of digital agriculture and precision farming in India, and the obstacles to their wider adoption by small farmers. (250 words)

Model answer

Digital agriculture uses data, satellites, sensors, drones and mobile platforms to help farmers decide what, when and how much to apply. Precision farming applies inputs at the right place and time, reducing waste and cost.

Initiatives

- The Digital Agriculture Mission, approved on 2 September 2024 with Rs 2,817 crore, builds AgriStack (farmer registry, village maps and crop-sown registry) and a Krishi Decision Support System that combines satellite, weather and soil data.
- Drone Rules, 2021 liberalised drone use; the Namo Drone Didi scheme gives women's self-help groups a subsidy of 80 per cent, up to Rs 8 lakh per drone, for spraying services.
- Karnataka's FRUITS platform has registered over 102.95 lakh farmers; 84.40 lakh unique beneficiaries received Rs 39,596.98 crore in assistance, and over 5,500 PACS use it.

Benefits

- Targeted spraying reduces chemical use and labour.
- Faster, direct benefit transfers and crop insurance claims.
- Timely advisories on weather and pests.

Obstacles

- Small and fragmented holdings make machines uneconomic.
- Digital literacy, patchy connectivity and language barriers.
- Data privacy and risk that tenant farmers are excluded when records favour land owners.
- Cost of drones and regulatory clearances.

Way forward

- Custom-hiring centres, farmer producer organisations and women's groups as service providers.
- Advisories in Kannada by voice; consent-based data sharing and tenant inclusion.

Conclusion Technology helps small farmers only when it is shared, local and trusted.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Record, Read, Respond, Reach": record the farmer, read the data, respond with advice, reach the last farmer.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present drones as a replacement for extension workers. Do not ignore tenant farmers and data privacy.

GS3 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · GI tags

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q13. Geographical Indications protect products linked to a place and its community. Explain the legal framework in India and discuss how GI tags can support livelihoods, with examples from Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

A Geographical Indication (GI) identifies goods whose quality or reputation arises from their place of origin, such as Mysore silk or Channapatna toys. It is protected under the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, in force from 2003, and TRIPS.

Features

- Collective right of producers, not of an individual; registration is administered in Chennai.
- Different from a patent (an invention) and a trademark (a brand name); the GI Registry is in Chennai.
- Unauthorised use is punishable.

Livelihood value

- Premium prices and export marketing; Karnataka had 46 registered GIs by March 2025.
- The State's Farmer Producer Organisations for off-farm products focus on GI items such as Channapatna toys, Kasuti and Kolhapuri chappals.
- Kempegowda International Airport hosts a "Karnataka" pavilion for GI-tagged products.

Challenges

- Counterfeits, low awareness and weak producer organisations.

Conclusion A GI is useful only if producers organise, maintain quality and market the tag.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Place + Quality + Community": the GI formula.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** A GI is not a patent and protects a name, not a method. Do not claim a GI belongs to one firm.

GS3 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · Groundwater

PREDICTED · GS3-C2

Q14. Groundwater is the backbone of Indian irrigation and drinking water, yet it is stressed in many regions. Examine the state of groundwater in Karnataka and evaluate the Atal Bhujal Yojana and other measures. (250 words)

Model answer

Groundwater supplies most of India's irrigation and drinking water. Because it is invisible and unpriced, it is over-drawn, especially where electricity for pumping is free or cheap and rainfall is erratic.

State of groundwater in Karnataka

- The 2025 assessment of the Central Ground Water Board puts the stage of extraction at 66.49 per cent, with 11.58 billion cubic metres drawn against 17.41 available.
- Of 237 assessment units, 45 taluks are over-exploited, 11 critical, 36 semi-critical and 145 safe.
- Over-exploited districts include Kolar, Chikkaballapura, Chitradurga and Bengaluru Urban and Rural, where borewells have gone ever deeper.

Atal Bhujal Yojana

- A central scheme with World Bank support that rewards communities for results, with Rs 6,000 crore for seven States; in Karnataka it covers 1,199 water-stressed Gram Panchayats in 41 taluks of 14 districts from 2020-21 to 2025-26.
- Its incentive component allocation is Rs 1,034.22 crore, of which Rs 786.81 crore has been released.

Other measures

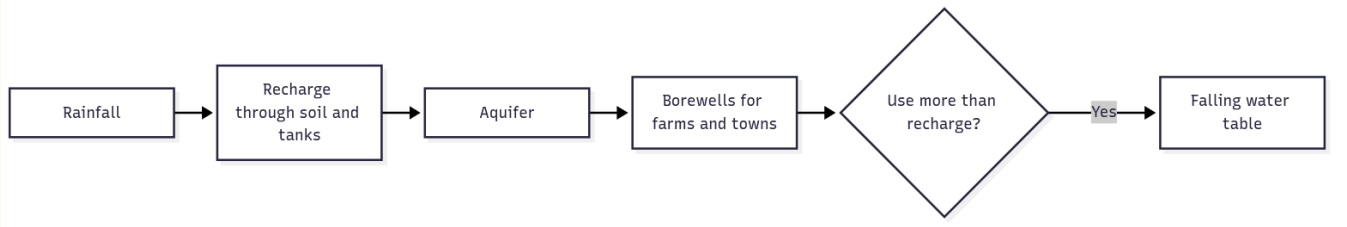
- Tank filling with treated water in Kolar and Chikkaballapura, recharge structures and watershed work.
- Regulation of borewell drilling and groundwater extraction.

Assessment Community water budgets are a strong feature, but over-extraction continues where crops and power subsidies encourage it.

Way forward

- Aquifer mapping, crop diversification and metering of agricultural pumps.
- Treated-water reuse and recharge.

Conclusion Groundwater must be managed by communities as a shared stock.



DRAW IT: Groundwater: use and recharge. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Map, Budget, Recharge, Reuse": four steps of aquifer management.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not use "over-exploited" for the whole State; most units are safe. Quote the assessment year and unit.

GS3 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · Livestock disease

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Livestock diseases cause large losses to farmers. Discuss the measures against livestock diseases in India, with the example of lumpy skin disease and vaccination in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Livestock gives income to small and landless households and is vital for dairy. Diseases cut milk yield, kill animals and restrict trade.

Disease control in India

- The National Animal Disease Control Programme, launched in 2019, aims at mass vaccination against foot-and-mouth disease and brucellosis.
- The Centre also supports States through the Assistance to States for Control of Animal Diseases (ASCAD) scheme.
- Lumpy skin disease, a viral infection spread by biting insects, spread across many States in 2022, reducing milk yield and killing cattle.

Karnataka

- Under ASCAD, up to December 2025, 81,66,756 cattle were vaccinated against lumpy skin disease, and 47,09,784 cattle, buffalo, sheep and goats against haemorrhagic septicaemia.

Gaps

- Cold-chain breaks, shortage of veterinarians, unreported outbreaks and poor compensation.

Way forward

- Regular vaccination calendars, insect control, disease surveillance and insurance for livestock owners.

Conclusion Vaccination should become routine, supported by the village veterinary network.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Vaccinate, Vector, Vet": the three levers of animal health.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Lumpy skin disease is a viral disease of cattle; it is not transmitted to humans through milk. Do not quote vaccination numbers without their period.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Karnataka ASCAD: 81,66,756 cattle vaccinated for lumpy skin disease and 47,09,784 for haemorrhagic septicaemia up to December 2025.

GS3: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Agricultural marketing.

GS3 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · Agricultural marketing

PREDICTED · GS3-B6

Q16. Reforms in agricultural marketing have been contested. Discuss the evolution of APMC regulation and the e-NAM platform, and examine Karnataka's experience with the 2020 and 2023 amendments. (250 words)

Model answer

Agricultural Produce Market Committees (APMCs) were created by State laws to protect farmers from exploitation by trading in regulated yards with open auction. Over time, they developed their own faults: licensing barriers for traders, commission agents' cartels, market fees and weak competition.

Reform path

- The Model APMC Act of 2003 and later model laws encouraged private markets and direct purchase.
- e-NAM, launched in 2016, links mandis on an electronic platform; by 30 June 2026 it had 1,656 mandis in 23 States and 4 Union Territories, with 1.89 crore farmers and 2.78 lakh traders registered.
- The three farm laws of 2020, which sought trade outside APMC yards, were repealed in 2021 after protests.

Karnataka

- In 2020 the State amended its APMC law to allow notified produce to be traded outside the yards.
- The Karnataka APMC (Amendment) Act, 2023 repealed this and restored the requirement of trade in yards with penalties for evasion; it was notified in March 2024.

Assessment

- Reforms widened choice, but critics feared weaker mandis and the loss of price assurance for farmers.
- e-NAM improves price discovery, but poor assaying, thin buyers and transport costs hold back inter-State trade.

Way forward

- Strengthen mandis, warehouses and grading; link e-NAM with warehouse receipts and farmer producer organisations; legal assurance for fair price at the farm gate.

Conclusion Markets work for farmers when competition is open and mandis remain accountable.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Yard, Online, Outside": three ways to sell: yard mandi, e-NAM online, outside the yard.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say APMC mandis were abolished in Karnataka; the 2023 Act restored the yard requirement. Do not equate e-NAM with an MSP guarantee.

GS3 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · Forest Rights Act

PREDICTED · GS3-C6

Q17. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 tries to balance forest conservation with the rights of forest-dwelling communities. Explain its provisions and evaluate its implementation in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Forest-dwelling communities lived in forests for generations, but colonial laws treated them as encroachers. The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 seeks to correct this historical injustice.

Provisions

- Individual rights over land under occupation and community rights over minor forest produce, grazing and water bodies.
- Gram Sabha initiates claims and a committee process decides them.
- Duty of communities to protect wildlife and forests.

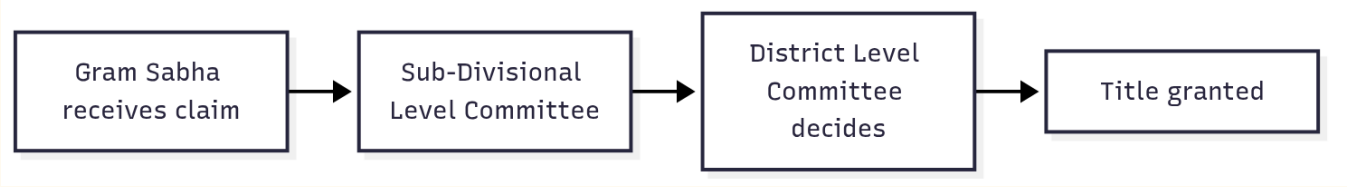
Karnataka

- As of December 2025, 2.95 lakh applications had been received, 16,700 title deeds distributed, 16,043 remain under consideration, and 2.62 lakh were rejected: close to nine in ten.
- In 2011 the Soliga gram sabhas of the BRT Tiger Reserve received community forest rights.

Evaluation

- High rejection, poor evidence rules and weak Gram Sabha role.

Conclusion Review of rejected claims and community rights can reconcile conservation and livelihood.



DRAW IT: Forest rights claim. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Claim, Verify, Title": three steps of the FRA process.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Act permits unlimited forest clearing; rights come with a duty to conserve. Quote the rejection numbers with their date.

GS3 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · Sericulture

PREDICTED · GS3-B3 · Karnataka-specific

Q18. Karnataka is India's leading producer of mulberry silk. Discuss the strengths of the State's sericulture sector, the recent initiatives to improve marketing, and the challenges before it. (250 words)

Model answer

Sericulture is rearing of silkworms and production of silk, a rural labour-intensive activity combining mulberry cultivation, rearing, reeling and weaving. Karnataka is the largest producer of mulberry raw silk in India.

Strengths

- Mulberry silk production reached 13,276.64 tonnes in 2024-25 on 1,22,939 hectares; by official data this is about 43 per cent of the national mulberry raw silk output.
- The Central Silk Board is in Bengaluru; Ramanagara and Shidlaghatta are major cocoon markets, and Mysuru is famed for silk sarees.
- Support included Rs 5,740.28 lakh for sericulturists and Rs 602.05 lakh for reelers.

Initiatives for marketing

- In 2025-26 the State promoted 120-end automatic silk reeling units.
- Phase I of the Hi-Tech Silk Markets at Ramanagara and Shidlaghatta was completed; Phase II is estimated at Rs 250 crore; a new cocoon market at Mysuru with NABARD support is under development.
- These improve quality testing, grading and price discovery.

Challenges

- Competition from imported Chinese silk and from cheaper synthetic fibres.
- Disease in silkworms, price volatility and competition from horticulture in the south.
- Drudgery and ageing rearers.

Way forward

- Bivoltine seed promotion, quality certification and a Silk Mark, rearer cooperatives, and weaving and design links with the GI Mysore silk brand.

Conclusion Better markets and quality can secure Karnataka's lead in silk.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Mulberry, Rear, Reel, Weave": the four rungs of the silk ladder.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Karnataka produces most of all silk; it leads in mulberry silk, and non-mulberry silks come from other States.

GS3 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Microorganisms

PREDICTED · GS3-B1

Q19. Microorganisms are small but central to agriculture and the environment. Explain their roles in soil fertility and waste management, with examples. (150 words)

Model answer

Microorganisms such as bacteria, fungi, algae and viruses recycle nutrients and sustain soil life. Many are used as low-cost inputs.

Soil fertility

- Rhizobium fixes nitrogen in the root nodules of pulses; Azotobacter and Azospirillum fix nitrogen in the soil.
- Phosphate-solubilising bacteria and mycorrhizal fungi make phosphorus available.
- Blue-green algae and Azolla enrich paddy fields.

Waste management

- Composting uses bacteria and fungi to convert farm and kitchen waste to manure; vermicomposting adds earthworms.
- Sewage treatment uses microbes to reduce biochemical oxygen demand.
- Biogas plants rely on methane-producing bacteria.

Karnataka

- The Organic Carbon Mission, under way since 2021-22, aims to raise soil organic carbon through green manure and related practices.

Cautions

- Quality of bio-fertilisers, short shelf life and farmers' limited awareness.

Conclusion Microbial inputs reduce dependence on chemical fertiliser, if quality is assured.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "N-P-C": Nitrogen fixers, Phosphate solubilisers, Compost makers.

COMMON TRAP: Bio-fertilisers are living cultures, not chemicals; they lose potency with heat and age. Do not say they fully replace chemical fertilisers.

GS3 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · S and T literacy and HDI

PREDICTED · GS3-A5

Q20. India's Human Development Index rank has improved, but the country still faces gaps in science and technology literacy. Discuss the link between human development, scientific temper and S&T literacy, and suggest measures. (250 words)

Model answer

Human development is the widening of people's choices through health, education and income. Scientific temper, a duty under Article 51A(h) of the Constitution, is the habit of asking for evidence, and science and technology (S&T) literacy is the ability to understand and use scientific information in daily life.

Status

- India's Human Development Index (HDI) value was 0.685 in 2023, ranking 130 among 193 countries in the 2025 Human Development Report, up three places; it is in the medium category.
- Gains in life expectancy and schooling are visible, but inequality and gender gaps persist.

Link

- Literate citizens use health, farm and digital services better and are less likely to believe rumours and quackery.
- Scientific temper supports rational public debate on vaccines, climate and artificial intelligence.
- S&T human resources drive innovation and productivity.

Gaps

- Weak learning outcomes in science and mathematics.
- Superstition, misinformation and unequal access to laboratories and teachers in rural areas.
- Low research spending.

Measures

- Activity-based teaching, school laboratories and tinkering spaces.
- Science museums and planetariums, such as the Visvesvaraya Industrial and Technological Museum and the Jawaharlal Nehru Planetarium in Bengaluru, reaching rural children with mobile units.
- Science communication in Kannada, media literacy and support for women in science.

Conclusion Human development rises when science becomes habit as well as syllabus.

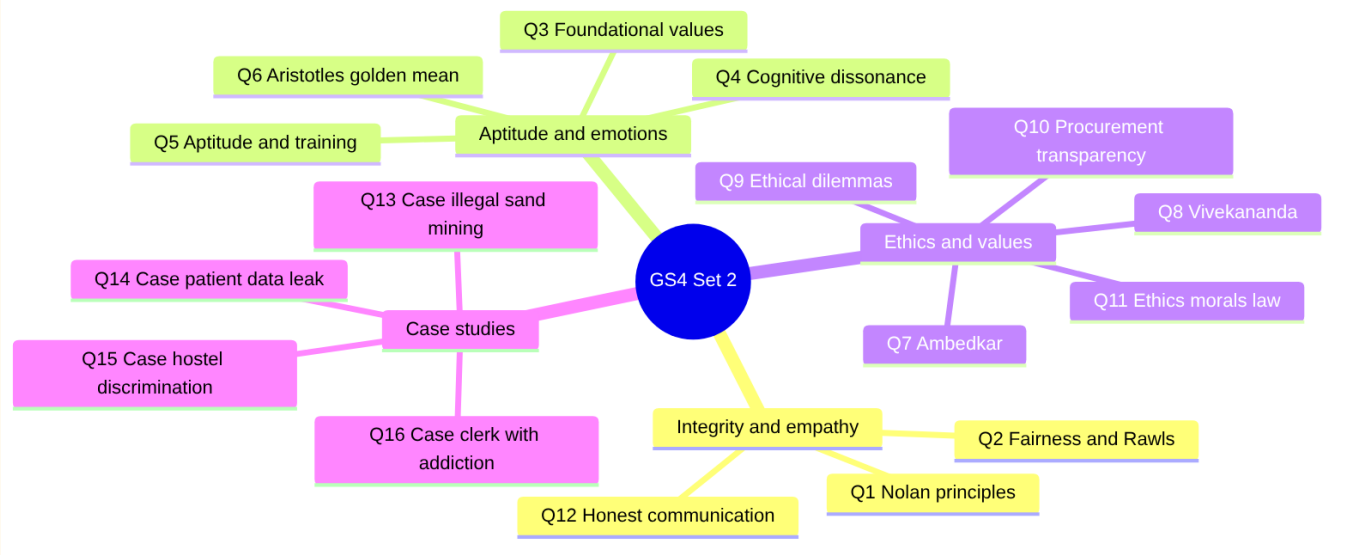
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Think, Test, Trust": think questions, test with evidence, trust verified results.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Scientific temper is not the same as science education or technology use; it is an attitude of questioning. Do not call the HDI a measure of income alone.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** HDI 0.685 in 2023, rank 130 of 193, up from 133 (UNDP HDR 2025).
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Agricultural marketing:** "Yard, Online, Outside": three ways to sell: yard mandi, e-NAM online, outside the yard. **Q17 Forest Rights Act:** "Claim, Verify, Title": three steps of the FRA process. **Q18 Sericulture:** "Mulberry, Rear, Reel, Weave": the four rungs of the silk ladder. **Q19 Microorganisms:** "N-P-C": Nitrogen fixers, Phosphate solubilisers, Compost makers. **Q20 S and T literacy and HDI:** "Think, Test, Trust": think questions, test with evidence, trust verified results.

Paper 5: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Set 2: step 6 of 6 (General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)). Next up: Kannada and English practice

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 16 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** This set's ethics paper is heavy on integrity and attitude. In cases, protect the weak first, then follow the law, then fix the system; and do not blame only the lowest officer.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS4 Q1 of 16 · 20 marks · Nolan principles

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q1. The seven standards set out by the Nolan Committee in the United Kingdom are widely used as a benchmark for holders of public office. Examine their relevance for Indian civil servants, illustrating each with a situation from administration. (300 words)

Model answer

Introduction. A British committee under Lord Nolan listed seven principles in 1995. They were not written for India, but the Second ARC's report on ethics (2007) builds on similar ideas. Their value lies in being short and testable.

The seven principles and their Indian meaning.

1. Selflessness: decisions serve only the public interest. A Tahsildar who allots land on merit, not for a relative's gain, applies it.
2. Integrity: no obligation to outsiders who might influence duty. Refusing a contractor's hospitality is the plainest example.
3. Objectivity: choices made on merit and evidence. Awarding a tender strictly by the evaluated score is objectivity.
4. Accountability: answerability to the public and to scrutiny. Timelines under the Sakala Act, which covers 1,452 services in 114 institutions, make delay visible and punishable.
5. Openness: reasons and information are made available unless the law prevents it. The RTI Act, 2005 is its statutory form.
6. Honesty: declaring private interests and resolving conflicts for the public. A correct annual property return is honesty in practice.

7. Leadership: promoting the principles by example. A Collector who follows the rules sets the tone for the district.

Relevance and limits.

- Fit with Indian law: Rule 3 of the State's 1966 Conduct Rules for civil servants requires "absolute integrity", which carries the same spirit.
- Gap: They do not say what to do when two clash, for example openness against a patient's confidentiality. Judgment and the Constitution must settle that.
- Social gap: In a kinship-heavy society, selflessness needs recusal rules and not only personal virtue.

Conclusion. The seven principles work best as a checklist before a decision: whom does this serve, can I defend it in public, and would I do it if it were reported tomorrow?

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SIO-AOHL": Selflessness, Integrity, Objectivity, Accountability, Openness, Honesty, Leadership. Say it as "Sio, A-O-H-L".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present the principles as binding Indian law; they are a British standard that India's own rules echo.

GS4 Q2 of 16 · 20 marks · Fairness and Rawls

PREDICTED · GS4-I · Karnataka-specific

Q2. "Equal treatment of unequals may itself be unjust." Discuss this statement with reference to fairness, equity and impartiality in public administration, drawing upon the ideas of Rawls and Ambedkar. (300 words)

Model answer

Introduction. Impartiality does not mean treating everyone the same in every case. It means applying the same principles to all and giving each what the principle requires. Rigid sameness can leave the weak where they were.

Equality, equity and impartiality.

- Equality: the same treatment for all. Suitable when people begin from a similar position.
- Equity: treatment adjusted to need so that outcomes become fair. A ramp or a scholarship is an example.
- Impartiality: the decision depends on the rule and the facts, not on who the person is, including rules that provide for need.

Rawls. In A Theory of Justice (1971), John Rawls asked us to choose rules behind a "veil of ignorance", not knowing our own caste, wealth or gender. His "difference principle" allows inequalities only if they benefit the least advantaged most. An officer can ask: would I accept this rule if I did not know whether I would be the applicant or the officer?

Ambedkar. On 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned the Constituent Assembly that political equality without social and economic equality would create a "life of contradictions". Equal rights needed special protection to become real. Articles 15(4) and 16(4) reflect this.

Karnataka illustration. The Special Development Plan, started in 2007-08, aims to promote balanced regional growth by targeting Karnataka's backward talukas. Spending more on those talukas is not partiality; it is an equity measure that followed the Nanjundappa Committee's findings.

Limits and safeguards.

- Equity must rest on written criteria, not on sympathy.
- Reasons should be recorded and open to review.

- Benefits should reach the intended group, not be captured by the better-off within it.

Conclusion. Fairness means identical rules and suitable treatment. The officer applies the first without losing sight of the second.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SAME rule, SUITED help": the same rule for all, the help suited to need.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not argue that special treatment equals partiality; impartiality is about rules and reasons, not identical outcomes.

GS4 Q3 of 16 · 20 marks · Foundational values

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q3. What are foundational values for a civil servant? Explain how a few of them can be built into daily administrative practice, and suggest institutional measures that can help sustain them. (300 words)

Model answer

Introduction. Foundational values are the basic commitments from which a public servant's decisions flow. Unlike skills, they are formed over years and tested under pressure. The Preamble, the Conduct Rules and the Second ARC's report on ethics point to the same core.

Core values and daily practice.

1. Allegiance to the Constitution: the officer serves the law before any person or party. In practice: "as per rule" notes and declining unwritten instructions.
2. Integrity and honesty: no private gain, no misleading. In practice: truthful files and refusing gifts.
3. Impartiality: the same service for every applicant, whatever caste, religion, party or wealth. In practice: queue order and published criteria.
4. Objectivity: decisions on evidence. In practice: recording reasons for every discretionary order.
5. Empathy: the poor and weak are served with respect. In practice: listening patiently and helping those who cannot reach the office.
6. Dedication: work is a duty, not a favour. In practice: meeting Sakala timelines.

Why they need support. Individual virtue is fragile; a young officer in an office where "everyone does it" is under heavy pressure.

Institutional measures.

- Selection and induction: case-based ethics tests and a values module, as at the Administrative Training Institute, Mysuru.
- Continuous learning: Mission Karmayogi (2020) offers online courses on behaviour and values.
- Role models: senior officers who follow the rules visibly.
- Protection for the honest: fixed tenure and safe channels to report an illegal order.
- Accountability: asset declarations, social audit and the Lokayukta.
- Recognition: reward values, not only targets.

Conclusion. Values show in small acts repeated daily. Institutions cannot create them, but can protect those who practise them.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A-I-I-O-E-D": Allegiance, Integrity, Impartiality, Objectivity, Empathy, Dedication, like "aye, I, I, O, E, D", six keys on one ring.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not list values as a bare glossary; the marks come from daily-practice examples and institutional support.

GS4 Q4 of 16 · 15 marks · Cognitive dissonance

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q4. Explain the theory of cognitive dissonance. How can an understanding of it help a civil servant in dealing with his or her own conduct and in handling public attitudes? (250 words)

Model answer

Meaning. Leon Festinger proposed in 1957 that people feel discomfort when two beliefs, or a belief and an action, contradict each other. They reduce it by changing the belief, changing the action, or adding an excuse.

Example. A civil servant believes "I am honest" but accepts a costly gift from a contractor. The discomfort is relieved by the thought "everyone does this", which changes the belief to fit the action. This is rationalisation, and it is how small lapses can become habits.

Value for the officer's own conduct.

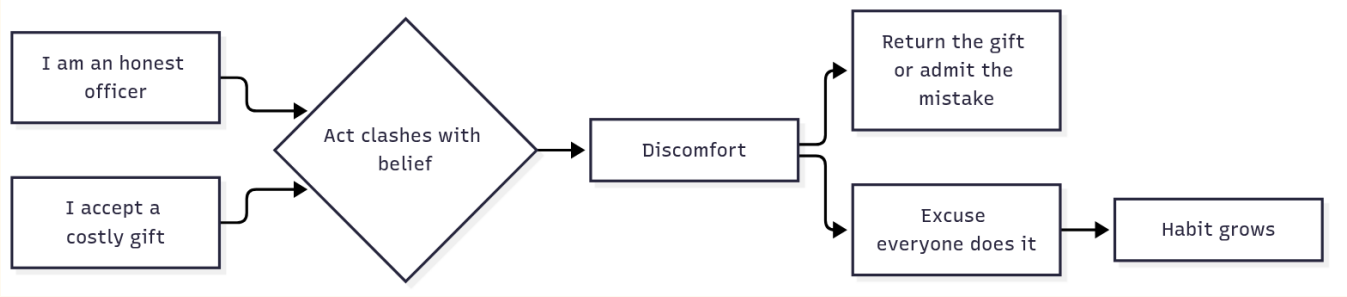
- Early warning: unease, or a need to justify an act, signals a value under pressure.
- Better decisions: pause and ask whether the act or the belief should change.
- Avoiding escalation: people defend their mistakes; admitting an error early costs less.

Value in handling public attitudes.

- Persuasion by small steps: a citizen who joins one village cleanliness drive tends to align later attitudes with that act.
- Dealing with resistance: a lecture does not change a family refusing vaccination; trusted local persons and personal experience can.
- Effort: people value what they have worked for; a village that contributes its own share to a water scheme will maintain it.

Caution. The theory should not be used to manipulate. Ethical use means giving true information and letting people reach their own conclusions.

Conclusion. Cognitive dissonance explains why good people drift into wrong acts and why attitudes resist change. Awareness is the first protection.



DRAW IT: The dissonance cycle in a tempting moment. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "BELIEF vs ACT, the itch decides": when belief and act clash, the itch asks for relief; do not scratch it with an excuse.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe dissonance as an attitude itself; it is the discomfort that drives attitude change.

GS4 Q5 of 16 · 15 marks · Aptitude and training

PREDICTED · GS4-T1 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. "Aptitude can be tested, but it must also be developed." Explain how aptitude for public service can be assessed and nurtured, with reference to training of civil servants in India and Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

Meaning. Aptitude is the natural capacity to learn and perform a kind of work. For public service, it includes analysis, communication, emotional steadiness and ethical sensitivity. It is only potential; training turns it into skill.

Assessment.

1. Written tests measure reasoning, comprehension and knowledge of public affairs.
2. Personality test or interview observes judgment, balance and attitude.
3. Case studies (as in the ethics paper) reveal how a person weighs duty, law and compassion.
4. Probation and field posting show conduct in real conditions, which no test can show.

Limits of assessment. A test cannot fully measure honesty or courage, and coaching can raise scores without raising ability.

Nurturing aptitude.

- Foundation and induction training: at the Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration, Mussoorie, and, for State service officers, at the State's training institute in Mysuru.
- Mission Karmayogi (2020): a national programme for capacity building through the iGOT online platform, linking learning to competencies for each post.
- Mentoring and rotation: postings in different departments with a senior mentor develop breadth.
- Feedback: regular appraisal, with attention to behaviour and not only targets.
- Reflection: case discussions and field diaries encourage ethical reasoning.

Karnataka angle. Newly recruited KAS officers undergo foundation training and field attachments in the district and taluk administration, where aptitude meets real citizens.

Conclusion. Selection finds promising candidates; training, mentoring and fair appraisal make good officers. A system that tests once and never develops wastes its best material.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "TEST to FIND, TRAIN to GROW": the test finds the seed; training grows the tree.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat aptitude and attitude as the same; aptitude is capacity, attitude is the mental leaning that shapes how it is used.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Mission Karmayogi National Programme for Civil Service Capacity Building and iGOT platform.

GS4: 5 of 16 done. Next up: Q6, Aristotle's golden mean.

GS4 Q6 of 16 · 15 marks · Aristotle's golden mean

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q6. Explain Aristotle's idea of virtue and the "golden mean". How can this idea guide a civil servant who must act between extremes? Illustrate with examples. (250 words)

Model answer

Aristotle's virtue ethics. Aristotle, in the Nicomachean Ethics, held that the aim of life is eudaimonia, a flourishing life. It is achieved through virtues, settled traits of character built by practice, as one becomes a builder by building. His question is not "what should I do?" but "what kind of person should I become?"

The golden mean. Every virtue lies between two vices, of excess and deficiency. The mean is not an arithmetic average; it depends on the person and situation and is found by practical wisdom (phronesis).

Virtue	Deficiency	Excess
Courage	Cowardice	Recklessness
Generosity	Stinginess	Wastefulness
Truthfulness	Understatement	Boastfulness

Application for a civil servant.

1. Firmness: an officer who never enforces the law is weak; one who enforces without regard to hardship is harsh. The good officer enforces, listens and uses discretion within the rule.
2. Initiative: between inaction and rashness lies a considered decision, such as a Deputy Commissioner who orders an evacuation on credible warnings, neither too early nor too late.
3. Openness: between secrecy and disclosing everything, share what the public needs and protect what the law protects.
4. Habit: integrity grows by repeated right action, so practise it in small matters.

Criticism. The mean is vague and may be used to justify compromise. Law and the Constitution must mark the outer limits.

Conclusion. Aristotle makes ethics a matter of character and judgment. For an officer, the golden mean is a reminder that right conduct lies between extremes, guided by wisdom and by law.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Too little, too much, JUST right": each virtue sits between a too-little vice and a too-much vice, like Goldilocks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the mean is the "average" or "compromise on principles"; it is the right response for the situation.

GS4 Q7 of 16 · 15 marks · Ambedkar

PREDICTED · GS4-E5

Q7. "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment; it has to be cultivated." Examine this view of Dr B. R. Ambedkar and explain what lessons his life and ideas offer to civil servants. (250 words)

Model answer

Constitutional morality. On 4 November 1948, Ambedkar quoted the historian George Grote in the Constituent Assembly: constitutional morality is a "paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution" and the habit of settling disputes by constitutional means. He said it was not a natural sentiment in India and had to be cultivated.

Related ideas.

- Social democracy: on 25 November 1949, he said political democracy cannot last unless it rests on social democracy, which treats liberty, equality and fraternity as one union.
- Dignity: every person has equal worth; law must remove the humiliation of untouchability.
- Education and agitation: his call to "educate, agitate, organise" ties change to knowledge and lawful means.

Lessons for civil servants.

1. Follow the spirit as well as the letter: following rules only to avoid blame, while ignoring their purpose, weakens the Constitution. Give reasons for decisions.
2. Resist pressure lawfully: disagree through the file, the appeal and the record, not through defiance or silence.
3. Treat the last person as equal: the poorest applicant for a pension or caste certificate tests the officer's commitment to dignity.
4. Learn continuously: he was a scholar of law, economics and history.
5. Courage with restraint: he fought discrimination without abandoning constitutional methods.

Karnataka link. The State's SC hostels and scholarships apply his emphasis on education.

Conclusion. For Ambedkar, a Constitution is only as good as the people who run it. The civil servant is its daily custodian.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "FORM + HABIT + HEART": respect the forms, make constitutional methods a habit, and feel the dignity of the last person.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse constitutional morality with public morality or popular sentiment; it concerns the principles of the Constitution.

GS4 Q8 of 16 · 10 marks · Vivekananda

PREDICTED · GS4-E5 · Karnataka-specific

Q8. Swami Vivekananda said that service to the poor is service to God. Explain the ethical message of his teaching and its relevance for civil servants. (150 words)

Model answer

Teaching. Swami Vivekananda (1863-1902) spoke at the Parliament of the World's Religions in Chicago in 1893 and founded the Ramakrishna Mission in 1897. His central ethical message was "service to man is service to God", expressed in his idea of Daridra Narayana, which means seeing God in the poor.

Related ideas.

- Fearlessness: weakness is the root of sin; confidence comes from character.
- Education for character: learning must build self-reliance.
- Harmony: all faiths lead to one truth; tolerance is a duty.

Karnataka link. In November 1892 he stayed in Mysore for about three weeks as a State guest of the Maharaja, Chamarajendra Wadiyar X, to whom Dewan K. Seshadri Iyer introduced him.

Relevance.

1. Service attitude: the citizen is served, not a petitioner.
2. Courage: a fearless officer takes honest decisions.
3. Tolerance: equal respect to all communities.

Conclusion. His message turns public service into a calling.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SERVE, STRONG, SAME": serve the poor, stay strong, treat all the same.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present his message as only religious; its ethical core is service and character.

GS4 Q9 of 16 · 10 marks · Ethical dilemmas

PREDICTED · GS4-E2 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. What is an ethical dilemma? Describe the four types of dilemma described by Rushworth Kidder, and explain how a civil servant may resolve one, with an example. (150 words)

Model answer

Meaning. An ethical dilemma arises when values, duties or interests point to different actions and each choice has a moral cost. Most are "right versus right".

Kidder's four patterns.

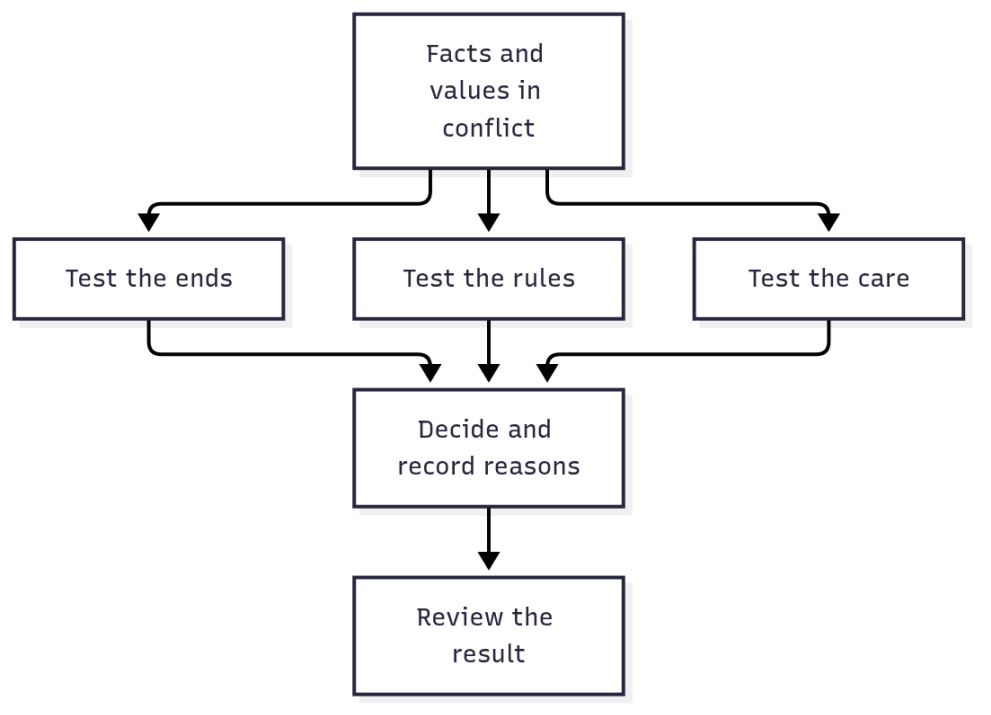
1. Truth versus loyalty: honesty to the public against loyalty to a colleague.
2. Individual versus community: one person's need against the larger group's interest.
3. Short-term versus long-term: immediate relief against lasting benefit.
4. Justice versus mercy: strict fairness against compassion.

Example (Karnataka). In a drought year, an officer deciding on reservoir release faces standing crops against a city's drinking water: individual against community, and short-term against long-term.

Resolution.

- Collect facts and name the values in conflict.
- Test with ends (best outcome), rules (law and policy) and care (what a caring person would do).
- Consult, decide, record reasons and review.

Conclusion. A dilemma cannot be removed, but a transparent method makes the decision defensible.



DRAW IT: A method for resolving an ethical dilemma. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "TLIJ": Truth/Loyalty, Individual/Community, short/Long term, Justice/Mercy. Say "TLIJ" like "tell-edge".

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix a dilemma with a temptation; in a dilemma both options have moral worth.

GS4 Q10 of 16 · 10 marks · Procurement transparency

PREDICTED · GS4-E4 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. How does transparency in public procurement reduce corruption? Give Karnataka examples and note the limitations. (150 words)

Model answer

Why procurement matters. Public purchasing involves wide discretion, so it is a leading source of corruption: inflated estimates, restricted tenders and kickbacks.

Transparency measures.

1. Law: the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurements (KTPP) Act, 1999 requires open tenders, published criteria and reasons for awarding. Karnataka was an early State to legislate on this.
2. e-Procurement: online bidding reduces personal contact and leaves a trail.
3. Rules in practice: for example, 4 Municipal Corporations have procured mechanized road sweeping machines through tender as per KTPP rules, according to the Economic Survey.
4. Training: officers are trained in the KTPP Act and e-procurement.

Limitations.

- Bidders may collude or "cartelise" even in an open tender.
- Conditions can be tailored for one firm.
- Emergency purchases bypass competition.

Way forward. Publish contracts and bills; use independent evaluators.

Conclusion. Openness reduces opportunity for corruption, but vigilance after the award is needed.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "OPEN, ONLINE, OVERSEEN": open tender, online bids, overseen by audit.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not claim that e-procurement ends corruption; collusion and tailored conditions persist.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** KTPP Act 1999 Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurements.

GS4: 10 of 16 done. Next up: Q11, Ethics, morals, law.

GS4 Q11 of 16 · 10 marks · Ethics, morals, law

PREDICTED · GS4-E1

Q11. Distinguish between ethics, morality, law and etiquette, with examples from public administration. (150 words)

Model answer

Core idea. All four guide behaviour but differ in source, force and consequence of breach.

Aspect	Ethics	Morality	Law	Etiquette
Source	Reasoned principles, professional codes	Personal and cultural beliefs	State legislation	Social custom
Force	Self-binding, professional censure	Conscience, social approval	Enforced by courts	Social disapproval
Breach leads to	Criticism, loss of trust	Guilt, shame	Penalty	Awkwardness
Example	Declining to favour a friend	Belief that lying is wrong	Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988	Addressing a citizen politely

Relationships.

- Law sets the minimum; ethics asks for more. An act can be legal yet unethical, such as awarding a tender to a relative's firm after leaking the estimate.
- Morality is personal and varies by community; ethics tests it by reasons accepted by all.
- Etiquette smooths interaction but does not decide right and wrong.

Conclusion. The civil servant must satisfy all four; when they conflict, law and ethics prevail over etiquette and taste.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "E-M-L-E, from inside to outside": Ethics and Morality are inner guides, Law is the outer enforcer, Etiquette is the outer polish.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate ethics and morality completely; keep the distinction of public/professional versus personal sources.

GS4 Q12 of 16 · 10 marks · Honest communication

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q12. Why is honesty in official communication important? Discuss, with examples, the difference between transparency, spin and misleading statistics. (150 words)

Model answer

Meaning. Honesty in communication means that what an officer says or writes truly reflects the facts, including inconvenient ones. It is the base of public trust.

Why it matters.

- Policy depends on accurate information; a false report misleads higher decisions.
- Citizens judge government on what it tells them.
- One exposed lie damages every later statement.

Transparency, spin and misleading statistics.

1. Transparency: publishing facts, methods and limits, including failures. An officer who reports that only 60 of 100 targeted houses were completed is transparent.
2. Spin: presenting true facts selectively, such as reporting only the successful villages.
3. Misleading statistics: numbers without context, such as a high satisfaction score without sample or method.

Practical test. Could I defend every line if the full file were published?

Conclusion. Honesty is not only avoiding falsehood; it is giving the whole truth in a usable way.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "FULL, FAIR, FIRST": give the full facts, report them fairly, and report bad news first.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate silence with lying; the issue is whether the omission misleads or hides a duty to disclose.

GS4 Q13 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: illegal sand mining

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q13. Fictional case. Imagine that you hold charge as Deputy Commissioner of a river-basin district in Karnataka. Illegal sand extraction at night is destroying the riverbank near a village, and a bridge pillar

downstream is at risk. Your Assistant Commissioner seized three tippers last week; the next day he received threats and his official vehicle was damaged. Local people are divided: some villagers earn a living by loading sand, and a powerful local contractor says that the official sand blocks are too few and too costly, so construction in the town will halt. A local leader asks you to "go slow" for a month until the election model code ends. (a) Identify the ethical issues. (b) List the options open to you. (c) State and justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Illegal mining threatens a bridge and the river, an officer is under threat, and livelihood and supply problems are real.

D - Dimensions. River and downstream public: ecology and safety of the bridge. Assistant Commissioner: personal security and morale. Loaders: income. Contractor and builders: supply and cost. Local leader: political pressure. You: rule of law and the credibility of the State.

R - Rules and values. The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 penalises illegal mining, and the State's Minor Mineral Concession Rules provide for legal sand blocks. Values: rule of law, protection of the environment, courage, sensitivity to livelihood and fairness. A request to "go slow" has no legal basis.

A - Options.

1. Go slow as requested: avoids conflict, but allows further damage and encourages the mafia.
2. Only crack down: upholds the law, but leaves the loaders jobless and the supply problem untouched.
3. Firm enforcement with a lawful alternative: act against the offenders, protect the officer and open legal supply.

T - Take the decision. I would adopt option 3, as follows.

- Immediate: Register an FIR for the attack; give police protection to the Assistant Commissioner; continue seizures. Report the political request to the Chief Secretary.
- Inspect the bridge pillar with engineers and take emergency steps.
- Livelihood: Link loaders to legal sand blocks or M-Sand units. The latest Karnataka Economic Survey reports that only 172 of 338 identified sand blocks have been auctioned and that 1,067 M-Sand units are operating.
- Supply: Speed up the auction of remaining blocks and supply at the notified rate of Rs 850 per unit for public works.
- Systemic: GPS tracking of tippers and night patrols.

Justification. The decision protects the rule of law, the environment and the officer, and provides lawful livelihoods.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "FIRM + FAIR + FUTURE": firm on the offenders, fair to the loaders and a future through legal supply.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not suggest "negotiating with the mafia" or stopping action until elections; and do not ignore livelihoods.

GS4 Q14 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: patient data leak

PREDICTED · CS

Q14. Fictional case. You are the Commissioner of Health in a State. A WhatsApp group of a taluk's health workers circulates a spreadsheet with the names, addresses and HIV status of 40 patients. The sheet was shared by a contract data operator, who says he forwarded it to a supervisor "for work". Within two days, a family in a village is boycotted; a young patient stops treatment; a newspaper is about to

publish the story. The Minister says that "a small operator made a mistake" and asks you to suspend him and close the matter, while the vendor that supplied the operator says that the contract places no data duties on it. (a) Identify the ethical issues. (b) List the options open to you. (c) State and justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. The confidential health data of vulnerable patients has leaked, causing harm and a risk to continued treatment, and responsibility is being pushed to the lowest person.

D - Dimensions. Patients: privacy, dignity, treatment. Operator: fairness. Vendor and department: accountability. Minister: reputation. Community: stigma and the need for awareness. You: the duty of care and truthfulness.

R - Rules and values. The HIV and AIDS (Prevention and Control) Act, 2017 protects confidentiality of HIV-related information and prohibits discrimination. The 2023 Act on personal data protection requires data fiduciaries to safeguard such data. Values: privacy, non-maleficence, accountability and justice.

A - Options.

1. Suspend the operator and close the file: quick, but unfair, and leaves the system unchanged.
2. Deny the leak to the media: protects reputation, but compounds the harm and breaks trust.
3. Protect the patients first, investigate fairly and fix the system.

T - Take the decision. I would adopt option 3, as follows.

- Immediate: Get the sheet deleted from the groups, ask the police cyber cell to trace its spread, and ask the district officer to restore the family's access to services and treatment through counselling.
- Ensure continuity of the affected young patient's medicine, with a trusted counsellor.
- Accountability: Hold a fair inquiry covering the operator, supervisor, vendor and the department's access rules; act proportionately, not only against the operator.
- Transparency: Issue a short, truthful statement and offer an apology without naming the patients.
- Systemic: Role-based access, data masking, and mandatory training; add data-protection clauses to the vendor contract.

Justification. The decision puts patients before reputation, applies fairness to all responsible persons, and corrects the cause.



DRAW IT: Response order after a data leak. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PATIENT first, PEOPLE next, PROCESS last": protect the patient, find all responsible people, then fix the process.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not blame only the lowest-ranking person, and do not publicly name the affected patients in the response.

GS4 Q15 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: hostel discrimination

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Fictional case. You are the District Social Welfare Officer in Karnataka. A complaint reaches you that, in a government residential school for SC and ST students in the district, students from a dominant caste are served first at meals and given better tasks, and Dalit students are made to clean the toilets. The headmaster is a respected local figure and the brother of a Zilla Panchayat member. Three teachers privately confirm the complaint but request anonymity. The students fear being sent home. The

headmaster says the complaint is "a plot by an outsider". (a) Identify the ethical issues. (b) List the options open to you. (c) State and justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Caste-based discrimination in a state-run school, with an influential accused, frightened children and fearful witnesses.

D - Dimensions. Students: dignity, safety and education. Teachers: job security and conscience. Headmaster: reputation and fair hearing. ZP member: political influence. You: impartiality and duty to the weak. Community: social harmony.

R - Rules and values. Articles 15 and 17 of the Constitution prohibit discrimination and abolish untouchability. The 1989 Act on atrocities against SCs and STs penalises such humiliation, including forcing a member of an SC or ST to do degrading work. Values: dignity, equality, impartiality, compassion and natural justice.

A - Options.

1. Rely on the headmaster's word: easy, but fails the students.
2. Immediate suspension without inquiry: satisfies activists, but violates natural justice and may fail in court.
3. Protect the students, verify quickly and act under law.

T - Take the decision. I would adopt option 3, as follows.

- Immediate: Visit the school unannounced with a woman officer and a counsellor; speak to students privately; ensure meals and duties are fairly rotated.
- Record statements; ask for a police case under the 1989 Act if the facts show an offence; protect the teachers' identity as witnesses.
- Give the headmaster a fair hearing; keep him away from the inquiry (a temporary transfer, not punishment) so that students are free to speak.
- Brief the Deputy Commissioner and refuse any pressure from the ZP member in writing.
- Systemic: Create a hostel monitoring committee including parents and a student representative, a complaints box and surprise visits.

Justification. The decision protects the dignity of children, treats the accused fairly and sends a message that discrimination will not be tolerated.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CHILD first, CASE next, CHANGE last": protect the child, build the case lawfully, then change the system.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not reveal the teachers' names, and do not punish the headmaster before inquiry.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Articles 15 and 17 of the Constitution.

GS4: 15 of 16 done. Next up: Q16, Case: clerk with addiction.

GS4 Q16 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: clerk with addiction

PREDICTED · CS

Q16. Fictional case. You are the Tahsildar of a taluk. Your senior clerk, who handles land records and mutation files, has been in service for 22 years and is respected by the staff. Recently he has been coming late, smelling of alcohol, and making errors; two wrong mutation entries have been challenged by farmers. His colleagues cover for him because his wife is seriously ill. A farmer's group threatens a protest. Your office is already short of staff, and the District Revenue Officer asks for a quick explanation.

(a) Identify the ethical issues. (b) List the options open to you. (c) State and justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A long-serving clerk's alcohol dependence is harming citizens through errors in land records, while colleagues hide the matter out of sympathy.

D - Dimensions. Clerk: health, dignity, livelihood and family stress. Farmers: correct land records and trust. Colleagues: loyalty and workload. You: the duty to the public and care for your staff. Department: discipline and public confidence.

R - Rules and values. The State's 1966 Conduct Rules do not permit a government servant to report for duty under the influence of intoxicants. The Mental Healthcare Act, 2017 recognises the right to access treatment. Values: public duty, compassion, fairness and proportionality.

A - Options.

1. Continue to protect him: kind, but harms farmers and entrenches the problem.
2. Immediate disciplinary action: upholds rule, but ignores the illness and may be disproportionate.
3. Combine accountability with help: correct the errors, remove him from sensitive work, counsel him, and apply the rule fairly.

T - Take the decision. I would adopt option 3, as follows.

- Immediate: Correct the two entries after a hearing of the farmers, and give a short written reply to the DRO, stating the facts and the action taken.
- Move the clerk away from land records pending recovery; verify his recent files.
- Meet him privately; offer leave and referral to a de-addiction programme and the employee assistance support, and warn that a repeat would attract proceedings.
- Speak with the staff, explaining that covering up harms citizens and the clerk himself.
- Meet the farmers' group, explain the corrections and invite them to verify.
- Systemic: Two-person verification of mutations and a wellness check-in programme.

Justification. The decision protects farmers first, treats the clerk as a person with a treatable illness, and is fair and proportionate.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CORRECT, CARE, CHECK": correct the records, care for the clerk, check the system.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say "suspend and forget"; compassion and accountability must go together.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q12 Honest communication:** "FULL, FAIR, FIRST": give the full facts, report them fairly, and report bad news first. **Q13 Case: illegal sand mining:** "FIRM + FAIR + FUTURE": firm on the offenders, fair to the loaders and a future through legal supply. **Q14 Case: patient data leak:** "PATIENT first, PEOPLE next, PROCESS last": protect the patient, find all responsible people, then fix the process. **Q15 Case: hostel discrimination:** "CHILD first, CASE next, CHANGE last": protect the child, build the case lawfully, then change the system. **Q16 Case: clerk with addiction:** "CORRECT, CARE, CHECK": correct the records, care for the clerk, check the system.

Kannada and English practice (short)

> **REVIEW:** The Kannada text in this section was written without a native-speaker check. Please have a Kannada teacher or fluent speaker read it before you treat it as a model. The English parts follow plain formal style.

Practice 1: Kannada essay (ಪ್ರಬಂಧ), about 120 words

Topic: ಶಿಕ್ಷಣದ ಮಹತ್ವ (The importance of education)

Outline (ರೂಪರೇಖೆ): ಪೀಠಿಕೆ → ಶಿಕ್ಷಣದ ಪ್ರಯೋಜನಗಳು → ಅಡೆತಡೆಗಳು → ಪರಿಹಾರಗಳು → ಉಪಸಂಹಾರ

Model essay (ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ):

ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಮನುಷ್ಯನ ಬದುಕಿಗೆ ಬೆಳಕು. ಶಿಕ್ಷಣದಿಂದ ಜ್ಞಾನ ಬೆಳೆಯುತ್ತದೆ, ಉದ್ಯೋಗದ ಅವಕಾಶಗಳು ಸಿಗುತ್ತವೆ ಮತ್ತು ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಗುಣಗಳು ರೂಪುಗೊಳ್ಳುತ್ತವೆ. ವಿದ್ಯಾವಂತ ವ್ಯಕ್ತಿ ತನ್ನ ಹಕ್ಕು ಮತ್ತು ಕರ್ತವ್ಯಗಳನ್ನು ಅರಿತು ಸಮಾಜದ ಸೇವೆ ಮಾಡುತ್ತಾನೆ. ಹೆಣ್ಣುಮಕ್ಕಳು ಓದಿದರೆ ಇಡೀ ಕುಟುಂಬ ಮುಂದೆ ಬರುತ್ತದೆ. ಆದರೂ ಬಡತನ, ದೂರದ ಶಾಲೆ ಮತ್ತು ಶಿಕ್ಷಕರ ಕೊರತೆಯಿಂದ ಕೆಲವು ಮಕ್ಕಳು ಶಾಲೆ ಬಿಡುತ್ತಾರೆ. ಉಚಿತ ಹಾಸ್ಟೆಲ್‌ಗಳು, ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿವೇತನ, ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನದ ಬಿಸಿಯೂಟ ಮತ್ತು ಸಾಕಷ್ಟು ಶಿಕ್ಷಕರ ನೇಮಕದಿಂದ ಈ ಸಮಸ್ಯೆಯನ್ನು ಕಡಿಮೆ ಮಾಡಬಹುದು. ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಕೇವಲ ಅಂಕಗಳಿಗಾಗಿ ಅಲ್ಲ; ಅದು ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಮನುಷ್ಯರನ್ನು ರೂಪಿಸಬೇಕು. ವಿದ್ಯೆಯೇ ನಿಜವಾದ ಸಂಪತ್ತು.

Practice 2: Translate into Kannada (ಅನುವಾದ)

#	English	Model Kannada
1	Education gives light to life.	ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಬದುಕಿಗೆ ಬೆಳಕು ನೀಡುತ್ತದೆ.
2	Every child has the right to go to school.	ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಂದು ಮಗುವಿಗೂ ಶಾಲೆಗೆ ಹೋಗುವ ಹಕ್ಕಿದೆ.
3	Government officers should serve citizens honestly.	ಸರ್ಕಾರಿ ಅಧಿಕಾರಿಗಳು ನಾಗರಿಕರಿಗೆ ಪ್ರಾಮಾಣಿಕವಾಗಿ ಸೇವೆ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬೇಕು.
4	Public information should be available to everyone.	ಸಾರ್ವಜನಿಕ ಮಾಹಿತಿ ಎಲ್ಲರಿಗೂ ಲಭ್ಯವಾಗಬೇಕು.
5	Honesty is the best policy.	ಪ್ರಾಮಾಣಿಕತೆಯೇ ಅತ್ಯುತ್ತಮ ನೀತಿ.

Practice 3: English precis (reduce to one-third)

Passage (about 150 words):

Trust is the quiet capital of a public institution. A citizen who believes that a file will be handled fairly does not pay extra to hurry it, and a village that believes in its health centre sends its children there. Such trust is not built by speeches. It grows when an office keeps its promises on time, explains its decisions in simple words and admits its mistakes openly. It is lost quickly: a single case of hidden favour can undo years of good work, because people remember what hurt them for longer than what helped them. Rules and technology can support trust, for example by fixing time limits and putting records online, but they cannot create it alone. The attitude of the officer at the counter matters just as much. When citizens feel respected, they cooperate with the law, pay their taxes and report wrongs. When they feel ignored, they look for shortcuts.

Model precis (about 50 words), with title "Trust as public capital":

Trust is the real capital of public institutions. It grows when offices keep promises, explain decisions simply and admit errors, and it is lost quickly through hidden favour. Rules and technology support it, but respectful officers create it. Respected citizens cooperate; ignored citizens seek shortcuts.

Practice 4: Formal letter (English)

Task: Write a letter to the District Health Officer about the absence of a doctor at the Primary Health Centre in your village.

Model letter:

From: S. Rao, Main Road, Hosahalli Village, Hosahalli Taluk, Karnataka - 500 000 To: The District Health Officer, District Office, Karnataka Date: 27 October 2026

Sir,

Subject: Absence of a doctor at the Primary Health Centre, Hosahalli

I write to bring to your notice that the Primary Health Centre in our village has had no regular doctor for the past two months. Patients, especially pregnant women, the elderly and children, must travel nearly twenty kilometres to the taluk hospital, which causes delay, expense and risk in emergencies.

I request you to post a doctor at the centre at the earliest, to arrange a visiting doctor until then, and to ensure that medicines are in stock. I would be grateful for an early reply.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, S. Rao

Review report for Set 2

REVIEW: Checks run on 27-10-2026 (IST). Machine checks cover every answer; the fact review covers a sample of 12 of 76 questions (16%, above the 15% target) plus the two essays' sources and every web-checked item listed below. The review was done by the same author in a separate read, not by an outside person, so treat it as a careful self-review.

Check	Result
Word limits (10 marks: 150; 15 marks: 250; 20 marks: 300; essays: 1,200)	0 over the limit; all answers at 80% of the limit or more
Copy check: 6-word overlaps with past mains papers, the existing 40 model answers, Set 1 and the other Set 2 files	0 flagged after fixes
Economic Survey and PRS figures, matched against the saved source text	0 mismatches
Remember-line and common-trap box on every answer	All present

Fact sources, honestly stated

- **Machine-matched (ES = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26 summary; PRS = Karnataka Budget analysis 2026-27):** about 65 ledger lines, found word for word in the saved source.
- **Checked on the web this session (official pages or news synthesis):** VB-G RAM G Act replaces MGNREGA from 1 July 2026, 125 days, 60:40 sharing (PIB); 18th BRICS Summit, Bharat Mandapam, 12-13 September 2026 and theme (BRICS India 2026 site, PIB); Census 2027 phases, caste in the February 2027 enumeration, reference date 1 March 2027 (PIB, Cabinet note); One Nation One Election Bill, JPC report still pending as of 21 October 2026; India's peacekeeping record (over 2.9 lakh personnel, over 50 missions, over 180 deaths, PIB and UN); Mission Karmayogi approved 2 September 2020 (PIB); ISM 2.0 approved 15 July 2026, Rs 1.275 lakh crore (PIB, Reuters); Vanashakti judgment of 16 May 2025 and its recall on 18 November 2025 by 2:1 (2025 INSC 1326); e-NAM figures as on 30 June 2026 (Lok Sabha reply); Mahadayi award 14 August 2018, 13.42 TMC; Cauvery 284.75 TMC; Kuvempu Jnanpith.
- **Found wrong and fixed:** the Vivekananda line said the Dewan "supported his journey to the West". The sources only support that he stayed in Mysore in November 1892 as the Maharaja's guest and was introduced by the Dewan; the answer now says exactly that, and the Maharaja's name is given as Chamarajendra Wadiyar X.
- **Static or textbook facts (statutes, case names, historical dates):** checked from memory in the sample read, not by live search (for example Article 14, Rawls 1971, Festinger 1957, Belgaum 1924, Sarkaria and Punchhi). Please re-verify any date you plan to quote in the real exam from a standard textbook.
- **Search-synthesis only, re-verify before quoting:** the CCTS status (seven sectors, about 490 entities, first issuance pending), the exact mandi counts in e-NAM, and the Mahadayi appeal status. These came from search summaries, not from reading each primary document in full.

Known gaps

- The 2025 past papers are scanned images, so the copy check against them is weaker than against 2014, 2015, 2020 and 2021.
- Fictional case studies are invented; no real person or institution is meant. Statutes in them are cited at a general level.
- The Kannada practice section needs a native reader.
- The Karnataka line in the One Nation One Election answer (Assembly term aligned to 2029) is a reasoning point, not an official statement.

KAS Mains Mock Set 3: Fully Solved

Built 27-10-2026 23:26 IST | 5 papers x 250 marks | every question is PREDICTED from the trend blueprint, never copied from a past paper

PREDICTED: These questions are predictions from the pattern of the 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 papers (see TREND_BLUEPRINT). They are practice, not leaked or past questions. Model answers stay inside the word limit printed with each question. Facts are tied to official sources where possible; a fact list is kept for each answer.

CHAI-TALK: Do this set like an exam: one paper at a time, three hours each, writing by hand. Then read the model answer, tick what you covered, and copy the purple memory line for anything you missed. Do not read all five papers in one sitting. Five good papers beat fifty skimmed ones.

Set 3: step 1 of 6. Next up: Paper 1, the Essay.

Paper 1: Essay

Set 3: step 2 of 6 (Essay). Next up: General Studies I (GS1)

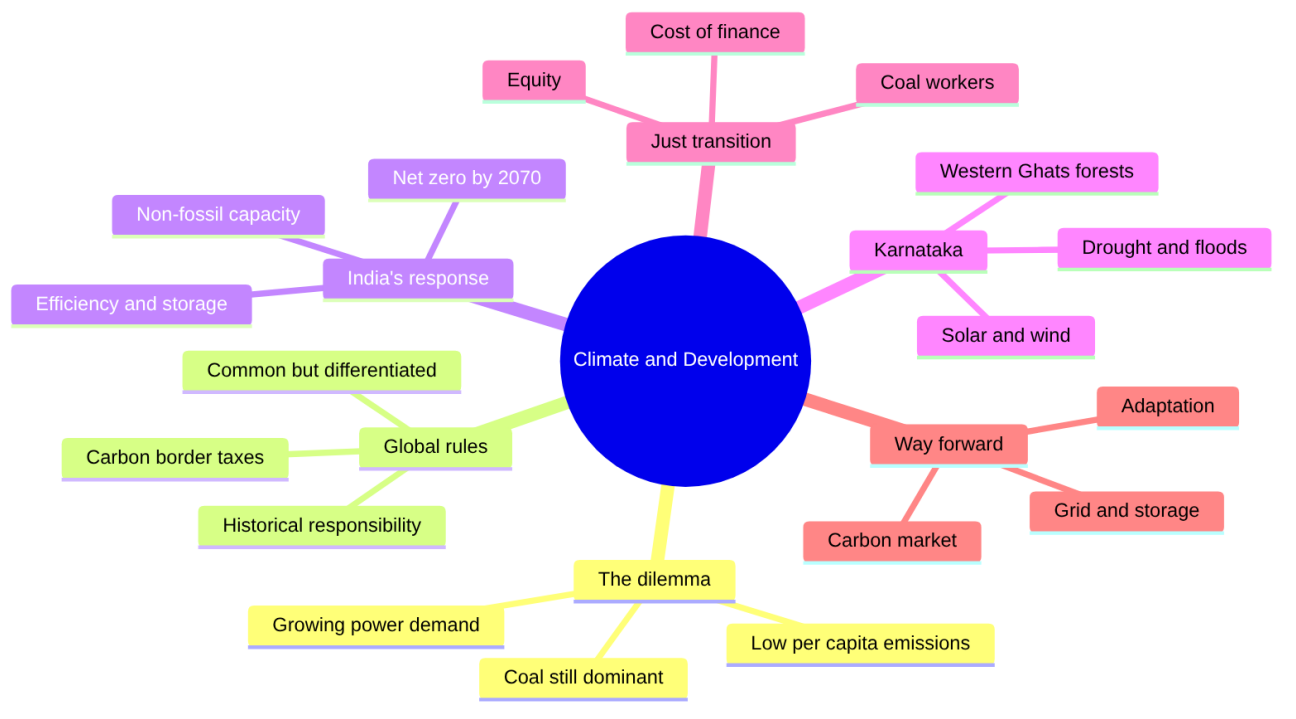
Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Instructions:** write two essays, one from each part, about 1,000 to 1,200 words each. Both carry 125 marks. (This is the practice shape; check the latest KPSC notification for exact instructions.)

> **CHAI-TALK:** An essay is a short journey: a hook, a clear stand, three or four strong turns, a fair look at the other side and a landing that points forward. Read the mind map first, then the essay, and then try to rebuild the map from memory.

Essay 1 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-1

Q1. Climate change, the energy transition and the right to develop: can India grow without burning its future? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 1: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

A farmer in north Karnataka who lost a crop to a dry spell, and a software engineer in Bengaluru who runs an air conditioner through a hot April, are both living the same fact: the climate is changing, and the country is also changing fast. India needs more electricity to lift incomes, yet the main source of that electricity, coal, is the main cause of the warming that now harms those incomes. The question is not whether to develop or to protect the climate, but in what order, at what cost and who pays.

The shape of the dilemma

India is home to about one-sixth of humanity but has contributed only a small share of the historical emissions that now sit in the atmosphere. Its per capita emissions remain well below the world average, and a household in India uses a fraction of the electricity of a household in a rich country. Demand will

therefore rise with every new home, factory, cooling appliance and electric vehicle. At the same time, India is among the countries most exposed to heat, erratic monsoons, floods, rising seas and glacial change. The poor, who have the least cause for the problem, have the least cushion against it.

What the world's rules say

The climate regime rests on the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities": every country must act, but rich countries, which emitted first and have more capacity, must lead and provide finance and technology. India has repeatedly argued that the promised climate finance has fallen short of what is needed. A newer irritation is the carbon border tax. The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism entered its definitive phase on 1 January 2026, and it requires importers to account for the emissions embedded in goods such as steel and aluminium. Indian exporters, especially of metals, face a possible price cost unless they can document lower emissions. The measure can push firms to clean up, but it also shifts the burden to developing economies without matching help.

India's response so far

At Glasgow in 2021 India announced net zero by 2070, with five goals for 2030 that included a target of 500 GW from non-fossil sources. The country crossed 50 per cent of non-fossil installed electricity capacity in June 2025, five years before the 2030 goal in its climate pledge. Solar parks, rooftop schemes, wind farms, hydropower and a small but growing nuclear fleet make up this mix. A word of caution is needed: capacity is not the same as generation. A solar plant works for a few hours a day, so even with a high share of capacity, coal still supplies much of the actual electricity, and it will for years as demand grows.

Karnataka as a mirror

Karnataka shows both the promise and the difficulty. In the Karnataka Economic Survey of 2025-26, installed capacity, counting what it draws from central plants, stood at 37,072.95 MW up to December 2025, and renewables supplied a little over half of it (53.32 per cent), leaving out independent thermal plants and mini-hydro. Pavagada, a solar park in Tumakuru district, is a national landmark, and the State has also been honoured for its wind power. Yet the State also faces the other side of the problem: droughts in the north and east, floods and landslides in the Malnad and coast, and heat in its growing cities. The same Survey notes that landslides affect slopes of more than 30 per cent and that the coast is exposed to sea erosion. The State's forests, which are the Western Ghats' evergreen cover, act as a carbon sink and a water source, so protecting them is itself a climate policy.

Four hard choices

First, the grid. Wind and sunshine are variable. To use them well, India needs storage, flexible grids, and better transmission, in addition to new plants. Without these, renewable power is wasted at noon and unavailable at night.

Second, coal. Coal supports millions of jobs, many in poor districts, and fills the revenue of States and railways. A sudden exit would be unjust and unwise. A "just transition" means a planned, gradual shift, retraining of workers, alternative industries in coal regions and new revenue for affected districts.

Third, finance. A solar plant has high costs at the start and low costs afterwards, so the price of borrowing decides whether it is affordable. Developing countries often borrow at higher rates, which makes clean energy more expensive for those who can least afford it. Lower-cost finance, from both domestic banks and international sources, matters as much as technology.

Fourth, markets. India has begun a carbon credit trading scheme, which, if well designed, can reward firms that cut emissions and help them meet foreign carbon rules at home. Its success depends on credible data, strong verification and a stable price signal.

Adaptation: the neglected half

Cutting emissions is only half the answer; the world will be warmer in the coming decades whatever is done today. Cities need heat action plans, drains and tree cover; farmers need weather advisories, crop

insurance and drought-tolerant seeds; coastal and hill communities need early warning and safer land use. Adaptation is local, and it succeeds when panchayats and municipalities are given money and power.

Fairness within India

The transition must be fair at home as well. A rooftop solar scheme that helps only the households that can afford the upfront payment increases inequality. A tax on fuel or an electricity price rise without relief hurts the poor most. Equally, clean cooking and reliable electricity bring large health and education gains to women and children. A good climate policy is also a social policy.

The way forward

India should keep adding renewable capacity while investing equally in storage, grids and demand management. It should plan the decline of coal in a way that protects workers and States. It should insist, in the global talks, on finance and technology transfer, and prepare its exporters to meet carbon rules by measuring and cutting their emissions. It should invest in adaptation at the level of the village and the ward. And it should tell citizens the truth: that this path has costs, but that doing nothing costs more.

Conclusion

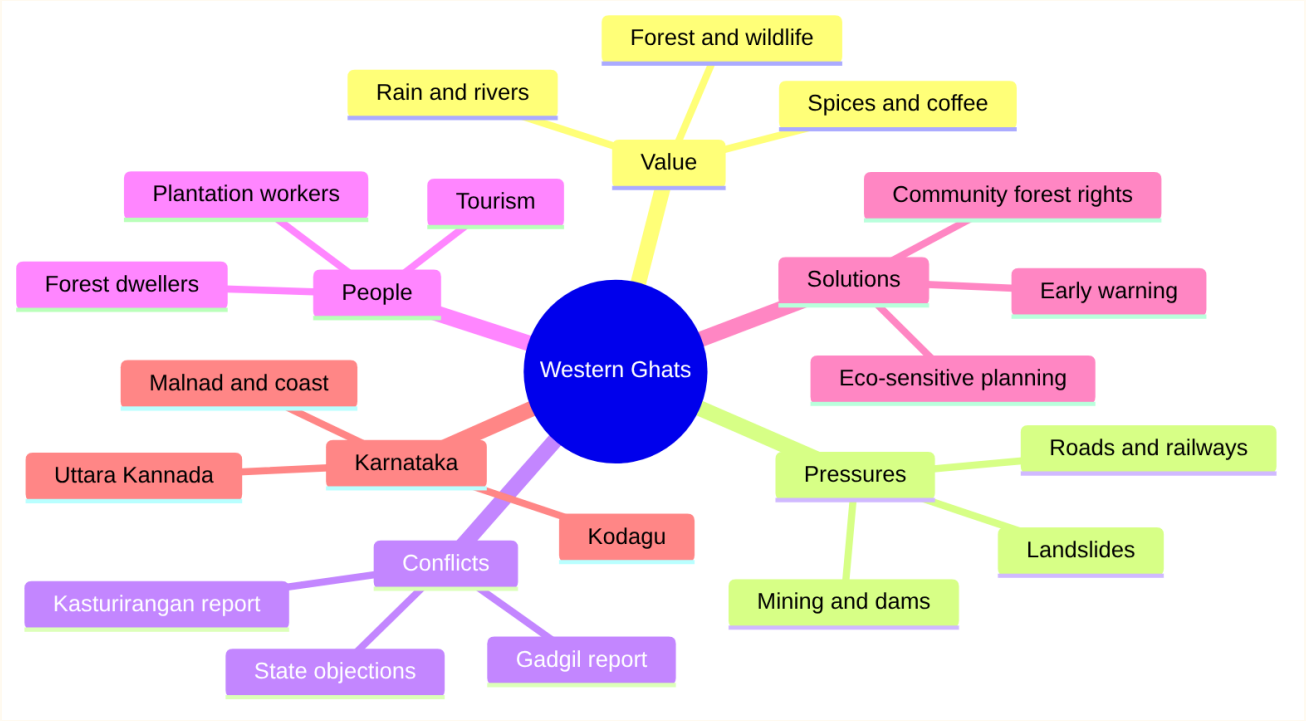
Development and climate protection are often described as rivals, but in India they depend on each other. A drought-hit farmer cannot be helped by growth that heats the planet further, and a clean grid that leaves the poor in the dark is no victory. The test of India's transition will be simple: when the next heat wave or flood comes, are the poorest better protected than before? If the answer is yes, the country will have grown without burning its future.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "DEPAC": the Dilemma, then Equity, Policy, Adaptation and Costs: remember D-E-P-A-C.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat the 50 per cent non-fossil capacity milestone as 50 per cent of electricity generated; capacity and generation differ, and coal still supplies most of the actual power.

Essay 2 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-2

Q2. The Western Ghats: how Karnataka can protect its forests and the people who live in them. (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 2: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

When the south-west monsoon breaks on the Karnataka coast, much of its water has already been caught and slowed by a long green wall: the Western Ghats, or the Sahyadri. The Ghats feed the Cauvery, the Krishna, the Sharavathi and dozens of smaller rivers; they hold forests older than most of our cities; and they support coffee estates, spice gardens, farms, fishers on the coast and millions of people downstream. The Ghats can be saved only if the people who live in them are partners and not suspects, and they can be developed only if development respects the limits of a fragile slope.

Why the Ghats matter

The mountain range, recognised as a global biodiversity hotspot, has many species found nowhere else. It also works as a water tower for peninsular India, since forest soil absorbs the rain and releases it slowly through the dry months. In 2012, the UNESCO World Heritage Committee inscribed 39 sites of the Western Ghats in seven clusters. Karnataka holds the largest share of the range: the latest State survey puts its portion at close to three-fifths, so a large part of the responsibility, and the credit, rests here.

The pressures on the range

The Survey lists the pressures plainly: population growth, infrastructure expansion, mining, encroachment, habitat fragmentation, illegal timber extraction, poaching, excessive fuelwood collection and unregulated grazing. To these should be added linear projects such as highways, railway lines, transmission lines and hydroelectric and pumped-storage schemes, which cut forests into pieces, and tourism that builds homestays and resorts on slopes without drainage or setbacks.

The cost is now visible in disasters. Cutting hill slopes for road widening, heavy rain on loosened soil and blocked natural drains turned a landslide on the national highway near Shirur in Uttara Kannada, in July 2024, into a deadly event; two weeks later, landslides at Wayanad in neighbouring Kerala claimed hundreds of lives. Karnataka's own disaster profile records that landslides affect slopes steeper than 30 per cent, and the Malnad is prone to floods and mudflows. A nature loss is therefore a risk to safety, and not only a cause for sentiment.

Two reports, one argument

The country has argued for more than a decade over how to protect the Ghats. The Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel under Madhav Gadgil (2011) proposed to treat the entire range as ecologically sensitive, divided into three zones with graded restrictions, and wanted decisions to rest with local bodies and gram sabhas. The High Level Working Group under K. Kasturirangan (2013) took a narrower view. It proposed that 37 per cent of the range, about 59,940 sq. km across six States, should be notified as an ecologically sensitive area, in which mining, quarrying, large thermal power and polluting industries are barred and large building projects are regulated. Karnataka's share in this proposal was about 20,668 sq. km. Draft notifications have been issued repeatedly; the Centre has not yet issued a final notification, and several States, including Karnataka, have objected, because they fear for the livelihoods of farmers and plantation workers and for local projects.

Both objections have some truth. The conservationist is right that a hillside, once cleared, cannot be restored in a human lifetime. The villager is right that a restriction written in a distant office, without a hearing or a share of the benefit, feels like punishment. A policy that ignores either group will fail.

The people of the Ghats

Those who live in these hills are not a single group. They include forest-dwelling communities who collect honey, soapnut and other non-timber produce; small farmers with areca, pepper, cardamom and paddy; coffee planters and estate workers in Kodagu and Chikkamagaluru; fishers on the coast whose catch depends on healthy rivers; and a growing number of people working in tourism. Many live with wild animals at the doorstep. For them conservation is real only if it brings income, security and dignity.

The Forest Rights Act, 2006 recognises individual and community rights of forest dwellers, including the right to protect and manage community forests. Where these rights are recognised, a village can police its own forest more reliably than a distant guard can. Where claims remain pending, people feel like intruders in their own homes, and the forest loses its best protector.

Keeping both: five practical steps

First, plan by watershed and slope, not by village boundary. Hazard maps that show landslide and flood zones should decide where roads, quarries and buildings may go, and these maps should be public and binding.

Second, give the village a stake. Pay communities for services they provide, such as water supply and carbon storage, share eco-tourism income with the gram panchayat, and expand the work of Biodiversity Management Committees, which the Survey reports at 6,554 in the Gram Panchayats of the State.

Third, design linear projects with care. A road or railway must prove that there is no feasible alternative, and where one is unavoidable, it should include underpasses, bridges, slope protection and compensatory forest that is properly monitored.

Fourth, support livelihood diversification. Shade-grown coffee and mixed spice gardens keep the canopy and the income; value addition, processing and fair prices help farmers cope with a smaller footprint. Compensation for crop damage by wild animals must be quick and fair.

Fifth, build early warning and local response. Rain gauges, slope sensors, trained village volunteers and clear evacuation routes are cheap compared with the cost of one disaster.

Karnataka's position

The State has a strong base: a protected-area network, forest and wildlife departments with experience, and community institutions in many villages. It has also objected to the Kasturirangan approach on grounds of livelihood. The better course is to replace a blanket answer with a local one, asking where and how: identify the truly critical zones with the participation of the gram sabhas and science-based mapping, protect those firmly, and allow carefully regulated activity elsewhere, with a monitoring system that is open to citizens.

Conclusion

The choice before Karnataka is not between a green hill and a hungry village. It is between a managed future, in which both are supported, and an unmanaged one, in which a landslide, a drought or a failed river settles the matter. A forest that sustains its people will be defended by them, and people who are secure in their land will defend the forest. The Western Ghats will be saved when those who live there have every reason to save them.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "WATER-Hill": Water, Anchor slopes, Tourism and roads, Equity for people, Rights of forest dwellers.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Kasturirangan report was accepted or that a final notification exists; the Centre has issued repeated drafts and no final notification, and several States, including Karnataka, have objected.

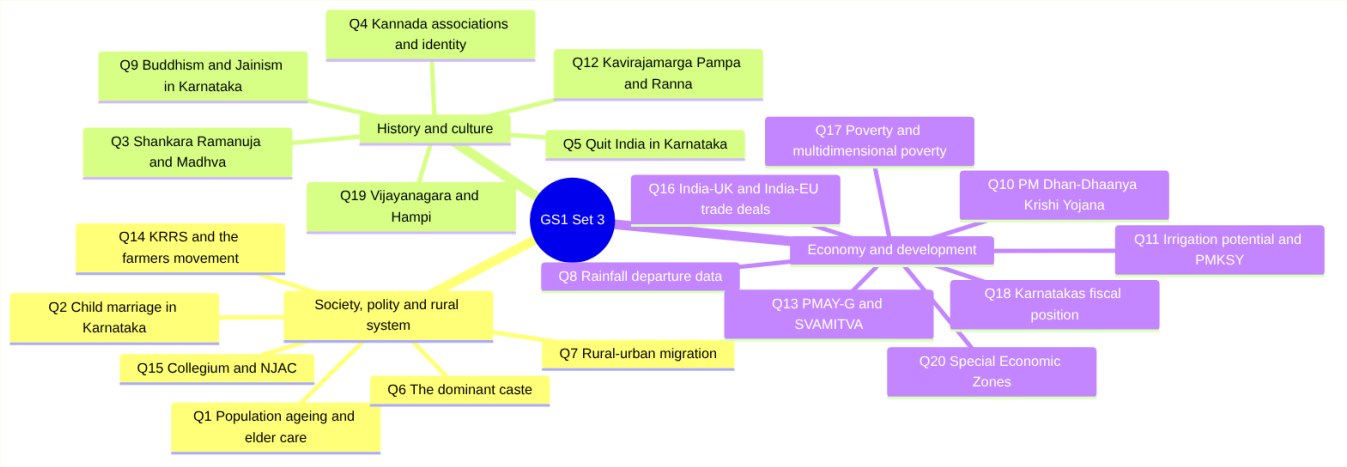
RECAP: Both essays follow the same shape: hook, stand, turns, other side, way forward. Try writing a 5-line plan for any new topic in 4 minutes before you start.

Paper 2: General Studies I (GS1)

Set 3: step 3 of 6 (General Studies I (GS1)). Next up: General Studies II (GS2)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Set 3 starts with society: ageing, child marriage, caste and migration, then travels from the Vedanta teachers and early Kannada poets to Quit India and the farmers' movement. Pair every point with a date, a figure or a Karnataka place.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS1 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · Population ageing and elder care

PREDICTED · GS1-B3 · Current affairs

Q1. India's population is ageing and families are changing. Discuss the social consequences of ageing and the legal and policy measures for the care of senior citizens. (250 words)

Model answer

Longer life and smaller families are changing who cares for the old. The UNFPA India Ageing Report 2023 estimates that people aged 60 and above were 10.5 per cent of India's population in 2022 and will be 20.8 per cent by 2050.

Social consequences

- Nuclear and migrating families reduce informal care; many elderly live alone or only with a spouse.
- Elderly women face widowhood, poor property rights and low pension cover.
- Rising health costs, loneliness and abuse, and greater need for long-term care.
- A positive side is the "silver dividend": experience, volunteering and spending power.

Legal and policy measures

- The Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007 makes it a duty of children and heirs to maintain parents, provides tribunals, and requires old-age homes.
- The National Social Assistance Programme gives old-age pensions to poor households; the Vay Vandana health cover extends the Ayushman scheme to everyone from 70 years of age.
- The Integrated Programme for Senior Citizens supports day-care and homes; Article 41 directs the State to provide public assistance in old age.

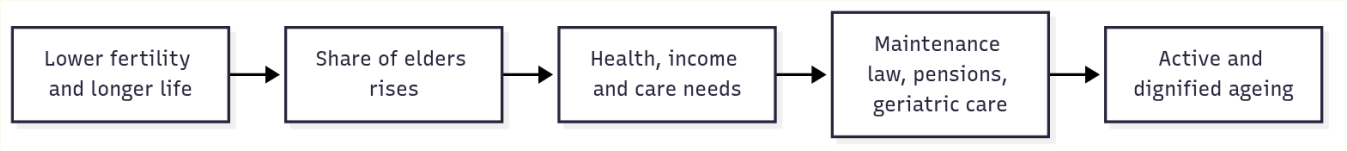
Gaps

- Tribunals are slow and unknown; pensions are small and uneven.
- Geriatric training and home-based care are scarce.

Way forward

- Contributory pensions, home care and geriatric centres in district hospitals.
- Community groups to prevent isolation, and awareness of the 2007 Act.

Conclusion A society is judged by how it treats its elders; family duty must be backed by public services.



DRAW IT: Ageing: from more elders to a care plan. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Care, Cash, Cover": care in the community, cash through pensions, cover for health.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confine the answer to the 2007 Act; examiners expect health, pension and social isolation as well.

GS1 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · Child marriage in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-B3

Q2. Explain why child marriage persists in India despite the law. What has Karnataka done to curb it? (150 words)

Model answer

Child marriage is marriage below 18 for girls and 21 for boys, banned by the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006. It persists because of the following causes.

Causes

- Poverty and dowry pressure, which make early marriage look cheaper.
- Social norms about honour, safety of girls and community pressure.
- Weak school access, especially after primary level, and poor job prospects for women.
- Under-reporting, as families, officials and priests often cooperate.

Consequences: early pregnancy, anaemia, lost schooling, domestic violence and an inter-generational cycle of poverty.

Karnataka's response

- Child marriage prevention officers act on complaints and helplines.
- During 2025-26 till December, the State received 3005 complaints, prevented 2360 marriages and registered FIRs in 645 cases.
- Girl-child schemes such as Bhagyalakshmi encourage birth and schooling.

Way forward: free secondary schooling, scholarships, community watch and prompt conviction.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Poor, Pressure, Pregnancy": poverty and social pressure cause marriage, and harm begins with early pregnancy.

COMMON TRAP: Do not state that the law alone ends the practice; discuss the social causes and the school and livelihood remedies.

GS1 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Shankara, Ramanuja and Madhva

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q3. Compare the philosophical positions of Shankaracharya, Ramanujacharya and Madhvacharya. How did their teachings and institutions influence Karnataka? (250 words)

Model answer

The three acharyas interpreted the Upanishads, the Bhagavad Gita and the Brahma Sutras differently, and each school took root in Karnataka.

Shankara (c. 8th century): Advaita

- Brahman alone is real; the world is maya, and the individual self is identical with Brahman.
- Knowledge (jnana) removes ignorance and leads to liberation.
- He founded four mathas; the Sharada Peetha at Sringeri in Karnataka is among them.

Ramanuja (11th-12th century): Vishishtadvaita

- Brahman is real with the world and souls as its body; the soul is distinct but dependent.
- Devotion (bhakti) and surrender (prapatti) lead to liberation.
- He lived for years in Melkote in Karnataka, where the Cheluvanarayana temple became a Vaishnava centre, under the patronage of the Hoysala king Vishnuvardhana.

Madhva (13th century): Dvaita

- God, souls and matter are eternally distinct, and God is supreme.
- Grace of Vishnu and devotion lead to salvation; the five eternal differences form the core.
- Born near Udupi, he founded the Udupi Krishna temple and eight mathas, which continue a tradition of worship and free feeding.

Influence

- Philosophical debate encouraged commentary, sacred centres and education in Sanskrit.
- Later, the Haridasa devotional movement spread Dvaita ideas in Kannada, through the songs of Purandaradasa and Kanakadasa.
- The mathas gave shelter to scholars, supported literature and were patronised by Vijayanagara rulers.

Conclusion Together the three schools show unity and diversity in Indian thought, and Karnataka kept all three alive.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "One, One-with-many, Two": Advaita, Vishishtadvaita and Dvaita.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix up the three schools' ideas of the soul; Shankara denies difference, Ramanuja qualifies it and Madhva insists on it.

GS1 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · Kannada associations and identity

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q4. Examine the role of Kannada literary and cultural associations in awakening a sense of Karnataka identity before 1956. (150 words)

Model answer

Kannada speakers lived in five administrative units, and cultural bodies gave them a common voice before any political demand arose.

Major bodies

- The Vidyavardhaka Sangha of Dharwad, founded in 1890, promoted Kannada education and research.
- Alur Venkata Rao's Karnataka Gatha Vaibhava (1912) recalled the glory of Vijayanagara and the Kannada past, inspiring a generation to seek unity.
- The Kannada Sahitya Parishat, Bengaluru (1915), standardised the language, published old texts and held literary conferences.

Impact

- A shared past created a shared identity, and writers called for one Karnataka (Karnataka Ekikarana).
- The 1924 Belgaum Congress session, where Gandhi presided, took forward the demand for linguistic provinces.
- After 1947, the States Reorganisation Commission and the Act of 1956 created the Mysore State, renamed Karnataka in 1973.

Limitation: the movement was led by middle-class Kannadigas, and Kannada in the Hyderabad area developed more slowly.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Sangha, Gatha, Parishat": 1890, 1912, 1915.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that the Parishat was set up to demand unification; its purpose was literary, and the political demand grew afterwards.

GS1 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Quit India in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. Describe the Quit India Movement of 1942 in Karnataka. Why did it take a militant form in some regions? (250 words)

Model answer

The All India Congress Committee passed the Quit India resolution on 8 August 1942, and Gandhi's call was "Do or die". Leaders were arrested the next day, leaving the movement to local workers.

In Karnataka

- Resistance was strongest in the Bombay Karnataka districts of Dharwad and Belgaum, where students, labourers and Congress workers held processions, boycotted schools and courts, and cut telegraph wires and railway lines.
- Underground groups published bulletins and organised parallel government in some villages, while women and students carried messages and hid workers.
- At Ishur (Isuru), Shivamogga, in the princely State of Mysore, villagers declared self-rule and clashed with the State's revenue and police officials, two of whom were killed. Five villagers were later hanged and many imprisoned.

- Martyrs include Mailar Mahadevappa, with Tirakappa Madiwalar and Veerappa Kamatar, shot at Hosaritti on 1 April 1943.

Why militant

- Gandhi's imprisonment and lack of central direction led local groups to use sabotage.
- Dharwad and Belgaum had strong Congress and Seva Dal networks and a tradition of mobilisation from earlier movements.
- Economic hardship from war-time prices hit peasants and workers.
- Princely States such as Mysore were less open to Congress work, so protest came as local revolts.

Significance It increased Karnataka's contribution to the freedom struggle and strengthened the demand for unification of Kannada-speaking regions. The sacrifices at Ishur and Hosaritti remain local memories of resistance, and later gave moral weight to the demand for a united State.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Dharwad, Belgaum, Ishur": the three Karnataka centres.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe the movement in Karnataka as non-violent throughout; there was sabotage and, at Ishur, a village revolt.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Quit India resolution 8 August 1942.

GS1: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, The dominant caste.

GS1 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · The dominant caste

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q6. Explain M.N. Srinivas's concept of the dominant caste. How does it help in understanding rural power in Karnataka? (150 words)

Model answer

M.N. Srinivas used the term in his study of Rampura village in Karnataka, published in 1959. A caste is dominant in a village when it has numerical strength and holds a large share of local land, and other castes depend on it.

Features

- Large numbers and ownership of land.
- Political power through village councils and links with officials.
- High place in the local ranking, often supported by Western education and jobs.
- Ritual rank alone is not enough; a middle-ranking caste can dominate.

Karnataka

- In the old Mysore State, Vokkaligas and Lingayats held land and dominated politics, which shaped patronage and elections.
- Land reforms, panchayats and reservation have created new leaders from other castes.

Value and limits

- It shows that power depends on land and numbers, not rituals alone.
- But dominance is now regional and fluid, and class, education and party matter more.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Numbers, Land, Power": the three marks of dominance.

COMMON TRAP: Do not equate the dominant caste with the highest caste; Srinivas stressed that it need not be ritually highest.

GS1 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Rural-urban migration

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q7. Examine why people leave villages for towns in India and what follows. What policies can make migration safer and more productive? (250 words)

Model answer

Migration means a change of usual residence. The 2011 Census counted about 45 crore migrants by place of last residence, around 37 per cent of the population. Most were women moving for marriage, but male migration is mainly for work.

Causes

- Push: farm distress, debt, landlessness, drought, shrinking holdings and low rural wages.
- Pull: jobs in construction, services, factories and domestic work; better schools and health care; social networks.
- Seasonal migration is common from drought-prone and tribal regions, often in debt-bonded gangs to brick kilns and sugarcane fields.

Consequences

- Positive: remittances raise rural consumption; cities gain labour; migrants gain skills and exposure.
- Negative: crowded slums and pressure on housing and water; informal and unsafe work; loss of rights to ration, voting and schooling; family strain and ageing of villages. The 2020 lockdown revealed their insecurity.

Policies

- Portability of benefits, through One Nation One Ration Card and the e-Shram portal.
- Affordable rental housing and hostels near work sites.
- Registration of contractors, safety and minimum wages.
- Rural non-farm jobs and skills to make migration a choice, not distress.
- Inter-State coordination, school admission for migrants' children and health cards that work across States.

Conclusion Migration drives growth, but only portable rights and decent work will make it fair.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Push, Pull, Port": push factors, pull factors and portability of rights.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat migration as only a city problem; remittances and village ageing are equally relevant.

GS1 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Rainfall departure data

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q8. Interpret the following fictional rainfall data for five districts in a monsoon season. Compute the percentage departure from normal for each district, classify it using the IMD scheme, and explain why the simple average of the departures can mislead. **Data (fictional):** Normal and actual rainfall (mm): District A 800 and 960; B 1,200 and 1,056; C 500 and 340; D 2,000 and 2,300; E 650 and 195. (150 words)

Model answer

Departure from normal = (Actual - Normal) / Normal x 100.

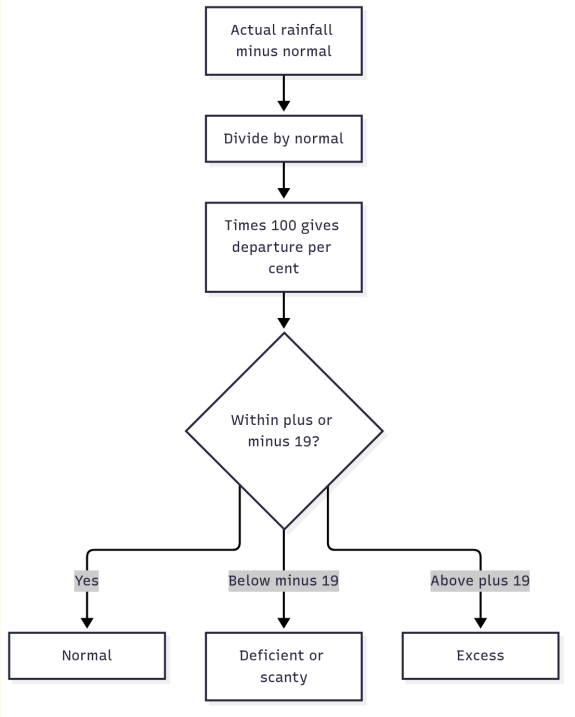
District	Departure	IMD category
A	+20%	Excess (20% to 59% above)
B	-12%	Normal (within 19%)
C	-32%	Deficient (20% to 59% below)
D	+15%	Normal
E	-70%	Large deficient (60% or more below)

Totals: normal rainfall is 5,150 mm and actual rainfall is 4,851 mm, so the combined departure is -299 / 5,150, about **-5.8%**, which is normal for the group.

Simple average: (20 - 12 - 32 + 15 - 70) / 5 = **-15.8%**, which would wrongly suggest deficiency. The mean treats each district equally, although D received far more water than E.

Reading

- Region-wide totals hide E's severe drought.
- Planners should treat C and E for relief and look at rainfall distribution, not just the total.



DRAW IT: Reading rainfall departure data. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Actual minus Normal, over Normal": the departure formula.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not average percentages directly; weight by the base (normal rainfall) or use totals.

GS1 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Buddhism and Jainism in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q9. Discuss the contribution of Buddhism and Jainism to the culture of Karnataka. Refer to Shravanabelagola and the Ashokan sites. (250 words)

Model answer

Both faiths reached Karnataka early and shaped its art, literature and values of non-violence and equality.

Jainism

- Tradition links Bhadrabahu and Chandragupta Maurya with Shravanabelagola in the 3rd century BCE, which made it a Jain centre.
- Under the Ganga kings, the commander Chavundaraya had the 57-foot monolithic statue of Gommateshwara (Bahubali) carved on Vindhyagiri, completed in 981 CE.
- The Mahamastakabhisheka, held about every twelve years, was last held in February 2018, with the next scheduled for 2030.
- Jain patrons supported Kannada literature: Pampa's Adipurana, and the works of Ranna and Ponna, show devotion and epic form.
- Basadis such as those at Lakkundi, Aihole and Shravanabelagola show Jain architecture and iconography.

Buddhism

- Ashoka's inscriptions at Maski, Brahmagiri and Siddapura show Mauryan rule and the spread of dhamma.
- Sannati-Kanaganahalli in Kalaburagi has a Buddhist stupa and Ashokan sculpture.
- Monastic and rock-cut traditions flourished in the Deccan, and Buddhist ideas of compassion shaped the early Kannada ethical vocabulary.

Legacy

- The Hoysala and Chalukya periods saw sculpture shaped by Jain forms.
- The faiths promoted vernacular languages, monastic education and tolerance, and their monasteries served as early centres of learning and medicine for the community.

Conclusion Together they gave Karnataka some of its finest monuments and its earliest Kannada classics.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Statue, Stupa, Scripts": Gommateshwara, Sannati and Ashokan inscriptions.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not state that Mahamastakabhisheka happens every year; it is about every twelve years, the latest in 2018.

GS1 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana

PREDICTED · GS1-C6 · Current affairs

Q10. Explain the objectives and design of the PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana. How is it different from earlier schemes? (150 words)

Model answer

The Union Cabinet approved the PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana on 16 July 2025. It is a six-year programme from 2025-26, with an annual outlay of Rs 24,000 crore, for 100 low-performing agricultural districts.

Objectives

- Raise productivity and crop diversification, and promote sustainable farming.
- Improve irrigation, storage at panchayat and block levels and credit access.

Design

- Districts are chosen on low productivity, low cropping intensity and low credit disbursement, and every State and Union Territory gets at least one.
- It brings together 36 existing central schemes across 11 ministries, together with State schemes and partnerships with the private sector.
- District plans are made locally, with progress tracked on a dashboard.

Difference Earlier schemes were scheme-wise and uniform; this approach is area-based, aspirational and converges funds on lagging districts.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "100, 36, 11": districts, schemes and ministries.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call it a new fund for farmers; it is a convergence scheme for lagging districts.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana approved 16 July 2025; six years from 2025-26; Rs 24,000 crore a year; 100 districts; 36 schemes across 11 ministries (PIB).

GS1: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Irrigation potential and PMKSY.

GS1 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Irrigation potential and PMKSY

PREDICTED · GS1-C6

Q11. Discuss the status of irrigation development in Karnataka and the role of the Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY). What are the major challenges? (250 words)

Model answer

Irrigation reduces dependence on the monsoon, and Karnataka, with its large dryland area, relies on both major projects and groundwater.

Status

- According to the Economic Survey, the ultimate irrigation potential under major and medium projects is estimated at 42.08 lakh hectares. As on December 2025, 30.92 lakh hectares had been created, leaving 11.16 lakh hectares.
- The State uses conventional flow, lift and drip irrigation, and a large share of irrigated area depends on borewells.

PMKSY

- Launched in 2015 with the motto Har Khet Ko Pani, it combines the Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme, watershed development and "Per Drop More Crop" on micro-irrigation.
- It funds the completion of ongoing projects and the efficient use of water at the farm level.

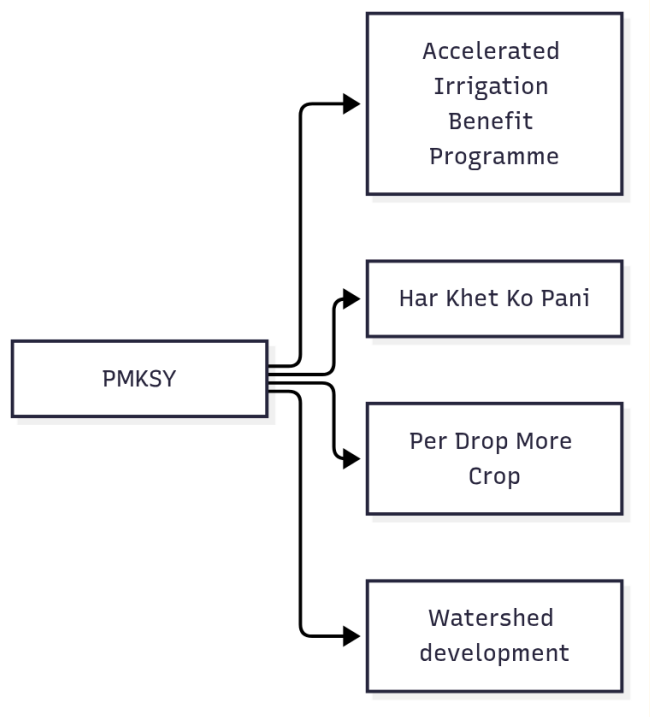
Challenges

- Delayed projects and cost overrun; land acquisition and rehabilitation.
- Gap between potential created and actually used, because canals are not maintained.
- Inter-State water disputes and the limits of the allocation.
- Groundwater depletion and low water-use efficiency.
- Tail-end farmers get little water.

Way forward

- Complete projects in priority order and modernise canals.
- Expand drip and sprinklers, form water user associations and use sensors for water accounting.

Conclusion More than building new capacity, Karnataka needs to use the existing capacity well.



DRAW IT: PMKSY components. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Create, Convey, Conserve": make potential, carry water to the field, save it by micro-irrigation.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mistake irrigation potential created for area actually irrigated; the two differ.

GS1 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Kavirajamarga, Pampa and Ranna

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q12. Discuss the importance of the Kavirajamarga in the history of Kannada literature. How did Pampa and Ranna advance the tradition? (150 words)

Model answer

The Kavirajamarga, attributed to Sri Vijaya during the reign of the Rashtrakuta king Amoghavarsha I (c. 850 CE), is the oldest surviving treatise on Kannada poetics.

Importance

- It discusses figures of speech and styles, and defines the extent of the Kannada country between the Kaveri and the Godavari.
- It shows that Kannada was already a cultivated literary language, with earlier poets whose works are lost.
- It praises the speech of the common people.

Pampa

- Called the Adikavi, he wrote Adipurana and Vikramarjuna Vijaya (Pampa Bharata) in the mid-10th century, in the champu style, linking Jain faith with the Mahabharata story.

Ranna

- Court poet of the Western Chalukya king Tailapa II, he wrote Gadayuddha (Sahasabhimavijaya) and Ajitapurana.

- With Pampa and Ponna he forms the "three gems" of Kannada.

Legacy: Their work set standards for later Kannada prose and verse.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Marga, Pampa, Ranna": the guide, the first great poet and the successor.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call Kavirajamarga the first Kannada text; it is the earliest surviving work, and it refers to earlier writers.

GS1 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · PMAY-G and SVAMITVA

PREDICTED · GS1-C7 · Current affairs

Q13. Examine the contribution of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin and the SVAMITVA scheme to rural development. What challenges remain? (250 words)

Model answer

Secure housing and clear property rights are basic to rural well-being and credit.

PMAY-Gramin

- It provides assistance for pucca houses to rural families who lack them. The second phase, approved for April 2024 to March 2029, targets 2 crore additional houses, with an outlay of Rs 3,06,137 crore.
- By August 2026, 97.48 lakh of the 1.22 crore houses allocated in Phase II had been sanctioned, and overall 3.91 crore houses sanctioned and 3.12 crore completed.
- Beneficiaries are selected through the Socio-Economic and Caste Census and Awaas Plus; payments go through DBT, with convergence with toilets, MGNREGA work days and electricity.

SVAMITVA

- Launched on 24 April 2020, it uses drone mapping to survey inhabited village land and issue property cards to owners.
- By August 2026, drone surveys covered 3.30 lakh villages; 3.24 crore property cards had been prepared and 2.72 crore distributed.
- Property cards give legal proof of ownership, help access to bank credit and reduce disputes; panchayats can improve own-source revenue by tax mapping.

Challenges

- Delay in releases, quality of houses and shortage of masons and land for landless families.
- Cards not accepted by banks, women's names missing and record updating.
- State-level differences in laws on rural land.

Conclusion Housing and land titles together give security, but they must be implemented with women's rights and transparency.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Roof and Record": PMAY-G gives the roof, SVAMITVA gives the record.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mix up the two figures; PMAY-G counts houses, while SVAMITVA counts villages and property cards.

GS1 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · KRRS and the farmers' movement

PREDICTED · GS1-B2

Q14. Trace the rise of farmers' movements in Karnataka, with reference to the Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha and the Nargund-Navalgund agitation. (150 words)

Model answer

Farmers' movements in Karnataka grew from discontent with prices, levies and State policy after the Green Revolution.

Nargund-Navalgund (1980)

- Farmers in Dharwad district protested the betterment levy on irrigation water and the State's collection methods. The agitation ended in police firing and deaths, which turned the countryside against the Government.

Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha (KRRS)

- Led by Professor M.D. Nanjundaswamy, it organised farmers around remunerative prices, cheaper inputs, loan waivers and freedom from debt recovery.
- It also resisted multinational seed companies and fast-food chains, linking local issues to global trade.

Features

- Mostly middle peasants from irrigated areas; non-party in form but political in effect.
- Use of rallies, road blockades and "dharna" before offices.

Significance The movements put farm prices and debt in State politics; they later joined the national struggle against the 2020 farm laws, repealed in 2021.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Levy, Leader, Law": levy at Nargund, leader Nanjundaswamy, laws of 2020.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe KRRS as a party; it is a farmers' organisation and its demands were mainly economic.

GS1 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Collegium and NJAC

PREDICTED · GS1-B4

Q15. Trace the evolution of the collegium system for appointing judges. Why was the National Judicial Appointments Commission struck down, and what reforms are needed? (250 words)

Model answer

Articles 124 and 217 say High Court and Supreme Court judges are appointed by the President "after consultation" with the judiciary. The practice has changed with judicial interpretation.

Evolution

- First Judges Case (1981): the Chief Justice's recommendation was held to be only consultative, so the executive had the last word.
- Second Judges Case (1993): "consultation" came to mean concurrence, and the Chief Justice with two senior judges decided appointments, giving primacy to the judiciary.
- Third Judges Case (1998): a Presidential reference expanded the Supreme Court collegium to the Chief Justice and four senior-most judges.

NJAC

- The 99th Constitutional Amendment and NJAC Act of 2014 created a six-member commission: the Chief Justice, two senior judges, the Law Minister and two eminent persons.
- On 16 October 2015, a five-judge bench struck it down by a 4:1 majority, holding that judicial independence belongs to the Constitution's basic structure and that the executive role was too strong.

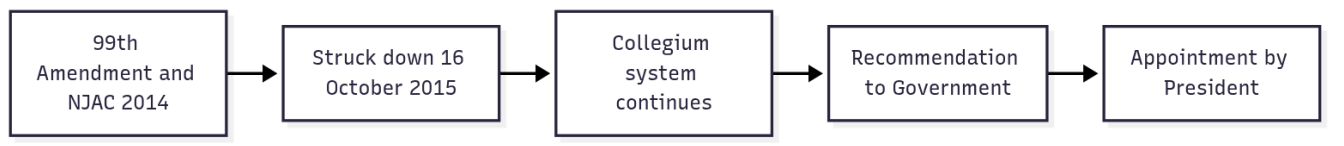
Criticisms of the collegium

- Opaque, with no stated criteria; family and regional imbalance.
- Delay and vacancies, little diversity of women and marginalised groups.

Reforms

- A transparent Memorandum of Procedure, a permanent secretariat, published reasons for choice, and clear criteria.
- A balanced body with the judiciary retaining primacy.

Conclusion Independence and accountability must be balanced, and transparency is the first step.



DRAW IT: How judges are appointed after 2015. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "1-2-3": the three Judges Cases of 1981, 1993 and 1998.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the 2015 judgment restored executive primacy; it restored the collegium, with the Court asking for improvement.

PEAK FACT: Judges Cases 1981, 1993, 1998; NJAC Act 2014; 99th Amendment struck down on 16 October 2015 (4:1).

GS1: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, India-UK and India-EU trade deals.

GS1 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · India-UK and India-EU trade deals

PREDICTED · GS1-C2 · Current affairs

Q16. Discuss the significance of the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement and the proposed India-EU free trade agreement for India's economy. (150 words)

Model answer

India has moved from caution to selective trade deals with large advanced markets, to secure market access and attract investment.

India-UK CETA

- Signed on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026, it cuts tariffs on most goods, giving gains to labour-intensive exports such as textiles, leather and gems.
- It improves access to services and mobility of professionals.

India-EU FTA

- Negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026. It has not yet been signed or ratified; signing is targeted for December 2026, with entry into force expected in 2027 after EU and Indian approval.

Significance

- Diversifies exports at a time of tariff pressure from other partners.
- Brings supply-chain links and technology.

Concerns

- Competition for dairy and farm products, carbon-border rules, standards and non-tariff barriers.
- Need to improve competitiveness and logistics.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "UK in, EU next": the British deal is in force; the European deal awaits ratification.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe the EU deal as in force; it has been concluded but is awaiting signature and approvals.

GS1 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Poverty and multidimensional poverty

PREDICTED · GS1-C1

Q17. How is poverty measured in India? Discuss the trends in multidimensional poverty and the role of public policy in reducing it. (250 words)

Model answer

Poverty is the lack of resources to meet basic needs. India has measured it by income and consumption, and now also by non-income deprivation.

Methods

- Planning Commission poverty lines based on calorie and consumption norms; the Tendulkar Committee estimated 21.9 per cent poverty in 2011-12, and the Rangarajan Committee estimated a higher figure.
- The global Multidimensional Poverty Index looks at health, education and standard of living, and NITI Aayog has adapted it with 12 indicators, including nutrition, schooling, sanitation, cooking fuel, housing and bank accounts.

Trends

- NITI Aayog's discussion paper reports that India's multidimensional poverty headcount ratio fell from 29.17 per cent in 2013-14 to 11.28 per cent in 2022-23, with 24.82 crore people moving out.
- Karnataka's rate fell from 12.77 per cent in 2015-16 to 7.58 per cent in 2019-21, according to the national index.

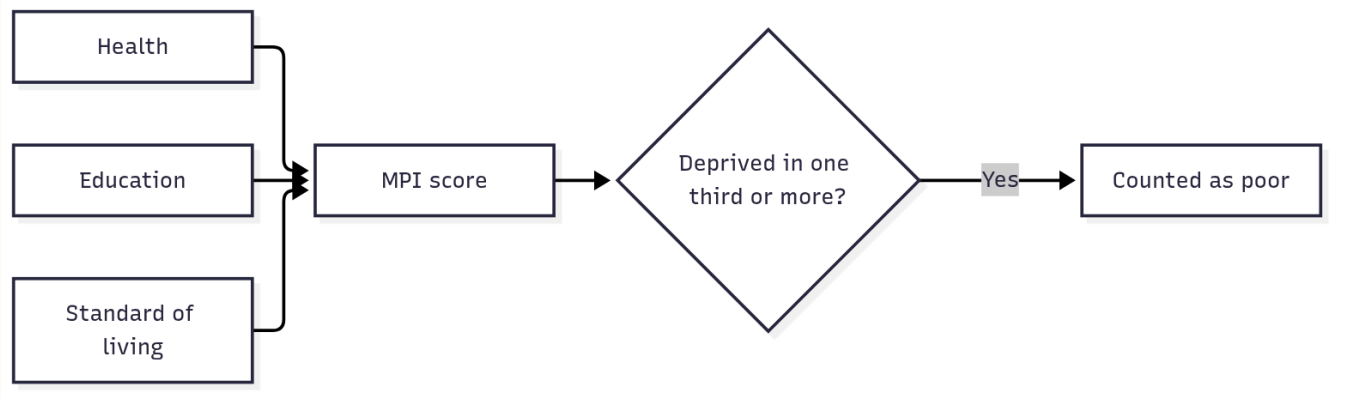
Role of policy

- Public delivery of toilets, cooking gas, housing, electricity and bank accounts addressed living standards.
- Food security, nutrition and school programmes addressed health and education.

Limitations

- The index does not capture income or inequality.
- Rural-urban and social-group gaps and vulnerability to shocks remain.

Way forward Link jobs and skills with basic services, and target the left-behind districts.



DRAW IT: Multidimensional poverty in three boxes. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Health, Learning, Living": the three dimensions of the index.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the multidimensional index replaced the income-based poverty line; they measure different things.

GS1 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Karnataka's fiscal position

PREDICTED · GS1-C5

Q18. Analyse Karnataka's fiscal position in the Budget for 2026-27, with reference to deficits and the guarantee schemes. (150 words)

Model answer

A State's fiscal health is judged by its deficits, borrowing and the quality of its spending.

Key indicators (PRS)

- The fiscal deficit for 2026-27 is targeted at 2.9 per cent of GSDP (Rs 97,448 crore), against 3 per cent in the revised figure for the year before.
- The revenue deficit is estimated at 0.7 per cent of GSDP (Rs 22,957 crore), lower than 0.8 per cent in the current year.
- The State estimates Rs 51,286 crore, 12 per cent of total expenditure, on its five guarantee schemes.

Assessment

- The deficit is below the 3 per cent ceiling but a revenue deficit means borrowing for current spending.
- Guarantee schemes support women and the poor and raise demand, but they crowd out capital spending.
- Tax devolution and cess, and a growing economy, will decide sustainability.

Way forward: improve own tax revenue, protect capital outlay, and target subsidies.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "2.9, 0.7, 12": fiscal deficit, revenue deficit and guarantee share.

COMMON TRAP: Do not quote the revised estimate for 2025-26 as the target for 2026-27; keep the years clear.

GS1 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · Vijayanagara and Hampi

PREDICTED · GS1-A4 · Karnataka-specific

Q19. Describe the administration, economy and culture of the Vijayanagara Empire. Why is Hampi a World Heritage Site? (250 words)

Model answer

The Vijayanagara Empire was founded in 1336 by Harihara I and Bukka I of the Sangama dynasty on the Tungabhadra. Four dynasties ruled: Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva and Aravidu. Krishnadevaraya (1509-1529) of the Tuluva dynasty was its greatest ruler.

Administration

- The king was assisted by ministers; the empire was divided into provinces, districts and villages.
- The nayankara system gave military chiefs, the nayakas, land grants (amaram) in return for troops and tribute.
- Local bodies and temples handled village affairs.

Economy

- Agriculture was helped by tanks and canals on the Tungabhadra.
- Trade through west coast ports such as Bhatkal and Mangalore brought horses and sold spices and cotton.
- Foreign travellers such as Abdur Razzaq, Domingo Paes and Nuniz noted its wealth.

Culture

- Patronage of Kannada, Telugu, Tamil and Sanskrit; Krishnadevaraya wrote Amuktamalyada in Telugu.
- The Vittala and Virupaksha temples, the Hazara Rama temple, stone chariot and the Lotus Mahal show Dravidian and Indo-Islamic fusion.
- Music and devotional movements such as the Haridasas flourished.

Decline: The defeat at Talikota in 1565 by the Deccan sultanates ended the empire's glory.

Hampi UNESCO inscribed it in 1986 as an exceptional record of a lost civilisation, with temples, markets, water works and royal buildings in a boulder landscape.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Four dynasties, Nayaks, 1565": the empire's frame in three hooks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say Vijayanagara fell at Panipat or to the Mughals; the Deccan sultanates defeated it at Talikota in 1565.

GS1 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Special Economic Zones

PREDICTED · GS1-C3 · Karnataka-specific

Q20. Evaluate the performance of Special Economic Zones in India, with reference to Karnataka. What reforms are needed? (150 words)

Model answer

Special Economic Zones (SEZs) are duty-free enclaves treated as foreign territory for trade, set up under the SEZ Act, 2005 to promote exports, investment and jobs.

Karnataka

- The State Survey for the year records 38 operational SEZs in the State, with investment of Rs 23,331 crore, employing 4,25,696 persons by December 2025, with 396 units working.
- The zones are concentrated in information technology, aerospace and port-based activity, such as at Mangaluru.

Performance and criticism

- They created export capacity and urban employment, but many zones lie idle.
- Tax concessions caused revenue loss; land acquisition displaced farmers.
- Many units merely shifted from existing sites, so net additional output is doubtful.

Reforms

- Align SEZs with industrial corridors and the manufacturing push, and with the sunset clause on tax benefits.
- Make land use transparent, and tie incentives to jobs and value added.

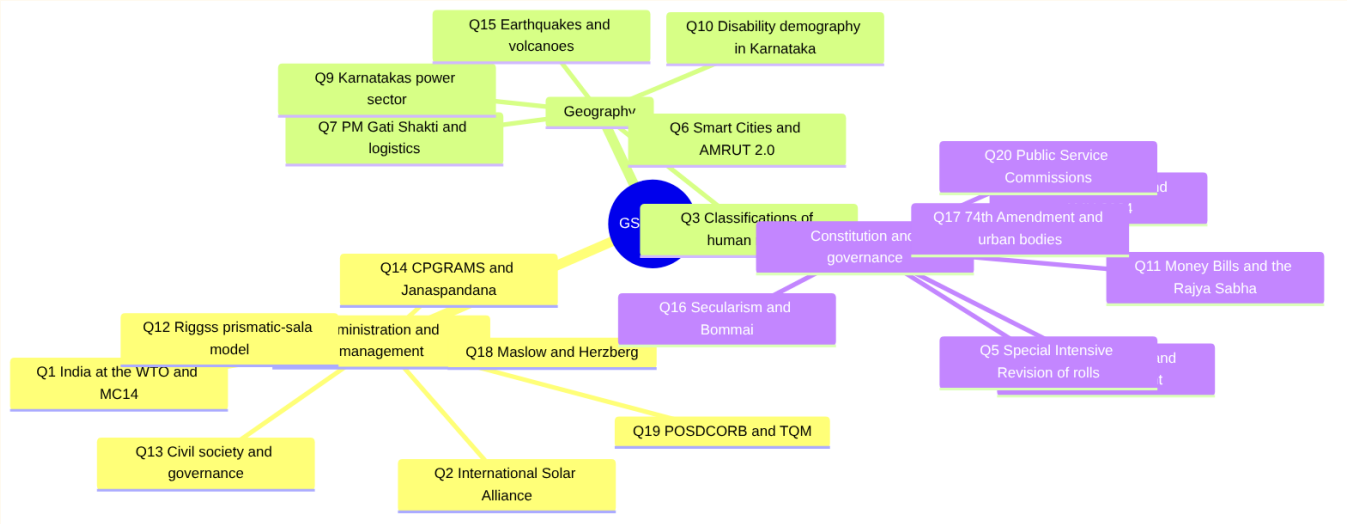
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "38, 396": zones and units.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat SEZs as only a Karnataka matter; link the figure with the national policy and its criticisms.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Karnataka 38 operational SEZs, investment Rs 23,331 crore, 4,25,696 persons employed, 396 units.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 India-UK and India-EU trade deals:** "UK in, EU next": the British deal is in force; the European deal awaits ratification. **Q17 Poverty and multidimensional poverty:** "Health, Learning, Living": the three dimensions of the index. **Q18 Karnataka's fiscal position:** "2.9, 0.7, 12": fiscal deficit, revenue deficit and guarantee share. **Q19 Vijayanagara and Hampi:** "Four dynasties, Nayaks, 1565": the empire's frame in three hooks. **Q20 Special Economic Zones:** "38, 396": zones and units.

Paper 3: General Studies II (GS2)

Set 3: step 4 of 6 (General Studies II (GS2)). Next up: General Studies III (GS3)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Polity and administration here test procedure: Money Bills, the 74th Amendment, Public Service Commissions and electoral rolls. Geography and world questions mix earthquakes, races and the WTO with Karnataka's power and towns.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS2 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · India at the WTO and MC14

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q1. Discuss India's concerns and negotiating positions at the World Trade Organization, with reference to the 14th Ministerial Conference held in Yaounde in March 2026. (250 words)

Model answer

The World Trade Organization (WTO) sets multilateral trade rules and settles disputes. For India, with 40 per cent of its workforce on farms, the key issue is that rules should not restrict food security and policy space.

India's concerns

- Public stockholding: subsidised grain procurement for the poor is counted against agricultural subsidy limits. Since the Bali Conference of 2013, members have promised a permanent solution but have only extended an interim "peace clause".
- Special Safeguard Mechanism: developing countries want a tool to guard farmers against import surges.
- Subsidy asymmetry: rich countries give large, unlimited support to farmers while developing countries are capped.
- Dispute settlement: the Appellate Body has been non-functional since December 2019, so rulings can be blocked.
- E-commerce moratorium: India opposes a long ban on customs duties on electronic transmissions, to preserve revenue and digital policy space.

MC14, Yaounde (26-30 March 2026)

- It ended without an agriculture package; India's demand for a permanent stockholding solution and a safeguard mechanism went unresolved.
- The e-commerce duty moratorium lapsed on 30 March 2026 without an extension; talks continue in Geneva.

Assessment

- India's stand protects farmers, but repeated deadlock weakens the WTO and pushes countries to bilateral deals, such as the agreements with the United Kingdom and the European Union.

Way forward India should keep building coalitions of developing countries, press for dispute settlement reform and use bilateral deals as supplements, not replacements.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PSH, SSM, AB": stockholding, safeguard mechanism, Appellate Body.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not state that MC14 produced a stockholding deal; it ended without an agriculture agreement.

GS2 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · International Solar Alliance

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q2. What is the International Solar Alliance? Discuss its objectives, structure and significance for India's foreign policy. (150 words)

Model answer

The International Solar Alliance (ISA) is a treaty-based intergovernmental organisation of sun-rich countries between the Tropics of Cancer and Capricorn, with other countries also allowed to join. India and France launched it on 30 November 2015 at COP21, Paris.

Objectives

- To raise solar energy use and mobilise large-scale finance and technology, aiming for about one trillion dollars of investment by 2030.
- To cut costs through joint buying and standards.

Structure

- The Framework Agreement of 2016 made it a treaty body with an Assembly of members; its secretariat is at Gurugram, Haryana.
- Its "One Sun, One World, One Grid" programme seeks cross-border power links.

Significance for India

- Shows leadership in climate diplomacy and the Global South.
- Supports energy security and supply-chain links.
- Opens markets for Indian firms and links with Africa.

Challenges: Finance, project readiness and dependence on imported panels.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Sun-belt, Paris, Gurugram": members, birth place, home office.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe the ISA as a UN agency; it is an independent treaty-based organisation created on India's initiative.

GS2 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Classifications of human races

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q3. Explain the major classifications of human races. Why is the biological concept of race rejected by modern science? (250 words)

Model answer

Race is a group of people said to share inherited physical traits such as skin colour, hair form, head shape and stature. Classification began in the 18th century with European travellers and scientists.

Major classifications

- Kroeber and others use three broad stocks: Caucasoid, Mongoloid and Negroid, with small groups such as Australoid placed separately.
- Griffith Taylor (1919) proposed "zones and strata", in which the oldest groups were pushed to the margins of the continents by newer groups moving outward from Central Asia.
- Haddon (1924) listed Caucasoid, Mongoloid and Negroid with subtypes, using hair form and skin colour.
- In India, Risley (1901) described seven types, such as Indo-Aryan and Mongoloid, and B.S. Guha (1935) six, but both mixed biology with caste.

Why the concept is rejected

- Human beings are genetically more than 99 per cent similar, and most variation lies within, not between, groups.
- Traits vary gradually (clines); there are no sharp boundaries, and continuous migration and mixing have blurred them.
- Different traits give different "races", so classification is arbitrary.
- The UNESCO statements on race (1950 and 1951) declared that race is a social myth, not a biological category, and that all human beings belong to one species.
- Racial theory was misused for slavery, colonialism and Nazi persecution.

Conclusion Variation among humans is real but cultural and social identity, not race, should guide study. Modern geography speaks of ethnic and cultural groups.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "C-M-N, Taylor, Haddon": the main stocks, then the two classifiers.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that races differ in ability; science shows no basis, and this would score nothing.

GS2 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · NHRC powers and 2019 amendment

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q4. Examine the powers and limitations of the National Human Rights Commission. How have recent amendments changed its composition? (150 words)

Model answer

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) is a statutory body under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, set up to protect rights guaranteed by the Constitution or by international covenants enforceable in India.

Powers

- Inquires into violations, suo motu or on petition, with civil-court powers.
- Visits prisons, reviews safeguards and promotes awareness.
- May intervene in court cases.

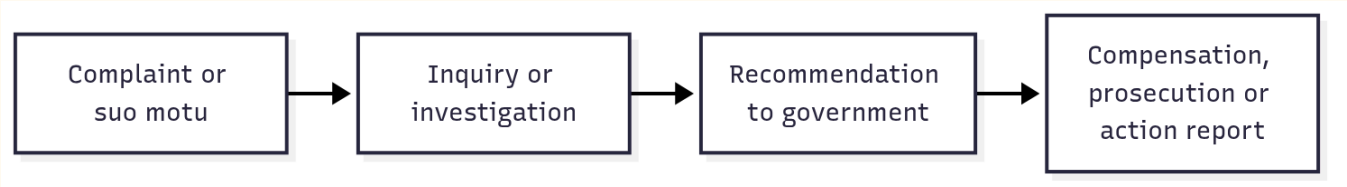
Limitations

- Its recommendations are not binding.
- It cannot ordinarily inquire into a matter more than one year old.
- Its role in complaints against the armed forces is limited to seeking a report.
- Dependence on government investigators.

2019 amendment

- The Chairperson may be a former Chief Justice or any former Supreme Court judge.
- Human-rights members rose from two to three, with at least one woman.
- Terms were reduced from five to three years, with reappointment allowed.

State level: Karnataka has its own State Human Rights Commission under the same Act.



DRAW IT: NHRC complaint path. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Inquire, Inspect, Inform": the three tools of the Commission.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the NHRC can punish; it can only recommend action and approach courts.

GS2 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Special Intensive Revision of rolls

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q5. Examine the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. What are the arguments for and against it? (250 words)

Model answer

Article 324 entrusts the poll body, the ECI (Election Commission of India), with superintendence, direction and control over the preparation of electoral rolls. Under the Representation of the People Act, 1950, rolls are revised periodically. A Special Intensive Revision (SIR) is a house-to-house re-verification, in which electors fill a form and may need documents, and not a summary update.

Progress

- In Bihar, the final roll was published on 30 September 2025 with about 7.42 crore electors, against 7.89 crore before the exercise.
- The ECI then carried SIR to other States and Union Territories in phases, and challenges are being heard in the Supreme Court.

Arguments for

- Rolls had not been intensively revised for many years, with duplicates, dead and shifted voters.
- A clean roll protects the principle of "one person, one vote" and the legitimacy of elections.
- Only citizens can vote under Article 326.

Arguments against

- Documentation burden may exclude the poor, migrants, women and those without papers.
- Citizenship verification is not the task of the ECI under the Act, and deletions without notice may violate natural justice.

- Short timelines and the load on booth-level officers.

Way forward

- Publish deletion lists with reasons, allow claims by easy methods, use data matching with safeguards, and hold independent audits.

Conclusion Roll cleaning is necessary, but a legitimate process needs inclusion, transparency and due process.



DRAW IT: Special Intensive Revision of rolls. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Verify, Notify, Include": the ECI must verify, give notice and keep people in.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe the exercise as a citizenship test; the roll is limited to eligible electors, and challenges concern process, not abolition.

PEAK FACT: Bihar SIR final roll 30 September 2025: about 7.42 crore electors from 7.89 crore (PIB); later phases in other States; Supreme Court hearings continue (Indian Express; Tribune).

GS2: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Smart Cities and AMRUT 2.0.

GS2 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Smart Cities and AMRUT 2.0

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q6. Evaluate the Smart Cities Mission and AMRUT 2.0 as tools of urban renewal in Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Indian towns hold nearly a third of the population but their civic services are weak. Two central missions target this.

Smart Cities Mission (2015)

- It selected 100 cities for area-based development and pan-city technology, through special purpose vehicles. Karnataka had seven selected cities, including Mangaluru, Belagavi and Hubballi-Dharwad.
- Gains: command centres, mobility, and public spaces. Criticisms: small area focus, weak municipal involvement and delays.

AMRUT 2.0 (2021)

- It aims at universal water supply and sewerage in towns.
- The Economic Survey notes that under AMRUT 2.0, 616 projects have been approved at a total cost of Rs.10,258.46 crore in Karnataka.

Assessment

- Both missions improved assets, but town governments lack funds and staff to run them.

Way forward: strengthen municipal finance, integrate planning with the 74th Amendment bodies, and fund operation and maintenance.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Smart is Spot, AMRUT is Pipe": the Smart Cities Mission works in a spot, AMRUT lays pipes across the town.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call the Smart Cities Mission a city-wide programme; it was mostly area-based.

GS2 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · PM Gati Shakti and logistics

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q7. Explain the aims of the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan and the National Logistics Policy. How do they address the infrastructure gap, and what challenges remain? (250 words)

Model answer

Slow movement of goods raises costs and weakens exports. India's logistics costs have been estimated at a much higher share of output than in advanced economies, because of poor links between modes and delays at ports and borders.

PM Gati Shakti (13 October 2021)

- A digital platform that maps all major infrastructure and land use in one place, so that ministries plan together and avoid duplication.
- It rests on seven engines: roads, railways, ports, waterways, airports, mass transport and logistics infrastructure.
- It gives a single view of forest, utility and land constraints before projects begin.

National Logistics Policy (17 September 2022)

- It seeks to reduce logistics cost to global benchmarks, with a Unified Logistics Interface Platform to link digital systems, and the improvement of the ease of doing business and skills.
- States are encouraged to frame their own logistics policies.

Karnataka link The Economic Survey notes multimodal integration under PM Gati Shakti, with railways linked to highways, ports, airports and logistics hubs for its suburban rail and other projects.

Challenges

- Land acquisition and clearances.
- Poor first and last-mile links and the dominance of road transport.
- Fragmented data and different State rules.
- Skilled manpower in warehouses.

Conclusion Planning together can cut cost, if States, private operators and agencies share data and follow through.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "7 engines, 1 map": seven sectors, one platform.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse the two: Gati Shakti is a planning platform, and the Logistics Policy is a cost and process policy.

GS2 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Minority rights and AMU 2024

PREDICTED · GS2-B2

Q8. Explain the constitutional safeguards for minorities under Articles 29 and 30. How did the Supreme Court's 2024 decision on Aligarh Muslim University affect the debate? (150 words)

Model answer

Article 29 protects any section of citizens with a distinct language, script or culture, and bars denial of admission to State-aided institutions on grounds of religion, race, caste or language. Article 30(1) gives religious and linguistic minorities the right to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice.

Key points

- The right is not absolute; the State may regulate standards, not take away management.
- In T.M.A. Pai (2002) the Court held that minorities are identified State-wise, and aided institutions may be regulated more than unaided.
- Article 30(2) prevents discrimination in aid.

AMU decision (8 November 2024)

- A seven-judge Bench overruled Azeez Basha (1967) by 4:3, holding that creation by a statute does not by itself end minority character.
- It set tests of origin, purpose and administration and left AMU's status to a regular Bench.

Meaning: the test is now substance, not form.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "29 culture, 30 colleges": Article 29 protects culture, Article 30 education.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Court declared AMU a minority institution; it laid down tests and left that decision open.

GS2 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Karnataka's power sector

PREDICTED · GS2-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. Analyse the structure and challenges of Karnataka's power sector, using Economic Survey 2025-26 data on demand, supply and the finances of the distribution companies. (250 words)

Model answer

Reliable power underpins industry, farming and households. Karnataka's power sector has public generation, private and central supply, and five regional distribution companies (ESCOMs).

Supply and demand

- The public sector has hydel capacity of 3,681 MW and thermal capacity of 5,020 MW, and since 2024-25 a 370 MW gas plant.
- The Survey records a peak demand of 18,395 MW and a one-day maximum of 356.88 million units. Shortfalls are managed by short-term purchase and banking.

Finance of ESCOMs

- Total losses of the five ESCOMs were Rs 8,869.85 crore for 2024-25, and their cumulative loss stands at Rs 34,979.41 crore, with BESCOM the largest.
- Free power goes to irrigation pump sets up to 10 HP, 35.67 lakh in number as of December 2025, since 1 August 2008. The State reimburses the cost of this supply.

Challenges

- Subsidy burden, cumulative debt, and delayed payments to producers.
- Technical and commercial losses, theft, and ageing networks.
- Variable renewables in the grid needing storage.
- Dependence on coal and imports at peak demand.

Reforms

- Feeder separation and solar feeders for farm supply, smart meters, and tariffs that cover cost.
- Direct benefit transfer of subsidy, and professional management of distribution companies.

Conclusion Supply is no longer the main problem; a healthy distribution sector is.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Make, Move, Meter, Money": generate, transmit, meter and recover money.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not count the subsidy as the only cause of losses; discuss technical and commercial losses too.

GS2 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · Disability demography in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS2-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Analyse the demography of disability in Karnataka and the measures needed to include persons with disabilities in development. (150 words)

Model answer

Persons with disabilities are among the most excluded citizens, though inclusion is a constitutional duty under Article 41 and the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016.

Numbers

- As per Census 2011, the Economic Survey records 13,24,205 differently abled persons in Karnataka, counted under only seven notified disabilities.
- The Union Government notified 21 disabilities on 19 April 2017, so the real number is higher and the data are dated.

Challenges

- Poor access to buildings, transport and schools.
- Low employment and little early detection.
- Stigma, and difficulty in getting certificates.

Measures

- Reservation in jobs and education, and the Unique Disability ID.
- Barrier-free design, assistive devices, and inclusive education.
- Pensions and skill training.
- Census 2027 should use the wider list and updated data.

Way forward: update the count, combine health and welfare departments, and make public buildings accessible.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "7 to 21": the old Census list had seven disabilities, the 2016 Act lists twenty-one.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not quote the 2011 figure as today's number; it is dated and covers only seven categories.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Census 2011: 13,24,205 differently abled persons in Karnataka under seven notified disabilities; 21 notified on 19.04.2017.

GS2 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Money Bills and the Rajya Sabha

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q11. Explain the procedure for Money Bills and the powers of the Rajya Sabha over them. Discuss the controversy over the use of Money Bills, including the Aadhaar judgment. (250 words)

Model answer

Financial legislation needs special rules because the Lok Sabha, which represents the people directly, holds the nation's purse.

Money Bill

- Article 110 defines a Money Bill as one dealing only with matters such as taxes, borrowing, the Consolidated Fund and expenditure charged on it.
- It can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha, on the President's recommendation, and not in the Rajya Sabha.
- The Speaker's certificate that a Bill is a Money Bill is final (Article 110(3)).

Rajya Sabha's role (Article 109)

- It must return the Bill within 14 days with or without recommendations; the Lok Sabha may accept or reject them.
- If the Rajya Sabha does not return it within 14 days, the Bill is deemed passed. A Money Bill cannot be stopped, and there is no joint sitting for it.

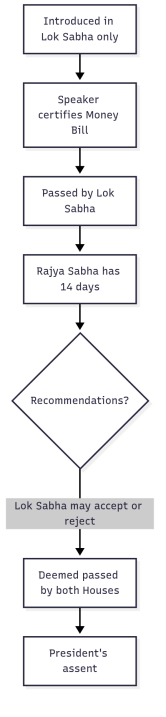
Controversy

- Governments have used the Money Bill route for laws with wider effect, as with the Aadhaar Act, 2016.
- In the 2018 Aadhaar judgment, a Constitution Bench upheld the Act as a Money Bill by 4:1, with Justice Chandrachud dissenting that it was a fraud on the Constitution.
- In Rojer Mathew (2019), the Court referred the question of the use of Money Bills for tribunal reforms to a larger Bench.

Way forward

- Speakers should certify only when the criteria are met, and judicial review should be open to check misuse.

Conclusion Money Bill powers protect the Lok Sabha's financial primacy but must not bypass the Rajya Sabha.



DRAW IT: The path of a Money Bill. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "110 define, 109 delay": Article 110 defines the Bill; Article 109 limits the Rajya Sabha to 14 days.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Rajya Sabha can reject a Money Bill; it can only recommend changes, which the Lok Sabha may ignore.

GS2 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Riggs's prismatic-sala model

PREDICTED · GS2-C1

Q12. Explain Fred Riggs's prismatic-sala model of administration. How far does it describe administration in developing societies? (150 words)

Model answer

Fred Riggs, in Administration in Developing Countries (1964), described societies as fused, prismatic or diffracted, as a prism splits white light into its colours.

Types

- Fused: functions are combined in a few institutions, as in traditional societies.
- Diffracted: functions are specialised, as in modern, industrial societies.
- Prismatic: a transitional society with traits of both. Its administrative sub-system is called the sala, like the Spanish word for a government office.

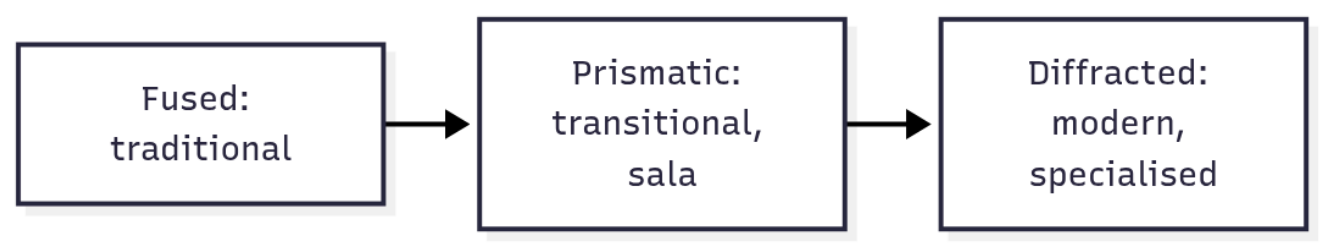
Features of prismatic society

- Heterogeneity: old and new practices side by side.
- Formalism: gap between law and practice.
- Overlapping: new offices still follow old kin and caste roles.
- Poly-communalism and nepotism, and the "bazaar-canteen" market of fixed and bargained prices.

Value and limits

- The model explains why reform fails when formal rules clash with social practice.

- But it is abstract, hard to test and treats development as a single path.



DRAW IT: Riggs's three kinds of society. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Fused, Prism, Diffracted": the three colours of Riggs.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call the sala a society; it is the administrative sub-system of a prismatic society.

GS2 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Civil society and governance

PREDICTED · GS2-C6

Q13. Examine how civil society and non-governmental organisations strengthen governance in India. What constraints do they face? (250 words)

Model answer

Civil society is the space between the family, the market and the State, made of voluntary groups, NGOs, media, unions and community bodies. It acts as watchdog, partner and voice of the weak.

Roles

- Information and accountability: the movement led by the Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan in Rajasthan through public hearings created the demand for the RTI law of 2005.
- Service delivery: NGOs run schools, health and livelihood programmes where the State is weak, and work with governments as partners.
- Advocacy and litigation: public interest litigation has widened access to justice, on matters from prison conditions to the environment.
- Empowerment: women's collectives and self-help groups build leadership.
- Disaster response: local groups aid relief.

Constraints

- Dependence on donor funds, and limits on foreign contributions: the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act was amended in 2020 to cap administrative expenses at 20 per cent and to tighten the route for foreign funds.
- Weak internal governance in some organisations and doubts about transparency.
- Distrust between officials and activists, and shrinking space for dissent.
- Elite capture of voices.

Way forward

- Clear and fair regulation based on transparency, not suspicion.
- Partnerships with panchayats and urban bodies through social audit and citizen scorecards.
- Self-regulation by NGOs and open reporting of finances.

Conclusion Strong civil society complements the State; governance improves when both are accountable.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Watch, Work, Win-voice": watchdog, workers in the field and advocates.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat all NGOs as equal; examiners expect a balance between their value and their accountability.

GS2 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · CPGRAMS and Janaspandana

PREDICTED · GS2-C6

Q14. Explain how grievance redressal systems such as CPGRAMS and Karnataka's Janaspandana support good governance. (150 words)

Model answer

Grievance redressal tells government where services fail, and holds officials answerable. It is a core part of citizen-centric governance.

CPGRAMS

- The Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System is an online portal of the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances, allowing a citizen to lodge a complaint with any central or State body and track it.
- It gives departments a uniform system with time limits, appeals and analysis of root causes.

Janaspandana in Karnataka

- The Chief Minister's Janaspandana recorded 9,725 grievances and 12,838 petitions with over 99 per cent resolution, says the Economic Survey.
- The monthly District Janaspandana programmes registered 71,385 grievances and resolved 97.94 per cent.

Value

- Early warning of poor services, trust in the State, and data to reform.

Limits: Closure may mean a reply rather than a remedy; follow-up and independent appeal are needed.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Lodge, Track, Close": three steps in the grievance cycle.

COMMON TRAP: Do not equate a high disposal rate with satisfaction; ask whether the citizen was satisfied with the outcome.

GS2 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Earthquakes and volcanoes

PREDICTED · GS2-A1

Q15. Explain the causes and global distribution of earthquakes and volcanoes. How do they affect human life, and how does Karnataka's seismic profile compare? (250 words)

Model answer

Earthquakes and volcanoes are linked to the movement of the lithospheric plates. Together they show where the Earth's crust is most active.

Causes

- Earthquakes: sudden release of strain energy along faults, mostly at plate boundaries, and sometimes from reservoirs, mining or nuclear tests. Waves are measured by seismographs; the Richter and moment magnitude scales rate the energy.

- Volcanoes: molten rock (magma) rises through weak zones at subduction zones, divergent boundaries and hot spots such as Hawaii.

Distribution

- The Circum-Pacific Ring of Fire has most of the world's active volcanoes and earthquakes.
- The Alpine-Himalayan belt, and the Mid-Atlantic ridge, form the other major zones.

Effects

- Loss of life, collapsed buildings, tsunamis, landslides and fires. The 2023 Turkey-Syria earthquakes show how weak buildings multiply deaths.
- Volcanic ash disrupts air travel and farming, though volcanic soils are fertile.

India and Karnataka

- India's Himalayan belt is highly active; the Latur (1993) and Bhuj (2001) earthquakes struck the peninsula and the west, and Barren Island in the Andaman Sea is India's only active volcano.
- The Economic Survey says that 22% of the Geographical area in the State is prone to moderate earthquake risks, and its monitoring centre receives data from 14 observatories in real time.

Mitigation: building codes, early warning, retrofitting and drills.

Conclusion Hazards cannot be prevented but their impact can be reduced by preparedness.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Plates Push, Fire Rings": plate movement causes the quakes and the Ring of Fire holds the volcanoes.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that India has no volcano; Barren Island is active, and Karnataka's risk is moderate, not nil.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Karnataka 22 per cent area prone to moderate earthquake risk; 14 seismic observatories.

GS2: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Secularism and Bommai.

GS2 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · Secularism and Bommai

PREDICTED · GS2-B1

Q16. Examine how the Indian Constitution understands secularism. How did the Bommai case (1994) strengthen it? (150 words)

Model answer

Indian secularism does not mean separation of religion and State, but equal respect for all faiths and the State's neutrality. The word "secular" was inserted into the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment, 1976, though the idea was already in the Constitution.

Constitutional basis

- Articles 14, 15 and 16 ban discrimination on grounds of religion.
- Articles 25 to 28 protect freedom of conscience, the practice of religion subject to public order, and bar State religion.
- The State may reform social practices, as in temple entry and personal law.

Bommai (1994)

- A nine-judge Bench held secularism to be a basic feature, so a State government acting against it can face President's rule.

- It also limited Article 356: a Government's majority is judged in the legislature, not by the Governor's view.
- S.R. Bommai was Chief Minister of Karnataka, whose Government was dismissed in 1989.

Concern: political misuse of religion and communal polarisation.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "42, 25, Bommai": amendment, articles, case.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say India follows the Western separation model; the Indian State intervenes for equality and reform.

GS2 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · 74th Amendment and urban bodies

PREDICTED · GS2-B5

Q17. Discuss the provisions of the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992. How effective has urban local government been in Karnataka? (250 words)

Model answer

The 74th Amendment gave constitutional status to urban local bodies by adding Part IXA (Articles 243P to 243ZG) and the Twelfth Schedule with 18 functions.

Main provisions

- Three types of bodies: a Nagar Panchayat for transition areas, a municipal council for smaller and a municipal corporation for larger urban areas.
- Direct elections, a five-year term, and elections within six months of dissolution.
- Reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes and Tribes, and at least one-third for women.
- A State Election Commission, and a State Finance Commission to review finances every five years.
- District Planning Committees and Metropolitan Planning Committees for integrated planning.
- Wards committees in bigger cities.

Karnataka

- Under the Karnataka Municipalities Act, 1964 the Directorate of Municipal Administration oversees 13 City Corporations, 64 City Municipal Councils, 120 Town Municipal Councils, 120 Town Panchayats and 4 Notified Area Committees, according to the Economic Survey.

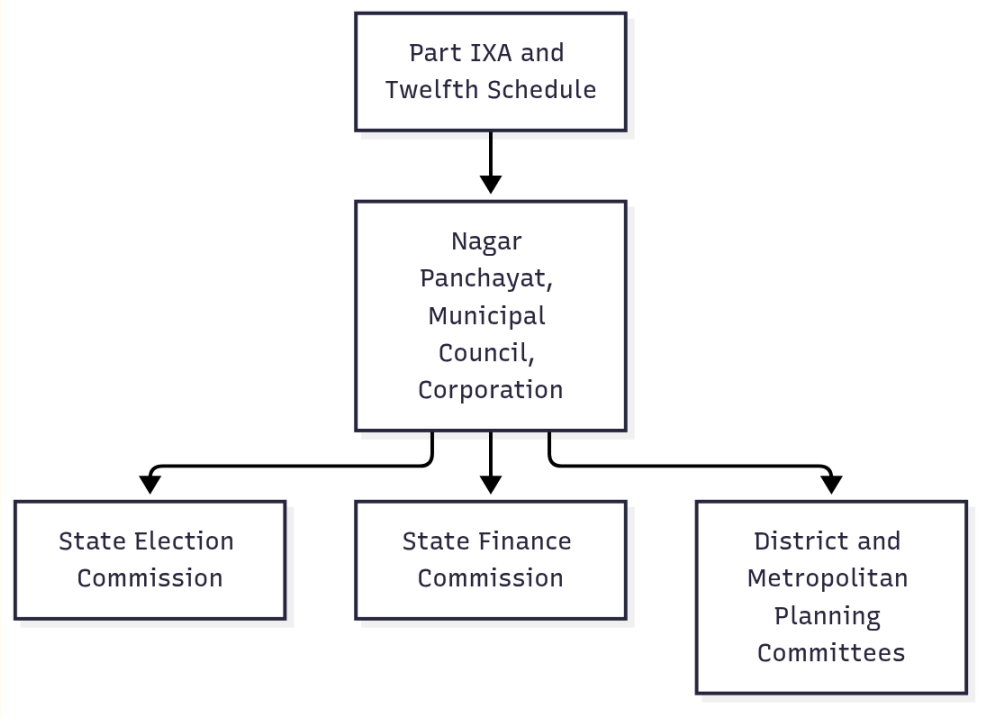
Effectiveness

- Regular elections and women's participation have grown.
- But functions in the Twelfth Schedule are not fully transferred; parastatals, such as development authorities and water boards, do the work.
- Weak finances, dependence on grants, poor property-tax collection and shortage of staff.
- Mayors have short terms and little power.
- Wards committees are rarely active.

Way forward

- Transfer functions, funds and staff together; strengthen property tax; make mayors' terms longer, and empower ward committees.

Conclusion The Amendment gave urban bodies a legal status, but real power has yet to reach them.



DRAW IT: Urban local government under the 74th Amendment. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "243P to ZG, 12th Schedule, 18": the part, the articles and the functions.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat the 74th Amendment as the rural counterpart; the 73rd is for panchayats, and the 74th is for towns.

GS2 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Maslow and Herzberg

PREDICTED · GS2-C4

Q18. Compare Maslow's hierarchy of needs with Herzberg's two-factor theory. How can a public manager use them to motivate staff? (150 words)

Model answer

Motivation is the inner drive that makes people act to achieve goals.

Maslow (1943)

- Needs are arranged as a hierarchy: physiological, safety, belonging, esteem and self-actualisation.
- A lower need must be reasonably met before a higher one drives behaviour. A satisfied need no longer motivates.

Herzberg (1959)

- Hygiene factors, such as pay, working conditions, security and supervision, prevent dissatisfaction but do not motivate.
- Motivators, such as achievement, recognition, responsibility and growth, create real satisfaction.

Comparison

- Maslow's lower needs resemble hygiene factors; the higher needs resemble motivators.
- Maslow speaks of individuals; Herzberg of the job design.

Use in public service

- Provide basic security and decent offices, then recognition, training and responsibility.

- Enlarge the job, and give credit for results.

Criticism: research is limited, and public servants are also motivated by public purpose.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Hygiene holds, Motivator moves": hygiene prevents anger, motivators create drive.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that pay never matters in Herzberg's theory; it prevents dissatisfaction but does not alone motivate.

GS2 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · POSDCORB and TQM

PREDICTED · GS2-C5

Q19. Explain Gulick's POSDCORB and Total Quality Management as management tools. How far are they relevant to public organisations? (250 words)

Model answer

Management tools help turn policy into results. POSDCORB gives a list of managerial functions, and Total Quality Management (TQM) gives a continuing quality approach.

POSDCORB (Gulick and Urwick, 1937)

- Planning, Organising, Staffing, Directing, Co-ordinating, Reporting and Budgeting.
- It summarises what an executive does in any organisation.
- Strengths: simplicity and a ready checklist for training and reform.
- Criticisms: it ignores the human and political side of administration, and treats public and private management as alike (Simon called such principles "proverbs").

Total Quality Management

- Associated with W. Edwards Deming and J.M. Juran, and widely adopted in Japan from the 1950s.
- Features: focus on the customer, quality at every stage, employee involvement, continuous improvement (kaizen), measurement and the PDCA cycle of plan, do, check and act.
- It seeks to prevent errors rather than to inspect and correct them.

Relevance to public organisations

- POSDCORB still frames reports, budgets and training in government offices.
- TQM underlies citizen charters, Sevottam and process re-engineering of services such as passports and registration.
- Constraints: multiple goals, political interference and lack of incentives, and customers who cannot choose.

Way forward

- Use both with a public-service ethos, measure outcomes, and involve staff.

Conclusion These tools are useful, if adapted to the public purpose and accountable service.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "P-O-S-D-Co-R-B": seven words, one executive.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call POSDCORB a theory of motivation; it is a list of managerial functions.

GS2 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Public Service Commissions

PREDICTED · GS2-B7

Q20. Explain the constitutional provisions on Public Service Commissions (Articles 315 to 323). Why are they considered guardians of the merit system? (150 words)

Model answer

Part XIV, Chapter II provides for a Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) and a Public Service Commission for each State, such as the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC).

Provisions

- Appointment (Article 316): the President appoints UPSC members and the Governor State members, for six years or until age 65 (UPSC) or 62 (State).
- Removal (Article 317): only by the President on the ground of misbehaviour after an inquiry by the Supreme Court, or on certain other grounds.
- Independence: service conditions cannot be altered to a member's disadvantage; expenses are charged on the Consolidated Fund (Article 322); some later jobs are barred (Article 319).
- Functions (Article 320): hold recruitment examinations; advise on rules, promotions and discipline.
- Report (Article 323): annual report to the President or the Governor, to be laid before the legislature.

Merit: security of tenure protects recruitment from political favour, though advice is not binding.



DRAW IT: Recruitment through a Public Service Commission. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Hire, Advise, Report": three jobs of a Commission.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Commission can appoint officers; it conducts recruitment and gives advice, and the Government appoints.

PEAK FACT: Articles 315 to 323; UPSC term six years or age 65; State 62; removal under Article 317 after Supreme Court inquiry.

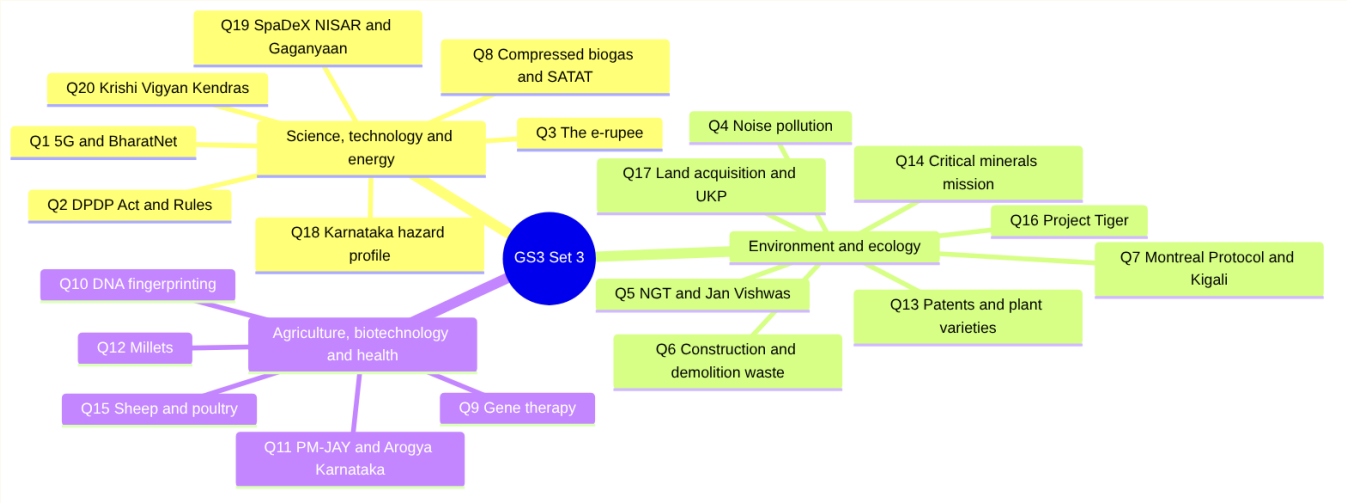
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Secularism and Bommai:** "42, 25, Bommai": amendment, articles, case. **Q17 74th Amendment and urban bodies:** "243P to ZG, 12th Schedule, 18": the part, the articles and the functions. **Q18 Maslow and Herzberg:** "Hygiene holds, Motivator moves": hygiene prevents anger, motivators create drive. **Q19 POSDCORB and TQM:** "P-O-S-D-Co-R-B": seven words, one executive. **Q20 Public Service Commissions:** "Hire, Advise, Report": three jobs of a Commission.

Paper 4: General Studies III (GS3)

Set 3: step 5 of 6 (General Studies III (GS3)). Next up: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

CHAI-TALK: The science paper leans on law and technology together: data protection, patents, waste rules and the Montreal Protocol. Quote the Act or the mission, one Karnataka figure and one risk, then draw the flow chart.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS3 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · 5G and BharatNet

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q1. Connectivity underpins digital governance. Discuss the progress of 5G rollout and the Amended BharatNet Programme, and examine the gaps that remain in rural India. (250 words)

Model answer

Telemedicine, e-governance and online learning depend on the network that carries them. India has pursued two tracks: mobile networks led by operators, and a publicly funded fibre backbone for villages.

5G rollout

- By October 2024, 4,62,084 5G base stations were deployed across 779 districts, which the Government called the fastest 5G rollout in the world.
- In Karnataka, 19,633 villages had 5G service as on 28 February 2026, against 29,239 villages with 4G, according to a Lok Sabha reply.

Amended BharatNet Programme (ABP)

- Approved on 4 August 2023 at Rs 1,39,579 crore, it aims to take optical fibre in ring topology to all 2.64 lakh Gram Panchayats.
- It also offers connections to about 3.8 lakh non-GP villages on demand and provides 1.5 crore home fibre connections through local entrepreneurs.
- Operation and maintenance are funded for ten years, with a central network operations centre.
- By February 2026, 2,17,805 Gram Panchayats were service-ready, but only 13,494 had been upgraded under ABP by June 2026.

Gaps

- Fibre is laid, but power backup, maintenance and last-mile connections lag.
- Affordability of devices and digital skills limit use.
- Hilly, forest and border areas lack towers.

Way forward Gram Panchayats should be made anchors for service delivery, with local entrepreneurs trained to maintain the network.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Tower, Trunk, Tap": mobile towers carry the signal, BharatNet is the trunk, and home fibre is the tap.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate "service-ready" Gram Panchayats with working broadband; the upgrade under the amended programme is far smaller than the older figure.

GS3 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · DPDP Act and Rules

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q2. Explain the main provisions of the DPDP Act, 2023, along with the Rules notified in 2025. How will they change the way organisations handle personal data? (150 words)

Model answer

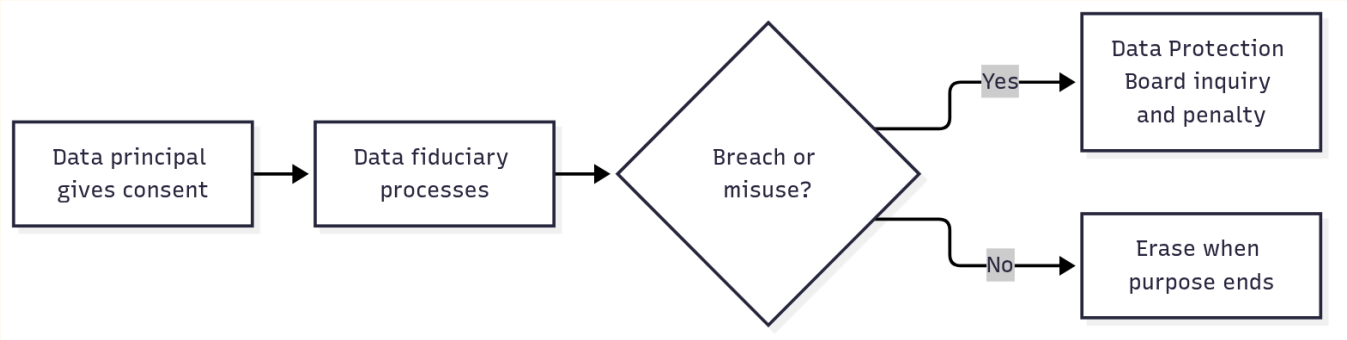
The DPDP Act, 2023 governs digital personal data, balancing the right to protect data with lawful use. The DPDP Rules were notified on 13 November 2025.

Main provisions

- A Data Fiduciary may process data only with free, informed and specific consent, or for listed legitimate uses.
- Each notice must itemise the data and state the purpose in plain language; withdrawing consent must be as easy as giving it.
- Data Principals have rights to access, correction, erasure and grievance redress.
- A Data Protection Board of a Chairperson and four Members adjudicates complaints, digitally.
- Consent Managers must be Indian companies with net worth of at least Rs 2 crore.

Phasing Board provisions took effect at once, Consent Manager rules after one year, and most duties after eighteen months.

Impact Firms must map their data, secure it, report breaches and delete data once the purpose ends. Small firms need support.



DRAW IT: Personal data under the DPDP law. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Notice, Consent, Rights": three steps every firm must show.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the Act is fully in force; the Rules phase compliance duties over eighteen months from November 2025.

GS3 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · The e-rupee

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q3. Evaluate the retail digital rupee (e-rupee) as a payment instrument. How does it differ from UPI, and where might it help or hurt? (250 words)

Model answer

The e-rupee is a digital form of legal tender issued by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). The retail pilot began on 1 December 2022 in four cities, including Bengaluru, through closed user groups using bank-run wallets.

How it differs from UPI

- UPI moves money between bank deposits; the e-rupee is cash in digital form, a liability of the RBI.
- It can be held in a wallet, earns no interest and settles with finality like physical cash.
- Merchants can accept it through a CBDC QR or a UPI QR.

Current position

- Retail e-rupee in circulation was Rs 771.66 crore on 31 March 2026, lower than Rs 1,016.46 crore a year earlier.
- Programmability, which lets a sponsor tie funds to a purpose, expiry date or merchant category, is being used in welfare and agricultural-credit pilots.
- Offline payment is still being tested.

Prospects

- Targeted subsidies that cannot be diverted.
- Payments in places with weak connectivity.
- Cross-border settlement pilots.

Risks

- Little extra benefit for users who already have free and instant UPI.
- Privacy of transactions and the risk of bank deposits moving into wallets.
- Security and double-spending in offline mode.

Conclusion Its value lies in programmable public payments and offline use, not in competing with UPI.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Cash with a brain": e-rupee is cash that can be coded for a purpose.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe the e-rupee as a replacement for UPI or as a cryptocurrency; it is central bank money, and its circulation fell in 2025-26.

GS3 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · Noise pollution

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q4. Describe the sources and effects of noise pollution. Explain the legal framework to control it in India, with a Karnataka example. (150 words)

Model answer

Noise is unwanted sound, measured in decibels (dB). Its sources are road and rail traffic, aircraft, construction, generators, loudspeakers, festivals and industry.

Effects

- Hearing loss, high blood pressure, stress and disturbed sleep.
- Lower learning in children and reduced work output.
- Harm to birds and wildlife.

Legal framework

- The Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000, framed under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, set ambient limits for industrial, commercial, residential and silence zones, with a lower night limit. For residential areas the limit is 55 dB by day and 45 dB by night.
- Loudspeakers are banned at night, with limited exceptions.
- In Re Noise Pollution (2005), the Supreme Court held that peace is part of the right to life under Article 21.

Karnataka During 2025-26 up to December, 8,46,680 vehicles were checked for noise, 26,641 were booked and Rs 6.93 crore was collected as fine.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "55-45": residential limit by day and night.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not cite the day limit alone; the night limit is lower, and silence zones near hospitals and schools have stricter limits.

GS3 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · NGT and Jan Vishwas

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q5. Discuss the role of the National Green Tribunal in environmental governance. How have recent moves to decriminalise pollution offences changed enforcement? (250 words)

Model answer

The National Green Tribunal (NGT), created by a 2010 Act of Parliament, hears civil cases on environmental laws, with a target of disposal within six months. It replaced the National Environment Appellate Authority and draws on the Supreme Court's recognition of a healthy environment under Article 21.

Role

- It has expert and judicial members, with a principal bench at Delhi and zonal benches at Bhopal, Pune, Kolkata and Chennai; the Chennai bench serves the south, including Karnataka.
- It applies the principles of sustainable development, precaution and "polluter pays", which the Supreme Court adopted in Vellore Citizens Welfare Forum (1996).
- It can order relief, restoration and environmental compensation, and appeals lie to the Supreme Court.
- It has handled cases on lakes, rivers, waste, mining and tree felling.

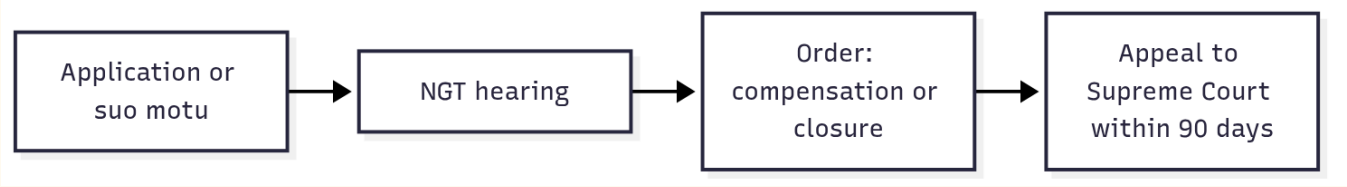
Decriminalisation

- The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023 replaced prison terms under the Air Act with penalties from Rs 10,000 to Rs 15 lakh, imposed by adjudicating officers.
- A separate amendment to the Water Act in 2024 follows the same approach.
- In 2026 Parliament passed a further Jan Vishwas law (Act 8 of 2026), amending 784 provisions in 79 central Acts.

Assessment

- Civil penalties are easier to impose than slow prosecutions and ease compliance.
- But a fine can be treated as a cost of doing business, so the penalty must scale with the harm, and the adjudicating officers need independence.

Conclusion Trust in firms should be paired with firm, swift penalties.



DRAW IT: NGT: from complaint to order. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Six, Five, Fifteen": six months to decide, five benches, penalties up to Rs 15 lakh.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say pollution offences are no longer punished; the change replaces prison with civil penalties for many, not all, offences.

PEAK FACT: NGT Act 2010; principal bench Delhi and four zonal benches; polluter pays and precaution in Vellore Citizens Welfare Forum (1996).

GS3: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Construction and demolition waste.

GS3 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Construction and demolition waste

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q6. Construction and demolition (C&D) waste is rising in fast-growing cities. Explain the Environment (Construction and Demolition) Waste Management Rules, 2025 and their significance. (150 words)

Model answer

Construction and demolition waste includes concrete, bricks, plaster, tiles and rubble. Cities such as Bengaluru generate large quantities, and illegal dumping chokes drains, lakes and roads. The Karnataka Economic Survey lists C&D waste as one of the major sources of the State's waste.

Key features of the 2025 Rules

- Notified on 2 April 2025; compliance began on 1 April 2026.
- They apply extended producer responsibility to reconstruction and demolition projects.
- Recycling targets are 25 per cent in 2025-26, 50 per cent in 2026-27, 75 per cent in 2027-28 and 100 per cent from 2028-29.
- Large projects of 20,000 sq. m or more must use recycled material, rising from 5 per cent in 2026-27 to 25 per cent from 2030-31.

Significance They save river sand and quarried stone, cut landfill and create a market for recycled aggregates.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "25-50-75-100": the recycling ladder.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix these Rules with the Solid Waste Management Rules; C&D debris has its own rules and excludes metals, wood and glass.

GS3 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Montreal Protocol and Kigali

PREDICTED · GS3-C5

Q7. How have the Montreal Protocol and its Kigali Amendment shaped global action on ozone depletion and climate change? Discuss India's obligations. (250 words)

Model answer

The ozone layer in the stratosphere absorbs harmful ultraviolet-B radiation. In the 1980s chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs), used in refrigeration and aerosols, were found to be thinning it, most visibly over Antarctica.

Montreal Protocol

- Adopted on 16 September 1987 under the Vienna Convention, it set binding phase-outs of ozone-depleting substances (ODS) with a Multilateral Fund to help developing countries.
- It is widely regarded as the most successful environmental treaty, because it ended the use of CFCs and the ozone layer is slowly recovering.

Kigali Amendment

- Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs) replaced CFCs but do not harm ozone; they are potent greenhouse gases.
- The 2016 Amendment brought HFCs under the Protocol, in force from 2019.

India

- India ratified Kigali in September 2021.
- As a developing country in Group 2, it must freeze HFC consumption in 2028, then cut it by 10 per cent in 2032, 20 per cent in 2037, 30 per cent in 2042 and 85 per cent in 2047.
- The India Cooling Action Plan guides the shift to efficient cooling.

Challenges

- Rising demand for air conditioners.
- Safe, affordable alternatives and training of servicing technicians.

Conclusion Kigali shows how one treaty can address both ozone and climate, if cooling is made efficient.



DRAW IT: From ozone hole to climate gain. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "28-32-37-42-47": Kigali steps for India, a freeze, then 10, 20, 30 and 85.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say HFCs deplete ozone; they are greenhouse gases, and that is why Kigali is a climate measure.

GS3 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Compressed biogas and SATAT

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q8. What is compressed biogas (CBG)? Explain the SATAT initiative and the CBG blending obligation, and give the status of Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Compressed biogas (CBG) is purified biogas, with more than 90 per cent methane, from farm residue, cattle dung, food waste and sewage, compressed for use like CNG. It cuts imports and methane emissions, and its slurry is a fertiliser.

SATAT

- Sustainable Alternative Towards Affordable Transportation, launched on 1 October 2018, lets oil marketing companies invite expressions of interest and buy CBG from entrepreneurs.
- SATAT gives no capital subsidy for plants.

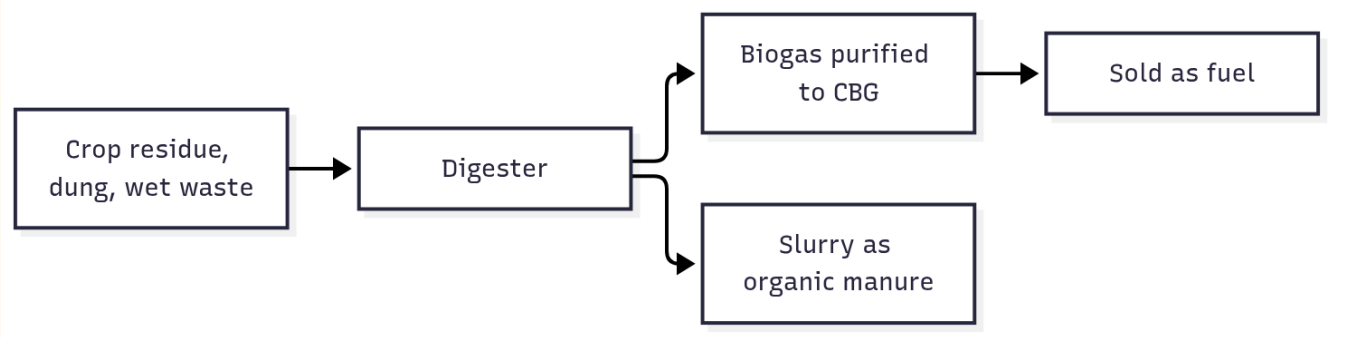
Blending obligation

- CBG blending in CNG and domestic PNG is mandatory at 1 per cent in 2025-26, 3 per cent in 2026-27, 4 per cent in 2027-28 and 5 per cent from 2028-29.
- The first-year target was met at 1.05 per cent.

Status

- On 31 July 2026, 217 plants with about 1,773 tonnes a day were running, against a target of 5,000.
- Karnataka had 22 plants.

Issues: feedstock, pipelines and price.



DRAW IT: Compressed biogas chain. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "1-3-4-5": blending steps by year.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call SATAT a subsidy scheme; the Government supports feedstock aggregation and pipelines, not plant capital under SATAT.

GS3 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Gene therapy

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q9. Gene therapy promises to treat inherited disease. Discuss with reference to India's sickle-cell gene therapy BIRSA 101, and examine the scientific and ethical issues involved. (250 words)

Model answer

Gene therapy treats or cures disease by altering a person's genes. In somatic therapy, cells of the patient are edited and the change is not passed on; germline editing changes embryos and is inherited, and most countries bar it.

Sickle-cell disease

- A single mutation in the haemoglobin gene produces rigid red cells, pain crises and organ damage; it is common among tribal and other communities in India.
- The National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission, launched in 2023, aims at screening and care.

BIRSA 101

- Launched in November 2025 by CSIR-IGIB, it is described as India's first indigenous CRISPR-based therapy for sickle cell, using a home-grown Cas9 enzyme.
- It is an ex-vivo treatment: the patient's stem cells are edited outside the body and returned.
- CSIR transferred the technology to the Serum Institute to scale production and cut the cost, since foreign therapies cost many crores.

Issues

- Off-target edits, long-term safety and the need for conditioning treatment.
- High cost and the capacity of hospitals.
- Informed consent, equity of access and the line between therapy and enhancement.
- Need for strong regulation and trial oversight.

Conclusion Gene therapy can fulfil its promise only if it is made safe, affordable and equitable.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Edit, Return, Reach": edit the cells, return them, and make sure the therapy reaches the poor.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say BIRSA 101 is already a routine treatment; it is at an early clinical stage and the cost goal is still a target.

GS3 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · DNA fingerprinting

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q10. Explain the principle and uses of DNA fingerprinting. What is the legal position in India on the collection and storage of DNA samples? (150 words)

Model answer

DNA fingerprinting compares short repeated sequences of DNA that differ from person to person. Alec Jeffreys developed it in 1984; the Indian scientist Lalji Singh pioneered its use at the Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology and the CDFD at Hyderabad.

Method DNA is extracted, cut or copied by PCR, separated by size and compared with a reference profile. Identical twins alone share a profile.

Uses

- Identifying offenders and victims, and clearing the innocent.
- Paternity and disaster-victim identification.
- Tracking poaching, and breeding records of animals and crops.

Legal position

- The Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022 allows collection of biological samples and records in specified cases.
- The DNA Technology (Use and Application) Regulation Bill, 2019 was withdrawn from the Lok Sabha in July 2023, so no separate DNA data-bank law exists.
- Privacy is protected by Puttaswamy (2017), requiring legality, need and proportionality.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Extract, Cut, Compare": the three steps of the test.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the 2019 DNA Bill became law; it was withdrawn, and the 2022 Act is the operative law on identification.

PEAK FACT: DNA fingerprinting developed by Alec Jeffreys 1984; Lalji Singh in India.

GS3: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, PM-JAY and Arogya Karnataka.

GS3 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · PM-JAY and Arogya Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS3-B7 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. Discuss how Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY and Arogya Karnataka have improved access to hospital care. What gaps remain? (250 words)

Model answer

Out-of-pocket spending on hospital care pushes many families into debt. Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY), launched on 23 September 2018, offers cashless secondary and tertiary care of up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year to eligible households through empanelled hospitals. Since 2024 it also covers every citizen aged 70 and above.

Karnataka's model

- Karnataka merges the central scheme with its own Arogya Karnataka, running them through a common trust.
- For 1 April to 31 December 2025, the Economic Survey reports 23,63,681 cases under the scheme, with claims of Rs 1,55,557.74 lakh.
- The State has been strengthening government hospitals to perform knee and hip replacement under the scheme.

Benefits

- Cashless treatment reduces catastrophic spending.
- Public hospitals earn revenue to improve services, and patients avoid distress sales of land.
- Care for heart disease, cancer and dialysis has expanded, and referral links between district and medical college hospitals have improved.

Gaps

- Eligibility lists exclude some poor and near-poor families.
- Private hospitals may refuse low-paying packages, and fraud needs audits.
- Primary and preventive care is weaker than hospital cover, and rural areas lack specialists.

Way forward Link hospital cover with the screening of diseases at primary level, publish hospital performance, and settle claims promptly. Independent audit of claims would check fraud and unnecessary procedures, while grievance cells at district level would protect patients. Pairing the cover with health education would reduce avoidable hospital stays.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Cash-less, Care-more": cashless cover must be matched with more primary care.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe insurance as a substitute for a good public health system; it covers hospital stays, not prevention.

GS3 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Millets

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q12. Explain why millets are called "nutri-cereals" and "climate-smart" crops. How can their production and consumption be promoted? (150 words)

Model answer

Millets such as ragi (finger millet), jowar (sorghum), bajra, foxtail, little and kodo millet were staples of dry regions before rice and wheat spread.

Why nutri-cereals

- Rich in fibre, iron, calcium and protein, with a low glycaemic effect.
- Ragi has high calcium, which suits children and women.

Why climate-smart

- They grow on poor soil with little water, tolerate heat and need few chemicals.
- Short duration makes them suitable for dryland farming and rotation.

Promotion

- India led the proposal for the International Year of Millets, 2023, and the Government uses the name Shree Anna.
- Karnataka has made special efforts for millet production and processing, an organic and millet hub and a mission on natural farming.
- Measures: inclusion in the public distribution system and school meals, assured procurement at MSP, processing units for value addition, and awareness campaigns.

Constraint: low yields, drudgery in processing and shifting tastes.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Few, Fibre, Fast": needs few inputs, rich in fibre, quick to mature.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call millets minor crops with low value; their nutrition and climate resilience are their strength.

GS3 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Patents and plant varieties

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q13. Discuss how the Patents Act, 1970 and the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act, 2001 treat living organisms and seeds. How do they balance innovation with farmers' rights? (250 words)

Model answer

Intellectual property rights reward invention, but seeds are also the farmer's means of production. Indian law therefore treats plants differently from machines.

Patents Act, 1970

- It excludes plants and animals in whole or in part, including seeds, varieties and biological processes for producing them [Section 3(j)].
- Microorganisms may be patented if they meet the usual tests.
- India follows the TRIPS Agreement, which requires some form of protection for plant varieties, and chose a distinct system.

PPV&FR Act, 2001

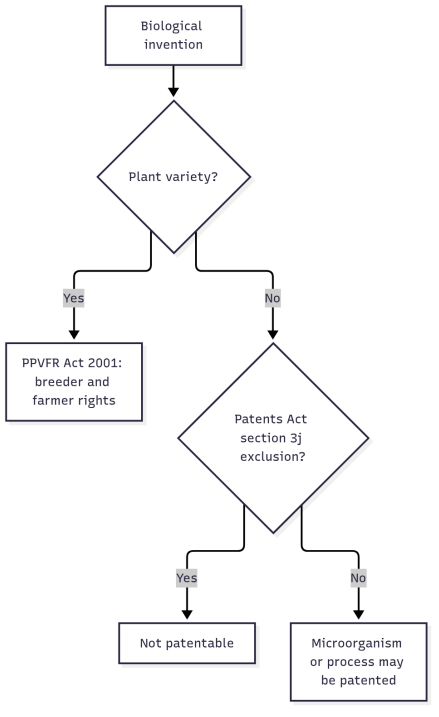
- It protects new, distinct, uniform and stable varieties, and extant and farmers' varieties.

- A breeder has exclusive rights for a fixed period, for example 15 years for most crops.
- A farmer may save, use, sow, resow, exchange, share or sell farm-saved seed, except in a brand name of a registered variety.
- Farmers can be rewarded for conserving genetic resources, and the Act provides for benefit sharing and compensation if a variety fails to perform.
- The Authority is the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority, and a Gene Fund supports conservation.

Balance and issues

- Farmers' rights are real but weakly known, and registration of local varieties is slow.
- Seed prices and disputes over multinational varieties show the tension.
- Traditional knowledge needs protection from misappropriation, as in the neem and turmeric cases.

Conclusion Awareness and support can make farmers co-owners of innovation.



DRAW IT: Living things and IP law. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Plant is out, farmer is in": patents exclude plants; the Plant Variety Act gives farmers rights.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say India permits patents on seeds; Section 3(j) excludes them, and the plant variety law applies instead.

GS3 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Critical minerals mission

PREDICTED · GS3-C2

Q14. What is the National Critical Mineral Mission? Why are critical minerals important for India's energy transition, and what is Karnataka's position? (150 words)

Model answer

Critical minerals such as lithium, cobalt, nickel, graphite and rare earths are essential for batteries, solar panels, wind turbines and electronics. India imports most of them, so supply security matters.

National Critical Mineral Mission

- Approved by the Cabinet on 29 January 2025 with Rs 16,300 crore over seven years, plus about Rs 18,000 crore of investment from public sector undertakings.
- It covers exploration, mining, processing, recycling, overseas assets and stockpiles.
- Targets include about 1,200 exploration projects, processing parks and centres of excellence.

Karnataka

- The Economic Survey notes advanced exploration for gold, limestone, bauxite, iron ore and critical minerals in various districts.
- Four critical-mineral blocks in Karnataka have been auctioned under the central auction regime.

Concerns: environmental damage in mining areas, rights of local communities, and the need to build recycling to reduce dependence.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Find, Process, Recycle": the three legs of the mission.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat critical minerals as only lithium; the list is long and includes graphite, cobalt, nickel and rare earths.

GS3 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Sheep and poultry

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Sheep, goat and poultry rearing support many rural households in Karnataka. Discuss their importance, the State's schemes and the challenges. (250 words)

Model answer

Small livestock need little land and capital, so they suit the landless, women and dryland farmers, who use them as a buffer against crop failure.

Importance

- As per the 20th Livestock Census, Karnataka has 3.03 crore livestock and 5.95 crore poultry, equal to 5.41 and 6.98 per cent of the country's totals.
- Animal husbandry adds 3.64 per cent to the State's GSDP.
- Sheep and goat provide meat, wool and manure, and poultry gives eggs and quick income.

Karnataka's initiatives

- Amrutha Swabhimani Kurigahi Yojane supports shepherds with a unit of 20 ewes and one ram or buck, costing Rs 1,75,000, with half the cost taken as a loan from the National Cooperative Development Corporation; 1,569 beneficiaries had been identified by December 2025.
- Veterinary services, vaccination and breed improvement programmes support all species.
- Poultry is largely run by contract growers and private integrators, so the State's role lies in disease surveillance, feed quality and market linkage.

Challenges

- Diseases such as peste des petits ruminants, sheep pox and avian influenza.
- Shrinking grazing land and low wool prices.
- Weak credit, insurance and marketing; fodder shortage in drought.
- Wool-based livelihoods have declined with cheap synthetic fibre and poor processing.

Way forward Vaccination coverage, community grazing rights, producer companies of shepherds and cold chain for meat and eggs would raise incomes.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "20 plus 1": the sheep unit is twenty ewes and one ram or buck.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix up the livestock total with poultry; the Census reports 3.03 crore livestock and 5.95 crore poultry separately.

PEAK FACT: 20th Livestock Census: 3.03 crore livestock and 5.95 crore poultry; shares 5.41 and 6.98 per cent.

GS3: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Project Tiger.

GS3 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · Project Tiger

PREDICTED · GS3-C1 · Karnataka-specific

Q16. Explain the objectives and organisation of Project Tiger. How has Karnataka contributed to tiger conservation? (150 words)

Model answer

Project Tiger was launched on 1 April 1973 to protect the tiger and its habitat. It began with nine reserves, and Bandipur in Karnataka was among them.

Organisation

- Core areas are kept free of human use and surrounded by buffer zones where people can continue limited, regulated use.
- The National Tiger Conservation Authority, a statutory body since 2006, guides the project.
- Tigers are counted every four years by camera traps in the All India Tiger Estimation.

Karnataka

- The State has five tiger reserves: Bandipur, Nagarhole, Bhadra, BRT Hills and Dandeli-Anshi.
- According to the 2022 estimation, Karnataka is second among States in tigers.
- The Survey mentions the Project Tiger and Project Elephant schemes within the State's conservation strategy.

Challenges: human-wildlife conflict, linear projects and relocation of villages.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Core, Buffer, Count": the three working parts.

COMMON TRAP: Do not mix up Project Tiger with Project Elephant; the first is for the tiger and its reserves, the second for elephant corridors.

GS3 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Land acquisition and UKP

PREDICTED · GS3-C6

Q17. Development projects often displace people. Examine the provisions of the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013 and discuss the issues with reference to irrigation projects such as the Upper Krishna Project. (250 words)

Model answer

Dams, mines, highways and industrial parks need land, but the loss falls on farmers, tribal communities and the landless, whose rights are often undocumented. The LARR Act, 2013 replaced the colonial Land Acquisition Act of 1894.

Key provisions

- Social Impact Assessment and public hearings before acquisition, with limits on acquiring multi-crop irrigated land.
- Consent of 70 per cent of affected families for public-private projects and 80 per cent for private projects.
- Compensation of up to two times the market value in rural areas, plus a solatium equal to the compensation.
- Rehabilitation and resettlement entitlements, including house, land, jobs or annuity, and special care for Scheduled Castes and Tribes.
- A rule that land unused for five years must be returned.

Irrigation projects

- The Upper Krishna Project Stage I and II was planned to use 173 TMC allotted by the first Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal and irrigate 6.22 lakh hectares in districts including Yadgir and Kalaburagi.
- Such projects submerge villages, and delays in resettlement and payment of compensation have been a frequent complaint.

Issues

- Delays and litigation; the absence of a record of rights for forest dwellers.
- Weak livelihood restoration, in contrast with cash compensation.
- Land owners often get only one payment, while the gains of irrigation accrue downstream.

Way forward Fair compensation, early resettlement, shares in project benefits and independent monitoring are needed.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Assess, Consent, Pay, Resettle": the four tests of fair acquisition.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the 2013 Act abolished all private acquisition; it set consent and impact rules, while many States have their own amendments.

GS3 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Karnataka hazard profile

PREDICTED · GS3-A4 · Karnataka-specific

Q18. Explain the hazard profile of Karnataka and the institutional mechanism for disaster management in the State. (150 words)

Model answer

Karnataka faces droughts, floods, hailstorms, thunderstorms and lightning, landslides on the Western Ghats slopes and coastal erosion. The Economic Survey states that all districts are vulnerable to more than one natural hazard.

Institutional mechanism

- The Disaster Management Act, 2005 sets up authorities at the national, State and district levels; the State Disaster Management Authority is headed by the Chief Minister.
- Karnataka was the first State in the country to install a Drought Monitoring Cell, in 1988. It was later widened and renamed KSNDMC, the State's natural disaster monitoring centre, to watch every hazard.
- KSNDMC provides forecasts, alerts and early warnings, with a flood forecast cell.
- Relief is financed through the State Disaster Response Fund.

Gaps: warnings must reach the last person, and lightning and hail need local action.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "DMC to KSNDMC": from drought cell (1988) to all-hazard centre.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write that KSNDMC is only a weather office; its remit covers every natural hazard, with warnings sent to local officials.

GS3 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · SpaDeX, NISAR and Gaganyaan

PREDICTED · GS3-A2

Q19. Review India's recent achievements in space, including SpaDeX, NISAR and the Gaganyaan programme. How do they advance India's strategic and social goals? (250 words)

Model answer

India's space programme began as a tool for development and has become a base for science, security and commerce. The recent missions show a move to complex, human-rated and cooperative projects.

SpaDeX

- On 16 January 2025, ISRO demonstrated docking of two satellites in orbit, making India the fourth country to do so.
- Docking is needed for space stations, sample return and in-orbit servicing.

NISAR

- Launched on 30 July 2025, the NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar satellite maps changes in land, ice and vegetation every twelve days, in all weather.
- It supports disaster response, crop and forest monitoring, and glacier and landslide studies.

Gaganyaan

- It aims to send Indian astronauts to low Earth orbit and return them safely.
- Crew module and service module separation tests have been completed; the first uncrewed flight is targeted by the end of 2026, and the first crewed mission in 2027-28 after three uncrewed flights.

Goals served

- Strategic: secure communication, navigation and surveillance.
- Social: weather, fisheries, agriculture and telemedicine.
- Economic: private launchers and start-ups under IN-SPACe, and a growing export market for small satellites.

Challenges: reliability of human-rated systems, cost, space debris, and the need to retain scientific talent.

Conclusion The test lies in turning space capability into daily benefit. Open data from NISAR and clear rules for private launchers will help spread that benefit to farmers, fishers and local bodies.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Dock, Look, Crew": SpaDeX, NISAR, Gaganyaan in order.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Gaganyaan has flown; only ground and separation tests are complete, and the uncrewed flight is a target.

GS3 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Krishi Vigyan Kendras

PREDICTED · GS3-A7

Q20. Explain the role of Krishi Vigyan Kendras in spreading agricultural technology to rural India. What improvements are needed? (150 words)

Model answer

Research is useful only when it reaches the field. Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) are district-level farm science centres, the first of which was set up in 1974 at Puducherry. They are funded by ICAR and hosted by agricultural universities, institutes and NGOs.

Role

- ICAR reports 731 KVKs across 638 rural districts.
- They test technologies on farmers' fields, run frontline demonstrations and train farmers, rural youth and women.
- They supply seeds and planting material and give weather-based advice.

Rural upliftment Their work on soil testing, millets, integrated farming and processing links science with income.

Improvements

- Fill scientific posts, and use mobile apps and video advice.
- Link KVKs with Farmer Producer Organisations and watershed programmes.
- Focus on women farmers and small holdings, and on markets, not only production.

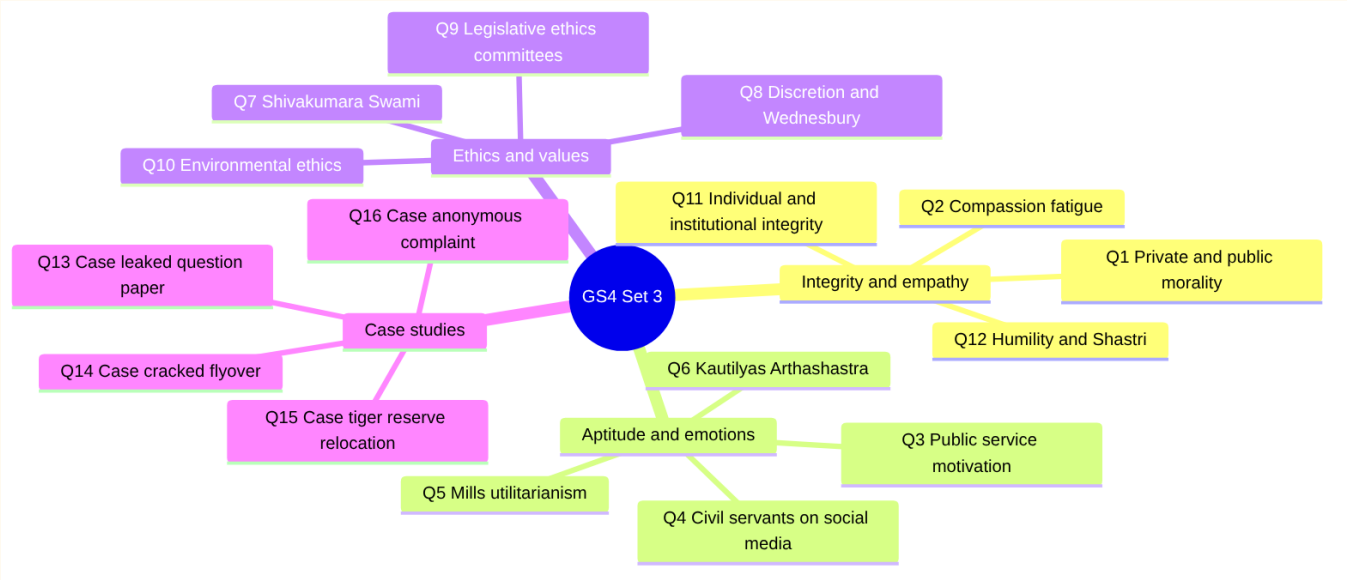
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Test, Show, Train": a KVK's three jobs.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe a KVK as a research station; its task is to adapt and demonstrate technology locally.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** ICAR reports 731 KVKs covering 638 rural districts.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Project Tiger:** "Core, Buffer, Count": the three working parts. **Q17 Land acquisition and UKP:** "Assess, Consent, Pay, Resettle": the four tests of fair acquisition. **Q18 Karnataka hazard profile:** "DMC to KSNDMC": from drought cell (1988) to all-hazard centre. **Q19 SpaDeX, NISAR and Gaganyaan:** "Dock, Look, Crew": SpaDeX, NISAR, Gaganyaan in order. **Q20 Krishi Vigyan Kendras:** "Test, Show, Train": a KVK's three jobs.

Paper 5: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Set 3: step 6 of 6 (General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)). Next up: Kannada and English practice

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 16 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** The ethics paper is about the person behind the post: private conduct, fatigue, motivation and humility. In the cases, verify before you act, put life and rights first, and write your reasons down.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS4 Q1 of 16 · 20 marks · Private and public morality

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q1. "A person of poor private character can still be an excellent public servant." Critically examine this claim by discussing the relationship between private and public morality. (300 words)

Model answer

Private morality governs conduct in one's personal life: family, friendships and habits. Public morality governs conduct in the discharge of public office. The question is whether the two can be separated.

The case for separation

- Private life is a matter of personal liberty, and the State should not police it. The Supreme Court has recognised privacy as part of Article 21.
- Results matter: a competent and honest official who delivers services is judged by public conduct.
- Moral judgment of private matters is often shaped by prejudice and by the media.

The case against separation

- Character is indivisible. A person who deceives a spouse, or exploits dependants, may find it easy to deceive the public.
- Public office rests on trust. A private habit such as bribery, abuse or addiction that affects judgment or exposes the officer to blackmail is a public concern.
- Officers are role models; the example they set shapes the culture of the office.
- The conduct rules of the All India Services require integrity and bar "conduct unbecoming".

A balanced view The test should be a link to public duty, not private taste. Matters that touch the officer's duty, such as corruption, harassment, abuse of position or a conflict of interest, are legitimate public concerns. Matters of faith, food, dress or lawful personal relationships are not.

In practice

- Leaders whom people admire, such as Gandhi, held themselves to the same standard in private and public, and he held that "means and ends" cannot be separated.
- Institutions should act on proven misconduct with due process, not rumour.

Conclusion Private and public morality are distinct but not unconnected. A civil servant should be judged on whether private conduct harms public trust or duty, while the State protects the dignity and privacy of citizens in matters that do not.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Link, not Look": the link to duty decides, not how it looks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not argue that anything private is public; examiners also expect respect for privacy and due process.

GS4 Q2 of 16 · 20 marks · Compassion fatigue

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q2. "Empathy without limits can destroy the helper." Discuss the idea of compassion fatigue among frontline officials, and suggest ways to protect integrity and judgment while remaining humane. (300 words)

Model answer

Frontline officials, such as health workers, police, disaster managers and social welfare staff, meet suffering every day. Empathy helps them to understand need, but constant exposure without recovery leads to compassion fatigue.

Meaning and signs

- Compassion fatigue is emotional and physical exhaustion from caring for those in distress, with irritability, numbness and a feeling of helplessness.
- It differs from burnout, which comes mainly from workload, though the two often occur together.

Why it matters for ethics

- Impartiality: a tired officer may begin to treat applicants as files, or favour those whose stories move them.
- Integrity: exhaustion lowers self-control and may lead to shortcuts, rudeness or rationalised favours.
- Judgment: extreme emotional involvement can cloud objectivity, as when sympathy leads to breaking a rule.
- Quality of service: indifference towards the poor.

Causes

- Heavy caseload, long hours, danger and abuse, lack of recognition, and the absence of counselling.

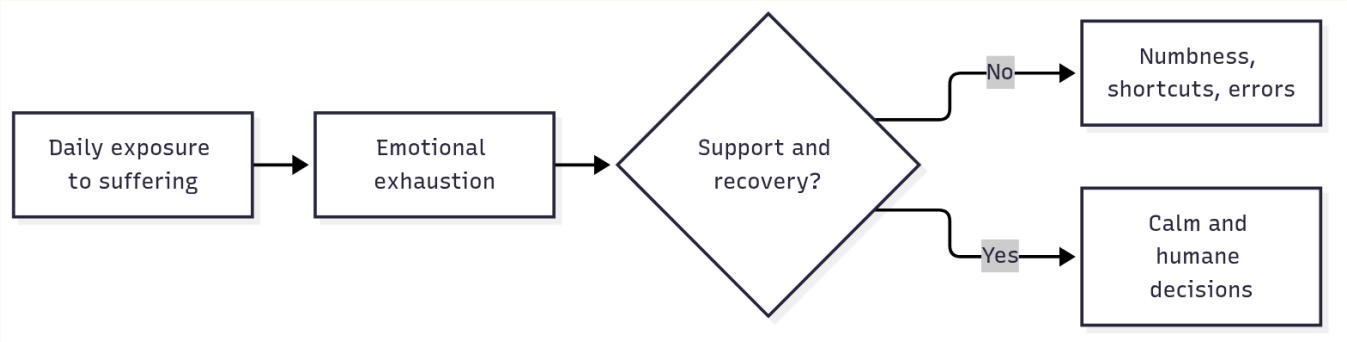
Ways to protect the helper

- Personal: sleep, exercise, hobbies, family time and mindfulness; being clear about what can and cannot be done.
- Professional: distinguish "feeling with" from "feeling as", that is, compassionate concern with a calm head.

- Institutional: reasonable posting and leave, peer support, supervision, confidential counselling and rotation from high-stress duty.
- Recognition: thank staff and share the credit.

Balance Empathy should lead to action within rules. A rule-bound decision made humanely, with explanation and referral, is better than a rule broken in pity.

Conclusion Caring for the carers protects both the public and the system. A resilient official keeps compassion alive without losing integrity, objectivity or health.



DRAW IT: Feel, think, rest. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Feel, Think, Rest": feel for the person, think by the rule, rest to stay whole.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not suggest becoming cold to avoid fatigue; the aim is balance, not indifference.

GS4 Q3 of 16 · 20 marks · Public service motivation

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q3. Explain the concept of public service motivation. How can administrative systems attract and retain persons with a high aptitude for public service? (300 words)

Model answer

Public service motivation (PSM) is an individual's predisposition to respond to motives found mainly in public institutions and organisations. The concept was developed by James Perry and Lois Wise (1990) and later refined by Perry (1996).

Dimensions (Perry)

- Attraction to policy making: interest in shaping public policy.
- Commitment to the public interest and civic duty.
- Compassion: concern for the needy.
- Self-sacrifice: willingness to put public good above personal reward.

Why it matters

- People with high PSM are willing to accept lower pay for meaningful work, show greater effort and are less likely to be corrupt, though this is a tendency and not a rule.
- It links to aptitude, because aptitude for public service is not only skill but also the drive to serve.

Attracting such people

- Recruitment: tests that look at values, ethics and situation judgment, not only knowledge, and interviews that explore motives.
- Message: describe public service as a mission, with stories of impact.
- Early exposure: field attachments, internships and fellowships.

Retaining them

- Meaningful work: give responsibility, discretion and clear goals.
- Fair and quick promotion by merit, with protection from arbitrary transfers.
- Recognition: awards and public appreciation of good work.
- Capacity building: continuous learning, as in the Mission Karmayogi's online platform, aligns skills to roles.
- Ethical climate: leaders who show integrity, since cynicism kills motivation.

Limits

- Motivation is not a substitute for adequate pay; low pay and political interference crowd out the drive to serve.

Conclusion Aptitude and motivation together make a good civil servant. Systems that reward public purpose as well as skill will draw and keep people who serve for the right reasons.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A-C-C-S": Attraction to policy, Civic duty, Compassion, Self-sacrifice.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that high-PSM officials need no incentives; fair pay and safety remain necessary.

GS4 Q4 of 16 · 15 marks · Civil servants on social media

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q4. What guidelines should a civil servant follow while using social media? Discuss with reference to attitude, political neutrality and the conduct rules. (250 words)

Model answer

Social media gives officials a chance to inform and listen, but it also magnifies private views into public acts, and posts remain permanent.

Principles

- Neutrality: the conduct rules of the All India Services (1968) and of the States require political neutrality and restrict criticism of the Government's policy. A post that appears to back a party or attack a policy erodes public trust.
- Impartiality: officials should not appear to favour a community, religion or leader.
- Confidentiality: no official files, plans or personal data of citizens should be posted.
- Dignity and courtesy: language must be civil and free of abuse.
- Accuracy: verify before sharing, because rumours can cause panic and violence.

Attitude angle

- Attitude has thought, feeling and behaviour. A post reveals attitude, and a hostile or prejudiced attitude damages the perception of fairness.
- Officers should reflect before posting: "Would I defend this to a citizen who disagrees?"

Positive uses

- Official handles to share schemes, warnings, and citizens' grievances, as district administrations do during floods.

Safeguards

- Separate personal and official accounts, with privacy settings, but remember that private accounts are not private in practice.

- Training on social-media rules, and clear office guidelines.

Way forward The aim is responsible use, not silence. Officers should use platforms to serve citizens and keep views on politics out.

Conclusion The test is public trust. An official who is neutral, courteous and careful on social media serves democracy; one who is not harms it.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Think, Check, Post": think of the public, check the facts and rules, then post.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that civil servants have no right to speech; they have one, restricted by service rules.

GS4 Q5 of 16 · 15 marks · Mill's utilitarianism

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q5. Explain the main ideas of John Stuart Mill's utilitarianism. How far can it guide public policy decisions? (250 words)

Model answer

Utilitarianism holds that an action is right if it produces the greatest happiness of the greatest number. It was founded by Jeremy Bentham and refined by John Stuart Mill, in Utilitarianism (1863).

Mill's main ideas

- Happiness as the good: actions are right as they promote happiness and wrong as they produce the reverse.
- Quality of pleasure: unlike Bentham, who counted only the quantity of pleasure, Mill said that intellectual and moral pleasures are higher than bodily ones: "It is better to be Socrates dissatisfied than a fool satisfied."
- Sympathy and social feeling make people care for the happiness of others.
- Justice and rights are important because they protect the general welfare in the long run.

Use in public policy

- Cost-benefit analysis of projects, health priorities and budget choices, and the idea of welfare for the maximum number, which underlies many welfare programmes.
- Policies such as vaccination and road safety rules, which restrict some freedoms for large gains.

Limits

- It may sacrifice a minority for the many, as in displacement for a dam, unless safeguards of rights exist.
- Happiness is difficult to measure and compare.
- Ends may seem to justify bad means.
- It can neglect duties and intentions, which Kant stressed.

Balanced use

- Combine it with constitutional rights and fair process: use utility to choose among options that are lawful and respect dignity.

Conclusion Mill's utilitarianism offers a practical test for public decisions, but it must work within rights, justice and compassion for those who bear the cost.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Quantity to Quality": Bentham counted pleasures, Mill graded them.

COMMON TRAP: Do not identify Mill's view with Bentham's; the distinction of higher and lower pleasures is the key difference.

PEAK FACT: Utilitarianism by J.S. Mill 1863; Bentham greatest happiness principle; higher and lower pleasures.

GS4: 5 of 16 done. Next up: Q6, Kautilya's Arthashastra.

GS4 Q6 of 16 · 15 marks · Kautilya's Arthashastra

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q6. What lessons on ethics in governance can be drawn from Kautilya's Arthashastra? Evaluate their relevance today. (250 words)

Model answer

Kautilya, also called Chanakya, the minister of Chandragupta Maurya, wrote the Arthashastra, a treatise on statecraft. It combines realism with a strong sense of the ruler's duty to the people.

Lessons for governance

- Welfare of the people: the ruler's own good is said to lie in the happiness and welfare of his people (prajasukhe sukham rajnah), so public good comes before personal pleasure.
- Rajarshi: the ideal ruler is self-disciplined, learned and free from lust, anger and greed.
- Accountability: officials are to be tested for honesty before appointment, watched by spies and punished for misappropriation. Kautilya listed many ways in which officials may steal, and noted that, like fish moving in water, it is hard to detect them.
- Rule of law: punishment must be proportionate (danda), neither too harsh nor too lenient.
- Service delivery: care of orphans, the old and the sick, and the relief of famine.
- Merit: appointment according to ability.

Relevance today

- Principles of welfare, probity, merit and proportionality match the Constitution's goals and the demand for ethical governance.
- Vigilance and audit as safeguards parallel today's CAG and vigilance bodies.

Limits

- The use of spies and secret punishment would conflict with rights and privacy today.
- It was written for a monarchy, so participation and rights of citizens, central to democracy, are limited.

Conclusion Kautilya's emphasis on duty, probity and welfare is still valuable, but must be applied within constitutional rights, transparency and the rule of law.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Happy Subjects, Honest Servants": the welfare principle and the probity principle.

COMMON TRAP: Do not present Kautilya as only a cunning strategist; his work also has strong ideas of welfare and duty.

GS4 Q7 of 16 · 15 marks · Shivakumara Swami

PREDICTED · GS4-E5 · Karnataka-specific

Q7. Examine how the life of Shivakumara Swami of Siddaganga Math offers lessons on service, equality and education. Which values can public servants draw from it? (250 words)

Model answer

Shivakumara Swami (1 April 1907 to 21 January 2019) was the head of the Siddaganga Math at Tumakuru in Karnataka. Called the "Walking God", he lived for over 110 years in the service of children.

His work

- Through the Sri Siddaganga Education Society, he gave free food, shelter and education to thousands of children, regardless of caste, religion or background.
- The "trividha dasoha" of food, education and shelter became a model of social service.
- He received the Karnataka Ratna in 2007 and the Padma Bhushan in 2015.

Lessons on values

- Service (dasoha): work as service, with no thought of personal gain; the Math stayed simple while serving thousands.
- Equality: a common table for all children, which weakened caste barriers and followed the Lingayat tradition of Basavanna.
- Education as empowerment: he built schools and colleges in rural Karnataka, so first-generation learners gained opportunity.
- Discipline and consistency: a routine kept for decades.
- Humility and simplicity: a life of austerity, which gave moral authority.

Lessons for public servants

- Treat every citizen alike, and serve the last person first.
- Consistency in small tasks, like a daily meal, creates large results.
- Partnership between community institutions and the State can extend services.

Role of society

- Religious and community institutions can supplement government in education and welfare, if they are open and accountable.

Conclusion His life shows that character, equality and steady service move society more than speeches. Public servants can follow the same spirit in their daily work.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Food, Letters, Roof": the three gifts of the trividha dasoha.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not describe him only as a religious leader; his lasting contribution is social service and education.

GS4 Q8 of 16 · 10 marks · Discretion and Wednesbury

PREDICTED · GS4-E2

Q8. What is administrative discretion? Explain the ethical limits on its use with reference to the Wednesbury principle. (150 words)

Model answer

Administrative discretion is the freedom of an official to choose among lawful options. It is needed because rules cannot foresee every case.

Risks

- Arbitrariness, favouritism and corruption, since discretion can be used for personal benefit.

Limits

- Legal: the power must be used for the purpose given in the law, on relevant grounds, and in line with Article 14.
- Wednesbury principle (a 1948 English case, accepted in India): a decision is unreasonable if no reasonable authority could have made it, or if the official ignored relevant matters or considered irrelevant ones.
- Natural justice: a fair hearing and reasons for the decision.
- Ethical: use discretion in the public interest, apply it consistently, and avoid personal interest.

Safeguards

- Written reasons, guidelines, supervision, and judicial review.
- Transparency, such as publishing criteria.

Conclusion Discretion is a trust. It should be exercised openly, reasonably and for the public interest.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Right Purpose, Right Reasons, Right Process".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate discretion with licence; it is always bound by law, reason and fairness.

GS4 Q9 of 16 · 10 marks · Legislative ethics committees

PREDICTED · GS4-E4

Q9. Explain the role of ethics committees of legislatures in maintaining standards of public conduct. What are their limitations? (150 words)

Model answer

Legislators hold public trust, so Parliament has created bodies to enforce standards of conduct.

Institutions

- The Rajya Sabha Committee on Ethics was constituted on 4 March 1997.
- The Lok Sabha began with an ad hoc Ethics Committee in 2000, and made it a permanent committee in 2015.

Functions

- Prepare and enforce a code of conduct for members, examine complaints of unethical behaviour and recommend penalties such as censure, suspension or expulsion.
- In December 2023 the Lok Sabha expelled a member after the Ethics Committee's report on a cash-for-query allegation.

Limitations

- Members judge colleagues, so partisan influence is feared.
- The code is not a statute, and procedures for hearing are not always clear.
- Wide discretion in penalties, with limited disclosure.

Way forward

- Clear code and procedure, fair hearing, reasoned reports, and independent expert assistance.

Conclusion Self-regulation works when it is fair, transparent and consistent, not partisan.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Code, Complaint, Censure": the committee's three steps.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse the ethics committee with the Privileges Committee; the first looks at conduct and the second at breach of privilege.

GS4 Q10 of 16 · 10 marks · Environmental ethics

PREDICTED · GS4-E1 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Explain the main approaches in environmental ethics. How do Indian traditions, including community practices in Karnataka, support environmental protection? (150 words)

Model answer

Environmental ethics asks what moral duties human beings owe to nature.

Approaches

- Anthropocentric: nature has value for human use, so conservation protects human welfare.
- Biocentric: every living being has a value of its own.
- Ecocentric: ecosystems as wholes, including soil, water and species, deserve moral concern.
- Sustainability and justice: the present generation must not harm the future one, and the poor should not bear the cost.

Indian traditions

- Reverence for rivers, trees and animals in religious and folk practices; the Bishnoi community protects trees and wildlife.
- Gandhi said that the earth provides enough for everyone's need but not for everyone's greed.
- In Karnataka, sacred groves (devarakadu) of Kodagu and other hill districts protect forest patches through community belief.

Application: weigh development against ecological costs, with consent of affected communities.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Human, Life, Whole": the three circles of concern.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say that tradition alone can protect the environment; law and community participation are also needed.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Anthropocentric, biocentric and ecocentric approaches.

GS4: 10 of 16 done. Next up: Q11, Individual and institutional integrity.

GS4 Q11 of 16 · 10 marks · Individual and institutional integrity

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q11. Distinguish between individual integrity and institutional integrity. Why does each need the other? (150 words)

Model answer

Individual integrity is the consistency of a person's values, words and actions. Institutional integrity is the capacity of an organisation to act in line with its stated purpose and rules, resisting capture by private or political interests.

Differences

- Source: character for the first; rules, checks and culture for the second.
- Failure: an honest officer can be sidelined; an institution can decay even with some honest members.

Why each needs the other

- A good person in a weak system may be pressured or silenced, and may despair.
- A strong system without good people can become a shell, where checks are followed in form but not in spirit.
- Institutions shape behaviour through incentives, and individuals shape institutions through example.

Building both

- Transparent procedures, independent oversight, and protection for those who report wrongdoing.
- Selection for values, leadership by example, and ethics training.

Conclusion Honest people need protective institutions, and institutions need honest people.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Person plus Process": character and structure together.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not blame only individuals for corruption; weak systems and incentives also matter.

GS4 Q12 of 16 · 10 marks · Humility and Shastri

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q12. Explain how humility and simplicity strengthen public service, with reference to the life of Lal Bahadur Shastri. (150 words)

Model answer

Humility is awareness of one's limits and a readiness to learn; simplicity is a frugal life without show. In public service both increase trust.

Why they matter

- Humble officials listen to citizens and juniors, accept correction and avoid abuse of power.
- Simplicity reduces the temptation of luxury and corruption, and makes the official approachable.

Shastri's example

- After the Mahbubnagar train accident in 1956 he offered to resign and Nehru refused. After the Ariyalur accident later that year, he resigned again, and it was accepted, accepting moral responsibility.
- As Prime Minister, he coined "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan" in 1965, honouring the soldier and the farmer.
- He lived modestly, and spoke softly but acted firmly.

Lessons for officers

- Own mistakes and take responsibility.
- Avoid VIP culture, and treat all alike.

Caution: humility is not weakness; it should go with firmness in duty.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Own it, Slim it": own mistakes, keep life light.

COMMON TRAP: Do not equate humility with weakness; Shastri was both modest and decisive.

GS4 Q13 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: leaked question paper

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q13. Fictional case. Imagine that you are Secretary of the State Recruitment Board in Karnataka. A written examination for 1,200 posts is scheduled in two days, with three lakh candidates. Your vigilance officer tells you in confidence that a photograph of what appears to be the question paper is circulating in a closed messaging group, and that an unknown person is selling it. The printing press says its security has not been breached. If you cancel the exam, honest candidates, many from poor homes who have travelled long distances, will suffer, and the Minister's office wants "no controversy". If you do nothing, the exam may be compromised. (a) What values are in conflict here? (b) What courses of action are available? (c) Which would you adopt, and why? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Possible leak, two days to go, a secretive source, unclear truth, and political pressure.

D - Dimensions. Candidates: fairness and cost. Honest aspirants: heavy loss if the exam is cancelled. Board: credibility. Minister's office: pressure. Police and vigilance: need for evidence. You: duty to uphold merit under Article 16.

R - Rules and values. Merit and equality of opportunity; the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 for central examinations and the State's own laws and criminal law for conspiracy; integrity, courage and transparency. "No controversy" is not a legal ground to ignore a threat.

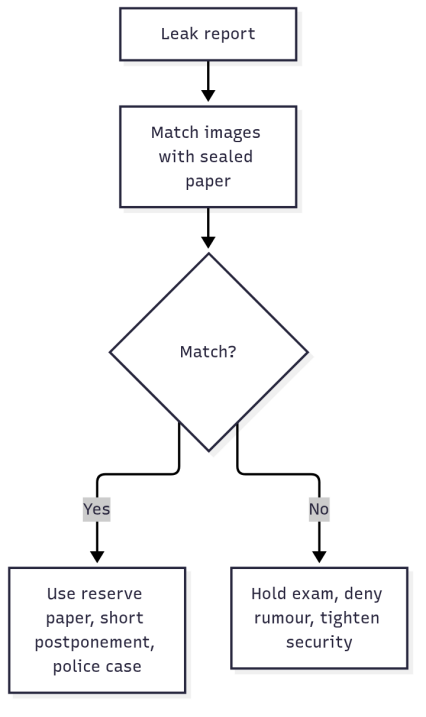
A - Options.

1. Proceed without checking: convenient, but may reward cheats.
2. Cancel at once: protects fairness, but without proof it may be unfair to candidates and costly.
3. Verify fast, then decide on facts, with a backup: compare the photograph with the paper, secure the press, and prepare an alternate paper.

T - Take the decision. My choice is option 3.

- Within hours: Match the images with the sealed papers with the press, and report to the police for a quick investigation of the source.
- If it matches: replace the paper, using a reserve set kept for emergencies, and announce a short postponement with clear reasons; arrange extra transport help for the poor.
- If it does not match: hold the exam as planned, tell candidates that the rumour is false, and tighten security.
- Inform the Chairman and Government in writing, and refuse to take instructions to hide facts.
- Systemic: Digital watermarking, fewer people with access.

Justification. The decision protects merit and honest candidates, and keeps the Board credible.



DRAW IT: Responding to a possible paper leak. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CHECK, CHOOSE, COMMUNICATE": verify, decide on facts and tell the public.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not cancel on a rumour, and do not hide a likely leak to avoid "controversy".

GS4 Q14 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: cracked flyover

PREDICTED · CS

Q14. Fictional case. Imagine that you are the Chief Engineer of a Public Works Department in a State. A flyover due for opening by the Chief Minister in five days has been completed, and a young assistant engineer reports in writing that load tests on two spans show cracks beyond the permitted limit. The contractor says that the cracks are cosmetic. Your superior asks you to "sign the completion certificate", saying that a delay will embarrass the Government, and that the defect can be repaired after inauguration. The assistant engineer fears for his job. (a) Who are the stakeholders, and what is at stake for each? (b) Evaluate your options. (c) What will you do? (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A possible structural defect, a political deadline, a contractor's denial, and a junior who has warned in writing.

D - Dimensions. Road users: safety of life. Assistant engineer: integrity and fear of retaliation. Contractor: contract and reputation. Superior and Government: pressure and image. You: professional duty and the department's standing.

R - Rules and values. Professional duty and the technical codes for bridge testing; public safety as the highest value; the law on negligence causing death; honesty, courage and accountability. A date set for an event cannot override safety. A false certificate is a record falsified.

A - Options.

1. Sign and repair later: meets the date, but endangers lives and makes me an accomplice.
2. Refuse silently: keeps me clean, but gives no solution and leaves the junior exposed.

3. Get an independent test, refuse to certify until it passes, and report in writing.

T - Take the decision. Option 3 is my choice.

- Order an urgent independent load test by an expert institution, with the contractor present.
- Do not sign the certificate until the report is clear; inform the superior in writing that a certificate cannot be given on present evidence.
- Offer the Government alternatives: a delayed inauguration, or opening only after repair, with a clear public explanation.
- Protect the assistant engineer by recording his report officially, and ensure he faces no harassment.
- If the test shows poor work, enforce the contract: repair at the contractor's cost, and fix responsibility.

Justification. The decision puts life before a ceremony, upholds professional honesty and protects a truthful junior.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "TEST, TELL, TURN DOWN": test independently, tell in writing, refuse to certify.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not sign "subject to repairs"; a certificate is a statement of fitness.

GS4 Q15 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: tiger reserve relocation

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Fictional case. Imagine that you head the administration of a Karnataka district that contains a tiger reserve. Forty families of a tribal hamlet inside the core area have been listed for voluntary relocation, and the Forest Department wants the process to be completed in a month, to meet a target. A visit shows that many families have not been told the details of the package, that some have rights recognised under the Forest Rights Act and others have claims pending, and that a few elders say they will not leave their ancestral land. A local contractor is pressing the families to sign "for a better life", and he is likely to benefit from the construction at the new site. (a) Bring out the ethical dilemmas. (b) Examine the alternatives before you. (c) Explain the course you would take. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Relocation target, inadequate information, pending rights, resistance by elders and a contractor with an interest.

D - Dimensions. Families: livelihood, culture, consent. Elders: attachment to land. Forest Department: conservation target. Wildlife: core habitat. Contractor: private gain. You: rule of law and justice to a vulnerable group.

R - Rules and values. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 requires recognition of rights before relocation and the free, informed consent of the Gram Sabha. The Wildlife Protection Act allows only voluntary relocation from core areas with a fair package. Values: justice, consent, dignity, sustainability and conflict of interest.

A - Options.

1. Complete in a month: meets the target, but forced consent would violate rights.
2. Drop relocation: respects the elders, but ignores the conservation purpose.
3. Proceed only with rights settled, full information and consent.

T - Take the decision. Option 3 is my choice.

- Complete the settlement of rights claims first, with the Sub-Divisional Committee.
- Hold a Gram Sabha with the package explained in the tribal language, with an independent observer; consent should be recorded without pressure.

- Keep the contractor away from the talks, and examine his link with the project.
- Let willing families go first, with choice of site, schools and livelihood training; keep dialogue open with the elders.
- Tell the Department in writing that the target will be revised, since a hurried move would invite legal challenge and lasting distrust.
- Track the families after the move, with a grievance cell, so that promises on land, houses and jobs are kept.

Justification. The decision protects tribal rights, and also honours conservation by securing relocation that is voluntary and lasting.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "RIGHTS, READ, RESPECT": settle rights, inform fully and respect the Gram Sabha.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat relocation as a target to be met, or use "voluntary" to describe a signature under pressure.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Forest Rights Act 2006: recognition of rights and Gram Sabha consent; Wildlife Protection Act voluntary relocation.

GS4: 15 of 16 done. Next up: Q16, Case: anonymous complaint.

GS4 Q16 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: anonymous complaint

PREDICTED · CS

Q16. Fictional case. Imagine that you are the head of a department in a State. An anonymous letter alleges that an Assistant Director, known as honest and hard working, took money from a trader to approve a licence. No evidence is attached. A senior officer, your immediate superior, wants the Assistant Director to be suspended immediately, since "the media is already asking". The Assistant Director says that the trader holds a grudge because his licence was refused for a defect. A rejected file does support this. Meanwhile, the trader has met your superior's relative. (a) Set out the ethical questions involved. (b) Weigh the possible responses. (c) Describe and defend your response. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. An anonymous allegation without proof, pressure to act quickly, a possible motive for a false complaint and a possible link between the trader and your superior.

D - Dimensions. Assistant Director: reputation and livelihood. Public and the media: trust. Trader: possible grudge. Superior: pressure and a possible conflict of interest. You: fairness and the department's integrity.

R - Rules and values. Natural justice, the presumption of innocence, and Article 311 and the Karnataka Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1957, which require an inquiry before punishment. Suspension is not punishment, but should not be used as a show. Values: fairness, objectivity, courage and zero tolerance for corruption.

A - Options.

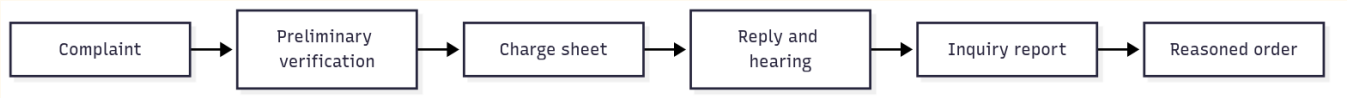
1. Suspend at once: satisfies the media, but may punish an innocent person.
2. Ignore the letter: protects the officer, but a real offence would escape.
3. Verify discreetly, inquire fairly, and manage the conflict of interest.

T - Take the decision. Option 3 is my choice.

- Ask the vigilance wing for a quick, confidential preliminary check of bank records and the licence file.

- Give the Assistant Director a chance to explain, and keep the complainant's motive on record.
- Record the superior's relative's meeting, and request that the matter be handled by someone else, or report it to the higher authority.
- Suspend only if the check shows a prima facie case or risk of tampering with evidence, with reasons.
- Tell the media that the complaint is under inquiry.

Justification. The decision protects the innocent, deals with real corruption and keeps the process free from influence.



DRAW IT: Natural justice in a disciplinary case. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "CHECK, HEAR, DISCLOSE": check the facts, hear the officer, disclose the conflict.

COMMON TRAP: Do not suspend to please the media; and do not ignore the complaint because the officer is "honest".

RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q12 Humility and Shastri:** "Own it, Slim it": own mistakes, keep life light. **Q13 Case: leaked question paper:** "CHECK, CHOOSE, COMMUNICATE": verify, decide on facts and tell the public. **Q14 Case: cracked flyover:** "TEST, TELL, TURN DOWN": test independently, tell in writing, refuse to certify. **Q15 Case: tiger reserve relocation:** "RIGHTS, READ, RESPECT": settle rights, inform fully and respect the Gram Sabha. **Q16 Case: anonymous complaint:** "CHECK, HEAR, DISCLOSE": check the facts, hear the officer, disclose the conflict.

Kannada and English practice (short)

> **REVIEW:** The Kannada text in this section was written without a native-speaker check. Please have a Kannada teacher or fluent speaker read it before you treat it as a model. The English parts follow plain formal style.

Practice 1: Kannada essay (ಪ್ರಬಂಧ), about 120 words

Topic: ಪರಿಸರ ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆ ಮತ್ತು ನಮ್ಮ ಹೊಣೆ (Protecting the environment and our duty)

Outline (ರೂಪರೇಖೆ): ಪೀಠಿಕೆ → ಪರಿಸರ ನಾಶದ ಕಾರಣಗಳು → ಪರಿಣಾಮಗಳು → ನಾವು ಮಾಡಬಹುದಾದದ್ದು → ಉಪಸಂಹಾರ

Model essay (ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ):

ಗಾಳಿ, ನೀರು, ಮಣ್ಣು ಮತ್ತು ಕಾಡು ನಮ್ಮ ಬದುಕಿನ ಆಧಾರ. ಆದರೆ ಕಾಡು ಕಡಿಯುವಿಕೆ, ಪ್ಲಾಸ್ಟಿಕ್ ಬಳಕೆ, ವಾಹನಗಳ ಹೊಗೆ ಮತ್ತು ಕಸದ ರಾಶಿಯಿಂದ ಪರಿಸರ ಹಾಳಾಗುತ್ತಿದೆ. ಇದರಿಂದ ಮಳೆ ಅನಿಯಮಿತವಾಗಿದೆ, ಬರ ಮತ್ತು ಪ್ರವಾಹ ಹೆಚ್ಚಾಗಿವೆ ಮತ್ತು ಜನರ ಆರೋಗ್ಯ ಕೆಡುತ್ತಿದೆ. ಪಶ್ಚಿಮ ಘಟ್ಟಗಳ ಕಾಡುಗಳು ಕರ್ನಾಟಕದ ನದಿಗಳಿಗೆ ಜೀವ ನೀಡುತ್ತವೆ; ಅವುಗಳನ್ನು ಉಳಿಸುವುದು ನಮ್ಮ ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ. ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಬ್ಬರೂ ಗಿಡ ನೆಡಬಹುದು, ಬಟ್ಟೆಯ ಚೀಲ ಬಳಸಬಹುದು, ನೀರು ಮತ್ತು ವಿದ್ಯುತ್ ಉಳಿಸಬಹುದು ಮತ್ತು ಕಸವನ್ನು ಬೇರ್ಪಡಿಸಿ ನೀಡಬಹುದು. ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಕಾನೂನುಗಳ ಜೊತೆಗೆ ಜನರ ಸಹಭಾಗಿತ್ವವೂ ಬೇಕು. ಭೂಮಿ ನಮಗೆ ಪೂರ್ವಜರಿಂದ ಬಂದ ಆಸ್ತಿ ಮಾತ್ರವಲ್ಲ, ಮುಂದಿನ ಪೀಳಿಗೆಯಿಂದ ಪಡೆದ ಸಾಲವೂ ಹೌದು.

Practice 2: Translate into Kannada (ಅನುವಾದ)

#	English	Model Kannada
1	Forests bring rain.	ಕಾಡುಗಳು ಮಳೆ ತರುತ್ತವೆ.
2	Do not waste water.	ನೀರನ್ನು ವ್ಯರ್ಥ ಮಾಡಬೇಡಿ.
3	The farmer is the backbone of the country.	ರೈತ ದೇಶದ ಬೆನ್ನೆಲುಬು.
4	Every citizen must vote in the election.	ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಬ್ಬ ನಾಗರಿಕನೂ ಚುನಾವಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಮತ ಚಲಾಯಿಸಬೇಕು.
5	The office will remain closed tomorrow.	ನಾಳೆ ಕಚೇರಿಗೆ ರಜೆ ಇರುತ್ತದೆ.

Practice 3: English precis (reduce to one-third)

Passage (about 150 words):

A village tank is more than a pool of water. For centuries, tanks in the dry districts of the Deccan stored the monsoon run-off, recharged wells, watered paddy and gave fish, silt and grazing to the community. They survived because people looked after them together: farmers removed silt before the rains, a local watchman guarded the sluice, and customs fixed who could draw water and when. In the last century, much of this care faded. Canals and borewells made tanks seem unnecessary, encroachments narrowed their feeder channels, and towns dumped sewage into them. Many tanks became dry hollows or dirty ponds. Yet the reasons for reviving them are stronger than ever. Groundwater is falling, rain arrives in short heavy bursts, and cities flood when their lakes are filled in. Restoring tanks is cheap compared with new dams, but it works only if the community again takes ownership, with the government supporting rather than replacing it.

Model precis (about 50 words), with title "Reviving the village tank":

Village tanks once stored water, recharged wells and fed communities because people maintained them jointly. Canals, borewells, encroachment and sewage led to their decline. Falling groundwater, intense rain and urban floods now make revival urgent. It is cheap, but it needs community ownership backed by government.

Practice 4: Formal letter (English)

Task: Write a letter to the Executive Engineer of the electricity supply company about frequent unscheduled power cuts in your area.

Model letter:

From: K. Lakshmi, 2nd Cross, Gandhinagar, Hosapete Town, Karnataka - 500 000 To: The Executive Engineer, Electricity Supply Company Division Office, Karnataka Date: 27 October 2026

Sir,

Subject: Frequent unscheduled power cuts in Gandhinagar

I write on behalf of the residents of Gandhinagar to report that our area has had power cuts of two to four hours almost every day for the last three weeks, without any notice. Students preparing for examinations, small shops and patients who use medical equipment at home are badly affected, and repeated voltage changes have damaged household appliances.

I request you to inspect the local transformer and lines, to announce any planned shutdowns in advance, and to provide a complaint number that responds promptly. I would be grateful for early action.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, K. Lakshmi

Review report for Set 3

REVIEW: Checks run on 27-10-2026 (IST). Machine checks cover every answer; the fact review covers a sample of 12 of 76 questions (16%, above the 15% target): Essay 2; GS1 Q5, Q15, Q18; GS2 Q9, Q17; GS3 Q2, Q7, Q16; GS4 Q9, Q12, Q13. The review was done by the same author in a separate read, not by an outside person, so treat it as a careful self-review.

Check	Result
Word limits (10 marks: 150; 15 marks: 250; 20 marks: 300; essays: 1,200)	0 over the limit; all answers at 80% of the limit or more
Copy check: 6-word overlaps with past mains papers, the existing 40 model answers, Sets 1 and 2 and the other Set 3 files	0 flagged after fixes
Economic Survey and PRS figures, matched against the saved source text	0 mismatches
Remember-line and common-trap box on every answer	All present

Fact ledger for Set 3: 38 ES lines, 3 PRS lines, 48 web-checked lines, 92 static lines (181 in all).

Fact sources, honestly stated

- **Machine-matched (ES = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26; PRS = Karnataka Budget analysis 2026-27):** fiscal deficit 2.9% of GSDP and guarantee spending Rs 51,286 crore; power peak 18,395 MW, ESCOM losses, 35.67 lakh pump sets; tiger reserves; Western Ghats share and Biodiversity Management Committees; urban local body counts; CPGRAMS/Janaspandana figures; disability count from Census 2011.
- **Checked on the web this session:** Kigali schedule for India (freeze 2028, cuts to 85% by 2047; ratified September 2021); DPDP Rules notified 13 November 2025; Kasturirangan area 59,940 sq km; UNESCO 2012 inscription with 39 sites; Rajya Sabha Ethics Committee 4 March 1997 and Lok Sabha permanent committee 2015; Shastri's 1956 resignations; Shivakumara Swami dates and awards; SIR of the Bihar roll; AMU judgment of 8 November 2024 (4:3); WTO MC14 at Yaounde.
- **Found wrong and fixed:** the Quit India answer said the Ishur villagers "defied British officers". Ishur was in princely Mysore, and the officials they clashed with were the State's revenue and police officers; the answer now says that, and that five villagers were hanged. In the GS2 sample, a Set 1 repeat (sex ratio) was replaced by a new disability question.
- **Source conflict to note:** the Economic Survey lists 13 + 64 + 120 + 120 + 4 = 321 urban local bodies in one place and 316 in another table. The answer quotes the itemised list; check the latest figure before quoting a total.
- **Static or textbook facts** (Judges Cases, NJAC 4:1, Project Tiger 1973 with nine reserves, Montreal 1987, Articles, Maslow, Riggs): checked from memory in the sample read, not all by live search.
- **Search-synthesis only, re-verify before quoting:** BIRSA 101, Gaganyaan timeline, Jan Vishwas 2026, CBAM, KVK numbers, BharatNet, PMAY-G/SVAMITVA figures, India-UK and India-EU trade deals, MPI figure for Karnataka, MC14 outcomes, ISA membership, NHRC 2019 amendment details, Wayanad and Shirur dates.

Known gaps

- The 2025 past papers are scanned images, so the copy check against them is weaker.
- Fictional case studies are invented; the GS4 cases share the SDRAT method but now use different question wording.
- The Kannada practice section needs a native reader.

KAS Mains Mock Set 4: Fully Solved

Built 27-10-2026 23:46 IST | 5 papers x 250 marks | every question is PREDICTED from the trend blueprint, never copied from a past paper

PREDICTED: These questions are predictions from the pattern of the 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 papers (see TREND_BLUEPRINT). They are practice, not leaked or past questions. Model answers stay inside the word limit printed with each question. Facts are tied to official sources where possible; a fact list is kept for each answer.

CHAI-TALK: Do this set like an exam: one paper at a time, three hours each, writing by hand. Then read the model answer, tick what you covered, and copy the purple memory line for anything you missed. Do not read all five papers in one sitting. Five good papers beat fifty skimmed ones.

Set 4: step 1 of 6. Next up: Paper 1, the Essay.

Paper 1: Essay

Set 4: step 2 of 6 (Essay). Next up: General Studies I (GS1)

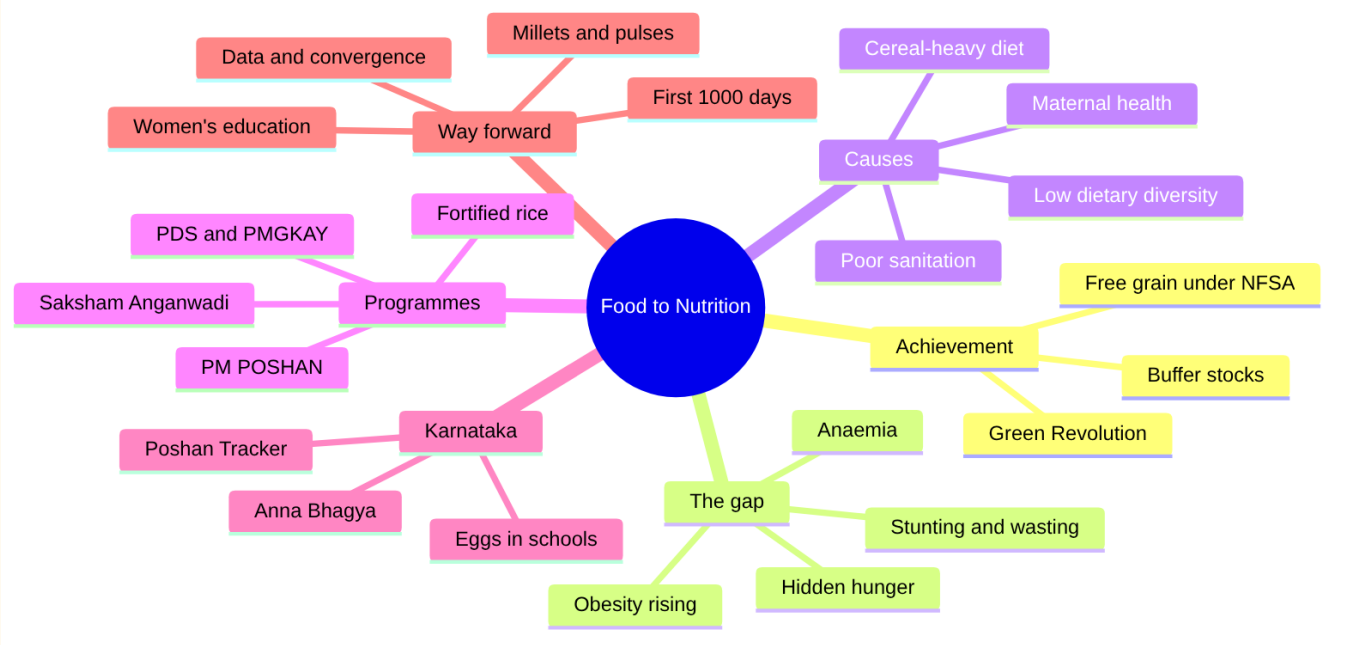
Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Instructions:** write two essays, one from each part, about 1,000 to 1,200 words each. Both carry 125 marks. (This is the practice shape; check the latest KPSC notification for exact instructions.)

> **CHAI-TALK:** An essay is a short journey: a hook, a clear stand, three or four strong turns, a fair look at the other side and a landing that points forward. Read the mind map first, then the essay, and then try to rebuild the map from memory.

Essay 1 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-1

Q1. From food security to nutrition security: India has filled its granaries, but has it filled its children's plates? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 1: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

In 1966 India imported grain from the United States, ship by ship, to avoid famine. Six decades later, the Food Corporation of India stores more grain than it can comfortably hold, and about 80 crore people receive free foodgrains each month. This is one of the great achievements of independent India. Yet a child in a village anganwadi may eat rice every day and still be too short for her age, pale with anaemia and slow to learn. Filling the stomach and nourishing the body are two different tasks. India has largely solved the first; the second is its unfinished agenda.

From scarcity to surplus

The Green Revolution of the late 1960s, built on high-yielding seeds, irrigation, fertiliser and assured procurement, turned India from a food-deficit country into a food-surplus one. The public distribution system grew from a rationing device into a safety net. The National Food Security Act, 2013 converted that safety net into a legal entitlement: up to 75 per cent of the rural and 50 per cent of the urban

population are entitled to five kilograms of grain per person per month at subsidised prices, with special provisions for pregnant women, lactating mothers and children. Since January 2024 this grain has been given free under the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana, which has been extended for five years. In calorie terms, starvation as a mass condition has largely disappeared.

The nutrition gap

The National Family Health Survey 2019-21 (NFHS-5) shows the other side. About 35 per cent of children under five are stunted, about 19 per cent are wasted and about 32 per cent are underweight. More than half of women aged 15-49 and about two-thirds of young children are anaemic. At the same time, overweight and diabetes are rising, even in poorer households. Nutritionists call this the "double burden": undernutrition and obesity in the same country, sometimes in the same family.

Stunting matters because it is largely irreversible after the first two years of life. A stunted child is likely to learn less in school, earn less as an adult and give birth to a smaller baby, so the disadvantage passes to the next generation. A country that wants a demographic dividend cannot afford a generation whose potential has been cut short before it entered school.

Why grain is not enough

Diet is narrow. The PDS has historically supplied rice and wheat, which are cheap sources of calories but poor in protein, iron, zinc and vitamins. Pulses, milk, eggs, fruit and vegetables cost more, and their prices rise faster during inflation.

The body cannot absorb what the gut loses. Diarrhoea and intestinal infection caused by unsafe water and poor sanitation waste nutrients. Swachh Bharat has reduced open defecation, but hygiene and water quality remain uneven.

Mothers carry the burden. Early marriage, early pregnancy, low maternal weight and anaemia produce low-birth-weight babies. Women often eat last and least in the household.

Knowledge and care. Exclusive breastfeeding for six months and proper complementary feeding after that are cheap, but they depend on counselling, time and the support of the family, which working mothers often lack.

What the State is doing

The response has widened from grain to nutrition. PM POSHAN provides a hot cooked meal to school children. Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 combine supplementary food, growth monitoring and counselling, and the Poshan Tracker records the weight and height of children in real time. Rice fortified with iron, folic acid and vitamin B12 is now supplied through the PDS and welfare schemes. Anaemia Mukt Bharat provides iron and folic acid supplements to children, adolescents and pregnant women, and the United Nations' millet year of 2023 revived interest in nutritious coarse grains.

Karnataka's experience

Karnataka gives an instructive example. The State's latest Economic Survey notes that, under NFSA and the State's Anna Bhagya, eligible families receive ten kilograms of rice per member per month. The State has added eggs, milk and other items to school and anganwadi menus. Yet the same Survey reports that Poshan Tracker data for December 2025 identified 72,367 moderately and 6,444 severely malnourished children. The lesson is plain: more rice reduces hunger, but it does not automatically reduce malnutrition. Northern districts in Kalyana Karnataka, with higher poverty and lower female literacy, need more than a bigger grain ration.

Counter-arguments

Some argue that free grain creates dependence and distorts cropping, since procurement favours paddy and wheat and encourages water-hungry crops in dry regions. Others say that cash transfers would let families choose a better diet. Both points deserve attention. But cash is eroded by inflation and may not

reach the woman of the house, while food in kind is reliable during crises, as the pandemic showed. The better answer is not to dismantle the PDS but to diversify what it delivers.

The way forward

First, diversify the plate. Add pulses, millets and edible oil to the PDS in a phased way, linked to local procurement so that farmers have a reason to grow them.

Second, focus on the first thousand days. From conception to the child's second birthday, intensive support for the mother and child through anganwadis, ASHAs and health centres gives the best return on every rupee.

Third, connect water, sanitation and health. Nutrition will not improve where children drink unsafe water. Jal Jeevan Mission and sanitation work should be targeted at districts with high stunting.

Fourth, empower women. Girls' secondary education, delayed marriage and women's income are among the strongest predictors of a well-fed child.

Fifth, use data well. The Poshan Tracker should drive action at the anganwadi level, not only reports at the State level, and the accuracy of measurement must be checked regularly.

Sixth, fight the new problem too. Labelling of foods high in sugar, salt and fat, and school education on diet, can slow the rise of obesity and diabetes.

Conclusion

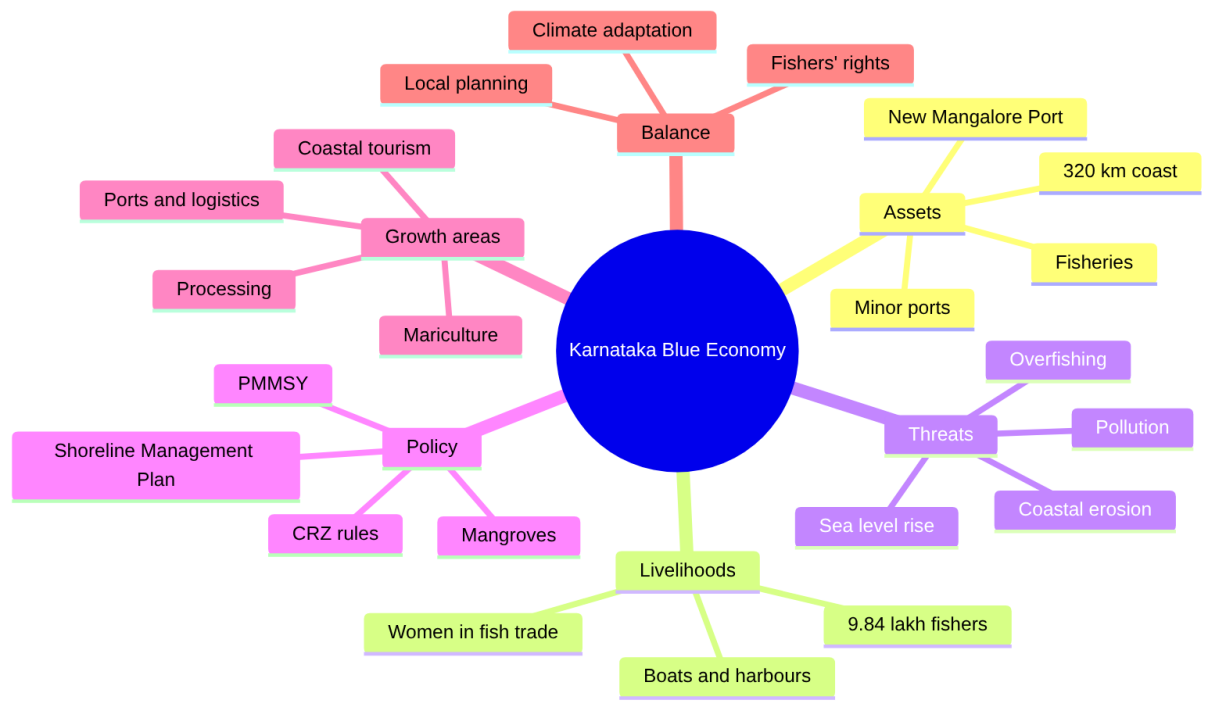
India's granaries are proof that policy, science and farmers working together can change a nation's fate. The next test is quieter but no less important: whether every child grows to her full height and mind. Food security asked, "Does everyone have enough to eat?" Nutrition security asks, "Does everyone have enough of the right food, and can the body use it?" The second question will decide whether India's young population becomes its strength.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PLATE": Pulses and diversity, Little ones' first 1,000 days, Anaemia, Toilets and water, Empower women.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate free grain with good nutrition; the essay must show the gap between calorie sufficiency and micronutrient and growth outcomes, with data.

Essay 2 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-2 · Karnataka-specific

Q2. Karnataka's 320-kilometre coast: how can the State grow a blue economy while protecting its fishers and its shoreline? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 2: mind map.

Model answer

Introduction

At dawn on the Malpe harbour in Udupi, hundreds of boats come in with fish that will reach Bengaluru, Kerala and export markets within a day. A few kilometres away, a family watches the sea eat into its coconut grove a little more each monsoon. Karnataka's coast holds both promise and peril. The State's Economic Survey for 2025-26 describes a shoreline of roughly 320 kilometres served by a single major harbour and thirteen smaller ones, and a vision to make Karnataka a competitive maritime hub. The question is how to use the sea for growth without sacrificing the people who live by it and the land it protects.

What the coast offers

Ports and trade. New Mangalore, the one port under the Centre's major-port category, handles petroleum, coal, iron ore and containers. Minor ports such as Karwar and Belekeri, and new projects proposed under public-private partnership such as the Keni greenfield port, can reduce logistics costs for north Karnataka's industries.

Fisheries. According to the Survey, close to ten lakh people (9.84 lakh) earn a living from fishing, a third of them at sea. Output has risen by about two-thirds in a decade, reaching 9.63 lakh tonnes last year (2024-25). Fish is also a cheap source of protein for coastal families.

Tourism and culture. Gokarna, Murudeshwar, the St Mary's Islands and the beaches of Udupi and Uttara Kannada attract visitors. The coast's temples, Yakshagana and cuisine are part of the attraction.

New industries. Mariculture, seaweed farming, fish processing, ship repair and offshore wind are possible growth areas, as the national push for a blue economy has recognised.

Who lives on the coast

The coast is not a single economy. The Mogaveera, Kharvi and other fishing communities have their own customs, cooperatives and temples, and women dominate the drying and retail trade in fish markets from Bhatkal to Mangaluru. Migrant workers from Odisha and Jharkhand now crew many trawlers. Coconut and areca growers, cashew processors and small traders live a few kilometres inland. Any coastal policy has to reckon with these different interests: what helps a trawler owner may hurt a canoe fisher, and what brings

tourists may raise land prices beyond the reach of a fishing family. A blue economy that does not recognise these layers will produce winners and losers without meaning to.

The pressures

Erosion. The coast is eroding in many stretches. The Survey records that 2,285 metres of sea walls were built in three coastal districts in 2024-25 at a cost of Rs 28.57 crore. Hard sea walls protect a stretch but often shift erosion to the next one.

Overfishing. Trawlers and purse-seiners have increased catch pressure. Juvenile fish are caught, and conflicts between mechanised boats and traditional fishers are common. The annual monsoon fishing ban helps, but enforcement and alternative income during the ban are uneven.

Pollution and habitat loss. Untreated sewage from towns, plastic, and discharge from industries affect estuaries and mangroves, which are nurseries for fish.

Climate change. Warmer seas change fish migration, as the oil sardine's fluctuating catch has shown, and stronger cyclones in the Arabian Sea threaten boats and coastal homes.

Development conflicts. Ports, highways and tourism projects compete for the same narrow strip between the Western Ghats and the sea. Fishers fear losing landing beaches and access to the water.

The policy framework

The Coastal Regulation Zone Notification, 2019 regulates construction near the shore and requires Coastal Zone Management Plans. The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana funds harbours, cold chains, boats and insurance. Karnataka engaged the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management to prepare a Shoreline Management Plan for its coastline, which was submitted in November 2024, according to the Survey. The State's mangrove conservation programme works in the Honnavar, Mangaluru, Karwar and Kundapur areas. Fish farmer producer organisations and Kisan Credit Cards for fishers are expanding credit and collective marketing.

Balancing growth and protection

The case for growth is strong. Coastal Karnataka has high literacy, good banking and a tradition of enterprise, from the Udupi hotel trade to cooperative banking. Better ports can spread industry to Uttara Kannada, which has lagged behind Dakshina Kannada. But growth that ignores the sea's limits will undermine itself. A port that destroys a fishing village's beach, or a resort that blocks a creek, transfers wealth from the poor to the powerful and makes the coast more vulnerable to storms.

The way forward

First, plan with the Shoreline Management Plan. Decisions on sea walls, ports and buildings should follow the sediment cells identified by scientists. Soft measures such as beach nourishment, dune restoration and mangrove belts should be preferred where they work.

Second, manage fish as a shared resource. Strict enforcement of mesh sizes and juvenile catch limits, a stronger monsoon ban with income support, and co-management with fishing cooperatives can restore stocks.

Third, add value on land. Cold storage, processing, export certification and the participation of women fish vendors can raise income without catching more fish.

Fourth, protect fishers' rights. Their landing sites, villages and access routes should be mapped and protected in coastal plans, and they should be consulted before projects are approved.

Fifth, prepare for climate. Cyclone shelters, early warning through mobile phones, boat insurance and climate-resilient housing are necessary in every coastal taluk.

Sixth, clean the estuaries. Sewage treatment in Mangaluru, Udupi and Karwar and a ban on dumping plastic in rivers will help both tourism and fisheries.

Conclusion

The sea has given Karnataka's coast its wealth, its food and its culture. A blue economy that treats the coast only as real estate for ports and resorts will impoverish it; one that treats it only as a place to protect will leave its young people without jobs. The State's task is to grow along the coast, not at its cost: with plans drawn on science, fishers at the table and the shoreline treated as public wealth.

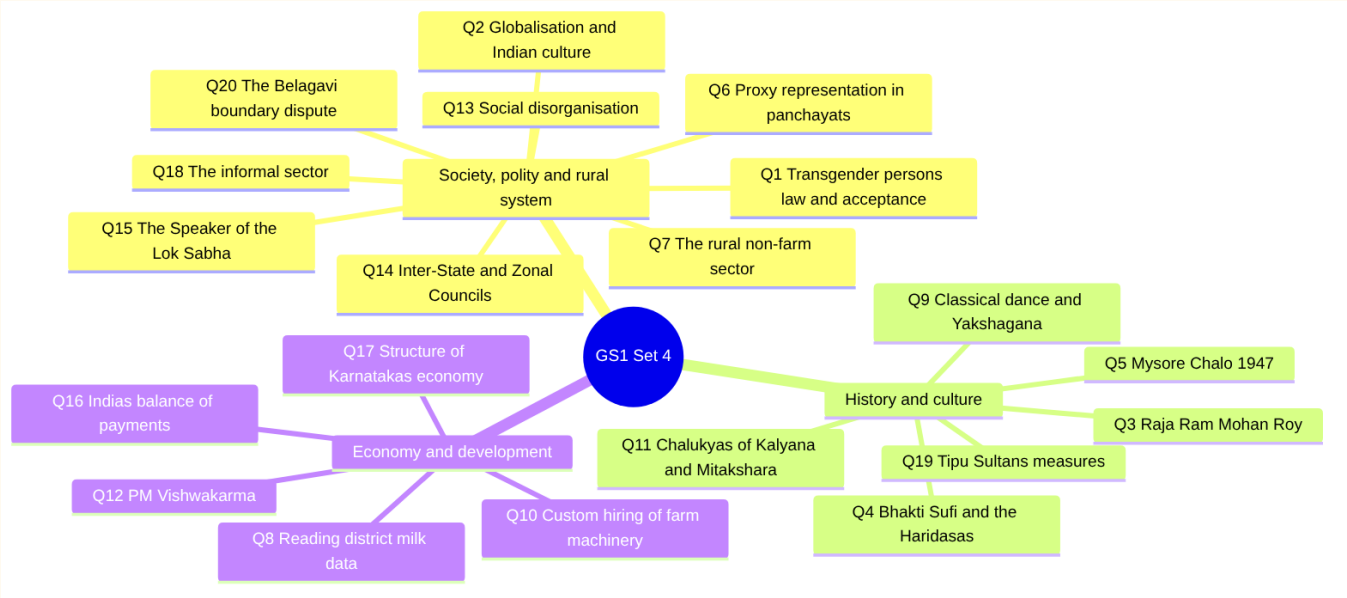
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PORTS-FISH": Plans on science, Ocean stocks, Rights of fishers, Tourism with care, Shoreline; Fish value, Infrastructure, Storms, Harbours clean.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write only about ports and investment; the examiner expects fishers, erosion, CRZ and climate, with a balance between growth and protection.
>
> **RECAP:** Both essays follow the same shape: hook, stand, turns, other side, way forward. Try writing a 5-line plan for any new topic in 4 minutes before you start.

Paper 2: General Studies I (GS1)

Set 4: step 3 of 6 (General Studies I (GS1)). Next up: General Studies II (GS2)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Set 4 opens with society and culture: transgender rights, globalisation, Ram Mohan Roy and the Haridasas, then Mysore Chalo, the Kalyana Chalukyas and Tipu Sultan. Anchor each answer in a date, a law or a Karnataka place.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS1 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · Transgender persons: law and acceptance

PREDICTED · GS1-B3 · Current affairs

Q1. "Legal recognition has come, social acceptance has not." Examine this statement with reference to transgender persons in India. (150 words)

Model answer

In NALSA v Union of India (2014) the Supreme Court recognised transgender persons as a "third gender" with the right to self-identify, and the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 prohibits discrimination in education, jobs, health care and housing.

Gains

- Identity certificates and cards through the National Portal for Transgender Persons; the SMILE scheme supports shelter homes (Garima Greh) and skills.
- Karnataka was the first State to reserve one per cent of government posts for them (2021).

Why acceptance lags

- Family rejection pushes many out of home and school early; begging and sex work remain the default for some.
- Stigma in hospitals, schools and police stations; a certificate process critics call intrusive.
- Supriyo v Union of India (2023) declined to recognise same-sex marriage, leaving partnership rights to Parliament.

Way forward Sensitise teachers, doctors and police; inclusive school curricula; and enforce the 2019 Act's grievance officers.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Law, Label, Livelihood": the law exists, the label is accepted, livelihood and dignity lag.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse transgender rights with the same-sex marriage case; mention it only as a related limit.

GS1 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · Globalisation and Indian culture

PREDICTED · GS1-B3

Q2. How has globalisation influenced Indian family life, food, dress and youth culture? Is it a threat to cultural identity or an opportunity for cultural renewal? (250 words)

Model answer

Globalisation is the growing flow of goods, capital, people and ideas across borders. Since 1991 it has reached Indian homes through television, the internet, multinational brands and migration.

Influences

- Family: more nuclear and dual-income families; later marriage; individual choice in partners and careers.
- Food: fast food chains and packaged snacks, alongside a global market for Indian cuisine, spices and millets.
- Dress: jeans and western office wear are common, while traditional dress is kept for festivals and weddings.
- Youth culture: social media, global music and gaming; English as aspiration; a new consumer identity.

Why some see a threat

- Homogenisation and the loss of local languages, crafts and food traditions.
- Consumerism, rising lifestyle diseases and weaker care for the elderly.
- Cultural products of rich countries dominate screens.

Why it can renew culture

- Glocalisation: global brands adapt to local tastes, and Indian content travels abroad, from yoga to Kannada and Telugu cinema.
- Diaspora networks fund temples, festivals and language schools; crafts find online buyers.
- Exposure to ideas of equality has strengthened women's and Dalit voices.

Karnataka example Bengaluru's IT workforce mixes global work culture with Kannada Rajyotsava celebrations and a revival of interest in Yakshagana and millets.

Way forward Promote mother-tongue education, protect crafts through GI tags and online markets, and teach media literacy to the young.

Conclusion Culture is not a museum piece; it survives by adapting. Globalisation is a threat only when a society loses confidence in its own roots.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "FFDY": Family, Food, Dress, Youth; then threat versus renewal.

COMMON TRAP: Do not write a one-sided lament; the question asks you to weigh threat against opportunity.

GS1 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · Raja Ram Mohan Roy

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q3. Assess Raja Ram Mohan Roy's contribution to social and religious reform in nineteenth-century India. (150 words)

Model answer

Raja Ram Mohan Roy (1772-1833) is often called the "father of the Indian Renaissance" for combining rational inquiry with a reading of the Upanishads.

Contributions

- Religious reform: set up the Brahmo Sabha (1828) (later the Brahmo Samaj), preaching monotheism and opposing idol worship and ritualism.
- Sati: his campaign helped Lord William Bentinck abolish sati through Regulation XVII of 1829.
- Women: argued for women's property rights and against polygamy and child marriage.
- Education: supported English and scientific education, helped found the Hindu College and his own Anglo-Hindu school.
- Press: published Sambad Kaumudi and Mirat-ul-Akhbar, and protested the Press Regulation of 1823.

Limits His influence was largely urban, upper-caste and Bengali, and the Samaj later split.

Conclusion He opened the path that later reformers, from Vidyasagar to the Prarthana Samaj, would widen.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "SWEP": Sati, Women, Education, Press.

COMMON TRAP: Do not credit him with the Widow Remarriage Act of 1856; that was Vidyasagar's campaign, after Roy's death.

GS1 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · Bhakti, Sufi and the Haridasas

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q4. "The Bhakti and Sufi saints spoke to the common people in their own language." Discuss the social impact of these movements, citing Karnataka examples. (250 words)

Model answer

Between the eighth and seventeenth centuries, the Bhakti and Sufi movements taught that devotion and love, not ritual or birth, lead to God. They used regional languages and music, which carried them to ordinary people.

Social impact

- Challenge to caste and ritual: Kabir, Ravidas and Namdev mocked caste pride; the Varkari saints welcomed all.
- Rise of regional languages: Kabir's dohas, Tukaram's abhangs, Mirabai's bhajans and the Tamil Alvars' hymns enriched vernacular literature.
- Status of women: Akka Mahadevi, Mirabai and Andal show women as spiritual leaders.

- Composite culture: Sufi khanqahs and dargahs drew Hindus and Muslims; qawwali and shared shrines grew.
- Music: devotional song shaped Carnatic and Hindustani traditions.

Karnataka examples

- Haridasa movement: Purandara Dasa and Kanaka Dasa composed in Kannada. Kanaka Dasa, a shepherd by birth, questioned caste in songs such as "Kula kula kulavendu".
- Sufi centres: the dargah of Khwaja Banda Nawaz Gesudaraz in Kalaburagi (Gulbarga) remains a site of shared devotion.
- Shared sites: Baba Budangiri in Chikkamagaluru has been revered by both Hindus and Muslims.

Limits The movements rarely changed property or political power, and later many saints were absorbed into new sects with their own hierarchies.

Conclusion By speaking the people's language, these saints democratised religion and prepared the cultural ground for the tolerance later written into the Constitution.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "CLWCM": Caste, Language, Women, Composite culture, Music.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat Bhakti and Sufi as identical; note that Sufism grew within Islam through silsilas, while Bhakti had many separate regional streams.

GS1 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · Mysore Chalo, 1947

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. What was the "Mysore Chalo" movement of 1947? How did it bring popular rule to Mysore? (150 words)

Model answer

After independence on 15 August 1947, the Maharaja of Mysore acceded to India, but power remained with the ruler and his Dewan. The Mysore Congress demanded a fully responsible government elected by the people.

The movement

- Launched in September 1947 by the Mysore Congress (K.C. Reddy, K. Hanumanthaiah, S. Nijalingappa and others) under the call "Mysore Chalo".
- Students, workers and peasants courted arrest, picketed offices and boycotted revenue payments; the police fired on protesters in several towns.

Outcome

- In October 1947 the Maharaja conceded a popular ministry, headed by K.C. Reddy as Chief Minister.
- A Constituent Assembly for Mysore was set up; in 1950 Mysore became a Part B State and the Maharaja its Rajpramukh.

Significance It completed the transfer of power in the princely State and gave the later unified Karnataka its first democratic leaders.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Chalo, Cell, Chief Minister": the march, the jails, the first CM K.C. Reddy.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse Mysore Chalo (1947) with the 1938 Shivapura flag satyagraha or the 1942 Quit India movement.

PEAK FACT: Mysore Chalo movement September 1947; responsible government October 1947; K.C. Reddy first Chief Minister (Karnataka Gazetteer).

GS1: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Proxy representation in panchayats.

GS1 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · Proxy representation in panchayats

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q6. Reservation for women in panchayats has created a large number of women leaders, but the phenomenon of the "proxy" husband persists. Examine the causes and suggest remedies. (250 words)

Model answer

Article 243D reserves at least one-third of panchayat seats and chair posts for women; Karnataka and many other States reserve half.

The proxy problem In many villages the husband or a male relative attends meetings, signs papers or speaks for the elected woman. The Ministry of Panchayati Raj appointed an advisory committee in 2023, which in its 2025 report recommended steps against "pradhan pati" practice.

Causes

- Patriarchal norms, purdah and the burden of housework and farm work.
- Low literacy and limited exposure to administration.
- Rotation of reserved seats every term, which cuts short the experience of a woman leader.
- Officials who deal with the husband out of habit.

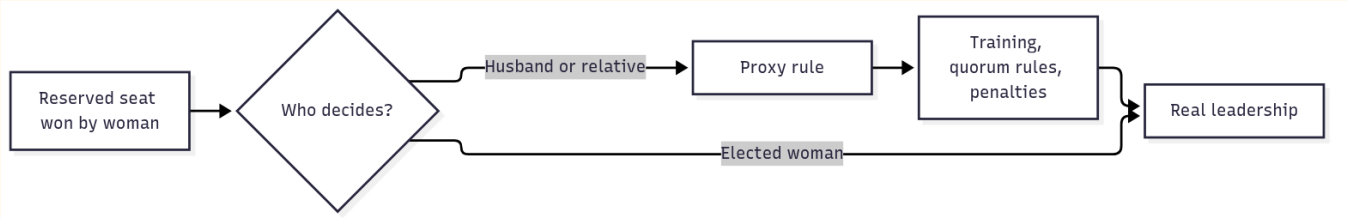
Evidence of change Studies, including the well-known Chattopadhyay and Duflo work in West Bengal and Rajasthan, found that women leaders invest more in drinking water and other public goods women value. Second-term women are far more independent.

Remedies

- Training through the Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan, with mentoring by experienced women leaders.
- Penalties for proxy functioning and video records of gram sabha meetings.
- Longer reservation cycles so that skills are not lost.
- Women-only ward sabhas and federations of elected women.
- Self-help groups as a political school for women.

Karnataka example Karnataka reserved Mandal Panchayat seats for women under its 1983 Act, well before the 73rd Amendment.

Conclusion Reservation opened the door; capacity, confidence and community support must help women walk through it.



> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PATRO": Patriarchy, Awareness, Training, Rotation, Officials.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not claim the problem is universal or that women leaders have failed; cite evidence that women leaders change spending priorities.

GS1 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · The rural non-farm sector

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q7. Why is the rural non-farm sector important for rural development? What limits its growth? (150 words)

Model answer

The rural non-farm sector includes manufacturing, construction, trade, transport and services in villages and small towns.

Importance

- Absorbs surplus labour from small and fragmented farms; it is the main path out of poverty for landless households.
- Smooths income when crops fail and offers work in the lean season.
- Employs women in food processing, tailoring and services.
- Reduces distress migration to big cities.

Constraints

- Poor roads, unreliable power and weak market links.
- Low skills and education, and little access to credit for very small firms.
- Most jobs are informal, low-paid and insecure; construction dominates.

Measures PMEGP, PM Vishwakarma, DAY-NRLM's start-up village programme and rural industrial clusters; Karnataka's district industries centres support micro units.

Conclusion Diversification beyond the farm is essential, but it must create productive jobs rather than only low-wage work.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Off-farm, on-income": off the farm, but income stays in the village.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate non-farm work with MGNREGA or its successor alone; it is mostly private enterprise and self-employment.

GS1 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · Reading district milk data

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q8. Study the following fictional data on milk production in a district and answer the questions.

Year	Milk (lakh tonnes)	Number of milch animals (lakh)
2021	4.0	2.0
2022	4.4	2.1
2023	4.6	2.2
2024	5.2	2.3
2025	5.5	2.4

(a) Calculate the year-on-year growth of milk production and identify the year of highest growth. (b) Compute the yield per animal for 2021 and 2025, and the percentage change. (c) What does the data suggest about the source of growth? (250 words)

Model answer

(a) Year-on-year growth Growth = (current - previous) / previous x 100.

- 2022: (4.4 - 4.0) / 4.0 = 10.0 per cent
- 2023: (4.6 - 4.4) / 4.4 = 4.5 per cent
- 2024: (5.2 - 4.6) / 4.6 = 13.0 per cent
- 2025: (5.5 - 5.2) / 5.2 = 5.8 per cent

The highest growth was in **2024 (13.0 per cent)**. Over the whole period, production rose by 1.5 / 4.0 = 37.5 per cent.

(b) Yield per animal

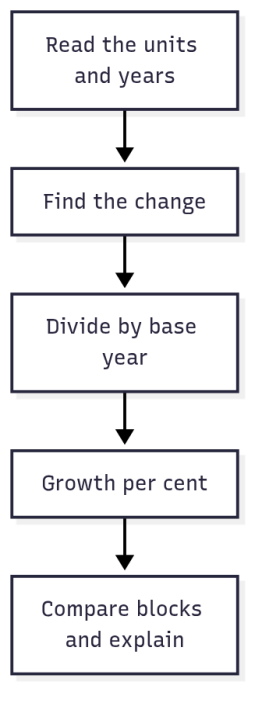
- 2021: 4.0 / 2.0 = 2.00 tonnes per animal per year
- 2025: 5.5 / 2.4 = 2.29 tonnes per animal per year
- Change: (2.29 - 2.00) / 2.00 = **14.6 per cent**

(c) Source of growth Milch animals rose from 2.0 to 2.4 lakh, an increase of 20 per cent, while yield rose about 14.6 per cent. Since 1.20 x 1.146 = 1.375, the two together explain the 37.5 per cent rise. So roughly half the growth came from more animals and half from better yield.

Interpretation

- Growth from numbers needs more fodder, water and land, and is harder to sustain.
- Yield gains suggest better breeds, feed and veterinary care. Policy should focus here: artificial insemination with high-quality semen, balanced rations, mineral mixtures and disease control.
- Year-to-year swings (13 per cent then 5.8 per cent) may reflect rainfall and fodder, so a drought plan for fodder banks is useful.

Caution Five years of data and one district cannot establish a trend; the figures are fictional and illustrative.



DRAW IT: Reading a production table. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Number times Yield": output growth = (1 + growth in animals) x (1 + growth in yield) - 1.

COMMON TRAP: Do not add the two percentage changes (20 + 14.6); growth rates multiply, they do not add.

GS1 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · Classical dance and Yakshagana

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q9. Name the classical dance forms recognised in India. How does Yakshagana differ from them? (150 words)

Model answer

The Sangeet Natak Akademi recognises eight classical dance forms: Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (north India), Kathakali and Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Manipuri (Manipur) and Sattriya (Assam). The Ministry of Culture also lists Chhau. Their grammar draws on the Natya Shastra of Bharata: abhinaya (expression), mudras (hand gestures) and rasa (emotional flavour).

Yakshagana of coastal Karnataka

- A dance-drama performed through the night in the open air, usually from the epics and Puranas.
- The bhagavata (singer-narrator) leads with chende and maddale drums; actors improvise spoken dialogue, which classical solo forms lack.
- Elaborate costumes, crowns and face paint; two main styles, Tenkutittu and Badagutittu.
- Performed by troupes (melas), often attached to temples such as Dharmasthala, Saligrama and Mandarthi.

Conclusion Yakshagana is a folk-classical theatre tradition that keeps Kannada and Tulu epic storytelling alive.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Eight plus Chhau"; Yakshagana = "Bhagavata, Beat, Banter".

COMMON TRAP: Do not list Yakshagana among the eight classical forms; it is a recognised traditional theatre form, not one of them.

GS1 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · Custom hiring of farm machinery

PREDICTED · GS1-C6 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Small and fragmented holdings make farm machinery unaffordable for most farmers. How do custom hiring centres address this problem? Discuss Karnataka's experience. (250 words)

Model answer

Mechanisation saves labour, reduces costs and allows timely sowing and harvesting. But according to the Agriculture Census 2015-16, about 86 per cent of India's holdings are small and marginal, and tractors and harvesters are too costly to own for most of these farmers.

Custom hiring centres (CHCs) These are centres, run by entrepreneurs, cooperatives or FPOs, that rent out machines by the hour or acre. The Centre supports them under the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanisation, and the FARMS app links farmers with nearby machine owners.

Benefits

- Access without ownership; costs spread over many users.
- Timely operations when labour is scarce.

- Rural jobs for operators and mechanics.
- Machines such as happy seeders and balers reduce stubble burning.

Karnataka's experience

- Karnataka's Krishi Yantra Dhare programme has set up custom hiring service centres at hobli level in partnership with private agencies and foundations, renting tractors, rotavators, sprayers and harvesters at reasonable rates.
- The State also subsidises machines for individual farmers, with higher subsidy for SC/ST farmers.

Problems

- Small tools for hill or horticulture farms are scarce.
- Late arrival in peak season; few trained operators.
- Some centres are under-used because farmers do not know rates or how to book.

Way forward

- Booking apps with transparent rates, run through FPOs and primary cooperatives.
- Crop-specific machines for millets, sugarcane and areca.
- Drone services through women's SHGs, as in the Namo Drone Didi scheme.

Conclusion For a land-poor country, machinery-as-a-service is more practical than machinery-as-property.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Hire, not buy": hobli-level hiring, not individual purchase.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not argue that mechanisation simply destroys jobs; show how it fills labour gaps and creates service jobs.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Agriculture Census 2015-16: small and marginal holdings about 86%.

GS1: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Chalukyas of Kalyana and Mitakshara.

GS1 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Chalukyas of Kalyana and Mitakshara

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. Discuss the cultural and legal contributions of the Chalukyas of Kalyana, with special reference to Vikramaditya VI. (150 words)

Model answer

The Chalukyas of Kalyana (Kalyani, modern Basavakalyan in Bidar district), also called the Western Chalukyas, ruled much of the Deccan from about 973 to 1189 CE after overthrowing the Rashtrakutas.

Vikramaditya VI (1076-1126)

- Started the Chalukya-Vikrama era in 1076 in place of the Saka era.
- His court poet Bilhana wrote the Sanskrit Vikramankadevacharita on his life.
- His jurist Vijnaneshwara wrote the Mitakshara, a commentary on the Yajnavalkya Smriti; it became the main school of Hindu inheritance law in most of India and shaped the Hindu Succession Act, 1956.

Architecture The "Kalyani Chalukya" style, using soapstone and stepped plans, is seen at Lakkundi, Ittagi (Mahadeva temple) and Kuruvatti; it was a bridge to Hoysala art.

Literature Ranna wrote here, and the Vachana movement arose under Kalachuri Bijjala, who usurped Kalyana.

Conclusion Kalyana gave India a legal code and Karnataka a temple style.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Era, Epic, Estate": Vikrama era, Bilhana's epic, Mitakshara on estates.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse the Kalyana Chalukyas with the Badami Chalukyas (6th-8th centuries) who built Pattadakal.

GS1 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · PM Vishwakarma

PREDICTED · GS1-C7 · Current affairs

Q12. Evaluate the PM Vishwakarma scheme as a tool for reviving traditional artisans. What are its strengths and limitations? (250 words)

Model answer

PM Vishwakarma, launched on 17 September 2023, supports artisans and craftspeople who work with their hands and tools in 18 traditional trades, such as carpentry, smithy, pottery, stone carving, cobbling, tailoring, basket weaving and fishing-net making.

Components

- Recognition through a PM Vishwakarma certificate and ID card.
- Basic and advanced skill training with a daily stipend.
- A toolkit incentive of Rs 15,000 through e-vouchers.
- Collateral-free credit of up to Rs 3 lakh in two tranches (Rs 1 lakh and Rs 2 lakh) at a concessional 5 per cent interest, with the government paying an interest subvention of up to 8 per cent.
- Incentives for digital transactions and marketing support.

Registration is through CSCs with biometric checks.

Strengths

- Formalises artisans' credit and skills.
- Addresses the specific barriers of tools, credit and markets together.
- Can reduce migration by making traditional crafts viable.

Limitations

- Critics fear the trade list mirrors caste occupations; it favours trades practised in the family in the guru-shishya pattern.
- Loans are small against factory competition.
- Marketing support is the weakest link; artisans need design, branding and e-commerce access.
- Verification delays exclude artisans who lack documents.

Karnataka angle Channapatna toy makers and Bidriware artisans could gain if training links to GI branding and ONDC.

Way forward Open it to anyone who wants to learn a craft and link it to design institutes and ODOP.

Conclusion The scheme can revive crafts if it treats artisans as entrepreneurs rather than as heirs to a caste trade.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "RTTCM": Recognition, Training, Toolkit, Credit, Market.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present it as a pure welfare grant; its core is credit and skilling, and the caste-occupation critique must be noted.

GS1 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · Social disorganisation

PREDICTED · GS1-B2

Q13. What is social disorganisation? Identify its main indicators in contemporary Indian society. (150 words)

Model answer

Social disorganisation is a condition in which social norms, institutions and relationships weaken, so that they no longer regulate behaviour effectively. Thomas and Znaniecki, in their study of Polish immigrants, and the Chicago School of sociologists linked it to rapid change and migration. Durkheim's idea of anomie, normlessness, is closely related.

Indicators in India

- Family: rising divorce, neglect of the elderly, domestic violence.
- Community: weakening village institutions, communal riots, mob violence.
- Individual: drug and alcohol addiction, suicides, especially among farmers and students.
- Urban: slums, crime, homelessness and anonymity in big cities.
- Institutional: corruption and loss of trust in public institutions.

Causes Rapid urbanisation, migration, unemployment and the clash of old and new values.

Remedies Strong families and schools, community policing, mental-health services and inclusive growth.

Conclusion Disorganisation is often a phase of transition; institutions must adapt so that change does not become breakdown.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "FCIUI": Family, Community, Individual, Urban, Institutional.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat all social change as disorganisation; change is normal, disorganisation is when norms stop working.

GS1 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · Inter-State and Zonal Councils

PREDICTED · GS1-B5

Q14. Evaluate how the Council under Article 263 and the five regional councils of 1956 work in promoting cooperative federalism in India. (250 words)

Model answer

Cooperative federalism needs standing forums for Centre-State dialogue; two exist.

The Council under Article 263

- The President may set up a council to inquire into disputes between States and discuss subjects of common interest.
- Set up in 1990 on the Sarkaria Commission's recommendation, with the Prime Minister as chair and Chief Ministers and six Union ministers as members.
- Record: it has met only about eleven times, the last full meeting in 2016. Its recommendations are advisory.

Zonal Councils

- Statutory bodies under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956: Northern, Central, Eastern, Western and Southern. The North Eastern Council was created separately in 1971.
- The Union Home Minister chairs each council; Chief Ministers rotate as vice-chair.

- Karnataka is a member of the Southern Zonal Council with Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Puducherry.
- Record: since 2014 meetings have become more frequent, and the Home Ministry reports that a large share of the issues raised have been resolved through standing committees.

Strengths

- Dialogue on boundaries, water, policing and transport links.
- Prepare consensus before issues reach courts.

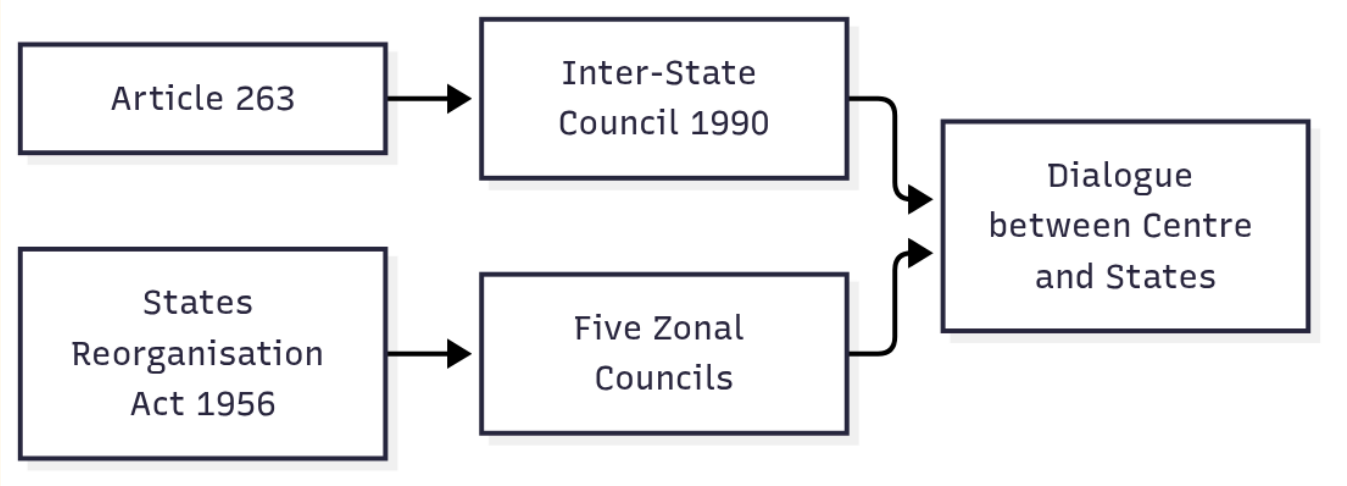
Weaknesses

- Irregular meetings; no permanent agenda-setting secretariat of the ISC's stature.
- Advisory nature; real bargaining happens in the GST Council and NITI Aayog.
- Political mistrust between Centre and opposition-ruled States.

Way forward

- Regular ISC meetings at least once a year, as the Punchhi Commission advised.
- Give the ISC a role in reviewing centrally sponsored schemes.

Conclusion These councils are useful but under-used; regular dialogue is cheaper than litigation.



DRAW IT: Forums for cooperative federalism. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "263 and 1956": Article 263 for the ISC, 1956 Act for the Zonal Councils.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the Zonal Councils constitutional bodies; they are statutory, created by the States Reorganisation Act.

GS1 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · The Speaker of the Lok Sabha

PREDICTED · GS1-B4

Q15. Discuss the powers of the Speaker of the Lok Sabha. Why is the Speaker's impartiality crucial for parliamentary democracy? (150 words)

Model answer

The Speaker is elected by the Lok Sabha from among its members (Article 93) and is the guardian of the House.

Powers

- Presides over the House, maintains order and interprets the rules.

- Certifies Money Bills (Article 110(3)), with finality.
- Decides disqualification petitions under the Tenth Schedule, subject to judicial review (Kihoto Hollohan, 1992).
- Presides over joint sittings (Article 118(4)) and has a casting vote (Article 100).
- Appoints committee chairs and refers Bills to committees.

Why impartiality matters

- Opposition voices depend on fair time and fair handling of motions.
- Delays in deciding defection cases have drawn criticism; in Keisham Meghachandra Singh (2020) the Supreme Court said they should normally be decided within three months.

Reform Speakers could quit party, as in Britain; defection cases could go to a tribunal.

Conclusion A neutral Speaker makes the House a forum for all, not a tool of the majority.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Money, Members, Meeting": Money Bill, members' disqualification, joint meeting.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Speaker's anti-defection decision is beyond judicial review; Kihoto Hollohan made it reviewable.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Article 93 election of Speaker; Article 110(3) Money Bill certification; Article 118(4) joint sitting; Article 100 casting vote.

GS1: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, India's balance of payments.

GS1 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · India's balance of payments

PREDICTED · GS1-C2

Q16. What are the components of India's balance of payments? Why has India been able to manage a current account deficit despite a large merchandise trade deficit? (250 words)

Model answer

The balance of payments (BoP) records all economic transactions between residents of India and the rest of the world in a period.

Components

- Current account: merchandise trade (exports and imports of goods), services trade, primary income (interest, dividends) and secondary income (mainly remittances).
- Capital and financial account: foreign direct investment, portfolio investment, external commercial borrowing, NRI deposits and changes in reserves.
- By definition the BoP balances; a current account deficit must be financed by net capital inflows or reserves.

India's pattern

- India runs a large merchandise trade deficit, driven by crude oil, gold, electronics and coal imports.
- Yet the current account deficit has been modest, about 0.6 per cent of GDP in 2024-25 according to RBI data, because:
- Services exports (software, business services, global capability centres) earn a large surplus.
- Remittances from Indians abroad are the world's largest, over 100 billion dollars a year.
- FDI and portfolio inflows finance the remaining deficit, and foreign exchange reserves act as a buffer.

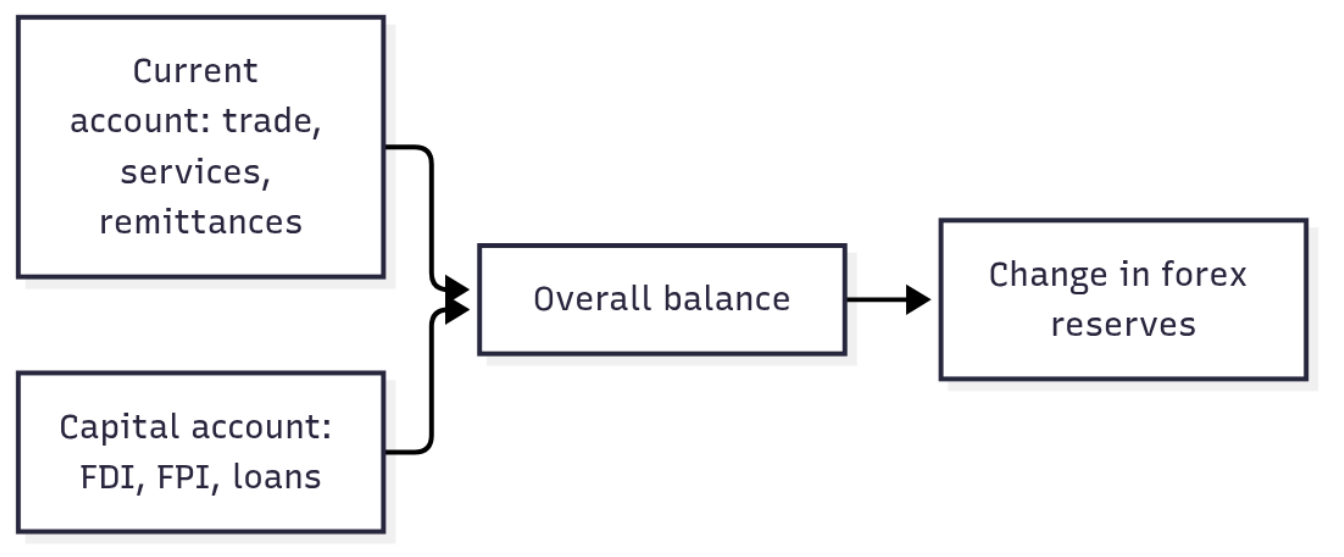
Risks

- Oil price shocks and a slowdown in services demand.
- Volatile portfolio flows, which can reverse quickly.
- Protectionist tariffs and slowing global trade.

Karnataka's role Bengaluru's IT and GCC exports are a major part of the services surplus that offsets the goods deficit.

Way forward Raise manufactured exports through PLI and trade agreements, reduce oil dependence through renewables, and keep reserves adequate.

Conclusion India's BoP is resilient because it earns from skills and its diaspora; the next step is to earn more from goods.



DRAW IT: Balance of payments in two accounts. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Goods out, Services and Sons in": the goods deficit is offset by services and remittances.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate trade deficit with current account deficit; services and income flows make the difference.

GS1 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · Structure of Karnataka's economy

PREDICTED · GS1-C1

Q17. Describe the sectoral composition of Karnataka's economy and the main features of its recent growth. (150 words)

Model answer

The State's 2025-26 Economic Survey puts GSDP at Rs 32.81 lakh crore at current prices, 12.9 per cent above the previous year.

Sectoral pattern

- Services dominate, led by IT and IT-enabled services, finance and real estate; the Survey projects services growth of 8.1 per cent, with IT-related services at 10.5 per cent.
- Industry grows on manufacturing (projected 7.2 per cent) and electricity.
- Agriculture has a smaller share but employs the largest number of people; it is rain-dependent and volatile.

Features

- High per capita income but sharp regional disparity: Bengaluru Urban dominates, while Kalyana Karnataka lags.
- Strong outward orientation: the Survey ties about two-fifths of output to exports.
- Fiscal deficit kept within 3 per cent of GSDP under the Fiscal Responsibility Act, 2002.

Conclusion Karnataka's challenge is to spread its services-led growth to farms and to its northern districts.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Services lead, farms feed": services drive output, farms employ.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not quote the share of agriculture in employment as its share of output; the two differ sharply.

GS1 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · The informal sector

PREDICTED · GS1-B6

Q18. Most Indian workers are in the informal sector. Explain the causes of informality and assess recent efforts to extend social security to informal workers. (250 words)

Model answer

The informal sector consists of unregistered enterprises and workers without written contracts, paid leave or social security. The Periodic Labour Force Survey shows that most of the workforce is self-employed or casual, and an even larger share has no formal social security.

Causes

- Agriculture and small family businesses dominate employment.
- Labour laws and compliance costs historically encouraged firms to stay small.
- Low education and skills limit access to formal jobs.
- Seasonal and migrant work, and the growth of gig and platform work.
- Weak enforcement and preference for cash transactions.

Consequences

- Low and irregular income; no protection from illness, accident or old age.
- Low productivity and little tax revenue.
- Vulnerability in shocks, as the pandemic migration showed.

Efforts to extend social security

- e-Shram portal (2021): a national database of unorganised workers, with over 30 crore registrations.
- Code on Social Security, 2020, now operational, recognises gig and platform workers and provides for welfare funds.
- PM Shram Yogi Maan-dhan: a voluntary contributory pension.
- Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY health cover, PM Jeevan Jyoti and Suraksha Bima insurance.

Karnataka The State's 2025 law for platform gig workers creates a welfare board financed by a fee on aggregators.

Gaps Low uptake of contributory schemes, portability problems for migrants and lack of awareness.

Way forward Link e-Shram to benefits automatically, make schemes portable, and simplify registration of small firms.

Conclusion Formalisation will be gradual; social security must reach workers where they are, not only in factories.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Register, Protect, Port": register on e-Shram, protect through schemes, port across States.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not suggest that informality can be ended by law alone; it reflects the structure of the economy.

GS1 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Tipu Sultan's measures

PREDICTED · GS1-A4 · Karnataka-specific

Q19. Assess the administrative, military and economic measures of Tipu Sultan. (150 words)

Model answer

Tipu Sultan ruled Mysore from 1782 until his death defending Srirangapatna in the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War in 1799.

Administration

- Introduced a new calendar, new coins and new weights and measures.
- Reorganised revenue to collect directly from cultivators, reducing intermediaries such as poligars.

Military

- Modernised the army on European lines with French help.
- Used iron-cased rockets; some captured "Mysorean rockets" influenced the later British Congreve rocket.
- Built a navy and forts.

Economy

- Promoted sericulture, bringing silkworms from Bengal; set up state trading houses and factories.
- Banned the export of certain goods and sought trade with France and the Ottoman empire.

Assessment He was an innovative and modernising ruler who resisted British expansion. Historians debate his treatment of some communities in Kodagu and Malabar.

Conclusion His legacy in Karnataka includes Srirangapatna's monuments, its silk and its rocketry.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Coins, Cannons, Cocoons": currency reform, military modernisation, sericulture.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not offer a one-sided portrait; acknowledge the historical debate on his rule in Kodagu and Malabar.

GS1 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · The Belagavi boundary dispute

PREDICTED · GS1-B1 · Karnataka-specific

Q20. The Karnataka-Maharashtra boundary dispute over Belagavi has persisted since 1956. Trace its history, the Mahajan Commission's recommendations and the present position. (250 words)

Model answer

When the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 merged Kannada-speaking areas of Bombay State into Mysore State, the Bombay (later Maharashtra) government claimed Belagavi (Belgaum) city and over 800 villages with large Marathi-speaking populations.

History

- The Maharashtra Ekikaran Samiti led agitation for transfer; Karnataka claimed parts of Solapur and Kolhapur in turn.
- In 1966 the Centre appointed a one-man commission under former Chief Justice Mehr Chand Mahajan.

Mahajan Commission (report 1967)

- Recommended that Belagavi city remain in Karnataka.
- Suggested an exchange: about 264 villages, including Nippani and Khanapur areas, to Maharashtra, and about 247 villages, including Jath and Akkalkot areas, to Karnataka.
- Karnataka accepted the report; Maharashtra rejected it, and the Centre did not implement it.

Present position

- Maharashtra filed an original suit in the Supreme Court in 2004 seeking the transfer of disputed areas; it remains pending.
- Karnataka built the Suvarna Vidhana Soudha in Belagavi, inaugurated in 2012, and holds a legislature session there each winter to assert its claim.
- Flare-ups occur over buses, language boards and political statements; the Union Home Minister has mediated between Chief Ministers.

Issues

- Linguistic identity versus administrative continuity.
- Rights of linguistic minorities under Articles 29, 30, 350A and 350B.

Way forward Await the Supreme Court's decision; protect Marathi-medium schools and minority rights in Karnataka; avoid provocative statements.

Conclusion Boundaries were settled by the 1956 Act; respect for minorities on both sides is the best guarantee of peace.

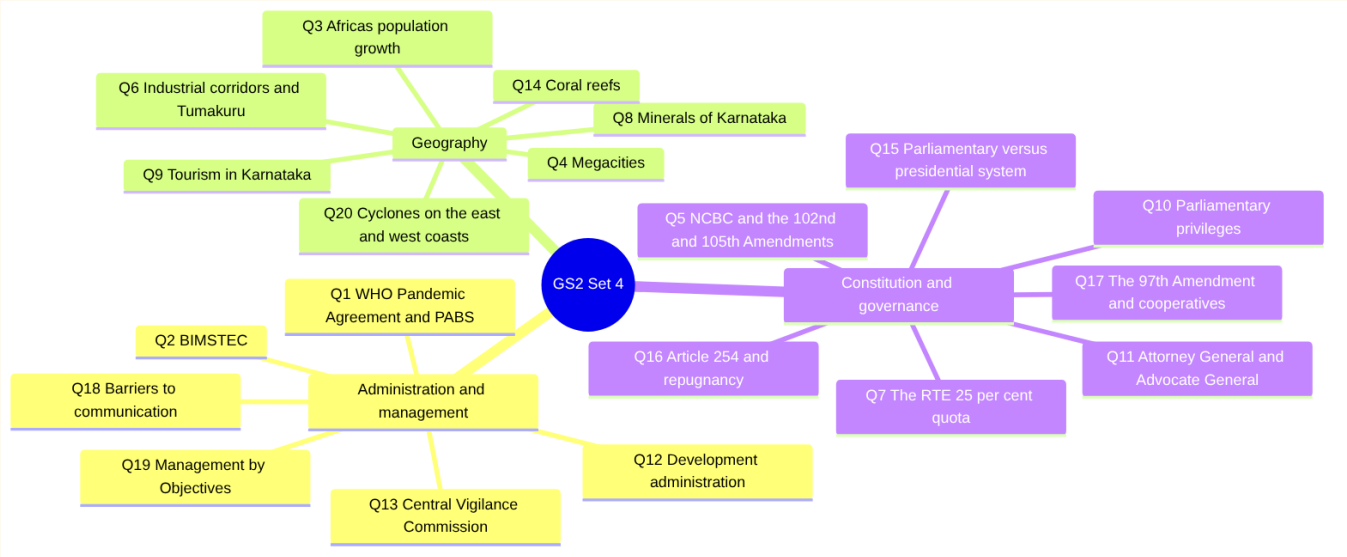
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "1956, 1966, 2004": reorganisation, Mahajan Commission, Supreme Court suit.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write that the Mahajan report was implemented; it was accepted by Karnataka alone and never acted upon.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Mahajan Commission appointed 1966, report 1967; Belagavi to remain in Karnataka; village exchange (264 and 247).
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 India's balance of payments:** "Goods out, Services and Sons in": the goods deficit is offset by services and remittances. **Q17 Structure of Karnataka's economy:** "Services lead, farms feed": services drive output, farms employ. **Q18 The informal sector:** "Register, Protect, Port": register on e-Shram, protect through schemes, port across States. **Q19 Tipu Sultan's measures:** "Coins, Cannons, Cocoons": currency reform, military modernisation, sericulture. **Q20 The Belagavi boundary dispute:** "1956, 1966, 2004": reorganisation, Mahajan Commission, Supreme Court suit.

Paper 3: General Studies II (GS2)

Set 4: step 4 of 6 (General Studies II (GS2)). Next up: General Studies III (GS3)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Polity and world questions test structure: the NCBC amendments, Article 254, the 97th Amendment, privileges and the CVC. Geography covers Africa, megacities, coral reefs and cyclones, and Karnataka's minerals and tourism.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS2 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · WHO Pandemic Agreement and PABS

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q1. What is the WHO Pandemic Agreement? Why has the annex on pathogen access and benefit sharing proved difficult to finalise? (150 words)

Model answer

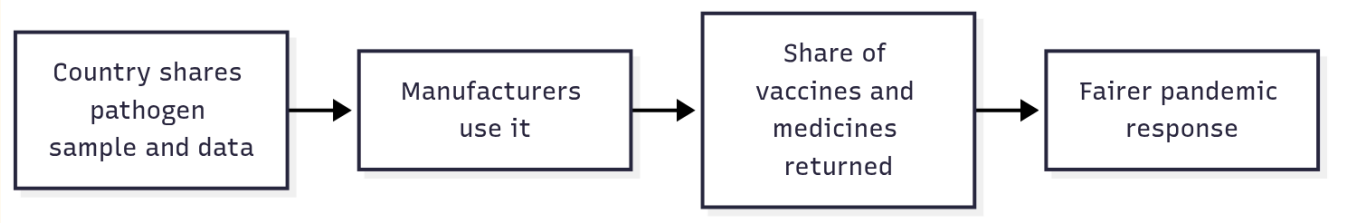
The World Health Assembly adopted the WHO Pandemic Agreement on 20 May 2025, after the COVID-19 pandemic exposed unequal access to vaccines, tests and medicines. It is the second treaty under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution, after the tobacco convention.

Main provisions

- Prevention through a "One Health" approach linking human, animal and environmental health.
- Stronger research and regional manufacturing, and technology transfer on mutually agreed terms.
- A global supply chain and logistics network.
- WHO gets no power to order lockdowns.

The PABS annex The Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing system must decide how countries share virus samples and data and, in return, receive vaccines and medicines. Rich and developing countries differ on binding commitments. At the 79th Assembly in May 2026 no annex was adopted, and talks were extended to 2027.

Significance for India India seeks fair benefit-sharing and a vaccine-making role.



DRAW IT: How PABS is meant to work. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Prevent, Produce, Share": prevention, production, fair sharing.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the treaty is in force; it opens for signature only after the annex is adopted, and needs 60 ratifications.

GS2 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · BIMSTEC

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q2. "BIMSTEC is India's bridge between South and South-East Asia." Assess the organisation's achievements and the obstacles to its effectiveness. (250 words)

Model answer

The Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was formed in 1997 by the Bangkok Declaration. Its seven members are Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand, and the secretariat is in Dhaka.

Why it matters for India

- Links the Act East and Neighbourhood First policies.
- Offers regional cooperation when SAARC has stalled since 2016.
- Develops the north-east through connectivity to the Bay of Bengal.

Achievements

- The BIMSTEC Charter, adopted at the Colombo summit in 2022, gave the grouping legal personality and seven sectors with a lead country each; India leads security.
- The sixth summit in Bangkok on 4 April 2025 adopted the Bangkok Vision 2030 and a maritime transport cooperation agreement; Bangladesh took over the chair.
- A Master Plan for Transport Connectivity; the Kaladan multimodal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand highway.
- Cooperation on disaster management, counter-terrorism and an energy centre.

Obstacles

- The free trade agreement negotiated since 2004 is still unfinished.
- Myanmar's civil conflict delays connectivity projects.
- India-Bangladesh relations have seen strains since 2024.
- A small secretariat and limited funding; summits are infrequent.
- China's growing presence in the region through investment.

Way forward

- Conclude the FTA in stages, starting with goods and customs cooperation.
- Coastal shipping, power grid interconnection and a BIMSTEC business council.
- Strengthen the secretariat and hold regular summits.

Conclusion BIMSTEC has the geography to unite the Bay of Bengal; it now needs political will and money to match.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "BIMSTEC = Bay + Bridge": Bay of Bengal geography, bridge between two regions.

COMMON TRAP: Do not list Pakistan, Maldives or Afghanistan as members; the seven are around the Bay of Bengal.

GS2 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · Africa's population growth

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q3. Africa has the fastest-growing population among the continents. Discuss the opportunities and challenges this creates. (150 words)

Model answer

Africa, with 54 countries, has the youngest population in the world. United Nations projections indicate that it will account for more than half of world population growth up to 2050, and its population will approach 2.5 billion by then.

Opportunities

- A large working-age population can produce a demographic dividend, as in East Asia.
- Abundant resources: cobalt and copper in the DR Congo and Zambia, oil in Nigeria and Angola, platinum and gold in South Africa.
- A growing consumer market and the African Continental Free Trade Area.

Challenges

- Jobs: millions of young people enter the labour market each year.
- Food security, climate stress in the Sahel, and urban slums.
- Weak health and education systems; conflict in some regions.

India's interest India-Africa trade, development partnerships and the African Union's G20 membership (2023, under India's presidency).

Conclusion Whether Africa's youth becomes a dividend depends on education, jobs and peace.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Young, Rich in resources, Ready market".

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat Africa as one country; give examples of particular countries and regions.

GS2 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · Megacities

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q4. The world now has more people in cities than in villages. Examine the factors behind the rise of megacities and the problems they face. (250 words)

Model answer

A megacity is usually defined as an urban agglomeration of more than 10 million people. According to the UN, more than half of the world's population has lived in urban areas since 2007, and the number of megacities has grown from a handful in the 1970s to more than 30 today, most of them in Asia.

Factors behind growth

- Economic: concentration of industry, services and jobs; agglomeration economies.

- Rural push: falling farm incomes, landlessness and climate stress.
- Natural increase within cities and reclassification of nearby villages.
- Globalisation: cities as nodes of finance, trade and technology, such as Tokyo, Shanghai and Mumbai.

Problems

- Housing: slums and informal settlements, from Dharavi to Lagos.
- Transport: congestion, pollution and long commutes.
- Water and sanitation: shortages and untreated sewage.
- Climate risk: floods, heat islands, sea-level rise in coastal cities such as Jakarta and Dhaka.
- Governance: fragmented authorities and weak finances.
- Inequality: gated communities beside slums.

Indian case Delhi, Mumbai and Kolkata are megacities; Bengaluru, with more than 10 million people, is the fastest-growing among them in the south, facing traffic and water stress.

Responses

- Metropolitan planning authorities and regional plans.
- Mass transit such as metros and bus rapid transit; transit-oriented development.
- Affordable rental housing; urban flood management.
- Satellite towns to decongest the core.

Conclusion Megacities are engines of growth but also of risk; their future depends on planning, finance and good governance.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HTWCGI": Housing, Transport, Water, Climate, Governance, Inequality.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse "megacity" with "metropolitan city" in the Indian Census sense (one million plus).

GS2 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · NCBC and the 102nd and 105th Amendments

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q5. How did the 102nd Constitutional Amendment change the status of the National Commission for Backward Classes? Why was the 105th Amendment needed? (150 words)

Model answer

The National Commission for Backward Classes was first a statutory body under a 1993 Act, set up after the Indra Sawhney judgment (1992).

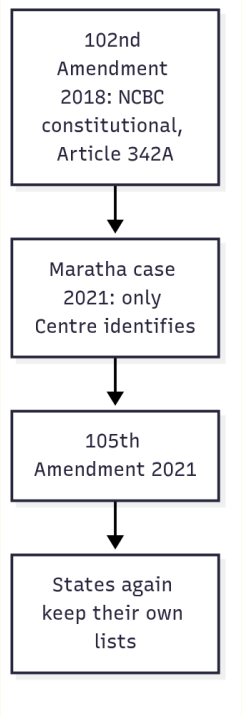
102nd Amendment, 2018

- Inserted Article 338B, making the NCBC a constitutional body like the commissions for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.
- Empowered it to investigate safeguards and to hear complaints from backward classes.
- Inserted Article 342A, under which the President notifies backward classes for each State.

The problem In Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil (Maratha reservation case, 2021), the Supreme Court held by majority that after Article 342A only the Centre could identify such classes.

105th Amendment, 2021 Restored the States' power to prepare their own backward-class lists.

Conclusion The two amendments together strengthened the NCBC while keeping the federal balance in identifying backward classes.



DRAW IT: Backward class lists after 2018. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "338B gives status, 342A gives list, 105th gives back".

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the NCBC fixes reservation percentages; it advises and investigates.

PEAK FACT: 102nd Amendment 2018 inserted Articles 338B and 342A.

GS2: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Industrial corridors and Tumakuru.

GS2 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · Industrial corridors and Tumakuru

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q6. Explain the concept of industrial corridors. Assess the progress of the Chennai-Bengaluru Industrial Corridor and its significance for Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

An industrial corridor is a belt of planned industrial cities and clusters along a major transport artery, with power, water, logistics and single-window approvals. The National Industrial Corridor Development Programme, run by the National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation, covers eleven corridors.

Benefits

- Ready land and plug-and-play plots for investors.
- Lower logistics cost through connections to ports and freight corridors.
- Planned urbanisation and jobs away from crowded metros.

Chennai-Bengaluru Industrial Corridor (CBIC)

- Links Chennai and Bengaluru through Andhra Pradesh, with nodes at Krishnapatnam, Ponneri and Tumakuru, and connection to ports in the east.
- Tumakuru node in Karnataka: an integrated township on about 8,500 acres planned for engineering, aerospace, food processing and other industries, with trunk infrastructure under way.
- The Union Cabinet in 2024 approved 12 new industrial smart cities under the programme, adding nodes in several States.

Significance for Karnataka

- Reduces pressure on Bengaluru by moving manufacturing to Tumakuru.
- Complements the Bengaluru-Mumbai corridor proposal through Dharwad.
- Creates jobs for youth from central Karnataka.

Challenges

- Land acquisition and farmer compensation.
- Slow arrival of anchor investors; water supply in a dry district.
- Coordination between Centre, State and the special-purpose vehicle.

Way forward Fast approvals, skill centres, rail and road links to Chennai and Krishnapatnam ports, and housing for workers.

Conclusion Corridors can spread industry from the metro to the hinterland if land, water and skills are planned together.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Plot, Port, Power": ready plots, port links, power and water.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse the industrial corridor with the dedicated freight corridors of the Railways; they complement each other.

GS2 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · The RTE 25 per cent quota

PREDICTED · GS2-B2 · Current affairs

Q7. Article 21A makes education a fundamental right. Examine the working of the 25 per cent reservation for weaker sections in private schools under the RTE Act. (150 words)

Model answer

The 86th Amendment, 2002 inserted Article 21A, making free and compulsory education a fundamental right for children aged 6 to 14. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 implements it.

Section 12(1)(c)

- Private unaided schools must admit at least 25 per cent of their entry-class students from weaker sections and disadvantaged groups, with fees reimbursed by the State.
- Upheld in Society for Unaided Private Schools of Rajasthan (2012); minority schools were exempted in Pramati Educational Trust (2014).

Working

- It has given lakhs of poor children access to better schools.
- Problems: delayed reimbursement, hidden fees, social segregation inside schools and low awareness.

Karnataka example Karnataka amended its RTE rules in 2018 to apply the quota only where no government school exists nearby, sharply reducing seats.

Conclusion The quota works best alongside improving government schools.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "21A, 2009, 12(1)(c), 25".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the quota applies to minority schools; Pramati exempted them.

GS2 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · Minerals of Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS2-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q8. Describe the distribution of Karnataka's important minerals and discuss the issues in mineral development in the State. (250 words)

Model answer

The ancient Dharwar rocks give the State its metallic wealth.

Distribution

- Iron ore: Ballari-Hosapete-Sandur belt, Chitradurga and Chikkamagaluru (the former Kudremukh mines, closed in 2005 to protect the Western Ghats).
- Gold: Hutti in Raichur district, operated by Hutti Gold Mines Limited, now India's main producing gold mine; the historic Kolar Gold Fields closed in 2001.
- Manganese: Sandur, Shivamogga and Uttara Kannada.
- Limestone: Kalaburagi, Bagalkot and Belagavi, the base of a large cement industry.
- Bauxite, chromite and granite: Belagavi, Hassan, Mysuru and granite across the south.

According to the State Economic Survey 2025-26, 88 iron ore and manganese leases and 118 limestone leases are sanctioned, and exploration for gold and critical minerals continues in Ballari, Raichur, Haveri and other districts.

Issues

- Illegal mining: the Ballari mining scandal led the Supreme Court in 2011 to ban mining in Ballari, Chitradurga and Tumakuru and later allow it in categories with caps and reclamation plans.
- Environment: dust, deforestation, water pollution and damage to farmland.
- Social: displacement and health problems for mine workers.
- Revenue: under-pricing and royalty leakage.

Reforms

- MMDR Amendment Acts (2015 and later) made auctions mandatory.
- District Mineral Foundations fund welfare in mining areas.
- The Supreme Court's Comprehensive Environment Plan for Mining Impact Zone in Ballari region.

Way forward Transparent auctions, satellite monitoring, reclamation and investment of mineral revenue in local health and education.

Conclusion Minerals are a finite asset; they should leave behind schools and skills, not scarred land.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Iron Ballari, Gold Hutti, Lime Kalaburagi".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Kolar Gold Fields are still working; they closed in 2001.

GS2 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · Tourism in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS2-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. Examine the potential of tourism for Karnataka's economy and the measures in the Tourism Policy 2024-29. (150 words)

Model answer

Karnataka offers heritage (Hampi, Pattadakal, the Hoysala temples), wildlife (Bandipur, Nagarhole, Kabini), the Western Ghats, coffee estates, beaches and pilgrim centres.

Scale The State Economic Survey 2025-26 records about 3,017 lakh domestic and 4.37 lakh foreign tourist visits in 2025 up to December.

Tourism Policy 2024-29

- Targets investment of Rs 5,000 crore and 10 lakh jobs, with private and PPP participation.
- Development of basic infrastructure at the UNESCO sites of Belur, Halebidu and Somanathapura, and a plan to seek World Heritage status for Lakkundi.
- Tourist safety through trained "Pravasi Mitra" home guards.

Issues Poor last-mile connectivity, few quality hotels outside major centres, seasonal crowding and the ecological pressure of home-stays in Kodagu and Chikkamagaluru.

Way forward Heritage circuits, eco-tourism carrying-capacity limits and community-run home-stays.

Conclusion Tourism can spread income to the districts if growth is sustainable.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Heritage, Hills, Habitat, Holy places".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not quote total visits as unique visitors; the figures count visits.

GS2 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · Parliamentary privileges

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q10. What are parliamentary privileges? Should they be codified? Discuss with reference to recent controversies. (250 words)

Model answer

Parliamentary privileges are special rights and immunities enjoyed by each House, its members and committees so that they can work without obstruction. Article 105 covers Parliament and Article 194 the State legislatures.

Main privileges

- Freedom of speech in the House; no court proceedings for anything said or any vote given (Article 105(2)).
- Freedom from arrest in civil cases during the session and 40 days before and after.
- The right to publish proceedings and to exclude strangers.
- The power to punish for contempt or breach of privilege.

The codification debate Article 105(3) said privileges would be those of the British House of Commons until Parliament defined them; the 44th Amendment removed the British reference but Parliament has still not codified them.

Arguments for codification

- Uncertainty allows Houses to punish critics, journalists or citizens arbitrarily.
- Codification would bring clarity and allow courts to test privileges against fundamental rights.

Arguments against

- Codification may make privileges subject to judicial review and reduce the independence of the legislature.

Recent issues

- In Sita Soren v Union of India (2024), seven judges ruled that legislators who take bribes to vote or speak do not enjoy immunity, overruling P.V. Narasimha Rao (1998).

- Breach-of-privilege notices against journalists and the expulsion of members have raised questions of proportionality.

Way forward Codify core privileges, make breach procedures fair with a right to be heard, and restrict punishment of non-members.

Conclusion Privileges exist to protect the legislature's function, not to place legislators above the law.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Speech, Safety, Publish, Punish".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say privileges protect bribery for votes; Sita Soren (2024) ended that immunity.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Articles 105 and 194 on privileges; 44th Amendment removed House of Commons reference.

GS2: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Attorney General and Advocate General.

GS2 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Attorney General and Advocate General

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q11. Compare the constitutional position and functions of the Attorney General of India and the Advocate General of a State. (150 words)

Model answer

Attorney General (Article 76)

- Appointed by the President; must be qualified to be a Supreme Court judge.
- Serves at the President's pleasure.
- Chief law officer of the Government of India; advises on legal matters and appears for it in courts.
- Has the right to speak in Parliament and its committees, but no vote (Article 88).
- Not a Cabinet member; may practise privately, but not against the government.

Advocate General (Article 165)

- Appointed by the Governor; qualified to be a High Court judge.
- Holds office during the pleasure of the Governor.
- Advises and represents the State government.
- Speaks in the legislature without a vote (Article 177).

Similarity and difference Both are law officers; the AG serves the Union, the Advocate General a State. The Solicitor General, unlike the AG, is not a constitutional post.

Conclusion Both must balance loyalty to the government with duty to the court.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "76 for the nation, 165 for the State".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the Solicitor General a constitutional office; it is created by rules.

GS2 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · Development administration

PREDICTED · GS2-C1

Q12. What is development administration? How does it differ from traditional administration, and what is its relevance in India today? (250 words)

Model answer

Development administration is administration aimed at planned economic and social change. The term was popularised by Edward Weidner and Fred Riggs in the 1950s and 1960s, when newly independent countries sought rapid development.

Features

- Goal-oriented: focused on outcomes such as growth, literacy and health.
- Change-oriented: seeks to transform society rather than maintain order.
- Citizen participation: involves people in planning and delivery.
- Innovative and flexible: open to new methods and decentralisation.
- Ecological: sensitive to the social and cultural setting.

Difference from traditional administration | Traditional | Development | |---|---| | Law and order, revenue | Socio-economic change | | Rule-bound, hierarchical | Flexible, goal-oriented | | Officials as controllers | Officials as change agents | | Centralised | Decentralised, participatory |

Relevance in India

- Five-Year Plans, community development and district planning were built on this idea.
- Today it is seen in mission-mode programmes such as Jal Jeevan Mission and the Aspirational Districts Programme, which track outcomes with data.
- Panchayati raj and self-help groups provide participation.

Karnataka example The Aspirational Taluks programme and the Janaspandana grievance system show administration oriented to outcomes and feedback.

Criticism Critics argue that it can become top-down and bureaucratic; "administrative development", which builds capacity in administration itself, is needed alongside it.

Conclusion Development administration remains relevant because India's state still has to deliver change, not merely maintain order; it must now be paired with accountability and citizen voice.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "GCCIE": Goal, Change, Citizens, Innovation, Ecology.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate development administration with New Public Management; NPM is market-oriented, development administration is change-oriented.

GS2 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · Central Vigilance Commission

PREDICTED · GS2-C6

Q13. Discuss the role and limitations of the Central Vigilance Commission in combating corruption. (150 words)

Model answer

The Central Vigilance Commission was set up in 1964 on the Santhanam Committee's recommendation and became a statutory body under the CVC Act, 2003, following the Vineet Narain judgment (1997).

Composition A Commissioner and up to two members, chosen by a panel of the Prime Minister, Home Minister and Leader of the Opposition.

Functions

- Superintends the CBI's work in cases under the Prevention of Corruption Act.
- Advises ministries on vigilance cases and reviews prosecution sanctions.
- Receives public-interest disclosures from whistle-blowers.

Limitations

- An advisory body; it cannot register cases itself.
- Small staff; relies on departments' chief vigilance officers.
- Its advice can be ignored; delays in prosecution sanction.

Way forward Give it its own investigation wing, time-bound sanctions and wider use of preventive vigilance.

Conclusion The CVC is a watchdog that can bark but not bite.



DRAW IT: How the CVC handles a complaint. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Santhanam to Vineet": 1964 committee to 1997 judgment and 2003 Act.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the CVC prosecutes; it supervises and advises.

GS2 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · Coral reefs

PREDICTED · GS2-A1

Q14. What are coral reefs? Explain the conditions for their growth, their ecological value and the causes of coral bleaching. (250 words)

Model answer

Coral reefs are ridges built over thousands of years by colonies of tiny animals called polyps, which secrete calcium carbonate skeletons. Algae called zooxanthellae live inside the polyps and supply them food through photosynthesis.

Conditions for growth

- Warm water, about 20 to 29 degrees Celsius.
- Shallow, clear, sunlit water; turbidity cuts light.
- Saline water without fresh-water inflow; hence few reefs near large river mouths.
- A solid base, often a continental shelf or volcanic island.

Types Fringing reefs (close to the coast), barrier reefs (separated by a lagoon, as the Great Barrier Reef) and atolls (rings around a lagoon, as in Lakshadweep and the Maldives).

In India Gulf of Mannar, Gulf of Kachchh, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep. The Netrani island off Murudeshwar in Karnataka has notable coral communities.

Ecological value

- About a quarter of marine species depend on reefs.
- Protect coasts from waves and storms.
- Support fisheries, tourism and new medicines.

Bleaching When water becomes too warm, polyps expel their algae and turn white. If heat persists, they die. NOAA confirmed the fourth global bleaching event in 2024. Other causes are ocean acidification, pollution, sediment, overfishing and destructive tourism.

Conservation

- Marine protected areas, controls on sewage and sediment.

- Coral restoration and transplantation, as tried in the Gulf of Mannar.
- Global action to limit warming.

Conclusion Reefs are the "rainforests of the sea"; their survival is a measure of the health of the oceans.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Warm, Clear, Salty, Shallow".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say bleaching always kills corals; they can recover if temperatures fall quickly.

GS2 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · Parliamentary versus presidential system

PREDICTED · GS2-B1

Q15. Why did the Constituent Assembly prefer the parliamentary form of government over the presidential form? (150 words)

Model answer

India adopted the parliamentary system, in which the executive is drawn from and responsible to the legislature, at both Union and State levels.

Reasons

- Familiarity: Indians had worked with legislatures under the Government of India Acts of 1919 and 1935.
- Responsibility over stability: Dr Ambedkar argued in the Assembly that the parliamentary system offers more responsibility, with daily and periodic accountability, while the presidential system offers more stability. India chose responsibility.
- Diversity: a Cabinet can represent many regions and communities; a single President cannot.
- Avoiding deadlock: no conflict between an independently elected executive and legislature.

Criticism Unstable coalitions, a weak separation of powers and dominance of the executive over Parliament.

Assessment The system has survived many crises and allowed peaceful changes of government.

Conclusion The choice reflected India's history and plurality.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Familiar, Responsible, Representative".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say India rejected stability; it judged accountability more important.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Ambedkar's 4 November 1948 speech: parliamentary system more responsibility, presidential more stability.

GS2: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Article 254 and repugnancy.

GS2 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · Article 254 and repugnancy

PREDICTED · GS2-B3

Q16. How does Article 254 resolve conflicts between Union and State laws on Concurrent List subjects? Illustrate with examples and assess its effect on federal balance. (250 words)

Model answer

List III covers subjects on which both Parliament and States may legislate, such as criminal law, education, forests and labour, so conflicts arise.

Article 254(1): the general rule If a State law on a Concurrent subject is repugnant to a law made by Parliament, the Union law prevails and the State law is void to the extent of the repugnancy.

Tests of repugnancy From M. Karunanidhi v Union of India (1979) and earlier cases, courts ask:

- Is there a direct conflict, so that both cannot be obeyed?
- Did Parliament intend to occupy the whole field?
- Do the two laws deal with the same subject matter?

Article 254(2): the exception A State law that receives the President's assent prevails in that State, even if it conflicts with an earlier Union law. Parliament can still later amend or repeal it.

Examples

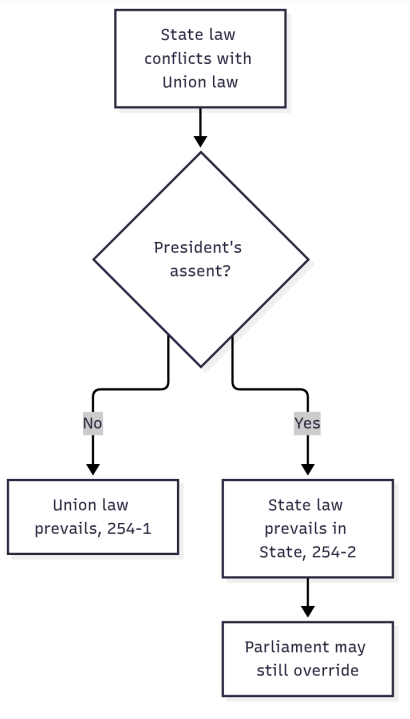
- States have amended labour laws with assent for local needs.
- Tamil Nadu's 2017 law allowing jallikattu, amending the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act for the State, received assent and was upheld by the Supreme Court in 2023.
- Karnataka's 2017 Kambala amendment also got assent.

Effect on federal balance

- Centralising: Union law prevails; assent rests with the Union executive.
- Flexible: States can tailor national laws to local conditions.
- Delays in assent cause friction, as the 2025 Presidential reference on timelines showed.

Way forward Consult States before legislating on Concurrent subjects (Sarkaria) and decide assent in fixed time.

Conclusion Article 254 keeps law coherent while allowing State variation.



DRAW IT: Resolving a Concurrent List conflict. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "One prevails, Two permits": 254(1) Union prevails; 254(2) assent permits State variation.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say a State law with assent is permanently protected; Parliament can later override it under the proviso to Article 254(2).

GS2 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · The 97th Amendment and cooperatives

PREDICTED · GS2-B5

Q17. What changes did the 97th Constitutional Amendment make for cooperative societies? Why was part of it struck down? (150 words)

Model answer

The 97th Amendment, 2011 sought democratic, autonomous, professional cooperatives.

Changes

- Added cooperatives to Article 19(1)(c).
- Inserted Article 43B, a Directive Principle to promote cooperatives.
- Inserted Part IXB (Articles 243ZH to 243ZT): a maximum of 21 board members, a five-year term, elections by an independent authority, reserved seats for SC/ST and women, audit and penalties.

Judgment In Union of India v Rajendra N. Shah (2021), the Supreme Court held that Part IXB, as it applied to State cooperatives, needed ratification by half the States under Article 368(2), since cooperatives are a State List subject (Entry 32). As this was not done, it was struck down for State societies; it survives for multi-State cooperatives.

Aftermath A Union Ministry of Cooperation followed in 2021, and the multi-State law was amended in 2023.

Conclusion The case shows that federal procedure matters even for welcome reforms.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "19, 43B, IXB": right, directive, structure.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the whole amendment was struck down; the Article 19 and 43B changes survive.

GS2 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · Barriers to communication

PREDICTED · GS2-C3

Q18. "Most organisational failures are failures of communication." Discuss the barriers to effective communication in government offices and how they can be overcome. (250 words)

Model answer

Communication is the transfer of information and meaning from one person to another. In administration it links policy with delivery and officials with citizens.

Types

- Downward (orders), upward (reports and feedback), horizontal (between departments) and diagonal.
- Formal channels and the informal "grapevine".

Barriers

- Hierarchical: long chains of command distort and delay messages; subordinates fear reporting bad news.
- Semantic: legal jargon, English-only circulars and complex forms confuse staff and citizens.
- Psychological: status, prejudice and selective listening.
- Physical and technical: distance, poor connectivity, file movement.
- Organisational: silos between departments, lack of feedback mechanisms.
- Overload: too many circulars; important instructions are lost.

Consequences Delayed decisions, duplicated work, poor implementation and citizen distrust.

Overcoming barriers

- Flatter structures and delegation; open-door policies.
- Plain-language circulars in the local language; Kannada in Karnataka's offices under the Kannada Language Comprehensive Development Act, 2022.
- e-Office and dashboards for faster file movement.
- Regular review meetings and video conferences across levels.
- Feedback channels such as grievance portals and social audits.
- Training in listening and presentation skills.

Example During the COVID-19 response, war rooms and daily dashboards in Karnataka improved coordination between health, police and revenue officials.

Conclusion Good communication is two-way, clear and timely; it turns a rule-bound office into a responsive one.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HSPPOO": Hierarchy, Semantics, Psychology, Physical, Organisation, Overload.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not list only technology solutions; attitudes and structure matter as much.

GS2 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Management by Objectives

PREDICTED · GS2-C5

Q19. What is Management by Objectives? Discuss its usefulness in public administration. (150 words)

Model answer

Management by Objectives (MBO) was popularised by Peter Drucker in The Practice of Management (1954). Superiors and subordinates jointly set clear, measurable objectives, review progress and evaluate performance against them.

Steps

- Set organisational goals; break them into unit and individual targets.
- Agree on action plans and timelines.
- Periodic review and feedback.
- Appraisal based on results.

Usefulness in government

- Focuses on results rather than procedure.
- Improves motivation through participation.
- Supports outcome budgets and performance dashboards, as in Results-Framework Documents and the mission-mode programmes.

Limitations

- Public goals are often hard to measure, such as justice or dignity.
- Risk of gaming targets and neglecting unmeasured work.
- Requires trust and delegation, which rigid hierarchies lack.

Conclusion MBO works in government when targets are realistic, measurable and accompanied by genuine participation.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Set, Plan, Review, Appraise".

COMMON TRAP: Do not present MBO as a top-down target imposition; its essence is joint goal-setting.

GS2 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · Cyclones on the east and west coasts

PREDICTED · GS2-A3

Q20. Why are cyclones more frequent and intense along India's east coast than the west coast? Discuss the recent trend in the Arabian Sea and the steps for cyclone preparedness. (250 words)

Model answer

Tropical cyclones are intense low-pressure systems that form over warm seas, with sea surface temperatures above about 26.5 degrees Celsius, high humidity, low vertical wind shear and enough Coriolis force.

East-west contrast

- The Bay of Bengal is warmer and receives more moisture and fresh water from large rivers, which keep the surface warm.
- Remnants of Pacific typhoons enter the Bay and re-intensify.
- The funnel shape of the Bay and the low, flat deltas of Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and West Bengal increase storm surges.
- The Arabian Sea has historically been cooler, and many storms move away from the Indian coast towards Oman.

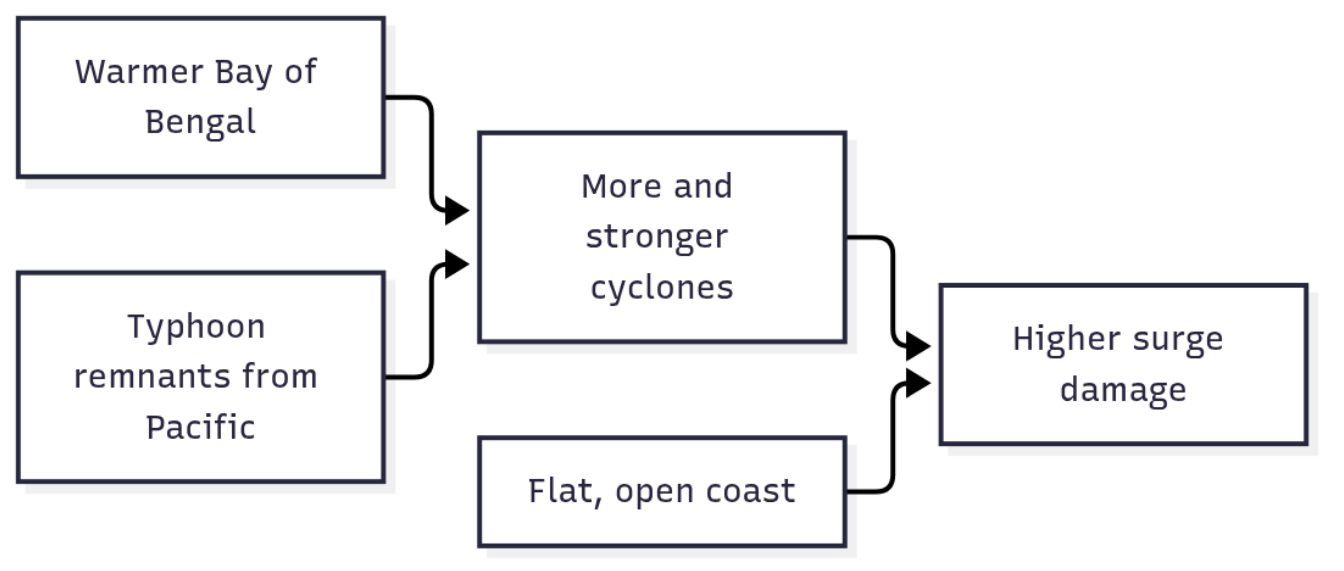
Recent trend in the Arabian Sea Studies by Indian researchers have found an increase in the frequency and intensity of Arabian Sea cyclones in recent decades, linked to warming of the sea. Tauktae (2021) and Biparjoy (2023) affected Gujarat and the west coast; Ockhi (2017) hit Kerala and Lakshadweep.

Preparedness

- IMD's improved forecasts and colour-coded warnings; it is the WMO regional centre for the north Indian Ocean.
- The National Cyclone Risk Mitigation Project: cyclone shelters, early warning dissemination and underground cabling.
- Odisha's community-based evacuation model reduced deaths from thousands in 1999 to very few in recent cyclones.
- Mangroves and coastal shelterbelts.

Karnataka Coastal districts face storm surges and heavy rain; shelters and fishermen's alerts are key.

Conclusion Better forecasts have reduced deaths; the next challenge is to reduce damage to homes, crops and livelihoods.



DRAW IT: Why the east coast gets more cyclones. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Warm, Wet, Wide, Weak shear".

COMMON TRAP: Do not say the west coast is safe from cyclones; Arabian Sea cyclones are increasing.

PEAK FACT: Cyclone formation above about 26.5 degrees Celsius SST.

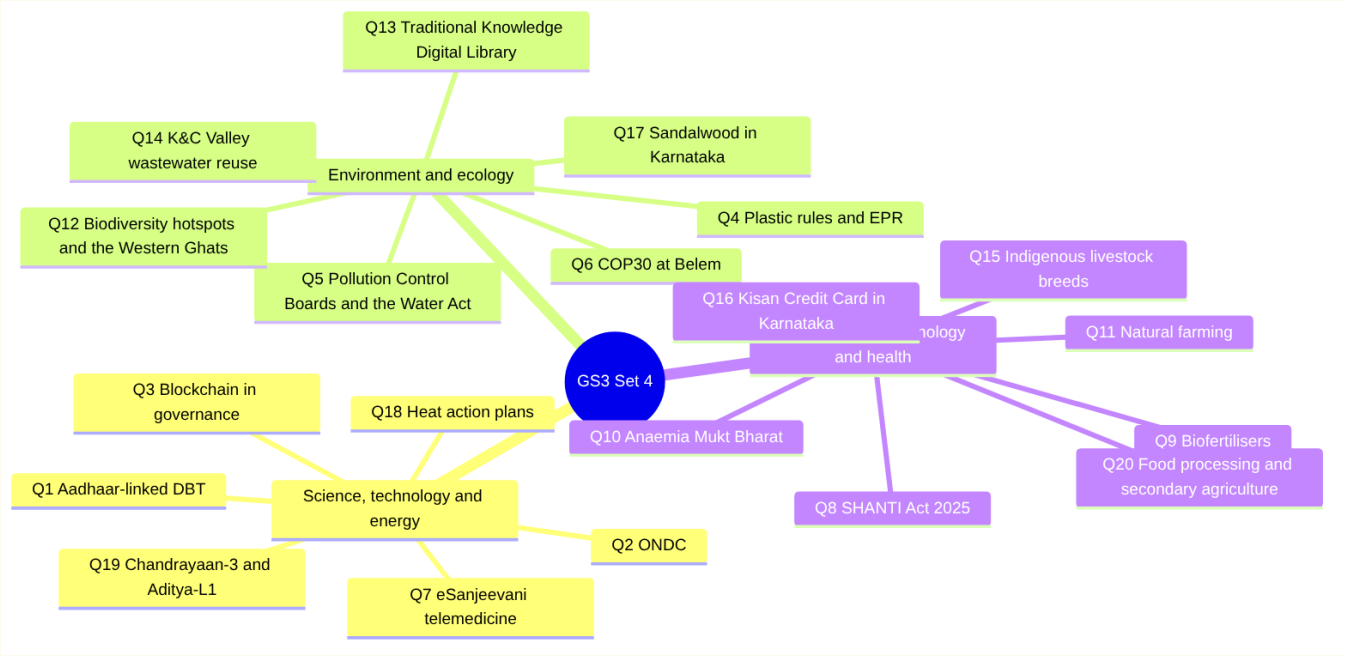
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Article 254 and repugnancy:** "One prevails, Two permits": 254(1) Union prevails; 254(2) assent permits State variation. **Q17 The 97th Amendment and cooperatives:** "19, 43B, IXB": right, directive, structure. **Q18 Barriers to communication:** "HSPPOO": Hierarchy, Semantics, Psychology, Physical, Organisation, Overload. **Q19 Management by Objectives:** "Set, Plan, Review, Appraise". **Q20 Cyclones on the east and west coasts:** "Warm, Wet, Wide, Weak shear".

Paper 4: General Studies III (GS3)

Set 4: step 5 of 6 (General Studies III (GS3)). Next up: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** The science paper links technology, environment and farms: ONDC, the SHANTI Act, COP30, plastic rules, anaemia, natural farming and Karnataka's K&C Valley, KCC and food parks. Quote one figure, one risk and one way forward.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS3 Q1 of 20 · 10 marks · Aadhaar-linked DBT

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q1. How has Aadhaar-linked Direct Benefit Transfer changed welfare delivery? What problems remain? (150 words)

Model answer

Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), launched in 2013, sends benefits straight to beneficiaries' bank accounts. It rests on the JAM trinity of Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar and mobile phones.

Gains

- Removing duplicate and ghost beneficiaries saves money; LPG subsidy under PAHAL was an early example.
- Fewer intermediaries means less leakage and faster payment.
- Section 7 of the Aadhaar Act, 2016 lets governments require Aadhaar for subsidies; the Supreme Court upheld this in K.S. Puttaswamy (2018).
- Karnataka credits Gruha Lakshmi's monthly Rs 2,000 to women heads of household through DBT.

Problems

- Biometric failures and seeding errors exclude the old and manual workers.
- Payments fail when accounts are inactive or mapped wrongly.
- Last-mile cash access is weak in remote villages.

Way forward Offline and OTP alternatives, regular account checks and grievance desks at Gram Panchayats.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "J-A-M": Jan Dhan carries, Aadhaar identifies, Mobile informs.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat removed names as savings by default; some were genuine beneficiaries excluded by error.

GS3 Q2 of 20 · 15 marks · ONDC

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q2. What is the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)? Assess its potential to democratise e-commerce for small sellers. (250 words)

Model answer

E-commerce in India is dominated by a few large platforms that control search, pricing and customer data. ONDC, promoted by DPIIT as a not-for-profit company in 2021 and piloted from April 2022, tries to change this with open protocols rather than a single platform.

How it works

- Buyer apps and seller apps are separate; any registered buyer app can show products from any seller app.
- Like UPI in payments, it is a public digital infrastructure, not a marketplace.
- It covers groceries, food, mobility, financial services and more.

Progress

- ONDC reported more than 500 million cumulative transactions by July 2026, with about 218 million in 2025-26.

Potential for small sellers

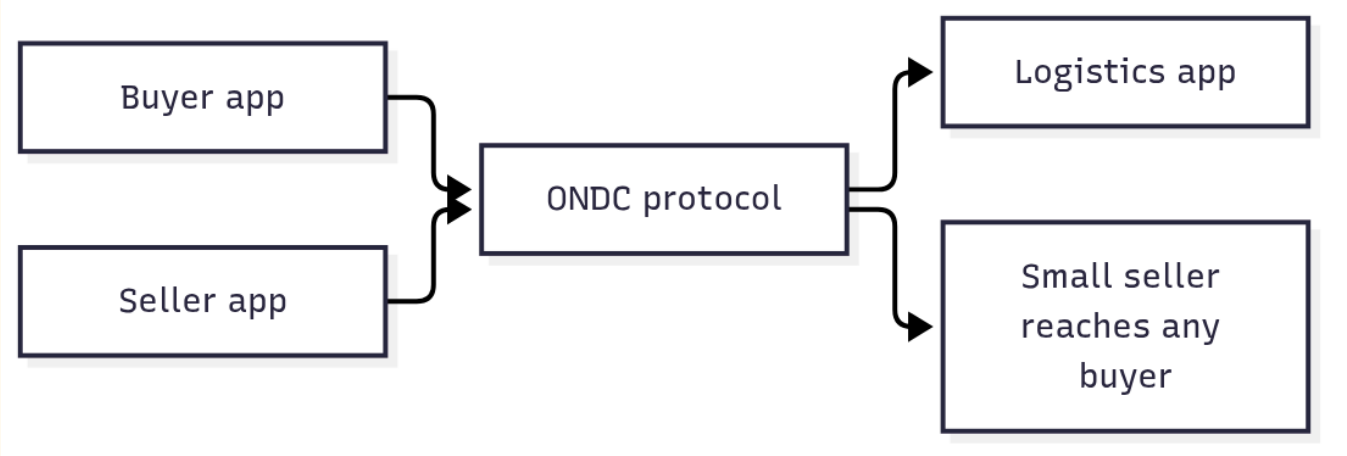
- Kirana shops, artisans and FPOs can list without joining a big platform.
- Lower commissions and more control over their own data.
- Discovery across many apps raises reach to smaller towns.
- Karnataka's Namma Yatri, an auto-ride app in Bengaluru built on the ONDC protocol, showed how drivers can keep fares without commission.

Challenges

- Low awareness and digital skills among small traders.
- Uneven quality of logistics and returns across apps.
- Trust and grievance redress spread across many players.
- Discounts on network apps fell once early incentives ended.

Way forward Onboarding through Common Service Centres, shared logistics, a single grievance window, and links with credit so that sales data helps sellers borrow.

Conclusion ONDC can do for commerce what UPI did for payments, if it builds trust and convenience as well as openness.



DRAW IT: ONDC: open network, many apps. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Open, Not Owned": many apps on one network, no single owner.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call ONDC a government e-commerce site; it is a network protocol on which private apps run.

GS3 Q3 of 20 · 10 marks · Blockchain in governance

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q3. How can blockchain technology improve governance? What are its limits? (150 words)

Model answer

Blockchain is a shared, tamper-evident ledger in which every record is linked to the previous one and verified by many nodes.

Uses in governance

- Land records: a change of ownership cannot be quietly altered.
- Certificates: degrees and caste certificates can be checked instantly.
- Supply chains: tracking drugs, seeds and PDS grain from source to shop.
- In September 2024, MeitY launched the Vishvasya stack under the National Blockchain Framework so departments can build such services.

Limits

- A blockchain only keeps what is entered; wrong data at entry stays wrong. Karnataka's Bhoomi land records show that digitising alone does not clean old disputes.
- Energy use and cost of some designs.
- Privacy conflicts with permanent records.
- Lack of skills and interoperability among departments.

Conclusion It is useful where many parties must trust one record, but it cannot replace clean data and good law.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Chain, not cure": it secures records but does not correct them.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not link blockchain mainly to cryptocurrencies; governments use permissioned ledgers.

GS3 Q4 of 20 · 15 marks · Plastic rules and EPR

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q4. Explain how India regulates plastic packaging through its 2016 Rules and producer obligations (EPR). Why has the plastic problem persisted? (250 words)

Model answer

India generates millions of tonnes of plastic waste a year, much of it single-use and poorly collected. The 2016 plastic waste rules, issued under the 1986 environment law, are the main instrument.

Main features

- Minimum thickness for carry bags was raised to 75 microns in September 2021 and 120 microns in December 2022.
- Nineteen identified single-use plastic items were banned from 1 July 2022.
- Urban local bodies and Gram Panchayats must segregate and collect plastic waste.

Extended Producer Responsibility

- Guidelines issued in February 2022 make producers, importers and brand owners responsible for collecting and recycling their packaging.
- Targets cover rigid plastics, flexible packaging and multi-layered packaging, with rising shares of recycled content.
- A centralised CPCB portal registers producers and recyclers and trades EPR certificates.
- Environmental compensation applies to those who miss targets.

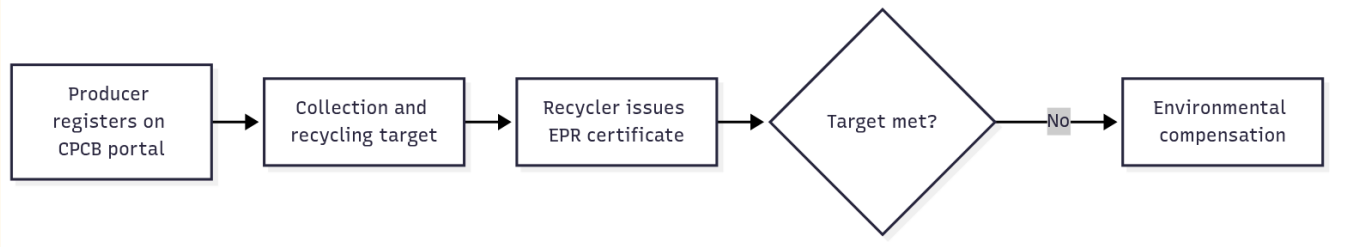
Why the problem persists

- Weak enforcement in small towns and informal markets.
- Fake EPR certificates found on the portal.
- Lack of cheap alternatives for vendors.
- The informal waste-pickers who do most recycling are not integrated.
- Multi-layered packaging is hard to recycle.

Karnataka Karnataka banned plastic carry bags and some single-use items in 2016, before the national ban, but enforcement in Bengaluru markets remains uneven.

Way forward Audits of EPR certificates, deposit-refund schemes, support to waste-picker cooperatives and alternatives through SHGs.

Conclusion Rules exist; the gap lies in enforcement and in making alternatives affordable.



DRAW IT: Producer responsibility for plastic. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Thick, Banned, Paid": thicker bags, banned items, producers pay.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse the 75 and 120 micron limits with dates; 120 microns has applied since 31 December 2022.

GS3 Q5 of 20 · 10 marks · Pollution Control Boards and the Water Act

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q5. Explain the role of the Central and State Pollution Control Boards under the Water Act, 1974. What did the 2024 amendment change? (150 words)

Model answer

The Water Act of 1974 was India's first major environmental law. Parliament passed it under Article 252 after States consented, since water is a State subject.

Roles of the Boards

- The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) sets standards, coordinates States and advises the Union.
- State Boards such as the Karnataka State Pollution Control Board grant "consent to establish" and "consent to operate" to industries.
- They monitor rivers and can order closure of polluting units.

2024 amendment

- Replaced imprisonment for many minor violations with penalties.
- Allows the Union to exempt some industries from consent.
- Lets the Union guide how Chairpersons of State Boards are selected.

Concerns Boards lack staff; Bengaluru's lakes such as Bellandur show sewage remains the main polluter.

Conclusion Strong, independent and well-staffed Boards are the key to clean rivers.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Consent, Check, Close": consent, monitor, close polluting units.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the amendment applies to all States automatically; it applies to States that adopt it under Article 252.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Water Act 1974 under Article 252.

GS3: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, COP30 at Belem.

GS3 Q6 of 20 · 15 marks · COP30 at Belem

PREDICTED · GS3-C5 · Current affairs

Q6. What did COP30 at Belém agree on climate finance and adaptation? Assess its significance for India. (250 words)

Model answer

The 30th Conference of the Parties to the UN climate convention met at Belém, Brazil, in November 2025, ten years after the Paris Agreement.

Main outcomes

- The "Global Mutirão" decision called for at least tripling adaptation finance by 2035.
- It kept the New Collective Quantified Goal of 300 billion dollars a year by 2035, agreed at Baku, and the aim of raising 1.3 trillion dollars a year from all sources by 2035.
- A two-year work programme on climate finance was set up.
- Indicators for the Global Goal on Adaptation were adopted.
- No agreed roadmap on moving away from fossil fuels made it into the final text.

Significance for India

- Adaptation: India faces heat, floods and cyclones; more adaptation finance helps.
- Equity: the text keeps finance as the duty of developed countries, which India supports.
- Trade: India has objected to unilateral measures like the EU's carbon border tax; COP30 opened dialogue on trade and climate.
- NDCs: India must show progress on 50% non-fossil capacity, which it reached in 2025.

Karnataka The State's coastal and drought-prone districts need adaptation funds, and its solar parks such as Pavagada show what mitigation can do.

Limits

- Tripling is from a low base, and the source of funds is vague.
- Without a fossil fuel roadmap, the 1.5°C goal recedes.

Conclusion COP30 kept the process alive and moved adaptation up the agenda, but India must still push for public, predictable finance.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Triple, Keep, Review": triple adaptation finance, keep the 300 billion goal, review finance in two years.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say COP30 agreed a fossil fuel phase-out; that roadmap stayed outside the final decision.

GS3 Q7 of 20 · 10 marks · eSanjeevani telemedicine

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q7. What is eSanjeevani? How far has telemedicine improved rural healthcare? (150 words)

Model answer

eSanjeevani is the Union Health Ministry's national telemedicine service, developed by C-DAC.

Two modes

- Doctor to doctor: launched in November 2019, it links health workers at Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (spokes) with specialists at hubs.
- Patient to doctor (eSanjeevani OPD): launched in April 2020 during Covid, it lets patients consult doctors from home.

Gains

- Specialist advice reaches villages without travel.
- It is linked with ABHA health IDs for records.
- Karnataka uses it through its health centres, with hubs at district hospitals and medical colleges.

Limits

- Poor connectivity and few smartphones in remote areas.
- Diagnosis without physical examination has limits.
- Medicines and tests must still be available locally.

Way forward Better broadband, diagnostic kits at health centres and training for community health officers.

Conclusion Telemedicine adds to rural healthcare but cannot replace doctors on the ground.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Hub and Spoke, Home and Clinic": two modes of eSanjeevani.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call it a private app; it is a government platform run by the Health Ministry with C-DAC.

GS3 Q8 of 20 · 15 marks · SHANTI Act, 2025

PREDICTED · GS3-B4 · Current affairs

Q8. What changes does the SHANTI Act, 2025 bring to India's nuclear energy sector? Discuss its opportunities and concerns. (250 words)

Model answer

India's nuclear power was long a state monopoly under the Atomic Energy Act, 1962. The Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India (SHANTI) Act, 2025, which received assent on 21 December 2025, opens the sector.

Main changes

- Private and joint-venture companies can be licensed to build, own and run nuclear plants.
- It replaces the Atomic Energy Act, 1962 and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act, 2010.
- The Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB) gets statutory status and grants safety authorisation.
- Operator liability is capped in slabs from Rs 100 crore to Rs 3,000 crore by plant size, with the government covering damage beyond that.
- Sensitive activities such as enrichment, reprocessing and heavy water remain with the government.

Opportunities

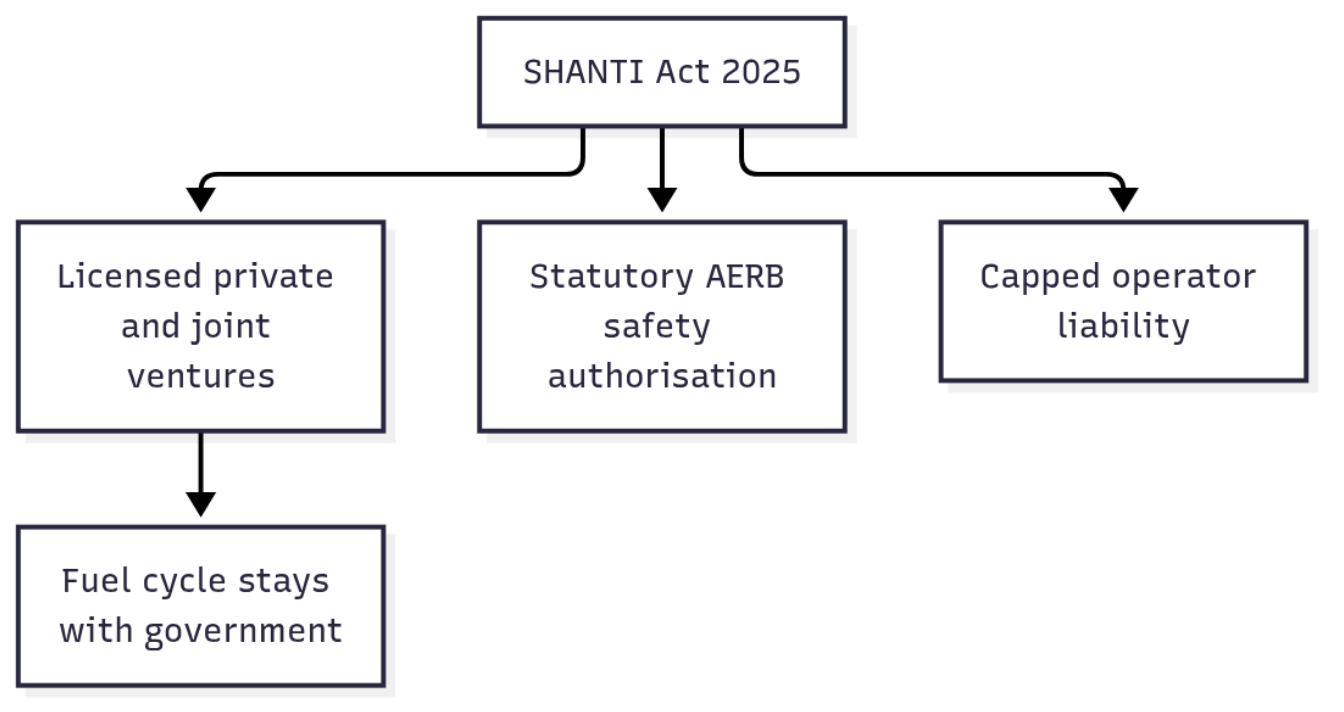
- Supports the target of 100 GW of nuclear capacity by 2047.
- Small modular reactors can serve industry and replace old coal plants.
- Clean baseload power for data centres and manufacturing.
- Karnataka's Kaiga plant could see expansion.

Concerns

- Lower liability caps may weaken compensation after an accident.
- The removal of supplier liability, which the 2010 law allowed, worries safety groups.
- Regulator independence must be real, not only on paper.
- Waste disposal and public consent remain unresolved.

Way forward An independent regulator answerable to Parliament, transparent site selection, a strong insurance pool and public consultation.

Conclusion SHANTI can speed clean energy, but safety and accountability must keep pace with private entry.



DRAW IT: Nuclear sector after SHANTI. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Open, Regulate, Cap": opens entry, strengthens AERB, caps liability.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say private firms can enrich uranium; fuel-cycle activities stay with the state.

GS3 Q9 of 20 · 10 marks · Biofertilisers

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q9. What are biofertilisers? Explain their types and the reasons for their limited adoption. (150 words)

Model answer

Biofertilisers are preparations of living microbes that make nutrients available to plants by fixing nitrogen, dissolving phosphate or helping roots absorb nutrients.

Types

- Nitrogen fixers: Rhizobium in pulses; Azotobacter and Azospirillum in cereals; blue-green algae and Azolla in paddy.
- Phosphate solubilisers: Bacillus and Pseudomonas.
- Mycorrhiza: fungi that help roots absorb phosphorus and water.
- Potash mobilisers and zinc solubilisers.

Benefits Lower chemical fertiliser costs, better soil health and higher yields over time. They are covered by the Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985.

Why adoption is limited

- Short shelf life and poor quality in the market.
- Slow, less visible results compared with urea.
- Weak extension and cold storage.

Way forward Liquid formulations, quality checks, and supply through Raitha Samparka Kendras in Karnataka.

Conclusion Biofertilisers are a low-cost path to soil health.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Fix, Free, Fungi": fix nitrogen, free phosphate, fungi aid roots.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call compost a biofertiliser; biofertilisers contain live microbes.

GS3 Q10 of 20 · 15 marks · Anaemia Mukt Bharat

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q10. Despite many schemes, anaemia remains widespread in India. Explain the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy and suggest measures to improve it. (250 words)

Model answer

NFHS-5 (2019-21) found 67.1% of children aged 6 to 59 months and 57% of women aged 15 to 49 anaemic, higher than in NFHS-4. Anaemia lowers learning, work output and safe childbirth.

Anaemia Mukt Bharat (2018) It follows a "6x6x6" strategy:

- Six target groups: children of 6 to 59 months, 5 to 9 years, adolescents, women of reproductive age, pregnant women and nursing mothers.
- Six interventions: iron and folic acid supplements, deworming, behaviour change, testing and treatment with digital methods, fortified food in government programmes, and treating non-nutritional causes like malaria.
- Six institutional mechanisms: including a national centre and a dashboard.

Why anaemia persists

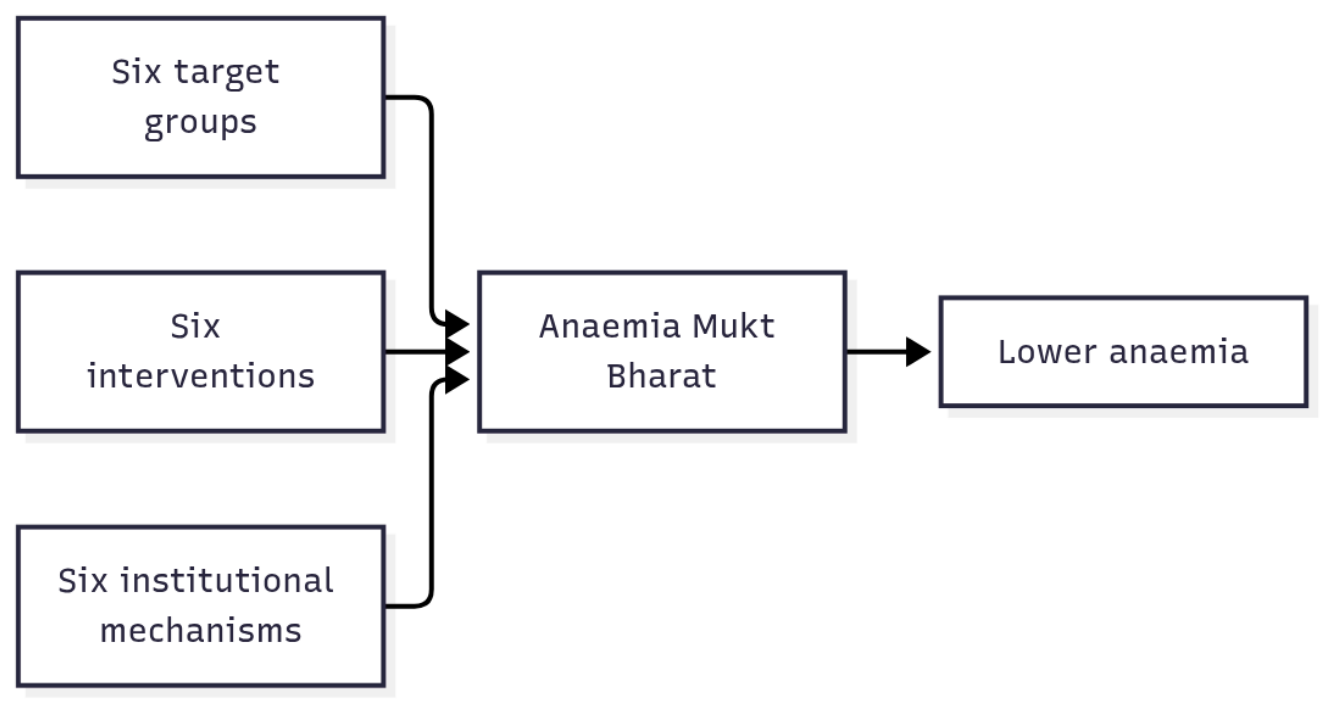
- Diets low in iron, vitamin B12 and folate.
- Poor absorption due to infections and worms.
- Low uptake of tablets due to side effects.
- Early marriage and closely spaced pregnancies.
- Sickle cell and thalassaemia in tribal areas.

Measures

- Include eggs, greens and millets in PM POSHAN and Anganwadi meals.
- Fortified rice through PDS, with checks for thalassaemia patients.
- Point-of-care testing in schools.
- Peer educators among adolescents.

Karnataka The State's mid-day meals give eggs or bananas several days a week, and fortified rice is supplied through PDS.

Conclusion Anaemia is a diet, health and gender problem at once; a combined response is needed.



DRAW IT: The 6x6x6 strategy. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "6x6x6": six groups, six interventions, six systems.

COMMON TRAP: Do not cite NFHS-5 anaemia as falling; it rose from NFHS-4 for both women and children.

PEAK FACT: NFHS-5: children 6-59 months 67.1%; women 15-49 57% anaemic.

GS3: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Natural farming.

GS3 Q11 of 20 · 10 marks · Natural farming

PREDICTED · GS3-B7 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. What is natural farming? Evaluate the National Mission on Natural Farming, citing its Karnataka coverage. (150 words)

Model answer

Natural farming is a chemical-free method using on-farm inputs such as jeevamrutha (cow dung, urine, jaggery and pulse flour), mulching and mixed cropping. Karnataka's Subhash Palekar movement popularised it.

National Mission on Natural Farming

- Approved in November 2024 as a centrally sponsored scheme.
- Aims at 1 crore farmers and 7.5 lakh hectares through 15,000 clusters.
- Bio-input resource centres and trained "Krishi Sakhis" support farmers.

Karnataka As per the State's 2025-26 Survey, the Mission runs in 990 clusters covering 49,500 hectares.

Benefits Lower costs, better soil and less debt.

Concerns

- Yield falls in the first years.
- No price premium without certification and markets.

- Limited scientific evidence across all crops.

Way forward Research by agricultural universities, transition support and markets through FPOs.

Conclusion Natural farming suits small farmers if the transition is supported.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Cow, Cover, Combine": cow-based inputs, mulch cover, mixed crops.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate natural farming with certified organic farming; it avoids even bought organic inputs.

GS3 Q12 of 20 · 15 marks · Biodiversity hotspots and the Western Ghats

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q12. What are biodiversity hotspots? Describe India's hotspots and discuss threats to the Western Ghats. (250 words)

Model answer

The idea of biodiversity hotspots was introduced by Norman Myers in 1988. A region qualifies if it has at least 1,500 endemic vascular plants and has lost at least 70% of its original habitat. There are 36 hotspots worldwide.

India's four hotspots

- Himalaya: high-altitude species like the snow leopard and red panda.
- Indo-Burma: the North-East, rich in orchids and primates.
- Western Ghats and Sri Lanka: high endemism among amphibians and plants.
- Sundaland: India's part is the Nicobar Islands.

Western Ghats

- They stretch about 1,600 km from Gujarat to Kanyakumari.
- UNESCO listed 39 sites as World Heritage in 2012, including Karnataka's Kudremukh, Bhadra and parts of Talacauvery.
- They host the lion-tailed macaque and many endemic frogs.
- They are the source of the Cauvery, Krishna and Godavari tributaries.

Threats

- Mining, quarrying and roads.
- Hydro and linear projects.
- Plantations replacing natural forest.
- Landslides worsened by land use change, as in Kodagu in 2018.
- Climate change and invasive species.

Conservation debate

- Gadgil panel (2011) proposed wide ecological sensitivity zones.
- Kasturirangan panel (2013) narrowed this to about 37% of the area.
- Karnataka has objected to parts of the draft ESA notifications, citing livelihoods.

Way forward Community-based conservation, strict limits on quarries, and payment for ecosystem services.

Conclusion The Ghats are water towers of the south; their protection is also water security.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "1,500 and 70": the two hotspot tests.

COMMON TRAP: Do not list the Eastern Ghats or Sundarbans as hotspots; they are not.

GS3 Q13 of 20 · 10 marks · Traditional Knowledge Digital Library

PREDICTED · GS3-C2

Q13. What is the Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL)? How does it protect India's traditional knowledge? (150 words)

Model answer

The Traditional Knowledge Digital Library was set up in 2001 by CSIR with the Ministry of AYUSH.

What it does

- Converts Ayurveda, Unani, Siddha, Sowa Rigpa and Yoga texts into patent-office formats in several languages.
- Gives patent offices in Europe, the US and elsewhere access under non-disclosure agreements.
- Lets examiners reject claims based on known knowledge.

Why it was needed Patents on turmeric for wound-healing (1995) and neem as a fungicide were challenged at great cost; TKDL prevents such cases before grant.

Impact Many foreign patent applications have been withdrawn or rejected after TKDL evidence.

Limits

- Covers mainly codified texts, not oral tribal knowledge.
- Does not secure benefit-sharing.

Karnataka Folk healers in the Western Ghats hold oral knowledge; People's Biodiversity Registers under the Biological Diversity Act can record it.

Conclusion TKDL is a shield; benefit-sharing laws are also needed.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Shield, not sword": it blocks false patents but does not earn royalties.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say TKDL grants patents to India; it is prior art used to defend against patents.

GS3 Q14 of 20 · 15 marks · K&C Valley wastewater reuse

PREDICTED · GS3-C1 · Karnataka-specific

Q14. Treated wastewater can be a resource. Examine the Koramangala-Challaghatta (K&C) Valley project in Karnataka and its lessons for urban water reuse. (250 words)

Model answer

Bengaluru produces large volumes of sewage, while the dry districts of Kolar and Chikkaballapur have no perennial rivers. The K&C Valley project links the two.

The project

- Sewage treatment plants at Belur Nagasandra near Challaghatta treat Bengaluru's sewage.
- The Economic Survey 2025-26 lists four K&C Valley plants with a combined capacity of 458 MLD, treating about 393 MLD.

- Treated water is pumped about 440 MLD to fill tanks in Kolar and Chikkaballapur, recharging groundwater.

Benefits

- Groundwater levels in served areas rose, reviving borewells.
- Farmers grow vegetables and keep dairy animals.
- It reduces pressure on the Cauvery.

Concerns

- Secondary treatment does not remove all nutrients, heavy metals and emerging pollutants.
- Studies found foam and algal growth in some tanks.
- High Court cases asked for tertiary treatment.

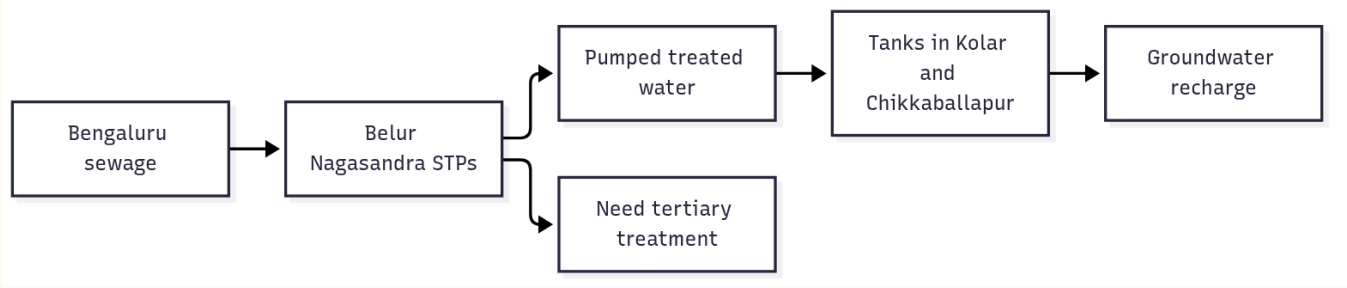
Wider context

- Bengaluru depends on Cauvery water pumped over 100 km and lifted about 300 m, so reuse cuts both cost and energy.
- Similar projects such as H.N. Valley now carry treated water from Hebbal-Nagavara to Chikkaballapur tanks.
- Other dry districts have demanded similar schemes.

Lessons for urban reuse

- Tertiary treatment should be standard before reuse.
- Regular, public water-quality monitoring.
- Reuse for industry, construction and parks within cities.
- Pricing so treated water is cheaper than fresh water.
- AMRUT 2.0 and the National Framework on Safe Reuse of Treated Water (2022) support this.

Conclusion K&C shows that sewage can become a resource, but only if treatment standards keep pace with ambition.



DRAW IT: From Bengaluru sewage to Kolar tanks. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Treat, Test, Transfer": treat fully, test openly, then transfer.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the water is for drinking; it is for tank filling and groundwater recharge.

GS3 Q15 of 20 · 10 marks · Indigenous livestock breeds

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Why should indigenous livestock breeds be conserved? Illustrate from Karnataka. (150 words)

Model answer

Karnataka counts over three crore livestock and nearly six crore poultry birds (20th Livestock Census, cited in the State Survey). Native breeds are a big part of this wealth, shaped over centuries by local farmers and pastoralists.

Karnataka's breeds

- Cattle: Hallikar, Amrit Mahal, Khillar, Deoni, Malnad Gidda and Krishna Valley.
- Sheep: Bannur (Bandur), Deccani and Mandya.

Why conserve them

- Adapted to heat, drought and local diseases.
- Low input needs suit small farmers.
- A2 milk and draught power.
- Genetic diversity for future breeding.

Threats

- Crossbreeding with exotic breeds for higher milk.
- Mechanisation reducing demand for draught bullocks.
- Loss of grazing land to encroachment.

Measures

- The Rashtriya Gokul Mission (2014) supports indigenous breeds through sex-sorted semen and IVF.
- Amrit Mahal Kavals protect grazing land.
- Breed societies and incentives for keepers.

Conclusion Indigenous breeds are a climate-resilient asset.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Hardy, Cheap, Diverse": three reasons to conserve.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call all native cattle low-yielding; Deoni and Hallikar are valued for draught and resilience.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** 20th Livestock Census: Karnataka 3.03 crore livestock, 5.95 crore poultry.

GS3: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Kisan Credit Card in Karnataka.

GS3 Q16 of 20 · 15 marks · Kisan Credit Card in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q16. How far has the Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme widened formal farm credit in Karnataka? Suggest improvements. (250 words)

Model answer

Timely credit decides whether a farmer buys seed and fertiliser or turns to a moneylender. The Kisan Credit Card scheme, introduced in 1998-99, provides a revolving credit limit through banks.

Features

- Covers crop loans, post-harvest needs and household consumption.
- Extended to animal husbandry and fisheries in 2018-19.
- Under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme, short-term crop loans within a Rs 3 lakh ceiling carry 7% interest, falling to 4% for prompt repayment.
- The Union Budget 2025-26 raised the limit for subvention to Rs 5 lakh.

Karnataka

- As on 30 September 2025, the State had 50,73,080 KCCs with Rs 72,961 crore outstanding (Economic Survey Table 10.36).
- Cooperative banks issued 30,00,675 cards and Karnataka Grameena Bank 9,30,523.

- 12,122 KCCs had been given to fishermen by December 2025.

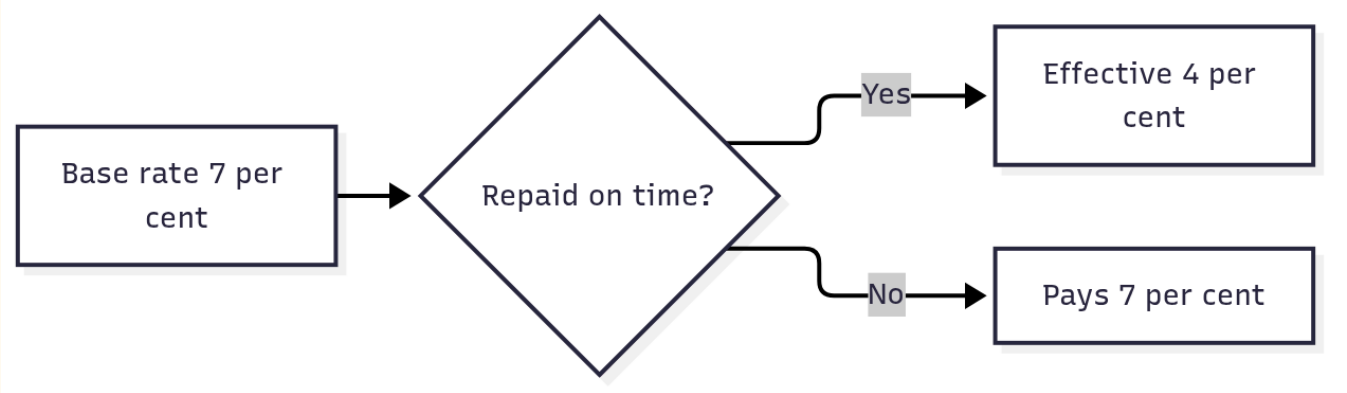
Problems

- Tenant farmers and sharecroppers lack land papers.
- Credit is used for consumption, leading to debt.
- Loan waivers weaken repayment culture.
- Regional skew towards irrigated districts.

Reforms

- Recognise tenant farmers through land-leasing laws.
- Digital KCC with land records in Bhoomi for quick sanction.
- Link KCC with crop insurance and FPO membership.
- Financial literacy through cooperative societies.

Conclusion KCC has widened formal credit, but it must reach tenants and dryland farmers to end dependence on moneylenders.



DRAW IT: KCC interest arithmetic. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "7-4-3": 7% interest, 4% on prompt repayment, 3% subvention.

COMMON TRAP: Do not count all KCC accounts as active; many cards are dormant.

GS3 Q17 of 20 · 10 marks · Sandalwood in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS3-C6 · Karnataka-specific

Q17. Karnataka was once called the land of sandalwood. Explain the decline of sandalwood and the measures for its revival. (150 words)

Model answer

Sandalwood (Santalum album) gave Mysore its famous soap, oil and carvings. Natural stands have shrunk sharply, and IUCN lists the species as Vulnerable.

Causes of decline

- Smuggling, notoriously by Veerappan's gang.
- Strict state ownership, which made farmers uproot trees on their land.
- Sandal spike disease and forest fires.
- Slow growth over decades.

Measures

- Karnataka amended its forest law in 2001 and later relaxed rules, so growers own trees on their land and can sell them.

- Institute of Wood Science and Technology in Bengaluru researches disease and planting.
- Karnataka Soaps and Detergents Limited buys sandalwood oil; Mysore Sandal Soap has a GI tag.
- Farmers grow it with host plants in private plantations.

Concerns Theft risk for growers and a long wait for returns.

Conclusion Private plantations backed by security and fair pricing can revive Karnataka's sandalwood heritage.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Smuggled, Seized, Sick": three causes of decline.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say private growing is banned in Karnataka; it was liberalised from 2001.

GS3 Q18 of 20 · 15 marks · Heat action plans

PREDICTED · GS3-A4 · Karnataka-specific

Q18. Heat waves are becoming more frequent in India. Examine the role of heat action plans and suggest how they can be strengthened. (250 words)

Model answer

The India Meteorological Department declares a heat wave in the plains when the maximum temperature is at least 40°C and 4.5°C or more above normal, or when it reaches 45°C. Heat waves are rising in number and length due to climate change and urban heat islands.

Heat action plans (HAPs)

- Ahmedabad's plan of 2013 was the first in South Asia.
- NDMA issued national guidelines in 2016, later revised.
- Plans include early warnings, cooling centres, water points, changed work hours, and training of health staff.

Karnataka North Karnataka districts like Kalaburagi, Raichur and Ballari often cross 42°C. The State's disaster monitoring centre (KSNDMC) issues forecasts, and the State has prepared heat action plans with district-level guidance.

Gaps

- Most plans have weak legal backing and little funding.
- Thresholds ignore humidity, which makes coastal heat deadly.
- Outdoor workers, the elderly and slum dwellers are not mapped.
- Heat deaths are under-reported.
- Heat waves are not a notified disaster for SDRF funds in all cases.

Strengthening

- Use humid heat indices and local thresholds.
- Map vulnerable people and use mobile alerts in Kannada.
- Cool roofs, tree cover and shaded bus stops.
- Labour rules for rest breaks in afternoons.
- Ensure funds through State disaster funds.

Conclusion Heat is a silent disaster; plans with money, data and legal force can save lives.



DRAW IT: A heat action plan cycle. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Warn, Cool, Protect": warnings, cooling, protecting the vulnerable.

COMMON TRAP: Do not use one national temperature for all regions; IMD uses different criteria for plains, coasts and hills.

GS3 Q19 of 20 · 10 marks · Chandrayaan-3 and Aditya-L1

PREDICTED · GS3-A2

Q19. Explain the scientific achievements of Chandrayaan-3 and Aditya-L1. (150 words)

Model answer

Both missions were launched by ISRO in 2023 and controlled from Bengaluru.

Chandrayaan-3

- Its Vikram lander touched down near the lunar south pole on 23 August 2023, making India the first country to land there.
- The Pragyan rover confirmed sulphur in the lunar soil.
- The landing site was named Shiv Shakti Point, and 23 August became National Space Day.

Aditya-L1

- India's first solar observatory, launched on 2 September 2023.
- Placed in a halo orbit around the L1 point, about 1.5 million km from Earth, in January 2024.
- Its seven payloads study the corona, solar wind and flares; the coronagraph (VELC) observes the corona.

Significance Low cost, self-reliance and data for space weather.

Karnataka ISRO headquarters, the U R Rao Satellite Centre and ISTRAC in Bengaluru built and steered both missions.

Conclusion They show India's space capability across the Moon and the Sun.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "South Pole, First Point": first landing near the south pole; L1 is the first point to watch the Sun.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Aditya-L1 lands on the Sun; it orbits L1.

GS3 Q20 of 20 · 15 marks · Food processing and secondary agriculture

PREDICTED · GS3-B6 · Karnataka-specific

Q20. Food processing links farms to markets. Examine the scope of the sector in India, the constraints it faces and Karnataka's approach through food parks and "secondary agriculture". (250 words)

Model answer

India is among the largest producers of milk, fruits, vegetables and pulses, yet only a small share of its farm output is processed, and post-harvest losses are high. Food processing adds value, cuts waste and creates jobs in villages.

Scope

- Lower post-harvest losses in perishables like tomato, onion and mango.
- Better prices for farmers through steady demand.
- Rural jobs, especially for women.
- Exports of processed foods, spices and marine products.

Union support

- PM Kisan SAMPADA Yojana for cold chains, mega food parks and processing clusters.
- PM Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises (PMFME) for small units under "One District One Product".
- A Production Linked Incentive scheme for food processing.

Constraints

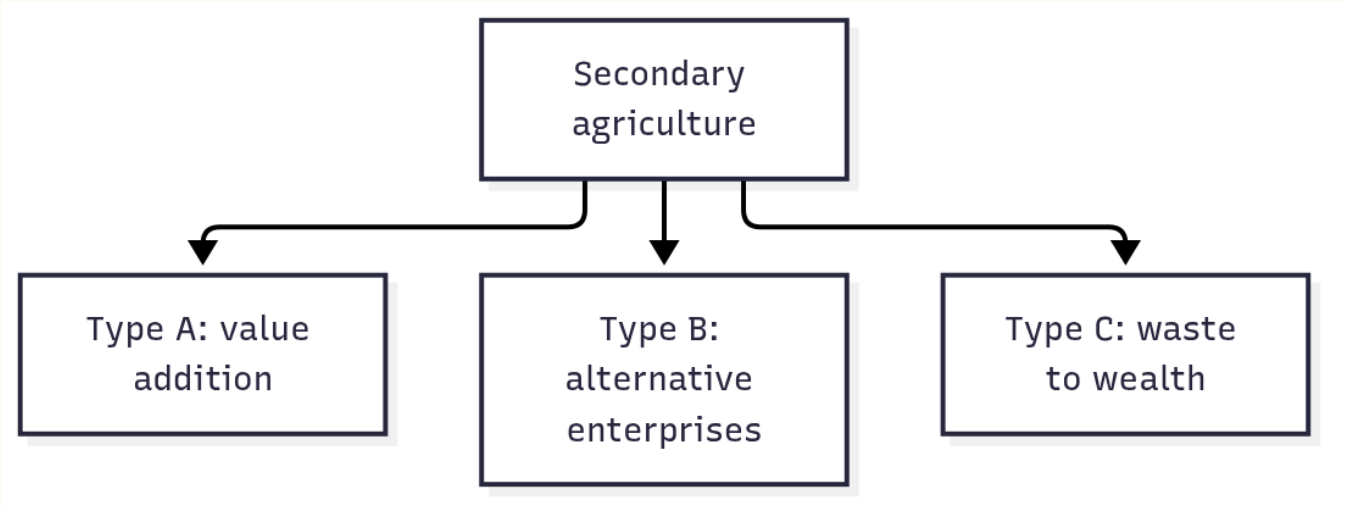
- Small, scattered farms and uneven quality of produce.
- Weak cold chains and power supply.
- Credit and packaging costs for micro units.
- Food safety compliance is hard for small firms.

Karnataka's approach

- The Economic Survey 2025-26 lists food parks at Malur (Kolar), Bagalkote, Hiriyur (Chitradurga) and Jewargi, and the India Food Park mega park at Tumakuru on 110 acres.
- In Malur, 22 units have been allotted land and 14 are operating.
- Karnataka set up a Directorate of Secondary Agriculture, which promotes value addition, alternative enterprises such as beekeeping and mushroom growing, and "waste to wealth" units using crop residue.

Way forward Link FPOs to food parks, extend cold chains to taluks, and give micro units shared labs for quality testing.

Conclusion Processing is how farm output becomes farm income.



DRAW IT: Three types of secondary agriculture. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Add, Alternate, Reuse": the three types of secondary agriculture.

COMMON TRAP: Do not count every allotted plot as an operating unit; many food parks have only part of their units working.

PEAK FACT: PM Kisan SAMPADA; PMFME with ODOP; PLI for food processing.

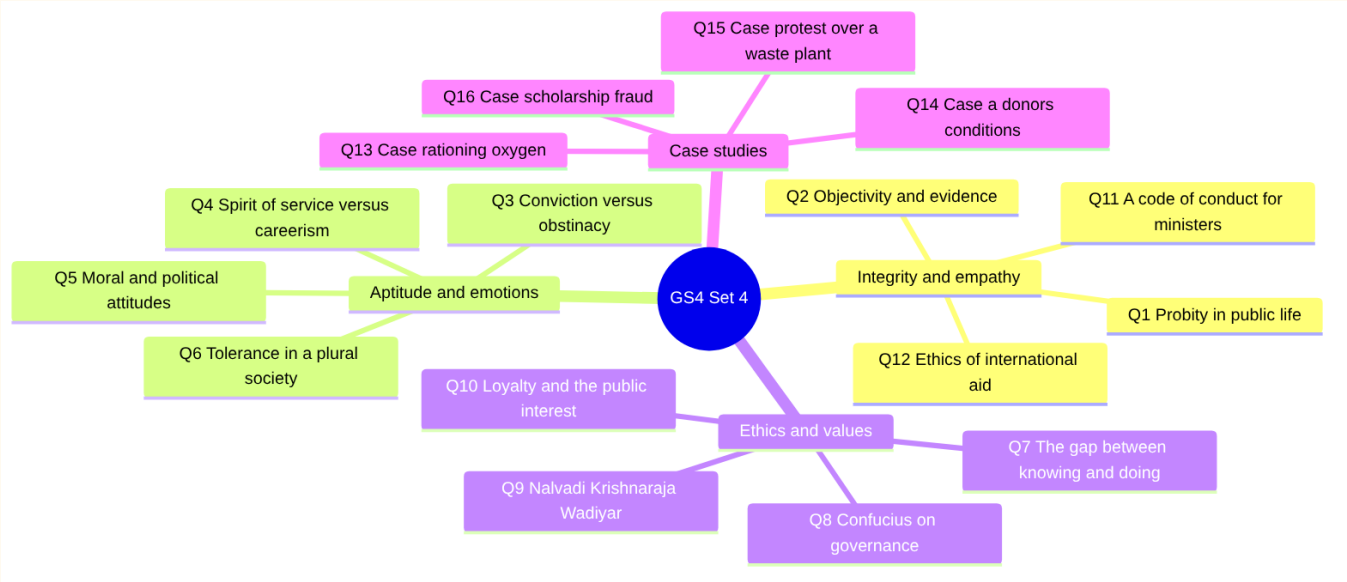
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Kisan Credit Card in Karnataka:** "7-4-3": 7% interest, 4% on prompt repayment, 3% subvention. **Q17 Sandalwood in Karnataka:** "Smuggled, Seized, Sick": three causes of decline. **Q18 Heat action plans:** "Warn, Cool, Protect": warnings, cooling, protecting the vulnerable. **Q19 Chandrayaan-3 and Aditya-L1:** "South Pole, First Point": first landing near the south pole; L1 is the first point to watch the Sun. **Q20 Food processing and secondary agriculture:** "Add, Alternate, Reuse": the three types of secondary agriculture.

Paper 5: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Set 4: step 6 of 6 (General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)). Next up: Kannada and English practice

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 16 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** The ethics paper tests character in action: probity, objectivity, conviction and the knowing-doing gap. In the cases, separate the lawful from the unlawful, protect the vulnerable and record your reasons.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS4 Q1 of 16 · 20 marks · Probity in public life

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q1. What is probity in public life? Why does it go beyond mere honesty in money matters? Suggest ways to strengthen it in Indian administration. (300 words)

Model answer

Probity means uprightness: acting with integrity, fairness and decency in every part of public duty, not just refusing bribes. The Second ARC, in its 2007 report on ethics, treated it as the bedrock of public trust.

Why it goes beyond money

- Use of power: favouring a relative in a transfer or tender breaks probity even when no money changes hands.
- Use of information: leaking official data or sitting on a file to help someone.
- Use of time and resources: absenteeism and using official vehicles privately.
- Conflict of interest: deciding a matter in which one has a personal stake.
- Fairness: treating a poor applicant with less courtesy than a powerful one.
- Truthfulness: misreporting progress on a scheme to look good.

Why it matters Citizens judge the state by daily contact with officials. A single unfair act weakens faith in the whole system, and probity also protects the officer from pressure.

Ways to strengthen it

- Rules: declarations of assets and interests, codes of conduct and recusal rules.

- Institutions: Lokayuktas, vigilance commissions and the Lokpal; Karnataka's Lokayukta is among the older ones, set up under a 1984 Act.
- Transparency: RTI, proactive disclosure and e-procurement, such as Karnataka's e-procurement platform.
- Whistle-blower protection and swift action on complaints.
- Training: case-based ethics training and mentoring by senior officers.
- Culture: rewarding honest officers publicly and protecting them from punitive transfers.
- Citizen charters and social audits.

Conclusion Probity is integrity in action across all choices an official makes. Laws set the floor; character and an institutional culture that rewards fairness build the rest.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Power, Information, Time, Interest": four areas where probity is tested beyond money.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not reduce probity to financial honesty; examiners expect conflict of interest and fairness too.

GS4 Q2 of 16 · 20 marks · Objectivity and evidence

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q2. "In administration, evidence should guide decisions, not opinion or pressure." Discuss the importance of objectivity and the obstacles to it. (300 words)

Model answer

Objectivity means taking decisions on facts, evidence and merit, without bias, favour or fear. The UK's Nolan Committee (1995) named it one of its seven standards for holders of public office.

Why it matters

- Fairness: like cases are treated alike.
- Efficiency: resources go where they are most needed.
- Trust: citizens accept decisions they may dislike if they see they are reasoned.
- Legality: courts strike down arbitrary orders under Article 14.

Examples

- Choosing beneficiaries of housing by survey data, not by local recommendations.
- Selecting road works by traffic and need rather than constituency pressure.
- Karnataka's use of the Kutumba family database to check welfare eligibility is an attempt at data-based targeting.

Obstacles

- Political pressure: demands to favour certain areas or people.
- Personal bias: caste, religion, region or friendship.
- Cognitive bias: confirmation bias, anchoring on first information, and herd thinking in committees.
- Poor data: outdated or wrong records.
- Fear: of audit or transfer, leading to safe rather than right decisions.
- Emotion: sympathy that clouds judgement.

How to promote objectivity

- Written reasons for every major decision.
- Clear criteria announced in advance.
- Committees with diverse members and recusal for conflicts.

- Data systems that are accurate and open to audit.
- Training to recognise one's own biases.
- Pilots and evaluations before scaling schemes.

Objectivity and compassion Objectivity does not mean coldness. A fair officer can show empathy in how a decision is explained while keeping the decision itself fair.

Conclusion Objective decisions are fair, defensible and lasting. Evidence-based governance is the practical form of this value.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Facts, Criteria, Reasons": three supports of objectivity.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present objectivity as opposed to compassion; the two work together.

GS4 Q3 of 16 · 20 marks · Conviction versus obstinacy

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q3. Distinguish between courage of conviction and obstinacy. Why is this distinction important for a civil servant? (300 words)

Model answer

Courage of conviction is the readiness to stand by what one believes is right, after careful thought, even at personal cost. Obstinacy is refusing to change one's view in spite of new facts or good reasons.

Differences | Courage of conviction | Obstinacy | |---|---| | Based on reason, law and values | Based on ego or habit | | Open to new evidence | Closed to argument | | Seeks the public good | Seeks to win | | Accepts consequences calmly | Blames others | | Explains and persuades | Insists and imposes |

Why the distinction matters

- Independence: officers must resist illegal orders. T.N. Seshan's firm enforcement of the election code as Chief Election Commissioner is often cited as conviction in action.
- Collective work: governance needs teamwork; an obstinate officer can stall projects.
- Learning: policies need correction when evidence changes, such as revising a scheme after a social audit.
- Credibility: a principled stand gains respect, but stubbornness on small matters wastes goodwill.

How a civil servant can stay on the right side

- Test the belief against the Constitution, law and facts.
- Consult colleagues and experts; listen to dissent.
- Put objections in writing through proper channels rather than refusing silently.
- Distinguish between non-negotiable values (legality, integrity) and negotiable means (method, timing).
- Reflect after decisions to see if pride played a role.

Karnataka example An officer who refuses to regularise an illegal building despite pressure, but agrees to give the owner a fair hearing and time to comply, shows conviction with flexibility.

Conclusion Conviction is firmness in ends with openness on means. Obstinacy is rigidity in both. Good administrators are firm on principles and flexible on methods.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Firm on ends, flexible on means": the dividing line.

COMMON TRAP: Do not praise every refusal as courage; examiners want to see openness to evidence.

GS4 Q4 of 16 · 15 marks · Spirit of service versus careerism

PREDICTED · GS4-T1

Q4. How does a spirit of service differ from careerism in the civil services? How can the spirit of service be nurtured? (250 words)

Model answer

A spirit of service means seeing public office as a duty to serve citizens, especially the weakest. Careerism means treating office mainly as a ladder for promotion, postings and status.

Differences

- Motive: service seeks impact for people; careerism seeks personal gain.
- Choices: a service-minded officer takes hard postings and difficult tasks; a careerist avoids risk.
- Behaviour: service shows in listening and follow-up; careerism shows in pleasing superiors and seeking visibility.
- Outcomes: service builds institutions; careerism chases short-term targets.

Why careerism grows

- Frequent transfers and postings linked to political favour.
- Appraisal systems that reward output figures, not outcomes.
- Lack of recognition for quiet, sincere work.

Nurturing the spirit of service

- Training: field attachments in villages and tribal areas during induction.
- Role models: stories of officers like S.R. Sankaran, known for work on bonded labour and tribal welfare.
- Appraisal: 360-degree feedback, including from citizens.
- Stable tenure: so officers see projects through.
- Recognition: awards such as the PM's Awards for Excellence in Public Administration.
- Mission Karmayogi: competency-based learning aimed at a citizen-centric outlook.

Karnataka Officers who served long in districts such as Raichur or Chamarajanagar and built schools and health systems are remembered more than those who rose fast.

Conclusion A career is not wrong in itself; it becomes careerism when service is sacrificed for advancement.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Serve, then rise": service first, career follows.

COMMON TRAP: Do not condemn ambition as such; the problem is ambition that overrides service.

GS4 Q5 of 16 · 15 marks · Moral and political attitudes

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q5. Distinguish between moral attitudes and political attitudes. How do they interact in public life? (250 words)

Model answer

An attitude is a settled way of thinking and feeling about something, which shapes behaviour.

Moral attitudes Views about right and wrong, such as honesty, fairness and care for others. They come from family, religion, education and conscience.

Political attitudes Views about power, government and public policy, such as support for a party, an ideology, or a view on reservation or federalism. They are shaped by group identity, media and political socialisation.

Differences

- Moral attitudes are about personal and universal conduct; political attitudes concern collective choices and power.
- Moral attitudes tend to be stable; political attitudes shift with events and leaders.
- Political attitudes are often partisan; moral attitudes claim universality.

How they interact

- Positive: moral attitudes can make politics principled, for example Gandhi's view of politics as service.
- Negative: strong political loyalty can override moral judgement, leading people to excuse wrongdoing by "their side".
- Moralising politics: treating opponents as evil can destroy dialogue.
- Civil servants: they may hold political views but must act neutrally; their moral attitudes such as integrity must guide work.

Example A voter who opposes corruption morally but votes for a corrupt candidate from his caste shows the conflict.

Conclusion A healthy democracy needs political attitudes tested by moral reasoning, and moral views expressed with tolerance for difference.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Right-wrong vs who-governs": the core difference.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say civil servants must have no political views; they must not let them affect duty.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Gandhi on politics as service.

GS4: 5 of 16 done. Next up: Q6, Tolerance in a plural society.

GS4 Q6 of 16 · 15 marks · Tolerance in a plural society

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q6. Why is tolerance essential in a plural society like India? What are its limits? (250 words)

Model answer

Tolerance means accepting the right of others to hold beliefs and lead lives different from one's own, even when one disagrees.

Why it is essential

- India has many religions, languages, castes and cultures; living together needs mutual respect.
- The Constitution guarantees religious freedom (Articles 25-28), minority rights (Articles 29 and 30) and free speech.
- Fundamental duties ask citizens to promote harmony and common brotherhood (Article 51A(e)).

- History offers models: Ashoka's edicts asked people to honour other sects; Akbar's Sulh-i-kul.
- Karnataka's Basavanna and the Sharanas questioned caste and welcomed all into the Anubhava Mantapa, and the Sufi shrine of Bandenawaz in Kalaburagi draws people of many faiths.

Benefits

- Social peace and economic growth.
- Creativity through the meeting of ideas.
- Democratic debate rather than violence.

Limits of tolerance

- Tolerance does not mean accepting injustice; untouchability, dowry and violence against women cannot be tolerated.
- Hate speech and incitement to violence fall outside protected speech.
- Karl Popper's "paradox of tolerance": unlimited tolerance of the intolerant can destroy tolerance itself.
- The state must be firm against violence while protecting dissent.

For administrators Neutral treatment of all communities, quick action against hate crimes, and dialogue through peace committees.

Conclusion Tolerance is the minimum; the goal is respect and fraternity, as the Preamble says.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Accept difference, reject injustice": tolerance and its limits.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate tolerance with silence about harmful practices.

GS4 Q7 of 16 · 15 marks · The gap between knowing and doing

PREDICTED · GS4-E5

Q7. People often know what is right yet fail to do it. Explain this gap between moral thought and behaviour and suggest how it can be narrowed. (250 words)

Model answer

Aristotle called the failure to act on what one knows is right akrasia, or weakness of will. Socrates held that no one does wrong knowingly; experience shows otherwise.

Causes of the gap

- Self-interest: short-term gains outweigh long-term values.
- Social pressure: fear of standing out or being isolated.
- Authority: Milgram's experiments showed people obey harmful orders.
- Rationalisation: "everyone does it" or "the system is like this".
- Moral disengagement: blaming victims or diffusing responsibility.
- Situational factors: fatigue, stress and lack of time.
- Lack of courage: knowing is easier than acting.

Example in administration An officer knows a file has been inflated but signs it because seniors approved it.

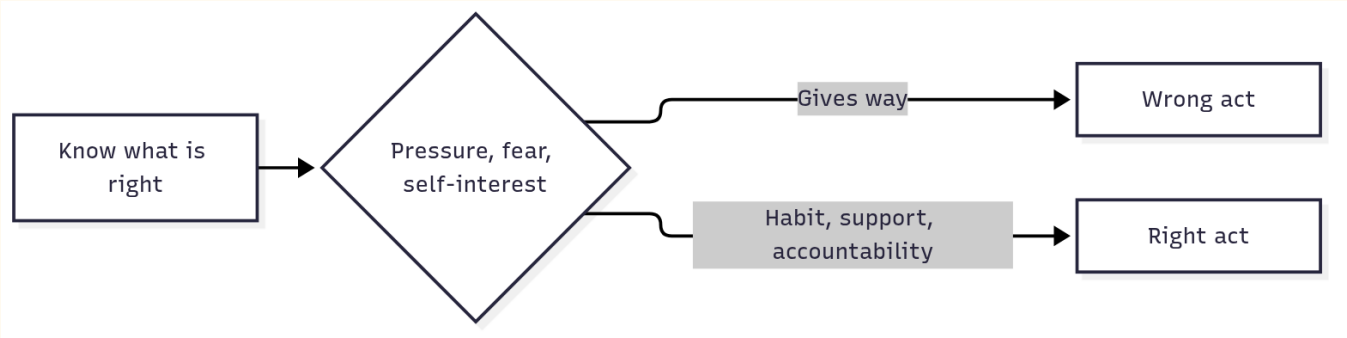
Narrowing the gap

- Habit: Aristotle said virtue comes from practice; small right acts build character.
- Commitment: public pledges and codes make values concrete.
- Environment: systems that make honesty easy, such as online services that remove discretion.
- Role models and peers who act on values.

- Reflection: journaling, meditation and ethics discussions.
- Accountability: knowing actions are visible.
- Protection: whistle-blower safeguards so acting rightly is not ruinous.

Indian thought The Gita urges action without attachment to results, and Gandhi's experiments with truth showed values tested in daily life.

Conclusion Ethics becomes real only in action. Character is built when knowledge, will and supportive systems work together.



DRAW IT: Why knowing does not become doing. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Know, Will, Do": the chain that akrasia breaks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not answer only with philosophy; give at least one practical administrative example.

GS4 Q8 of 16 · 10 marks · Confucius on governance

PREDICTED · GS4-E2

Q8. What can administrators learn from Confucius's ideas on governance? (150 words)

Model answer

Confucius (551–479 BCE) was a Chinese thinker whose teachings, recorded in the Analects, shaped East Asian governance.

Key ideas

- Ren (humaneness): rulers must care for people's welfare.
- Li (propriety): rituals and manners create social order.
- Rule by virtue: leading by example is better than leading by punishment. "If you lead by virtue, people will correct themselves."
- Rectification of names: titles should match duties; a ruler must act like a ruler.
- Merit: officials should be selected for learning and character, an idea behind China's examination system.

Lessons for administrators

- Personal example matters more than orders.
- Respect and courtesy towards citizens.
- Recruitment on merit.
- Duties should match designations; no post should be a sinecure.

Limits Emphasis on hierarchy can stifle dissent.

Conclusion Confucius reminds administrators that virtue and example sustain good governance.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Ren, Li, Example": humaneness, propriety, leading by example.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse Confucius with Lao Tzu, who taught Taoism and minimal government.

GS4 Q9 of 16 · 10 marks · Nalvadi Krishnaraja Wadiyar

PREDICTED · GS4-E4 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. What lessons in ethical governance does the reign of Nalvadi Krishnaraja Wadiyar offer? (150 words)

Model answer

Nalvadi Krishnaraja Wadiyar IV ruled Mysore from 1902 to 1940. Gandhi is said to have called him a "Rajarshi", a saintly king.

Achievements

- Representative institutions: expanded the Representative Assembly and the Legislative Council.
- Social justice: accepted the Miller Committee report (1918–19), which led to reservation for backward classes in government jobs.
- Education: compulsory primary education and the University of Mysore (1916).
- Development: with Diwans like Sir M. Visvesvaraya, built the Krishna Raja Sagara dam, Bhadravati Iron Works and the State Bank of Mysore.
- Women: supported education for girls and widows' welfare.

Lessons

- Power used as a trust for the people.
- Choosing able advisers and listening to them.
- Balancing growth with social justice.
- Simple personal life.

Conclusion His reign shows that ethical leadership combines welfare, merit and humility.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Rajarshi: rule as service": the core lesson.

COMMON TRAP: Do not credit him alone; Diwans like Visvesvaraya were central to the reforms.

GS4 Q10 of 16 · 10 marks · Loyalty and the public interest

PREDICTED · GS4-E1

Q10. "Loyalty to a superior must not become disloyalty to the public." Discuss. (150 words)

Model answer

Civil servants owe loyalty to their superiors and the government of the day. This is needed for discipline and smooth functioning. But the higher loyalty is to the Constitution and the public.

When loyalty is right

- Carrying out lawful orders faithfully, even if one disagrees.
- Keeping confidential matters secret.
- Supporting policy decisions once taken.

When it becomes wrong

- Following illegal orders, such as falsifying records.

- Covering up a superior's misconduct.
- Favouring a superior's relatives in contracts.

How to balance

- Express disagreement in writing through channels.
- Seek written orders for doubtful instructions.
- Report wrongdoing to vigilance authorities when needed.
- Service conduct rules demand integrity, not blind obedience.

Example The Shah Commission after the Emergency criticised officials who followed unlawful orders.

Conclusion True loyalty is to the purpose of office, the public good.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Obey law, not whim": loyalty within legality.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not suggest open defiance as the first step; disagreement should be recorded through channels.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** CCS (Conduct) Rules 1964; Shah Commission 1977-78.

GS4: 10 of 16 done. Next up: Q11, A code of conduct for ministers.

GS4 Q11 of 16 · 10 marks · A code of conduct for ministers

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q11. Is there a need for a code of conduct for ministers in India? Explain. (150 words)

Model answer

Ministers exercise great power, but India's Code of Conduct for Ministers, issued by the Union Home Ministry, is only an executive guideline.

Present position

- Ministers must declare assets and liabilities to the Prime Minister or Chief Minister.
- They should not engage in business or accept valuable gifts.
- There is no independent body to enforce it.

Why a stronger code is needed

- Conflict of interest cases where ministers or relatives benefit from decisions.
- Hate speech and abusive language.
- Misuse of official machinery for party work.
- Public trust falls when there are no consequences.

Recommendations

- The 2nd ARC suggested a statutory code with an ethics commissioner.
- Annual public disclosure of assets and interests.
- Cooling-off periods after leaving office.

Counterpoint Ministers already answer to the House and to voters; excessive rules may stifle political judgement.

Conclusion A clear, public and enforceable code would strengthen accountability.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Declare, Avoid, Enforce": disclose interests, avoid conflicts, enforce independently.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say no code exists; one exists but is non-statutory.

GS4 Q12 of 16 · 10 marks · Ethics of international aid

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q12. Discuss the ethical issues involved in international aid. (150 words)

Model answer

International aid includes grants, loans and disaster relief given by countries, multilateral bodies and charities.

Ethical arguments for aid

- Duty of rescue: Peter Singer argues that if we can prevent suffering at little cost, we must.
- Justice: historic exploitation and climate harm create duties to help.
- Shared humanity: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam.

Ethical issues

- Conditionality: aid tied to political or economic conditions can undermine sovereignty.
- Dependency: long-term aid may weaken local institutions.
- Corruption: funds may not reach the poor.
- Strategic motives: aid as a tool for influence or debt traps.
- Dignity: images of suffering used in fundraising.

India's approach India gives development partnership and humanitarian aid on demand-driven terms, as with vaccines under Vaccine Maitri and relief under Operation Dost in Turkey (2023).

Conclusion Ethical aid respects dignity, is transparent and builds self-reliance.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Help, Respect, Empower": three marks of ethical aid.

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat all conditions as wrong; transparency conditions can prevent corruption.

GS4 Q13 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: rationing oxygen

PREDICTED · CS

Q13. Fictional case. Imagine you are the Medical Superintendent of a district hospital during a sudden surge of a respiratory epidemic. Oxygen supply is limited, and you have only enough for 40 patients over the next 12 hours, while 55 need it. A local MLA calls demanding that his relative, admitted last night with mild symptoms, be given oxygen and a bed in the ICU. Doctors are exhausted, and some relatives of patients are threatening violence. A new supply may arrive by tomorrow morning. (a) Which ethical dilemmas does this raise? (b) Outline your plan for the next 12 hours. (c) Defend your choices. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Scarce oxygen, more patients than supply, political pressure, exhausted staff and risk of violence.

D - Dimensions. Patients: right to life and fair treatment. Doctors: clinical judgement and safety. MLA: influence. Families: fear and anger. District administration: supply and order. Me: duty of fair allocation.

R - Rules and values. Right to health under Article 21; medical ethics (beneficence, non-maleficence, justice); the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897 and the Disaster Management Act, 2005 for emergency powers; values of fairness, compassion, courage and transparency.

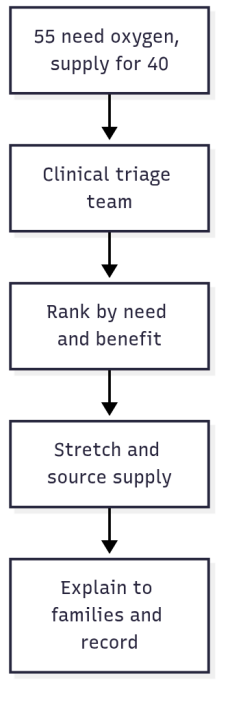
A - Options.

1. Give oxygen to the MLA's relative: breaks fairness and may cost another life.
2. First come, first served: simple but ignores clinical need.
3. Clinical triage with transparent criteria, plus urgent steps to raise supply: fair and open to scrutiny.

T - Take the decision. Transparent triage, with supply raised in parallel.

- Triage: form a team of senior doctors to rank patients by oxygen saturation and chance of benefit; record decisions.
- Stretch supply: use oxygen concentrators, prone positioning, and reduce flow where clinically safe.
- Raise supply: inform the District Collector and request oxygen from nearby hospitals and industrial units; seek a green corridor for tankers.
- MLA: explain politely that his relative will be assessed like everyone else and will receive oxygen if clinically needed.
- Safety: ask the police for protection; address families honestly through a help desk.
- Staff: arrange rest in shifts and volunteers for non-clinical tasks.
- Later: review the crisis and plan buffer stocks.

Justification. Clinical triage follows justice and the duty to save the most lives. Transparency builds trust and reduces conflict.



DRAW IT: Triage under scarcity. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Triage, Stretch, Source": rank fairly, stretch supply, source more.

COMMON TRAP: Do not let influence decide care, and do not ignore staff safety.

GS4 Q14 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: a donor's conditions

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q14. Fictional case. Imagine you are the senior-most officer of a district in northern Karnataka. A wealthy NRI offers to donate Rs 10 crore to rebuild a dilapidated government school. His conditions are that the school be named after his late father, that he choose the contractor, and that one teacher's post be filled by a candidate he recommends. The school badly needs classrooms and toilets, and the education budget is tight. Local leaders welcome the offer. (a) Bring out the values at stake. (b) List the paths open to you. (c) Explain your response with reasons. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A generous donation for a needy school, but with conditions on naming, contracts and hiring.

D - Dimensions. Students: better facilities. Donor: goodwill and wish to honour his father. Teachers and candidates: fair recruitment. Government: control over public assets. Local leaders: support. Me: duty to accept help lawfully.

R - Rules and values. Government recruitment must follow merit and the rules under Articles 14 and 16; public works must follow the State's 1999 procurement transparency law; naming of public institutions follows government policy; values of integrity, gratitude and fairness.

A - Options.

1. Accept all conditions: quick funds but illegal hiring and procurement.
2. Reject the offer: protects rules but loses help for children.
3. Negotiate: accept the donation with lawful conditions.

T - Take the decision. Negotiation: welcome the gift, decline the unlawful strings.

- Naming: recommend to government that a building or the school be named after his father, as permitted under policy for major donations.
- Contractor: explain that works must follow transparent tendering. Offer him a place on a monitoring committee and suggest he can execute the work himself through a trust under a formal agreement, if rules allow.
- Teacher post: firmly decline; recruitment must be through the official process.
- Agreement: sign a memorandum with clear terms, timelines and audit.
- Recognition: honour the donor publicly and invite him to inaugurate the school.
- Wider: use schemes for school development through public-private partnership.

Justification. This keeps the benefit for children, respects the donor's wish to honour his father, and protects fairness in hiring and spending.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Accept help, refuse strings": take the gift, not the illegal conditions.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not reject a generous offer outright; negotiation is expected.

GS4 Q15 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: protest over a waste plant

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Fictional case. Imagine you are the Commissioner of a city corporation in Karnataka. The State has approved a waste-processing plant on a site near the city, and the project is vital because the landfill is overflowing. Residents of nearby villages are protesting, blocking roads and saying the plant will cause smell, disease and fall in land value. Some protesters are being supported by land developers with their own interests. Your deadline to start construction is next month, and the court has warned the corporation

about waste mismanagement. (a) Map the stakeholders and the clashing values. (b) Evaluate the choices available. (c) Set out the course you would follow. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A needed waste plant, local opposition, mixed motives behind protests, court pressure and a deadline.

D - Dimensions. City residents: need for waste disposal. Villagers: health, environment and property fears. Developers: hidden interests. Court: compliance. Corporation: duty to act. Me: balance urgency and fairness.

R - Rules and values. Article 21 covers a clean environment; the Solid Waste Management Rules require scientific processing; environmental clearances and pollution control norms; the right to peaceful protest under Article 19; values of transparency, empathy and public interest.

A - Options.

1. Use force and build: meets deadline but loses trust and may cause violence.
2. Abandon the site: pleases protesters but harms the city and defies court orders.
3. Engage, address concerns, then proceed: slower but sustainable.

T - Take the decision. Engagement first, then construction with safeguards.

- Dialogue: meet village representatives with experts from the KSPCB and doctors; share the project report in Kannada.
- Address fears: commit to closed processing, a green buffer zone, odour control and regular public monitoring of air and water.
- Benefits: jobs for local youth, compost for farmers, and development of village roads and health centres.
- Independent review: invite a committee including village members to visit a well-run plant elsewhere.
- Separate motives: gather facts on developer influence, but avoid painting all protesters as motivated.
- Court: inform it of the plan and seek reasonable time.
- Law and order: protect the site but avoid force against peaceful protest.

Justification. Participation builds legitimacy, while firm commitment to the project protects public health in the city.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Listen, Assure, Deliver": listen to fears, assure safeguards, deliver the project.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not dismiss protest as motivated without facts.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Article 21 clean environment; Article 19 peaceful assembly.

GS4: 15 of 16 done. Next up: Q16, Case: scholarship fraud.

GS4 Q16 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: scholarship fraud

PREDICTED · CS

Q16. Fictional case. Imagine you are the Director of a State scholarship programme for students from poor families. An audit finds that a private college run by a powerful local leader has claimed scholarships for 600 students, but only 200 seem to attend. Officials who verified the claims may have been complicit. The leader's supporters warn that any action will be seen as an attack on the community the college serves, and genuine students may lose support if payments are frozen. (a) Identify the ethical concerns

involved. (b) Examine the possible responses. (c) Indicate, with reasons, the action you would take. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Likely large-scale scholarship fraud, possible official complicity, political pressure and risk to genuine students.

D - Dimensions. Genuine students: need for support. Taxpayers: public money. College and leader: accountability. Officials: possible complicity. Community: fear of being targeted. Me: duty to protect the scheme.

R - Rules and values. Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988; criminal law on cheating and forgery; scheme guidelines for verification; values of integrity, fairness, courage and compassion.

A - Options.

1. Ignore: avoids conflict but rewards fraud.
2. Freeze all payments: stops fraud but punishes genuine students.
3. Verify, protect genuine students, act against fraud: balanced.

T - Take the decision. Separate the genuine from the fake, and act on both.

- Verification: send an independent team to verify attendance with Aadhaar-based records and exam results.
- Genuine students: release scholarships directly to verified students' accounts through DBT without delay.
- Fraud: suspend payments for unverified claims, recover excess amounts and file a police complaint.
- Officials: recommend departmental inquiry and suspension where evidence shows complicity.
- Pressure: explain publicly that the action is against fraud, not the community, and that genuine students are protected.
- Superiors: report in writing to the Secretary and the Minister.
- Systemic: biometric attendance, random checks and a public dashboard of scholarships by college.

Justification. The response stops misuse of public money, protects poor students who rely on the scheme and is based on evidence, not on who runs the college. It also sends a message to other institutions that claims will be checked, and it shields honest verifying officers from blame. Treating the leader like any other manager, neither harsher nor softer, reflects equality before law and keeps the action from looking political.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Verify, Protect, Punish": check facts, protect genuine students, punish fraud.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not freeze payments for all students, and do not fear political labels.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q12 Ethics of international aid:** "Help, Respect, Empower": three marks of ethical aid. **Q13 Case: rationing oxygen:** "Triage, Stretch, Source": rank fairly, stretch supply, source more. **Q14 Case: a donor's conditions:** "Accept help, refuse strings": take the gift, not the illegal conditions. **Q15 Case: protest over a waste plant:** "Listen, Assure, Deliver": listen to fears, assure safeguards, deliver the project. **Q16 Case: scholarship fraud:** "Verify, Protect, Punish": check facts, protect genuine students, punish fraud.

Kannada and English practice (short)

> **REVIEW:** The Kannada text in this section was written without a native-speaker check. Please have a Kannada teacher or fluent speaker read it before you treat it as a model. The English parts follow plain formal style.

Practice 1: Kannada essay (ಪ್ರಬಂಧ), about 120 words

Topic: ಮಹಿಳಾ ಸಬಲೀಕರಣ (Empowerment of women)

Outline (ರೂಪರೇಖೆ): ಪೀಠಿಕೆ → ಮಹಿಳೆಯರ ಸ್ಥಿತಿ → ಅಡೆತಡೆಗಳು → ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಕ್ರಮಗಳು → ಉಪಸಂಹಾರ

Model essay (ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ):

ಮಹಿಳೆ ಕುಟುಂಬ ಮತ್ತು ಸಮಾಜದ ಆಧಾರ. ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ, ಉದ್ಯೋಗ ಮತ್ತು ರಾಜಕೀಯದಲ್ಲಿ ಮಹಿಳೆಯರು ಮುಂದೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದ್ದಾರೆ. ಆದರೂ ಬಾಲ್ಯ ವಿವಾಹ, ವರದಕ್ಷಿಣೆ, ಕೌಟುಂಬಿಕ ಹಿಂಸೆ ಮತ್ತು ಕಡಿಮೆ ವೇತನ ಇನ್ನೂ ಉಳಿದಿವೆ. ಕರ್ನಾಟಕದಲ್ಲಿ ಗ್ರಾಮ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಅರ್ಧದಷ್ಟು ಸ್ಥಾನಗಳು ಮಹಿಳೆಯರಿಗೆ ಮೀಸಲಾಗಿವೆ. ಸ್ವಸಹಾಯ ಸಂಘಗಳು ಹಳ್ಳಿಯ ಮಹಿಳೆಯರಿಗೆ ಸಾಲ ಮತ್ತು ಆತ್ಮವಿಶ್ವಾಸ ನೀಡಿವೆ. ಗೃಹಲಕ್ಷ್ಮಿ ಮತ್ತು ಶಕ್ತಿ ಯೋಜನೆಗಳು ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ನೆರವು ಮತ್ತು ಉಚಿತ ಪ್ರಯಾಣ ಒದಗಿಸುತ್ತಿವೆ. ಆದರೆ ನಿಜವಾದ ಸಬಲೀಕರಣ ಎಂದರೆ ಮಹಿಳೆ ತನ್ನ ಬದುಕಿನ ನಿರ್ಧಾರಗಳನ್ನು ತಾನೇ ತೆಗೆದುಕೊಳ್ಳುವುದು. ಅದಕ್ಕಾಗಿ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ, ಸುರಕ್ಷತೆ ಮತ್ತು ಸಮಾನ ಗೌರವ ಅಗತ್ಯ. ಮಹಿಳೆ ಬೆಳೆದರೆ ಕುಟುಂಬ ಬೆಳೆಯುತ್ತದೆ; ಕುಟುಂಬ ಬೆಳೆದರೆ ದೇಶ ಬೆಳೆಯುತ್ತದೆ.

Practice 2: Translate into Kannada (ಅನುವಾದ)

#	English	Model Kannada
1	Health is wealth.	ಆರೋಗ್ಯವೇ ಭಾಗ್ಯ.
2	Please stand in the queue.	ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ಸಾಲಿನಲ್ಲಿ ನಿಲ್ಲಿ.
3	The bus leaves at six in the morning.	ಬಸ್ಸು ಬೆಳಿಗ್ಗೆ ಆರು ಗಂಟೆಗೆ ಹೊರಡುತ್ತದೆ.
4	Submit the application before the last date.	ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕದ ಮೊದಲು ಅರ್ಜಿ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಿ.
5	Children should drink clean water.	ಮಕ್ಕಳು ಶುದ್ಧ ನೀರನ್ನು ಕುಡಿಯಬೇಕು.

Practice 3: English precis (reduce to one-third)

Passage (about 150 words):

Every day, thousands of young people in small towns spend hours on their phones. Much of this time goes to short videos and games that leave little behind. Yet the same phone can be a library, a classroom and a market. A student in a village can now attend a lecture by a famous teacher, learn a new language or prepare for a competitive examination without leaving home. A weaver can sell sarees to a buyer in another State, and a farmer can check the price of his crop before taking it to the market. The difference lies not in the device but in how it is used. Schools and parents rarely teach young people to manage their screen time or to judge what they read online. As a result, rumours spread quickly, and attention spans shrink. Digital literacy, which includes self-control and critical thinking, is now as important as reading and writing.

Model precis (about 50 words), with title "Using the phone wisely":

Young people spend long hours on phones, mostly on entertainment. The same device can educate, open markets and inform farmers. What matters is its use. Without guidance on screen time and judging content, rumours spread and attention shrinks. Digital literacy, with self-control and critical thinking, is now essential.

Practice 4: Formal letter (English)

Task: Write a letter to the Commissioner of the city corporation about the poor condition of a public park in your ward.

Model letter:

From: R. Prakash, 4th Main, Vidyanagar, Davanagere, Karnataka - 500 000 To: The Commissioner, City Corporation, Davanagere, Karnataka Date: 27 October 2026

Sir,

Subject: Poor maintenance of the public park in Vidyanagar

I write on behalf of the residents of Vidyanagar about the public park on 4th Main. The walking track is broken, the lights have not worked for two months, garbage is dumped near the gate, and the children's play equipment is rusted and unsafe. Senior citizens and children, who used the park every day, now avoid it, especially in the evening.

I request you to repair the track and lights, clear the garbage regularly, replace the play equipment and assign a caretaker. Residents are willing to form a park committee to help maintain it.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, R. Prakash

Review report for Set 4

REVIEW: Checks run on 27-10-2026 (IST). Machine checks cover every answer; the fact review covers a sample of 13 of 78 questions (17%, above the 15% target): Essay 2; GS1 Q5, Q11, Q17; GS2 Q5, Q16, Q17; GS3 Q2, Q8, Q14, Q16; GS4 Q9, Q13. The review was done by the same author in a separate read, not by an outside person, so treat it as a careful self-review.

Check	Result
Word limits (10 marks: 150; 15 marks: 250; 20 marks: 300; essays: 1,200)	0 over the limit; all answers at 80% of the limit or more
Copy check: 6-word overlaps with past mains papers, the existing 40 model answers, Sets 1 to 3 and the other Set 4 files	0 flagged after fixes
Economic Survey figures, matched against the saved source text	0 mismatches
Remember-line and common-trap box on every answer	All present
Diagrams	2 essay mind-maps and 19 flow charts

Fact ledger for Set 4: 31 ES lines, 39 web-checked lines, 146 static lines (216 in all).

Fact sources, honestly stated

- **Machine-matched (ES = Karnataka Economic Survey 2025-26):** coastal fisheries figures and sea walls; K&C Valley plant capacities and flows; KCC totals as on 30 September 2025 (50,73,080 cards, Rs 72,961 crore); 12,122 fishermen's KCCs; 20th Livestock Census totals; natural farming clusters (990, 49,500 ha); food parks at Malur, Bagalkote, Hiriyur and Jewargi and the Tumakuru mega park; Directorate of Secondary Agriculture.
- **Checked on the web this session:** Vishvasya blockchain stack launched 4 September 2024 (PIB, MeitY); Supreme Court opinion on the Presidential reference on assent, 20 November 2025 (no fixed timelines, no deemed assent); India at 50.08% non-fossil installed capacity on 30 June 2025 (PIB); SHANTI Act assent and liability slabs; COP30 Mutirao decision; ONDC transaction totals; Sita Soren (2024, seven judges).
- **Replaced during review:** the planned GS3 Q20 on critical minerals repeated a Set 3 topic, so it became a new food processing question built on Survey data; GS2 Q16 (Article 356) and Q17 (Ninth Schedule) leaned on cases already covered in earlier sets and the existing answers, so they became Article 254 and the 97th Amendment.
- **Static or textbook facts** (Myers' hotspot criteria, NFHS-5 anaemia, MISS interest rates, Miller Committee, Confucius, Aristotle, Milgram): checked from memory in the sample read, not all by live search.
- **Search-synthesis only, re-verify before quoting:** ONDC transaction totals for 2025-26; SHANTI Act liability slabs; COP30 finance numbers; Karnataka's 2001 sandalwood ownership change; K&C lift volume of about 440 MLD.

Known gaps

- The 2025 past papers are scanned images, so the copy check against them is weaker.
- Fictional case studies are invented; the GS4 cases share the SDRAT method but use different question wording.
- The Kannada practice section needs a native reader.

KAS Mains Mock Set 5: Fully Solved

Built 28-10-2026 00:03 IST | 5 papers x 250 marks | every question is PREDICTED from the trend blueprint, never copied from a past paper

PREDICTED: These questions are predictions from the pattern of the 2014, 2015, 2021 and 2025 papers (see TREND_BLUEPRINT). They are practice, not leaked or past questions. Model answers stay inside the word limit printed with each question. Facts are tied to official sources where possible; a fact list is kept for each answer.

CHAI-TALK: Do this set like an exam: one paper at a time, three hours each, writing by hand. Then read the model answer, tick what you covered, and copy the purple memory line for anything you missed. Do not read all five papers in one sitting. Five good papers beat fifty skimmed ones.

Set 5: step 1 of 6. Next up: Paper 1, the Essay.

Paper 1: Essay

Set 5: step 2 of 6 (Essay). Next up: General Studies I (GS1)

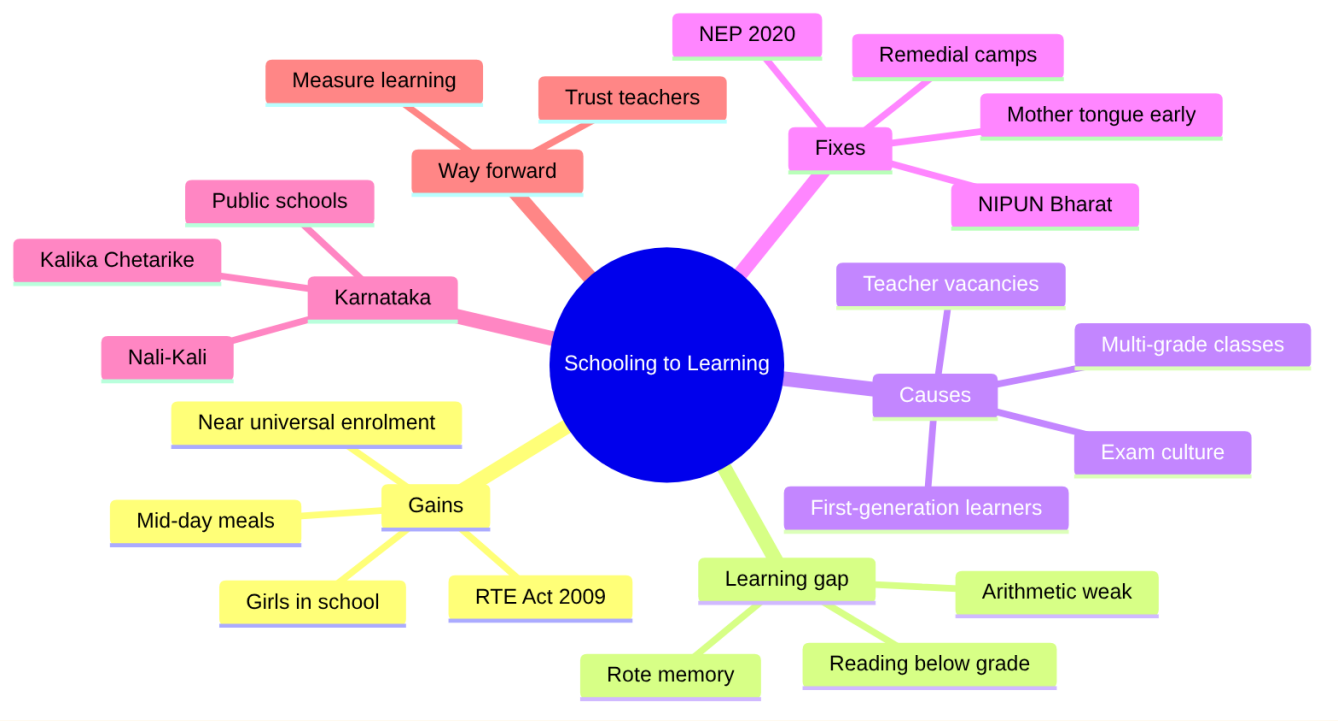
Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Instructions:** write two essays, one from each part, about 1,000 to 1,200 words each. Both carry 125 marks. (This is the practice shape; check the latest KPSC notification for exact instructions.)

> **CHAI-TALK:** An essay is a short journey: a hook, a clear stand, three or four strong turns, a fair look at the other side and a landing that points forward. Read the mind map first, then the essay, and then try to rebuild the map from memory.

Essay 1 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-1

Q1. From schooling to learning: India has put almost every child in a classroom, but are its children learning? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 1: mind map.

Model answer

A ten-year-old girl in a village school in Raichur wears a clean uniform, eats a hot mid-day meal and carries free textbooks. On paper she is a success story of Indian education. Ask her to read a short paragraph from a Class 2 book, though, and she may stumble. Her story sums up the central question of Indian schooling today. The country has won the battle of access. It has not yet won the battle of learning.

How far India has come

At independence, fewer than one in five Indians could read. Schools were few, far apart and closed to many castes and to most girls. Seven decades later, enrolment at the primary level is close to universal. The RTE Act of 2009, passed under Article 21A, made eight years of schooling a fundamental right under Article 21A for every child between six and fourteen. The mid-day meal, now called PM POSHAN, drew hungry children to school and kept them there. Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan built classrooms, toilets and

boundary walls, and girls' enrolment caught up with boys' at the primary level. Karnataka played its part: its Nali-Kali method, born in Mysuru district in the 1990s, replaced rows of desks with activity-based, multi-level groups for the early grades and was later copied by other States.

These gains are real. A family that once sent only its eldest son to school now sends all its children. The first-generation learner, whose parents never held a pencil, has become ordinary rather than rare.

The learning gap

Yet attendance is not learning. Independent household surveys and the government's own National Achievement Survey have shown for years that a large share of children in Class 5 cannot read a Class 2 text fluently or do simple division. The gap opens early. A child who cannot read by the age of eight falls further behind each year, because every later subject assumes reading. By Class 8 many children are sitting in class, but understanding little of it.

The COVID-19 school closures made matters worse. For almost two years many rural children had no smartphone, no data and no teacher. When schools reopened, learning had slipped back, especially in reading and arithmetic.

Why children are not learning

The causes lie less in the child than in the system around the child.

- Teachers: many schools have vacant posts or a single teacher handling several grades at once. Teachers also spend many days on non-teaching work such as surveys and election duty.
- Curriculum pace: textbooks race ahead of what children actually know. A teacher who must "finish the portion" has no time for the child who is behind.
- Language: a child who speaks Lambani, Tulu or Urdu at home may be taught in a language she barely understands.
- Exams and memory: Indian schooling rewards memorising answers rather than understanding them. Coaching culture rewards the same habit later.
- Home: first-generation learners get little help at home, and poverty pulls older children into work or care of siblings.

What is being tried

The National Education Policy 2020 named foundational literacy and numeracy as the most urgent priority and set a target that every child should achieve it by Grade 3. The NIPUN Bharat Mission, launched in 2021, turned that target into classroom practice: simple learning goals, teacher guides and regular checks. NEP also favours teaching in the mother tongue or home language at least till Grade 5, wherever possible, and replaces the 10+2 structure with a 5+3+3+4 design that treats ages three to eight as one foundational stage.

Karnataka ran a "Kalika Chetarike" (learning recovery) programme after the pandemic to bridge lost learning, and has been setting up larger public schools that combine pre-primary to Class 12 on one campus. Several States now test learning levels, not just enrolment, and publish district results so that officers know where to act.

The other side

Some argue that the gloom is overdone. Learning surveys are snapshots and can miss what children learn outside textbooks: skills, confidence, a sense of rights. Others point out that big gains in enrolment always bring in weaker learners first, so average scores fall for a time. There is also the risk that a narrow focus on test scores turns schools into coaching centres and squeezes out art, play and sport.

These are fair points. But the core finding is too consistent to dismiss. A child who cannot read cannot use any other right that schooling promises.

The way forward

India needs to treat learning, not enrolment, as the main measure of success.

1. Measure and act: simple, frequent assessments in every classroom, with results used by teachers to regroup children, not to punish schools.
2. Teach at the right level: group children by what they know, not by age, for at least part of the day, an idea Nali-Kali pioneered.
3. Free the teacher: fill vacancies, limit non-teaching duties and give teachers better training and respect.
4. Start early: strengthen anganwadis as pre-schools so that children arrive ready to learn.
5. Involve parents: School Development and Monitoring Committees can track learning, not just buildings.
6. Use technology carefully: digital content helps a good teacher; it cannot replace one.

Conclusion

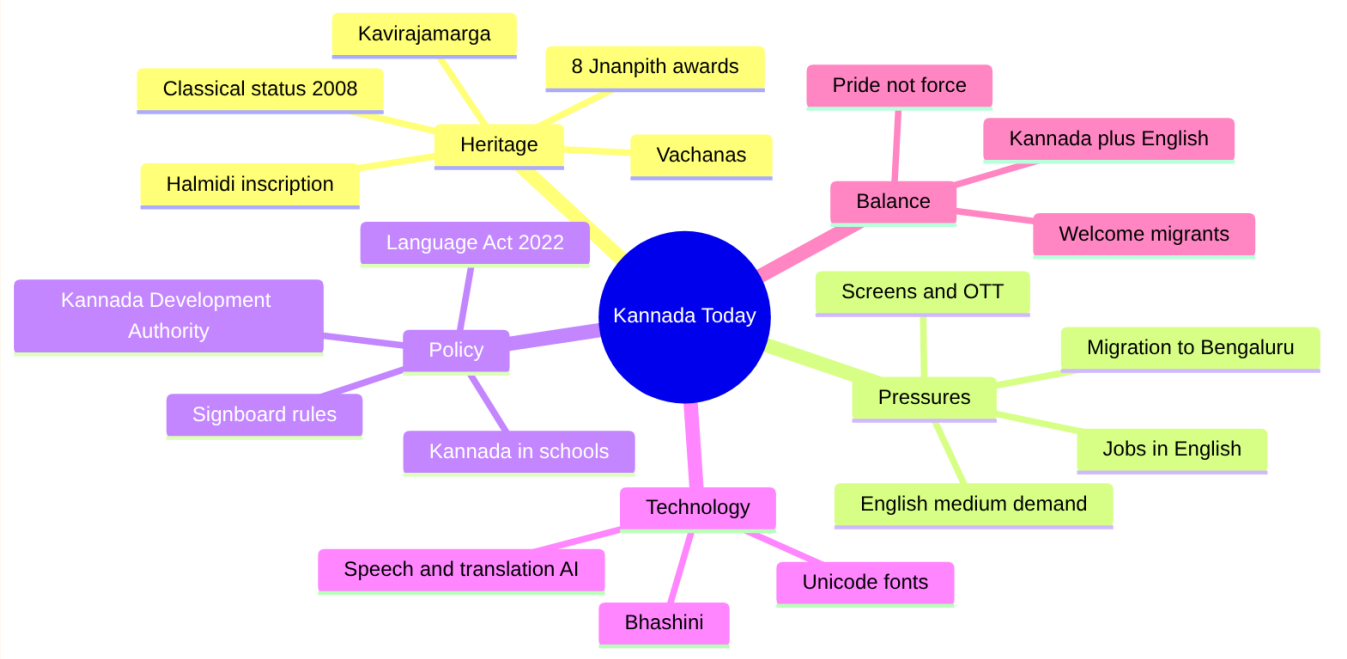
India's classrooms are full. The next task is to make sure the minds inside them are growing. The girl in Raichur has done her part: she comes to school every day. The system must now do its part and make sure that, by the age of eight, she can read a story, enjoy it and ask a question about it. That is when schooling becomes education, and when the promise of Article 21A is truly kept for every child in every district.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Seat, Sheet, Skill": a seat in class (access), a sheet of marks (exams), and finally a skill (learning). India has the first two; the essay is about the third.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write only about enrolment statistics and schemes. The question is about learning outcomes; keep returning to what children can actually do.

Essay 2 (125 marks)

PREDICTED · ESSAY-2 · Karnataka-specific

Q2. Kannada in the age of English and artificial intelligence: how can Karnataka keep its language alive and useful? (Write a balanced essay in about 1,000 words.)



Essay 2: mind map.

Model answer

Walk through any Bengaluru technology park and you will hear English, Hindi, Telugu, Tamil and a dozen other languages. Walk into a village fair in Haveri and you will hear Kannada in its many dialects, rich with proverbs and songs. Between these two scenes lies the question of this essay: how does a language with more than fifteen centuries of written history remain alive, and useful, in a world of English-medium schools and artificial intelligence?

A language with deep roots

Kannada's oldest known inscription, at Halmidi, is usually dated to around the fifth century CE. The Kavirajamarga of the ninth century, written in the court of the Rashtrakuta king Amoghavarsha, is the earliest surviving work on poetics in the language. Pampa, Ponna and Ranna gave it epic poetry; Basavanna, Akka Mahadevi and Allama Prabhu gave it the vachanas, short sayings in everyday speech; Purandaradasa and Kanakadasa gave it devotional songs. In modern times Kuvempu, Bendre, Shivaram Karanth, Masti, U.R. Ananthamurthy and others won the Jnanpith, and Kannada has eight such awards. The Government of India declared it a classical language in 2008.

The language also built the State itself. The unification movement, which brought Kannada-speaking regions together in 1956, rested on the idea that people who share a language should share a government.

The pressures today

Yet many Kannadigas worry about the future of their language.

- Schooling: parents, rich and poor, increasingly choose English-medium schools because they see English as the language of jobs and status. A child may then grow up speaking Kannada at home but unable to read it well.
- Migration: Bengaluru has drawn workers from across India. Many live and work there without needing Kannada, which can create resentment on one side and isolation on the other.
- The economy: higher education, courts at senior levels, science and the private sector run largely in English.
- Media: young people spend hours on global streaming platforms and social media where English and Hindi dominate.

What the State has done

Karnataka has used both law and encouragement. The Kannada Development Authority promotes the use of Kannada in administration and public life. Karnataka's 2022 law for the comprehensive development of Kannada sought to make Kannada the language of administration, require its use in many public settings and give preference to Kannadigas in some jobs and training. Rules on signboards ask businesses to give Kannada prominence. Kannada is taught in schools, and the State has argued in courts over how far it can compel the medium of instruction; the Supreme Court held in 2014 that parents, not the State, choose the medium of primary education.

That judgment matters. It tells us that the future of Kannada cannot rest on compulsion alone.

The State has also tried softer tools. Kannada Rajyotsava on 1 November is celebrated across offices and schools, the Kannada Sahitya Parishat organises literary meets in every district, and Kannada films and theatre continue to draw loyal audiences. These efforts work because they invite people in. A child who enjoys a Kannada story, a song or a play is more likely to keep the language than one who is only told that she must.

Technology: threat or friend?

Artificial intelligence can deepen the dominance of English, because most data on the internet is English. If voice assistants, search engines and chatbots work best in English, the incentive to use Kannada falls further.

But technology can also help. Unicode fonts allow Kannada to be typed on any phone. Machine translation and speech tools, including the Union government's Bhashini platform, can let a farmer ask a question in Kannada and get an answer in Kannada. Government services in Kannada, from land records to bus tickets, make the language useful every day. If Kannada speakers produce more content online, such as news, lessons, songs and reference material, AI systems trained on that data will speak better Kannada.

The other side

Critics warn that language pride can turn into language policing. Forcing shopkeepers or migrants to use Kannada under threat may harden attitudes rather than win hearts. Employers worry that strict quotas tied to language may drive investment away. These concerns deserve respect. A language survives when people want to use it, not when they are afraid not to.

A balanced way forward

1. Kannada plus English, not Kannada versus English: strong Kannada in the early years, with good English taught well, gives children both roots and wings.
2. Make Kannada useful: high-quality Kannada textbooks in science and law, Kannada interfaces for all government apps, and Kannada data sets for AI.
3. Welcome learners: free, friendly Kannada classes for migrants at workplaces and in apartment complexes; a migrant who learns a little Kannada should be praised, not mocked.
4. Support creators: grants for Kannada films, podcasts, children's books and online channels.
5. Respect dialects: Dharwad, Mangaluru and Kalaburagi Kannada are part of the language's wealth.

Why it matters beyond pride

A language is not only a symbol. It is how a farmer explains a crop disease to an officer, how a patient describes pain to a doctor and how a citizen reads a government order. When governance moves away from the people's language, the poor and the less schooled are pushed to the edge. Keeping Kannada strong in administration is therefore a matter of democracy and access, not just culture.

Conclusion

Kannada has survived empires, colonial rule and the arrival of English. It survived because ordinary people sang, argued and joked in it. In the age of AI the same rule holds. If Kannadigas use their language on their phones, in their offices and with their children, and if newcomers are invited in rather than shut out, Kannada will remain what Kuvempu hoped for: a language that makes its speakers more fully human, not less.

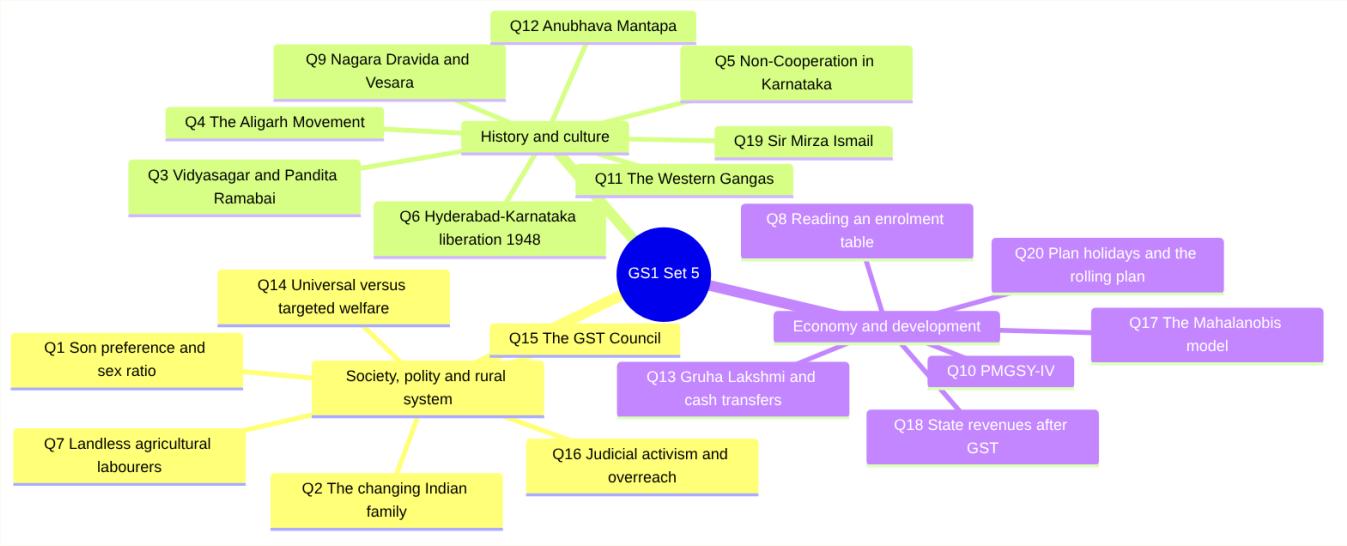
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Roots, Rules, Robots": the deep roots (Halmidi to Jnanpith), the rules (KDA, 2022 Act, signboards), and the robots (AI that can help or hurt).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not write a one-sided attack on English or on migrants. Examiners reward balance; the 2014 Supreme Court ruling on medium of instruction shows force has limits.
>
> **RECAP:** Both essays follow the same shape: hook, stand, turns, other side, way forward. Try writing a 5-line plan for any new topic in 4 minutes before you start.

Paper 2: General Studies I (GS1)

Set 5: step 3 of 6 (General Studies I (GS1)). Next up: General Studies II (GS2)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Set 5 opens with families and reformers: son preference, Vidyasagar and Ramabai, Aligarh, then Karnataka's freedom struggle, Hyderabad-Karnataka and the Western Gangas. Tie each answer to a law, a year or a place.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS1 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · Son preference and sex ratio

PREDICTED · GS1-B3

Q1. Son preference persists in India even as incomes and literacy rise. Examine the social roots of this preference and evaluate the measures taken to correct the sex ratio at birth. (250 words)

Model answer

Son preference means valuing a male child above a female one. It shows up in a skewed sex ratio at birth, neglect of girls' health and the "missing women" that Amartya Sen described in 1990.

Social roots

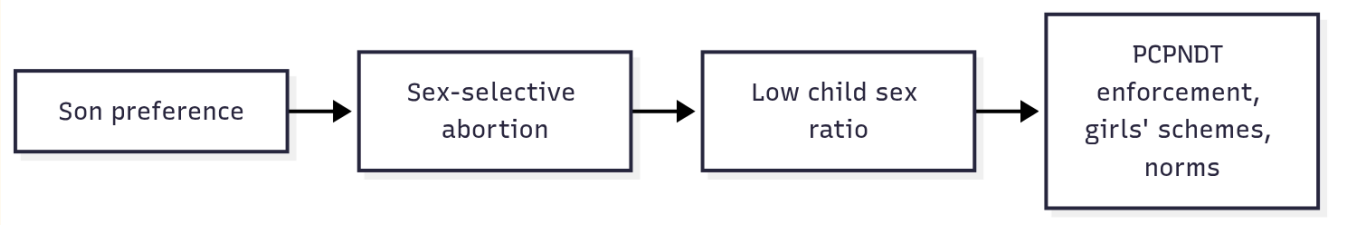
- Patrilineal inheritance and residence: property and the family name pass through sons; daughters "leave" at marriage.
- Old-age security: sons are expected to support parents, while daughters' help is seen as belonging to the in-laws.
- Dowry: a daughter is seen as a cost, a son as a source of gain at his marriage.
- Ritual: often only sons perform last rites.
- Small family norm: as families have fewer children, the pressure to have at least one son rises, so prosperity can sharpen the bias rather than end it.
- Technology: ultrasound shifted the bias from neglect after birth to selection before it.

Measures and their record

- The Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (PCPNDT) Act, 1994, bans sex determination; enforcement has been uneven, with few convictions.
- Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (2015) combined awareness with district targets.

- Sukanya Samriddhi accounts and State incentives such as Karnataka's earlier Bhagyalakshmi scheme reward families for daughters.
- Equal inheritance rights for daughters under the Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act, 2005, strengthened by Vineeta Sharma (2020).

Assessment The national sex ratio at birth has improved in recent surveys, but law alone cannot change preference. Lasting change needs daughters' economic value to be visible: jobs, property in their names and social respect for daughters who care for parents.



DRAW IT: Why daughters go missing. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "PODS" behind son preference: Property, Old-age, Dowry, Shraddha (last rites).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate the child sex ratio (0-6 years) with the sex ratio at birth, and do not claim rising income automatically ends the bias.

GS1 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · The changing Indian family

PREDICTED · GS1-B3

Q2. The Indian family is changing in structure but not always in values. Comment. (150 words)

Model answer

The joint family, in which several generations shared a hearth and property, is giving way to nuclear and even single-person households, especially in cities.

Change in structure

- Migration for work splits families across towns and countries.
- Smaller families, later marriage and more dual-income couples.
- Rising numbers of elderly living alone, and of single parents.

Continuity in values

- Arranged marriages within caste and community remain the norm for most.
- Parents still expect care from children; many nuclear families stay "functionally joint", sharing money and decisions across households.
- Gender roles change slowly: working women often carry a "double burden" of job and housework.

Assessment Sociologists such as A.M. Shah argued that the joint family was never as universal as believed. Today's family is best seen as flexible: modern in form, traditional in many expectations. Policy must support both the elderly and working women within it.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "New house, old rules": the structure moves, the values follow slowly.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Avoid claiming the joint family has disappeared; the "functionally joint" family is the key nuance.

GS1 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Vidyasagar and Pandita Ramabai

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q3. Discuss the contribution of Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Pandita Ramabai to the cause of women's education and reform in the nineteenth century. (250 words)

Model answer

Nineteenth-century reform in India often began with the "woman question": child marriage, widowhood, purdah and the denial of education.

Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (1820-1891)

- Widow remarriage: he gathered scriptural arguments and public petitions that persuaded the government to pass the widow remarriage law of 1856.
- Girls' schools: as an inspector of schools in Bengal he helped open dozens of girls' schools and supported Bethune's school in Calcutta.
- Against child marriage and polygamy: he campaigned for raising the age of marriage and against Kulin polygamy.
- Language: his Bengali primer Barnaparichay made learning easier for children, girls included.

Pandita Ramabai (1858-1922)

- A Sanskrit scholar who was given the title "Pandita" in Calcutta, she was widowed young and turned her own hardship into reform.
- She founded the Arya Mahila Samaj in Pune (1882) and the Sharada Sadan (1889) for widows, giving them shelter and education.
- Her book The High-Caste Hindu Woman (1887) exposed the condition of widows to a wide audience.
- She later set up the Mukti Mission at Kedgaon, and translated the Bible into Marathi.

Comparison and legacy Vidyasagar worked from within the tradition, using the shastras to argue for change. Ramabai challenged the tradition more directly and faced criticism for her conversion to Christianity. Together they showed two routes to the same goal: law and schools from above, and shelter and self-reliance built by women themselves. Their work prepared the ground for later laws such as the Sarda Act, 1929.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "V for Vidhava (widow) law, R for Refuge": Vidyasagar won the law of 1856; Ramabai built the refuge, Sharada Sadan.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit Raja Ram Mohan Roy with the 1856 Act; his main legal victory was the abolition of sati in 1829.

GS1 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · The Aligarh Movement

PREDICTED · GS1-A2

Q4. What were the aims of the Aligarh Movement? Assess its impact on Muslim society. (150 words)

Model answer

The Aligarh Movement was led by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan after 1857 to modernise Indian Muslims through Western education while keeping their faith.

Aims

- Spread modern, scientific education in English among Muslims, who had fallen behind after the decline of Mughal power.
- Reconcile Islam with reason and science.
- Build trust with the British government, which blamed Muslims for 1857.

- Reform social customs such as purdah and polygamy, slowly.

Institutions The Scientific Society (1864) translated Western works; the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh (1875) later became Aligarh Muslim University in 1920.

Impact

- Created an educated Muslim middle class that entered government service and professions.
- Gave Urdu journalism and prose a modern voice.
- Sir Syed's later opposition to the Indian National Congress encouraged a separate Muslim political identity, which some historians link to later separatism, while others see it as a defensive response.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Syed's 1875 College" became AMU in 1920: two dates, 45 years apart.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the Aligarh Movement anti-national outright; give both readings of its political impact.

GS1 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Non-Cooperation in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q5. Describe the course of the Non-Cooperation and Khilafat movements in Karnataka. How did they widen the base of the national movement in the region? (250 words)

Model answer

The Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-22), launched by Gandhi with the Khilafat issue, reached both British-ruled Karnataka (Bombay and Madras Presidency districts) and, more cautiously, the princely State of Mysore.

Course in Karnataka

- Leaders: Gangadharrao Deshpande of Belagavi, known as the "Lion of Karnataka", led the movement in the north, with leaders such as Hardekar Manjappa and R.R. Diwakar spreading Gandhian ideas.
- Boycott: students left government schools and colleges; national schools were opened in towns such as Dharwad and Belagavi.
- Swadeshi and khadi: spinning and khadi sales spread; foreign cloth was burnt in public.
- Temperance: picketing of toddy and liquor shops was a major activity in many villages.
- Khilafat: Muslim and Hindu leaders shared platforms, and Khilafat committees worked alongside Congress committees in north Karnataka towns.
- Mysore: open defiance was limited because the Maharaja's government was not British, but students and youth joined khadi and temperance work.

Widening the base

- Peasants, artisans, students and women took part, not only lawyers and journalists.
- Kannada newspapers and pamphlets carried the message to villages.
- It built the organisation that hosted the Belgaum Congress of 1924, the only session Gandhi presided over.
- Constructive work, especially khadi and Harijan uplift, gave volunteers a permanent role after the movement was withdrawn following Chauri Chaura in 1922.

Conclusion Though suspended, the movement gave Karnataka its first mass nationalist experience and a cadre that led later struggles.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Deshpande's 3 Ks": Khadi, Khilafat, Kallu-picketing (toddy).

COMMON TRAP: Mysore was a princely State: do not describe British-style mass arrests there in 1920-22.

PEAK FACT: Gangadharrao Deshpande "Lion of Karnataka".

GS1: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Hyderabad-Karnataka liberation, 1948.

GS1 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Hyderabad-Karnataka liberation, 1948

PREDICTED · GS1-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q6. How did the Hyderabad-Karnataka region become part of India in 1948, and why is 17 September observed in the region? (150 words)

Model answer

The Kannada-speaking districts of Bidar, Gulbarga (Kalaburagi) and Raichur were part of the Nizam's Hyderabad State, which refused to join India in August 1947.

Course of events

- The Nizam sought independence; the Razakars, a militia led by Qasim Razvi, terrorised people who demanded accession.
- The State Congress and local leaders such as Swami Ramananda Tirtha led a popular struggle; many people crossed into neighbouring areas to run camps.
- After talks failed, the Indian Army launched Operation Polo on 13 September 1948. The Nizam's forces surrendered on 17 September 1948.

Why it matters

- 17 September is observed as Kalyana Karnataka Utsava (formerly Hyderabad-Karnataka Liberation Day).
- The region joined Mysore State in 1956 and was renamed Kalyana Karnataka in 2019.
- Its historical backwardness led to Article 371J (2012), giving it special provisions in jobs and education.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "13 to 17": Operation Polo began 13 September and ended 17 September 1948.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call Operation Polo a war with Pakistan or date it to 1947.

GS1 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Landless agricultural labourers

PREDICTED · GS1-B7

Q7. Landless agricultural labourers form the poorest group in rural India. Examine the causes of their vulnerability and the measures needed to improve their condition. (250 words)

Model answer

Agricultural labourers work on others' land for wages and own little or no land themselves. Censuses have shown that their number has grown faster than that of cultivators, as small holdings shrink and families slip into wage work.

Causes of vulnerability

- No assets: without land or livestock they have nothing to borrow against, so they depend on moneylenders and employers.
- Seasonal work: farm work lasts only a few months; the rest of the year brings distress migration.
- Caste: a large share are Dalits and Adivasis, facing social exclusion as well as poverty.
- Weak bargaining: workers are scattered, unorganised and often in debt to the same landlord who employs them.
- Low and unequal wages: women are frequently paid less than men for the same work.
- Climate shocks: drought and floods cut both wages and days of work.

Measures in place

- Rural employment guarantee laws, minimum wage notifications and the Code on Wages, 2019.
- Land reforms that conferred ownership on tenants, and house-site schemes for the landless.
- Subsidised grain under the 2013 food security law.

What more is needed

- Allot surplus and government land to the landless, with women as co-owners.
- Build rural non-farm jobs in agro-processing, construction and services.
- Skill training linked to local demand.
- Social security for unorganised workers through the e-Shram registry.
- Strong enforcement of minimum wages and equal pay.

Conclusion Dignity for the landless needs both an asset base and a floor of income and social protection.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "ACW-SC": Assets nil, Casual work, Wages low, Social caste, Climate shocks.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse agricultural labourers with tenants or small farmers; their defining feature is wage dependence without land.

GS1 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Reading an enrolment table

PREDICTED · GS1-C8

Q8. The table shows enrolment (in thousands) in a district's government schools. Answer: (a) the percentage change in total enrolment from 2022 to 2024; (b) the share of girls in 2024; (c) one inference. Data (illustrative): 2022: Boys 120, Girls 100; 2024: Boys 110, Girls 105. (150 words)

Model answer

The figures are illustrative, made up for practice; they are not official statistics.

Step 1: totals

- 2022: 120 + 100 = 220 thousand.
- 2024: 110 + 105 = 215 thousand.

(a) Percentage change Change = 215 minus 220 = minus 5 thousand. Percentage change = (minus 5 / 220) x 100 = about minus 2.3 per cent. Total enrolment fell by about 2.3 per cent.

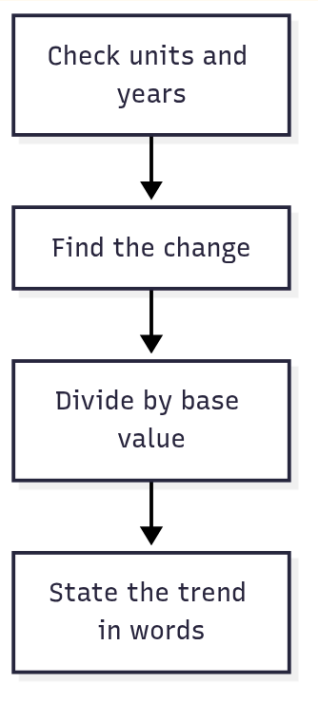
(b) Share of girls in 2024 Girls / total = 105 / 215 x 100 = about 48.8 per cent.

(c) Inferences

- Boys' enrolment fell by 10 thousand (about 8.3 per cent), while girls' rose by 5 thousand (5 per cent).
- The gender gap narrowed from 20 thousand to 5 thousand.

- A likely reading is that boys are moving to private schools or dropping out for work, while schemes for girls are retaining them. This needs checking against private school data before a firm conclusion.

Check: boys' share is 51.2 per cent; 51.2 + 48.8 = 100.



DRAW IT: Reading an enrolment table. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Change over old": percentage change always divides by the old (base) value.

COMMON TRAP: Do not divide the change by the new value (215); the base is 2022.

GS1 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Nagara, Dravida and Vesara

PREDICTED · GS1-A1

Q9. Distinguish between the Nagara, Dravida and Vesara styles of temple architecture with suitable examples. Why is Karnataka called a laboratory of temple styles? (250 words)

Model answer

Indian temple architecture developed three broad styles, classified by the shape of the tower over the sanctum and the plan of the temple.

Nagara (north Indian)

- Curvilinear tower called the shikhara, topped by an amalaka and kalasha.
- Usually no large boundary wall or gateways; temples often stand on a raised platform.
- Examples: Kandariya Mahadeva at Khajuraho, Sun Temple at Konark.

Dravida (south Indian)

- Pyramidal, storeyed tower called the vimana.
- High boundary walls with large gateways (gopurams), which in later periods became taller than the vimana itself.
- Water tank inside the complex is common.

- Examples: Brihadeshwara at Thanjavur, Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram.

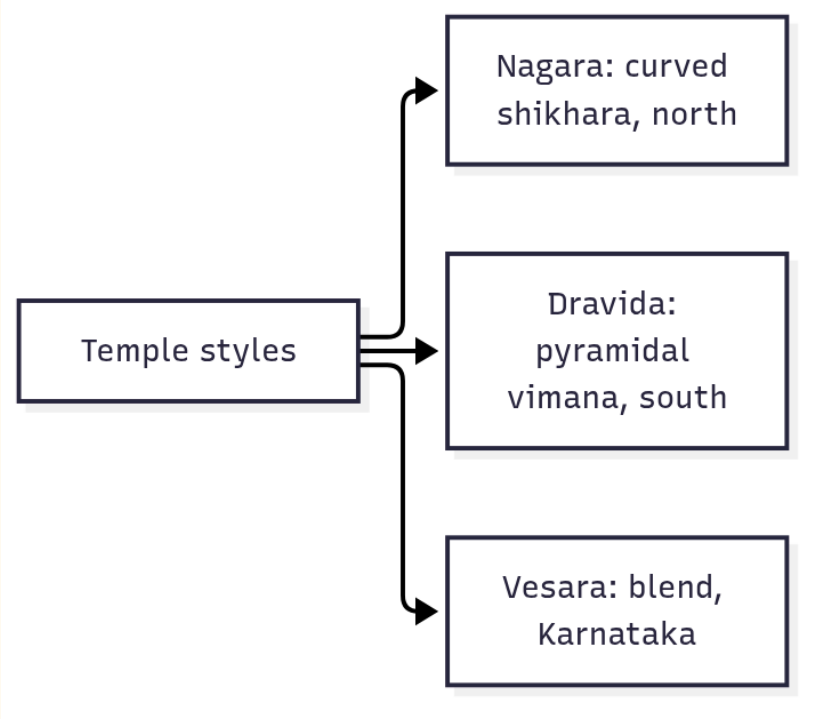
Vesara (hybrid, Deccan)

- Combines features of both, with star-shaped (stellate) plans and stepped towers.
- Developed under the later Chalukyas and Hoysalas.
- Examples: temples at Lakkundi and Itagi, and the Hoysala temples of Belur, Halebidu and Somanathapura.

Karnataka as a laboratory

- At Aihole, often called the "cradle of Indian temple architecture", early Chalukyan builders experimented with different forms, such as the Durga temple with its apsidal plan.
- At Pattadakal, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, Nagara and Dravida temples stand side by side: the Papanatha temple in Nagara style and the Virupaksha temple in Dravida style.
- Later Chalukyas and Hoysalas refined the Vesara style, whose Hoysala temples were inscribed on the World Heritage List in 2023.

Conclusion Karnataka shows the evolution of Indian temple styles at one place, from experiments to fusion.



DRAW IT: Three temple styles. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "N-D-V = Northern curve, Dravidian pyramid, Vesara mix"; "Aihole tries, Pattadakal pairs, Hoysalas fuse".

COMMON TRAP: Do not call Pattadakal purely Dravida; its key feature is both styles side by side.

GS1 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · PMGSY-IV

PREDICTED · GS1-C6 · Current affairs

Q10. What are the objectives of the fourth phase of the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana? How do rural roads contribute to rural development? (150 words)

Model answer

The Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY), launched in December 2000, gives all-weather road links to unconnected rural habitations.

PMGSY-IV

- Approved by the Union Cabinet in September 2024 for 2024-25 to 2028-29.
- Aims to connect about 25,000 unconnected habitations eligible on the basis of population as per Census 2011, through about 62,500 km of all-weather roads, including bridges.
- Uses new technology such as cold mix, waste plastic and full-depth reclamation, and planning on the PM Gati Shakti platform.

How roads help rural development

- Markets: farmers reach mandis and get better prices; perishables reach buyers in time.
- Services: children reach secondary schools; pregnant women reach hospitals; ambulances reach villages.
- Jobs: non-farm work in nearby towns becomes possible without migrating.
- Women: safer, faster travel increases mobility.

Caution Maintenance after the five-year contract period is often weak; States must budget for upkeep.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Road = Rate, Reach, Rozgar": better price rates, reach to services, and jobs.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mix up PMGSY (rural roads) with Bharatmala (highways).
>
> **PEAK FACT:** PMGSY launched 25 December 2000.

GS1: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, The Western Gangas.

GS1 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · The Western Gangas

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q11. Assess the contribution of the Western Gangas of Talakad to the polity, religion and art of Karnataka. (250 words)

Model answer

The Western Gangas ruled much of southern Karnataka from about the fourth to the eleventh century CE, first from Kolar and later from Talakad on the Kaveri.

Polity

- They ruled a region called Gangavadi, covering present Mysuru, Mandya, Bengaluru, Tumakuru and Kolar.
- They were often feudatories or allies of larger powers such as the Chalukyas of Badami and the Rashtrakutas, yet kept substantial autonomy for centuries.
- Their copper plate grants record land gifts and village administration, valuable sources for historians.
- Their rule ended when the Cholas captured Talakad in the early eleventh century.

Religion

- Strong patrons of Jainism. Their minister and general Chavundaraya commissioned the colossal monolith of Gommateshwara (Bahubali) at Shravanabelagola, about 57 feet high, around 983 CE.
- Chavundaraya also wrote the Chavundaraya Purana, one of the earliest prose works in Kannada.
- They also supported Hindu temples and Brahmin settlements, showing religious tolerance.

Art and literature

- Jain bastis on Chandragiri hill at Shravanabelagola, and the free-standing manastambha pillars.
- Kings such as Durvinita are credited with scholarly work in Sanskrit.
- The Mahamastakabhisheka of Gommateshwara, held about every twelve years, continues this heritage today.

Conclusion The Gangas gave Karnataka a stable kingdom for centuries, made Shravanabelagola a world centre of Jainism and helped shape early Kannada prose.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Ganga gave Gomata": Gangas gave Gommateshwara (983 CE) through Chavundaraya.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit the Hoysalas or the Rashtrakutas with the Gommateshwara statue; it was commissioned by the Ganga minister Chavundaraya.

GS1 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Anubhava Mantapa

PREDICTED · GS1-A3 · Karnataka-specific

Q12. What was the Anubhava Mantapa? Why is it seen as an early experiment in social democracy? (150 words)

Model answer

The Anubhava Mantapa ("hall of spiritual experience") was a gathering of saints and seekers associated with Basavanna at Kalyana (present Basavakalyan in Bidar) in the twelfth century, under the Kalachuri king Bijjala, whom Basavanna served as a minister.

Features

- People from every caste and occupation, including cobblers, washermen and weavers, and women such as Akka Mahadevi, discussed spiritual and social questions as equals.
- Allama Prabhu is traditionally said to have presided over it.
- Its ideas were expressed in vachanas in simple Kannada, not Sanskrit.

Why it is called democratic

- Equality of all, rejecting caste and gender hierarchy.
- Kayaka (dignity of labour) and dasoha (sharing wealth with the community).
- Open debate and free expression.

Limits The movement met fierce resistance after an inter-caste marriage it supported, and Kalyana saw violence. Its ideals still inspire debates on equality.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Kalyana's KKD": Kayaka, Kalyana, Dasoha.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call it a formal parliament with elected members; it was a spiritual assembly with democratic ideals.

GS1 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Gruha Lakshmi and cash transfers

PREDICTED · GS1-C7 · Current affairs

Q13. Karnataka's Gruha Lakshmi scheme gives a monthly cash transfer to women heads of households. Evaluate such unconditional cash transfers as a tool of rural development and women's empowerment. (250 words)

Model answer

Gruha Lakshmi, one of Karnataka's five "guarantee" schemes, was launched in August 2023. It pays Rs 2,000 a month into the bank account of the woman recognised as the head of an eligible family.

Arguments in favour

- Women's control over money: the transfer goes to the woman, increasing her say in household spending.
- Consumption and nutrition: families spend on food, school needs and health, which supports the local rural economy.
- Low leakage: direct benefit transfer to Aadhaar-linked accounts reduces middlemen.
- Dignity and choice: unlike in-kind schemes, cash respects the household's own priorities.
- Evidence: studies of cash transfers in many countries find little sign that money is wasted on "temptation goods".

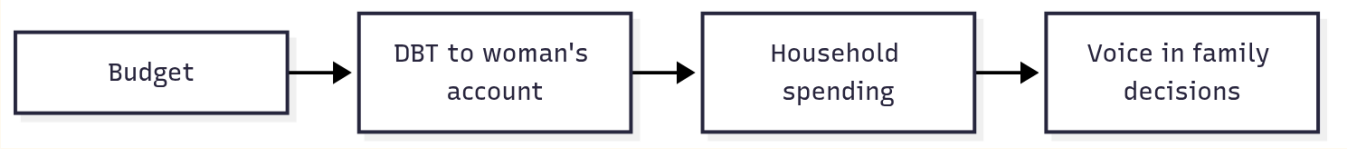
Concerns

- Fiscal cost: the guarantees together cost the State a large share of its budget, which may squeeze capital spending on roads, irrigation and schools.
- Targeting: excluding income-tax payers and GST payers may still leave errors of inclusion and exclusion.
- Not a substitute: cash cannot replace jobs, health care or quality schools.
- Delays: monthly payments sometimes arrive late, reducing reliability.
- Political competition: the risk of ever-larger promises without long-term funding.

Way forward

- Independent impact evaluation, with results made public.
- Link beneficiaries to self-help groups, skills and credit so that cash becomes capital.
- Regular checks to clean the beneficiary list.

Conclusion Unconditional cash can empower women and steady rural demand, but it works best as a floor beneath, not a replacement for, investment in productive assets and services.



DRAW IT: How a cash transfer reaches a home. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Cash is a floor, not a ladder": helpful below, but jobs and skills are the ladder.

COMMON TRAP: Do not quote an exact annual budget figure for the guarantees unless you know the Budget number; describe the scale instead.

GS1 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Universal versus targeted welfare

PREDICTED · GS1-B2

Q14. Distinguish between universal and targeted social policy. Which approach suits India? (150 words)

Model answer

Universal social policy gives a benefit to everyone in a category, regardless of income: for example free primary schooling or mid-day meals for all government school children.

Targeted social policy gives benefits only to those identified as needy, such as ration cards for poor households or scholarships by income.

Basis	Universal	Targeted
Coverage	All	Selected poor
Cost	Higher	Lower
Errors	Fewer exclusion errors	Exclusion and inclusion errors
Stigma	Low	Can be high
Political support	Broad	Narrow

Which suits India? A mix. Basic services that build capability, such as primary education, immunisation and nutrition for young children, work best when universal, because missing a poor child is costly. Cash support and subsidies that are expensive can be targeted, but using good data (such as Aadhaar-linked databases and family registries) and with easy grievance redress. Tamil Nadu's universal PDS and Kerala's health system show the value of universality.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Build universal, help targeted": capability services universal, cash help targeted.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not argue that targeting is always cheaper overall; administrative costs and exclusion errors can be large.

GS1 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · The GST Council

PREDICTED · GS1-B5

Q15. "The GST Council is an experiment in cooperative federalism." Examine with reference to its composition, working and the tensions that have emerged. (250 words)

Model answer

The 101st Constitutional Amendment, 2016, created the Goods and Services Tax and, under Article 279A, the GST Council, a shared body where the Centre and every State sit together.

Composition

- Chaired by the Union Finance Minister; members include the Union Minister of State for Finance and the Finance Ministers of all States and Union Territories with legislatures.
- Voting: the Union has one-third of the weighted votes and the States together two-thirds; a decision needs three-fourths of the weighted votes present.

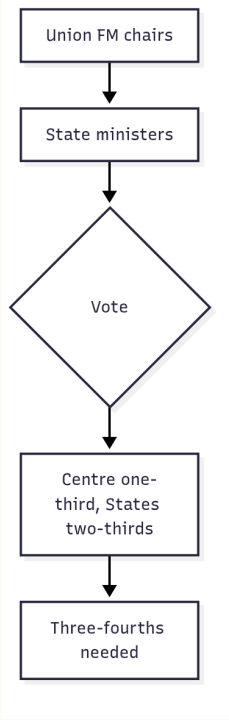
Why it is cooperative

- States gave up independent taxing power over many items and pooled it with the Union.
- Most decisions have been taken by consensus.
- It has evolved rates, rules and later rate rationalisation through continuous negotiation.

Tensions

- Weighted voting: the Union effectively holds a veto, while States cannot block jointly without large coalitions.
- Compensation: GST compensation to States for revenue loss ended in June 2022, worrying States like Karnataka whose share of collections exceeds their share of devolution.
- Mohit Minerals (2022): the Supreme Court held that the Council's recommendations are persuasive, not binding, on Parliament and State legislatures.
- Petroleum and alcohol are outside GST, and debates continue on bringing them in.
- Concerns about rate changes affecting State revenues without enough consultation.

Conclusion The Council shows that sovereignty can be shared through institutions. Its future depends on fair voting, timely compensation and respect for State autonomy recognised in Mohit Minerals.



DRAW IT: Inside the GST Council. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "279A, 1/3 and 3/4": Article 279A; the Union holds one-third of votes; decisions need three-fourths.

COMMON TRAP: Do not say Council decisions are binding; Mohit Minerals (2022) says they are recommendatory.

PEAK FACT: 101st Amendment 2016, Article 279A.

GS1: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Judicial activism and overreach.

GS1 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · Judicial activism and overreach

PREDICTED · GS1-B4

Q16. Distinguish between judicial activism and judicial overreach, with examples. (150 words)

Model answer

Judicial activism is the court's active role in protecting rights and making the executive act when it fails. It grew with public interest litigation (PIL) from the late 1970s.

- Examples: expanding Article 21 to include the right to livelihood, health and a clean environment; the Vishaka guidelines (1997) on workplace sexual harassment before Parliament made a law.

Judicial overreach is when courts move into policy areas that belong to the legislature or executive, or issue orders that are hard to implement.

- Examples often cited: the 2016 order requiring the national anthem in cinema halls (later modified); detailed orders on liquor shops near highways.

The line The difference lies in whether the court is enforcing a constitutional right or replacing a policy choice. Restraint, clear reasoning and respect for the separation of powers (Article 50 and the basic structure) help courts stay on the right side.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Rights = activism, Policies = overreach."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call all PILs overreach; the Vishaka case is an accepted example of activism filling a legal vacuum.

GS1 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · The Mahalanobis model

PREDICTED · GS1-C1

Q17. Explain the Mahalanobis strategy of the Second Five-Year Plan. What were its achievements and limitations? (250 words)

Model answer

The Second Five-Year Plan (1956-61) was based on a model developed by the statistician P.C. Mahalanobis.

The strategy

- Rapid industrialisation with priority to heavy and basic industries, such as steel, machinery and power, to make India self-reliant in capital goods.
- A leading role for the public sector, following the Industrial Policy Resolution of 1956.
- Import substitution, with consumer goods to be produced largely by small and cottage industries to create jobs.
- Assumption of a closed economy and long-run growth from investment in capital goods.

Achievements

- Steel plants at Bhilai, Rourkela and Durgapur set up with foreign help.
- A broad industrial base and institutions in science and technical education.
- Higher investment rates and growth of the public sector, with Karnataka benefiting from units such as Bharat Electronics and Hindustan Machine Tools in Bengaluru.

Limitations

- Agriculture neglected: food shortages in the 1960s forced dependence on imports.
- Foreign exchange crisis of 1957-58 due to heavy imports of machinery.
- Few jobs: capital-intensive industry created limited employment.
- Inefficiency: licences, controls and loss-making public units in later decades.
- Inflation and fiscal pressure.

Conclusion The Mahalanobis plan built India's industrial foundation, but its neglect of agriculture, exports and jobs led to the course corrections of the Green Revolution and, later, the 1991 reforms.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Heavy-first, food-later": Mahalanobis put heavy industry first and food came second, until the 1960s crisis.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse the Mahalanobis model with the Harrod-Domar model used in the First Plan, which prioritised agriculture.

GS1 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · State revenues after GST

PREDICTED · GS1-C5

Q18. What problems do States face in raising their own revenue after the introduction of GST? Suggest remedies. (150 words)

Model answer

GST subsumed many State taxes such as VAT, entry tax and entertainment tax, so States' freedom to set tax rates shrank.

Problems

- Loss of autonomy: rates are decided jointly in the GST Council.
- End of compensation: the guaranteed 14 per cent annual growth in GST revenue ended in June 2022.
- Narrow own sources: States rely on petroleum, alcohol, stamp duty, motor vehicle tax and electricity duty, several of which face social or political limits.
- Dependence on transfers: higher reliance on Finance Commission devolution and grants.
- Producer States: as GST is destination-based, manufacturing States may gain less than expected.

Remedies

- Improve tax administration: data analytics, e-invoicing and audits to curb evasion.
- Rationalise stamp duty and property guidance values.
- Strengthen property tax for urban local bodies.
- Seek a fair share in Finance Commission devolution and a voice in GST rate changes.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "GST took VAT, kept PASME": Petroleum, Alcohol, Stamps, Motor vehicles, Electricity duty remain with States.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say petroleum products are under GST; they are outside it for now.

GS1 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · Sir Mirza Ismail

PREDICTED · GS1-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q19. Assess the role of Sir Mirza Ismail as Dewan of Mysore in its modernisation. (250 words)

Model answer

Sir Mirza Ismail served as Dewan of Mysore from 1926 to 1941 under Maharaja Krishnaraja Wadiyar IV. He continued the modernising work of Sir M. Visvesvaraya, with special stress on industry and town planning.

Industry

- Expanded industries such as the Mysore Sugar Company at Mandya (1933), and supported others in paper, chemicals and fertilisers, and porcelain.
- Helped bring the aircraft factory of Walchand Hirachand to Bangalore in 1940, the origin of Hindustan Aeronautics Limited.
- Encouraged hydroelectric power from Shivanasamudra, which supplied electricity to Bangalore and the Kolar Gold Fields.

Urban and public works

- Beautified Bangalore and Mysore with gardens, wide roads and public buildings; the Brindavan Gardens below the Krishna Raja Sagar dam were laid out during his time.
- Built rural roads, schools and hospitals.

Administration and politics

- Known for efficient administration and religious tolerance.
- He faced the growing demand for responsible government; the Vidurashwatha firing in 1938, during the Mysore Congress agitation, occurred under his administration and damaged his reputation.

Assessment

- Strengths: industrial growth, infrastructure and an attractive urban environment.
- Weaknesses: limited political reform and a top-down style.

Conclusion Mirza Ismail helped turn Mysore into one of India's most industrialised princely States, but his era also showed that economic modernisation without political participation could not last.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Mirza's 3 S: Sugar, Sky (aircraft), Scenery (Brindavan)".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse Mirza Ismail with Visvesvaraya, who built the KRS dam and founded Bhadravati iron works and the Bank of Mysore.

GS1 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Plan holidays and the rolling plan

PREDICTED · GS1-C4

Q20. What were the "plan holidays" and the "rolling plan" in India's planning history? What lessons do they offer? (150 words)

Model answer

Plan holidays (1966-69) After the Third Plan (1961-66) failed because of the wars of 1962 and 1965, two droughts and high inflation, the Fourth Plan was postponed. Three annual plans were adopted from 1966 to 1969. This period also saw the start of the Green Revolution and the devaluation of the rupee in 1966.

Rolling plan (1978-80) The Janata government ended the Fifth Plan a year early and adopted a "rolling plan", in which plans were revised every year, with a fixed annual plan, a five-year plan rolled forward each year, and a longer perspective plan. It was dropped when the Congress returned in 1980 and the Sixth Plan began.

Lessons

- Plans need flexibility to respond to shocks.
- Annual reviews improve realism, but frequent changes create uncertainty.
- Political stability matters, a lesson reflected in NITI Aayog's mix of vision and action agendas.

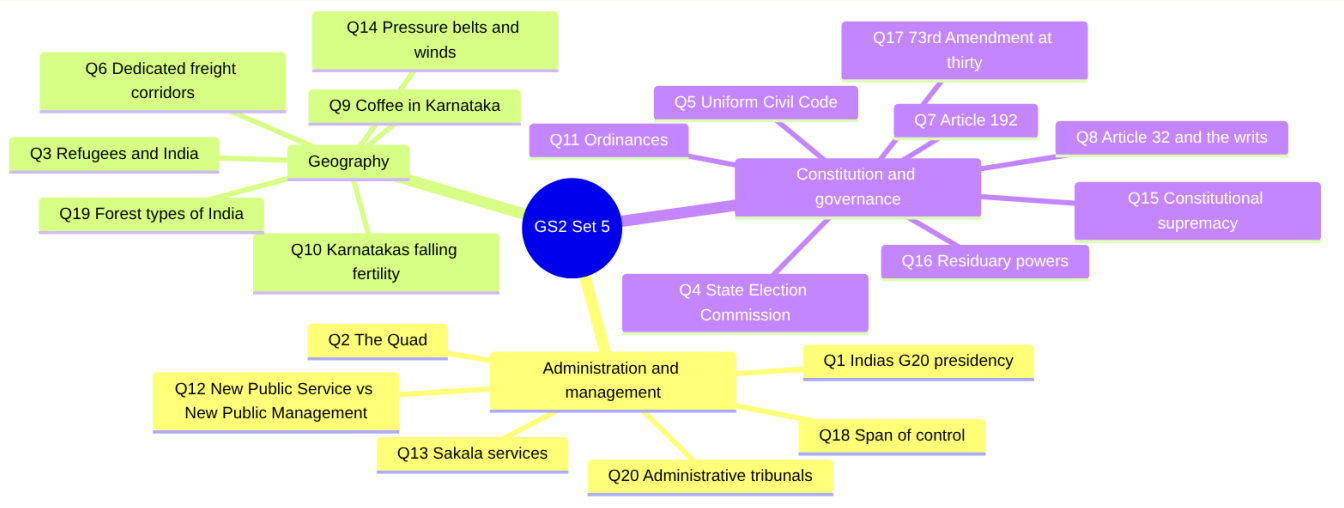
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "66-69 holiday, 78-80 rolling".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the 1990-92 annual plans a "rolling plan"; those were annual plans before the Eighth Plan.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Annual plans 1966-69 plan holiday.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Judicial activism and overreach:** "Rights = activism, Policies = overreach." **Q17 The Mahalanobis model:** "Heavy-first, food-later": Mahalanobis put heavy industry first and food came second, until the 1960s crisis. **Q18 State revenues after GST:** "GST took VAT, kept PASME": Petroleum, Alcohol, Stamps, Motor vehicles, Electricity duty remain with States. **Q19 Sir Mirza Ismail:** "Mirza's 3 S: Sugar, Sky (aircraft), Scenery (Brindavan)". **Q20 Plan holidays and the rolling plan:** "66-69 holiday, 78-80 rolling".

Paper 3: General Studies II (GS2)

Set 5: step 4 of 6 (General Studies II (GS2)). Next up: General Studies III (GS3)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** Polity and world questions test the machinery: the State Election Commission, Article 19(2), the writs, ordinances and tribunals. Geography moves from pressure belts and forest types to Karnataka's coffee and falling fertility.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS2 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · India's G20 presidency

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q1. What did India's G20 presidency in 2023 achieve for the Global South? How can India carry that agenda forward in other forums? (250 words)

Model answer

India held the G20 presidency from 1 December 2022 to 30 November 2023, under the theme "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam: One Earth, One Family, One Future". The New Delhi Leaders' Summit was held in September 2023.

Achievements

- African Union: admitted as a permanent member of the G20 at the New Delhi summit, giving Africa a seat alongside the European Union.
- Consensus declaration: the New Delhi Declaration was adopted by consensus despite sharp divisions over the war in Ukraine.
- Voice of the Global South: India held "Voice of the Global South" summits before and after its presidency, bringing developing countries' concerns into G20 talks.
- Digital public infrastructure: G20 accepted a framework on DPI, drawing on India's experience with Aadhaar and UPI.
- Multilateral development banks: calls to reform and enlarge lending by the World Bank and others to meet climate and development needs.
- Global Biofuels Alliance: launched at the summit, with India, the US and Brazil among founders.
- Connectivity: the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) was announced.

Carrying it forward

- In BRICS, push for reform of global finance and local currency trade.
- At the UN, continue the demand for Security Council reform.
- In the WTO, defend food security and fair rules for developing countries.
- At climate talks, press for finance and technology transfer.
- Through bilateral DPI partnerships with countries in Africa and the Pacific.

Conclusion The presidency showed India as a bridge between the developed world and the Global South. The test now is to turn declarations into money, rules and institutions.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A-D-B-C": African Union in, DPI framework, Biofuels Alliance, Corridor (IMEC).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say India was the first to admit a new permanent member to any forum; the specific point is the African Union joining the G20.

GS2 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · The Quad

PREDICTED · GS2-C7 · Current affairs

Q2. What is the Quad? Discuss its significance for India's Indo-Pacific policy. (150 words)

Model answer

The Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad) brings together India, the United States, Japan and Australia. It began as a group to coordinate relief after the 2004 tsunami, faded after 2008 and was revived in 2017; leaders' summits began in 2021.

Agenda

- A free, open and inclusive Indo-Pacific based on international law.
- Practical cooperation: vaccines, critical and emerging technologies, climate, infrastructure and maritime domain awareness through the Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness.
- Disaster relief and health security.

Significance for India

- Balances China's assertiveness in the Indian Ocean and South China Sea without a formal military alliance.
- Access to technology, investment and supply chains.
- Supports India's "Act East" and SAGAR outlooks.

Limits India avoids treaty commitments and values strategic autonomy; it also belongs to the SCO and BRICS. The Quad's value lies in flexible, issue-based cooperation.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Tsunami to Tech": born from 2004 tsunami relief, now about technology and maritime awareness.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call the Quad a military alliance like NATO; it has no mutual defence clause.

GS2 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Refugees and India

PREDICTED · GS2-A2

Q3. India is not a party to the 1951 Refugee Convention, yet it hosts many refugees. Examine India's approach to refugees and the case for a national refugee law. (250 words)

Model answer

A refugee is a person who has fled their country owing to a well-founded fear of persecution. The 1951 Convention and its 1967 Protocol define refugee rights, especially non-refoulement: not sending a person back to a place where they face danger.

India's approach

- India has not signed the Convention or Protocol, citing porous borders, security concerns and the burden on a developing country.
- Refugees are dealt with under general laws such as the Foreigners Act, 1946, and the Passports Act.
- In practice India has hosted Tibetans, Sri Lankan Tamils, Afghans, Chakmas and others, often with long-term stay and some benefits.
- UNHCR works in India for some groups, such as Afghans and Myanmar nationals.
- Courts have read protection into Article 21, which applies to all persons, not only citizens.
- The Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 provides a route to citizenship for certain non-Muslim migrants from three neighbouring countries, which critics say is selective.

Case for a national law

- Uniform, transparent procedure instead of ad hoc decisions.
- Clear distinction between refugees and illegal migrants.
- Rights to work, education and health for recognised refugees.
- Better security screening through registration.
- India's own tradition of asylum, from Parsis to Tibetans, supports a humane framework.

Concerns Security, demographic change in border States and resource strain.

Conclusion A national asylum law that combines security screening with non-refoulement would give India both control and credibility as a responsible regional power.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Not signed, still kind": India has not signed the 1951 Convention but hosts many; it needs a law to make kindness predictable.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say India has a refugee law; it relies on the Foreigners Act, 1946 and ad hoc policy.

GS2 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · State Election Commission

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q4. Explain the role and independence of the State Election Commission in conducting elections to local bodies. (150 words)

Model answer

Articles 243K and 243ZA, added by the 73rd and 74th Amendments, create a State Election Commission (SEC) to conduct elections to panchayats and municipalities.

Role

- Superintendence, direction and control of the preparation of electoral rolls and the conduct of local body elections.
- Issues the model code of conduct, delimitation support and polling arrangements.

Independence

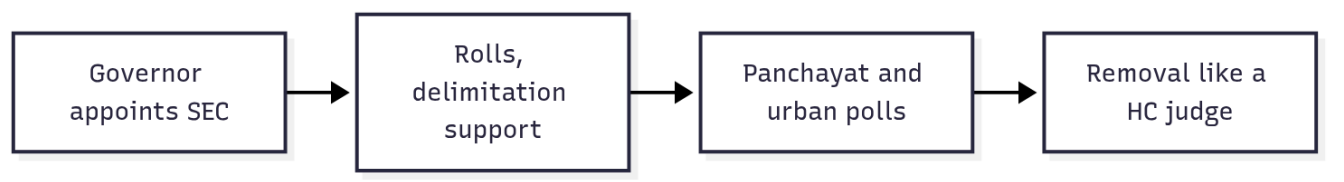
- The State Election Commissioner is appointed by the Governor.

- Removal follows the same procedure and grounds as for a High Court judge; his terms of service cannot be made worse once he is in office.

Problems

- Delays in elections when States hold back reservation lists or delimitation; the Supreme Court has repeatedly insisted that elections must be held on time (for example in the 2022 OBC "triple test" cases).
- Dependence on State staff and funds.

In Karnataka, delays in Bengaluru civic and zilla-taluk panchayat polls show why SEC independence matters.



DRAW IT: Who runs local elections. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "243K for villages, 243ZA for towns."

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse the SEC with the Election Commission of India; the ECI does not conduct panchayat elections.

GS2 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Uniform Civil Code

PREDICTED · GS2-B6 · Current affairs

Q5. "A Uniform Civil Code is a Directive Principle, not a command." Discuss with reference to Article 44, the debate around it and recent developments. (250 words)

Model answer

Article 44, a Directive Principle of State Policy, says the State shall endeavour to secure for citizens a uniform civil code throughout India. A UCC would replace religion-based personal laws on marriage, divorce, inheritance and adoption with common rules.

Why it is not a command

- Directive Principles are not enforceable in courts (Article 37), though they are fundamental in governance.
- The framers left it to the future because of the diversity of customs.

Arguments for

- Equal treatment under Article 14 and gender justice.
- National integration and simpler law.
- Courts in Shah Bano (1985) and Sarla Mudgal (1995) urged Parliament to act.

Arguments against

- Freedom of religion (Articles 25 and 26) and cultural autonomy of minorities and tribes.
- The fear that "uniform" may mean majority norms.
- Sixth Schedule areas and customary law in the North-East.
- The 21st Law Commission (2018) said a UCC was "neither necessary nor desirable at this stage" and suggested reforming each personal law instead.

Recent developments

- Goa has long had a common civil code from Portuguese times.
- Uttarakhand passed a UCC law in 2024, which came into force in January 2025, including registration of live-in relationships; Scheduled Tribes were kept out. Gujarat's Assembly passed a similar code in March 2026.
- The 22nd Law Commission sought public views in 2023.

Way forward Codify and reform personal laws for gender justice step by step, build consensus and protect tribal customs.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "44 asks, 37 excuses": Article 44 asks for a UCC; Article 37 makes it non-justiciable.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say a UCC already applies across India; only Goa and Uttarakhand have codes in force, and Gujarat passed a bill in March 2026.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Article 44 and Article 37.

GS2: 5 of 20 done. Next up: Q6, Dedicated freight corridors.

GS2 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Dedicated freight corridors

PREDICTED · GS2-A4

Q6. What are Dedicated Freight Corridors? How will they change India's logistics? (150 words)

Model answer

Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFCs) are railway lines meant only for goods trains, built and run by the Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL).

The two main corridors

- Eastern DFC: from Ludhiana (Punjab) to Sonnagar (Bihar), mainly for coal, steel and food grains.
- Western DFC: from Dadri (Uttar Pradesh) to Jawaharlal Nehru Port (Maharashtra), mainly for containers.

Benefits

- Faster, heavier and longer goods trains, with double-stack containers on the western corridor.
- Frees passenger lines for more passenger trains.
- Lower logistics costs, which in India are high compared with major economies.
- Shift from road to rail, cutting emissions and road congestion.
- Industrial nodes along the Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor gain.

Challenges Land acquisition delays, last-mile links to ports and factories, and the need for more corridors (such as East Coast and East-West) to spread benefits southward, including to Karnataka.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "East carries coal, West carries containers."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not mix up DFCs with industrial corridors such as DMIC; DFCs are the rail spine, DMIC is the industrial belt beside it.

GS2 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Article 19(2)

PREDICTED · GS2-B2

Q7. Examine the scope of "reasonable restrictions" on freedom of speech under Article 19(2). How have the courts balanced liberty and order? (250 words)

Model answer

Article 19(1)(a) guarantees all citizens freedom of speech and expression. Article 19(2) allows the State to impose "reasonable restrictions" by law on specific grounds.

Grounds under Article 19(2) Sovereignty and integrity of India, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, decency or morality, contempt of court, defamation and incitement to an offence. The First Amendment (1951) added public order and friendly relations; the Sixteenth Amendment (1963) added sovereignty and integrity.

How courts test restrictions

- Only listed grounds: restrictions must fit one of the eight grounds; "public interest" alone is not enough.
- Proximate link: in Ram Manohar Lohia (1960) the Court said the link between speech and disorder must be close, not remote.
- Vagueness: Shreya Singhal (2015) struck down Section 66A of the IT Act because it was vague and chilled speech.
- Proportionality: Anuradha Bhasin (2020) held that internet shutdowns must be necessary, proportionate and reviewed periodically.
- Sedition: in 2022 the Supreme Court put Section 124A IPC on hold; the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 dropped the word sedition but has a provision on acts endangering sovereignty, unity and integrity.

Balance Courts have generally protected speech, including criticism of the government, while allowing restrictions on incitement and hate speech.

Conclusion The test of reasonableness keeps the balance: speech is the rule, restriction the exception, and every restriction must be narrow, clear and proportionate.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "8 grounds, 3 tests": eight listed grounds; tests of proximity, clarity (not vague) and proportionality.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not list "public interest" or "national interest" as a ground under Article 19(2); it is not one.

GS2 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Article 32 and the writs

PREDICTED · GS2-B2

Q8. Why did Dr. Ambedkar call Article 32 the "heart and soul" of the Constitution? Explain the writs available under it. (150 words)

Model answer

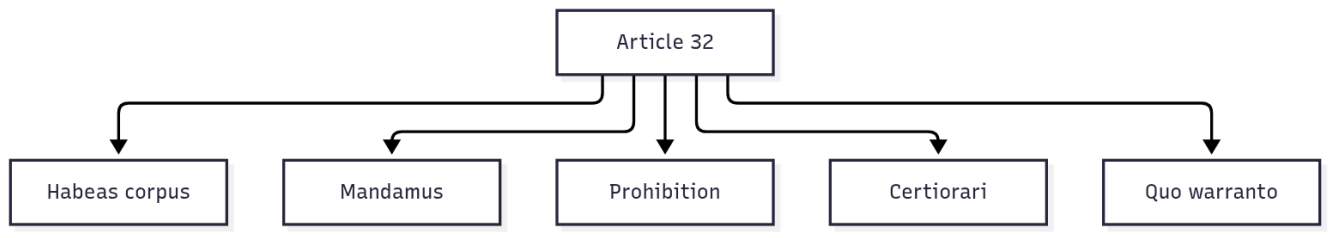
Article 32 gives every person the right to move the Supreme Court directly for enforcement of Fundamental Rights. Ambedkar called it the "very soul" and "heart" of the Constitution because rights without a remedy are empty. It is itself a Fundamental Right and part of the basic structure.

Writs

- Habeas corpus: produce a detained person before the court; tests legality of detention.
- Mandamus: orders a public authority to perform its legal duty.

- Prohibition: stops a lower court or tribunal from exceeding its jurisdiction.
- Certiorari: quashes an order passed by a lower court or tribunal without jurisdiction or in error.
- Quo warranto: asks a person by what authority he holds a public office.

Article 226 gives High Courts wider writ power, for Fundamental Rights and "any other purpose". Article 32 can be suspended only during a national emergency, under Article 359.



DRAW IT: The five writs. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "HM-PCQ": Habeas, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari, Quo warranto, "Have My Pen Copied Quickly".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say High Courts have narrower writ powers; Article 226 is wider than Article 32.

GS2 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Coffee in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS2-A5 · Karnataka-specific

Q9. Karnataka is India's leading coffee producer. Explain the geographical conditions favouring coffee in the State and the challenges faced by growers. (250 words)

Model answer

Karnataka produces the largest share of India's coffee, a little over two-thirds by most Coffee Board estimates, mainly from Kodagu, Chikkamagaluru and Hassan districts. Coffee came to India, according to legend, through Baba Budan, who planted seeds in the Chandragiri hills (now Baba Budangiri) of Chikkamagaluru in the seventeenth century.

Geographical conditions

- Relief: hill slopes of the Western Ghats between about 600 and 1,600 metres, which drain well.
- Climate: warm temperatures, moderate to heavy rainfall from the south-west monsoon, and "blossom showers" in March-April that make the plant flower.
- Shade: coffee is grown under a canopy of native trees, which protects it from sun and supports biodiversity.
- Soils: deep, fertile, well-drained laterite and forest soils rich in humus.
- Labour: plantations need many hands for picking and processing.

Types Arabica grows at higher altitudes and fetches higher prices; Robusta grows lower down and gives higher yields. Monsooned Malabar coffee is a GI product.

Challenges

- Climate change: erratic rain, delayed blossom showers and extreme rain in recent years have caused landslides, especially in Kodagu after 2018.
- Pests: white stem borer in Arabica.
- Price swings in world markets and rising labour costs.
- Human-wildlife conflict with elephants.
- Small growers lack processing and branding.

Way forward Climate-resilient varieties, crop insurance, value addition (speciality coffee, GI branding such as Coorg Arabica and Chikmagalur Arabica) and support for small growers.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Baba Budan's 3 S: Slopes, Showers, Shade".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say coffee needs full sunlight; Indian coffee is shade-grown.

GS2 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · Karnataka's falling fertility

PREDICTED · GS2-A6 · Karnataka-specific

Q10. Karnataka's fertility rate is below the replacement level. What are the implications for the State's population policy? (150 words)

Model answer

The replacement-level total fertility rate (TFR) is about 2.1 children per woman. NFHS-5 (2019-21) recorded Karnataka's TFR at 1.7, below replacement and below the national 2.0.

Implications

- Ageing: the share of elderly will rise, increasing demand for pensions, geriatric care and health spending.
- Demographic dividend window: the working-age share is high now but will narrow; jobs and skills must come quickly.
- Regional gaps: northern districts such as those in Kalyana Karnataka still have higher fertility than the south.
- Migration: labour shortages may be filled by migrants from northern States, with social implications.
- Federal politics: delimitation based on population could reduce the political weight of States that controlled population.

Policy shifts

- From "control" to "quality": health, nutrition and education.
- Elder care and social security.
- Support for working parents, such as creches.
- Focus on remaining high-fertility pockets.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "2.1 is the line, Karnataka is at 1.7."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not argue for a two-child norm; with TFR below replacement, coercive measures are unnecessary and counterproductive.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** NFHS-5 Karnataka TFR 1.7; India 2.0.

GS2: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Ordinances.

GS2 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Ordinances

PREDICTED · GS2-B4

Q11. Examine the ordinance-making power of the President and the Governor. How has the Supreme Court checked its misuse? (250 words)

Model answer

Articles 123 and 213 allow the President and the Governor to promulgate ordinances when the legislature is not in session and immediate action is needed.

Features

- Issued on ministerial advice, not personal choice.
- Have the same force as a law, but must be laid before the legislature and cease to operate six weeks after it reassembles, unless approved earlier.
- Can be withdrawn at any time.
- Limited to subjects on which the legislature can make laws.
- The Governor needs the President's instructions for certain ordinances, such as those that would need presidential sanction as a Bill.

Concerns about misuse

- Ordinances re-issued repeatedly without being placed before the legislature, bypassing debate.
- Use for major policy changes just before or after sessions.

Judicial checks

- R.C. Cooper (1970): the satisfaction of the President is not immune from challenge.
- 38th Amendment (1975) had made satisfaction final; the 44th Amendment (1978) removed that clause.
- D.C. Wadhwa (1987): Bihar had re-promulgated ordinances for years; the Court called this a "fraud on the Constitution".
- Krishna Kumar Singh (2017): seven judges ruled that re-promulgation is unconstitutional, that not laying an ordinance before the legislature is a serious breach, and that ordinances are subject to judicial review.

Way forward Ordinances should be rare, with reasons stated, laid on the first day of the session and never re-promulgated.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "123 for the President, 213 for the Governor; six weeks after the House returns."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say an ordinance lasts six months; it lapses six weeks after the legislature reassembles (the maximum gap is about six months plus six weeks).

GS2 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · New Public Service vs New Public Management

PREDICTED · GS2-C1

Q12. How does the "New Public Service" approach differ from New Public Management? (150 words)

Model answer

New Public Management (NPM), popular from the 1980s, treats citizens as customers and borrows from business: efficiency, performance targets, contracting out and competition.

New Public Service (NPS), proposed by Robert and Janet Denhardt around 2000, argues that government should "serve rather than steer".

Basis	NPM	NPS
Citizen	Customer	Citizen with rights
Role of officer	Manager	Facilitator, servant
Core value	Efficiency	Democracy, public interest
Method	Markets, contracts	Dialogue, collaboration
Accountability	Results	Law, values, community

Why the shift happened NPM was criticised for treating public goods like products, for weakening accountability when services were contracted out, and for ignoring equity. NPS says the public interest is built through dialogue.

Relevance to India Social audits under rural employment schemes, participatory budgeting, citizen charters and Gram Sabha consultation reflect NPS values. A blend works best: NPM tools for efficiency, NPS values for fairness and participation.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "NPM steers, NPS serves."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit NPS to Osborne and Gaebler; their Reinventing Government (1992) belongs to the NPM tradition.

GS2 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Sakala services

PREDICTED · GS2-C6 · Karnataka-specific

Q13. Assess Karnataka's Sakala scheme as a model of right to public services. What reforms can make it more effective? (250 words)

Model answer

The Karnataka Sakala Services Act, 2011 guarantees delivery of listed public services within fixed time limits. It was rolled out in 2012.

Key features

- Each service, such as caste certificates, income certificates, land record extracts and trade licences, has a stipulated time limit.
- Every application gets a unique number for tracking online or by SMS.
- Officers who delay without good reason can face a fine, and citizens can be compensated.
- An appeal goes to a competent officer.
- A Sakala mission monitors performance and ranks offices and districts.

Strengths

- Shifted the culture from "favour" to "right".
- Data on delays helps senior officers manage workloads.
- Reduced the need for middlemen.
- Covers a large number of services across departments.

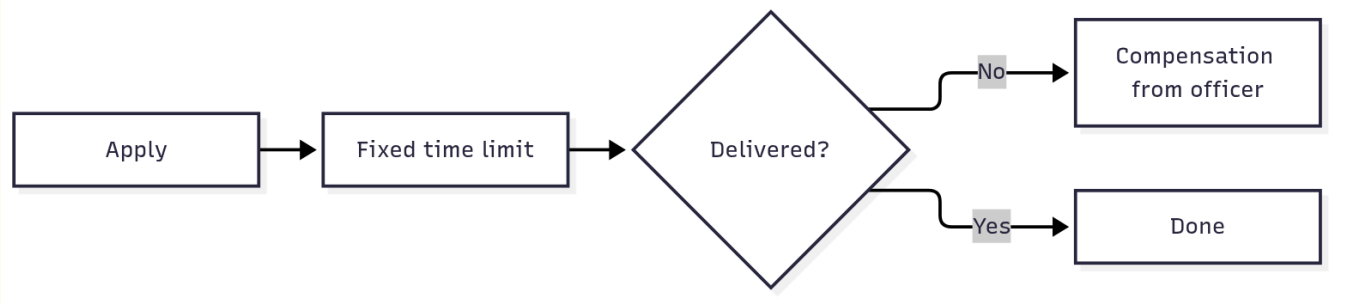
Weaknesses

- Applications are sometimes rejected to meet the deadline, then filed again.
- Penalties are rarely imposed.
- Digital access is uneven in rural areas; many citizens rely on paid agents.
- Poor integration with back-end systems in some departments.
- Low awareness among the poor.

Reforms

- Treat rejection without reasons as a deemed delay.
- Automate penalties and compensation.
- Integrate with Seva Sindhu and Grama One centres for doorstep service.
- Publish monthly scorecards and use social audits.
- Add proactive delivery: certificates issued automatically when data already exists.

Conclusion Sakala made time-bound service a citizen's right. The next step is to make it automatic, accountable and truly paperless.



DRAW IT: Sakala in four steps. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Sakala = time is a right": a number, a deadline, a fine.

COMMON TRAP: Do not confuse Sakala (time-bound service guarantee) with the RTI Act (right to information).

GS2 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Pressure belts and winds

PREDICTED · GS2-A1

Q14. Explain the global pattern of pressure belts and planetary winds. How does the shifting of these belts affect climate? (150 words)

Model answer

Unequal heating of the Earth and its rotation create alternating belts of pressure, from which planetary winds blow.

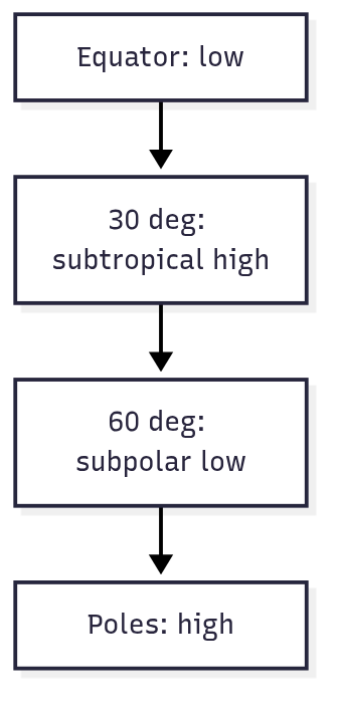
Pressure belts

- Equatorial low (about 0 to 5 degrees): rising warm air; also called the doldrums.
- Subtropical highs (about 30 degrees north and south): sinking air; the horse latitudes.
- Subpolar lows (about 60 degrees).
- Polar highs.

Planetary winds

- Trade winds: from subtropical highs to the equatorial low, north-easterly in the northern hemisphere.
- Westerlies: from subtropical highs to subpolar lows.
- Polar easterlies: from polar highs to subpolar lows. Winds are deflected by the Coriolis force, to the right in the northern hemisphere (Ferrel's law).

Shifting of belts The belts move north and south with the sun's apparent movement. This creates Mediterranean climates (dry summers, wet winters) and helps explain the onset of the Indian monsoon as the inter-tropical convergence zone moves north in summer.



DRAW IT: Pressure belts. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Low-High-Low-High from equator to pole: 0, 30, 60, 90."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say winds blow from low to high pressure; they blow from high to low.

GS2 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Constitutional supremacy

PREDICTED · GS2-B1

Q15. "India follows neither parliamentary sovereignty nor judicial supremacy, but constitutional supremacy." Discuss. (250 words)

Model answer

Parliamentary sovereignty, as in Britain, means Parliament can make or unmake any law and courts cannot strike down an Act. **Judicial supremacy**, often linked to the USA, gives courts the final word on the constitution through strong judicial review. India blends both under the supremacy of a written Constitution.

Features of parliamentary power

- Parliament can amend the Constitution under Article 368.
- Laws on Union and Concurrent lists, and powers over residuary subjects.
- Parliamentary form of government, with collective responsibility.

Features of judicial power

- Judicial review under Articles 13, 32 and 226: laws violating Fundamental Rights are void.
- The basic structure doctrine from Kesavananda Bharati (1973) limits even constitutional amendments.
- Minerva Mills (1980) held that limited amending power is itself part of the basic structure.
- I.R. Coelho (2007) extended review to laws in the Ninth Schedule after 1973.

Why "constitutional supremacy"

- Both Parliament and courts derive power from the Constitution and are bound by it.

- Courts cannot make laws; they interpret them. Parliament cannot override the basic structure.
- The NJAC judgment (2015) and the response to it show both institutions testing limits within the Constitution.

Balance in practice Courts show restraint on economic policy, while Parliament has accepted the basic structure. Dialogue between the two, through amendments, rulings and fresh laws, keeps the system flexible.

Conclusion India's Constitution, not Parliament or the courts, is supreme; each organ checks the other within its frame.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Britain = Parliament, USA = Court, India = Constitution."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not cite Golaknath as the origin of the basic structure doctrine; that was Kesavananda Bharati (1973).
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Kesavananda Bharati 1973 basic structure.

GS2: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, Residuary powers.

GS2 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · Residuary powers

PREDICTED · GS2-B3

Q16. What are residuary powers? How does the Indian position differ from that of the USA? (150 words)

Model answer

Residuary powers are powers to legislate on subjects not mentioned in any of the three lists of the Seventh Schedule.

India

- Article 248 and Entry 97 of the Union List give residuary powers, including taxation, to Parliament.
- This reflects the framers' preference for a strong Centre after Partition.
- Courts decide whether a subject is truly residuary; for example, in some tax cases the Supreme Court held that residuary power should be used only when no list entry covers the subject.

USA

- The Tenth Amendment reserves powers not delegated to the federal government to the States or the people.
- This reflects the origin of the US as a union of independent States.

Canada, like India, gives residuary powers to the Centre; **Australia**, like the USA, gives them to the States.

Significance New subjects such as cyber law or space have fallen under Union power, strengthening the Centre.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "India 248 to the Centre; USA's 10th to the States."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say residuary powers in India lie with States, as in the USA.

GS2 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · 73rd Amendment at thirty

PREDICTED · GS2-B5

Q17. Three decades after the 73rd Amendment, panchayats remain "local governments without power". Critically examine. (250 words)

Model answer

The 73rd Constitutional Amendment, 1992 (in force April 1993) gave panchayats constitutional status through Part IX and the Eleventh Schedule of 29 subjects.

What it achieved

- Regular elections every five years through State Election Commissions.
- Seats reserved for SCs and STs, and a minimum of one-third for women; Karnataka and many States now reserve 50 per cent for women.
- A three-tier structure and Gram Sabhas.
- State Finance Commissions to recommend devolution.
- Millions of elected representatives, a large share of them women.

Why "without power"

- Funds: own revenue is tiny; panchayats depend on tied grants from the Union and State.
- Functions: many States have not transferred all 29 subjects, or transferred them on paper only.
- Functionaries: staff remain controlled by line departments.
- Parallel bodies: committees and agencies run schemes outside panchayat control.
- Proxy representation: in some places women's seats are run by male relatives.
- Delays: postponed elections and uneven SFC reports.

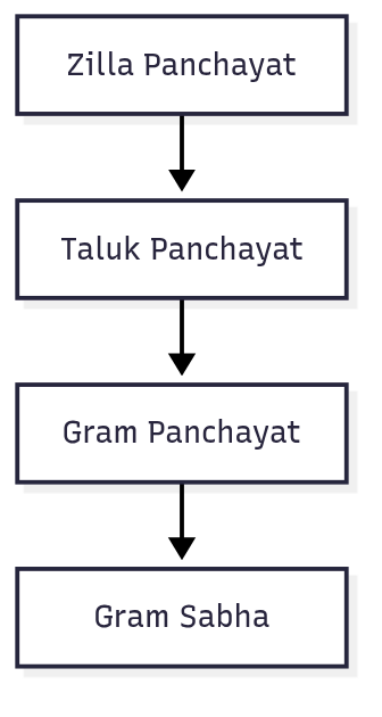
Counter view

- Kerala's people's plan campaign and Karnataka's early lead under the 1983 Act show what is possible.
- Finance Commission grants now flow directly to local bodies, and digital tools improve accountability.

Way forward

- "Activity mapping" of the 3Fs (funds, functions, functionaries).
- Untied funds and property tax powers.
- Training and a cadre of panchayat staff.
- Strengthen Gram Sabhas and social audits.

Conclusion The 73rd Amendment created the form of local government; the substance depends on States sharing power.



DRAW IT: Three tiers of panchayats. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "3Fs missing: Funds, Functions, Functionaries."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the Constitution mandates 50 per cent reservation for women; it mandates one-third, and States may go higher.

GS2 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Span of control

PREDICTED · GS2-C3

Q18. What is span of control? What factors determine the right span in a government office? (150 words)

Model answer

Span of control is the number of subordinates a superior can supervise effectively. Classical thinkers such as V.A. Graicunas showed that relationships multiply quickly as subordinates increase, and Urwick suggested a small span of about five or six at higher levels.

Factors

- Nature of work: routine, similar tasks allow a wider span; complex, varied work needs a narrower one.
- Skill of subordinates: trained, experienced staff need less supervision.
- Ability of the supervisor.
- Communication tools: e-office, dashboards and video meetings widen the possible span.
- Geographical spread: scattered field offices narrow it.
- Clarity of rules and delegation: clear procedures widen it.

Trade-off A narrow span means many levels and slow decisions; a wide span means flat structures but risks weak control. Government offices in India often have too many levels; delayering with delegation can speed service.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Narrow span, tall office; wide span, flat office."

COMMON TRAP: Do not give a single "correct" number; the right span depends on the factors.

GS2 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · Forest types of India

PREDICTED · GS2-A3

Q19. Classify the forests of India and explain their distribution. What explains the variation in forest types? (250 words)

Model answer

India's forests are usually classified, following Champion and Seth, by climate, especially rainfall and temperature.

Major types

- Tropical evergreen: areas with more than about 200 cm rainfall, such as the Western Ghats, the North-East and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands; tall, dense trees such as rosewood and ebony.
- Tropical deciduous: the most widespread type. Moist deciduous (100-200 cm) in the eastern plateau and Shivaliks, with teak and sal; dry deciduous (70-100 cm) in central India and the Deccan.
- Tropical thorn: below about 70 cm rainfall in Rajasthan, Gujarat and parts of the Deccan; acacia and cactus-like plants.
- Montane: in the Himalayas, changing with altitude from broadleaf oak and chestnut to conifers such as pine and deodar, then alpine meadows.
- Littoral and swamp: mangroves in the Sundarbans, Bhitarkanika and along the west coast.

Why types vary

- Rainfall: the chief factor, decreasing from evergreen to thorn.
- Temperature and altitude: in the mountains.
- Soil: saline tidal soils support mangroves.
- Human impact: clearing and fire can turn moist forests into drier scrub.

Karnataka Evergreen forests on the Western Ghats in Uttara Kannada and Kodagu; moist deciduous on the eastern slopes; dry deciduous and scrub on the northern plateau.

Conclusion Forest type is a climatic map drawn in trees, which also guides conservation priorities.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "200-100-70": above 200 cm evergreen, 100-200 moist deciduous, 70-100 dry deciduous, below 70 thorn.

COMMON TRAP: Do not call evergreen forests the most widespread type in India; tropical deciduous forests cover the largest area.

GS2 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Administrative tribunals

PREDICTED · GS2-C2

Q20. What are administrative tribunals? Assess their role in reducing the burden on courts. (150 words)

Model answer

Administrative tribunals are quasi-judicial bodies that decide disputes involving the government, especially service matters. The 42nd Amendment (1976) added Article 323A (service matters) and Article 323B (other matters such as taxation and land reforms).

Examples The Central Administrative Tribunal (1985), State Administrative Tribunals such as the Karnataka State Administrative Tribunal, and bodies such as the National Green Tribunal.

Benefits

- Specialised members with expertise.
- Simpler procedure and lower cost.
- Reduce the workload of High Courts.

Concerns

- L. Chandra Kumar (1997): tribunal decisions are subject to High Court review, so cases often go one more step.
- Vacancies and delays.
- Executive control over appointments; the Tribunal Reforms Act, 2021 was challenged, and the Supreme Court in Madras Bar Association (2025) struck down key parts on 19 November 2025 and ordered a National Tribunals Commission.

Conclusion Tribunals help only if they are independent, staffed and fast.

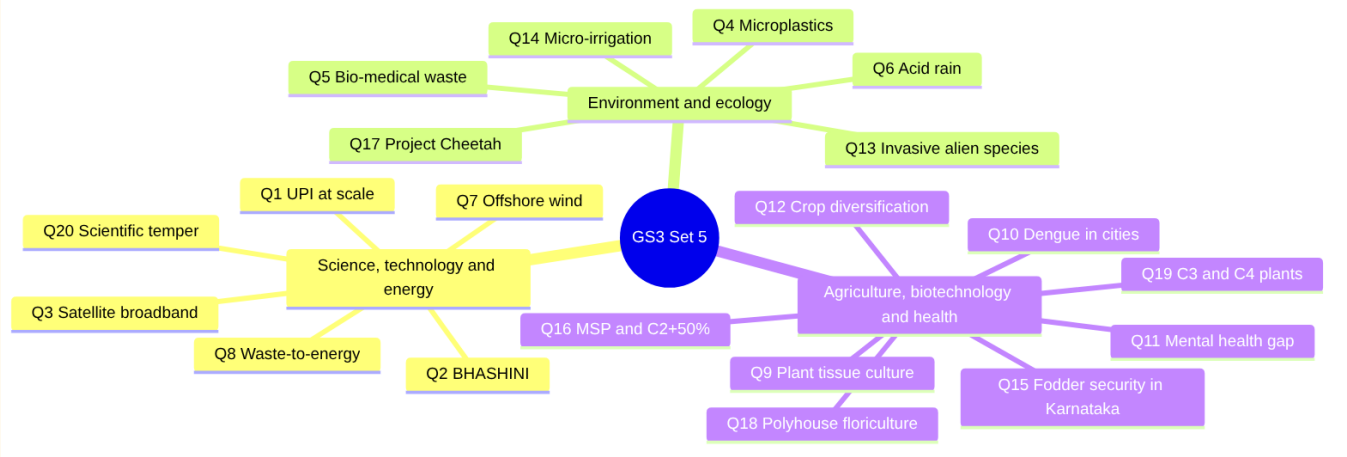
> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "323A for staff, 323B for the rest."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say tribunal decisions cannot be challenged in High Courts; L. Chandra Kumar made High Court review part of the basic structure.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** 42nd Amendment Articles 323A and 323B.
>
> **RECAP:** Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 Residuary powers:** "India 248 to the Centre; USA's 10th to the States." **Q17 73rd Amendment at thirty:** "3Fs missing: Funds, Functions, Functionaries." **Q18 Span of control:** "Narrow span, tall office; wide span, flat office." **Q19 Forest types of India:** "200-100-70": above 200 cm evergreen, 100-200 moist deciduous, 70-100 dry deciduous, below 70 thorn. **Q20 Administrative tribunals:** "323A for staff, 323B for the rest."

Paper 4: General Studies III (GS3)

Set 5: step 5 of 6 (General Studies III (GS3)). Next up: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 20 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** The science paper runs from UPI and BHASHINI to microplastics, offshore wind, dengue and C4 plants, with Karnataka's fodder and flowers. Give one fact, one risk and one fix.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS3 Q1 of 20 · 15 marks · UPI at scale

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q1. How has the Unified Payments Interface transformed payments in India? Discuss the risks that come with its scale and the steps needed to manage them. (250 words)

Model answer

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI), launched by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) in 2016, lets users send money instantly between bank accounts through a mobile phone, using a virtual address or a QR code.

Transformation

- Scale: UPI handles the large majority of India's retail digital payments by volume, running into many billions of transactions a month.
- Small merchants: a vegetable seller with a printed QR code can accept payments without a card machine.
- Low cost: zero merchant charges for most person-to-merchant UPI payments.
- Inclusion: works on basic smartphones; UPI 123PAY extends it to feature phones and UPI Lite to small offline payments.
- Interoperability: any app works with any bank, encouraging competition.
- Global reach: links with Singapore's PayNow, the UAE and France.

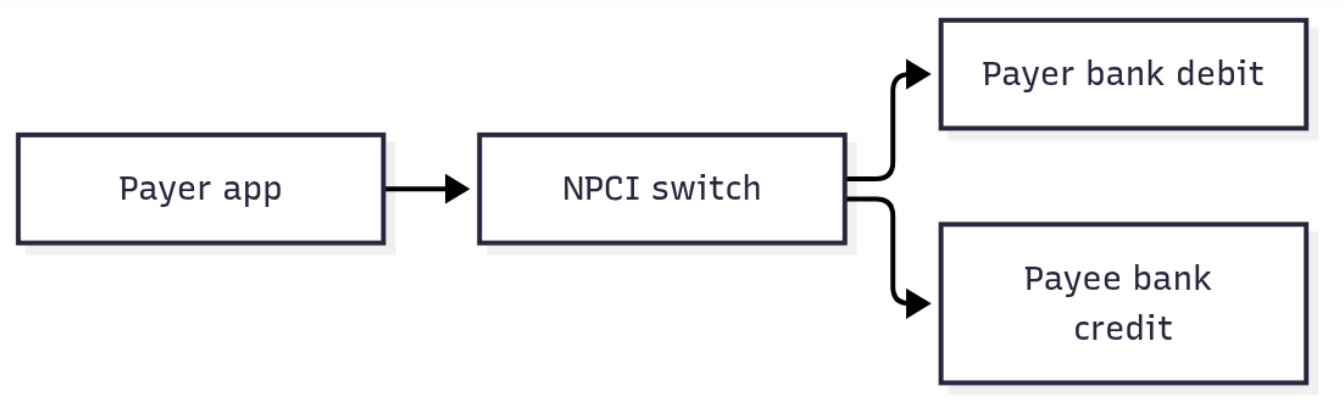
Risks

- Fraud: social engineering, fake collect requests and screen-sharing scams.
- Concentration: two private apps hold most of the market, a risk NPCI has tried to address through market-share caps whose deadline has been extended.
- Outages: a nationwide outage affects millions of daily transactions.
- Business model: with zero charges, banks and apps question how to fund the system.

Steps needed

- Real-time fraud detection using AI, and faster complaint resolution.
- Awareness campaigns in local languages.
- Strengthen backup systems and cyber resilience.
- A sustainable funding model, such as government subsidy for small merchants.
- Application of the DPDP Act, 2023 to protect user data.

Conclusion UPI is India's flagship digital public infrastructure. Its next challenge is trust: safety, resilience and fair competition.



DRAW IT: A UPI payment. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "UPI = Universal, Phone, Instant"; risks are "FCOD": Fraud, Concentration, Outage, Data.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say UPI is run by the RBI directly; it is run by NPCI under RBI regulation.

GS3 Q2 of 20 · 10 marks · BHASHINI

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q2. What is the BHASHINI mission? How can language technology narrow the digital divide? (150 words)

Model answer

BHASHINI (Bhasha Interface for India) is a National Language Translation Mission of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, launched in 2022. It builds open AI models and data sets for Indian languages: translation, speech-to-text, text-to-speech and optical character recognition.

How it narrows the divide

- Most online content is in English; citizens who read only Kannada or Odia are left out.
- Voice tools help people with low literacy use government services by speaking.
- Translation lets government portals, court judgments and health advice reach all languages.
- Open models allow start-ups and States to build local apps.

Examples of use Real-time translation at public events, multilingual chatbots for farmers and integration with government apps.

Challenges Low data availability for smaller languages and dialects, accuracy of technical terms and the need for community contributions such as the "Bhasha Daan" crowdsourcing effort.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Bhashini = Bhasha + Interface": speak, translate, read in your own language.

COMMON TRAP: Do not describe BHASHINI as a private app; it is a government mission with open platforms.

GS3 Q3 of 20 · 15 marks · Satellite broadband

PREDICTED · GS3-A1 · Current affairs

Q3. Satellite broadband is being opened up in India. Explain how it works and discuss its potential and concerns for connecting remote areas. (250 words)

Model answer

Satellite broadband delivers internet from satellites instead of cables or mobile towers. Older services used geostationary satellites about 36,000 km above the Earth, which caused delays. New services use large constellations of low Earth orbit (LEO) satellites a few hundred to about 1,200 km up, giving lower delay and higher speeds.

How it works

- A user terminal (small dish) connects to satellites passing overhead.
- Satellites relay data to ground stations (gateways) connected to the internet.
- Many satellites working together give continuous coverage.

Recent developments

- The Telecommunications Act, 2023 allows spectrum for satellite services to be assigned administratively rather than auctioned.
- Companies such as Eutelsat OneWeb, Jio-SES and Starlink have received licences, with space-sector authorisation through IN-SPACe.

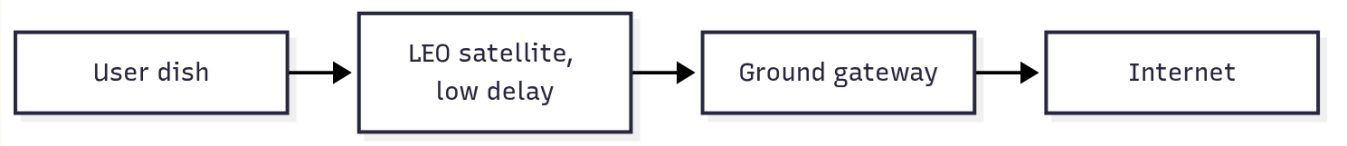
Potential

- Remote areas: hills, forests, islands and border villages where laying fibre is costly.
- Disaster resilience: works when ground networks fail in floods or cyclones.
- Services: telemedicine, online classes and e-governance in villages.
- Mobility: ships, aircraft and trains.

Concerns

- Cost: terminals and monthly plans are expensive for rural users.
- Security: data must route through Indian gateways under lawful-interception rules.
- Space debris from thousands of satellites, and impact on astronomy.
- Competition with domestic telecom operators, and fair spectrum pricing.

Way forward Use satellite links to complement BharatNet, subsidise access in hard-to-reach areas through the Digital Bharat Nidhi, and enforce security and debris rules.



DRAW IT: LEO versus GEO. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "LEO is low and quick; GEO is high and slow."

COMMON TRAP: Do not say satellite spectrum is auctioned in India; the 2023 Act provides for administrative assignment for satellite services.

GS3 Q4 of 20 · 10 marks · Microplastics

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q4. What are microplastics? Explain their sources and their effects on health and the environment. (150 words)

Model answer

Microplastics are plastic particles smaller than 5 mm. Primary microplastics are made small, such as microbeads in cosmetics and pellets. Secondary microplastics come from the breakdown of larger plastic items.

Sources

- Tyre wear and road dust.
- Synthetic clothes shedding fibres in washing.
- Breakdown of bags, bottles and fishing nets.
- Cosmetics and industrial abrasives.
- Sewage sludge spread on farmland.

Effects

- Marine life: fish and plankton swallow them, which can cause physical harm and carry toxic chemicals.
- Food chain: found in seafood, salt and drinking water.
- Human health: studies have detected them in blood and other tissues; long-term effects are still being researched.
- Soil: may affect soil structure and organisms.

Responses The ban on many single-use plastic items in India (July 2022), extended producer responsibility rules, better wastewater treatment and filters in washing machines.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Less than 5 mm: Tyres, Textiles, Trash."

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim proven specific human diseases from microplastics; say effects are under study.

GS3 Q5 of 20 · 15 marks · Bio-medical waste

PREDICTED · GS3-C4

Q5. Why is bio-medical waste a serious public health hazard? Examine the Bio-Medical Waste Management Rules, 2016 and the gaps in their implementation. (250 words)

Model answer

Bio-medical waste is waste produced during diagnosis, treatment or immunisation of humans or animals, such as dressings, needles, body parts and discarded medicines.

Why it is a hazard

- Infections such as hepatitis B and C and HIV spread through needle-stick injuries.

- Rag-pickers and sanitation workers face direct risk.
- Open burning releases dioxins and furans.
- Dumping in water bodies and landfills spreads pathogens and antimicrobial-resistant bacteria.

Rules of 2016 (amended later)

- Colour coding: yellow (anatomical and soiled waste, for incineration), red (contaminated recyclable plastic), white (sharps, in puncture-proof containers) and blue (glassware).
- Pre-treatment: lab and highly infectious waste must be disinfected on site.
- Common treatment facilities: hospitals must hand waste to authorised common facilities; a barcode system tracks bags.
- Coverage: includes vaccination camps, blood donation camps and surgical camps.
- Phase-out of chlorinated plastic bags and gloves.
- State Pollution Control Boards grant authorisations and monitor.

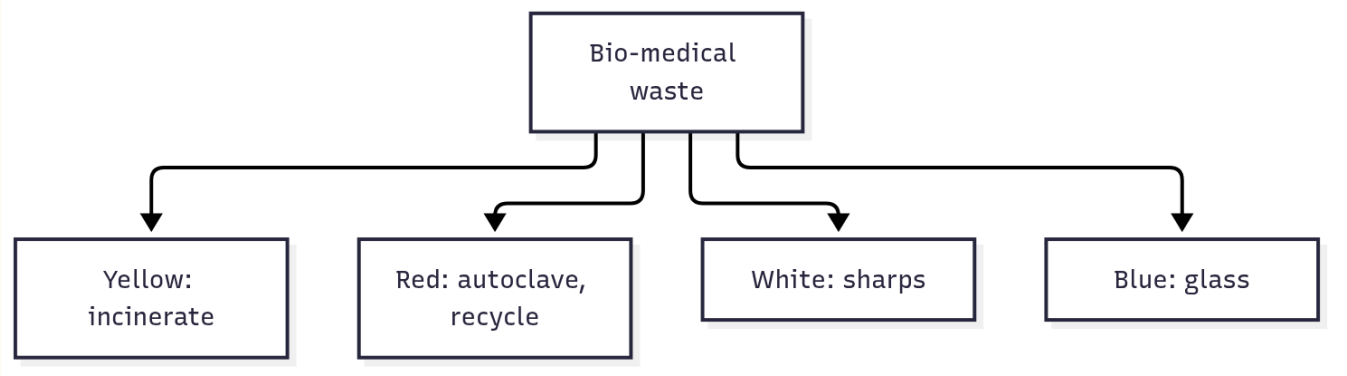
Gaps

- Poor segregation by staff in small clinics.
- Too few common facilities in some districts, leading to long transport.
- Home care and COVID-era waste overwhelmed systems.
- Weak inspections and low penalties.
- Informal recycling of syringes.

Way forward

- Training and audits for every health facility.
- Online tracking linked to licences.
- More common facilities, and safe alternatives to incineration.
- Health insurance and vaccination for waste handlers.

Conclusion Hospitals that heal must not harm. Strict segregation at source is the cheapest and most effective step.



DRAW IT: Colour codes for hospital waste. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Yellow burns, Red recycles, White sharps, Blue glass."

COMMON TRAP: Do not say all bio-medical waste should be incinerated; red-category plastics go for autoclaving and recycling.

PEAK FACT: Bio-Medical Waste Management Rules 2016 colour coding.

GS3 Q6 of 20 · 10 marks · Acid rain

PREDICTED · GS3-C5

Q6. What causes acid rain? Why is it a concern for India, even though it is often linked with Europe and North America? (150 words)

Model answer

Acid rain is rain, snow or fog with a pH below about 5.6, made acidic by sulphuric and nitric acids. It forms when sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides from burning coal, oil and vehicles react with water vapour in the atmosphere.

Effects

- Damages forests and crops by leaching nutrients from soils.
- Acidifies lakes and kills fish.
- Corrodes buildings and monuments; marble (calcium carbonate) is especially vulnerable, as concerns about the Taj Mahal from the Mathura refinery showed.
- Harms human health through fine particles formed from the same gases.

Why India should worry

- Large coal-based thermal power, steel and cement industries.
- Many thermal plants have delayed installing flue gas desulphurisation units, despite emission norms of 2015.
- Rising vehicle numbers.

Response FGD units, cleaner fuels under BS-VI norms and a shift to renewable power.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "SOx and NOx make rain sour."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say carbon dioxide is the main cause of acid rain; it is sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides.

GS3 Q7 of 20 · 15 marks · Offshore wind

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q7. India has set a target for offshore wind energy. Discuss the potential, the advantages over onshore wind and the challenges of developing offshore wind farms. (250 words)

Model answer

Offshore wind farms are wind turbines installed in the sea, usually on the continental shelf, where winds are stronger and steadier than on land.

India's potential

- A long coastline of about 7,500 km.
- The best sites identified so far are off Gujarat and Tamil Nadu, where studies by the National Institute of Wind Energy found strong winds.
- The government has set a goal of 30 GW of offshore wind by 2030 and a scheme of viability gap funding for the first 1 GW, approved in 2024.

Advantages over onshore wind

- Higher and more consistent wind speeds give a higher capacity factor.
- No competition for scarce land.

- Larger turbines possible.
- Close to coastal cities and industrial demand.

Challenges

- Cost: foundations, undersea cables and installation vessels make it far costlier than onshore wind; the first 500 MW tender off Gujarat drew no bids.
- Technology: dependence on imported turbines and specialised ports.
- Environment: effects on fish, fishermen's livelihoods, birds and marine mammals.
- Weather: cyclones on India's coasts.
- Grid: offshore substations and evacuation lines.
- Approvals: coastal regulation and marine planning.

Way forward

- Develop port infrastructure and local manufacturing.
- Marine spatial planning with fishing communities.
- Long-term power purchase agreements and green hydrogen links to use the power.
- Learn from Europe, where costs fell sharply as the industry grew.

Conclusion Offshore wind can add clean, steady power for coastal India if early costs are shared and fishers are partners.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Offshore = Steadier wind, Spare land, Steeper cost."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say Karnataka's coast is the leading offshore wind site; studies point first to Gujarat and Tamil Nadu.

GS3 Q8 of 20 · 10 marks · Waste-to-energy

PREDICTED · GS3-A3

Q8. Can waste-to-energy plants solve India's urban waste problem? Examine. (150 words)

Model answer

Waste-to-energy (WtE) plants turn municipal solid waste into electricity or fuel through incineration, gasification, biomethanation or refuse-derived fuel (RDF).

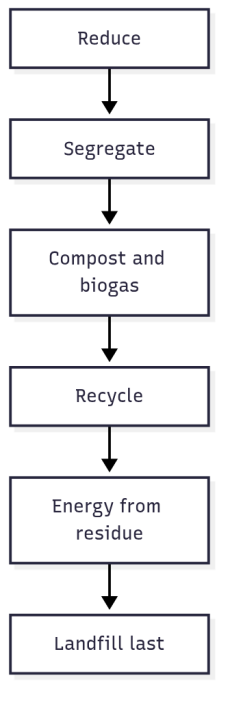
Benefits

- Reduce the volume of waste going to landfills.
- Generate power and, through biogas, cooking or transport fuel.
- Can use legacy waste from old dumps after processing.

Problems in India

- Indian waste is wet and has a low calorific value, as it is rich in food scraps; incinerators often need extra fuel.
- Poor segregation at source.
- Several plants have run below capacity or shut down.
- Emissions of dioxins and fine particles if controls are weak, provoking local protests.
- Power from WtE is costlier than solar.

Better approach Follow the waste hierarchy: reduce, segregate, compost and biomethanate wet waste, recycle dry waste and send only non-recyclable, high-calorific residue to RDF or WtE. Bengaluru's dry waste collection centres show the value of segregation first.



DRAW IT: The waste hierarchy. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Wet waste won't burn well": compost the wet, burn only the dry residue.

COMMON TRAP: Do not present WtE as the first solution; it comes near the bottom of the waste hierarchy.

GS3 Q9 of 20 · 15 marks · Plant tissue culture

PREDICTED · GS3-B4

Q9. What is plant tissue culture? Explain its applications in agriculture and forestry, with Indian examples. (250 words)

Model answer

Plant tissue culture is the growth of plant cells, tissues or organs on a nutrient medium in sterile, controlled conditions. It relies on totipotency, the ability of a single plant cell to grow into a whole plant.

Main techniques

- Micropropagation: producing many identical plantlets from a small piece of tissue.
- Meristem culture: using the virus-free growing tip to produce disease-free plants.
- Embryo rescue: growing hybrid embryos that would otherwise die.
- Somaclonal variation: using natural variation in culture to select new traits.
- Germplasm conservation: storing tissues at very low temperatures (cryopreservation).

Applications

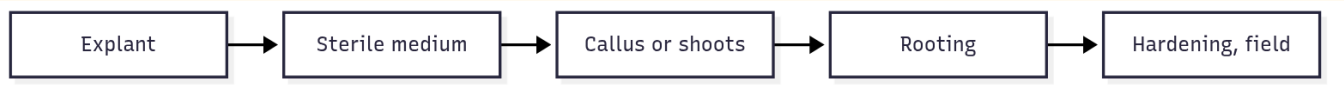
- Banana: tissue-cultured Grand Naine plantlets are widely used, giving uniform, disease-free crops.
- Sugarcane and potato: virus-free seed material.
- Horticulture and floriculture: orchids, gerberas and carnations for export; Karnataka's floriculture units use such plantlets.
- Forestry: teak, bamboo and eucalyptus for plantations; bamboo, which flowers rarely, is multiplied rapidly.
- Medicinal plants: conserving endangered species.

Indian support The Department of Biotechnology's National Certification System for Tissue Culture Raised Plants (NCS-TCP) certifies labs and plantlets for quality.

Limits

- Cost of labs and skilled staff.
- Genetic uniformity can make crops vulnerable to new diseases.
- Contamination risks.

Conclusion Tissue culture is a "plant photocopier" that gives farmers healthy, uniform planting material fast. Combined with certification and diversity, it can raise yields and incomes.



DRAW IT: The plant photocopier. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Totipotency = one cell, whole plant"; tissue culture is the "plant photocopier".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse tissue culture with genetic modification; tissue culture copies a plant, it does not insert foreign genes.

GS3 Q10 of 20 · 10 marks · Dengue in cities

PREDICTED · GS3-B7

Q10. Why does dengue remain a persistent public health challenge in Indian cities? Suggest measures for its control. (150 words)

Model answer

Dengue is a viral disease spread by the Aedes aegypti mosquito, which bites during the day and breeds in clean, stagnant water. There are four virus types, and a second infection with a different type can cause severe dengue.

Why it persists

- Urban breeding: water in coolers, tyres, flower pots, construction sites and overhead tanks.
- Climate: warmer temperatures and erratic rain expand the mosquito's range and season.
- Rapid urbanisation with poor drainage and solid waste management.
- No specific drug, and vaccines are still being developed or tested in India.
- Under-reporting by private clinics.

Control measures

- Source reduction: weekly "dry day" campaigns to empty containers.
- Larvicides and guppy fish in tanks.
- Building by-laws for construction sites.
- Early diagnosis and platelet monitoring in hospitals.
- Community participation through ward committees and schools.

Bengaluru's yearly spikes after monsoon showers show the need for steady, not seasonal, action.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Aedes = Day biter, clean-water breeder."

COMMON TRAP: Do not say dengue spreads through Anopheles; that is the malaria vector.

PEAK FACT: Aedes aegypti day biter; four serotypes.

GS3: 10 of 20 done. Next up: Q11, Mental health gap.

GS3 Q11 of 20 · 15 marks · Mental health gap

PREDICTED · GS3-B7

Q11. India faces a large treatment gap in mental health. Discuss the causes and evaluate the role of the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017 and Tele-MANAS. (250 words)

Model answer

The National Mental Health Survey 2015-16 estimated that about one in ten adults had a mental disorder needing care, and that the treatment gap for many conditions was over 70 per cent.

Causes of the gap

- Stigma: mental illness is hidden or seen as weakness or spirit possession.
- Few professionals: very low numbers of psychiatrists, psychologists and psychiatric nurses per lakh people.
- Urban concentration of services.
- Low budget: mental health gets a tiny share of health spending.
- Lack of awareness of symptoms of depression and anxiety.

Mental Healthcare Act, 2017

- Makes access to mental health care a right, funded or provided by the government.
- Decriminalises attempted suicide: a person attempting suicide is presumed to be under severe stress and should not be punished.
- Allows advance directives and nominated representatives.
- Protects against inhuman treatment; restricts electroconvulsive therapy without anaesthesia.
- Mental health review boards to protect rights.

Tele-MANAS Launched in October 2022, it is a 24x7 tele-mental health helpline (14416) in many languages, with NIMHANS in Bengaluru as a nodal centre. It offers counselling and referral to specialists.

Assessment The Act is progressive, but review boards and services are thin in many States. Tele-MANAS widens reach but needs links to local follow-up care.

Way forward Train primary health workers, add counsellors in schools and colleges, integrate mental health into Ayushman Arogya Mandirs and increase budgets.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Ten per cent ill, seventy per cent untreated; dial 14416."

COMMON TRAP: Do not say attempted suicide is still punished under the law; the 2017 Act presumes severe stress, and the BNS has no section like IPC 309.

GS3 Q12 of 20 · 10 marks · Crop diversification

PREDICTED · GS3-B2

Q12. Why is crop diversification important for Indian agriculture? What prevents farmers from diversifying? (150 words)

Model answer

Crop diversification means growing a wider mix of crops, or shifting from low-value cereals to higher-value crops such as pulses, oilseeds, fruits, vegetables and millets.

Importance

- Soil and water: paddy-wheat cycles in Punjab and Haryana have depleted groundwater; pulses fix nitrogen.
- Risk: a mix of crops reduces the loss from one crop failure or price fall.
- Nutrition: more pulses, millets and vegetables in diets.
- Income: horticulture and dairy give higher returns per hectare.
- Climate resilience: drought-tolerant crops suit rainfed areas.

Barriers

- Assured procurement at MSP for rice and wheat makes them safer.
- Weak markets and storage for perishables.
- Lack of quality seed and extension advice.
- Small holdings and credit constraints.
- Power and water subsidies that favour water-intensive crops.

Solutions Price support and procurement for pulses and millets, crop-neutral incentives, FPOs for marketing and cold chains.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Diversify to Defend: soil, risk, nutrition, income."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not blame farmers' choices alone; procurement and subsidies shape the cropping pattern.

GS3 Q13 of 20 · 15 marks · Invasive alien species

PREDICTED · GS3-C3

Q13. Invasive alien species are among the leading threats to biodiversity. Explain with examples from India, including the Western Ghats, and suggest control measures. (250 words)

Model answer

Invasive alien species are plants, animals or microbes introduced, by accident or design, outside their natural range, where they spread rapidly and harm native species and ecosystems.

Why they succeed

- No natural predators or diseases in the new area.
- Fast growth and reproduction.
- Disturbed habitats that favour them.

Indian examples

- Lantana camara: brought as an ornamental, it now covers large areas of forest, including the Western Ghats and tiger reserves such as Bandipur and Nagarahole, suppressing grasses that herbivores eat.
- Prosopis juliflora: spreads across dry lands in Gujarat, Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu, drying out grasslands such as Banni.
- Water hyacinth: chokes lakes and rivers, including Bengaluru's lakes.
- Parthenium (congress grass): causes allergies and crop losses.
- Senna spectabilis in the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve.
- African catfish in rivers, preying on native fish.

Impacts

- Loss of native biodiversity and fodder for wildlife.
- Higher fire risk in Lantana-infested forests.
- Economic losses in agriculture and fisheries.

Control measures

- Prevention: quarantine checks under plant and animal import rules.
- Mechanical removal: cut-rootstock method for Lantana, followed by planting native grasses.
- Biological control: weevils for water hyacinth.
- Use: Lantana furniture and crafts, which create local jobs.
- Policy: Target 6 of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework seeks to cut the rate of new invasions by half by 2030.

Conclusion Invasives are a slow-moving disaster. Early detection and community-based removal are cheaper than late action.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "LPW-P": Lantana, Prosopis, Water hyacinth, Parthenium, the "invasive four".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call every non-native species invasive; only those that spread and cause harm are invasive.

GS3 Q14 of 20 · 10 marks · Micro-irrigation

PREDICTED · GS3-C2

Q14. How can micro-irrigation improve water-use efficiency in Indian agriculture? What limits its adoption? (150 words)

Model answer

Micro-irrigation delivers water directly to the root zone of plants through drip or sprinkler systems, rather than flooding the field.

Benefits

- Water savings of roughly 30 to 50 per cent, according to many field studies, compared with flood irrigation.
- Higher yields and better quality produce.
- Fertilisers can be given with water (fertigation), reducing waste.
- Less weed growth and soil erosion.
- Energy savings in pumping.

Policy support "Per Drop More Crop" under PMKSY gives subsidies; Karnataka gives high subsidies for drip and sprinkler for small farmers.

Limits

- High upfront cost and delays in subsidy release.
- Small, fragmented plots.
- Free or flat-rate electricity reduces the incentive to save water.
- Clogging and poor maintenance.
- Suitability mainly for horticulture and row crops, not for paddy.

Way forward Group schemes through FPOs, pricing reforms for power and water, and training.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Drip = drop at the root."

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim drip suits all crops equally; it is best for orchards, vegetables, sugarcane and row crops.

GS3 Q15 of 20 · 15 marks · Fodder security in Karnataka

PREDICTED · GS3-B5 · Karnataka-specific

Q15. Fodder shortage is a growing constraint on Karnataka's dairy and livestock sector. Examine its causes and suggest a fodder security strategy. (250 words)

Model answer

Livestock, especially dairy, is a major source of income for small and marginal farmers in Karnataka, and milk production through cooperative unions under the Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF) is among the highest in India. Yet animals often lack enough green fodder, dry fodder and concentrates.

Causes of shortage

- Shrinking grazing land: common lands (gomala) and village pastures have been encroached or diverted.
- Cropping changes: shift from cereals such as ragi and jowar, whose straw is valuable fodder, to commercial crops.
- Drought: frequent droughts in north Karnataka cut fodder supply sharply.
- Burning and waste of residues.
- Rising herd quality: crossbred cows need more and better feed.
- High feed prices.

Effects

- Low milk yields per animal.
- Distress sale of cattle in drought years.
- Pressure on forests from grazing.

Fodder security strategy

- Fodder banks: drought-time fodder depots and fodder kits for farmers, as Karnataka issues during droughts.
- Fodder crops: high-yielding varieties of napier grass, maize and cowpea on part of farm land.
- Silage and hay: training farmers and SHGs to preserve green fodder.
- Commons: restore gomala lands and village pastures with community management.
- Crop residues: chaff cutters, baling and enrichment with urea or molasses.
- Agroforestry: fodder trees such as subabul and agase on farm boundaries.
- Data: district fodder balance sheets to plan ahead.

Conclusion Milk flows from fodder. A State-wide fodder plan is as important as milk prices for Karnataka's dairy farmers.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "No fodder, no milk": Banks, Crops, Silage, Commons, Residues, Trees.

COMMON TRAP: Do not reduce the answer to milk prices or breeds; the question is about feed supply.

PEAK FACT: KMF cooperative network Karnataka.

GS3: 15 of 20 done. Next up: Q16, MSP and C2+50%.

GS3 Q16 of 20 · 10 marks · MSP and C2+50%

PREDICTED · GS3-B6

Q16. What is the "C2 + 50 per cent" formula for MSP? Why is legal guarantee of MSP debated? (150 words)

Model answer

The National Commission on Farmers, chaired by M.S. Swaminathan (2004-06), recommended that MSP should be at least 50 per cent above the weighted average cost of production.

Cost concepts used by CACP

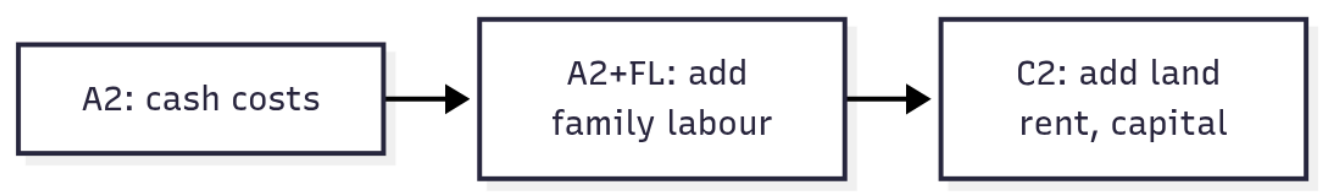
- A2: paid-out costs such as seed, fertiliser, hired labour.
- A2 + FL: adds imputed value of family labour.
- C2: comprehensive cost, also including rent on owned land and interest on owned capital.

Since 2018-19 the government has fixed MSPs at no less than one and a half times A2 + FL. Farmer groups demand 1.5 times C2.

Legal guarantee debate

- For: assured income, reduced distress sales and protection from price crashes.
- Against: heavy fiscal cost, distortion of cropping patterns, WTO subsidy limits and difficulty of buying all produce.

Middle path Price deficiency payments (as in Madhya Pradesh's Bhavantar) and better procurement for pulses and oilseeds.



DRAW IT: Three cost lines. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "A2 = cash, FL = family, C2 = complete."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say the government already pays C2 + 50 per cent; it uses A2 + FL.

GS3 Q17 of 20 · 15 marks · Project Cheetah

PREDICTED · GS3-C1

Q17. Evaluate Project Cheetah as an exercise in species reintroduction. What lessons does it offer for wildlife conservation in India? (250 words)

Model answer

The cheetah was declared extinct in India in 1952. Project Cheetah, launched on 17 September 2022, brought cheetahs from Namibia and later South Africa to Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh, the first intercontinental translocation of a large carnivore.

Aims

- Restore a lost top predator and the dry grassland and savannah ecosystems it represents.

- Use the cheetah as a flagship to conserve grasslands, often neglected and wrongly classified as "wastelands".
- Eco-tourism and local livelihoods.

Progress

- Cheetah cubs have been born in India, and some animals have been released into the wild.
- A second site, Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary in Madhya Pradesh, has been prepared, with more sites planned.

Problems

- Mortality: several adult cheetahs and cubs died from causes such as infections linked to a thick winter coat, heat and fights.
- Space: Kuno may be too small for a large free-ranging population; cheetahs have strayed into villages.
- Prey base and competition with leopards.
- Science and transparency: experts questioned site choice and the lack of open data.
- Cost compared with saving existing threatened species such as the great Indian bustard.

Lessons

- Reintroduction needs large connected habitats and long-term commitment.
- Local communities must be partners, not bystanders.
- Independent scientific monitoring and publication of data.
- Grassland policy must follow the flagship species.

Conclusion Project Cheetah is a bold experiment. Its success will be judged not by the number of animals released but by whether a self-sustaining wild population and healthy grasslands emerge.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "1952 gone, 2022 Kuno": extinct in 1952, back at Kuno on 17 September 2022.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not call Project Cheetah a reintroduction of the Asiatic cheetah; the animals are African cheetahs.

GS3 Q18 of 20 · 10 marks · Polyhouse floriculture

PREDICTED · GS3-B3 · Karnataka-specific

Q18. How has polyhouse cultivation changed floriculture in Karnataka? What are its limitations? (150 words)

Model answer

A polyhouse is a structure covered with plastic film that controls temperature, humidity and light, allowing crops to be grown under protected conditions.

Change in floriculture

- Bengaluru's mild climate, airport and markets made the region a hub for cut flowers such as roses, gerberas and carnations grown in polyhouses.
- Higher yields, quality suited to export markets and year-round production.
- The International Flower Auction Bengaluru at Hebbal offers a transparent auction platform.
- Subsidies under the Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture and State schemes reduced setup costs.

Limitations

- High cost: construction, fertigation and climate control.
- Disease build-up: soil-borne pests and nematodes in continuous cropping.
- Market risk: prices fall sharply after festivals and wedding seasons.
- Skill gaps in managing nutrients and climate.
- Plastic waste when film is replaced.

Way forward Cold chains, FPO-based marketing and training through horticulture universities such as UHS Bagalkot.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Poly roof, flower proof": a plastic roof gives flowers quality all year.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse a polyhouse (plastic-covered) with a shade net house (net-covered).

GS3 Q19 of 20 · 15 marks · C3 and C4 plants

PREDICTED · GS3-B1

Q19. Distinguish between C3 and C4 plants. Why is the C4 pathway seen as important for food security in a warming world? (250 words)

Model answer

Photosynthesis converts carbon dioxide and water into sugars using sunlight. Plants differ in how they first fix carbon dioxide.

C3 plants

- The first stable product is a three-carbon compound (3-phosphoglycerate), formed by the enzyme RuBisCO.
- Examples: rice, wheat, soybean, most trees.
- In hot, dry conditions, stomata close and RuBisCO starts binding oxygen instead of carbon dioxide. This wasteful process, photorespiration, can reduce photosynthesis sharply.

C4 plants

- The first product is a four-carbon compound (oxaloacetate), formed in mesophyll cells by the enzyme PEP carboxylase.
- Carbon dioxide is then concentrated in bundle sheath cells, around RuBisCO, which has a special "Kranz" (wreath) anatomy.
- Photorespiration is almost eliminated.
- Examples: maize, sugarcane, sorghum, many millets.

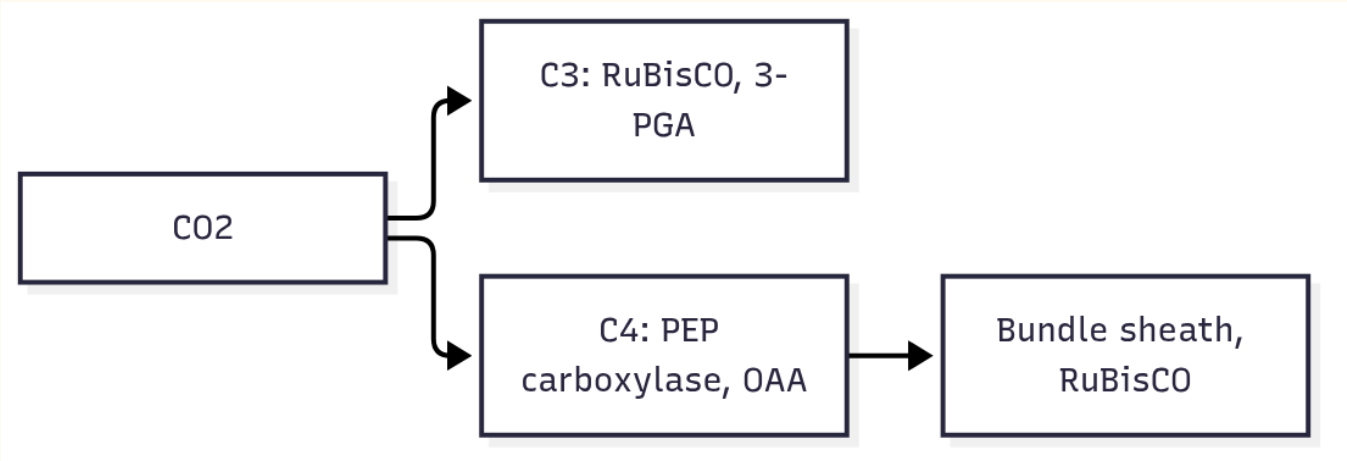
Feature	C3	C4
First product	3-carbon	4-carbon
Photorespiration	High in heat	Very low
Water use	Higher	Lower
Best in	Cool, moist	Hot, sunny, dry

Importance for food security

- C4 crops use water and nitrogen more efficiently, suiting hotter, drier climates.
- Millets, celebrated globally in 2023 as the UN millet year, are C4 and climate-hardy.
- Scientists are working on "C4 rice" to raise rice yields.

Caution C4 traits are complex to transfer; engineering them into rice has taken decades of research. Rising carbon dioxide levels may benefit C3 plants more, so both pathways matter.

Conclusion C4 plants show how nature adapted to heat. Their traits, and a larger place for millets, sorghum and maize in diets and procurement, can help Indian farming face a warmer future.



DRAW IT: C3 versus C4. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "C4 = Corn, Cane, Cereals of the poor (millets)"; "Kranz = wreath".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say C4 plants have no RuBisCO; they have it, but concentrate carbon dioxide around it.

GS3 Q20 of 20 · 10 marks · Scientific temper

PREDICTED · GS3-A5

Q20. What is scientific temper? Why does the Constitution include it as a fundamental duty, and how can it be promoted? (150 words)

Model answer

Scientific temper means approaching questions with reason, evidence and an open mind, and being willing to change views when new evidence appears. Jawaharlal Nehru used the term in The Discovery of India.

Constitutional basis Article 51A(h), inserted in 1976 through the 42nd Amendment, makes it a fundamental duty "to develop the scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry and reform".

Why it matters

- Fights superstition, such as witch-hunting and harmful practices.
- Helps citizens judge health claims and misinformation online.
- Supports innovation and democratic debate.

Promotion

- Inquiry-based teaching, science fairs and the National Science Day (28 February).
- Laws against harmful superstitions, such as Karnataka's anti-superstition Act of 2017.
- Science communication in local languages.
- Fact-checking and media literacy.

Scientific temper is not hostility to culture; it is the habit of asking "how do we know?"

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "51A(h) = how do we know?"

COMMON TRAP: Do not say scientific temper was in the original Constitution of 1950; it came with the 42nd Amendment in 1976.

PEAK FACT: Article 51A(h) 42nd Amendment 1976.

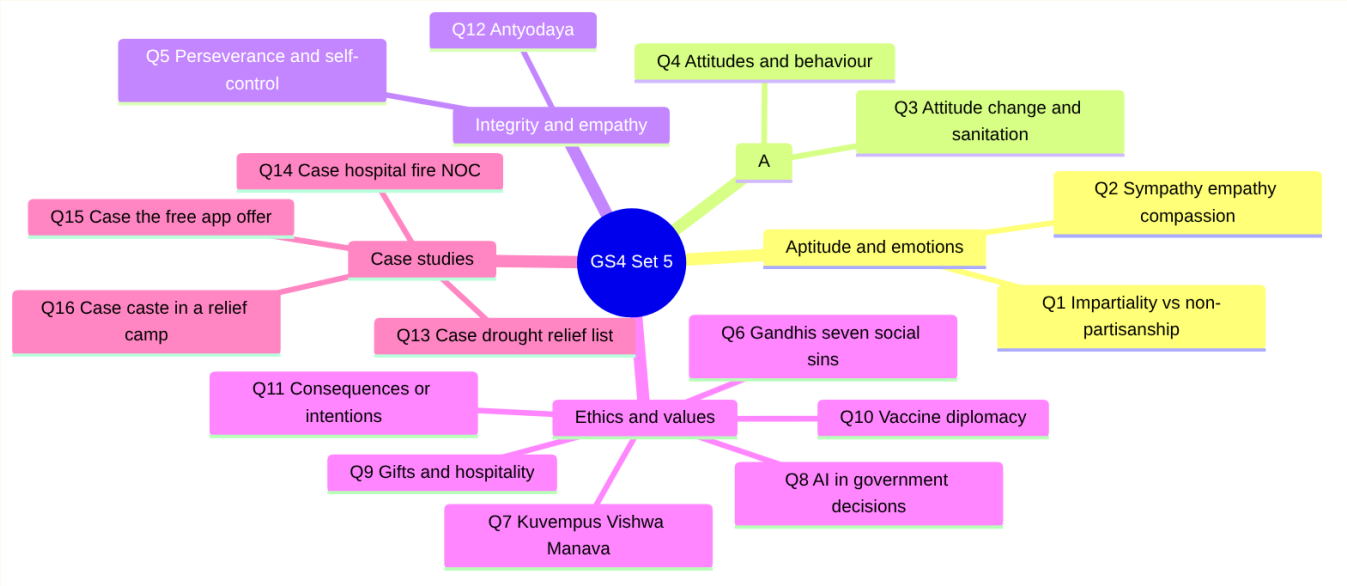
RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q16 MSP and C2+50%:** "A2 = cash, FL = family, C2 = complete." **Q17 Project Cheetah:** "1952 gone, 2022 Kuno": extinct in 1952, back at Kuno on 17 September 2022. **Q18 Polyhouse floriculture:** "Poly roof, flower proof": a plastic roof gives flowers quality all year. **Q19 C3 and C4 plants:** "C4 = Corn, Cane, Cereals of the poor (millets)"; "Kranz = wreath". **Q20 Scientific temper:** "51A(h) = how do we know?"

Paper 5: General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)

Set 5: step 6 of 6 (General Studies IV (GS4, Ethics)). Next up: Kannada and English practice

Time: 3 hours | **Marks:** 250 | **Questions:** 16 (word limits as printed)

> **CHAI-TALK:** The ethics paper tests the inner compass: impartiality, empathy, attitude change and Kuvempu's universal human. In the cases, pay the eligible, protect the weak and write down your reasons.



Mind map of the paper: what this set covers.

GS4 Q1 of 16 · 20 marks · Impartiality vs non-partisanship

PREDICTED · GS4-T3

Q1. Distinguish between impartiality and non-partisanship in the civil services. Why are both necessary, and how are they tested in practice? (300 words)

Model answer

Meaning

- Impartiality means treating every person and case on merit, without favour or prejudice based on caste, religion, wealth, gender or personal ties. It concerns how an officer decides.
- Non-partisanship means not being aligned with any political party, and serving whichever government is elected with equal loyalty and frankness. It concerns the officer's relationship with politics.

Difference with an example A tahsildar who issues caste certificates quickly to his own community but delays others is not impartial, even if he belongs to no party. An officer who campaigns quietly for a ruling party but processes files fairly is not non-partisan. One can fail one test and pass the other.

Why both are needed

- Rule of law: Article 14 requires equal treatment; impartiality makes it real at the counter.
- Continuity: governments change every five years, but the administration must be trusted by all.
- Frank advice: a non-partisan officer can tell a minister an inconvenient truth.
- Public trust: citizens accept even an unfavourable decision if they believe it was fair.
- Conduct rules: the AIS conduct code of 1968 and State rules bar officers from politics.

How they are tested

- During elections, when officers are under the Election Commission and must ignore pressure from all sides.
- In transfers and postings used to reward or punish.
- In social media posts expressing political views.
- In law and order situations involving rival groups.
- In allocation of welfare benefits before elections.

Strengthening them

- Fixed tenures, as directed in T.S.R. Subramanian v. Union of India (2013), and Civil Services Boards for transfers.
- Clear written orders for every instruction.
- Training on unconscious bias.

Conclusion Impartiality is fairness to citizens; non-partisanship is fairness to governments. Together they make the civil service a trustworthy referee rather than a player.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Impartial = fair to People; Non-partisan = fair to Parties."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not treat the two as synonyms; give an example where an officer passes one test and fails the other.

GS4 Q2 of 16 · 20 marks · Sympathy, empathy, compassion

PREDICTED · GS4-T2

Q2. "Sympathy feels for others; empathy feels with them." Explain the difference and discuss why empathy is a core value for a public servant. Can empathy ever mislead? (300 words)

Model answer

Difference

- Sympathy is feeling sorry for someone's suffering from the outside. It can create distance: "poor people, I pity them."
- Empathy is understanding a person's feelings and situation as if from inside, while remaining aware that one is separate. It asks "what would this feel like for me, and what do they need?"
- Compassion goes a step further, adding the desire to act to relieve suffering.

Example An officer who says "it is sad that the farmer lost his crop" shows sympathy. An officer who visits the field, understands that the farmer cannot wait three months for compensation and fast-tracks the first instalment shows empathy turned into compassion.

Why empathy matters in public service

- Better policy design: understanding how a widow struggles with online forms leads to assisted service counters.
- Dignity: citizens feel heard, which builds trust.
- Conflict resolution: understanding the fears of protesting groups helps negotiation.
- Weaker sections: Gandhi's talisman, picturing the weakest person you have seen, is empathy in action.
- Prevention of cruelty: empathy checks the use of power in police stations and prisons.

Can empathy mislead? Yes, if unchecked.

- Bias: we feel more empathy for people like ourselves, which can make decisions partial.
- Identifiable victim effect: one visible case can draw resources away from larger, invisible needs.

- Emotional burnout among officers who absorb suffering daily.
- Manipulation: emotional appeals may be used to bend rules.

Balancing it Empathy must be joined with reason, rules and fairness. Psychologists describe "cognitive empathy", understanding without being overwhelmed, as useful for professionals. Data on overall needs should balance individual stories, and supervisors should watch for staff burnout through rotation and counselling.

Conclusion Sympathy is a feeling; empathy is understanding; compassion is action. A good administrator uses empathy to see clearly and impartiality to decide fairly.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Sympathy = for; Empathy = with; Compassion = act."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not present empathy as purely positive; examiners reward the answer that notes its limits.

GS4 Q3 of 16 · 20 marks · Attitude change and sanitation

PREDICTED · GS4-A1

Q3. How can attitudes be changed to support public goals? Discuss with reference to sanitation campaigns, using the ideas of persuasion and social influence. (300 words)

Model answer

An attitude is a learned tendency to evaluate an object, person or idea favourably or unfavourably. It has three parts: what we feel (affective), what we do (behavioural) and what we believe (cognitive).

Why sanitation needed attitude change Building toilets was not enough; many people believed open defecation was cleaner or traditional, and toilets were used for storage. Behaviour change required changing beliefs, feelings and social norms.

Tools of attitude change

- Persuasive communication: the source (credible and liked), message (clear, emotional and factual) and audience (local language and culture). Film stars, cricketers and local leaders were used as messengers.
- Social norms: people follow what neighbours do. Declaring villages "ODF" (open defecation free) and celebrating them created pride and peer pressure.
- Cognitive dissonance: when people's actions contradict their beliefs, they feel uneasy and change one of them. Pledges and public commitments made people act in line with what they said.
- Emotional appeals: messages about the dignity and safety of women, and about children's health.
- Community-led total sanitation: "triggering" exercises where villagers mapped open defecation spots, creating disgust and a collective decision to change.
- Incentives: financial support for building toilets, linked to use.
- Nudges: making the desired choice easy, such as placing toilets near homes.

Limits

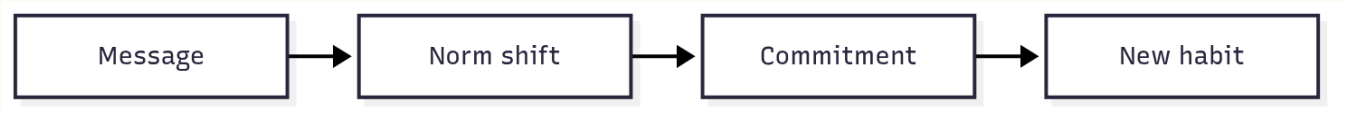
- Coercion, such as shaming or denying benefits, may produce compliance but not genuine attitude change, and violates dignity.
- Slippage back to old habits where water and maintenance are lacking.
- Caste prejudices about cleaning pits.

Lessons

- Combine infrastructure with persuasion.
- Use trusted local messengers, including women's self-help groups.

- Sustain change through follow-up, water supply and safe pit-emptying.

Conclusion Lasting change happens when people move from "I must" to "I want". Persuasion and social norms, not force, create that shift.



DRAW IT: From must to want. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "ABC of attitude = Affect, Behaviour, Cognition"; change it with "Source, Message, Norm".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not equate behaviour change through fines with attitude change; compliance is not internalisation.

GS4 Q4 of 16 · 15 marks · Attitudes and behaviour

PREDICTED · GS4-A1

Q4. Do attitudes always predict behaviour? Discuss with examples and explain what this means for policy. (250 words)

Model answer

Common sense says that if we know someone's attitude, we can predict their actions. Research shows the link is weaker than expected.

Classic evidence In the 1930s, the sociologist Richard LaPiere travelled across the United States with a Chinese couple, at a time of strong prejudice. They were refused service only once in over 250 places. Yet when he later wrote to the same establishments asking if they would serve Chinese guests, most said no. Stated attitudes did not match actual behaviour.

Why the gap exists

- Situational pressure: social norms, the presence of others or fear of conflict.
- General versus specific: a general attitude ("I care about the environment") predicts general patterns, not specific acts (carrying a cloth bag today).
- Habits: people act out of routine.
- Costs and convenience: people may value saving water but not fix a leaking tap.
- Weak or untested attitudes.

When attitudes predict well

- When they are strong, specific and based on direct experience.
- When people are self-aware and the behaviour is under their control.
- The theory of planned behaviour adds subjective norms and perceived control to attitudes.

Implications for policy

- Surveys of stated support are not enough; observe behaviour.
- Change the situation, not only the mind: make the desired action easy, cheap and normal.
- Use commitments and reminders.

Conclusion The gap between "saying" and "doing" is why good policy designs choices, not just slogans.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "LaPiere: served in person, refused on paper."

COMMON TRAP: Do not claim attitudes never predict behaviour; say they predict it under specific conditions.

GS4 Q5 of 16 · 15 marks · Perseverance and self-control

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q5. "Talent opens doors; perseverance keeps them open." Discuss the role of perseverance and self-control in public service. (250 words)

Model answer

Meaning

- Perseverance is sustained effort towards a goal in spite of difficulties, failures and delays.
- Self-control is the ability to manage impulses, emotions and desires to act in line with long-term goals and values.

Why they matter in public service

- Slow results: reforms such as land record digitisation or reducing infant mortality take years. Without perseverance, officers give up after transfers or setbacks.
- Resistance: vested interests oppose change; officers must persist through legal and political obstacles.
- Stress: disasters, protests and criticism test emotional control.
- Temptation: self-control resists bribes, favours and misuse of power.
- Courtesy: self-control lets an officer stay calm with an angry citizen.

Examples

- E. Sreedharan's steady push to finish the Konkan Railway and Delhi Metro on time despite difficult terrain and pressure.
- Countless district officials who kept vaccination drives going in remote areas during the pandemic.

Psychological insight Studies on delayed gratification, such as the "marshmallow test", suggest self-control is linked with later life outcomes, though later studies show that family background and trust also matter. Self-control can be trained through habits, routines and clear goals.

Caution Perseverance should not become stubbornness; a good officer persists in values but changes methods when evidence demands.

Conclusion Perseverance gives direction over time; self-control gives steadiness in the moment. Together they turn good intentions into public results.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Persevere over years, control in seconds."

COMMON TRAP: Do not present the marshmallow test as settled science; note the later caveats.

PEAK FACT: E. Sreedharan Konkan Railway Delhi Metro.

GS4 Q6 of 16 · 15 marks · Gandhi's seven social sins

PREDICTED · GS4-E3

Q6. Explain Gandhi's "seven social sins". Which of them do you find most relevant to governance today, and why? (250 words)

Model answer

Gandhi published a list of seven social sins in Young India in 1925. They describe failures that occur when an activity is cut off from its moral foundation.

The seven social sins

1. Politics without principles: power sought for its own sake.
2. Wealth without work: gains from speculation, corruption or exploitation.
3. Pleasure without conscience: enjoyment that harms others.
4. Knowledge without character: learning used for selfish or harmful ends.
5. Commerce without morality: profit through fraud or adulteration.
6. Science without humanity: technology that ignores human cost.
7. Worship without sacrifice: ritual without real devotion or service.

Most relevant to governance

- Politics without principles: defections for office, money power in elections and communal mobilisation weaken democracy.
- Wealth without work: corruption, rent-seeking and unearned windfalls from public contracts undermine trust.
- Science without humanity: artificial intelligence, surveillance and large projects must protect privacy and the displaced.
- Knowledge without character: highly educated officers involved in scams show that skill without integrity is dangerous.

My choice Knowledge without character is the most relevant for civil servants, because the civil service selects for knowledge but must constantly nurture character through training, role models and accountability. An officer's expertise multiplies the harm if integrity is missing.

Conclusion Gandhi's list is a moral checklist: every activity, from politics to technology, must remain tied to its human purpose.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Seven Ps without Ps": Politics without Principle, and so on; or "PWP-KCSW".
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not invent the list; it has exactly seven items, published in Young India, 1925.

GS4 Q7 of 16 · 15 marks · Kuvempu's Vishwa Manava

PREDICTED · GS4-E5 · Karnataka-specific

Q7. Explain Kuvempu's idea of "Vishwa Manava" (universal human). How is it relevant for a public servant in a diverse society? (250 words)

Model answer

Kuvempu (K.V. Puttappa), the Rashtrakavi of Karnataka and the first Kannada writer to receive the Jnanpith Award (1967), proposed the ideal of Vishwa Manava, the universal human.

The idea Kuvempu held that each newborn is a Vishwa Manava, but as it grows, society narrows it with labels of caste, religion, language and nation. The task of education and culture is to free the person again into a universal human. His "Panchamantra" for this includes:

- Manuja mata (the human religion),
- Vishwa patha (the universal path),
- Sarvodaya (welfare of all),
- Samanvaya (harmony),
- Poornadrishti (integral vision).

He also coined the inter-caste "Mantra Mangalya" simple marriage without priests and dowry, to break barriers.

Relevance for a public servant

- Impartiality: an officer must see citizens as humans first, not as members of groups.
- Social justice: his ideas oppose caste discrimination and support equal dignity.
- Harmony: in communal or linguistic tensions, the officer acts as a bridge.
- Rational outlook: Kuvempu rejected blind belief, supporting scientific temper.
- Simplicity: like Mantra Mangalya, avoiding display and waste in public life.
- Local and universal: loving Kannada while being open to the world, as in his State anthem "Jaya Bharata Jananiya Tanujate".

Conclusion Vishwa Manava asks the officer to grow beyond narrow identities. In a diverse State, this is the moral basis for fair, humane governance.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Born universal, made narrow, educate to free."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not confuse Vishwa Manava with "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam"; they are related but Kuvempu's idea is his own, with a specific Panchamantra.

GS4 Q8 of 16 · 10 marks · AI in government decisions

PREDICTED · GS4-E4 · Current affairs

Q8. What ethical concerns arise when governments use artificial intelligence to make decisions about citizens? (150 words)

Model answer

Governments increasingly use AI to detect welfare fraud, predict crime, screen applications and grade tax risks.

Ethical concerns

- Bias: systems trained on past data may repeat discrimination against certain castes, regions or genders.
- Transparency: "black box" models make it hard to explain why a pension was rejected.
- Accountability: who answers for a wrong decision, the officer, the vendor or the algorithm?
- Privacy: large databases and facial recognition risk surveillance.
- Due process: citizens may not know a machine decided, or how to appeal.
- Exclusion: errors in data can cut off rations or benefits for the poor.

Safeguards

- Human review of decisions affecting rights.
- Audits for bias and accuracy before use.
- Explanations and a right to appeal.

- Compliance with the 2023 data protection law.

AI should assist officers, not replace their judgement and responsibility.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "BTAP-DE": Bias, Transparency, Accountability, Privacy, Due process, Exclusion.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not oppose AI completely; the answer should show how to use it safely.

GS4 Q9 of 16 · 10 marks · Gifts and hospitality

PREDICTED · GS4-E2

Q9. Why do conduct rules restrict gifts and hospitality for public servants? Where should the line be drawn? (150 words)

Model answer

Why restrictions exist

- A gift creates a sense of obligation (reciprocity), even when no favour is asked.
- It can create a perception of bias, damaging public trust.
- It may be a disguised bribe, offered before or after a decision.

What the rules say AIS and State conduct codes allow small gifts from relatives and close friends on occasions such as weddings, within limits, but require reporting of gifts above set values and bar gifts from those with official dealings. Accepting any benefit as a reward for official work is a crime under the 1988 anti-corruption law.

Drawing the line

- Refuse anything from people who have business pending before you.
- Accept token courtesies (tea, a memento) only where refusal would be rude, and record them.

Small gifts can begin large obligations; the safest rule is transparency.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Gift = Grip": every gift tightens a grip.
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not say all gifts are illegal; the rules permit some with limits and reporting.

GS4 Q10 of 16 · 10 marks · Vaccine diplomacy

PREDICTED · GS4-E1

Q10. Was India's vaccine diplomacy during the COVID-19 pandemic ethically justified? (150 words)

Model answer

Under "Vaccine Maitri" (2021), India supplied COVID-19 vaccines to many countries as gifts, commercial sales and through the COVAX facility.

Arguments that it was ethical

- Global justice: rich countries hoarded doses; India helped poorer nations.
- Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam: the world as one family.
- Self-interest aligned with good: no country is safe until all are safe.
- Contractual obligations to COVAX and partners.

Arguments against

- Duty to own citizens: during the second wave in 2021, Indian citizens faced shortages, and exports were paused.
- Strategic motive: diplomacy for influence may reduce the moral weight.

Balance Duty to citizens comes first, but global cooperation is also a duty, since viruses spread across borders. Ethically sound vaccine diplomacy needs transparent allocation, planning domestic stocks first, and honouring commitments.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Maitri = friendship, but home first."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not ignore the domestic shortage of 2021; a one-sided answer loses marks.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** Vaccine Maitri launched January 2021.

GS4: 10 of 16 done. Next up: Q11, Consequences or intentions.

GS4 Q11 of 16 · 10 marks · Consequences or intentions

PREDICTED · GS4-E1

Q11. Should an action be judged by its consequences or by the intention behind it? Discuss. (150 words)

Model answer

Consequences view Consequentialism, such as utilitarianism (Bentham, Mill), judges actions by their results: the right act produces the greatest good for the greatest number.

Intention view Deontology (Kant) judges actions by the motive and the duty followed. An act is right if done from duty and if its principle could be a universal law, whatever the outcome.

Example An officer who diverts funds from a planned road to urgent flood relief may produce good results but break rules. Another who follows every rule while people suffer may have good intentions but poor results.

Balanced view

- Intentions matter for judging character and blame.
- Consequences matter for policy, which affects millions.
- The Gita's nishkama karma asks for right action with detachment from results.
- Good governance needs both: right motives, lawful means and good outcomes.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Kant counts motives; Mill counts results."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not pick one side absolutely; examiners reward a balanced, example-based answer.

GS4 Q12 of 16 · 10 marks · Antyodaya

PREDICTED · GS4-I

Q12. What does Antyodaya mean? How can it guide administrative compassion? (150 words)

Model answer

Antyodaya means "rise of the last person". The idea comes from Gandhi's reading of Ruskin's Unto This Last and was developed by Deendayal Upadhyaya. It is reflected in the Antyodaya Anna Yojana (2000), which gives the poorest households subsidised grain.

Guidance for administration

- Priority: start with the poorest, such as landless labourers, people with disabilities, widows and tribal families.
- Outreach: go to people who cannot come to offices; camps and doorstep services.
- Simple procedures: fewer documents for the most vulnerable.
- Grievance attention: the voice of the weakest should count most.
- Measuring success: judge schemes by how the last person benefits, not by averages.

Example Identifying excluded families during ration card verification and adding them proactively.

Antyodaya turns compassion into a rule of priority: serve the last first.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Antyodaya = Last first."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not credit only one person; mention its roots (Ruskin, Gandhi) and its later development.

GS4 Q13 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: drought relief list

PREDICTED · CS

Q13. Fictional case. As Deputy Commissioner, you are handling a district hit by drought. The State has announced input subsidy for farmers whose crop loss is above 33 per cent, based on a field survey. The survey team reports that 18,000 farmers qualify. A powerful local leader demands that 4,000 more names from his supporters' villages be added, though the survey shows lower crop loss there. He threatens to stage a protest and complain that you are biased. Payments must be sent within a week. (a) What ethical issues arise? (b) What will you do? (c) Justify your course of action. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Drought relief with a fixed eligibility rule, political pressure to add ineligible names, a deadline and a threat of protest.

D - Dimensions. Eligible farmers: timely relief. Excluded farmers: possible genuine grievance. Leader: political interest. Taxpayers: public money. Survey staff: credibility. Me: duty to the rule and to fairness.

R - Rules and values. State Disaster Response Fund norms for input subsidy, transparency, objectivity, accountability and courage; Article 14's promise of equal treatment.

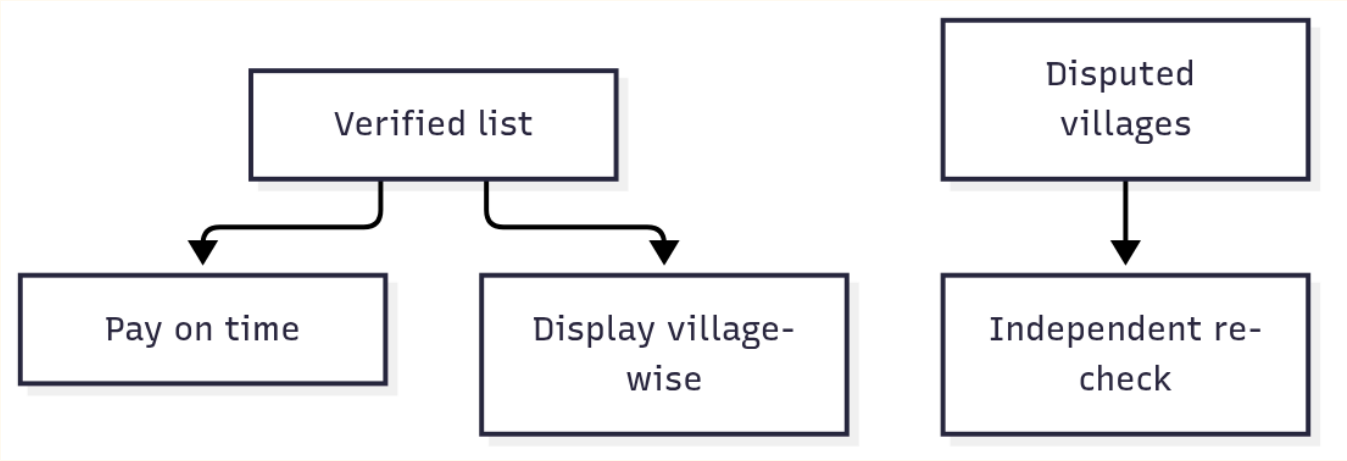
A - Options.

1. Add all 4,000 names: avoids protest but misuses funds and is unfair to others.
2. Reject the demand outright: lawful but may ignore genuine errors.
3. Pay the verified list on time, and order a quick, transparent re-check of the disputed villages: fair and responsive.

T - Take the decision. Go with option 3.

- Release payments to the 18,000 eligible farmers through direct benefit transfer on schedule.
- Display the survey results village-wise in gram panchayat offices and online.
- Form a re-verification team from a different taluk, with agriculture and revenue officials, to re-check sample plots in the disputed villages within five days, using satellite images and crop-cutting data.
- Allow farmers to file objections individually, not through the leader.
- Meet the leader, explain the rules politely and invite him to submit specific cases.
- Inform the State government and record all instructions.
- If the protest occurs, ensure peace through the police but avoid confrontation.

Justification. Paying the eligible farmers on time meets the urgent need. A transparent re-check respects the possibility of error without bowing to pressure. Public display reduces suspicion of bias. Fairness, not volume of protest, should decide public relief.



DRAW IT: Pay, display, re-check. Copy it in 30 seconds with boxes and arrows.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Pay, Display, Re-check": pay the eligible, display the list, re-check disputes.

COMMON TRAP: Do not delay payments to everyone because of a dispute about some.

GS4 Q14 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: hospital fire NOC

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q14. Fictional case. You are the Chief Fire Officer of a Karnataka district. A large private hospital applies to renew its fire safety no-objection certificate (NOC). Your inspector reports that fire exits are blocked, sprinklers in the ICU are not working, and the building has an extra floor that was not in the approved plan. The hospital owner, a prominent donor to many charities, says patients will suffer if the hospital is closed and offers to "fix things gradually". A senior official calls to ask you to issue the NOC since the hospital serves many poor patients. (a) Name the stakeholders and the ethical questions involved. (b) What will you do? (c) Justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A hospital with serious fire safety violations seeks renewal of its NOC, with pressure from the owner and a senior official.

D - Dimensions. Patients: safety and access to care. Staff: risk of fire. Owner: business and reputation. Senior official: pressure. Public: trust in safety rules. Me: legal and moral duty.

R - Rules and values. The Karnataka Fire Force Act, 1964, the National Building Code and fire safety norms; Article 21 (life and safety); integrity, courage, prudence and compassion.

A - Options.

1. Issue the NOC as requested: risks lives and makes me responsible for any fire.
2. Refuse and order immediate closure: lawful but may disrupt care for current patients.
3. Refuse the NOC, issue time-bound directions with interim safety steps, and coordinate with health authorities: safety first, with care for patients.

T - Take the decision. Go with option 3.

- Refuse the NOC in writing, listing each violation.
- Order immediate removal of blockages from exits, which can be done within hours.

- Direct repair of ICU sprinklers within a fixed short period; meanwhile, require extra fire extinguishers, trained fire wardens and fire drills.
- Bar use of the unapproved floor for patients until it is regularised and safe; refer the building violation to the local planning authority.
- Inform the District Health Officer to arrange shifting of patients if deadlines are missed.
- Reply to the senior official respectfully in writing, explaining the risks and the plan.
- Re-inspect and grant the NOC only after compliance.

Justification. Hospital fires in India have killed patients who could not escape. Safety is a non-negotiable part of care. The phased plan protects current patients while forcing compliance. Charity elsewhere cannot excuse risk here.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Exits today, sprinklers soon, NOC later."
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not close the hospital overnight without arranging care, and do not grant the NOC on promises.

GS4 Q15 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: the free app offer

PREDICTED · CS

Q15. Fictional case. You head the IT cell of a State department. A start-up offers to build and maintain a citizen grievance app free of cost for two years. It promises fast delivery. You learn that its terms allow it to store citizens' data on its own servers and use "anonymised insights" for its other products. The start-up's founder is a former classmate of your Minister. Your team is overloaded and the Minister wants the app launched in a month. (a) What ethical issues arise? (b) What should you do? (c) Justify your decision. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. A free offer of an app, with risky data terms, a possible conflict of interest, a tight deadline and an overloaded team.

D - Dimensions. Citizens: privacy and service. Department: efficiency and legal duty. Start-up: business interest. Minister: political goals and personal ties. Team: workload. Me: fair procurement and data protection.

R - Rules and values. The DPDP Act, 2023 on lawful processing and the duties of data fiduciaries; the General Financial Rules and procurement norms requiring open competition; integrity, transparency and objectivity.

A - Options.

1. Accept the offer: fast, but risks data misuse, vendor lock-in and favouritism.
2. Reject it outright: safe but delays the service and may ignore useful innovation.
3. Use a fair, open process with strict data terms: lawful and balanced.

T - Take the decision. Go with option 3.

- Brief the Minister in writing on the risks: data ownership, legal liability and conflict of interest perceptions.
- Explore existing government platforms, such as State grievance systems or open-source tools, that can be adapted quickly.
- If a vendor is needed, invite open proposals through the Government e-Marketplace or a transparent call, with the start-up free to compete.
- Require data to be stored in government or approved Indian data centres, with no secondary use, security audits and the right to the source code.
- Disclose the Minister's link to the start-up in the file.

- Set realistic milestones; launch a basic version first.

Justification. "Free" offers can carry hidden costs. Citizens' data is a public trust, and procurement must be fair. An open process protects the Minister and department from allegations while delivering the service.

> **HOW TO REMEMBER IT:** "Free is not free": check Data, Deal and Distance (conflict of interest).
>
> **COMMON TRAP:** Do not assume a free offer needs no procurement scrutiny; gifts to government also need rules.
>
> **PEAK FACT:** DPDP Act 2023 data fiduciary duties.

GS4: 15 of 16 done. Next up: Q16, Case: caste in a relief camp.

GS4 Q16 of 16 · 20 marks · Case: caste in a relief camp

PREDICTED · CS · Karnataka-specific

Q16. Fictional case. Floods have hit a Karnataka taluk where you serve as tahsildar. Relief camps are running. Volunteers report that in one village, families from a Dalit colony were not allowed into the main camp and were given food last, and some relief kits were taken by influential families twice. Local leaders say "everyone was helped" and ask you not to make it an issue as it may cause tension. Media reports are starting to appear. (a) What ethical issues arise? (b) What action will you take? (c) Justify your choices. (300 words)

Model answer

S - Situation. Caste discrimination in relief camps, duplication of relief by influential families, pressure to stay quiet and growing media attention.

D - Dimensions. Dalit families: dignity and equal relief. Other villagers: fear of tension. Influential families: misuse. Volunteers: whistle-blowers. Media: public interest. Me: duty to the law and to the vulnerable.

R - Rules and values. Article 17 ends untouchability, and the PCR law of 1955 and the Atrocities law of 1989 punish such discrimination; National Disaster Management Authority guidelines require relief without discrimination; equality, compassion, firmness and openness.

A - Options.

1. Stay quiet to avoid tension: condones discrimination and violates the law.
2. Act only against individuals: necessary but may not fix the camp system.
3. Immediate corrective action, legal action where warranted, and system changes: protects dignity and prevents repetition.

T - Take the decision. Go with option 3.

- Visit the camp at once; ensure Dalit families are admitted and served together with others.
- Assign a responsible officer to manage the camp, with a common kitchen and a register of families.
- Use a relief register linked to ration or Aadhaar details to stop duplication; recover extra kits.
- Record statements; register cases under the relevant laws if discrimination is confirmed, and inform the police and social welfare department.
- Hold a peace meeting with community leaders, stressing that relief is for all equally.
- Thank and protect the volunteers; brief the media with facts.

Justification. Disasters do not discriminate, and relief must not either. Silence would make the State complicit in untouchability. Firm, fair action and open communication can prevent tension better than cover-ups.

HOW TO REMEMBER IT: "Admit, Audit, Act, Assure."

COMMON TRAP: Do not treat discrimination as a law and order issue only; it is a constitutional violation.

RECAP: Memory lines from the last five questions. **Q12 Antyodaya:** "Antyodaya = Last first." **Q13 Case: drought relief list:** "Pay, Display, Re-check": pay the eligible, display the list, re-check disputes. **Q14 Case: hospital fire NOC:** "Exits today, sprinklers soon, NOC later." **Q15 Case: the free app offer:** "Free is not free": check Data, Deal and Distance (conflict of interest). **Q16 Case: caste in a relief camp:** "Admit, Audit, Act, Assure."

Kannada and English practice (short)

> **REVIEW:** The Kannada text in this section was written without a native-speaker check. Please have a Kannada teacher or fluent speaker read it before you treat it as a model. The English parts follow plain formal style.

Practice 1: Kannada essay (ಪ್ರಬಂಧ), about 120 words

Topic: ಜಲ ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆ (Water conservation)

Outline (ರೂಪರೇಖೆ): ಪೀಠಿಕೆ → ನೀರಿನ ಕೊರತೆ → ಕಾರಣಗಳು → ಪರಿಹಾರಗಳು → ಉಪಸಂಹಾರ

Model essay (ಮಾದರಿ ಪ್ರಬಂಧ):

ನೀರು ಜೀವನದ ಮೂಲ. ಕರ್ನಾಟಕದ ಅನೇಕ ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಗಳು ಪದೇ ಪದೇ ಬರಗಾಲವನ್ನು ಎದುರಿಸುತ್ತಿವೆ. ಅಂತರ್ಜಲ ಮಟ್ಟ ಕುಸಿಯುತ್ತಿದೆ, ಕೆರೆಗಳು ಒತ್ತುವರಿಯಾಗಿವೆ. ನಗರಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಬೇಸಿಗೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಟ್ಯಾಂಕರ್ ನೀರಿಗಾಗಿ ಜನರು ಕಾಯುತ್ತಾರೆ. ಹಳೆಯ ಕಾಲದಲ್ಲಿ ನಮ್ಮ ಪೂರ್ವಜರು ಕಲ್ಯಾಣಿಗಳು ಮತ್ತು ಕೆರೆಗಳನ್ನು ನಿರ್ಮಿಸಿ ಮಳೆನೀರನ್ನು ಸಂಗ್ರಹಿಸುತ್ತಿದ್ದರು. ಇಂದು ಮಳೆನೀರು ಕೊಯ್ಲು, ಹನಿ ನೀರಾವರಿ ಮತ್ತು ಕೆರೆಗಳ ಹೂಳೆತ್ತುವಿಕೆ ಅಗತ್ಯ. ಮನೆಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಸೋರುವ ನಲ್ಲಿಗಳನ್ನು ಸರಿಪಡಿಸುವುದು ಸಣ್ಣ ಆದರೆ ಮುಖ್ಯ ಹೆಜ್ಜೆ. ಶಾಲೆಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಮಕ್ಕಳಿಗೆ ನೀರಿನ ಮಹತ್ವ ಕಲಿಸಬೇಕು. ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಂದು ಹನಿಯೂ ಅಮೂಲ್ಯ; ಇಂದು ಉಳಿಸಿದ ನೀರು ನಾಳೆಯ ಪೀಳಿಗೆಯ ಬದುಕು.

Practice 2: Translate into Kannada (ಅನುವಾದ)

#	English	Model Kannada
1	Do not waste water.	ನೀರನ್ನು ವ್ಯರ್ಥ ಮಾಡಬೇಡಿ.
2	The office is closed on Sunday.	ಭಾನುವಾರ ಕಚೇರಿಗೆ ರಜೆ.
3	Plant a tree on your birthday.	ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹುಟ್ಟುಹಬ್ಬದಂದು ಒಂದು ಗಿಡ ನೆಡಿ.
4	Keep your Aadhaar card with you.	ನಿಮ್ಮ ಆಧಾರ್ ಕಾರ್ಡ್ ಜೊತೆಯಲ್ಲಿಡಿ.
5	Reading improves knowledge.	ಓದು ಜ್ಞಾನವನ್ನು ಹೆಚ್ಚಿಸುತ್ತದೆ.

Practice 3: English precis (reduce to one-third)

Passage (about 150 words):

In many villages, the weekly market is more than a place to buy vegetables. It is where farmers learn prices, where women sell pickles and baskets, and where news travels faster than any newspaper. Over the past decade, mobile phones and delivery apps have begun to change this. A farmer can now check prices online, and some buyers order directly from producers. Yet the market has not disappeared. People still come because they want to see, touch and bargain, and because the market is a social event where friends meet and disputes are settled. Planners who see the market only as a trading space often move it to distant sites without shade, water or toilets, and then wonder why vendors return to the roadside. A good market needs not just stalls but also space for people to gather. Technology can support such markets, but it cannot replace the trust built face to face.

Model precis (about 50 words), with title "The market that connects":

The village market is a hub for trade, prices and news. Phones and apps are changing buying, but people still value seeing, bargaining and meeting there. Planners who ignore its social role fail. Technology can help markets but cannot replace face-to-face trust.

Practice 4: Formal letter (English)

Task: Write a letter to the Executive Engineer, BESCOM, about frequent power cuts in your locality.

Model letter:

From: S. Kavya, 2nd Cross, Gandhinagar, Tumakuru, Karnataka - 500 000 To: The Executive Engineer, BESCOM Division, Tumakuru, Karnataka Date: 27 October 2026

Sir,

Subject: Frequent unscheduled power cuts in Gandhinagar

I write on behalf of the residents of Gandhinagar about repeated power cuts over the past three weeks. Supply fails four to five times a day, often for over an hour, without notice. Students preparing for examinations, small shops and an elderly resident on home oxygen support have been badly affected. Complaints to the helpline have been registered, but the problem continues.

I request you to inspect the local transformer, announce scheduled maintenance in advance and restore steady supply at the earliest. Residents are ready to share details of outage timings to help your staff.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, S. Kavya